

Tracts for the Times

John Henry Cardinal Newman

The tracts of the Oxford Movement, Newman's among them, closing with the famous Published from
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1833 to 1841.

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THE following Tracts were published with the object of contributing something towards the practical revival of doctrines, which, although held by the great divines of our Church, at present have become obsolete with the majority of her members, and are withdrawn from public view even by the more learned and orthodox few who still adhere to them. The Apostolic succession, the Holy Catholic Church, were principles of action in the minds of our predecessors of the 17th century; but, in proportion as the maintenance of the Church has been secured bylaw, her ministers have been under the temptation of leaning on an arm of flesh instead of her own divinely-provided discipline, a temptation increased by political events and arrangements which need not here be more than alluded to. A lamentable increase of sectarianism has followed; being occasioned (in addition to other more obvious causes,) first, by the cold aspect which the new Church doctrines have presented to the religious sensibilities of the mind, next to their meagreness in suggesting motives to restrain it from seeking out a more influential discipline. Doubtless obedience to the law of the land, and the careful maintenance of “decency and order,” (the topics in usage among us,) are plain duties of the Gospel, and a reasonable ground for keeping in communion with the Established Church; yet, if Providence has graciously provided for our weakness more interesting and constraining motives, it is a sin thanklessly to neglect them; just as it would be a mistake to rest the duties of temperance or justice on the mere law of natural religion, when they are mercifully sanctioned in the Gospel by the more winning authority of our Saviour Christ. Experience has shown the inefficacy of the mere injunctions of Church order, however scripturally enforced, in restraining from schism the awakened and anxious sinner; who goes to a dissenting preacher “because (as he expresses it) he gets good from him:” and though he does not stand excused in God’s sight for yielding to the temptation, surely the Ministers of the Church are not blameless if, by keeping back the more gracious and consoling truths provided for the little ones of Christ, they indirectly lead him into it. Had he been taught as a child, that the Sacraments, not preaching, are the sources of Divine Grace; that the Apostolical ministry had a virtue in it which went out over the whole Church, when sought by the prayer of faith; that fellowship with it was a gift and privilege, as well as a duty, we could not have had so many wanderers from our fold, nor so many cold hearts within it.

This instance may suggest many others of the superior *influence* of an apostolical over a mere secular method of teaching. The awakened mind knows its wants, but cannot provide for them; and in its hunger will feed upon ashes, if it cannot obtain the pure milk of the word. Methodism and Popery are in different ways the refuge of those whom the Church stints of the gifts of grace; they are the foster-mothers of abandoned children. The neglect of the daily service, the desecration of festivals, the Eucharist scantily administered, insubordination permitted in all ranks of the Church, orders and offices imperfectly developed, the want of Societies for particular religious objects, and the like deficiencies, lead the feverish mind, desirous of a vent to its feelings, and a stricter rule of life, to the smaller religious Communities, to prayer and bible meetings, and ill-advised institutions and societies, on the one hand,—on the other, to the solemn and captivating services by which Popery gains its proselytes. Moreover, the multitude of men cannot teach or guide themselves; and an injunction given them to depend on their private judgment, cruel in itself, is doubly hurtful, as throwing them on such teachers as speak daringly and promise largely, and not only aid but supersede individual exertion.

These remarks may serve as a clue, for those who care to pursue it, to the views which have led to the publication of the following Tracts. The Church of Christ was intended to cope with

human nature in all its forms, and surely the gifts vouchsafed it are adequate for that gracious purpose. There are zealous sons and servants of her English branch, who see with sorrow that she is defrauded of her full usefulness by particular theories and principles of the present age, which interfere with the execution of one portion of her commission; and while they consider that the revival of this portion of truth is especially adapted to break up existing parties in the Church, and to form instead a bond of union among all who love the Lord Jesus Christ in sincerity, they believe that nothing but these neglected doctrines, faithfully preached, will repress that extension of Popery, for which the ever multiplying divisions of the religious world are too clearly preparing the way.

OXFORD,

The Feast of All Saints, 1834.

Thoughts On The Ministerial Commission, Respectfully Addressed to the Clergy

Tract No. 1 (*Ad Clerum*)

I AM but one of yourselves,—a Presbyter; and therefore I conceal my name, lest I should take too much on myself by speaking in my own person. Yet speak I must; for the times are very evil, yet no one speaks against them.

Is not this so? Do not we “look one upon another,” yet perform nothing? Do we not all confess the peril into which the Church is come, yet sit still each in his own retirement, as if mountains and seas cut off brother from brother? Therefore suffer me, while I try to draw you forth from those pleasant retreats, which it has been our blessedness hitherto to enjoy, to contemplate the condition and prospects of our Holy Mother in a practical way; so that one and all may unlearn that idle habit, which has grown upon us, of owning the state of things to be bad, yet doing nothing to remedy it.

Consider a moment. Is it fair, is it dutiful, to suffer our Bishops to stand the brunt of the battle without doing our part to support them? Upon them comes “the care of all the Churches.” This cannot be helped: indeed it is their glory. Not one of us would wish in the least to deprive them of the duties, the toils, the responsibilities of their high Office. And, black event as it would be for the country, yet, (as far as they are concerned,) we could not wish them a more blessed termination of their course, than the spoiling of their goods, and martyrdom.

To them then we willingly and affectionately relinquish their high privileges and honours; we encroach not upon the rights of the SUCCESSORS OF THE APOSTLES; we touch not their sword and crosier. Yet surely we may be their shield-bearers in the battle without offence; and by our voice and deeds be to them what Luke and Timothy were to St. Paul.

Now then let me come at once to the subject which leads me to address you. Should the Government and Country so far forget their GOD as to cast off the Church, to deprive it of its temporal honours and substance, *on what* will you rest the claim of respect and attention which you make upon your flocks? Hitherto you have been upheld by your birth, your education, your wealth, your connexions; should these secular advantages cease, on what must CHRIST’S Ministers depend? Is not this a serious practical question? We know how miserable is the state of religious bodies not supported by the State. Look at the Dissenters on all sides of you, and you will see at once that their Ministers, depending simply upon the people, become the creatures of the people. Are you content that this should be your case? Alas! can a greater evil befall Christians, than for their teachers to be guided by them, instead of guiding? How can we “hold fast the form of sound words,” and “keep that which is committed to our trust,” if our influence is to depend simply on our popularity? Is it not our very office to *oppose* the world? can we then allow ourselves to *court* it? to preach smooth things and prophesy deceits? to make the way of life easy to the rich and indolent, and to bribe the humbler classes by excitements and strong intoxicating doctrine? Surely it must not be so;—and the question recurs, on what are we to rest our authority, when the State deserts us?

CHRIST has not left His Church without claim of its own upon the attention of men. Surely not. Hard Master He cannot be, to bid us oppose the world, yet give us no credentials for so doing. There are some who rest their divine mission on their own unsupported assertion; others, who rest it upon their popularity; others, on their success; and others, who rest it upon their temporal distinctions. This last case has, perhaps, been too much our own; I fear we have neglected the real ground on which our authority is built,—our APOSTOLICAL DESCENT.

We have been born, not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man, but of GOD. The LORD JESUS CHRIST gave His SPIRIT to His Apostles; they in turn laid their hands on those who should succeed them; and these again on others; and so the sacred gift has been handed down to our present Bishops, who have appointed us as their assistants, and in some sense representatives.

Now every one of us believes this. I know that some will at first deny they do; still they do believe it. Only, it is not sufficiently practically impressed on their minds. They *do* believe it; for it is the doctrine of the Ordination Service, which they have recognised as truth in the most solemn season of their lives. In order, then, not to prove, but to remind and impress, I entreat your attention to the words used when you were made Ministers of CHRIST'S Church.

The office of Deacon was thus committed to you: "Take thou authority to execute the office of a Deacon in the Church of GOD committed unto thee: In the name," &c.

And the priesthood thus:

"Receive the HOLY GHOST, for the office and work of a Priest, in the Church of GOD, now committed unto thee by the imposition of our hands. Whose sins thou dost forgive, they are forgiven; and whose sins thou dost retain, they are retained. And be thou a faithful dispenser of the Word of GOD, and of His Holy Sacraments: In the name," &c.

These, I say, were words spoken to us, and received by us, when we were brought nearer to GOD than at any other time of our lives. I know the grace of ordination is contained in the laying on of hands, not in any form of words;—yet in our own case, (as has ever been usual in the Church,) words of blessing have accompanied the act. Thus we have confessed before GOD our belief, that through the Bishop who ordained us, we received the HOLY GHOST, the power to bind and to loose, to administer the Sacraments, and to preach. Now *how* is he able to give these great gifts? *Whence* is his right? Are these words idle, (which would be taking GOD'S name in vain,) or do they express merely a wish, (which surely is very far below their meaning,) or do they not rather indicate that the Speaker is conveying a gift? Surely they can mean nothing short of this. But whence, I ask, his right to do so? Has he any right, except as having received the power from those who consecrated him to be a Bishop? He could not give what he had never received. It is plain then that he but *transmits*; and that the Christian Ministry is a *succession*. And if we trace back the power of ordination from hand to hand, of course we shall come to the Apostles at last. We know we do, as a plain historical fact: and therefore all we, who have been ordained Clergy, in the very form of our ordination acknowledged the doctrine of the APOSTOLICAL SUCCESSION.

And for the same reason, we must necessarily consider none to be *really* ordained who have not *thus* been ordained. For if ordination is a divine ordinance, it must be necessary; and if it is not a divine ordinance, how dare we use it? Therefore all who use it, all of *us*, must consider it necessary. As well might we pretend the Sacraments are not necessary to Salvation, while we make use of the offices of the Liturgy; for when GOD appoints means of grace, they are *the* means.

I do not see how any one can escape from this plain view of the subject, except, (as I have already hinted,) by declaring, that the words do not mean all that they say. But only reflect what a most unseemly time for random words is that, in which Ministers are set apart for their office. Do we not adopt a Liturgy, *in order to* hinder inconsiderate idle language, and shall we, in the most sacred of all services, write down, subscribe, and use again and again forms of speech, which have not been weighed, and cannot be taken strictly?

Therefore, my dear Brethren, act up to your professions. Let it not be said that you have neglected a gift; for if you have the Spirit of the Apostles on you, surely this is a great gift. "Stir

up the gift of GOD which is in you." Make much of it. Show your value of it. Keep it before your minds as an honourable badge, far higher than that secular respectability, or cultivation, or polish, or learning, or rank, which gives you a hearing with the many. Tell *them* of your gift. The times will soon drive you to do this, if you mean to be still any thing. But wait not for the times. Do not be compelled, by the world's forsaking you, to recur as if unwillingly to the high source of your authority. Speak out now, before you are forced, both as glorying in your privilege, and to ensure your rightful honour from your people. A notion has gone abroad, that they can take away your power. They think they have given and can take it away. They think it lies in the Church property, and they know that they have politically the power to confiscate that property. They have been deluded into a notion that present palpable usefulness, produceable results, acceptableness to your flocks, that these and such like are the tests of your Divine commission. Enlighten them in this matter. Exalt our Holy Fathers, the Bishops, as the Representatives of the Apostles, and the Angels of the Churches; and magnify your office, as being ordained by them to take part in their Ministry.

But, if you will not adopt my view of the subject, which I offer to you, not doubtingly, yet (I hope) respectfully, at all events, CHOOSE YOUR SIDE. To remain neuter much longer will be itself to take a part. *Choose* your side; since side you shortly must, with one or other party, even though you do nothing. Fear to be of those, whose line is decided for them by chance circumstances, and who may perchance find themselves with the enemies of CHRIST, while they think but to remove themselves from worldly politics. Such abstinence is impossible in troublous times. HE THAT IS NOT WITH ME, IS AGAINST ME, AND HE THAT GATHERETH NOT WITH ME SCATTERETH ABROAD.

[SIXTH EDITION.]

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The Catholic Church

Tract No. 2

No weapon that is formed against thee shall prosper, and every tongue that shall rise against thee in judgment THOU SHALT CONDEMN.

IT is sometimes said, that the Clergy should abstain from politics; and that, if a Minister of CHRIST is political, he is not a follower of him who said, "My kingdom is not of this world." Now there is a sense in which this is true, but, as it is commonly taken, it is very false.

It is true that the mere affairs of this world should not engage a Clergyman; but it is absurd to say that the affairs of this world should not at all engage his attention. If so, this world is not a preparation for another. Are we to speak when individuals sin, and not when a nation, which is but a collection of individuals? Must we speak to the poor, but not to the rich and powerful? In vain does St. James warn us against having the faith of our LORD JESUS CHRIST with respect of persons. In vain does the Prophet declare to us the word of the LORD, that if the watchmen of Israel "speak not to warn the wicked from his way," "his blood will be required at the watchman's hand."

Complete our LORD'S declaration concerning the nature of His kingdom, and you will see it is not at all inconsistent with the duty of our active and zealous interference in matters of this world. "If My kingdom were of this world," He says, "*then would My servants fight.*"—Here He has vouchsafed so to explain Himself, that there is no room for misunderstanding His meaning. No one contends that His ministers ought to use the weapons of a carnal warfare; but surely to protest, to warn, to threaten, to excommunicate, are not such weapons. Let us not be scared from a plain duty, by the mere force of a misapplied text. There is an unexceptionable sense in which a clergyman may, nay, must be *political*. And above all, when the Nation interferes with the rights and possessions of the Church, it can with even less grace complain of the Church interfering with the Nation.

With this introduction let me call your attention to what seems a most dangerous infringement on our rights, on the part of the State. The Legislature has lately taken upon itself to remodel the dioceses of Ireland; a proceeding which involves the appointment of certain Bishops over certain Clergy, and of certain clergy under certain Bishops, without the Church being consulted in the matter. I do not say whether or not harm will follow from this particular act with reference to Ireland; but consider whether it be not in itself an interference with things spiritual.

Are we content to be accounted the mere creation of the State, as schoolmasters and teachers may be, or soldiers, or magistrates, or other public officers? Did the State make us? can it unmake us? can it send out missionaries? can it arrange dioceses? Surely all these are spiritual functions; and Laymen may as well set about preaching, and consecrating the LORD'S Supper, as assume these. I do not say the guilt is equal; but that, if the latter is guilt, the former is. Would St. Paul, with his good will, have suffered the Roman power to appoint Timothy, Bishop of Miletus, as well as of Ephesus? Would Timothy at such a bidding have undertaken the charge? Is not the notion of such an order, such an obedience, absurd? Yet has it not been realized in what has lately happened? For in what is the English state at present different from the Roman formerly? Neither can be accounted members of the Church of CHRIST. No one can say the British Legislature is in our communion, or that its members are necessarily even Christians. What pretence then has it for not merely advising, but superseding the Ecclesiastical power?

Bear with me, while I express my fear, that we do not, as much as we ought, consider the force of that article of our Belief, "The One Catholic and Apostolic Church." This is a tenet so important

as to have been in the Creed from the beginning. It is mentioned there as a *fact*, and a fact *to be believed*, and therefore practical. Now what do we conceive is meant by it? As people vaguely take it in the present day, it seems only an assertion that there is a number of sincere Christians scattered through the world. But is not this a truism? who doubts it? who can deny that there are people in various places who are sincere believers? what comes of this? how is it important? why should it be placed as an article of faith, after the belief in the HOLY GHOST? Doubtless the only true and satisfactory meaning is that which our Divines have ever taken, that there is on earth an existing Society, Apostolic as founded by the Apostles, Catholic because it spreads its branches in every place; i.e. the Church Visible with its Bishops, Priests, and Deacons. And this surely is a most important doctrine; for what can be better news to the bulk of mankind than to be told that CHRIST when He ascended, did not leave us orphans, but appointed representatives of Himself to the end of time?

"The necessity of believing the Holy Catholic Church," says Bishop Pearson in his Exposition of the Creed, "appeareth first in this, that CHRIST hath appointed it as the only way to eternal life ... CHRIST never appointed two ways to heaven, nor did He build a Church to save some, and make another institution for other men's salvation. There is none other name under heaven given among men whereby we must be saved, but the name of JESUS; and that name is no otherwise given under heaven than in the Church," "This is the congregation of those persons here on earth which shall hereafter meet in heaven ... There is a necessity of believing the Catholic Church, because except a man be of that he can be of none. Whatsoever Church pretendeth to a new beginning, pretendeth at the same time to a new Churchdom, and whatsoever is so new is none." This indeed is the unanimous opinion of our divines, that, as the Sacraments, so Communion with the Church, is "generally necessary to salvation," in the case of those who can obtain it.

If then we express our belief in the existence of One Church on earth from CHRIST'S coming to the end of all things, if there is a promise it shall continue, and if it is our duty to do our part in our generation towards its continuance, how can we with a safe conscience countenance the interference of the Nation in its concerns? Does not such interference tend to destroy it? Would it not destroy it, if consistently followed up? Now, may we sit still and keep silence, when efforts are making to break up, or at least materially to weaken that Ecclesiastical Body which we know is intended to last while the world endures, and the safety of which is committed to our keeping in our day? How shall we answer for it, if we transmit that Ordinance of GOD less entire than it came to us?

Now what am I calling on you to do? You cannot help what has been done in Ireland; but you may protest against it. You may as a duty protest against it in public and private; you may keep a jealous watch on the proceedings of the Nation, lest a second act of the same kind be attempted. You may keep it before you as a desirable object that the Irish Church should at some future day meet in Synod and protest herself against what has been done; and then proceed to establish or rescind the State injunction, as may be thought expedient.

I know it is too much the fashion of the times to think any earnestness for ecclesiastical rights unseasonable and absurd, as if it were the feeling of those who live among books and not in the world. But it is our *duty* to live among books, especially to live by ONE BOOK, and a very old one; and therein we are enjoined to "keep that good thing which is committed unto us," to "neglect not our gift." And when men talk, as they sometimes do, as if in opposing them we were standing on technical difficulties instead of welcoming great and extensive benefits which would be the result of their measures, I would ask them, (letting alone the question of their beneficial nature, which

is a question,) whether this is not being wise above that is written, whether it is not doing evil that good may come. We cannot know the effects which will follow certain alterations; but we can decide that the means by which it is proposed to attain them are unprecedented and disrespectful to the Church. And when men say, "*the day is past* for stickling about ecclesiastical rights," let them see to it, lest they use substantially the same arguments to maintain their position as those who say, "The day is past for being a Christian."

Lastly, is it not plain that by showing a bold front and defending the rights of the Church, we are taking the only course which can make us respected? Yielding will not persuade our enemies to desist from their efforts to destroy us root and branch. We cannot hope by giving something to keep the rest. Of this surely we have had of late years sufficient experience. But by resisting strenuously, and contemplating and providing against the worst, we may actually prevent the very evils we fear. To prepare for persecution may be the way to avert it.

[FOURTH EDITION.]

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Thoughts Respectfully Addressed to the Clergy On Alterations in the Liturgy

Tract No. 3

ATTEMPTS are making to get the Liturgy altered. My dear Brethren, I beseech you, consider with me, whether you ought not to resist the alteration of even one jot or tittle of it. Though you would in your own private judgments wish to have this or that phrase or arrangement amended, is this a time to concede one tittle?

Why do I say this? because, though most of you would wish some immaterial points altered, yet not many of you agree in those points, and not many of you agree what is and what is not immaterial. If all your respective emendations are taken, the alterations in the Services will be extensive; and though each will gain something he wishes, he will lose more from those alterations which he did not wish. Tell me, are the present imperfections (as they seem to each) of such a nature, and so many, that their removal will compensate for the recasting of much which each thinks to be no imperfection, or rather an excellence?

There are persons who wish the Marriage Service emended; there are others who would be indignant at the changes proposed. There are some who wish the Consecration Prayer in the Holy Sacrament to be what it was in King Edward's first book; there are others who think this would be an approach to Popery. There are some who wish the imprecatory Psalms omitted; there are others who would lament this omission as savouring of the shallow and detestable liberalism of the day. There are some who wish the Services shortened; there are others who think we should have far more Services, and more frequent attendance at public worship than we have.

How few would be pleased by *any given* alterations; and how many pained!

But once begin altering, and there will be no reason or justice in stopping, till the criticisms of all parties are satisfied. Thus, will not the Liturgy be in the evil case described in the well-known story, of the picture subjected by the artist to the observations of passers-by? And, even to speak at present of comparatively immaterial alterations, I mean such as do not infringe upon the doctrines of the Prayer Book, will not it even with these be a changed book, and will not that new book be for certain an inconsistent one, the alterations being made, not on principle, but upon chance objections urged from various quarters?

But this is not all. A taste for criticism grows upon the mind. When we begin to examine and take to pieces, our judgment becomes perplexed, and our feelings unsettled. I do not know whether others feel this to the same extent, but for myself, I confess there are few parts of the Service that I could not disturb myself about, and feel fastidious at, if I allowed my mind in this abuse of reason. First, e.g. I might object to the opening sentences; "they are not evangelical enough; CHRIST is not mentioned in them; they are principally from the Old Testament." Then I should criticise the exhortation, as having too many words, and as antiquated in style. I might find it hard to speak against the Confession; but "the Absolution," it might be said, "is not strong enough; it is a mere declaration, not an announcement of pardon to those who have confessed." And so on.

Now I think this unsettling of the mind a frightful thing; both to ourselves, and more so to our flocks. They have long regarded the Prayer Book with reverence as the stay of their faith and devotion. The weaker sort it will make sceptical; the better it will offend and pain. Take, e.g. an alteration which some have offered in the Creed, to omit or otherwise word the clause, "He descended into *hell*." Is it no comfort for mourners to be told that CHRIST Himself has been in that unseen state, or Paradise, which is the allotted place of sojourn for departed spirits? Is it not very

easy to explain the ambiguous word, is it any great harm if it is misunderstood, and is it not very difficult to find any substitute for it in harmony with the composition of the Creed? I suspect we should find the best men in the number of those who would retain it as it is. On the other hand, will not the unstable learn from us a habit of criticising what they should never think of but as a divine voice supplied by the Church for their need?

But as regards ourselves, the Clergy, what will be the effect of this temper of innovation in us? We have the power to bring about changes in the Liturgy; shall we not exert it? have we any security, if we once begin, that we shall ever end? Shall not we pass from non-essentials to essentials? And then, on looking back after the mischief is done, what excuse shall we be able to make for ourselves for having encouraged such proceedings at first? Were there grievous errors in the Prayer Book, something might be said for beginning, but who can point out any? cannot we very well *bear* things as they are? does any part of it seriously disquiet us? no—we have before now freely given our testimony to its accordance with Scripture.

But it may be said that “we must conciliate an outcry which is made; that some alteration is demanded.” By whom? no one can tell who cries, or who can be conciliated. Some of the laity, I suppose. Now consider this carefully. Who are these lay persons? Are they serious men, and are their consciences involuntarily hurt by the things they wish altered? Are they not rather the men you meet in company, worldly men, with little personal religion, of lax conversation and lax professed principles, who sometimes perhaps come to Church, and then are wearied and disgusted? Is it not so? You have been dining, perhaps, with a wealthy neighbour, or fall in with this great Statesman, or that noble Land-holder, who considers the Church two centuries behind the world, and expresses to you wonder that its enlightened members do nothing to improve it. And then you get ashamed, and are betrayed into admissions which sober reason disapproves. You consider, too, that it is a great pity so estimable or so influential a man should be disaffected to the Church; and you go away with a vague notion that something must be done to conciliate such persons. Is this to bear about you the solemn office of a GUIDE and TEACHER in Israel, or to *follow a lead*?

But consider what are the concessions which would conciliate such men. Would immaterial alterations? Do you really think they care one jot about the verbal or other changes which some recommend, and others are disposed to grant? whether “the unseen state” is substituted for “hell,” “condemnation” for “damnation,” or the order of Sunday Lessons is remodeled? No;—they dislike the *doctrine* of the Liturgy. These men of the world do not like the anathemas of the Athanasian Creed, and other such peculiarities of our Services. But even were the alterations, which would please them, small, are they the persons whom it is of use, whom it is becoming to conciliate by going out of our way?

I need not go on to speak against doctrinal alterations, because most thinking men are sufficiently averse to them. But, I earnestly beg you to consider whether we must not come to them if we once begin. For by altering immaterials, we merely *raise* without *gratifying* the desire of correcting; we excite the craving, but withhold the food. And it should be observed, that the changes called immaterial often contain in themselves the germ of some principle, of which they are thus the introduction:—e.g. If we were to leave out the imprecatory Psalms, we certainly countenance the notion of the day, that love and love only is in the Gospel the character of ALMIGHTY GOD and the duty of regenerate man; whereas that Gospel, rightly understood, shows His Infinite Holiness and Justice as well as His Infinite Love; and it enjoins on men the duties of zeal towards Him, hatred of sin, and separation from sinners, as well as that of kindness and charity.

To the above observations it may be answered, that changes have formerly been made in the

Services without leading to the issue I am predicting now; and therefore they may be safely made again. But, waving all other remarks in answer to this argument, is not this enough, viz, that there *is* peril? No one will deny that the rage of the day is for concession. Have we not already granted (political) points, without stopping the course of innovation? This is a fact. Now, is it worth while even to risk fearful changes merely to gain petty improvements, allowing those which are proposed to be such?

We know not what is to come upon us; but the writer for one will try so to acquit himself now, that if any irremediable calamity befalls the Church, he may not have to vex himself with the recollections of silence on his part and indifference, when he might have been up and alive. There was a time when he, as well as others, might feel the wish, or rather the temptation, of steering a middle course between parties; but if so, a more close attention to passing events has cured his infirmity. In a day like this there are but two sides, zeal and persecution, the Church and the world; and those who attempt to occupy the ground between them, at best will lose their labour, but probably will be drawn back to the latter. Be practical, I respectfully urge you; do not attempt impossibilities; sail not as if in pleasure boats upon a troubled sea. Not a word falls to the ground, in a time like this. Speculations about ecclesiastical improvements which might be innocent at other times, have a strength of mischief now. They are realized before he who utters them understands that he has committed himself.

Be prepared then for petitioning against any alterations in the Prayer Book which may be proposed. And, should you see that our Fathers the Bishops seem to countenance them, petition still. Petition *them*. They will thank you for such a proceeding. *They do not wish these alterations*; but how can they resist them without the support of their Clergy? They consent to them, (if they do,) partly from the notion that they are thus pleasing you. Undeceive them. They will be rejoiced to hear that you are as unwilling to receive them as they are. However, if after all there be persons determined to allow some alterations, then let them quickly make up their minds *how far* they will go. They think it easier to draw the line elsewhere, than as things now exist. Let them point out the limit of their concessions now; and let them keep to it then; and, (if they can do this,) I will say that, though they are not as wise as they might have been, they are at least firm, and have at last come right.

THE BURIAL SERVICE

WE hear many complaints about the Burial Service, as unsuitable for the use for which it was intended. It expresses a hope, that the person departed, over whom it is read, will be saved; and this is said to be dangerous when expressed about all who are called Christians, as leading the laity to low views of the spiritual attainments necessary for salvation; and distressing the Clergy who have to read it.

Now I do not deny, I frankly own, it is sometimes distressing to use the Service; but this it must ever be in the nature of things; wherever you draw the line. Do you pretend you can discriminate the wheat from the tares? of course not.

It is often distressing to use this Service, because it is often distressing to think of the dead at all; not that you are without hope, but because you have fear also.

How many are there whom you know well enough to dare to give any judgment about? Is a Clergyman only to express a hope where *he* has grounds for having it? Are not the feelings of relatives to be considered? And may there not be a difference of judgments? I may hope more, another less. If each is to use the precise words which suit his own judgment, then we can have no words at all.

But it may be said, “every thing of a *personal* nature may be left out from the Service.” And do you really wish this? Is this the way in which your flock will wish their lost friends to be treated? a cold “edification,” but no affectionate valediction to the departed? Why not pursue this course of (supposed) improvement, and advocate the omission of the Service altogether.

Are we to have no kind and religious thoughts over the good, lest we should include the bad?

But it will be said, that, at least we ought not to read the Service over the flagrantly wicked; over those who are a scandal to religion. But this is a very different position. I agree with it entirely. Of course we should not do so, and truly the Church never meant we should. She never wished we should profess our hope of the salvation of habitual drunkards and swearers, open sinners, blasphemers, and the like; not as daring to despair of their salvation, but thinking it unseemly to honour their memory. Though the Church is not endowed with a power of absolute judgment upon individuals, yet she is directed to decide according to external indications, in order to hold up the *rules* of GOD’S governance, and afford a type of it, and an assistance towards the realizing it. As she denies to the scandalously wicked the LORD’S Supper, so does she deprive them of her other privileges.

The Church, I say, does not bid us read the Service over open sinners. Hear her own words introducing the Service. “The office ensuing is not to be used for any that die unbaptized, or excommunicate, or have laid violent hands upon themselves.” There is no room to doubt *whom* she meant to be excommunicated, open sinners. Those therefore who are pained at the general use of the Service, should rather strive to restore the practice of excommunication, than to alter the words used in the Service. Surely, if we do not this, we are clearly defrauding the religious, for the sake of keeping close to the wicked.

Here we see the common course of things in the world. We omit a duty. In consequence our services become inconsistent. Instead of retracing our steps we alter the Service. What is this but, as it were, to sin upon principle? While we keep to our principles, our sins are inconsistencies; at length, sensitive of the absurdity which inconsistency involves, we accommodate our professions to our practice. This is ever the way of the world; but it should not be the way of the church.

I will join heart and hand with any who will struggle for a restoration of that “godly discipline,” the restoration of which our Church publicly professes she considers desirable; but GOD forbid any one should so depart from her spirit, as to mould her formularies to fit the case of deliberate sinners! And is not this what we are plainly doing, if we alter the Burial Service as proposed? we are recognizing the right of men to receive Christian Burial, about whom we do not like to express a hope. Why should they have Christian burial at all?

It will be said that the restoration of the practice of Excommunication is impracticable; and that therefore the other alternative must be taken, as the only one open to us. Of course it is impossible, if no one attempts to restore it; but if all willed it, how would it be impossible; and if no one stirs because he thinks no one else will, he is arguing in a circle.

But, after all, what have we to do with probabilities and prospects in matters of plain duty? Were a man the only member of the Church who felt it a duty to return to the Ancient Discipline, yet a duty is a duty, though he be alone. It is one of the great sins of our times to look to consequences in matters of plain duty. Is not this such a case? If not, prove that it is not; but do not argue from consequences.

In the mean while I offer the following texts in evidence of the duty.

Matth. xviii. 15-17. Rom. xvi. 17. 1 Cor. v. 7-13. 2 Thess. iii. 6, 14, 15. 2 Tim. iii. 5. Tit. iii. 10, 11. 2 John 10, 11.

THE PRINCIPLE OF UNITY

Testimony of St. Clement, the associate of St. Paul, (Phil. iv. 3.) to the Apostolical Succession.

The Apostles knew, through our LORD JESUS CHRIST, that strife would arise for the Episcopate. Wherefore having received an accurate foreknowledge, they appointed the men I before mentioned, and have given an orderly succession, that on their death other approved men might receive in turn their office. Ep. i. 44.

Testimony of St. Ignatius, the friend of St. Peter, to Episcopacy.

Your celebrated Presbytery, worthy of GOD, is as closely knit to the Bishop, as the strings to a harp, and so by means of your unanimity and concordant love JESUS CHRIST is sung. Eph. 4.

There are who profess to acknowledge a Bishop, but do every thing without him. Such men appear to lack a clear conscience. Magn. 4.

He for whom I am bound is my witness that I have not learned this doctrine from mortal man. The Spirit proclaimed to me these words: "Without the Bishop do nothing." Phil. 7.

With these and other such strong passages in the Apostolical Fathers, how can we permit ourselves in our present *practical* disregard of the Episcopal Authority? Are not we apt to obey only so far as the law obliges us? Do we support the Bishop, and strive to move all together with him as our bond of union and head; or is not our every-day conduct as if, except with respect to certain periodical forms and customs, we were each independent in his own parish?

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The Present Obligation of Primitive Practice

Tract No. 6 (*Ad Populum*)

WHEN we look around upon the present state of the Christian Church, and then turning to ecclesiastical history acquaint ourselves with its primitive form and condition, the difference between them so strongly acts upon the imagination, that we are tempted to think, that to base our conduct now on the principles acknowledged then, is but theoretical and idle. We seem to perceive, as clear as day, that as a Primitive Church had its own particular discipline and political character, so have we ours; and that to attempt to revive what is past, is as absurd as to seek to raise what is literally dead. Perhaps we even go on to maintain, that the constitution of the Church, as well as its actual course of acting, is different from what it was; that Episcopacy now is in no sense what it used to be; that our Bishops are the same as the Primitive Bishops only in name; and that the notion of an Apostolical Succession is “a fond thing.” I do not wish to undervalue the temptation, which leads to this view of Church matters; it is the temptation of sight to overcome faith, and of course not a slight one.

But the following reflection on the history of the Jewish Church may perhaps be considered to throw light on our present duties.

1. Consider how exact are the injunctions of Moses to his people. He ends them thus: “These are the words of the covenant which the LORD commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the land of Moab, beside the covenant which He made with them in Horeb . . . Keep therefore the words of this covenant, and do them, that ye may prosper in all that ye do . . . Neither with you only do I make this covenant and this oath; but with him that standeth here this day before the LORD our GOD, and also with him that is not here with us this day.” Deut. xxix.

2. Next, survey the history of the chosen people for the several first centuries after taking possession of Canaan. The exactness of Moses was unavailing. Can a greater contrast be conceived than the commands and promises of the Pentateuch, and the history of the Judges? “Every man did that which was right in his own eyes.” Judges xvii. 6.

Samuel attempts a reformation on the basis of the Mosaic Law; but the effort ultimately fails, as being apparently against the stream of opinion and feeling then prevalent. The times do not allow of it. Again, contrast the opulent and luxurious age of Solomon, though the covenant was then openly acknowledged and outwardly accepted more fully than at any other time, with the vision of simple piety and plain straightforward obedience, which is the scope of the Mosaic Law. Lastly, contemplate the state of the Jews after their return from the captivity; when their external political relations were so new, the internal principle of their government so secular, GOD’S arm apparently so far removed. This state of things went on for centuries. Who would suppose that the Jewish Law was binding in all its primitive strictness at the age when CHRIST appeared? Who would not say that length of time had destroyed the obligation of a projected system, which had as yet never been realized?

Consider, too, the impossible nature (so to say) of some of its injunctions. An infidel historian somewhere asks scoffingly, whether “the ruinous law which required all the males of the chosen people to go up to Jerusalem three times a year, was ever observed in its strictness.” The same question may be asked concerning the observance of the Sabbatical year;—to which but a faint allusion, if that, is made in the books of Scripture subsequent to the Pentateuch.

3. And now, with these thoughts before us, reflect upon our SAVIOUR’S conduct. He set about to fulfil the Law in its strictness, just as if He had lived in the generation next to Moses. The practice of others, the course of the world, was nothing to Him; He received and He obeyed. It is not

necessary to draw out the evidence of this in detail. Consider merely His emphatic words in the beginning of Matt. xxiii. concerning those, whom as individuals He was fearfully condemning. "The Scribes and Pharisees sit in Moses' seat: all therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do."—Again, reflect upon the praise bestowed upon Zacharias and his wife, that "they were both righteous before GOD, walking in all the commandments and ordinances of the LORD blameless."—And upon the conduct of the Apostles.

Surely these remarkable facts impress upon us the necessity of going to the Apostles, and not to the teachers and oracles of the present world, for the knowledge of our duty, as individuals and as members of the Christian Church. It is no argument against a practice being right, that it is neglected; rather we are warned against going the broad way of the multitude of men.

Now is there any doubt in our minds, as to the feelings of the Primitive Church regarding the doctrine of the Apostolical Succession? Did not the Apostles observe, even in an age of miracles, the ceremony of Imposition of Hands? And are not we bound, not merely to acquiesce in, but zealously to maintain and inculcate the discipline which they established?

The only objection which can be made to this view of our duty, is, that the injunction to obey strictly is *not* precisely given to us, as it was in the instance of the Mosaic Law. But is not the real state of the case merely this; that the Gospel appeals rather to our love and faith, our divinely illuminated reason, and the free principle of obedience, than to the mere letter of its injunctions? And does not the conduct of the Jews just prove to us, that, *though* the commands of CHRIST were put before us ever so precisely, yet there would not be found in any extended course of history a more exact attention to them, than there is now; that the difficulty of resisting the influence, which the world's actual proceedings exert upon our imagination, would be just as great as we find it at present?

A SIN OF THE CHURCH

Remember from whence thou art fallen, and repent, and do thy first works; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will remove thy candlestick out of his place, except thou repent.

The following extract is from Bingham, *Antiq.* xv. 9.

In the primitive ages, it was both the rule and practice of all in general, both Clergy and Laity, to receive the Communion every LORD'S day ... As often as they met together for Divine Service on the LORD'S day, they were obliged to receive the Eucharist under pain of Excommunication ... And if we run over the whole history of the three first ages, we shall find this to have been the Church's constant practice ... We are assured farther, that in some places they received the Communion every day.

Is there any one who will deny, that the Primitive Church is the best expounder in this matter of our SAVIOUR'S will as conveyed through His Apostles?

Can a learned Church, such as the English, plead ignorance of His will thus ascertained?

Do we fulfil it?

Is not the regret and concern of pious and learned writers among us, such as Bingham, at our neglect of it, upon record?

And is it not written, "THAT SERVANT WHICH KNEW HIS LORD'S WILL, AND PREPARED NOT HIMSELF, NEITHER DID ACCORDING TO HIS WILL, SHALL BE BEATEN WITH MANY STRIPES?"

And putting aside this disobedience, can we wonder, that faith and love wax cold, when we so seldom partake of the MEANS, mercifully vouchsafed to us, of communion with our LORD and

SAVIOUR?

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The Episcopal Church Apostolical

Tract No. 7

THERE are many persons at the present day, who, from not having turned their minds to the subject, think they are Churchmen in the sense in which the early Christians were, merely because they are Episcopalians. The extent of their Churchmanship is, to consider that Episcopacy is the best form of Ecclesiastical Polity; and, again, that it originated with the Apostles. I am far from implying, that to go thus far is nothing; or is not an evidence (for it is,) of a reverent and sober temper of mind; still the view is defective. It is defective, because the expediency of a system, though a very cogent, is not the highest line of argument that may be taken in its defence: and because an opponent may deny the fact of the Apostolicity of Episcopacy, and so involve its maintainer in an argument. Doubtless the more clear and simple principle for a Churchman to hold, is that of a *Ministerial Succession*; which is undeniable as a fact, while it is most reasonable as a doctrine, and sufficiently countenanced in Scripture for its practical reception. Of this, Episcopacy, i.e. *Superintendence*, is but an accident; though, for the sake of conciseness, it is often spoken of by us as synonymous with it. It shall be the object of the following Tract to insist upon this higher characteristic of our Church.

My position then is this;—that the Apostles appointed successors to their ministerial office, and the latter in turn appointed others, and so on to the present day;—and further, that the Apostles and their Successors have in every age committed portions of their power and authority to others, who thus become their delegates, and in a measure their representatives, and are called Priests and Deacons. The result is an Episcopal system, *because* of the practice of delegation; but we may conceive their keeping their powers altogether to themselves, and in the same proportion in which this was done would the Church polity cease to be Episcopalian. We may conceive the Order of Apostolic Vicars (so to call it,) increased, till one of them was placed in every village, and took the office of parish Priest. I do not say such a measure would be justifiable or pious;—doubtless it would be a departure from the rule of antiquity—but it is conceivable; and it is useful to conceive it, in order to form a clear notion of the Essence of the Church System, and the defective state of those Christian Societies which are separate from the Church Catholic. It is a common answer made to those who are called High Churchmen, to say, that, “if GOD had intended the *form* of Church Government to be of great consequence, He would have worded His will in this matter more clearly in Scripture.” Now enough has already been said to show the irrelevancy of such a remark. We need not deny to the Church the abstract right, (however we may question the propriety,) of altering its own constitution. It is not merely *because* Episcopacy is a *better or more scriptural form* than Presbyterianism, (true as this may be in itself,) that Episcopalians are right, and Presbyterians are wrong; but because the Presbyterian Ministers have assumed a power, which was never intrusted to them. They have presumed to exercise the power of ordination, and to perpetuate a succession of ministers, without having received a commission to do so. This is the plain fact that condemns them; and is a standing condemnation, from which they cannot escape, except by artifices of argument, which will serve equally to protect the self-authorized teacher of religion. If *they* may ordain without being sent to do so, *others* may teach and preach without being sent. They hold a middle position, which is untenable as destroying itself; for if Christians can do without Bishops (i.e. Commissioned Ordainers), they may do without Commissioned Ministers (i.e. the Priests and Deacons). If an imposition of hands is necessary to convey one gift, why should it not be to convey another?

1. As to the *fact* of the Apostolical Succession, i.e. that our present Bishops are the heirs and representatives of the Apostles by successive transmission of the prerogative of being so, this is

too notorious to require proof. Every link in the chain is known, from St. Peter to our present Metropolitans. Here then I only ask, looking at this plain fact by itself, is there not something of a divine providence in it? can we conceive that this Succession has been preserved, all over the world, amid many revolutions, through many centuries, *for nothing*? Is it wise or pious to despise or neglect a gift thus transmitted to us in matter of fact, even if Scripture did not touch upon the subject?

2. Next, consider how *natural* is the doctrine of a succession. When an individual comes to me, claiming to speak in the name of the Most High, it is natural to ask him for his authority. If he replies, that we are all bound to instruct each other, this reply is intelligible, but in the very form of it excludes the notion of a ministerial order, i.e. a class of persons set apart *from* others for religious offices. If he appeals to some miraculous gift, this too is intelligible, and only unsatisfactory when the alleged gift is proved to be a fiction. No other answer can be given except a reference to some person, who has given him license to exercise ministerial functions; then follows the question, *how* that individual gained his authority to do so. In the case of the Catholic Church, the person referred to, i.e. the Bishop, has received it from a predecessor, and he from another, and so on, till we arrive at the Apostles themselves, and thence our LORD and. SAVIOUR. It is superfluous to dwell on so plain a principle, which in matters of this world we act upon daily.

3. Lastly, the *argument from Scripture* is surely quite clear to those who honestly wish direction for *practice*. CHRIST promised He should be with His Apostles always, as ministers of His religion, even unto the end of the world. In one sense the Apostles were to be alive till He came again; but they all died at the natural time. Does it not follow, that there are those now alive who represent them? Now who were the most probable representatives of them in the generation next their death? They surely, whom they had ordained to succeed them in the ministerial work. If any persons could be said to have CHRIST'S power and presence, and the gifts of ruling and ordaining, of teaching, of binding and loosing, (and comparing together the various Scriptures on the subject, all these seem included in His promise to be with the Church always,) surely those, on whom the Apostles laid their hands, were they. And so in the next age, if any were representatives of the first representatives, they must be the next generation of Bishops, and so on. Nor does it materially alter the argument, though we suppose the blessing upon Ministerial Offices made, not to the Apostles, but to the whole body of Disciples; i.e. the Church. For, even if it be the Church that has the power of ordination committed to it, still it exercises it through the Bishops as its organs; and the question recurs, *how* has the Presbytery in this or that country obtained the power? The Church certainly has from the first committed it to the Bishops, and as never resumed it; and the Bishops have no where committed it to the Presbytery, who therefore cannot be in possession of it.

However, it is merely for argument sake that I make this allowance, as to the meaning of the text in Matt. xxviii.; for our LORD'S promise of His presence "unto the end of the world," was made to the Apostles, *by themselves*. At the same time, let it be observed what force is added to the argument for the Apostolical Succession, by the acknowledged existence in Scripture of the doctrine of a standing Church, or permanent Body Corporate for spiritual purposes. For, if Scripture has formed all Christians into one continuous community through all ages, (which I do not here prove,) it is but according to the same analogy, that the Ministerial Office should be vested in an order, propagated from age to age, on the principle of Succession. And, if we proceed to considerations of utility and expedience, it is plain that, according to our notions, it is more necessary that a Minister should be perpetuated by a fixed law, than that the community of Christians should be, which can scarcely be considered to be vested with any powers such as to require the visible authority which a Succession

supplies.

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The Gospel a Law of Liberty

Tract No. 8

IT is a matter of surprise to some persons, that the ecclesiastical system under which we find ourselves, is so faintly enjoined on us in Scripture. One very sufficient explanation of the fact will be found in considering that the Bible is not intended to teach us matters of *discipline* so much as matters of *faith*; i.e. those doctrines, the reception of which are necessary to salvation. But another reason may be suggested, which is well worth our attentive consideration.

The Gospel is a Law of *Liberty*. We are treated as sons, not as servants; not subjected to a code of formal commands, but addressed as those who *love* GOD, and *wish* to please Him. When a man gives orders to those whom he thinks will mistake him, or are perverse, he speaks pointedly and explicitly; but when he gives directions to friends, he will trust much to their knowledge of his feelings and wishes, he leaves much to their discretion, and tells them not so much what he would have done in detail, as what are the objects he would have accomplished. Now this is the way CHRIST has spoken to us under the New Covenant; and apparently with this reason, to *try* us, whether or not we really love Him as our LORD and SAVIOUR.

Accordingly, there is no part, perhaps, of the ecclesiastical system, which is not faintly traced in Scripture, and no part which is much more than faintly traced. The question which a reverend and affectionate faith will ask, is, “what is *most likely* to please CHRIST?” And this is just the question that obtains an answer in Scripture; which contains just so much as *intimations* of what is most likely to please Him. Of course different minds will differ as to the degree of clearness with which this or that practice is enjoined, yet I think no one will consider the state of the case, as I have put it, exaggerated on the whole.

Many duties are intimated to us by example, not by precept—many are implied merely—others can only be inferred from a comparison of passages—and others perhaps are contained only in the Jewish Law. I will mention some specimens to assist the reflection of the reader.

The early Christians were remarkable for keeping to the Apostles’ *fellowship*. Who are *more likely* to stand in the Apostles’ place since their death, than that line of Bishops which they themselves began? for that the Apostles *were* in some sense or other to remain on earth to the end of all things, is plain from the text, “Lo, I am with you always,” &c.

St. Paul set Timothy over the Church at Ephesus, and Titus over the Churches of Crete; i.e. as Bishops; therefore it is *safer* to have Bishops now, it is more likely to be pleasing to Him who has loved us, and bids us in turn love Him with the heart, not with formal service.

Our LORD committed the Administration of the LORD’S SUPPER to *His Apostles*: “Do THIS in remembrance of Me;”—therefore the Church has ever continued it in the hands of their Successors, and the delegates of these.

From CHRIST’S words, “Suffer the little children,” &c. and from His blessing them, we infer His desire that children should be brought near to Him in baptism;—as we do also from St. Paul’s conduct on several occasions. Acts xvi. 15, 33. 1 Cor. i. 16.

So also we continue the practice of Confirmation, from a desire to keep as near the Apostles’ rule as possible.

Again, what little is there of express command in the New Testament for our meeting together in *public* worship, in large congregations! Yet we see what the custom of the Apostolic Church was from the book of Acts, 1 Cor. &c. and we follow it.

In like manner, the words in Genesis ii. and the practice of the Apostles in the Acts, are quite warrant enough for the Sanctification of the LORD’S Day, even though the fourth Commandment

be not binding on us.

For the same reason we continue the Patriarchal and Jewish rule of paying tithe to the Church. Some portion of our goods is evidently due to GOD;—and the ancient Divine Command is a *direction* to us, which the law of the land has made obligatory, in a case where reason and conscience have no means of determining.

These may be taken as illustrations of a general principle. And at this day it is most needful to keep it in view, since a cold spirit has crept into the Church of demanding rigid demonstration for every religious practice and observance. It is the fashion now to speak of those who maintain the ancient rules of the ecclesiastical system, not as zealous servants of CHRIST, not as wise and practical expounders of His will, but as *inconclusive reasoners*, and *fanciful theorists*, merely because, instead of standing still and arguing, they have a heart to obey. Are there not numbers in this day, who think themselves enlightened believers, yet who are but acting the part of the husbandman's son in the Gospel, who said, "I go, Sir,"—AND WENT NOT.

CHURCH REFORM

SURELY, before the blessing of a Millenium were vouchsafed to us, if it be to come, the whole Christian world has much to confess in its several branches. Rome has to confess her Papal corruptions, and her cruelty towards those who refuse to accept them. The Christian communities of Holland, Scotland, and other countries, their neglect of the Apostolical Order of Ministers. The Greek Church has to confess its saint-worship, its formal fasts, and its want of zeal. The Churches of Asia their heresy. All parts of Christendom have much to confess and reform. We have our sins as well as the rest. Oh that *we* would take the lead in the renovation of the Church Catholic on Scripture principles!

Our greatest sin perhaps is the disuse of a "godly discipline." Let the reader consider,

1. The command.

"Put away from yourselves the wicked person." "A man that is a heretic, after the first and second admonition, reject." "Mark them which cause divisions and offences, ... and avoid them."

2. The example, viz. in the Primitive Church.

"The Persons or Objects of Ecclesiastical Censure were all such delinquents, as fell into great and scandalous crimes after baptism, whether men or women, priests or people, rich or poor, princes or subjects." Bing. Antiq. xvi. 3.

3. The warning.

"Whosoever ... shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven."

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1840.

Heads of a Weekday Lecture, Delivered to a Country Congregation in —shire

Tract No. 10

BEFORE we meet again, we shall have celebrated the least of St. Simon and St. Jude, the Apostles. You will be at your daily work, and will not have the opportunity to attend the Service in Church. For that reason, it may be as well, you should lay up some good thoughts against that day; and such, by GOD'S blessing, I will now attempt to give you.

As you well know, there were twelve Apostles; St. Simon and St. Jude were two of them. They preached the Gospel of CHRIST; and they were like CHRIST, as far as sinful man may be accounted like the Blessed SON of GOD. They were like CHRIST in their deeds and in their sufferings. The Gospel for the festival [John xv. 17.] shows us this. They were like CHRIST in their *works*, because CHRIST was a witness of the FATHER, and they were witnesses of CHRIST. CHRIST came in the name of GOD the FATHER ALMIGHTY; He "came and spoke," and "did works which none other man did." In like manner, the Apostles were sent to bear witness of CHRIST, to declare His power, His great mercy, His sufferings on the cross for the sins of all men, His willingness to save all who come to Him.

But again, they were like CHRIST in their *sufferings*. "If the world hate you," He says to them, "you know that it hated Me, before it hated you. If ye were of the world, the world would love his own; but because ye are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world, therefore the world hateth you. Remember the word that I said unto you, The servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted Me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept My saying, they will keep yours also."

Thus, they were like CHRIST in *office*. I do not speak of their holiness, their faith, and all their other high excellencies, which GOD the HOLY GHOST gave them. I speak now, not of their personal graces, but of their *office*, of preaching, of witnessing CHRIST, of suffering for being His servants. Men ought to have listened to them, and honoured them; some did: but the many, the world, did not,—they *hated* them; they hated them, for their office-sake; not because they were Paul, and Peter, and Simon, and Jude, but because they bore witness to the SON of GOD, and were chosen to be His Ministers.

Here is a useful lesson for us at this day. The Apostles indeed are dead; yet it is quite as possible for men still to hate their preaching and to persecute them, as when they were alive. For in one sense they are still alive; I mean, they did not leave the world without appointing persons to take their place: and these persons represent them, and may be considered with reference to us, as if they were the Apostles. When a man dies, his son takes his property and represents him; that is, in a manner he still lives in the person of his son. Well, this explains how the Apostles may be said to be still among us; they did not indeed leave their sons to succeed them as Apostles, but they left *spiritual* sons; they did not leave this life, without first solemnly laying their hands on the heads of certain of their brethren, and these took their place, and represented them after their death.

But it may be asked, are these spiritual sons of the Apostles still alive? no:—all this took place many hundred years ago. These sons and heirs of the Apostles died long since. But then they in turn did not leave the world without committing their sacred office to a fresh set of Ministers, and they in turn to another, and so on even to this day. Thus the Apostles had, first, spiritual sons; then spiritual grandsons; then great grandsons; and so on, from one age to another, down to the present time.

Again, it may be asked, *who* are at this time the successors and spiritual descendants of the

Apostles? I shall surprise some people by the answer I shall give, though it is very clear, and there is no doubt about it; THE BISHOPS. They stand in the place of the Apostles, as far as the office of ruling is concerned ¹; and, whatever we ought to do, had we lived when the Apostles were alive, the same ought we to do for the Bishops. He that despiseth them, despiseth the Apostles. It is our duty to reverence them for their office-sake; they are the shepherds of CHRIST'S flock. If we knew them well, we should love them for the many excellent graces they possess, for their piety, loving-kindness, and other virtues. But we do not know them; yet still, for all this, we may honour them as the Ministers of CHRIST, without going so far as to consider their *private* worth; and we may keep to their "fellowship", [Acts ii. 42.] as we should to that of the Apostles. I say, we may all thus honour them even without knowing them in private, because of their high office; for they have the marks of CHRIST'S presence upon them, in that they *witness* for CHRIST, and *suffer* for Him, as the Apostles did. I will explain to you how this is.

There is a temptation which comes on many men to honour no one, except such as they themselves know, such as have done a favour or kindness to them personally. Thus sometimes people speak against those who are put over them in this world's matters, as the King. They say, "What is the King to me? he never did me any good." Now, I answer, whether he did or not, is nothing to the purpose. We are bound, *for* CHRIST'S sake, to honour him, *because* he is King, though he lives far from us; and this all well-disposed, right-minded people do. And so, in just the same way, though for much higher reasons, we must honour the Bishop, because he *is* the Bishop;—for his *office*-sake;—because he is CHRIST'S Minister, stands in the place of the Apostles, is the Shepherd of our souls on earth, while CHRIST is away. This is FAITH, to look at things not as seen, but as unseen; to be as sure that the Bishop is CHRIST'S appointed Representative, as if we actually saw him work miracles as St. Peter and St. Paul did, as you may read in the book of the Acts of the Apostles.

But you will say, how do we know this, since we do not see it? I repeat, the Bishops are Apostles to us, from their *witnessing* CHRIST, and *suffering* for Him.

1. They witness our LORD in their very *name*, for He is the true Bishop of our souls, as St. Peter says, and they are Bishops. They witness CHRIST in their *station*;—there is but one LORD to save us, and there is but one Bishop in each place. The meetings have no head, they are all of them mixed together in a confused way; but we of CHRIST'S Holy Church (blessed, be GOD!) have one Bishop over us, and our Bishop is the Bishop of ——. Many of you have seen him lately, when he confirmed in our Church. That very *confirmation* is another ordinance, in which the Bishop witnesses CHRIST. Our LORD and SAVIOUR confirms us with the SPIRIT in all goodness; the Bishop is His figure and likeness, when he lays his hands on the heads of children. Then CHRIST, (as we trust) comes to them, to confirm in them the grace of Baptism. Moreover, the Bishop *rules* the whole Church here below, as CHRIST, the true and eternal Sovereign, rules it above; and here again the Bishop is a figure or witness of our LORD. And further, it is the Bishop who is commissioned to make us Clergymen GOD'S Ministers. He is CHRIST'S instrument; and he visibly chooses those whom CHRIST vouchsafes to choose invisibly, to serve in the Word and Sacraments of the Church. And thus, in one sense, it is from the Bishop that the *news of redemption and the means of grace* have come to all men; this again is a witnessing CHRIST. I, who speak to you concerning CHRIST, was ordained to do so by the Bishop; he speaks in me,—as CHRIST wrought in him, and as GOD sent

¹As far as the office of *ruling*, not as far as the office of *teaching* is concerned. The Apostles were both *inspired teachers* (Acts ii. 3, 4), and Bishops (John xx. 21-23). Their successors are Bishops only, not inspired teachers; and rule according to the Apostles' teaching,—not absolutely, as the Apostles may be said to have done.

CHRIST. Thus the whole plan of salvation hangs together.—CHRIST the True Mediator above; His servant, the Bishop, His earthly likeness; mankind, the subjects of His teaching; GOD the Author of Salvation.

2. But I must now mention the more painful part of the subject, i.e. the *sufferings* of the Bishops, which is the second mark of their being our living Apostles. I may say, Bishops have undergone this trial in every age. As the first Apostles were hated and opposed by the world, so have they ever been. I do not say they have been always opposed in the same way. In these latter times, they have experienced the lesser sufferings of bearing slander, reproach, threats, vexations, and thwartings in their efforts to do good. Time was, when they were even persecuted, cruelly slain by fire and sword. That time, (though GOD avert it!) may come again. But, whether or not Satan is permitted so openly to rage, certainly some kinds of persecution are to be expected in our day; nay, such have begun. It is not so very long since the great men of the earth told them to *prepare for persecution*; it is not so very long since the mad people answered the summons, and furiously attacked them, and seemed bent on destroying them, in all parts of the country.

Yes! the day may come, even in this generation, when the Representatives of CHRIST are spoiled of their sacred possessions, and degraded from their civil dignities. The day may come, when each of us inferior Ministers—when I myself, whom you know—may have to give up our Churches, and be among you, in no better temporal circumstances than yourselves; with no larger dwelling, no finer clothing, no other fare, with nothing different beyond those gifts, which I trust we received from the All-gracious GOD when we were made Ministers; and those again, which have been vouchsafed to us before and after that time, for the due fulfilment of our Ministry. Then you will look at us, not as gentlemen, as now; not as your superiors in worldly station; but still, nay, more strikingly so than now, still as messengers from Him, who seeth and worketh in secret, and who judgeth not by outward appearance. Then you will honour us, with a purer honour than many men do now, namely, as those (if I may say so) who are intrusted with the keys of heaven and hell, as the heralds of mercy, as the denouncers of woe to wicked men, as intrusted with the awful and mysterious privilege of dispensing CHRIST'S Body and Blood, as far greater than the most powerful and the wealthiest of men in our unseen strength and our heavenly riches. This may all come in our day; *we* must do our duty; go straight forward, looking neither to the right hand nor the left, "in patience possessing our souls," watching and praying, and so preparing for the evil day. And after all, if GOD'S loving kindness spares both us and you the trial, still it will have been useful to have steadily thought about it beforehand, and to have prepared our hearts to meet it.

OXFORD,

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The Visible Church (In Letters to a Friend.)

Tract No. 11 (Ad Scholas)

Letter I.

You wish to have my opinion on the doctrine of “the Holy Catholic Church,” as contained in Scripture, and taught in the Creed. So I send you the following lines, which perhaps may serve through God’s blessing, to assist you in your search after the truth in this matter, even though they do no more; indeed no remarks, however just, can be much more than an assistance to you. You must search for yourself, and GOD must teach you.

I think I partly enter into your present perplexity. You argue, that true *doctrine* is the important matter for which we must contend, and a *right state of the affections* is the test of vital religion in the heart: and you ask, “Why may I not be satisfied if my Creed is correct, and my affections spiritual? Have I not in that case enough to evidence a renewed mind, and to constitute a basis of union with others like minded? The love of CHRIST is surely the one and only requisite for Christian communion here, and the joys of heaven hereafter.” Again you say, that — and — are constant in their prayers for the teaching of the HOLY SPIRIT; so that if it be true, that every one who asketh receiveth, surely they must receive, and are in a safe state.

Believe me, I do not think lightly of these arguments. They are very subtle ones; powerfully influencing the imagination, and difficult to answer. Still I believe them to be mere fallacies. Let me try them in a parallel case. You know the preacher at —, and have heard of his flagrantly immoral life; yet it is notorious that he can and does speak in a moving way of the love of CHRIST, &c. It is very shocking to witness such a case, which (we will hope) is rare; but it has its use. Do you not think him in peril, in spite of his impressive and persuasive language? Why?—You will say, his life is bad. True; it seems then that more is requisite for salvation than an orthodox creed, and keen sensibility; viz. consistent conduct.—Very well then, we have come to an additional test of truth faith, obedience to GOD’S word, and plainly a scriptural test, according to St. John’s canon, “He who *doeth* righteousness is righteous.” Do not you see then your argument is already proved to be unsound? It seems that true doctrine and warm feelings are not enough. How am I to know what *is* enough? you ask. I reply, *by searching Scripture*. It was your original fault that, instead of inquiring what GOD has told you is necessary for being a true Christian, you chose out of your own head to *argue* on the subject;—e.g. “I can never believe that to be such and such is not enough for salvation,” &c. Now this is *worldly wisdom*.

Let us join issue then on this plain ground, whether or not the doctrine of “the Church,” and the duty of obeying it, be laid down *in Scripture*. If so, it is no matter as regards our practice, whether the doctrine is primary or secondary, whether the duty is much or little insisted on. A Christian mind will aim at obeying the *whole* counsel and will of GOD; on the other hand, to those who are tempted arbitrarily to classify and select their duties, it is written, “Whosoever shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven.”

And here first, that you may clearly understand the ground I am taking, pray observe that I am not attempting to controvert any one of those high evangelical points, on which perhaps we do not altogether agree with each other. Perhaps you attribute less efficacy to the Sacrament of Baptism than I do; bring out into greater system and prominence the history of an individual’s warfare with his spiritual enemies; fix more precisely and abruptly the date of his actual conversion from darkness to light; and consider that Divine Grace acts more arbitrarily against the corrupt

human will, than I think is revealed in Scripture. Still, in spite of this difference of opinion, I see no reason why you should not accept heartily the Scripture doctrine of “the Church.” And this is the point I wish to press, not asking you at present to abandon your own opinions, but to *add to them* a practical belief in a tenet which the Creed teaches and Scripture has consecrated. And this surely is quite possible. The excellent Mr. —, of —, who has lately left —, was both a Calvinist, and a strenuous High-Churchman.

You are in the practice of distinguishing between the Visible and Invisible Church. Of course I have no wish to maintain, that those who shall be saved hereafter are exactly the same company that are under the means of grace here; still I must insist on it, that Scripture makes the existence of a Visible Church a condition of the existence of the Invisible. I mean, the *Sacraments* are evidently in the hands of the Church Visible; and these, we know, are generally necessary to salvation, as the Catechism says. Thus it is an undeniable fact, as true as that souls will be saved, that a Visible Church must exist as a means towards that end. The Sacraments are in the hands of the Clergy; this few will deny, or that their efficacy is independent of the personal character of the administrator. What then shall be thought of any attempts to weaken or exterminate that Community, or that Ministry, which is an appointed condition of the salvation of the elect? But every one, who makes or encourages a schism, *must* weaken it. Thus it is plain, schism must be wrong in itself, even if Scripture did not in express terms forbid it, as it does.

But further than this; it is plain this Visible Church is a standing body. Every one who is baptized, is baptized *into* an existing community. Our Service expresses this when it speaks of baptized infants being *incorporated* into GOD’S holy Church. Thus the Visible Church is not a voluntary association of the day, but a continuation of one which existed in the age before us, and then again in the age before that; and so back till we come to the age of the Apostles. In the same sense, in which Corporations of the State’s creating, are perpetual, is this which CHRIST has founded. This is a matter of fact hitherto: and it necessarily will be so always, for is not the notion absurd of an unbaptized person baptizing others? which is the only way in which the Christian community can have a new beginning.

Moreover Scripture directly insists upon the doctrine of the Visible Church, as being of importance. E.g. St. Paul say;—“There is *one body*, and one SPIRIT, even as ye are called in one hope of your calling; one LORD, one faith, one baptism, one GOD and FATHER of all.” Ephes. iv. 5, 6. Thus, as far as the Apostle’s words go, it is as false and unchristian, (I do not mean in degree of guilt, but in its intrinsic sinfulness), to make more bodies than one, as to have many Lords, many Gods, many Creeds. Now, I wish to know, how it is possible for any one to fall into this sin, if Dissenters are clear of it? What is the sin, if separation from the Existing Church is not it?

I have shown that there is a divinely instituted Visible Church, and that it has been one and the same by successive incorporation of members from the beginning. Now I observe further, that the word Church, as used in Scripture, ordinarily means this actually existing visible body. The possible exception to this rule, out of about 100 places in the New Testament, where the word occurs, are four passages in the Epistle to the Ephesians; two in the Colossians; and one in the Hebrews. (Eph. i. 22; iii. 10, 21; v. 23-32. Col. i. 18, 24. Heb. xii. 23.)—And in some of these exceptions the sense is at most but doubtful. Further, our SAVIOUR uses the word twice, and in both times of the Visible Church. They are remarkable passages, and may here be introduced, in continuation of my argument.

Matt. xvi. 18. “Upon this rock I will build My Church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.” Now I am certain, any unprejudiced mind, who knew nothing of controversy, consider-

ing the Greek word [*ekklēsia*] means simply an *assembly*, would have no doubt at all that it meant in this passage a visible body. What right have we to disturb the plain sense? why do we impose a meaning, arising from some system of our own? And this view is altogether confirmed by the other occasion of our LORD'S using it, where it can *only* denote the Visible Church. Matt. xviii. 17. "If he (thy brother) shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the Church; but if he neglect to hear the Church, let him be unto thee as a heathen man and a publican."

Observe then what we gain by these two passages;—the grant of *power* to the Church; and the promise of *permanence*. Now look at the fact. The body then begun has continued; and has always claimed and exercised the power of a corporation or society. Consider merely the article in the Creed, "The Holy Catholic Church;" which embodies this notion. Do not Scripture and History illustrate each other?

I end this first draught of my argument, with the text in 1 Tim. iii. 15, in which St. Paul calls the Church "the pillar and ground of the truth,"—which can refer to nothing but a Visible Body; else martyrs may be invisible, and preachers, and teachers, and the whole order of the Ministry.

My paper is exhausted. If you allow me, I will send you soon a second Letter; meanwhile I sum up what I have been proving from Scripture thus; that ALMIGHTY GOD might have left Christianity as a sort of sacred literature, as contained in the Bible, which each person was to take and use by himself; just as we read the works of any human philosopher or historian, from which we gain practical instruction, but the knowledge of which does not bind us to be Newtonians, or Aristotelians, &c., or to go out of our line of life in consequence of it. This, I say, He might have done; but, in matter of fact, He has ordained otherwise. He has actually set up a Society, which exists even this day all over the world, and which (as a general rule) Christians are bound to join; so that to believe in CHRIST is not a mere opinion or a secret conviction, but a social or even a political principle, forcing one into what is often stigmatized as party strife, and quite inconsistent with the supercilious mood of those professed Christians of the day, who stand aloof, and designate their indifference as philosophy.

Letter II.

I AM sometimes struck with the inconsistency of those, who do not allow us to express the gratitude due to the Church, while they do not hesitate to declare their obligation to individuals who have benefited them. To a vow that they owe their views of religion and their present hopes of salvation to this or that distinguished preacher, appears to them as harmless, as it may be in itself true and becoming; but if a person ascribes his faith and knowledge to the Church, he is thought to forget his peculiar and unspeakable debt to that SAVIOUR who died for him. Surely, if our LORD makes man His instrument of good to man, and if it is possible to be grateful to man without forgetting the Source of all grace and power, there is nothing wonderful in His having appointed a company of men as the especial medium of His instruction and spiritual gifts, and in consequence, of His having laid upon us the duty of gratitude to it. Now this is all I wish to maintain, what is most clearly (as I think) revealed in Scripture, that the blessings of redemption come to us through the Visible Church; so that, as we betake ourselves to a Dispensary for medicine, without attributing praise or intrinsic worth to the building or the immediate managers of its stores, in something of the like manner we are to come to that One Society, to which CHRIST has entrusted the office of stewardship in the distribution of gifts, of which He alone is the Author and real Dispenser.

In the letter I sent you the other day, I made some general remarks on this doctrine; now let me continue the subject.

First, the Sacraments, which are the ordinary means of grace, are clearly in possession of the Church. Baptism is an incorporation into a body; and invests with spiritual blessings, because it is the introduction into a body so invested. In 1 Cor. xii. we are taught first, the SPIRIT'S indwelling in the Visible Church or body; I do not say *in every member of it*, but generally *in it*;—next, we are told that the SPIRIT baptizes individuals *into* that body. Again, the LORD'S Supper carries evidence of its social nature even in its name; it is not a solitary individual act, it is a joint communion. Surely nothing is more alien to Christianity than the spirit of Independence; the peculiar Christian blessing, i.e. the presence of CHRIST, is upon *two or three* gathered together, not on mere individuals.

But this is not all. The Sacraments are committed, not into the hand of the Church Visible assembled together, (though even this would be no unimportant doctrine practically) but into certain definite persons, who are selected from their brethren for that trust. I will not here determine who these are in each successive age, but will only point out how far this principle itself will carry us. The doctrine is implied in the original institution of the LORD'S Supper, where CHRIST says to His Apostles, "Do this." Further, take that remarkable passage in Matt. xxiv. 45-51. Luke xii. 42-46, "Who then is that faithful and wise Steward, whom his Lord shall make ruler over His household, to give them their portion of meat in due season? Blessed is that servant, whom his Lord, *when He cometh*, shall find so doing!" &c. Now I do not inquire *who* in every age are the stewards spoken of, (though in my own mind I cannot doubt the line of Bishops is that Ministry, and consider the concluding verses fearfully prophetic of the Papal misuse of the gift;—by the bye, at least it shows this, that bad men may nevertheless be the channels of grace to GOD'S "household,") I do not ask who are the stewards, but surely the words, *when He cometh*, imply that they are to continue till the end of the world. This reference is abundantly confirmed by our LORD'S parting words to the eleven; in which, after giving them the baptismal commission, He adds, "Lo! I am with you *always*, even unto the end of the world." If then He was with the Apostles in a way in which He was not present with teachers who were strangers to their "fellowship," (Acts ii. 42.) which all will admit, so, in like manner, it cannot be a matter of indifference in *any* age, what teachers and fellowship a Christian selects; there must be those with whom CHRIST is present, who are His "Stewards," and whom it is our duty to obey.

As I have mentioned the question of faithfulness and unfaithfulness in Ministers, I may refer to the passage in 1 Cor. iv. where St. Paul, after speaking of himself and others as "*Stewards* of the mysteries of GOD," and noticing that "it is required of Stewards, that a man be found faithful," adds, "With me it is a very small thing that I should be judged of you or of man's judgment ... therefore *judge nothing before the time*."

To proceed, consider the following passage: "Obey them that have rule over you, and submit yourselves." Heb. xiii. 17. Again, I do not ask *who* these are; but whether this is not a duty, however it is to be fulfilled, which multitudes *in no sense* fulfil. Consider the number of people, professing and doubtless in a manner really actuated by Christian principle, who yet wander about from church to church or from church to meeting, as sheep without a shepherd, or who choose a preacher merely because he pleases their taste, and whose first movement towards any clergyman they meet, is to examine and criticize his doctrine: what conceivable meaning do they put upon these words of the Apostle? Does any one *rule over* them? do they in any way *submit themselves*? Can these persons excuse their conduct, except on the deplorably profane plea, (which yet I believe is in their hearts at the bottom of their disobedience,) that it matters little to keep CHRIST'S "least commandments," so that we embrace the peculiar doctrines of His Gospel?

Some time ago I drew up a sketch of the Scripture proof of the doctrine of the Visible Church;

which with your leave I will here transcribe. You will observe, I am not arguing for this or that form of Polity, or for the Apostolical Succession, but simply the duties of order, union, ecclesiastical gifts, and ecclesiastical obedience; I limit myself to these points, as being persuaded that, when they are granted, the others will eventually follow.

I. That there was a Visible Church in the Apostles' day.

1. General texts. Matt. xvi. 18; xviii. 17. 1 Tim. iii. 15. Acts passim, &c.

2. Organization of the Church.

(1.) Diversity of ranks. 1 Cor. xii. Eph. iv. 4-12. Rom. xii. 4-8. 1 Pet. iv. 10, 11.

(2.) Governors. Matt. xxviii. 19. Mark xvi. 15, 16. John xx. 22, 23. Luke xxii. 19, 20. Gal. ii. 9, &c.

(3.) Gifts. Luke xii. 42, 43. John xx. 22, 23. Matt. xviii. 18.

(4.) Order. Acts viii. 5, 6, 12, 14, 15, 17; xi. 22, 23; xi. 2, 4; ix. 27; xv. 2, 4, 6, 25; xvi. 4; xviii. 22; xxi. 17-19. conf. Gal. i. 1, 12. 1 Cor. xiv. 40. 1 Thess. v. 14.

(5.) Ordination. Acts vi. 6. 1 Tim. iv. 14; v. 22. 2 Tim. i. 6. Tit. i. 5. Acts xiii. 3. conf. Gal. i. 1, 12.

(6.) Ecclesiastical obedience. 1 Thess. v. 12, 13. Heb. xiii. 17. 1 Tim. v. 17.

(7.) Rules and discipline. Matt. xxviii. 19. Matt. xviii. 17. 1 Cor. v. 4-7. Gal. v. 12, &c. 1 Cor. xvi. 1, 2. 1 Cor. xi. 2, 16, &c.

(8.) Unity. Rom. xvi. 17. 1 Cor. i. 10; iii. 3; xiv. 26. Col. ii. 5. 1 Thess. v. 14. 2 Thess. iii. 6.

II. That the Visible Church, thus instituted by the Apostles, was intended to continue.

1. Why should it not? The *onus probandi* lies with those who deny this position. If the doctrines and precepts already cited are obsolete at this day, why should not the following texts? e.g. 1 Pet. ii. 13, or e.g. Matt. vii. 14. John iii. 3.

2. Is it likely so elaborate a system should be framed, yet with no purpose of its continuing?

3. The objects to be obtained by it are as necessary now as then. (1.) Preservation of the faith. (2.) Purity of doctrine. (3.) Edification of Christians. (4.) Unity of operation. Vid. Epistles. to Tim. & Tit. passim.

4. If system were necessary in a time of miracles, much more is it now.

5. 2 Tim. ii. 2. Matt. xxviii. 20, &c.

Take these remarks, as they are meant, as mere suggestions for your private consideration.

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On the Apostolical Succession in the English Church

Tract No. 15

WHEN Churchmen in England maintain the Apostolical Commission of their Ministers, they are sometimes met with the objection, that they cannot prove it without tracing their orders back to the Church of Rome; a position, indeed, which in a certain sense is true. And hence it is argued, that they are reduced to the dilemma, either of acknowledging they had no right to separate from the Pope, or, on the other hand, of giving up the Ministerial Succession altogether, and resting the claims of their pastors on some other ground; in other words, that they are inconsistent in reprobating Popery, while they draw a line between their Ministers and those of Dissenting Communions.

It is intended, in the pages that follow, to reply to this supposed difficulty; but first, a few words shall be said, by way of preface, on the doctrine itself, which we Churchmen advocate.

The Christian Church is a body consisting of Clergy and Laity; this is generally agreed upon, and may here be assumed. Now, what we say is, that these two classes are distinguished from each other, and united to each other, by the commandment of GOD Himself; that the Clergy have a commission from GOD ALMIGHTY through regular succession from the Apostles, to preach the Gospel, administer the Sacraments, and guide the Church; and, again, that in consequence the people are bound to hear them with attention, receive the Sacrament from their hands, and pay them all dutiful obedience. I shall not prove this at length, for it has been done by others, and indeed the common sense and understanding of men, if left to themselves, would be quite sufficient in this case. I do but lay before the reader the following considerations.

1. We hold, with the Church in all ages, that, when our LORD, after His resurrection, breathed on His Apostles, and said, "Receive ye the HOLY GHOST,—as My FATHER hath sent Me, so send I you;" He gave them the power of sending *others* with a divine commission, who in like manner should have the power of sending others, and so on even unto the end; and that our LORD promised His continual assistance to these successors of the Apostles in this and all other respects, when He said, "Lo, I am with you," (that is, with you, and those who shall represent and succeed you,) "always, even unto the end of the world."

And, if it is plain that the Apostles left successors after them, it is equally plain that the Bishops are these Successors. For it is only the Bishops who have ever been called by the title of Successors; and there has been actually a perpetual succession of these Bishops in the Church, who alone were always esteemed to have the power of sending other Ministers to preach and administer the Sacraments. So that the proof of the doctrine seems to lie in a very small space.

2. But, perhaps it may be as well to look at it in another point of view. I suppose no man of common sense thinks himself entitled to set about teaching religion, administering Baptism, and the LORD'S Supper, and taking care of the souls of other people, unless he has *in some way* been called to undertake the office. Now, as religion is a business between every man's own conscience and GOD ALMIGHTY, no one can have any right to interfere in the religious concerns of another with the authority of a teacher, unless he is able to show, that it is GOD that has in some way called and sent him to do so. It is true, that men may as *friends* encourage and instruct each other with consent of both parties; but this is something very different from the office of a Minister of religion, who is entitled and called to "exhort, rebuke, and" "rule," "with all authority," as well as love and humility.

You may observe that our LORD Himself did not teach the Gospel, without proving most plainly that His FATHER had sent Him. He and His Apostles proved their divine commission by

miracles. As miracles, however, have long ago come to an end, there must be some *other* way for a man to prove his right to be a Minister of religion. And what other way can there possibly be, except a regular call and ordination by those who have succeeded to the Apostles?

3. Further, you will observe, that all sects think it necessary that their Ministers should be ordained by other Ministers. Now, if this be the case, then the validity of ordination, even with *them*, rests on a *succession*; and is it not plain that they ought to trace that succession to the Apostles? Else, why are they ordained at all? And, any how, if *their* Ministers have a commission, who derive it from private men, much more do the Ministers of our Church, who actually do derive it from the Apostles. Surely those who dissent from the Church have *invented* an ordinance, as they themselves must allow; whereas Churchmen, whether rightly or wrongly, still maintain *their* succession not to be an invention, but to be GOD'S ordinance. If Dissenters say, that *order* requires there should be some such *succession*, this is true, indeed, but still it is only a testimony to the mercy of CHRIST, in having, as Churchmen maintain, *given us* such a succession. And this is *all* it shows; it does nothing for *them*; for, their succession, not professing to come from GOD, has no power to restrain any fanatic from setting up to preach of his own will, and a people with itching ears choosing for themselves a teacher. It does but witness to a need, without supplying it.

4. I have now given some slight suggestions by way of evidence for the doctrine of the Apostolical Succession, from Scripture, the nature of the case, and the conduct of Dissenters. Let me add a word on the usage of the Primitive Church. We know that the succession of Bishops, and ordination from them, was the invariable doctrine and rule of the early Christians. Is it not utterly inconceivable, that this rule should have prevailed from the first age, everywhere, and without exception, had it not been given them by the Apostles?

But here we are met by the objection, on which I propose to make a few remarks, that, though it is true there was a continual Succession of pastors and teachers in the early Church who had a divine commission, yet that no Protestants can have it; that we gave it up, when our communion ceased with Rome, in which Church it still remains; or, at least, that no Protestant can plead it without condemning the Reformation itself, for that our own predecessors then revolted and separated from those spiritual pastors, who, according to our principles, then had the commission of JESUS CHRIST.

Our reply to this is a flat denial of the alleged facts on which it rests. The English Church did not revolt from those who in that day had authority by succession from the Apostles. On the contrary, it is certain that the Bishops and Clergy in England and Ireland remained the same as before the separation, and that it was these, with the aid of the civil power, who delivered the Church of those kingdoms from the yoke of Papal tyranny and usurpation, while at the same time they gradually removed from the minds of the people various superstitious opinions and practices which had grown up during the middle ages, and which, though never formally received by the judgment of the whole Church, were yet very prevalent. I do not say the case might never arise, when it might become the duty of private individuals to take upon themselves the office of protesting against and abjuring the heresies of a corrupt Church. But such an extreme case it is unpleasant and unhealthy to contemplate. All I say here is, that this was not the state of things at the time of the Reformation. The Church then by its proper rulers and officers reformed itself. There was no new Church founded among us, but the rights and the true doctrines of the Ancient existing Church were asserted and established.

In proof of this we need only look to the history of the times. In the year 1534, the Bishops and Clergy of England assembled in their respective convocations of Canterbury and York, and signed

a declaration that the Pope or Bishop of Rome had no more jurisdiction in this country by the word of GOD, than any other foreign Bishop; and they also agreed to those acts of the civil government, which put an end to it among us ².

The people of England, then, in casting off the Pope, but obeyed and concurred in the acts of their own spiritual Superiors, and committed no schism. Queen Mary, it is true, drove out after many years the orthodox Bishops, and reduced our Church again under the Bishop of Rome, but this submission was only exacted by force, and in itself null and void; and, moreover, in matter of fact it lasted but a little while, for on the succession of Queen Elizabeth, the true Successors of the Apostles in the English Church were reinstated in their ancient rights. So, I repeat, there was no revolt, in any part of these transactions, against those who had a commission from God; for it was the Bishops and Clergy themselves, who maintained the just rights of their Church.

But, it seems, the Pope has ever said, that our Bishops were bound by the laws of GOD and the Church to obey *him*; that they were subject to him; and that they had no right to separate from him, and were guilty in doing so, and that accordingly they have involved the people of England in their guilt; and, at all events, that *they* cannot complain of their flock disobeying and deserting them, when they have revolted from the Pope. Let us consider this point.

Now that there is not a word in *Scripture* about our duty to obey the Pope, is quite clear. The Papists indeed say, that he is the Successor of St. Peter; and that therefore he is Head of all Bishops, because St. Peter bore rule over the other Apostles. But though the Bishops of Rome were often called the Successors of St. Peter in the early Church, yet every other Bishop had the *same* title. And though it be true, that St. Peter was the *foremost* of the Apostles, that does not prove he had any *dominion* over them. The eldest brother in a family has certain privileges and a precedence, but he has no power over the younger branches of it. And so Rome has ever had what is called the *primacy* of the Christian Churches; but it has not therefore any right to interfere in their internal administration; not more of a right, than an elder brother has to meddle with a younger brother's household.

And this is plainly the state of matters between us and Rome, *in the judgment of the Ancient Church* also, to which the Papists are fond of appealing, and by which we are quite ready to stand or fall. In early times, as is well known, all Christians thought substantially alike, and formed one great body all over the world, called the Church Catholic, or Universal. This great body, consisting of a vast number of separate Churches, with each of them its own Bishop at its head, was divided into a number of portions called Patriarchates; these again into others called Provinces, and these were made up of the separate Dioceses or Bishoprics. We have among ourselves an instance of this last division in the Provinces of Canterbury and York, which constitute the English Church, each of them consisting of a number of distinct Bishoprics or Churches. The head of a Province was called Archbishop, as in the case of Canterbury and York; the Bishops of those two sees being, we know, not only Bishops with Dioceses of their own, but having, over and above this, the place of precedence among the Bishops in the same Province. In like manner, the Bishop at the head of a Patriarchate was called the Patriarch, and had the place of honour and certain privileges over all other Bishops within his own Patriarchate. Now, in the early Christian Church, there were four or five Patriarchates; e.g. one in the East, the Head of which was the Bishop of Antioch; one in Egypt, the Head of which was the Bishop of Alexandria; and, again, one in the West, the Head of which was the Bishop of Rome. These Patriarchs, I say, were the Primates or Head Bishops of

²Vide Collier, Eccl. Hist. v. ii. p. 94.

their respective Patriarchates; and they had an order of precedence among themselves, Rome being the first of them all. Thus the Bishop of Rome, being the first of the Patriarchs in dignity, might be called the honorary Primate of all Christendom.

However, as time went on, the Bishop of Rome, not satisfied with the honours which were readily conceded to him, attempted to gain *power* over the whole Church. He seems to have been allowed the privilege of *arbitrating* in case of appeal from other Patriarchates. If, *e.g.* Alexandria and Antioch had a dispute, he was a proper referee; or if the Bishops of those Churches were at any time unjustly deprived of their sees, he was a fit person to interfere and defend them. But, I say, he became ambitious, and attempted to *lord it* over GOD'S heritage. He interfered in the internal management of other Patriarchates; he appointed Bishops to sees, and Clergy to parishes which were contained within them, and imposed on them various religious and ecclesiastical usages illegally. And in doing so, surely he became a remarkable contrast to the Holy Apostle, who, though inspired, and an universal Bishop, yet suffered not himself to control the proceedings even of the Churches he founded; saying to the Corinthians, "not for that we have dominion over your faith, but are helpers of your joy; for by faith ye stand." 2 Cor. i. 24. This impressive declaration, which seems to be intended almost as a prophetic warning against the times of which we speak, was neglected by the Pope, who, among other tyrannical proceedings, took upon him the control of the Churches in Britain, and forbade us to reform our doctrine and usages, which he had no right at all to do. He had no pretence for so doing, because we were altogether independent of him; the English and Irish Churches, though in the West, being exterior to his Patriarchate. Here again, however, some explanation is necessary.

You must know, then, that from the first there were portions of the Christian world, which were not included in any Patriarchate, but were governed by themselves. Such were the Churches of Cyprus, and such were the British Churches. This need not here be proved; even Papists have before now confessed it. Now it so happened, in the beginning of the 5th century, the Patriarch of Antioch, who was in the neighbourhood of Cyprus, attempted against the Cyprian Churches what the Pope has since attempted against us; *viz.* took measures to reduce them under his dominion. And, as a sign of his authority over them, he claimed to consecrate their Bishops. Upon which the Great Council of the whole Christian world assembled at Ephesus, A.D. 451, made the following decree, which you will find is a defence of England and Ireland against the Papacy, as well as of Cyprus against Antioch.

"An innovation upon the Rule of the Church and the Canons of the Holy Fathers, such as to affect the general liberties of Christendom, has been reported to us by our venerable brother Reginus, and his fellow Bishops of Cyprus, Zeno, and Evagrius. Wherefore, since public disorders call for extraordinary remedies, as being more perilous, and whereas it is against ancient usage, that the Bishop of Antioch should ordain in Cyprus, as has been proved to us in this Council both in words and writing, by most orthodox men, We therefore decree, that the Prelates of the Cyprian Churches shall be suffered without let or hindrance to consecrate Bishops by themselves; and moreover, that the *same rule shall be observed also in other dioceses and provinces every where, so that no Bishop shall interfere in another province, which has not from the very first been under himself and his predecessors*; and further, that if any one has so encroached and tyrannized, he must relinquish his claim, that the Canons of the Fathers be not infringed, nor the Priesthood be made an occasion and pretence for the pride of worldly power, nor the least portion of that freedom unawares he lost to us, which our LORD JESUS CHRIST, who bought the world's freedom, vouchsafed to us, when He shed His own blood. Wherefore it has seemed good to this Holy Ecumenical Council, that *the rights*

of every province should be preserved pure and inviolate, which have always belonged to it, according to the usage which has ever obtained, each Metropolitan having full liberty to take a copy of the acts for his own security. And should any rule be adduced repugnant to this decree, it is hereby repealed."

Here we have a remarkable parallel to the dispute between Rome and us; and we see what was the decision of the General Church upon it. It will be observed, the decree is past *for all provinces in all future times*, as well as for the immediate exigency. Now this is a plain refutation of the Romanists on their own principles. *They* profess to hold the Canons of the Primitive Church: the very line they take, is to declare the Church to be one and the same in all ages. Here then they witness against themselves. The Pope *has* encroached on the rights of other churches, and violated the Canon above cited. Herein is the difference between his relation to us, and that of any civil Ruler, whose power was in its origin illegally acquired. Doubtless we are bound to obey the Monarch under whom we are born, even though his ancestor were an usurper. Time legitimises a conquest. But this is not the case in spiritual matters. The Church goes by *fixed laws*; and this usurpation has all along been counter to one of her acknowledged standing ordinances, founded on reasons of universal application.

After the Canon above cited, it is almost superfluous to refer to the celebrated rule of the First Nicene Council, A.D. 325, which, in defending the rights of the Patriarchates, expresses the same principle in all its simple force and majesty.

"Let the ancient usages prevail, which are received in Egypt, Libya, and Pentapolis, relative to the authority of the Bishop of Alexandria; as they are observed in the case of the Bishop of Rome. And so in Antioch too, and other provinces, let the prerogatives of the Churches be preserved."

On this head of the subject, I will but notice, that, as the Council of Ephesus controlled the ambition of Antioch, so in like manner did St. Austin rebuke Rome itself for an encroachment of another kind on the liberties of the African Church.

Bingham says,

*"When Pope Zosimus and Celestine took upon them to receive Appellants from the African Churches, and absolve those whom they had condemned, St. Austin and all the African Churches sharply remonstrated against this, as an irregular practice, violating the laws of unity, and the settled rules of ecclesiastical commerce; which required, that no delinquent excommunicated in one Church should be absolved in another, without giving satisfaction to his own Church that censured him. And therefore, to put a stop to this practice and check the exorbitant power which Roman Bishops assumed to themselves, they first made a Law in the Council of Milevis, That no African Clerk should appeal to any Church beyond sea, under pain of being excluded from communion in all the African Churches. And then, afterwards, meeting in a general Synod, they dispatched letters to the Bishop of Rome, to remind him how contrary this practice was to the Canons of Nice, which ordered, That all controversies should be ended in the places where they arose, before a Council and the Metropolitan."*³

Thus I have shown, that our Bishops, at the time of the Reformation, did but vindicate their ancient rights; were but acting as grateful, and therefore jealous champions of the honour of the old Fathers, and the sanctity of their institutions. Our duty surely in such matters lies in neither encroaching nor conceding to encroachment; in taking our rights as we find them, and using them; or rather in regarding them altogether as trusts, the responsibility of which we cannot avoid. As the same Apostle says, "Let every man abide in the same calling, wherein he is called." And, if

³Bingh. Antiq. xvi. 1. § 14.

England and Ireland had a plea for asserting their freedom under any circumstances, much more so, when the corruptions imposed on them by Rome even made it a duty to do so.

I shall answer briefly one or two objections, and so bring these remarks to an end.

1. First, it may be said, that Rome has withdrawn our orders, and excommunicated us; therefore we cannot plead any longer our Apostolical descent. Now I will not altogether deny, that a Ministerial Body might become so plainly apostate, as to lose its privilege of ordination. But, however this may be, it is a little too hard to *assume*, as such an objection does, the very point in dispute. *When* we are proved to be heretical in doctrine, then will be the time to begin to consider, whether our heresy is of so grievous a character as to invalidate our orders; but, *till then*, we may fairly and fearlessly maintain, that our Bishops are still invested with the power of ordination.

2. But it may be said on the other hand, that if we do not admit ourselves to be heretic, we necessarily must accuse the Romanists of being such; and that therefore, on our own ground, we have really no valid orders, as having received them from an heretical Church. But even if Rome be so considered now, at least she was not heretical in the primitive ages; no one will say that she was then Antichrist ⁴. Nay, as to the middle ages, we may say with the learned Dr. Field, "that none of those points of false doctrine and error which Romanists now maintain, and we condemn, were the doctrines of the Church before the Reformation constantly delivered or generally received by all them that were of it, but doubtfully broached, and devised without all certain resolution, or factiously defended by some certain only, who as a dangerous faction adulterated the sincerity of the Christian verity, and brought the Church into miserable bondage."

⁵ Accordingly, acknowledging and deploring all the errors of the middle ages, yet we need not fear to maintain, that after all they were but the errors of individuals, though of large numbers of Christians; and we may safely maintain, that they no more interfere with the validity of the ordination received by our Bishops from those who lived before the Reformation, than errors of faith and conduct in a priest interfere with the grace of the Sacraments received at his hands.

3. It may be said, that we throw blame on Luther, and others of the foreign Reformers, who did act without the authority of their Bishops. But we reply, that it has been always agreeable to the principles of the Church, that, if a Bishop taught and upheld what was contrary to the orthodox faith, the Clergy and people were not bound to submit, but were obliged to maintain the true religion; and if excommunicated by such Bishops, they were never accounted to be cut off from the Church. Luther and his associates upheld in the main the true doctrine; and though it is not necessary to defend *every* act of fallible men like them, yet we are fully justified in maintaining, that the conduct of those who defended the truth against the Romish party, even in opposition to their spiritual rulers, was worthy of great praise. At the same time it is impossible not to lament, that they did not take the first opportunity to place themselves under orthodox Bishops of the Apostolical Succession. Nothing, as far as we can judge, was more likely to have preserved them from that great decline of religion, which has taken place on the Continent.

[NEW EDITION.]

⁴The following is from the Life of Bernard Gilpin, vid. Wordsworth's Ecclesiastical Biography, vol. iv. p. 94. "Mr. Gilpin would often say that the Churches of the Protestants were not able to give any firme and solid reason of their separation besides this, to wit, that the Pope is Antichrist ... The Church of Rome kept the rule of faith intire, until that rule was changed and altered *by the Council of Trent, and from that time it seemed to him a matter of necessitie to come out of the Church of Rome*, that so that Church which is true and called out from thence might follow the word of God ... But he did not these things violently, but by degrees."

⁵See Field on the Church, Appendix to book iii. where he proves all this. See also Birkbeck's Protestant's Evidence.

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On Arguing concerning the Apostolical Succession

Tract No. 19

MEN are sometimes disappointed with the proofs offered in behalf of some important doctrines of our religion; such especially as the necessity of Episcopal Ordination, in order to constitute a Minister of CHRIST. They consider these proofs to be not so strong as they expected, or as they think desirable. Now such persons should be asked, whether these arguments they speak of are in their estimation weak as a guide to their own practice, or weak in controversy with hardheaded and subtle disputants. Surely, as Bishop Butler has convincingly shown, the faintest probabilities are strong enough to determine our *conduct* in a matter of duty. If there be but a reasonable likelihood of our pleasing CHRIST more by keeping than by not keeping to the fellowship of the Apostolic Ministry, this of course ought to be enough to lead those, who think themselves moved to undertake the Sacred Office, to seek for a licence to do so from it.

It is necessary to keep this truth distinctly in view, because of the great temptation, that exists among us, to put it out of sight. I do not mean the temptation, which results from pride,—hardness of heart,—a profane disregard of the details and lesser commandments of the Divine Law,—and other such like bad principles of our nature, which are in the way of our honestly confessing it. Besides these, there is a still more subtle temptation to slight it, which will bear insisting on here, arising from an over-desire to convince others, or, in other words, a desire to out-argue others, a fear of seeming inconclusive and confused in our own notions and arguments. Nothing, certainly, is more natural, when we hold a truth strongly, than to wish to persuade others to embrace it also. Nay, without reference to persuasion, nothing is more natural than to be dissatisfied in all cases with our own convictions of a principle or opinion, nay suspicious of it, till we are able to set it down clearly in words. We know, that, in all matters of thought, to write down our meaning is one important means of clearing our minds. Till we do so, we often do not know what we really hold, and what we do not hold. And a cautious and accurate reasoner, when he has succeeded in bringing the truth of any subject home to his mind, next begins to look round about the view he has adopted, to consider what others will say to it, and try to make it unexceptionable. At least we are led thus to fortify our opinion, when it is actually attacked; and if we find we cannot recommend it to the judgment of the assailant, at any rate we endeavour to make him feel that it is to be respected. It is painful to be thought a weak reasoner, even though we are sure in our minds that we are not such.

Now, observe how these feelings will affect us, as regards such arguments as were alluded to above; viz. such as are open to exception, though they are sufficiently strong to determine our conduct. A friend, who differs from us, asks for our reasons for our own view. We state them, and he sifts them. He observes, that our conclusions do not necessarily follow from our premises. E.g. to take the argument for the Apostolical Succession derived from the ordination of St. Paul and St. Barnabas (Acts xiii. 2, 3), he will argue, that their ordination *might* have been an accidental rite, intended merely to commission them for their Missionary journey, which followed it, in Asia Minor; again, that St. Paul's direction to Timothy (1 Tim. v. 22), to "lay hands suddenly on no man," *may* refer to confirmation, not ordination.

We should reply (and most reasonably too), that, *considering the undeniable fact* that ordination has ever been thought necessary in the Church for the Ministerial Commission, our interpretation is the most probable one, and therefore the safest to act upon; on which our friend will think awhile, then shake his head, and say, that "at all events this is an *unsatisfactory* mode of reasoning, that it does not convince *him*, that he is desirous of clearer light," &c.

Now what is the consequence of such a discussion as this on ourselves? not to make us *give up* the doctrine, but to make us afraid of *urging* it. We grow lukewarm about it; and, with an appearance of judgment and caution (as the world will call it), confess that “to rest the claims of our Clergy on an Apostolical Descent is an unsafe and inexpedient line of argument; that it will not convince men, the evidence not being sufficient; that it is not a practical way of acting to insist upon it,” &c.—whereas the utmost that need be admitted is, that it is out of place to make it the subject of a speculative dispute, and to argue about it on that abstract logical platform which virtually excludes a reference to conduct and duty. And indeed, it would be no unwise caution to bear about us, wherever we go, that our first business, as Christians, is to address men as responsible servants of CHRIST, not as antagonists; and that it is but a secondary duty (though a duty) to “refute the gainsayers.”

And, as on the one hand it continually happens, that those who are most skilled in debate are deficient in sound practical piety, so on the other it may be profitable to us to reflect, that doctrines, which we believe to be most true, and which are received as such by the most profound and enlarged intellects, and which rest upon the most irrefragable proofs, yet may be above *our* disputative powers, and can be treated by us only with reference to our conduct. And in this way, as in others, is fulfilled the saying of the Apostle, that “the preaching of the Cross is to them that perish foolishness; but unto us, who are saved, it is the power of GOD . . . Where is the wise? where is the scribe? where is the disputer of this world? hath not GOD made foolish the wisdom of this world? . . . The foolishness of GOD is wiser than men; and the weakness of GOD is stronger than men.”

ON RELUCTANCE TO CONFESS THE APOSTOLICAL SUCCESSION

IF a Clergyman is quite convinced that the Apostolical Succession is lost, then of course he is at liberty to turn his mind from the subject. But if he is not quite sure of this, it surely is his duty seriously to examine the question, and to make up his mind carefully and deliberately. For if there be a chance of its being preserved to us, there is a chance of his having had a momentous talent committed to him, which he is burying in the earth.

It cannot be supposed that any serious man would treat the subject scoffingly. If any one is tempted to do so, let him remember the fearful words of the Apostle. “Esau, a *profane person*, who for one morsel of meat, sold his birthright.”

If any are afraid that to insist on their commission will bring upon them ridicule, and diminish their usefulness, let them ask themselves whether it be not cowardice to refuse to leave the event to GOD. It was the reproach of the men of Ephraim, that, though they were “harnessed and carried bows,” they “turned themselves back in the day of battle.”

And if any there be, who take upon them to contrast one doctrine of the Gospel with another, and preach those only which they consider the more essential, let them consider our SAVIOUR’S words, “These things ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.”

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The Visible Church Letters to a Friend No. III.

Tract No. 20 (Ad Scholas)

YOU have some misgivings, it seems, lest the doctrine I have been advocating “should lead to Popery.” I will not, by way of answer, say that the question is not, whether it will *lead to Popery*, but whether it is *in the Bible*; because it would bring the Bible and Popery into one sentence, and seem to imply the possibility of a “communion” between “light and darkness.” No; it is the very enmity I feel against the Papistical corruptions of the Gospel, which leads me to press upon you a doctrine of Scripture, which we are sinfully surrendering, and the Church of Rome has faithfully retained.

How comes it that a system, so unscriptural as the Popish, makes converts? because it has in it an element of truth and comfort amid its falsehoods. And the true way of opposing it, is, not to give up to them that element, which GOD’S providence has preserved to us also, thus basely surrendering “the inheritance of our Fathers,” but to claim it as our own, and to make use of it for the purposes for which GOD has given it to us. I will explain what I mean.

Before CHRIST came, Divine Truth was, as it were, a pilgrim in the world. The Jews excepted, men who had portions of the SPIRIT of GOD, knew not their privilege. The whole force and current of the external world was against them, acting powerfully on their imagination, and tempting them to set sight against faith, to trust the many witnesses who prophesied falsehood (as if) in the name of the LORD, rather than the still small voice which spoke within them. Who can undervalue the power of this fascination, who has had experience of the world ever so little? Who can go at this day into mixed society, who can engage in politics or other active business, and not find himself gradually drifting off from the true Rock on which his faith is built, till he begins in despair to fancy, that solitude is the only safe place for the Christian, or, (with a baser judgment,) that strict obedience will not be required at the last day of those who have been engaged in active life? If such is now the power of the world’s enchantments, surely much greater was it before our SAVIOUR came.

Now what did He do for us, in order to meet this evil? His merciful Providence chose means which might act as a counter-influence on the imagination. The visible power of the world enthralled men to a lie; He set up a Visible Church, to witness the other way, to witness for Him, to be a matter of fact, as undeniable as the shining of the sun, that there *was* such a principle as conscience in the world, as faith, as fear of GOD; that there *were* men who considered themselves bound to live as His servants. The common answer which we hear made every day to persons who engage in any novel undertaking, is, “You will get no one to join you; nothing can come of it; you are singular in your opinion; you do not take practical views, but are smit with a fancy, with a dream of former times,” &c. How cheering it is to a person so circumstanced, to be able to point to others elsewhere, who actually hold the same opinions as himself, and exert themselves for the same objects! Why? because it is an appeal to a *fact*, which no one can deny; it is an evidence that the view which influences him is something external to his own mind, and not a dream. What two persons see, cannot be an ideal apparition. Men are governed by such facts much more than by argumentative proof. These act upon the imagination. Let a person be told ten times over that an opinion is true, the *fact* of its being said becomes an argument for the truth of it; *i.e.* it is so with most men. We see from time to time the operation of this principle of our nature in political matters. Our American colonies revolt; France feels the sympathy of the event, and is revolutionized. Again, in the same colonies, the Episcopal Church flourishes; we Churchmen at home hail it as an omen of the Church’s permanence among ourselves. On the other hand, what can be more dispiriting than to find a cause, which we advocate, sinking in some other country or neighbourhood, though there

be no reason for concluding, that, *because* it has fallen elsewhere, therefore it will among ourselves. In order then to supply this need of our minds, to satisfy the imagination, and so to help our faith, for this among other reasons CHRIST set up a visible Society, His Church, to be as a light upon a hill, to all the ends of the earth, while time endures. It is a witness of the unseen world; a pledge of it; and a prefiguration of what hereafter will take place. It prefigures the ultimate separation of good and bad, holds up the great laws of GOD'S Moral Governance, and preaches the blessed truths of the Gospel. It pledges to us the promises of the next world, for it is something (so to say) in hand; CHRIST has done one work as the earnest of another. And it witnesses the truth to the whole world; awing sinners, while it enspirits the fainting believer. And in all these ways it helps forward the world to come; and further, as the keeper of the Sacraments, it is an essential means of the realizing it at present in our fallen race. Nor is it much to the purpose, as regards our duty towards it, what are the feelings and spiritual state of the individuals who are its officers. True it is, were the Church to teach heretical doctrine, it might become incumbent on us (a miserable obligation!) to separate from it. But, while it teaches substantially the Truth, we ought to look upon it as one whole, one ordinance of GOD, not as composed of individuals, but as a house of GOD'S building;—as an instrument in His hand, to be used and revered for the sake of its Maker.

Now the Papists have retained it; and so they have the advantage of possessing an instrument, which is, in the first place, suited to the needs of human nature; and next, is a special gift of CHRIST, and so has a blessing with it. Accordingly we see that in its measure success follows their zealous use of it. They act with great force upon the imaginations of men. The vaunted antiquity, the universality, the unanimity of their Church puts them above the varying fashions of the world, and the religious novelties of the day. And truly when one surveys the grandeur of their system, a sigh arises in the thoughtful mind, to think that we should be separate from them; Cum talis esset, utinam noster esset!—But, alas! AN UNION IS IMPOSSIBLE. Their communion is infected with heterodoxy; we are bound to flee it, as a pestilence. They have established a lie in the place of GOD'S truth and, by their claim of immutability in doctrine, cannot undo the sin they have committed. They cannot repent. Popery must be destroyed; it cannot be reformed.

Now then what is the Christian to do? Is he forced back upon that cheerless atheism (for so it practically must be considered) which prevailed in the world before CHRIST'S coming, poorly alleviated, as it was, by the received polytheisms of the heathen? Can we conceive a greater calamity to have occurred at the time of our Reformation, one which the Enemy of man would have been more set on effecting, than to have entangled the whole of the Church Catholic in the guilt of heterodoxy, and so have forced every one who worshipped in spirit and in truth, to flee out of doors into the bleak world, in order to save his soul? I do not think that Satan could have desired any event more eagerly, than such an alternative; viz. to have forced Christians, either to remain in communion with error, or to join themselves in some such spontaneous union among themselves, as is dissolved as easily as it is formed. Blessed be GOD! his malice has been thwarted. I do believe it to be one most conspicuous mark of GOD'S adorable Providence over us, as great as if we saw a miracle, that Christians in England escaped in the evil day from either extreme, neither corrupted doctrinally, nor secularized ecclesiastically. Thus in every quarter of the world, from North America to New South Wales, a Zoar has been provided for those who would fain escape Sodom, yet dread to be without shelter. I hail it as an omen amid our present perils, that our Church will not be destroyed. He hath been mindful of us; He will bless us. He has wonderfully preserved our Church as a true branch of the Church universal, yet withal preserved it free from doctrinal error. It is Catholic and Apostolic, yet not Papistical.

With this reflection before us, does it not seem to be utter ingratitude to an astonishing Providence of GOD'S mercy, to be neglectful, as many Churchmen now are, of the gift; to attempt unions with those who have separated from the Church, to break down the partition walls, and to argue as if religion were altogether and only a matter of each man's private concern, and that the State and Nation were not bound to prefer the Apostolical Church to all self-originated forms of Christianity? But this is a point beside my purpose. Take the matter merely in the light of human expedience. Shall we be so far less wise in our generation than the children of this world, as to relinquish the support which the Truth receives from the influence of a visible Church upon the imagination, from the energy of operation which a well disciplined Body ensures? Shall we not foil the Papists, not with their own weapons, but with weapons which are ours as well as theirs? or, on the other hand, shall we with a melancholy infatuation give them up to them? Depend upon it, to insist on the doctrine of the Visible Church is not to favour the Papists, it is to do them the most serious injury. It is to deprive them of their only strength. But if we neglect to do so, what will be the consequence? Break down the Divine Authority of our Apostolical Church, and you are plainly preparing the way for Popery in our land. Human nature cannot remain without visible guides; it chooses them for itself, if it is not provided for them. If the Aristocracy and the Church fall, Popery steps in. Political events are beyond our power, and perhaps out of our sphere; but ecclesiastical matters are in the hands of all Churchmen.

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Mortification of the Flesh a Scripture Duty

Tract No. 21 (Ad Populum)

IF we take the example of the Holy men of Scripture as our guide, certainly bodily privation and chastisement are a very essential duty of all who wish to serve GOD, and prepare themselves for His presence.

1. First, we have the example of Moses. His recorded Fasts were miraculous; still they were Fasts, and the ordinance was recommended to the notice of all believers afterwards, by the honour put upon it. "I abode in the mount forty days and forty nights; I neither did eat bread nor drink water." Again; "I fell down before the LORD, as at the first, forty days and forty nights; I did neither eat bread nor drink water, because of all your sins." Deut. ix. 9, 18. Fasting is in the former instance subservient to divine contemplation, in the latter to humiliation and intercession for sinners.

Elijah. "He said unto him, What manner of man was he which came up to meet you, and told you these words? And they answered him, He was an hairy man, and girt with a girdle of leather about his loins. And he said, It is Elijah the Tishbite." 2 Kings i. 7, 8. It is indeed needless to show the ascetic character of him who was in fact the chief and type of those who "wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins," "in deserts, and in mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth." He too fasted by the power of GOD for forty days and nights; "He arose and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meat forty days and forty nights, unto Horeb the mount of GOD" 1 Kings xix. 8.

Daniel. "I set my face unto the LORD GOD, to seek by prayer and supplications, with fasting, and sackcloth, and ashes; and I prayed unto the LORD my GOD, and made my confession." Dan. ix. 3, 4. It must be observed, that Daniel was not bound by any vow, as Samson and Samuel. Moreover it would appear the gift of prophecy was given him in reward for his self-chastisements, as the following passage shows. "In those days I Daniel was mourning three full weeks; I ate no pleasant bread, neither came flesh nor wine in my mouth; neither did I anoint myself at all, till three whole weeks were fulfilled . . . And he said unto me, O Daniel, a man greatly beloved, understand the words that I speak unto thee, and stand upright; for unto thee am I now sent . . . Fear not, Daniel ; for *from the first day* that thou didst set thine heart to understand, and *to chasten thyself* before thy GOD, thy words were heard, and I am come for thy words." Dan. x. 2, 3, 11, 12. Vide also Luke ii. 37. Acts x. 30.

2. Now here it will be objected, perhaps, that these instances are taken from the Old Testament, and belong to the Law of Moses, which is not binding on Christians.

I answer:

(1.) That in the above passages Fasting is connected with moral acts, humiliation, prayer, meditation, which are equally binding on us as on the Jews. Man is now what he was then; and if affliction of the flesh was good then, it is now.

(2.) In matter of fact, *private* Fasting, such as instanced in the passages above quoted, was no special duty of the Mosaic Law. Public Fasting, indeed, was on one occasion enjoined by Moses himself, and on others by subsequent rulers; but this was in part a ceremonial act, not a moral discipline, and was doubtless abolished with the other rites of the Law.

"Of Fasts," says Lewis, "there was no more than one appointed by the Law of Moses, called the Fast of Expiation . . . The great day of Expiation was a most severe Fast, kept every year upon the tenth day of the month Tizri, which answers to our September . . . This solemnity was observed with fasting and abstinence, not only from all meat and drink, but from all other pleasure whatsoever; insomuch that they did not wash their faces, much less anoint their heads, nor wear

their shoes . . . nor, (if their Doctors say true,) read any portion of the law which would give them delight. They refrained likewise not only from pleasure, but from labour, nothing being to be done upon this day, but confessing of sins and repentance.”⁶

Nay, it may rather be said, that the Jewish Law, as such, was rather opposed than otherwise to austerities. The Nazarites and Rechabites, being exceptions to the rule, are evidence of it. Vide, on the other hand, Deut. xii. Eccles. v. 18⁷.

Such then being the character of the Law in its formal letter, it tells just the contrary way to that which superficial reasoners might expect. For it is most remarkable, first, that the greatest prophets under it, such as Elijah and Daniel, were without express command singularly austere and self-afflicting men, in the midst of a people, who from the first went lusting after “the fish which they eat in Egypt freely; the cucumbers, and the melons, and the leeks, and the onions, and the garlick, and said, Who shall give us flesh to eat?” Next there is something of a very startling and admonitory nature in the *miraculous* fasts of Moses and Elijah, under this same imperfect dispensation. The miracle evidently was for some purpose; yet it did not sanction, in any direct way, any injunction of the Law. Was it not an admonition to the Israelites, that there was a more excellent way of obedience than that which ALMIGHTY GOD as yet thought fit to promulgate by solemn enactment? Is it not an intimation serviceable for Christian practice, as much as Moses’ announcement of the destined “Prophet like unto him” is intended for the comfort of Christian faith?

Surely the duty of bodily discipline might be rested on the answer to this plain question, *Why* did Daniel use austerities not enjoined by the Law?

3. Now turn to the New Testament, and observe what clear light is therein thrown upon the duty already recommended to us by the Old Testament Saints.

First, there is the instance of St. John the Baptist. “John came neither eating nor drinking,” Matt. xi. 18: and his disciples fasted, Matt. ix. 14.

Our SAVIOUR did *not* stately fast; but here also the exception proves the rule. He who did not fast stately was the only one born of woman who was untainted by sinful flesh; which seems to imply, that all who are natural descendants of guilty Adam ought to fast.

He bade His disciples to fast. Consider his implied precept, which is an express command to those who obey the Law of Liberty. “When thou fastest, anoint thy head, and wash thy face, that thou appear not unto men to fast.” Matt. vi. 17, 18.

Consider, moreover, the *general austere* character of Christian obedience, as enjoined by our LORD;—a circumstance much to be insisted on in an age like this, when what is really self-indulgence is thought to be a mere moderate and innocent use of this world’s goods. I will but refer to a few, out of many texts, which I am persuaded are now forgotten by numbers of educated and amiable men who are fond of extolling what they call the mild, tolerant, enlightened spirit of the Gospel. Matt. v. 29, 30. vii. 13, 14. x. 37-39. Mark ix. 43-50. x. 25. Luke xiv. 12, 26-33.

And reflect, too, whether the spirit of texts such as the following will not move every true member of the Church Militant. “The ark, and Israel, and Judah abide in tents; and my lord Joab, and the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open fields; shall I then go into mine house, to eat and to drink? . . . as thou liveth, and as thy soul liveth, I will not do this thing.” 2 Sam. xi. 11.

Now take the example of the Apostles. St. Peter was fasting, when he had the vision which sent him to Cornelius: Acts x. 10. The prophets and teachers at Antioch were fasting, when the HOLY

⁶Lewis, Hebrew Republic, iv. 15

⁷Vide Spencer de Regg. Hebræor. lib. 3. diss. 1. ii. 3. diss. 4. i. 5, &c.

GHOST revealed to them His purpose about Saul and Barnabas: Acts iii. 2, 3. Vide also Acts xiv. 23. 2 Cor. vi. 5. xi. 27.

Weigh well the following text, which I am persuaded many men would deny to be St. Paul's writing, had not a gracious Providence preserved to us the epistle containing it. "I keep under my body, and bring it into subjection; lest that by any means, when I have preached to others, I myself should be a cast-away." 1 Cor. ix. 27.

4. Lastly, Consider the practice of the Primitive Christians.

The following account of the early Christian Fasts, is from Bingham, *Antiq. lib. xxi.*

THE QUADRAGESIMAL OR LENT FAST.—"The Quadragesimal Fast before Easter," says Sozomen, "some observe six weeks, as the Illyrian and Western Churches, and all Libya, Egypt, and Palestine; others make it seven weeks, as the Constantinopolitans and neighbouring nations as far as Phœnicia; others fast three only of those six or seven weeks, by intervals; others the three weeks next immediately before Easter."

The manner of observing Lent among those that were piously disposed to observe it, was to abstain from all food till evening. For anciently a change of diet was not reckoned a fast: but it consisted in perfect abstinence from all sustenance for the whole day till evening.

THE FASTS OF THE FOUR SEASONS.—The next Anniversary fasting days were those which were called *Jejunia quatuor temporum*, the Fasts of the Four Seasons of the Year . . . These were at first designed . . . to beg a blessing of God upon the several seasons of the year, or to return thanks for the benefits received in each of them, or to exercise and purify both body and soul in a more particular manner, at the return of these certain terms of stricter discipline and more extraordinary devotion. [These afterwards became the Ember Fasts.]

MONTHLY FASTS.—In some places they had also Monthly Fasts throughout the year excepting in the two months of July and August . . . because of the sickness of the season.

WEEKLY FASTS.—Besides these they had their weekly Fasts or, Wednesday and Friday, called the Stationary Days, and Half-Fasts or Fasts of the Fourth and Sixth Days of the Week . . . These Fasts being of continual use every week throughout the Year, except in the Fifty Days between Easter and Pentecost, were not kept with that rigour and strictness which was observed in the time of Lent . . . [but] ordinarily held no longer than 9 o'clock, i.e. 3 in the afternoon.

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The Reformed Church

Tract No. 31 (Ad Clerum)

All the people shouted with a great shout, when they praised the LORD, because the foundation of the House of the LORD was laid. But many of the Priests and Levites, the chief of the fathers, who were ancient men that had seen the first House, when the foundation of this House was laid before their eyes, wept with a loud voice.—EZRA iii. 11, 12.

SOME remarks may, perhaps, be profitably made on the following well known lines in Herbert's Church Militant, in which the text above quoted is applied to our own period:

The second Temple could not reach the first,
And the late Reformation never durst
Compare with ancient times and purer years,
But in the Jews and us, deserveth tears.
Nay, it shall every year decrease and fade,
Till such a darkness shall the world invade
At CHRIST'S last coming, as His first did find;
Yet must their proportions be assigned
To these diminishings, as is between
The spacious world and Jewry to be seen.

Surely there is a close analogy between the state of the Jews after the captivity, and our own; and, if so, a clear understanding and acknowledgment of it will tend to teach us our own place and suggest to us our prospects.

1. It is scarcely necessary to notice the general correspondence between the fortunes of the two Churches. Both Jews and Christians "left their first love," mixed with the world, were brought under the power of their enemies, went into captivity, and at length, through GOD'S mercy, were brought back again from Babylon. Ezra and Nehemiah are the forerunners of our Hookers and Lauds; Sanballat and Geshem of the disturbers of our Israel. Samaria has set up its rival temple among us.

2. The second Temple lacked the peculiar treasures of the Temple of Solomon, the Prince of Peace; such as the Ark, the visible glory of GOD, the tables of the Covenant, Aaron's rod, the manna, the oracle. In like manner the Christian Church was, in the beginning, set up in unity; unity of doctrine, or *truth*, unity of discipline, or *Catholicism*, unity of heart, or *charity*. In spite of the heresies which then disturbed the repose of Christians, consider the evidences which present themselves in ecclesiastical history of their firm endurance of persecution, their tender regard for the members of CHRIST, however widely removed by place and language, their self-denying liberality in supplying their wants, the close correspondence of all parts of the body Catholic, as though it were but one family, their profound reverential spirit towards sacred things, the majesty of their religious services, and the noble strictness of their life and conversation. Here we see the "Rod" of the Priesthood, budding forth with fresh life; the "Manna" of the Christian ordinances uncorrupted; the "Oracle" of Tradition fresh from the breasts of the Apostles; the "Law," written in its purity on "the fleshly tables of the heart;" the "Shechinah," which a multitude of Martyrs, Saints, Confessors, and gifted Teachers, poured throughout the Temple. But where is our unity

now? our ministrations of self-denying love? our prodigality of pious and charitable works? our resolute resistance of evil? We are reformed; we have come out of Babylon, and have rebuilt our Church; but it is Ichabod; "the glory is departed from Israel."

3. The Jewish polity was, on its restoration, so secularized, that the vestiges of a Theocracy scarcely remained in the eyes of any but attentive believers. That it really existed as before, is plain from the prophetic gift possessed by Caiaphas, wicked man as he was. Consider the anomaly of the political relation of the Jews towards the Ptolemies and Seleucidæ, their alliance with Rome, their dispersion over the Roman Empire, their disuse of certain of the Mosaic ordinances, the cruelties and blasphemies of Antiochus, the reign of Herod, and his virtual rebuilding of the Temple, a remarkable omen as regards ourselves. Turn to the restored Christian Church, and reflect upon the perplexed questions concerning the union of Church and State, to which the politics of the last three centuries have given rise: the tyrannical encroachments of the civil power at various eras; the profanations at the time of the Great Rebellion; the deliberate impiety of the French Revolution; and the present apparent breaking up of Ecclesiastical Polity every where, the innumerable schisms, the mixture of men of different creeds and sects, and the contempt poured upon any show of Apostolical zeal.

4. Consider the following passages, from the Prophets, after the Captivity, and see if they do not apply to present times.

Hagg. i. 4-10. "Is it time for you, O ye, to dwell in your ceiled houses, and this house lie waste? Now, therefore, thus saith the LORD of Hosts, consider your ways. Ye have *sown much*, and *bring in little*; ye eat, but ye have not enough; ye drink, but ye are not filled with drink; ye clothe you, but there is none warm; and he that earneth wages, *earneth wages to put it into a bag with holes*," &c.

Mal. i. 6-13. "A son honoureth his father, and a servant his master; if then I be a Father, where is Mine honour? and if I be a Master, where is My fear? ... Ye say, *The table of the Lord is polluted, and the fruit thereof, even His meat, contemptible*. Ye say also, Behold what a *weariness* is it, ... and ye brought that which was torn, and the lame, and the sick; thus ye brought an offering; should I accept this of your hands, saith the LORD?"

Mal. ii. 1-9. "And now, O ye Priests, this commandment is for you ... And ye shall know that I have sent this commandment unto you, that My covenant might be with Levi, saith the LORD of Hosts. My covenant was with him of life and peace, and I gave them to him, for the fear wherewith he feared Me, and was afraid before My Name. The Law of Truth was in his mouth, and iniquity was not found in his lips; he walked with Me in peace and equity, and did turn many away from iniquity. For the Priest's lips should keep knowledge, and they shall seek the Law at his mouth; for he is the messenger of the LORD of hosts. *But ye are departed out of the way*; ye have caused many to stumble at the Law: *ye have corrupted the covenant of Levi*, saith the LORD of Hosts. *Therefore have I also made you contemptible and base before all the people*." Does not the history of the times of Hoadly and such as he, and our present trials, throw light upon the parallel?

Mal. iii. 8, 9. "Will a man rob GOD? yet ye have robbed Me; but ye say, Wherein have we robbed Thee? *in tithes and offerings*. Ye are *cursed with a curse*; for ye have robbed Me, even this whole nation."

5. It is remarkable that, while the reinstated Jewish Church was so deficient in zeal, piety, and consistent obedience, and was punished by failure and disorganization; yet it never fell into those gross and flagrant offences, which were the opprobrium of its earlier period. *It was clear of the sin of idolatry*.

6. Moreover consider the *parties*, unknown to the era of the Theocracy, which divided the

Church after the captivity; the Pharisees, Sadducees, and the rest; the necessary consequence of a relaxation of the original principle of national union. The case is the same in this day; as if the Church were already dead, new forms of organization, multiplied varieties of life and action, show themselves within her.

7. Lastly. The following texts suggest hope to all true Christians. (Hagg. ii. 5-9.) *"According to the word that I covenanted with you, when ye came out of Egypt, so MY SPIRIT REMAINETH AMONG YOU: fear ye not."* He will be with us even in this base and grovelling age, as with St. Paul, St. Cyprian, and St. Athanasius.

"Thou wilt; for Thou art Israel's GOD;

And thine unwearied arm

Is ready yet with Moses' rod," &c.

"The glory of this latter house SHALL BE GREATER THAN OF THE FORMER, saith the LORD of Hosts."

Strange it now seems before the event, how the Church should close both with glory and yet in unbelief; yet surely, as in the history of Jerusalem, so now both predictions will be at once fulfilled. (Mal. iv. 1, 2.) *"The day cometh that shall burn as an oven, and all the proud, yea, and all who do wickedly shall be stubble: but unto you that fear My name shall the Sun of Righteousness arise with healing in His wings."*

And let it be remembered, that when our Lord seems at greatest distance from His Church, then He is even at the doors. Doubtless, when the Angel appeared in the Temple to Zacharias, the news of a miraculous interposition was as great a marvel to the world at large as if it were now noised abroad of one of our own Ministers in the course of his Christian Service.

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The Feast of St. Mark

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Primitive Episcopacy

Tract No. 33 (Ad Scholas)

IN primitive times the first step towards evangelizing a heathen country seems to have been to seize upon some principal city in it, commonly the civil metropolis, as a centre of operation; to place a Pastor, *i.e.* (generally) a Bishop there; to surround him with a sufficient number of associates and assistants; and then to wait, till, under the blessing of Providence, this Missionary College was able to gather around it the scattered children of grace from the evil world, and invest itself with the shape and influence of an organized Church. The converts would, in the first instance, be those in the immediate vicinity of the Missionary or Bishop, whose diocese nevertheless would extend over the heathen country on every side, either indefinitely, or to the utmost extent of the civil province; his mission being without restriction to all to whom Christian faith had never been preached. As he prospered in the increase of his flock, and set out his clergy to greater and greater distances from the city, so would the homestead (so to call it) of his Church enlarge. Other towns would be brought under his government, openings would occur for stations in isolated places; till at length “the burden becoming too heavy for him,” he would appoint others to supply his place in this or that part of the province. To these he would commit a greater or lesser share of his spiritual power, as might be necessary: sometimes he would make them fully his representatives, or ordain them Bishops; at other times he would employ presbyters for his purpose. These assistants, or (as they were called) Chorepiscopi, would naturally be confined to their respective districts; and if Bishops, an approximation would evidently be made to a division of the large original diocese into a number of smaller ones connected with and subordinate to the Bishop of the metropolitan city. Thus, from the very Missionary character of the Primitive Church, there was a tendency in its polity to what was afterwards called the Provincial and Patriarchal system.

It is not, indeed, to be supposed that this was the only way in which the graduated order of sees (so to call it) originated; but, at least, it is one way. And there is this advantage in remarking it: we learn from it, that large dioceses are the characteristics of a church in its infancy or weakness; whereas, the more firmly Christianity was rooted in a country, and the more vigorous its rulers, the more diligently were its sees multiplied throughout the ecclesiastical territory. Thus, St. Basil, in the fourth century, finding his exarchate defenceless in the neighbourhood of Mount Taurus, created a number of dioceses to meet the emergency. These subordinate sees may be called suffragan to the Metropolitan Church, whether their respective rulers were mere representatives of the Bishop who created them, *i.e.*, Chorepiscopi; or, on the other hand, substantive authorities, sovereign within their own limits, though bound by external ties to each other and to their Metropolitan. The most perfect state of a Christian country would be, where there was a sufficient number of separate dioceses; the next to it, where there were Chorepiscopi, or Suffragan Bishops in the modern sense of the word.

Few persons, who have not expressly examined the subject, are aware of the minuteness of the dioceses into which many parts of Christendom were divided in the first ages. Some Churches in Italy were more like our rural deaneries than what we now consider dioceses; being not above ten or twelve miles in extent, and their sees not above five or six miles from each other. Even now (or, at least, in Bingham’s time) the kingdom of Naples contains 147 sees, of which twenty are Archbishoprics. Asia Minor is 630 miles long, 210 broad; yet in this country there were almost 400 dioceses. Palestine is in length 160 miles, in breadth 120; yet the number of known dioceses amounted to 48. Again, in the province of Syria Secunda, the see of Larissa (*e.g.*) was about 14 miles from Apamea, Arethusa 16 from Epiphania. And so again, turning to the West, though the

dioceses were generally larger, as partaking more of a Missionary character, yet we shall find in Ireland at one time from 50 to 60 sees.

Such was the character of the Primitive Regimen, where Christianity especially flourished in the zeal and number of its professors. But, where the country was mountainous or desert, the inhabitants scanty, or but partially Christian, it was considered advisable to leave all to the management of one chief Pastor, who appointed assistants to himself according to his discretion, as the circumstances of the times required. The office of these Chorepiscopi, or country Bishops, was to preside over the country clergy, inquire into their behaviour, and report to their principal; also to provide fit persons for the inferior ministrations of the Church. They had the power of ordaining the lower ranks of clergy, such as the readers, sub-deacons, and exorcists; they might ordain priests and deacons with the leave of the city Bishop, and administer the rite of confirmation; and were permitted to sit and vote in councils. Thus their office bore a considerable resemblance to that of our Archdeacons; except, of course, that they had the power of ordination; whereas the latter are only presbyters. And, in matter of fact, by such presbyters (*visitors*, as they were called) they were superseded in the course of the fourth and following centuries, till at length the Pope caused the order to be set aside almost altogether in the ninth.

Little use was made of Suffragans during the middle ages; but, at the time of our Reformation, Archbishop Cranmer felt the deficiency of the English Church in respect of Bishoprics, and projected several measures to supply it. The most complete was that of increasing the number of dioceses; availing himself of existing circumstances, he advised the King to apply the Abbey lands to the founding of twenty additional sees. Bishop Burnet gives some of the particulars of this attempt in the following passage:

“On the 23d of May, in the session of Parliament, a bill was brought in by Cromwell for giving the King power to erect new bishoprics by his letters-patent⁸. It was read that day for the first, second, and third time; and sent down to the Commons. The preamble of it was, ‘that it was known what slothful and ungodly life had been led by those who were called religious. But that these houses might be converted to better uses; that GOD’S word might be better set forth; children brought up in learning; clerks nourished in the universities; and that old decayed servants might have livings; poor people might have almshouses to maintain them; readers of Greek, Hebrew, and Latin, might have good stipends; daily alms might be administered, and allowance might be made for mending of the highways, and exhibitions for ministers of the Church; for these ends, if the King thought fit to have more bishoprics or cathedral churches erected out of the rents of these houses, full power was given him to erect and found them, and to make rules and statutes for them, and such translations of sees, or divisions of them, as he thought fit.’ In the same paper, there is a list of the sees which he intended to found; of which what was done afterwards came so far short, that I know nothing to which it can be so reasonably imputed, as the declining of Cranmer’s interest at court, who had proposed the erecting the new cathedrals and sees, with other things mentioned in the preamble of the statute, as a great mean of reforming the Church.”

⁹ Some of the proposed additional dioceses are then enumerated; Essex, Hertford, Bedfordshire and Buckinghamshire, Oxford and Berkshire, Northampton and Huntingdon, Middlesex, Leicester and Rutland, Gloucestershire, Lancashire, Suffolk, Stafford and Salop, Nottingham and Derby, Cornwall. As to the means by which they were to be endowed, no opinion is here expressed on its lawfulness, as the present sketch is confined to the consideration of the spiritual part of the

⁸It is scarcely necessary to observe, that parliament was then the lay synod of the Church of England.

⁹Burnet, Hist. Reform. iii.

ecclesiastical system. It is scarcely necessary to add, that Cranmer's views were partly realized, in the subsequent creation of the dioceses of Chester, Bristol, Gloucester, Oxford, and Peterborough.

The same prelate, whose episcopate has had so important an influence upon the constitution of our Church ever since, also projected with great wisdom, a system of suffragan bishops or Chorepiscopi, which he was able to bring into effect, and which lasted till the reign of King James. Twenty-six such bishops were appointed; the bishop of the diocese having the power of presenting two persons to the king, who might choose either of them, and present them to the archbishop of the province for consecration. These suffragans exercised such jurisdiction as their principal gave them, or as had formerly been committed to suffragans; their authority lasting no longer than he continued their commission to them. "These were believed," says Burnet ¹⁰, "to be the same with the Chorepiscopi in the primitive church which, as they were begun before the first council of Nice, so they continued in the Western Church till the 9th century, and then a decretal of Damascus being forged, that condemned them, they were put down every where by degrees, and now revived in England. The suffragan sees were as follows: Thetford, Ipswich, Colchester, Dover, Guilford, Southampton, Taunton, Shaftsbury, Molton, Marlborough, Bedford, Leicester, Gloucester, Shrewsbury, Bristol, Penrith, Bridgwater, Nottingham, Gantham, Hull, Huntingdon, Cambridge, Pereth, Berwick, St. Germain's, and the Isle of Wight."

After the disuse of suffragans in the reign of James I. there was a fresh project for establishing them on the Restoration. Charles, in one of his declarations, promises to increase the number of bishops, in accordance with Archbishop Ussher's plan for episcopal government. However, his intention was not put into execution, doubtless owing to existing circumstances, which reasonably interfered with it.

The following extract is made from Bingham, *Antiqu.* ix. 8: "One great objection against the present diocesan episcopacy, and that which to many may look the most plausible, is drawn from the vast extent and greatness of most of the northern dioceses of the world, which makes it so extremely difficult for one man to discharge all the offices of the episcopal function ... The Church of England has usually followed the larger model, and had very great and extensive dioceses; for at first she had but seven bishoprics in the whole nation, and those commensurate in a manner to the seven Saxon kingdoms. Since that time she has thought it a point of wisdom to contract her dioceses, and multiply them into above 20; and if she should think fit to add 40 or 100 more, she would not be without precedent in the practice of the Primitive Church ... In Ireland there are not now above half the number of dioceses that there were before, and consequently they must needs be larger by uniting them together. In England, there are more in number than formerly, some new ones being created out of old ones, and at present the whole number augmented to three times as many as they were for some ages after the first conversion. Besides that, we have another way of contracting dioceses in effect here in England appointed by law, which law was never yet repealed; which is by devolving part of the bishop's care upon the Chorepiscopi, or suffragan bishops, as the law calls them:—a method commonly practised in the ancient Church in such large dioceses as those of St. Basil and Theodoret, one of which had no less than fifty Chorepiscopi under him, if Nazianzen rightly informs us. And it is a practice which was continued here all the reign of Queen Elizabeth, and even to the end of King James; and is what may be revived again, whenever any bishop thinks his diocese too large, or his burden too great to be sustained by himself alone."

To the above statements, may be subjoined the present number of souls, and the area of square

¹⁰Hist. Reform. ii.

miles, in certain of our dioceses, as given in a pamphlet lately published, which has come into the writer's hands since the foregoing was put on paper. (Vide Plan for a New Arrangement, &c. by Lord Henley.)

Souls Square

Miles

Chester 1,806,722 4140

London 1,676,725 1942

York 1,526,288 5300

Lincoln 920,011 5775

Lichfield 978,655 3344

By this table, it is not here intended to insinuate the necessity of any immediate measure of multiplying the English sees or appointing suffragans, (the expediency of which is to be determined by a variety of considerations, which it were unprofitable here to detail,) but to show that the *genius* of our ecclesiastical system tends towards such an increase, and that the only question to be determined is one of time. These statements are also made with the view of keeping up in the minds of churchmen a recollection of the injury which the Irish branch of our Church has lately sustained in the diminution of its sees.

OXFORD,

The Feast of St. Philip and St. James

P.S.—Since this was written, a new arrangement of Dioceses and Sees has been made by authority of a Royal Commission, composed of members the greater part of whom were laymen, and without confirmation of their acts on the part of the Church.

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Rites and Customs of the Church

Tract No. 34 (Ad Scholas)

[*Ho men oun pistos, hōs chrē, kai errhōmenos oude deitai logou kai aitias, huper ōn an epitachthēi, all'arkeitai tēi paradosei monēi*]. Chrysost. in 1 Cor. Hom. 26.

He who is duly strengthened in faith, does not go so far as to require argument and reason for what is enjoined, but is satisfied with the *tradition* alone.

THE reader of ecclesiastical history is sometimes surprised at finding observances and customs generally received in the Church at an early date, which have not express warrant in the Apostolic writings; *e.g.* the use of the cross in baptism. The following pages will be directed to the consideration of this circumstance; with a view of suggesting from those writings themselves, that a minute ritual was contemporaneous with them, that the Apostles recognise it as existing anti binding, that it was founded on religious *principles*, and tended to the inculcation of religious truth. Not that any formal proof is attainable or conceivable, considering the brevity and subjects of the inspired documents; but such fair evidence of the fact, as may recommend it to the belief of the earnest and single-minded Christian. It is abundantly evident that the Epistles were not written to prescribe and enforce the Ritual of religion; all then we can expect, if it existed in the days of the Apostles, is an occasional allusion to it in their Epistles as existing, and a plain acquiescence in it: and thus much we find.

Let us consider that remarkable passage, (1 Cor. xi. 2-16.) which, I am persuaded, most readers pass over as if they could get little instruction from it. St. Paul is therein blaming the Corinthians for not adhering to the *custom* of the Church, which prescribed that men should wear their hair short, and that women should have their head covered during divine service; a custom apparently most unimportant, if any one ever was, but in his view strictly binding on Christians. He begins by implying that it is one out of many rules or traditions ([*paradoseis*]) which he had given them, and they were bound to keep. He ends by refusing to argue with any one who obstinately cavils at it and rejects it: "If any man seem to be contentious, we have no such custom, neither the Churches of GOD." Here then at once a view is opened to us which is quite sufficient to remove the surprise we might otherwise feel at the multitude of rites, which were in use in the Primitive Church, but about which the New Testament is silent; and further, to command our obedience to such as come down to us from the first ages, and are agreeable to Scripture.

In accordance with this conclusion, is the clear and forcible command given by the Apostle, (2 Thess. ii. 15.) "Brethren, stand fast, and hold the traditions, which ye have been taught, whether *by word*, or our epistle."

To return. St. Paul goes on to give the reason of the usage, for the satisfaction of the weak brethren at Corinth. It was, he implied, a symbol or development (so to say) of the principle of the subordination of the woman to the man, and a memorial of the history of our creation; nay it was founded in "*nature*," *i.e.* natural reason. And lastly, it had a practical object: the woman ought to have her head covered "*because of the angels*." We need not stop to inquire *what* this reason was; but it was a reason of a practical nature which the Corinthians understood, though we may not. If it mean, as is probable, "*because she is in the sight of the heavenly angels*," (1 Tim. v. 21.) it gives a still greater importance to the ceremonies of worship, as connecting them with the unseen world.

It would seem indeed as if the very multiplicity of the details of the Church ritual made it plainly impossible for St. Paul to write them all down, or to do more than *remind* the Corinthians of his way of conducting religious discipline when he was among them. "Be ye *followers* of me;"

he says, "I praise you that *ye remember me* in all things." It is evident there are ten thousand little points in the working of any large system, which a present instructor alone can settle. Hence it is customary at present, when a school is set up, or when any novel manufacture in trade, or extraordinary machinery, is to be brought into use, to set it going by sending a person fully skilled in its practical details. Such was St. Paul as regards the system of Christian discipline and worship; and when he could not go himself, he sent Timothy in his place. He says in the 4th chapter: "I beseech you, be ye followers of me. *For this cause* have I sent unto you Timotheus, who shall bring you into remembrance *of my ways which be in CHRIST, as I teach every where in every Church.*" Here there is a like reference to an uniform system of discipline,—whether as to Christian conduct, worship, or Church government.

Another important allusion appears to be contained in the 22d verse of the chapter above commented on. "What, have ye not houses to eat and drink in? or despise ye the *Church of GOD?*" This is remarkable as being a solitary allusion in Scripture to *houses* of prayer under the Christian System, which nevertheless we know from *ecclesiastical history* were used from the very first. Here then is a most solemn ordinance of primitive Christianity, which barely escapes, if it escapes, omission in Scripture.

A passing allusion is made in another passage of the same Epistle, to the use of the word Amen at the conclusion of the Eucharistical prayer, as it is preserved after it and all other prayers to this day. Thus the ritual of the Apostles descended to minutiae, and these so invariable in their use, as to allow of an appeal to them.

In the original institution of the Eucharist, as recorded in the Gospels, there is no mention of *consecrating* the cup; but in 1 Cor. x. 16, St. Paul calls it "*the cup of blessing which we bless.*" This incidental information, vouchsafed to us in Scripture, should lead us to be very cautious how we put aside other usages of the early Church concerning this Sacrament, which do not happen to be *clearly* mentioned in Scripture; as *e.g.* the solemn offering of the elements to GOD by way of pleading His mercy through CHRIST, which seems to have been universal in the early Church

As regards the same Sacrament, let us consider the use of the word [*leitourgountōn*], *ministering* (Acts xiii. 2.); a word which, dropt (so to say) by accident, and interpreted, as is reasonable, by its use in the services of the Jewish Law, (Luke i. 23; Heb. x. 11.) remarkably coincides with the [*leitourgia*] of the Primitive Church, according to which the offering of the Altar was intercessory, as pleading CHRIST'S merits before the throne of grace.

Again, in 1 Cor. xv. 29, we incidentally discover the existence of persons who are styled "the baptized for the dead." Perhaps it is impossible to determine what is meant by this phrase, on which little light is thrown by early writers. However, any how it seems to refer to a *custom* of the Church, which was so usual as to admit of an appeal to it, which St. Paul approved, yet which he did not in the Epistle directly enforce, and but casually mentions.

In 1 Cor. i. 16, St. Paul happens to inform us that he baptized the *household* of Stephanas. It has pleased the HOLY SPIRIT to preserve to us this fact; by which is detected the existence of a rule of discipline for which the express doctrinal parts of Scripture afford but indirect warrant, viz. the custom of household baptism. (Vid. also Acts xvi. 15, 33.) This accidental disclosure accurately anticipates the after practice of the early Church, according to which families, infants included, were baptized, and that on a weighty doctrinal *reason*; viz. that all men were born in sin and in the wrath of GOD, and needed to be individually translated into that kingdom of grace, into which baptism is the initiation.

These instances, then, not to notice others of a like or a different kind, are surely sufficient to

reconcile us to the complete ritual system which breaks upon us in the writings of the Fathers. If any parts of it indeed are contrary to Scripture, that is of course a decisive reason at once for believing them to be additions and corruptions of the original ceremonial; but till this is shown, we are bound to venerate what is certainly primitive, and probably is apostolic.

It will be remarked, moreover, that many of the religious observances of the early Church are expressly built upon words of Scripture, and intended to be a visible memorial of them, after the manner of St. Paul's directions about the respective habits of men and women, which was just now noticed. Metaphorical or mystical descriptions were represented by a corresponding literal action. Our LORD Himself authorised this procedure when He took up the metaphor of the prophets concerning the fountain opened for our cleansing (Zech. xiii. 1.) and represented it in the visible rite of baptism. Accordingly, from the frequent mention of *oil* in Scripture as the emblem of spiritual gifts, (Is. lxi. 1-3, &c.) it was actually used in the Primitive Church in the ceremony of admitting catechumens, and in baptizing. And here again they had the precedent of the Apostles, who applied it in effecting their miraculous cures. (Mark vi. 13. James v. 14.) And so from the figurative mention in Scripture of *salt*, as the necessary preparation of every religious sacrifice, it was in use in the Western Church, in the ceremony of admitting converts into the rank of catechumens. So again from Phil. ii. 10, it was customary to bow the head at the name of JESUS. It were endless to multiply instances of a similar pious attention to the very words of Scripture, as their custom of continual public prayer from such passages as Luke xviii. 7; or of burying the bodies of martyrs under the altar, from Rev. vi. 9; or of the white vestments of the officiating ministers, from Rev. iv. 4.

Two passages on the subject from the Fathers shall now be laid before the reader, by way of further illustration, and first from Tertullian:

"Though this observance has not been determined by any Scripture, yet it is established by custom, which doubtless is derived from tradition. For how can an usage ever obtain, which has not first been given by tradition? But you say, even though tradition can be produced, still a written (Scripture) authority must be demanded. Let us examine, then, how far it is true, that a tradition itself, unless written in Scripture, is inadmissible. Now I will give up the point at once, if it is not already determined by instances of other observances, which are maintained without any Scripture proof, on the mere plea of tradition, and the sanction of consequent custom. To begin with baptism. Before we enter the water, we solemnly renounce the devil, his pomp, and his angels, in church in the presence of the Bishop. Then we are plunged in the water thrice, and answer certain questions over and above what the LORD has determined in the written gospel. After coming out of it, we taste a mixture of milk and honey; and for a whole week from that day we abstain from our daily bath. The sacrament of the Eucharist, though given by the LORD to all and at supper time, yet is celebrated in our meetings before day break, and only at the hand of our presiding ministers ... We sign our forehead with the cross whenever we set out and walk, go in or out, dress, gird on our sandals, bathe, eat, light our lamps, sit or lie down to rest, whatever we do. If you demand a scripture rule for these and such like observances, we can give you none; all we say to you is, that tradition directs, usage sanctions, faith obeys. That reason justifies this tradition, usage, and faith, you will soon yourself see, or will easily learn from others; meanwhile you will do well to believe that there is a law to which obedience is due. I add one instance from the old dispensation. It is so usual among the Jewish females to veil their head, that they are even known by it. I ask where the law is to be found; the Apostle's decision of course is not to the point. Now if I no where find a law, it follows that tradition introduced the custom, which afterwards was confirmed by the

Apostle when he explained the reason of it. These instances are enough to show that a tradition, even though not in Scripture, still binds our conduct, if a continuous usage be preserved as the witness of it.”—Tertullian, *de Coron.* § 3.

Upon this passage it may be observed, that Tertullian, flourishing A.D. 200, is on the one hand a very early witness for the existence of the general doctrine which it contains, while on the other he gives no sanction to those later customs, which the Church of Rome upholds, but which cannot be clearly traced to primitive times.

St. Basil, whose work on the HOLY SPIRIT, § 66, shall next be cited, flourished in the middle of the fourth century, 150 years after Tertullian, and was of a very different school; yet he will be found to be in exact agreement with him on the subject before us, viz. that the ritual of the Church was derived from the Apostles, and was based on religious principles and doctrines. He adds a reason for its not being given us in Scripture, which we may receive or reject as our judgment leads us, viz. that the rites were memorials of doctrines not intended for publication except among baptized Christians, whereas the Scriptures were open to all men. This at least is clear, that the ritual could scarcely have been given in detail in Scripture, without imparting to the Gospel the character of a burdensome ceremonial, and withdrawing our attention from its doctrines and precepts.

“Of those articles of doctrine and preaching, which are in the custody of the Church, some come to us in Scripture itself, some are conveyed to us by a continuous tradition in mystical depositories. Both have equal claims on our devotion, and are received by all, at least by all who are in any respect Churchmen. For, should we attempt to supersede the usages which are not enjoined in Scripture as if unimportant, we should do most serious injury to Evangelical truth: nay, reduce it to a bare name. To take an obvious instance; which Apostle has taught us in Scripture to sign believers with the cross? Where does Scripture teach us to turn to the east in prayer? Which of the saints has left us recorded in Scripture the words of invocation at the consecration of the bread of the Eucharist, and of the cup of blessing? Thus we are not content with what Apostle or Evangelist has left on record, but we add other rites before and after it, as important to the celebration of the mystery, receiving them from a teaching distinct from Scripture. Moreover, we bless the water of baptism, and the oil for anointing, and also the candidate for baptism himself . . . After the example of Moses, the Apostles and Fathers who modelled the Churches, were accustomed to lodge their sacred doctrine in mystic forms, as being secretly and silently conveyed . . . This is the reason why there is a tradition of observances independent of Scripture, lest doctrines, being exposed to the world, should be so familiar as to be despised . . . We stand instead of kneeling at prayer on the Sunday; but all of us do not know the reason of this . . . Again, every time we kneel down and rise up, we show by our outward action that sin has levelled us with the ground, and the loving mercy of our Creator has recalled us to heaven.”

The conclusion to be drawn from all that has been said in these pages is this:—That rites and ordinances, far from being unmeaning, are in their nature capable of impressing our memories and imaginations with the great revealed verities; far from being superstitious, are expressly sanctioned in Scripture as to their principle, and delivered to the Church in their form by tradition. Further, that they varied in different countries, according to the respective founder of the Church in each. Thus *e.g.*, St. John and St. Philip are known to have adopted the Jewish rule for observing Easter-day; while other Apostles celebrated it always on a Sunday. Lastly, that, although the details of the early ritual varied in importance, and corrupt additions were made in the middle ages, yet that, as a whole, the Catholic ritual was a precious possession; and if we, who have rid ourselves of those corruptions, have lost not only the possession, but the sense of its value, it is a serious question

whether we are not like men who recover from some grievous illness with the loss or injury of their sight or hearing;—whether we are not like the Jews returned from captivity, who could never find the rod of Aaron or the Ark of the Covenant, which, indeed, had ever been hid from the world, but then was removed from the Temple itself.

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The Feast of St. Philip and St. James

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The Grounds of our Faith

Tract No. 45 (Ad Clerum)

EVERY system of theology has its dangers, its tendencies towards evil. Systems short of the truth have this tendency inherent in themselves, and in process of time discover it, and work out the anticipated evil, which is but the legitimate though latent consequence of their principles. Thus, we may consider the present state of Geneva the fair result on the long run of the system of self-will which was established there in the sixteenth century. But even the one true system of religion has its dangers on all sides, from the weakness of its recipients, who pervert it. Thus the Holy Catholic doctrines, in which the Church was set up, were corrupted into Popery, not legitimately, or necessarily, but by various external causes acting on human corruption, in the lapse of many ages. St. Paul's command of obedience to rulers, was changed into the tyrannical rule of one Bishop over all countries; his recommendation of an unmarried life, for certain religious objects, was made a rule of celibacy in the case of the clergy. Now let us ask, what are the bad tendencies of Protestantism? for this is a question which nearly concerns ourselves. We are nearly 300 years from its rise in this country; have any evils yet shown themselves from it? It is not here proposed to examine the question at large; but a hint on one part of the subject may be made in answer to it.

At the Reformation, the authority of the Church was discarded by the spirit then predominant among Protestants, and Scripture was considered as the sole document both for ascertaining and proving our faith. The question immediately arose, "Is this or that doctrine in Scripture?"—and in consequence, various intellectual gifts, such as argumentative subtilty, critical acumen, knowledge of the languages, rose into importance, and became the interpreters of Christian truth. Exposition lay through controversy. Now the natural effect of disputation is to make us shun all but the strongest proofs, those which an adversary will find substantial impediments in his line of reasoning; and, therefore, to generate a cautious discriminative turn of thought, to fix in the mind a *standard* of proof simulating demonstration, and to make light of mere probabilities. This intellectual habit, resulting from controversy, would also arise from the peculiar exercises of thought necessary for the accurate scholar or antiquarian. It followed, that in course of time, all the delicate shades of truth and falsehood, the unobtrusive indications of GOD'S will, the low tones of the "still small voice," in which Scripture abounds, were rudely rejected; the crumbs from the rich man's table, which Faith eagerly looks about for, were despised by the proud-hearted intellectualist, who (as if it were a favour in him to accept the Gospel,) would be content with nothing short of certainty, and ridiculed as superstitious and illogical whatever did not approve itself to his own cold, hard, and unimpassioned temper. For instance, if the cases of Lydia, of the jailer, of Stephanas, were brought to show our LORD'S *wish* as to the baptism of households, the actions of his apostles to *interpret* his own commands, it was answered; "This is no satisfactory *proof*; it is not *certain* that every one of those households was not himself a believer; it is not *certain* there were any children among them:"—though surely, in as many as *three* households, the probability is on the side which the Church has taken, especially viewing the texts in connexion with our SAVIOUR'S words, "Suffer the little children," &c. Again, while the observance of the LORD'S day was grounded upon the *practice* of the apostles, it was somehow felt, that this proof was not *strong enough* to bind the mass of Protestants: and so the chief argument now in use is one drawn from the Jewish law, viz. the direct Scripture *command*, contained in the fourth commandment.

Our SAVIOUR has noticed the frame of mind here alluded to, in Mark viii. 11, 12, where His feelings and judgment upon it are also told us:—"And the Pharisees came forth, and began to question with Him, seeking of Him *a sign from heaven*, tempting Him. And He sighed deeply in His

spirit, and saith, Why doth this generation seek after a sign? Verily I say unto you, *There shall no sign be given unto this generation*. And He left them."

We are warned against the same hard, intractable temper in the book of Psalms:—"I will inform thee, and teach thee in the way wherein thou shalt go: *and I will guide thee with Mine eye*. Be ye not like to horse and mule, *which have no understanding*; whose mouth must be held *with bit and bridle*, lest they fall upon thee." Ps. xxxii. 9, 10. This stubborn spirit, which yields to nothing but violence, is determined to *feel* CHRIST'S yoke ere it submits to it, will not see except in broad day-light, and like the servant who hid his talent, is ever making excuses, murmuring, doubting, grudging obedience, and stifling docile and open-hearted faith, is the spirit of ultra-Protestantism, *i.e.* that spirit, to which the principles of Protestantism *tend*, and which they have in a great measure *realized*. On this subject the reader may consult Nos. 4, 8, and 19, of this series of Tracts.

Now to apply this to the doctrines, at present so much under-valued, which it is the especial object of these Tracts to enforce.

When a clergyman has spoken strongly in defence of Episcopacy, a hearer will go away saying, that there is much very able and forcible, much very eloquent and excellent, in what he has just heard; but after all, *there is very little about Episcopacy in Scripture*. This is the point to which a shrewd, clear-headed reasoner will resort,—"*after all*;" we come round and round to it; the doctrine advocated is plausible, useful, generally received hitherto;—granted, *but* Scripture says very little about it.

Now it cannot be for a moment allowed, that Scripture *contains* little on the subject of Church Government; though it may readily be granted that it *obtrudes* on the reader little about it. The doctrine is in it, not on it; not on the surface. This need not be proved here, since the subject has been variously considered in former Numbers of this series. But it may be useful in a few words to show how the state of the argument and controversy concerning Episcopacy, illustrates the above remarks, and how parallel it is to the state in which other religious truths are found, which no Churchman ventures to dispute.

1. Now, in the first place, let us suppose, *for the sake of argument*, that Episcopacy is in fact not at all mentioned in Scripture: even then it would be our duty to receive it. Why? because the first Christians received it. If we wish to get at the truth, no matter how we get at it, *if* we get at it. If it be a fact, that the earliest Christian communities were universally episcopal, it is a reason for our maintaining Episcopacy; and *in proportion* to our conviction, is it incumbent on us to maintain it.

Nor can it be fairly dismissed as a non-essential, or ordinance indifferent and mutable, though formerly existing over Christendom; for, *who* made us judges of essentials and non-essentials? *how* do we determine them? In the Jewish law, the slightest transgression of the commandment was followed by the penalty of death; vide Lev. viii. 35; x. 6. Does not its universality imply a necessary connexion with Christian doctrine? Consider how such reasonings would carry us through life; how the business of the world depends on punctuality in minutes; how "great a matter" a mere spark dropped on gunpowder "kindleth."

But, it may be urged, that we Protestants believe the *Scriptures* to contain the whole rule of duty.—Certainly not; they constitute a rule of *faith*, not a rule of *practice*; a rule of *doctrine*, not a rule of *conduct* or *discipline*. Where (*e.g.*) are we told in Scripture, that gambling is wrong? or again, suicide? Our Article is precise: "Holy Scripture containeth all things necessary to salvation, so that whatsoever is not read therein, &c. it is not to be required of any man, that it should be *believed* as an article of *faith*." Again it says, that the Apocrypha is *not* to be applied "to establish any *doctrine*," implying that this is the use of the canonical books.

2. However, let us pass from this argument, which is but founded on a *supposition*, that Episcopacy is not enjoined in Scripture. Suppose we maintain, as we may well maintain, that it is enjoined in Scripture. An objector will say, that at all events it is but obscurely contained therein, and cannot be drawn out from it without a great deal of delicate care and skill. Here comes in the operation of that principle of *faith* in opposition to *criticism*, which was above explained; the principle of being content with a little light, where we cannot obtain sunshine. If it is *probably* pleasing to CHRIST, let us maintain it. Now take a parallel case: *e.g.* the practice of infant baptism; where is this *enjoined* in Scripture? No where. Why do we observe it? Because the primitive Church observed it, and because the Apostles in Scripture *appear* to have sanctioned it, though this is not altogether certain *from* Scripture. In a difficult case we do as well as we can, and carefully *study* what is most agreeable to our LORD and SAVIOUR. This is how our Church expresses it in the xxviith Article: "The baptism of young children is in any wise to be retained in the Church, as *most agreeable* with the institution of CHRIST." This is true wariness and Christian caution; very different from that spurious caution which ultra-Protestantism exercises. Let a man only be consistent, and apply the same judgment in the case of Episcopacy: let him consider whether the duty of keeping to Bishops, be not "*most agreeable* with the institution of CHRIST." If, indeed, he denies this altogether, these remarks do not apply; but they are addressed to waverers, and falsely moderate men, who cannot deny, that the evidence of Scripture is in favour of Churchmen, but say it is not strong enough. They say, that if Almighty GOD had intended an uniformity in Church Government among Christians, He would have spoken more clearly.

Now if they carried on this line of argument consistently, they would not baptize their children: happily they are inconsistent. It would be more happy still, were they consistent on the other side; and, as they baptize their children, because it is safer to observe than to omit the sacrament, did they also keep to the Church, as the safer side. The received practice, then, of infant baptism seems a final answer to all who quarrel with the Scripture evidence for Episcopacy.

3. But further still, infant baptism, like Episcopacy, is but a case of *discipline*. What shall we say, when we consider that a case of *doctrine*, necessary doctrine, doctrine the very highest and most sacred, may be produced, where the argument lies as little on the surface of Scripture,—where the proof, though *most conclusive*, is as indirect and circuitous as that for Episcopacy; viz. the doctrine of the Trinity? Where is this solemn and comfortable mystery formally stated in Scripture, as we find it in the creeds? Why is it not? Let a man consider whether all the objections which he urges against the Scripture argument for Episcopacy may not be turned against his own belief in the Trinity. It is a happy thing for themselves that men are inconsistent; yet it is miserable to advocate and establish a *principle*, which, not in their own case indeed, but in the case of others who learn it of them, leads to Socinianism. This being considered, can we any longer wonder at the awful fact, that the descendants of Calvin, the first Presbyterians, are at the present day in the number of those who have denied the LORD who bought them?

OXFORD,

The Feast of St. Luke

[FOURTH EDITION.]

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Advertisement

IN completing the second volume of a publication, to which the circumstances of the day have given rise, it may be right to allude to a change which has taken place in them since the date of its commencement. At that time, in consequence of long security, the attention of members of our Church had been but partially engaged in ascertaining the grounds of their adherence to it; but the imminent peril to which all that is dear to them has since been exposed, has naturally turned their thoughts that way, and obliged them to defend it on one or other of the principles which are usually put forward on its behalf. Discussions have thus been renewed in various quarters, on points which had long remained undisturbed; and, though numbers continue undecided in opinion, or take up a temporary position in some one of the hundred middle points which may be assumed between the two main theories in which the question issues, and others, again, have deliberately entrenched themselves in the modern or ultra-protestant alternative, yet, on the whole, there has been much hearty and intelligent adoption, and much respectful study, of those more primitive views maintained by our great Divines. As the altered state of public information and opinion has a necessary bearing on the efforts of those who desire to excite attention to the subject, (in which number the writers of these Tracts are to be included,) it will not be inappropriate briefly to state in this place, what it is conceived is the present position of the great body of Churchmen with reference to it.

While we have cause to be thankful for the sounder and more accurate language which is now very generally adopted among well-judging men on ecclesiastical subjects, we must beware of over-estimating what has been done, and so becoming sanguine in our hopes of success, or slackening our exertions to secure it. Many more persons, doubtless, have taken up a profession of the main doctrine in question, that, namely, of the One Catholic and Apostolic Church, than fully enter into it. This is to be expected, it being the peculiarity of all religious teaching, that words are imparted before ideas. A child learns his Creed or Catechism before he understands it; and in beginning any deep subject we are all but children to the end of our lives. The instinctive perception of a rightly instructed mind, the *primâ facie* force of the argument, or the authority of our celebrated writers, have all had their due and extensive influence in furthering the reception of the doctrine, when once it was openly maintained; to which must be added the prospect of the loss of state protection, which made it necessary to look out for other reasons for adherence to the Church besides that of obedience to the civil magistrate. Nothing, which has spread quickly, has been received thoroughly. Doubtless there are a number of seriously-minded persons, who think they admit the doctrine in question much more fully than they do, and who would be startled at seeing that realized in particulars, which they confess in an abstract form. Many there are who do not at all feel that it is capable of a practical application: and, while they bring it forward on special occasions, in formal expositions of faith, or in answer to a direct interrogatory, let it slip from their minds almost entirely in their daily conduct or their religious teaching, from the long and inveterate habit of thinking and acting without it. We must not then at all be surprised at finding, that to modify the principles and motives on which men act is not the work of a day; nor at undergoing disappointments, at witnessing relapses, misconceptions, sudden disgusts, and, on the other hand, abuses and perversions of the true doctrine, in the case of those who have taken it up with greater warmth than discernment.

And in the next place, it will be found, that much more has been done in awakening Churchmen to the truth of the Apostolical Commission as a fact, and to the admission of it as a duty, than to the enjoyment of it as a privilege. If asked what is the use of adhering to the Church, they

will commonly answer, that it is commanded, that all acts of obedience meet with their reward from Almighty God, and this in the number; but the notion of the Church as the storehouse and direct channel of grace, as a Divine Ordinance, not merely to be maintained for order's sake, or because schism is a sin, but to be approached joyfully and expectantly as a definite instrument, or rather the appointed means, of spiritual blessings,—as an Ordinance which conveys secret strength and life to every one who shares in it, unless there be some actual moral impediment in his own mind,—this is a doctrine which as yet is but faintly understood among us. Nay, our subtle Enemy has so contrived, that by affixing to this blessed truth the stigma of Popery, numbers among us are effectually deterred from profiting by a gracious provision, intended for the comfort of our faith, but in their case wasted.

The particular deficiency here alluded to may also be described by referring to another form under which it shows itself, viz. the *à priori* reluctance in those who believe the Apostolical Commission, to appropriate to it the power of consecrating the Lord's Supper; as if there were some antecedent improbability in GOD'S gifts being lodged in particular observances, and distributed in a particular way; and as if the strong wish, or moral worth, of the individual could create in the outward ceremony a virtue which it had not received from above. Rationalistic, or (as they may be more properly called) carnal notions concerning the Sacraments, and, on the other hand, a superstitious apprehension of resting in them, and a slowness to believe the possibility of GOD'S having literally blessed ordinances with invisible power, have, alas! infected a large mass of men in our communion. There are those whose "word will eat as doth a canker;" and it is to be feared, that we have been over-near certain celebrated Protestant teachers, Puritan or Latitudinarian, and have suffered in consequence. Hence we have almost embraced the doctrine, that GOD conveys grace only through the instrumentality of the mental energies, that is, through faith, prayer, active spiritual contemplations, or (what is commonly called) communion with GOD, in contradiction to the primitive view, according to which the Church and her Sacraments are the ordained and direct visible means of conveying to the soul what is in itself supernatural and unseen. For example, would not most men maintain, on the first view of the subject, that to administer the LORD'S Supper to infants, or to the dying and apparently insensible, however consistently pious and believing in their past lives, must be, under all circumstances, and in every conceivable case, a superstition? and yet neither practice is without the sanction of primitive usage. And does not this account for the prevailing indisposition to admit that Baptism conveys regeneration? Indeed, this may even be set down as the essence of Sectarian Doctrine, (however its mischief may be restrained or compensated, in the case of individuals,) to consider faith, and not the Sacraments, as the proper instrument of justification and other gospel gifts; instead of holding, that the grace of CHRIST comes to us altogether from without, (as from Him, so through externals of His ordaining,) faith being but the *sine quâ non*, the necessary condition on our parts for duly receiving it.

It has been with the view of meeting this cardinal deficiency (as it may be termed) in the religion of the day, that the Tract on Baptism, contained in the latter part of this volume, has been inserted; which is to be regarded, not as an inquiry into one single or isolated doctrine, but as a delineation, and serious examination of a modern system of theology, of extensive popularity and great speciousness, in its elementary and characteristic principles.

OXFORD,

The Feast of All Saints, 1835

The Visible Church Letter IV.

Tract No. 47 (Ad Clerum)

I AM sorry my delay has been so considerable in answering your remarks on my Letters on the Church. Indeed it has been ungrateful in me, for you have given me an attention unusual with the multitude of religious persons; who, instead of receiving the arguments of others in simplicity, and candour, seem to have a certain number of types, or measures of professing Christians, set up in their minds, to one or other of which they consider every one they meet with belongs, and who, accordingly, directly they hear an opinion advanced, begin to consider whether the speaker be a No. 1, 2, or 3, and having rapidly determined this, treat his views with consideration or disregard, as it may be. I am far from saying our knowledge of a person's character and principles should not influence our judgment of his arguments; certainly it should have great weight. I consider the cry "measures not men," to be one of the many mistakes of the day. At the same time there is surely is contrary extreme, the fault of fancying we can easily look through men, and *understand* what each individual is; an arbitrary classing of the whole Christian family under but two or three *countenances*, and mistaking one man's doctrine for another's. You at least have not called me an Arminian, or a high Churchman, or a Borderer, or one of this or that school, and so dismissed me.

To pass from this subject. You tell me that in my zeal in advocating the doctrine of the Church Catholic and Apostolic, I "use expressions and make assumptions which imply that the Dissenters are without the pale of salvation." So let me explain myself on these points.

You say that my doctrine of the one Catholic Church in effect excludes Dissenters, nay, Presbyterians, from salvation. Far from it. Do not think of me as of one who makes theories for himself in his closet, who governs himself by book-maxims, and who, as being secluded from the world, has no temptation to let his sympathies for individuals rise against his abstract positions, and can afford to be hard-hearted, and to condemn by wholesale the multitudes in various sects and parties whom he never saw. I have known those among Presbyterians whose piety, resignation, cheerfulness, and affection, under trying circumstances, have been such, as to make me say to myself, on the thoughts of my own higher privileges, "Woe unto thee Chorazin, woe unto thee Bethsaida!" Where little is given, little will be required; and that return, though little, has its own peculiar loveliness, as an acceptable sacrifice to Him who singled out for praise the widow's two mites. Was not Israel apostate from the days of Jeroboam; yet were there not even in the reign of Ahab, seven thousand souls who were "reserved," an elect remnant? Does any Churchman wish to place the Presbyterians, where, as in Scotland, their form of Christianity is in occupation, in a worse condition under the Gospel than Ephraim held under the Law? Had not the ten tribes the schools of the Prophets, and has not Scotland at least the word of GOD? Yet what would be thought of the Jew who had maintained that Jeroboam and his kingdom were in no guilt? and shall we, from a false charity, from a fear of condemning the elect seven thousand, scruple to say that Presbyterianism has severed itself from our temple privileges, and undervalue the line of Levi and the house of Aaron? Consider our SAVIOUR'S discourse with the woman of Samaria. While by conversing with her He tacitly condemned the Jews' conduct in refusing to hold intercourse with the Samaritans, yet He plainly declared that "salvation was of the Jews." "Ye worship ye know not what;" He says, "we know what we worship." Can we conceive His making light of the differences between Jew and Samaritan?

Further, if to whom much is given, of him much will be required, how is it safe for us to make light of our privileges, if we have them? is not this to reject the birth-right? to hide our talent under a napkin? When we say that GOD has done more for us than for the Presbyterians, this indeed

may be connected with feelings of spiritual pride; but it need not. We may, by so saying, provoke ourselves to jealousy; for we dare not deny that, in spite of our peculiar privileges of communion with CHRIST, yet even higher saints *may* lie hid (to our great shame) among those who have not themselves the certainty of our especial approaches to His glorious majesty. Was not Elijah sent to a widow of Sarepta? did not Elisha cure Naaman? and are not these instances set forward by our LORD Himself as warnings to us “not to be high-minded, but to fear;” and, again, as a gracious consolation when we think of our less favoured brethren? Where is the narrowness of view and feeling which you impute to me? Why may I not speak out, in order at once to admonish myself, and to attempt to reclaim to a more excellent way those who are at present severed from the true Church.

And what has here been said of an established Presbyterianism, is true (in its degree) of dissent, when it has become hereditary, and embodied in institutions.

Further, it is surely parallel with the order of Divine Providence that there should be a variety, a sort of graduated scale, in His method of dispensing His favour in CHRIST. So far from its being a strange thing that Protestant sects are not “in CHRIST,” in the same fulness that we are, it is more accordant to the scheme of the world that they should be between us and heathenism. It would be strange if there were but two states, one absolutely of favour, one of disfavour. Take the world at large, one form of paganism is better than another. The North American Indians are theists, and as such more privileged than polytheists. Mahometanism is a better religion than Hindooism. Judaism is better than Mahometanism. One may believe that long established dissent affords to such as are born and bred in it a sort of pretext, and is attended with a portion of blessing, (where there is no means of knowing better,) which does not attach to those who *cause* divisions, found sects, or wantonly wander from the Church to the Meeting House;—that what is called an orthodox sect has a share of Divine favour, which is utterly withheld from heresy. I am not speaking of the next world, where we shall all find ourselves as individuals, and where there will be but two states, but of existing bodies or societies. On the other hand, why should the corruptions of Rome lead us to deny her Divine privileges, when even the idolatry of Judah did not forfeit hers, annul her temple-sacrifice, or level her to Israel?

I say all this, merely, for the purpose of suggesting to those who are “weak,” some idea of possible modes in which Eternal Wisdom may reconcile the exuberance of his mercy in CHRIST to the whole race of man, with the placing of it in its fulness in a certain ordained society and ministry. For myself I prefer to rely upon the simple word of truth, of which Scripture is the depository, and since CHRIST has told me to preach the whole counsel of GOD, to do so fearlessly and without doubting; not being careful to find ways of smoothing strange appearances in His counsels, and of obviating difficulties, being aware on the one hand that His thoughts are not our thoughts, nor our ways His ways, and on the other, that He is ever justified in His sayings, and overcomes when He is judged.

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The Feast of All Saints

[NEW EDITION.]

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Advertisement

THE present Volume will be found to persevere in the change of plan adopted in the latter part of the Second, the substitution of Tracts of considerable extent of subject for the short and incomplete papers with which the publication commenced. The reason of this change is to be found in the altered circumstances under which they now make their appearance. When the series began, the prospects of Catholic Truth were especially gloomy, from the circumstance that irreligious principles and false doctrines, which had hitherto been avowed only in the closet or on paper, had just been admitted into public measures on a large scale, with a probability of that admission becoming a precedent for future. A great proportion of the Irish Sees had been suppressed by the State against the Church's wish, all parties who were concerned to resist the measure, acquiescing either in utter apathy or in despair. Scarcely a protesting voice was heard, and the attempt to remonstrate was treated on all hands with coldness and disapprobation. A sense of the dreariness of such a state of things naturally led to those anxious appeals and abrupt sketches of doctrine with which the Tracts opened. They were written with the hope of rousing members of our Church to comprehend her alarming position, of helping them to realize the fact of the gradual growth, allowance, and establishment of unsound principles in the management of her internal concerns; and, having this object, they spontaneously used the language of alarm and complaint. They were written, as a man might give notice of a fire or inundation, to startle all who heard him, with only so much of doctrine and argument as might be necessary to account for their publication, or might answer more obvious objections to the views therein advocated.

This peculiarity in their composition has occasioned them to be censured as intemperate and violent. If this be true in such sense that they discovered any personal feeling, bitterness, wrath, want of candour, unkindness, or reviling, of course nothing can be said in their defence. Or, if they contain an extravagant doctrine, crudely imagined, confusedly or hastily expressed, and unsanctioned by our standard Divines, then, too, they are entitled to very little respect. But if the charge of intemperance simply means that they contain strong expressions upon high and delicate matters, suddenly introduced, unexplained, and therefore obscure and harsh, though not intrinsically erroneous, then by intemperance is meant nothing else than want of judgment. Want of judgment, however, is commonly imputed to proceedings which tend to defeat their object, though allowable in themselves, and based upon true principles; and if so, the style of the Tracts in question is *not* injudicious, for their object has *not* been defeated. Naked statements, which offend the accurate and cautious, are necessary upon occasions to infuse seriousness into the indifferent.

These are the reasons, whether satisfactory or not in the judgment of others, for the style and manner of the earlier Tracts. When, however, from the circumstances of the times or from other causes, more interest seemed to be excited among Churchmen concerning those doctrines which it was their object to enforce, discussion became more seasonable than the simple statements of doctrine with which the series began; and their character accordingly changed.

It would be unbecoming to go into this detail in this place, were not a prejudice entertained against these Tracts by many who know them only by a few detached sentences, complete indeed in themselves, and on the whole not unfairly selected, but which, so detached, will not be understood in their true sense and bearings by readers unacquainted with the language of our old divinity. Dr. Pusey's valuable Pamphlet in answer to one objector, is, with the kind consent of the Author, appended to this Advertisement [As Tract 77—NR].

OXFORD,

The Feast of All Saints, 1836

Catena Patrum No. I. Testimony of Writers in the later English Church to the Doctrine of the Apostolical Succession

Tract No. 74 (Ad Populum)

The Baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven or of men? And they reasoned among themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven, He will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him? But if we shall say, Of men, we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet.

PERSONS who object to our preaching distinctly and unhesitatingly the doctrine of the Apostolical succession, must be asked to explain, why we may not do what our Fathers in the Church have done before us, or whether they too, as well as we, are mistaken, or injudicious theorists, or Papists, in so doing? This question is here plainly put to them; and at the same time the attention of inquirers, who have not made up their minds on the subject, is invited to the answer, if any is forthcoming, from the parties addressed.

The doctrine in dispute is this; that CHRIST founded a visible Church as an ordinance for ever, and endowed it once for all with spiritual privileges, and set His Apostles over it, as the first in a line of ministers and rulers, like themselves except in their miraculous gifts, and to be continued from them by successive ordination; in consequence, that to adhere to this Church thus distinguished, is among the ordinary duties of a Christian, and is the means of his appropriating the Gospel blessings with an evidence of his doing so not attainable elsewhere.

The passages quoted below contain, it is presumed, this doctrine; but they are not intended as more than tokens and suggestions of the full testimony, contained in the works of their great authors.

List of Authors cited.

1. Bilson 23. Wake
2. Hooker 24. Potter
3. Bancroft 25. Nelson
4. Andrews 26. Kettlewell
5. Hall 27. Hicks
6. Laud 28. Law
7. Bramhall 29. Johnson
8. Mede 30. Dodwell
9. Mason 31. Collier
10. Sanderson 32. Leslie
11. Hammond 33. Wilson
12. Taylor 34. Bingham
13. Heylin 35. Skelton
14. Allestrie 36. Samuel Johnson
15. Pearson 37. Horne
16. Fell 38. W. Jones
17. Bull 39. Horsley
18. Stillingfleet 40. Heber
19. Ken 41. Jebb
20. Beveridge 42. Van Mildert
21. Sharp 43. Mant
22. Scott

BILSON, BISHOP.—Perpetual Government of Christ's Church,
ch. ix. p. 105 ¹¹

It will happily [haply] be granted the Apostles had their prerogative and pre-eminence above others in the Church of CHRIST; but that limited to their persons, and during for their lives, and, therefore, no reason can be made for their superiority, to force the like to be received and established in the Church of CHRIST for all ages and places; since their office and function are long since ceased, and no like power reserved to their successors after them. I do not deny but many things in the Apostles were personal, &c. ... yet, that all their gifts ended with their lives, and no part of their charge and power remained to their after-comers, may neither be confessed by us, nor affirmed by any, unless we mean wholly to subvert the Church of CHRIST ... The Scriptures, once written, suffice all ages for instruction; the miracles then done, are for ever a most evident confirmation of their doctrine; the authority of their first calling liveth yet in their succession; and time and travel, joined with GOD'S graces, bring pastors at this present to perfection; yet the Apostles' charge to teach, baptize, and administer the LORD'S Supper, to bind and loose sinners in heaven and in earth, to impose hands for the ordaining of pastors and elders, these parts of the Apostolic function and charge are not decayed, and cannot be wanted in the Church of GOD. There must either be no Church, or else these must remain; for without these no Church can continue.

HOOKE, PRESBYTER AND DOCTOR.—Ecclesiastical Polity,
Book v. § 77

... In that they are CHRIST'S ambassadors and His labourers, who should give them their commission, but He whose most inward affairs they manage? Is not GOD alone the FATHER of spirits? Are not souls the purchase of JESUS CHRIST? What angel in heaven could have said to man, as our Lord did unto Peter, "Feed my sheep,—preach—baptize—do this in remembrance of Me. Whose sins ye retain, they are retained; and their offences in heaven pardoned, whose faults you shall on earth forgive?" What think we? Are these terrestrial sounds, or else are they voices uttered out of the clouds above? The power of the ministry of GOD, translateth out of darkness into glory; it raiseth man from the earth, and bringeth GOD Himself from heaven; by blessing visible elements it maketh them invisible graces; it giveth daily the HOLY GHOST; it hath to dispose of that flesh which was given for the life of the world, and that blood which was poured out to redeem souls; when it poureth malediction upon the heads of the wicked, they perish; when it revoketh the same, they revive. O wretched blindness, if we admire not so great power; more wretched if we consider it aright, and, notwithstanding, imagine that any but GOD can bestow it! To whom CHRIST hath imparted power, both over that mystical body which is the society of souls, and over that natural which is Himself, for the knitting of both in one, (a work which antiquity doth call the making of CHRIST'S body,) the same power is in such not amiss both termed a kind of mark or character, and acknowledged to be indelible ... "Receive the HOLY GHOST; whose sins soever ye remit, they are remitted; whose sins ye retain, they are retained." Whereas, therefore, the other Evangelists had set down, that CHRIST did before His suffering promise to give His Apostles the keys of the kingdom of heaven, and being risen from the dead, promised moreover at that time a miraculous power of the HOLY GHOST, St. John addeth, that He also invested them even then with the power of the HOLY GHOST for castigation and relaxation of sin, wherein was fully accomplished that which the promise of the keys did import. Seeing therefore, that the same power is now given, why should the same form of words expressing it be thought foolish?

¹¹As quoted by Dr. Spry in his Bampton Lectures, p. 311.

Ibid. § 68.

Now the privilege of the visible Church of GOD (for of that we speak) is to be herein like the ark of Noah, that, for any thing we know to the contrary, all without it are lost sheep; yet in this was the ark of Noah privileged above the Church, that whereas none of them which were in the one could perish, numbers in the other are cast away, because to eternal life our profession is not enough.

BANCROFT, ARCHBISHOP.—Sermon preached at Paul's Cross

This hath ever been reckoned a most certain ground and principle in religion, that that Church, which maintaineth without error the faith of CHRIST, which holdeth the true doctrine of the Gospel in matters necessary to salvation, and preacheth the same, which retaineth the lawful use of those Sacraments only which CHRIST hath appointed, and which appointeth vice to be punished, and virtue to be maintained, notwithstanding in some other respects, and in some points, it have many blemishes, imperfections, nay divers and sundry errors, is yet to be acknowledged for the Mother of the faithful, the House of GOD, the Ark of Noah, the pillar of Truth, and the spouse of CHRIST. From which Church whosoever doth separate himself, he is to be reckoned a schismatic or an heretic . . .

There are many causes set down by the said ancient Fathers, why so many false prophets do go out into the world; but I will only touch four; whereof I find the contempt of Bishops especially to be one; for unto them, as St. Jerome saith, ever since St. Mark's time, the care of Church Government hath been committed; they had authority over the rest of the ministry . . . "that the seed of schism might be taken away, &c."

Read the Scriptures, but with sobriety; if any man presuming upon his knowledge, seek further than is meet for him, besides

that he knoweth nothing as he ought to know, he shall cast himself into a labyrinth, and never find that he seeketh for. GOD hath bound Himself by His promise unto His Church of purpose, that men by her good direction might in this point be relieved; to whose godly determination in matters of question, her dutiful children ought to submit themselves without any curious or wilful contradiction. I could bring many authorities to this effect.

ANDREWS, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Sermons on Whitsunday,

No. 9. (Works, p. 695.)

The HOLY GHOST may be received more ways than one. He hath many spiramina; [*polytropōs*], "in many manners" He comes; and *multiformis gratia* He comes with. He and they carry the name of their cause; and to receive them is to receive the SPIRIT. There is a *gratum faciens*, the saving grace of the SPIRIT, for one to save himself by, received by each, without respect to others; and there is a *gratis data* (whatever become of us) serving to save others by, without respect to ourselves. And there is [*charis diakonias*], the grace of a holy calling, for it is a grace, to be a conduit of grace any way. All these; and all from one and the same SPIRIT.

That was here conferred, (in John xx. 22.) was not the saving grace of inward sanctimony; they were not "breathed on" to that end. The Church to this day gives this still in her ordinations, but the saving grace the Church cannot give; none but GOD can give that. Nor the *gratis data* it is not. That came by the tongues, both the gift of speaking divine languages, and the gift of [*apophthengesthai*], speaking wisely, and to the purpose: and (we know) none is either the holier or the learned by his ordination.

Yet a grace it is. For the very office itself is a grace; *mihi data est hæc gratia*, saith the Apostle, in more places than one; and speaks of his office and nothing else. The Apostleship was a grace, yet

no saving grace. Else, should Judas have been saved. Clearly then, it is the grace of their calling (this) whereby they were sacred and made persons public, and their acts authentical, and they enabled to do somewhat about the remission of sins, that is not (of like avail) done by others, though perhaps, more learned and virtuous than they, in that they have not the like *mitto vos*, nor the same *accipite* that these have.

Ibid.—Sermon on Absolution. (Appendix, p. 90.)

The power of remitting sin is originally in GOD, and in GOD alone. And CHRIST our SAVIOUR, by means of the union of the Godhead and manhood into one person, by virtue whereof “The Son of man hath power to forgive sins upon earth.”

This power being thus solely vested in GOD, He might, without wrong to any, have retained and kept to Himself, and without means of word or sacrament, and without ministers, either apostles or others, have exercised immediately by Himself from Heaven. But we should then have said of the remission of sins, saith St. Paul, “Who shall go up to heaven for it, and fetch it thence? for which cause,” saith he, “the righteousness of faith speaketh thus, Say not so, &c.”

Partly this, but there should be no such difficulty to shake our faith, as once to imagine to fetch CHRIST from heaven for the remission of our sins; and partly also, because CHRIST, to whom alone this commission was originally granted, having ordained Himself a body, would work by bodily things, and having taken the nature of a man upon Him, would honour the nature He had so taken, for these causes; that which was His, and His alone, He vouchsafed to impart, and out of His commission to grant a commission, and thereby to associate them to Himself, (it is His own word by the prophet) and to make them [*syergous*], that is *cooperatores*, workers together with Him (as the Apostle speaketh) to the work of salvation, both of themselves and of others. From GOD then it is derived; from GOD and to men. * * *

Now if we ask, to what men? the text is plain. They to whom CHRIST said this *Remiseritis*, were the Apostles.

In the Apostles, (that we may come nearer yet) we find three capacities as we may term them, 1. As Christians in general. 2. As preachers, priests, or ministers, more special. 3. As those twelve persons, whom in strict propriety of speech, we term the Apostles.

Some things that CHRIST spake to them, He spake to them as representing the whole company of Christians; as his *Vigilate*.

Some things to them, not as Christians, but as preachers or priests; as His *Ite prædicate Evangelium* and his *Hoc facite*; which no man thinketh all Christians may do.

And some things to themselves personally: as that He had appointed them witnesses of His miracles and resurrection, which cannot be applied but to them and them in person. It remaineth we inquire, in which of these three capacities CHRIST imparted to them this commission.

Not to the Apostles properly; that is, this was no personal privilege to be in them, and to die with them, that they should only execute it for a time, and none ever after them. GOD forbid we should so think it. For, this power being more than needful for the world, (as in the beginning it was said,) it was not to be either personal, or for a time; then those persons dying, and those times determining, them in the ages following (as we now in this) that should light into this prison or captivity of sin, how could they or we receive any benefit by it? Of nature, it is said by the heathen philosopher, that it does neither *abundare in superfluis*, nor *deficere in necessariis*. GOD forbid, but we should ascribe as much to GOD at the least, that neither He would ordain power superfluous or more than needed, or else, it being needful, would appropriate it unto one age, and leave all other destitute of it; and not rather, as all writers both new and old take it, continue it successively to the

world's end.

And as not proper to the Apostles' persons, so neither common to all Christians in general, nor in the persons of all Christians conveyed to them. Which thing the very circumstances of the text do evict. For He sent them first, and after inspired them; and after both these, gave them this commission. Now all Christians are not so sent, nor all Christians inspired with the grace or gift of the SPIRIT, that they were here. Consequently, it was not intended to the whole society of Christians. Yea, I add, that forasmuch as these two, both these two, must go before it, *Missio* and *Inspiratio*, that though GOD inspire some laymen, if I may have leave so to term them, with very special graces of knowledge to this end, yet inasmuch as they have not the former, of sending, it agreeth not to them, neither may they exercise it, until they be sent, that is, until they have their calling thereunto.

It being then neither personal nor peculiar to them as Apostles, nor again common to all as Christians, it must needs be committed to them as ministers, priests, or preachers; and consequently to these that in that office and function do succeed them, to whom this commission is still continued. Neither are they, that are ordained or instituted to that calling, ordained or instituted by any other words or verse than this (John xx. 23). Yet not so, that absolutely without them, GOD cannot bestow it, on whom or when Him pleaseth; or that He is bound to this means only, and cannot work without it. For, *gratia Dei non alligatur mediis*, the grace of GOD is not bound but free, and can work without means either of word or sacrament; and as without means, so without ministers, how and when to Him seemeth good. But speaking of that which is proper and ordinary, in the course by Him established, this is an ecclesiastical act, committed as the residue of the ministry of reconciliation to ecclesiastical persons. And if at any time He vouchsafe it by others that are not such, they be in that case *Ministri necessitatis, non officii*, in case of necessity ministers, but by office not so. * * *

The remission of sins, as it is from GOD only, so it is by the death and blood-shedding of CHRIST alone; but for the applying of this unto us, there are divers means established. * * * In the institution of Baptism there is a power to that end. * * 2. Again, there is also another power for the remission of sins, in the institution of the Holy Eucharist. * * 3. Besides, in the word itself there is a like power ordained. "Now are you clean," saith CHRIST, (no doubt from their sins) *propter Sermonem hunc*. And the very name giveth as much, that it is entitled, "The Word of Reconciliation." 4. Further there is to the same effect a power in prayer, and that in the priests' prayers, "Call for the Priests," saith the Apostle, "and let them pray for the sick person, and if he have committed sin, it shall be forgiven him." All and every of them, are acts for the remission of sins: and in all and every of these, is the minister required, and they cannot be dispatched without him.

But the ceremonies and circumstances that here (John xx. 23.) I find used, prevail with me to think, that there is somewhat here imparted to them, that was not before. For it carrieth no likelihood, that our SAVIOUR bestowing on them nothing here, but that which before He had, would use so much solemnity, so diverse and new circumstances, no new or diverse grace being here communicated. * * * take it to be a power distinct from the former, and (not to hold you long) to be the accomplishment of the promise made (Matt. xvi. 19.) of the power of the keys, which here in this place and in these words is fulfilled; and have therein for me, the joint consent of the Fathers. Which being a different power in itself, is that which we call the act or benefit of absolution; in which, as in the rest, there is in the due time and place of it, an use for the remission of sins.

HALL, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—On Episcopacy,

Pt. iii. p. 9.

And for you, my dearly beloved brethren at home, for CHRIST'S sake, for the Church's sake, for your souls' sake be exhorted to hold to this holy institution of your blessed SAVIOUR and His unerring apostles, and bless GOD for Episcopacy. Do but cast your eyes a little back, and see what noble instruments of GOD'S glory He hath been pleased to raise up in this very Church of ours out of this sacred vocation; what famous servants of GOD, what strong champions of truth, and renowned antagonists of Rome and her superstitions; what admirable preachers, what incomparable writers, yea, what constant and undaunted martyrs and confessors, &c. ... Neither doubt I but that it will please GOD, out of the same rod of Aaron, still to raise such blossoms and fruit, as shall win Him glory to all eternity. So you are to honour those your reverend pastors, to hate all factious withdrawals from that government, which comes the nearest of any Church upon earth to the Apostolical ... Let me therefore confidently shut up all with that resolute word of that blessed Martyr and Saint, Ignatius ... "Let all things be done to the honour of GOD, give respect to your bishop as you would GOD should respect you. My soul for theirs which obey their bishop, presbyters, and deacons; GOD grant that my portion may be the same with theirs." And let my soul have the same share with that blessed Martyr that said so. Amen.

LAUD, ARCHBISHOP AND MARTYR.—Conference with Fisher,

xvi. 29.

"I am with you always unto the end of the world." Yes most certain it is,—present by His SPIRIT; or else in bodily presence He continued not with His Apostles, but during His abode on earth. And this promise of His spiritual presence was to their successors; else, why "to the end of the world?" The Apostles did not, could not, live so long. But then to the successors the promise goes no farther, than "I am with you always," which reaches to continual assistance, but not to divine and infallible.

"The Comforter the HOLY GHOST shall abide with you for ever." Most true again; for the HOLY GHOST did abide with the Apostles, according to CHRIST'S promise thus made, and shall abide with their successors for ever, to comfort and preserve them.

Ibid.—xxv. 15.

CHRIST promised the Keys to St. Peter. (Matt. xvi.) True; but so did He to all the rest of the Apostles (Matt. xviii. John xx.) and to their successors as much as to his ... St. Augustine is plain, "If this were said only of St. Peter, then the Church hath no power to do it," which GOD forbid! The keys therefore were given to St. Peter and the rest in a figure of the Church, to whose power and for whose use they were given. But there's not one key in all that bunch, that can let in St. Peter's successors to a "more powerful principality" universal than the successors of the other Apostles had.

BRAMHALL, ARCHBISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Vindication of the Church of England.—Discourse III

I do also acknowledge that Episcopacy was comprehended in the Apostolic office, *tanquam trigonus in tetragono*, and the distinction was made by the Apostles, with the approbation of CHRIST; that the angels of the seven Churches in the Revelation were seven Bishops; that it is the most silly ridiculous thing in the world, to calumniate that for a Papal innovation, which was established in the Church before there was a Pope at Rome: which hath been received and approved in all ages since the very cradle of Christianity, by all sorts of Christians, Europeans, Africans, Asiatics, Indians, many of which never had any intercourse with Rome, nor scarcely ever heard of the name of Rome. If *semper, ubique, et ab omnibus* be not a sufficient plea, I know not what is.

But because I esteem them Churches not completely formed, do I, therefore, exclude them from

all hopes of salvation? or esteem them aliens and strangers from the commonwealth of Israel? or account them formal schismatics? No such thing. First, I know there are many learned persons among them who do passionately affect Episcopacy; some of which have acknowledged it to myself, that their Church would never be rightly settled, until it was new moulded. Baptism is a sacrament, the door of Christianity, a matriculation into the Church of Christ: yet the very desire of it in case of necessity, is sufficient to excuse from the want of actual Baptism. And is not the desire of Episcopacy sufficient to excuse from the actual want of Episcopacy, in like case of necessity? or should I censure these as Schismatics?

Secondly, there are others, who though they do not long so much for Episcopacy, yet they approve it, and want it only out of invincible necessity. In some places the sovereign prince is of another communion; the Episcopal chairs are filled with Roman Bishops. If they should petition for Bishops of their own, it would not be granted. In other places the magistrates have taken away Bishops: whether out of policy, because they thought that regiment not so proper for their republics, or because they were ashamed to take away the revenues, and preserve the order, or out of a blind zeal; they have given an account to GOD: they owe none to me. Should I condemn all these as schismatics for want of Episcopacy, who want it out of invincible necessity?

Thirdly, there are others who have neither the same desires, nor the same esteem of Episcopacy, but condemn it as an Anti-christian innovation, and a rag of Popery. I conceive this to be most gross schism materially. It is ten times more schismatical to desert, nay, to take away (so much as lies in them) the whole order of Bishops, than to subtract obedience from one lawful Bishop. All that can be said to mitigate this fault is, that they do it ignorantly, as they have been mistaught and misinformed. And I hope that many of them are free from obstinacy, and hold the truth implicitly in the preparation of their minds, being ready to receive it, when GOD shall reveal it to them. How far this may excuse (not the crime but) their persons from formal schism, either *a toto* or *a tanto*, I determine not, but leave them to stand or fall to their own Master.

But though these Protestants were worthy of this contumely, yet surely the Romanists are no fit persons to object it, whose *opinastrety* did hinder an uniform reformation of the Western Church. Who did invest Presbyters with Episcopal jurisdiction, and the power of ordaining and confirming, but the Court of Rome, by their commissions and delegations, for avaricious ends? And could they think that the world would believe, that necessity is not as strong and effectual a dispensation, as their mercenary Bulls? It is not at all material, whether Episcopacy and Priesthood be two distinct orders, or distinct degrees of the same orders, the one subordinate to the other; whether Episcopal ordination do introduce a new character, or extend the old. For it is generally confessed by both parties, Protestants and Roman Catholics, that the same power and authority is necessary to the extension of a character, or grace given by ordination, which is required to the Institution of a Sacrament that is not human but divine. These avaricious practices of that Court (though it be not commonly observed) were the first source of these present controversies about Episcopacy, and Ecclesiastical discipline, which do now so much disturb the peace of the Church.

Ibid.—Vindication of Grotius.—Discourse III.

Excuse me for telling the truth plainly; many who have had their education among Sectaries and Non-conformists have apostated to Rome, but few or no right Episcopal Divines. Hot water freezeth the soonest.

He addeth, that “Grotius himself assures him (whom he hath reason to believe) that there were not a few such among the prelatical men.” How! not a few such as these, who have apostated from the Church of England? For ingenuity’s sake let him tell us where Grotius saith any such thing.

Grotius hath not one word to his purpose, when it is duly examined. But this it is to confute books in less time than wise or modest men would require to read them.

Hitherto, he is not able to show us any tolerable reason of his warning. But he showeth us the occasion, p. 82, "Those that unchurch either all or most of the Protestant Churches, and maintain the Roman Church and not theirs to be true, do call us to a moderate jealousie of them." This is far enough from proving his bold suggestion, that they have a design to introduce the Pope into England. So though all he say were true; yet he can conclude nothing from thence to make good his accusation or insinuation. I wish he would forbear these imperfect enthymematical forms of argument, which serve only to cover deceit, and set down both his propositions expressly. His assumption is wanting, which should be this: but a considerable party of Episcopal divines in England do unchurch all or most of the Protestant Churches, and maintain the Roman Church to be a true Church, and these to be no true Churches. I can assent to neither of his prepositions, nor to any part of them, as true, *sub modo*, as they are alleged by him.

First, I cannot assent to his major proposition, that all those who make an ordinary personal uninterrupted succession of Pastors, to be of the integrity of a true Church, (which is the ground of his exception) have, therefore, an intention, or can justly be suspected thereupon to have any intention to introduce the Pope. The Eastern, Southern, and Northern Churches are all of them for such a personal succession, and yet all of them utter enemies to the Pope. Secondly, I cannot assent to his minor proposition, that either all or any considerable part of the Episcopal divines in England, do unchurch either all or most part of the Protestant Churches. No man is hurt but by himself. They unchurch none at all, but leave them to stand or fall to their own Master. They do not unchurch the Swedish, Danish, Bohemian Churches, and many other Churches in Polonia, Hungaria, and those parts of the world, who have an ordinary uninterrupted succession of Pastors, some by the names of Bishops, others under the name of Seniors, unto this day. (I meddle not with the Socinians:) they unchurch not the Lutheran Churches in Germany, who both assert Episcopacy in their confessions, and have actual superintendents in their practice, and would have Bishops, name and thing, if it were in their power. Let him not mistake himself: those Churches which he is so tender of, though they be better known to us by reason of their vicinity, are so far from being "all or most part of the Protestant Churches," that being all put together, they amount not to so great a proportion as the Britannick Churches alone. And if one secluded out of them all those who want an ordinary succession without their own faults, out of invincible ignorance or necessity, and all those who desire to have an ordinary succession either explicitly or implicitly, they will be reduced to a little flock indeed.

But let him set his heart at rest. I will remove this scruple out of his mind, that he may sleep securely upon both ears. Episcopal divines do not deny those Churches to be true Churches, wherein salvation may be had. We advise them, as it is our duty, to be circumspect for themselves, and not to put it to more question, whether they have ordination or not, or desert the general practice of the universal Church for nothing, when they may clear it if they please. Their case is not the same with those who labour under invincible necessity. What mine own sense is of it, I have declared many years since to the world in print; and in the same way received thanks, and a public acknowledgment of my moderation from a French divine. And yet more particularly in my reply to the Bishop of Chalcedon, Pres. p. 144. and cap. i. p. 164. Episcopal divines will readily subscribe to the determination of the learned Bishop of Winchester, in his answer to the second epistle of Molineus. "Nevertheless, if our form (of Episcopacy) be of divine right, it doth not follow from thence, that there is not salvation without it, or that a Church cannot consist without it. He is blind

who does not see churches consisting without it: he is hard-hearted who denyeth them salvation. We are none of those hard-hearted persons, we put a great difference between these things. There may be something absent in the exterior regiment, which is of divine right, and yet salvation to be had." This mistake proceedeth from not distinguishing between the true nature and essence of a Church, which we do readily grant them, and the integrity or perfection of a Church, which we cannot grant them, without swerving from the judgment of the Catholic Church.

MEDE, PRESBYTER.—Sermon on Urim and Thummim. Works,
Book 1. p. 186.

The Ministers of Christ must be *Lux Mundi*, the light of the world—*Vos estis Lux Mundi*—"Ye are the Light of the World: Ye are the World's Urim," saith Christ unto His Apostles. "For the lips of the priest should preserve knowledge, and they should learn the law at his mouth." This light of knowledge, this teaching knowledge, is the Urim of every Levite; and therefore Christ, when He inspired his Apostles with knowledge of heavenly mysteries, He sent a new Urim from above, even fiery tongues of Urim from heaven. He sent no fiery heads, but fiery tongues; for it is not sufficient for a Levite to have his head full of Urim, unless his tongue be a candle to show it to others. There came, indeed, no Thummim [integrity or perfection] from heaven, as there came an Urim; for though the Apostles were secured from errors, they were not freed from sin; and yet we who are Levites must have such a Thummim as may be gotten upon earth; for St. Paul bids Titus in all things to show himself an example of good works, and this is a Thummim of Integrity. But, besides this Thummim, the Ministers of the Gospel have received from GOD more especially another Thummim, like unto that which was proper to the High Priest; namely, the power of binding and loosing, which is, as it were, a power of oracle, to declare unto the people the remission of their sins, by the acceptance of CHRIST'S sacrifice.

MASON, PRESBYTER.—Vindiciæ Ecclesiæ Anglicanæ,
i. 2.

Anglican. Our Ministry is agreeable to Divine Scripture, and therefore holy. Nor do we doubt, that, when the Chief Shepherd shall appear, they who turn many to righteousness shall shine as the stars for ever and ever. However, what is your argument against our ministry?

Romanist. Can a man be a lawful minister without a lawful call?

Anglican. Of course not.

Romanist. If so, I pray tell we how the Anglican Chinch can defend her ministry. Surely I may address each of you in Harding's words to Jewel: "What say you, my master? You bear yourself as though Bishop of Salisbury; but how will you substantiate your call? What is your warrant for ministering in the Word and Sacraments?" &c. &c. ... I ask thee, Is your call inward or outward?

Anglican. Both.

Romanist. An outward call, to be lawful, must be either immediately from CHRIST'S mouth, as the Apostles were called, or mediately through the Church.

Anglican. Well; we are called by GOD through the Church; for it is He who gives "Pastors and Doctors for the perfecting of the Saints."

Romanist. They who are called by GOD through the Church, must derive their warrant and power by lawful succession from CHRIST and the Apostles. If you maintain you have proceeded from this origin, it is your business to prove it clearly to us; to set forth and trace your genealogy ...

Anglican. The Ministers of the Anglican Church derive their imposition of hands in a lawful way from lawful Bishops, possessed of a lawful authority; and therefore their call is ordinary [not extraordinary, by miracles].

Romanist. But whence have these Bishops derived their power?

Anglican. From GOD, through the hands of Bishops before them, &c. &c.

SANDERSON, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Divine Right of Episcopacy

My opinion is, that Episcopal Government is not to be derived merely from Apostolical practice or institution, but that it is originally founded in the Person and Office of the Messiah, our blessed LORD JESUS CHRIST; who, being sent by our heavenly Father to be the Great Apostle (Heb. iii. 1), Bishop, and Pastor (1 Peter ii. 25) of His Church, and anointed to that office immediately after His baptism by John, with power and the HOLY GHOST (Acts x. 37, 38), descending then upon Him in a bodily shape (Luke iii. 22), did afterwards, before His ascension into Heaven, send and empower His holy Apostles, in like manner as His Father had before sent Him (John xx. 21), to execute the same Apostolical, Episcopal, and Pastoral Office, for the ordering and governing of His Church, until His coming again; and so the same office to continue in them and their successors unto the end of the world. (Matt. xxviii. 18-20.) This I take to be so clear, from these and other like texts of Scripture, that if they shall be diligently compared together, both between themselves and with the following practice of the Churches of CHRIST, as well in the Apostles' times as in the purest and primitive times nearest thereunto, there will be left little cause why any man should doubt thereof.

HAMMOND, PRESBYTER, DOCTOR, AND CONFESSOR.—On the Power of the Keys.

Preface

That the prime act of power enstated by CHRIST on His Apostles, as for the governing of the Church, (and exercising or banishing all devils out of it,) so for the effectual performing that great act of charity to men's souls, reducing pertinacious sinners to repentance, should be so, either wholly dilapidated, or piteously deformed, as to continue in the Church, only under one of these two notions, either of an empty piece of formality, or of an engine of state and secular contrivance, (the true Christian use of shaming sinners into reformation, being well nigh vanished out of Christendom,) might by an alien, or an heathen, much more by the pondering Christian, be conceived very strange and unreasonable, were it not a little clear that we are fallen into those times, of which it was foretold by two Apostles, that in "these last days, there should come scoffers, walking after their own lusts," &c. ... I shall design to infer no further conclusion, but only this, that they which live ill in the profession of a most holy faith ... but especially they that discharge and banish out of the Church those means which might help to make the generality of Christians better, have the spirit of Antichrist working in them, even when they think themselves most zealously busied in beating down his kingdom. What those means are which might most effectually tend to the amending the lives of Christians, I shall need no farther to interpose my judgment, than, 1st, by submitting it to CHRIST, who put the keys into the Apostles' hands, on purpose as a means to exemplify the end of His coming ... 2nd, by minding myself and others what the Apostles say of this power, that it was given them [*pros oikodomēn*], to build up the Church of CHRIST, &c.

Chapter 3. The only difficulty remaining on the point, will be, who are the Apostles' successors in that power; and when the question is asked of that power, I must be understood of the power of governing the Church peculiarly, (of which the power of the keys was and is a principal branch,) for it must again be remembered that the Apostles are to be considered under a double notion, first, as planters, then as governors, of the Church ... Which distinction being premised, the question will now more easily be satisfied, being proposed in these terms; who were the Apostles' successors in that power, which concerned the governing their Churches which they planted? and first, I answer, that it being a matter of fact, or story, later than that the Scripture can universally reach to, it cannot be fully satisfied or answered from thence ... but will in the full latitude, through the universal

Church in these times, be made clear, from the recent evidences that we have, viz. from the consent of the Greek and Latin Fathers, who generally resolve that Bishops are those successors.

TAYLOR, BISHOP, CONFESSOR, AND DOCTOR.—On Episcopacy. Introduction

Antichrist must come at last, and the great apostasy foretold must be, and this not without means proportionable to the production of so great declensions of Christianity. “When ye hear of wars and rumours of wars, be not afraid,” says our blessed SAVIOUR, “the end is not yet.” It is not war that will do “this great work of destruction;” for then it might have been done long ere now. What then will do it? We shall know when we see it. In the mean time, when we shall find a new device, of which, indeed, the platform was laid, in Aërius and the Acephali, brought to a good possibility of completing a thing, that whosoever shall hear, his ears shall tingle, “an abomination of desolation standing where it ought not,” “*in sacris*,” in holy persons, and places, and offices, it is too probable that this is preparatory for the Antichrist, and grand apostasy.

For if Antichrist shall exalt himself above all that is called GOD, and in Scripture none but kings and priests are such, “*dii vocati, dii facti*,” I think we have great reason to be suspicious, that he that divests both of their power, (and they are, if the king be Christian, in very near conjunction,) does the work of Antichrist for him; especially if the men whom it most concerns will but call to mind, that if the discipline or government which CHRIST hath instituted is that kingdom by which He governs all Christendom, (so themselves have taught us,) when they (to use their own expressions) throw CHRIST out of His kingdom; and then either they leave the Church without a head, or else put Antichrist in substitution.

We all wish that our fears in this and all things else may be vain, that what we fear may not come upon us; but yet that the abolition of episcopacy is the forerunner, and preparatory to the great Apostasy, I have these reasons to show, at least, the probability. First, &c. * * *

Sections 2 and 3. This government was by immediate substitution delegated to the Apostles, by CHRIST Himself, “*in traditione clavium, inspiratione Spiritûs, in missione in Pentecosto*.” ... This power so delegated, was not to expire with their persons; for when the great Shepherd had reduced His wandering sheep into a fold, He would not leave them without “guides to govern” them, so long as the wolf might possibly prey upon them, and that is, till the last separation of the sheep from the goats. And this CHRIST intimates in that promise, “*Ero vobiscum (Apostolis) usque ad consummationem seculi*.” “*Vobiscum*,” not with your persons, for they died long ago: but “*vobiscum et vestri similibus*,” with Apostles to the end of the world. And, therefore, that the Apostolate might be successive and perpetual, CHRIST gave them a power of Ordination, that by imposing hands on others, they might impart that power which they received from CHRIST.

HEYLIN, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—On Episcopacy,

i. 6.

The Church, at his (St. John’s) departure, he left firmly grounded in all the points of faith and doctrine, taught by CHRIST our SAVIOUR, as well settled in the outward government, the polity and administration of the same, which had been framed by the Apostles, according to the pattern and example of their LORD and Master. For being that the Church was born of seed immortal, and they themselves, though excellent and divine, yet still mortal men, it did concern the Church, in a high degree, to be provided of a perpetuity, or, if you will, the immortality of overseers, both for the sowing of this seed, and for the ordering of the Church, or the field itself. This, since they could not do in person, they were to do it by successors, who by their office were to be the ordinary pastors of the Church, and the Vicars of CHRIST. Now, if you ask the Fathers who they were that were accounted in their times and ages the successors of the Apostles, they will with one accord

make answer, that the Bishops were.

ALLESTRIE, PRESBYTER.—Sermons, No. 16.

The separateness of the functions of the Clergy, the incommunicableness of their offices to persons not separated for them, is so express a doctrine both of the letter of the text, and of the HOLY GHOST, that sure I need not to say more, though several heads of probation offer themselves; as first the condition of the callings, which does divide from the community and sets them up above it. And here I might tell you of “bearing rule,” of “thrones,” of “stars,” and “Angels,” and other words of a high sense, and yet not go out of the Scripture bounds, although the dignity did not die with the Scripture age, or expire with the Apostles; the age as low as Photius words it thus, [*To apostolikon, k. t. l.*] “That Apostolical and Divine dignity, which the Chief Priests are acknowledged to be possessed of by right of succession.” Styles which I could derive yet lower, and they are of a prouder sound than those the modest bumble ears of this our age are so offended with. But these heights, it may be, would give umbrages; although it is strange that men should envy them to those, who are only exalted to them, that they may with the more advantage take them by the hands and lift them up to heaven. Those nearnesses to things above do but more qualify them to draw near to GOD, on your behalf, that these your Angels also may see the face of your FATHER which is in heaven, and those stars are, therefore, set in CHRIST’S right hand, that they may shed a blessing [blessed?] influence on you from thence . . .

The censures of the Church, the burden of the keys, which (passing by the private use of them in voluntary penitences, and discipline upon the sick,) as they signify public exclusion out of the Church, for scandalous enormities, and readmission into it upon repentance, have been sufficiently evinced to belong to the governors of the Church. The exercise of them is so much their work, that St. Paul calls them “the weapons of their spiritual warfare, by which they do cast down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of GOD, and bring into captivity every thought to the obedience of CHRIST,” (2 Cor. x. 4, 5.) a blessed victory, even for the conquered, and these the only weapons to achieve it with. If those who sin scandalously, and will not hear the admonition of the Church, were cast out of the Church, if not religion, reputation would restrain them somewhat; not to be thought fit company for Christians, would surely make them proud against their vices. Shame, the designed effect of their censures, hath great pungencies; the fear of it does goad men into actions of the greatest hazard, and the most unacceptable; such as have nothing lovely in them, but are wholly distasteful . . . Now, the infliction of these censures is so much the work to which Church governors are called by the HOLY GHOST, that they are equally called by Him to it and to Himself; both are alike bestowed upon them. “Receive the HOLY GHOST; whose sins ye retain, they are retained.” (John xx. 22.) And in the first derivations of this office, it was performed with severities, such as this age, I doubt, will not believe; and when they had no temporal sword to be auxiliary to these spiritual weapons.

PEARSON, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—On the Creed, Article ix.

[After considering the Church as one, by reason of its one foundation, faith, ministry of sacrament, hope, and charity, he continues,—]

Lastly, all the Churches of GOD are united into one by the unity of discipline and government, by virtue whereof the same CHRIST ruleth in them all. For they have all the same pastoral guides appointed, authorized, sanctified, and set apart by the appointment of GOD, by the direction of the SPIRIT, to direct and lead the people of GOD in the same way of eternal salvation: as, therefore, there is no Church where there is no order, no ministry; so, where the same order and ministry is, there is the same Church. * * *

The necessity of believing the Holy Catholick Church appeareth first in this, that CHRIST hath appointed it as the only way unto eternal life. We read at the first, "The LORD added to the Church daily such as should be saved;" and what was then daily done hath been done since continually. CHRIST never appointed two ways to heaven; nor did He build a Church to save some, and make another institution for other men's salvation. "There is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved," but the name of JESUS; and that is no otherwise given under heaven than in the Church. As none were saved from the Deluge but such as were within the ark of Noah, formed for their reception by the command of GOD; as none of the first-born of Egypt lived, but such as were within those habitations whose door-posts were sprinkled with blood by the appointment of GOD for their preservation; as none of the inhabitants of Jericho could escape the fire or sword, but such as were within the house of Rahab, for whose protection a covenant was made; so none shall ever escape the eternal wrath of GOD, which belong not to the Church of GOD. This is the congregation of those persons here on earth which shall hereafter meet in heaven. These are the vessels of the tabernacle carried up and down, at last to be translated into and fixed in the Temple.

Next, it is necessary to believe the Church of CHRIST, which is but one, that, being in it, we may take care never to cast ourselves, or be ejected, out of it. There is a power within the Church to cast those out which do belong to it: for if any neglect to hear the Church, saith our SAVIOUR, let him be unto thee as a heathen man and a publican. By great and scandalous offences, by incorrigible misdemeanors, we may incur the censure of the Church of GOD; and while we are shut out by them, we stand excluded out of Heaven. For our SAVIOUR said to His Apostles, upon whom He built his Church, "Whosoever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; and whosoever sins ye retain, they are retained." Again, a man may not only passively and involuntarily be ejected, but also may, by an act of his own, cast out or eject himself, not only by plain and complete apostasy, but by a defection from the unity of truth, falling into some damnable heresy; or by an active separation, deserting all which are in communion with the Catholick Church, and falling into an irrevocable schism.

FELL, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—On Ephesians,
v. 9.

Apostles, ... Prophets, ... Evangelists, ... Pastors, ... and Teachers ... For the three first, some part of their function was temporary and extraordinary; in what was ordinary and perpetual, Bishops succeeded.

BULL, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Vindication of the English Church, § 24.

We proceed, in the next place, to the constant visibility and succession of Pastors in our Church ... And here I make him this fair proposal: Let him, or any one of his party, produce any one solid argument to demonstrate such a succession of Pastors in the Church of Rome, and I will undertake by the very same argument to prove a like succession in our Church. Indeed, ... the Author of the Letter is concerned, no less than we are, to acknowledge such a succession of lawful pastors in our Church, till the time of the Reformation; and if we cannot derive our succession since, it is a hard case. But our records, faithfully kept and preserved, do evidence to all the world an uninterrupted succession of Bishops in our Church, canonically ordained, derived from such persons in whom a lawful power of ordination was seated by the confession of the Papists themselves. For the story of the Nag's head Ordination is so putrid a fable, so often and so clearly refuted by the writers of our Church, that the more learned and ingenuous Papists are now ashamed to make use of it.

STILLINGFLEET, BISHOP.—Unreasonableness of Separation; Preface

Unthinking people ... are carried away with mere noise and pretences, and hope these will secure them most against the fears of Popery, who talk with most passion, and with least understanding, against it; whereas no persons do really give them greater advantages than these do. For, where they meet only with intemperate railings, and gross misunderstandings of the state of the controversies between them and us (which commonly go together), the most subtle priests let such alone to spend their rage and fury; and when the heat is over, they will calmly endeavour to let them see how grossly they have been deceived in some things, and so wilt more easily make them believe, they are as much deceived in all the rest. And thus the East and West may meet at last, and the most furious antagonists may become some of the easiest converts. This I do really fear will be the case of many thousands among us, who now pass for most zealous Protestants; if ever, which GOD forbid, that religion should come to be uppermost in England. It is, therefore, of mighty consequence for preventing the return of Popery, that men rightly understand what it is. For, when they are as much afraid of an innocent ceremony as of real idolatry, and think they can worship images and adore the Host on the same grounds that they may use the sign of the cross, or kneel at the Communion, when they are brought to see their mistake in one case, they will suspect themselves deceived in the other also.

When they find undoubted practices of the Ancient Church condemned as Popish and Antichristian by their teachers, they must conclude Popery to be of much greater antiquity than really it is; and when they can trace it so very near the Apostles' times, they will soon believe it settled by the Apostles themselves. For it will be very hard to persuade any considering men, that the Christian Church should degenerate so soon, so unanimously, so universally, as it must do, if Episcopal government, and the use of some significant ceremonies, were any parts of that apostasy ... Three ways, Bishop Sanderson observes, our dissenting brethren, though not intentionally and purposely, yet really and eventually, have been the great promoters of the Roman interest among us; (1) by putting-to their helping hand to the pulling down of Episcopacy ... (2) by opposing the interest of Rome with more violence than reason; (3) by frequently mistaking the question, but especially through the necessity of some false principle or other, which, having once imbibed, they think themselves bound to maintain, whatever becomes of the common cause of our Reformation.

KEN, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Exposition of the Church Catechism

I believe, O blessed and adorable Mediator, that the Church is a society of persons, founded by Thy love to sinners, united into one body of which Thou art the head, initiated by baptism, nourished by the Eucharist, governed by pastors commissioned by Thee, and endowed with the power of the keys, professing the doctrine taught by Thee and delivered to the saints, and devoted to praise and to love Thee.

I believe, O holy JESUS, that Thy Church, is holy like Thee its Author; holy by the original design of its institution, holy by baptismal dedication, holy in all its administrations which tend to produce holiness; and though there will be always a mixture of good and bad in it in this world, yet that it has always many real saints in it; and, therefore, all love, all glory, be to Thee ...

Glory be to Thee, O LORD my GOD, who hast made me a member of the particular Church of England, whose faith, government, and worship are Holy, and Catholic, and Apostolic, and free from the extremes of irreverence and superstition, and which I firmly believe to be a sound part of Thy Church universal, and which teaches me charity to those who dissent from me; and, therefore, all love, all glory be to Thee.

BEVERIDGE, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Sermon on Christ's Presence with His Ministers

In the first place, I observe, how much we are all bound to acknowledge the goodness, to praise,

magnify, and adore the name of the most high GOD, in that we were born and bred, and still live in a Church, wherein the Apostolical line hath, through all ages, been preserved entire, there having been a constant succession of such Bishops in it, as were truly and properly successors to the Apostles, by virtue of that Apostolical imposition of hands, which, being begun by the Apostles, hath been continued from one to another, ever since their time, down to ours. By which means, the same SPIRIT which was breathed by our LORD into His Apostles is, together with their office, transmitted to their lawful successors, the pastors and governors of our Church at this time; and acts, moves, and assists at the administration of the several parts of the Apostolical office in our days, as much as ever. From whence it follows, that the means of grace which we now enjoy are in themselves as powerful and effectual as they were in the Apostles' days, &c. . . .

And this, I verily believe, is the great reason why the devil has such a great spite at our Church, still stirring up adversaries of all sorts against it,—Papists on the one hand, and Sectaries on the other, and all, if possible, to destroy it; even because the SPIRIT which is ministered in it, is so contrary to his nature, and so destructive of his kingdom, that he can never expect to domineer and tyrannize over the people of the land, so long as such a Church is settled among them, and they continue firm to it . . .

As for schism, they certainly hazard their salvation at a strange rate, who separate themselves from such a Church as ours is, wherein the Apostolical succession, the root of all Christian communion, hath been so entirely preserved, and the word and sacraments are so effectually administered; and all to go into such assemblies and meetings, as can have no pretence to the great promise in my text. For it is manifest, that this promise was made only to the Apostles and their successors to the end of the world. Whereas, in the private meetings, where their teachers have no Apostolical or Episcopal imposition of hands, they have no ground to succeed the Apostles, nor by consequence any right to the SPIRIT which our LORD hath; without which, although they preach their hearts out, I do not see what spiritual advantage can accrue to their hearers by it, &c. . . .

SHARP, ARCHBISHOP.—Sermons, Vol. vii. Of the Church

“Go,” He says, “and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them,” &c. . . . This commission of our SAVIOUR we may properly style the Charter of the Church; and mind, I pray, what is contained in it. Our SAVIOUR here declares the extent of His Church, and of what persons He would have it constituted. It was to extend throughout all the world, and to be made up of all nations. He here declares by whom He would have it built and constituted, viz., the Apostles. He here declares upon what grounds He would have it constituted, or upon what conditions any person was to be received into it, viz., their becoming the disciples of JESUS CHRIST, and undertaking to observe all that He has commanded. He here likewise declares the form or the method by which persons were to be admitted into this Church, and that was by being baptized in the name of the FATHER, and of the SON, and of the HOLY GHOST. And, lastly, He here promises the perpetual presence of His HOLY SPIRIT, both to assist the apostles and their successors in the building and governing this Church, and to actuate and enliven all the members of it . . . Thus, I am sure, I have given the true notion of the Church, which the Scripture always intends, when it speaks of the Church as the Body of CHRIST, when it speaks of the Church which CHRIST purchased with His blood, when it speaks of the Church into which we are baptized, when it speaks of the Church to which all those glorious promises are made of the forgiveness of sins, of the perpetual presence and assistance of the HOLY SPIRIT, of the gates of hell never prevailing against it, and of everlasting salvation in the world to come; I say, that Church is always meant of the whole company of Christians dispersed over all the world, that profess the common faith, (though perhaps none of them without mixture

of error,) and enjoy the administration of the word and sacrament, under their lawful pastors and governors: all these people, wherever they live, or by what name soever they call themselves, make up together that one Body of CHRIST which we call the Catholic Church.

SCOTT, PRESBYTER.—Christian Life, Part ii. ch. 7.

Another thing wherein those particular Churches, into which the Catholic Church is distributed, do communicate with each other, is, in the essentials of Christian regiment and discipline: for though the particular modes and circumstances of Christian government and discipline are not determined by divine institution, but left for the most part free to the prudent ordering and disposal of the governors of particular Churches, yet there is a standing form of government and discipline in the Church, instituted by our SAVIOR Himself, which, as I shall show hereafter, is this; that there should be an episcopacy, or order of men, authorized in a continual succession from the Apostles, (who were authorized by Himself) to oversee and govern all those particular Churches into which the Church Catholic should be hereafter distributed; to ordain, &c. &c. And this being the standing government and discipline of the Catholic Church, no particular Church or community of Christians can refuse to communicate in it, without dividing itself from the communion of the Church Catholic; I say, “refuse to communicate in it,” because it is possible for a Church to be without this government and discipline, which yet doth neither refuse it, nor the communion of any other Church for the sake of it. A Church may be debarred of it by unavoidable necessities, in despite of its power and against its consent . . . Though this instituted government is necessary to the perfection of a Church, yet it doth not therefore follow, that it is necessary to the being of it . . . But though a community of Christians may be a true part of the Catholic Church, and in communion with it, though it hath no episcopacy; yet it is a plain case, that if it rejects the episcopacy, and separates from the communion of it, it thereby wholly divides itself from the communion of the Catholic Church.

WAKE, ARCHBISHOP.—Exposition of the Doctrine of the English Church. Art. 15.

The imposition of hands in Holy Orders, being accompanied with a blessing of the HOLY SPIRIT, may, perhaps, upon that account, be called a kind of particular sacrament. Yet since that grace, which is thereby conferred, whatever it be, is not common to all Christians, nor by consequence any part of that federal blessing which our blessed SAVIOUR has purchased for us, but only a separation of him who receives it to a special employ, we think it ought not to be esteemed a common sacrament of the whole Church, as Baptism and the LORD’S Supper are . . . We confess that no man ought to exercise the ministerial office till he be first consecrated to it. We believe that it is the Bishop’s part only to ordain. We maintain the distinction of the several orders in the Church and though we have none of them below a deacon, because we do not read that the Apostles had any, yet we acknowledge the rest to have been anciently received in the Church, and shall not therefore raise any controversy about them.

WAKE.—Art. 25.

Professing in our Creed a Holy Catholic Church, we profess to believe not only that there was a Church planted by our SAVIOUR at the beginning, that has hitherto been preserved by Him, and ever shall be to the end of the world; but do in consequence undoubtedly believe too, that this universal Church is so secured by the promises of CHRIST, that there shall always be retained so much truth in it, the want of which would argue that there could be no such Church.

POTTER, ARCHBISHOP.—On Church Government. Chap. v.

First, then, it must be shown, that the office and character of all persons, who are admitted into holy orders, extends over the whole world, and it is manifest, in the first place, that the Apostles

had a general commission to “teach and baptize,” and to execute all other parts of their office in all nations. As the bishops of the Church have been shown to succeed the Apostles in all the parts of their office which are of standing and constant use in the Church; so we might reasonably conclude, though we have no farther proof of it, that the office and character of bishop, and consequently of inferior ministers, extends over all the world, because those of the Apostles, their predecessors, did so; since there is scarce any reason why the Apostles’ authority should be universal, which will not hold, at least in some degree, for the same extent of authority in the bishops, as will appear from some of the following considerations: —

There is but one Catholic Church, whereof all particular Churches are members, and therefore, when any spiritual privilege or character is conferred on any particular Church, it must be understood to extend over the whole Catholic Church: thus by Baptism, men are not only made members of the particular Church where they happen to be baptized, but of the Catholic Church over the world and therefore whoever has been lawfully baptized in one Church, has a right to partake of the LORD’S Supper, and other Church privileges, in all other Churches, where he happens to come; whereas, if baptism only admitted men into some particular Church, they must be re-baptized, before they can lawfully be received to communion in any diocese, where they have not been baptized already.

If it was not thus in holy orders, that they who have received them in one place, retain them in others; no minister could have authority to preach the Gospel or to administer the sacraments, or to exercise any other part of his functions beyond the particular district in which he was ordained; the consequence whereas is manifestly this, that the gospel of CHRIST must not be propagated, nor any churches erected, in countries where they had not stood even since the Apostles’ times. For since there can be no ministers without ordination, as was before proved, so then they, who have been ordained in one country, may lawfully exercise their respective functions in others, where there are no ordained ministers already settled, or else those countries must remain for ever without ministers, and consequently without sacraments and other public offices of religion.

NELSON, CONFESSOR.—Festivals and Fasts

The Church being a regular society founded by CHRIST, distinct from and independent of all other worldly societies, must naturally make us suppose that He instituted some Officers for the government of it ... [The] Powers peculiar to the superior Order being necessary for the good government of the Church, it is plain in fact they did not expire with the Apostles. But, as our SAVIOUR “glorified not Himself to be made an High Priest,” but had His commission from GOD the FATHER, so after His resurrection, He invested the Apostles with the same commission His FATHER had given unto Him: “As My FATHER hath sent Me, even so send I you: and He breathed on them, and said unto them, Receive ye the HOLY GHOST.” In which commission is plainly contained the authority of ordaining others, and a power to transfer that commission upon others, and those upon others to the end of the world. And to show that it was not merely personal to the Apostles, our SAVIOUR promises to be with them and their successors in the execution of this commission, “even unto the end of the world.” ... This commission the Apostles and their successors exercised in all places, and even in opposition to the Rulers that then were; so that the Church subsisted as a distinct society from the state, for above three hundred years, when the civil government was only concerned to suppress and destroy it. Indeed when the Church received the benefit of incorporation and protection from the state, she was content to suffer some limitation as to the exercise of these powers, and thought herself sufficiently recompensed by the advantages that accrued to her by the incorporation.

KETTLEWELL, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—Practical Believer, ii. 6.

Question. There remains yet one instance of the Communion of the Primitive Christians, mentioned by St. Luke, viz. their “continuing in the Apostles’ fellowship.” (Acts ii. 42.) I pray you what is meant by that?

Answer. Owning their authority and continuing under their government. They were appointed by CHRIST, as His deputies, to govern His Church; and, therefore, to adhere to them, as the delegates of CHRIST, is called living “in their fellowship.”

Q. But how can we live in their fellowship, and adhere to their government, now they are dead?

A. By adhering to and owning the authority of our own Bishops, who are their successors, and rule the Church in their stead.

HICKS, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Treatise on the Episcopal Order, § 2.

Can you, Sir, when you consider that Bishops are appointed to succeed the Apostles, and, like them, to stand in CHRIST’S place, and exercise their kingly, priestly, and prophetic office over their flocks; can you, when you consider this, think it novel, or improper, or uncouth, to call them spiritual princes, and their dioceses principalities?—when they have every thing in their office which can denominate a prince? For what is a prince but the chief ruler of a society, that hath authority over the rest to make laws for it, to challenge the obedience of all the members, and all ranks of men in it, and power to coerce them, if they will not obey? And now, Sir, I pray you attend to what follows, and then tell me, if the office of a Bishop contains not every thing that is in the definition of a chief or a prince. St. Ignatius, who was St. John’s disciple, writes of the Bishop in his Epistle, &c.

LAW.—Second letter to the Bishop of Bangor

“The priests of the sons of Levi shall come near; for them hath the LORD thy GOD chosen to minister unto Him, and to bless in the name of the Lord.” (Deut. xxi. 5.) Now, my LORD, this is what we mean by the authoritative administration of the Christian clergy: whether they be by way of benediction, or of any other kind. We take them to be persons whom GOD has chosen to minister unto Him, and to bless in His name. We imagine that our SAVIOUR was a greater priest and mediator than Aaron, or any of GOD’S former ministers. We are assured that CHRIST sent His Apostles, as His FATHER had sent Him; and that, therefore, they were His true successors; and since they did commission others to succeed them in their office by the imposition of hands, as Moses commissioned Joshua to succeed him, the clergy who have succeeded the Apostles, have as divine a call and commission to their work, as those who were called by our SAVIOUR; and are as truly His successors as the Apostles themselves were.

Ibid.—Postscript

The third objection against this uninterrupted succession is this: that it is a popish doctrine, and “gives Papists advantage over us.” The objection proceeds thus: “We must not assert the necessity of this succession, because the Papists say it is only to be found in them.” I might add, because some mighty zealous Protestants say so too.

But if this be good argumentation, we ought not to tell the Jews, or Deists, &c., that there is any necessity of embracing Christianity, because the Papists say, Christians can only be saved in their Church. Again, we ought not to insist upon a true faith, because the Papists say, that a true faith is only in their communion. So that there is just as much Popery in teaching this doctrine, as in asserting the necessity of Christianity to a Jew, or the necessity of a right faith to a Socinian, &c.

JOHNSON, PRESBYTER.—Unbloody Sacrifice, Part II. Chap. 3.

The Eucharist is one, as offered by priests, who are one by their commission. It is very evident

that it was not only our SAVIOUR'S intention, but His most passionate desire, that, as all His Apostles received their commission from Him, so they might execute it with such a harmony and consent of mind, that there might not be the least jarring between them; for thus He prays for them; "Keep through Thine own name those whom Thou hast given Me, that they may be one, as We are." And the foundation of our SAVIOUR'S wishes and expectations for so perfect an union between His Apostles was this, as is expressed by Himself, "I have given them the Words which Thou gavest Me," that is, He had committed to them the same treasures of Divine truth which the FATHER had before committed to him, &c. ... After His resurrection, He does, with great solemnity, tell them, "As My FATHER sent Me, even so send I you;" from which words it is evident, that the commission of all the Apostles was one and the same; that it was such a commission as CHRIST Himself in His human nature, had received from His FATHER; and even they who were not of the same order with the Apostles, but only inferior Presbyters under them, yet by deriving their authority from the same fountainhead, and exercising it in conformity to the instructions which they received from them, they still kept the "unity of the SPIRIT in the bond of peace." ... It was upon this account that Ignatius, Cyprian, and others, represent the whole college of Bishops throughout the whole world as one person, sitting in one chair, attending one altar; and that, therefore, is the one Eucharist which is celebrated by this one priesthood: and St. Clement of Rome allows nothing to be offered without the inspection of the high priest; and, therefore, when a new altar is erected, a new Bishop ordained in opposition to the former, then there is just occasion to ask that question, as St. Paul did, "Is CHRIST divided?" When two several pastors assume to themselves the privilege of offering and consecrating the Sacrament not only in two distinct places, but in contradiction to each other, and by two several inconsistent claims; then it is evident, that one of them acts by no commission, for if the true Eucharist can be had in two opposite assemblies, then CHRIST'S flesh ceases to be one.

DODWELL, CONFESSOR.—Discourse on the one Priesthood, one Altar. Ch. 12.

I observe that the Hierophanta, in their mysteries represented a Divine Person. The same, in all probability, were the thoughts of the primitive Christians, concerning their Bishops. This I take to be the true design of that description of the Majestic Presence in the Revelations, to represent the Divine Presence, and assistance in the Church, in as lively a way as possible, according to the ways of Mystical Representation received in those times ... St. John being particularly to affect the Churches he writes to, those of the Lydian or Proconsular Asia, with a very feeling sense of the Divine presence among them, (which might add the greater authority to his several exhortations respectively,) he represents our SAVIOUR in a human visible shape; and that the rest of the scene might be suitable, (that is, sensible also as well as Himself,) he personates the Angels by their visible Bishops, that so CHRIST might be apprehended as present with the Bishops, as GOD was supposed to be wherever these Seven Spirits were, which were peculiarly deputed to represent the Majestic Presence. This I take to be the reason why he confines his number, not that by any geographical distinction those seven cities were incorporated into a body, more than others of that province, but that he had particular regard to that number of those Angels of the presence. Therefore he makes seven candlesticks, alluding, as I have said, to the like number of those in the tabernacle, as emblems of those seven Churches. Therefore seven stars, alluding to the number of the Planets and the Angels who presided over them, as emblems of the Bishops of those Churches ... Thus it appears plainly, that the Bishops are here represented in a mystical way; and how particularly suitable it was, in this way, to personate them by the name of Angels. They were, indeed, to perform the same office under CHRIST, as a *visible* human person, which the Angels were under

Him as the Logos, in reference to the restitution of souls to their original dignity ...

But because even His human nature, though visible in itself, is yet invisible to us, therefore another way was thought of for copying out that heavenly [*teletē*], even in the ordinary external visible government of the Church. And here the Bishop was to personate CHRIST Himself, as the High Priest had, formerly, represented the Logos. The seven deacons were to represent the Seven Mystical Angels, as I am very apt to think, they were designed from the very original. I cannot think it casual that the number first pitched on was exactly seven. But, that which more confirms me in this opinion is the real suitableness of the office of the Deacon to the Bishops, as representing the Logos in a visible way, with that of those Angels to the same Logos, as He was invisible. The office of the Angels in general is thus described, by the Author of the Hebrews, that they are [“ ministering spirits, sent out for a diaconate.”] These are exactly the very terms by which the Church would have expressed the office of these Deacons, if she had been to have described the same office as vested in mortal men ... They (the Angels) were to stand before the presence of GOD, in a posture of readiness to be sent on messages by Him; and so were the Deacons to stand before the Bishop, to be sent by him on his messages. They were the “eyes of the LORD which ran to and fro through the whole earth.” So also the Deacons are, in the language of the Ancient Church, called the *Oculi Episcopi*, for the same reason ... Now we may not wonder why the Bishops are called Angels, in the forementioned mystical immediate relation to our SAVIOUR Himself as the chief “Bishop of our souls;” because, indeed, in regard of Him, they bear no higher office than that of Deacons ... Accordingly the Primitive Church were extremely rigorous in insisting on this very number of their Deacons, in all places, as I have elsewhere showed. The council of Neocæsarea imposed it as a universal rule, how great soever the Church were to which the Deacons were to serve; ... a canon, which, though it were at first designed only for their own province of Cappadocia, was, notwithstanding, afterwards extended, first, to the Eastern Empire ... afterwards to the Western ... Therefore, even then it is much more probable that this number was already received in more Churches than otherwise.

And now the comparisons of the Bishops in Ignatius cannot seem so strange, these things being considered, as they did to Blondell, who had considered none of them. They are generally designed to express the sacredness and excellency of the persons which the clergy bore in these mystical performances. Nor is there any thing in them that is really affected or strained, much less blasphemous, no, nor any extravagant flights of fancy ... If he were to compare them with the first invisible archetypes of unity, (as that is, indeed, his great design in those epistles, in opposition to the schisms then rising,) then it was very proper for him to take notice only of the two orders which were then immediately concerned in the office of ministration, and then to compare them with GOD the Father, and the Logos; because as this unity consists in the unity of the head, and the Scripture tells us that the head of every man is CHRIST, so also the same Scripture tells us that the Head of CHRIST is GOD ... These things, therefore, being thus solidly laid down by the first fathers, in their disputes against their contemporary Heretics and Schismatics, all the inferences thence deduced against them, will follow naturally and undeniably ... It will follow, that disunion from the Bishop was a disunion from CHRIST and the FATHER, and from all the invisible heavenly Priesthood, and sacrifice, and intercession. It will follow that disunion from any one ordinary, must consequently be a disunion from the whole Catholic Church, seeing it is impossible for any, to continue a member of CHRIST’S mystical body, who is disunited from the mystical head of it. It will follow that visible disunion from the external sacraments of the Bishop, is in the consequence a disunion from the Bishop, and from the whole Catholic Church in communion with him, who

ought to ratify each other's censures under pain of schism if they do not.

COLLIER, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Moral Essays, Part III.

'Tis the bulk and serviceableness of business, and the use it has in the world, which makes an employment honourable. And can any thing compare with the Apostles in this particular? Were they not to form and instruct the Church, and to govern the most noble society upon earth? Were they not to publish the Mysteries of Redemption, the offers of the New Covenant, and the glories of the other world ... Fire in the figure of tongues sat upon the heads of each of them. This was an emblem of the gift of languages, and the miracle was as bright as the flame ... This was a glorious attestation, this must needs make their Commission undisputed, and their character indelible. Should a Prince be proclaimed from the sky, anointed out of the Ampoul, and crowned by an Angel, his authority could not be more visible ... I can't help saying, that, in my opinion, a Prince made but a lean figure in comparison with an Apostle. What is the magnificence of palaces, the richness of furniture, the quality of attendance, what is all this to the pomp of miracles, and the grandeur of supernatural power? ... A Prince can bestow marks of distinction, and posts of honour and authority; but he can't give the HOLY GHOST, he can't register his favourites among the quality of heaven, nor entitle them to the bliss of eternity. No,—these powers were Apostolic privileges, and the enclosure of the Church. The prerogative royal cannot stretch thus far; these jewels are not to be found in the imperial crown ... I need not tell you how much they suffered through their progress, and how gloriously they went off into the other world. But before their departure they took care to perpetuate their authority, and provide governors for the Church. Thus the jurisdiction was conveyed to Bishops and Priests; this succession has continued without interruption for above sixteen hundred years.

LESLIE, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—Case of the Regale and Pontificate

When any constitution of civil government dissolves itself, another immediately succeeds; or, if a Monarchy be turned into a Commonwealth, or a Commonwealth into a Monarchy: and consequently that which was dissolved, is no more; but we cannot say that the Church is no more. There is still a Church, though in servitude, and nothing succeeds to it; if it were dissolved, there would be no Church, but nothing would come in its room, unless you will say a privation, that is, the want of a Church ... The Church is a society spread over the earth; and, therefore, cannot be dissolved in any one kingdom or state; nor can the concessions of any national Church oblige the Church Catholic; no, nor oblige that national Church herself, otherwise than according to the rules of the Catholic Church; more than a Committee of the House of Lords or Commons can oblige the whole House, or govern themselves by any other rules than those which are prescribed by the House.

The Church is laid as low and fenceless as the sand under their [Atheism, Deism, &c.] storms, which had long since overwhelmed the City of GOD, (after the change of her governors) if the Almighty promise (Matt. xvi. 18; xxviii. 20.) had not interposed to preserve some embers alive in the midst of these torrents. And they will be preserved till the time appointed by GOD shall come, when His breath shall put new life in them, to lick up that sea that now covers, but cannot drown them ... This is the city, the society, over which the temporal governments of the earth have assumed the dominion; and have said, "Let us break their bonds asunder, and cast away their cords from us." ...

And let not so weak a thought arise in your minds, as if all this were only the self-seeking of the Clergy, out of pride to advance themselves. Alas! it must have the quite contrary effect with any of them who consider what a heavy charge they have undertaken, and what account will be exacted

from them, for their faithful discharge of it! That the blood of all those souls who perish through their negligence or default, will be required at their hands! That they have to wrestle, not only with flesh and blood, but against principalities and powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against wicked spirits that are set up in high places! And whoever opposes these with that truth and freedom that is necessary, instead of honour must expect reproach and persecution; of which it is not the least that they cannot vindicate the honour of CHRIST'S commission without being thought to seek their own glory. Yet that must not hinder; the successors of the Holy Apostles must be content to pass, as they did, "through evil report and good report, as deceivers, and yet true."

WILSON, BISHOP, CONFESSOR AND DOCTOR.—Private Thoughts

"He that entereth not by the door into the sheepfold," &c. A lawful entrance, upon motives which aim at the glory of GOD and the good of souls; an external call and mission, from the apostolic authority of Bishops.

"A stranger will they not follow;" that is, they ought not to follow such as break Catholic Unity ...

Whoever is associated in the Priesthood of CHRIST, ought, in imitation of Him, to sacrifice himself for the advantage of His Church and for all the designs of GOD ...

"Bishops and Priests," saith St. Ambrose, "are honourable on account of the sacrifice they offer." The power of the keys and the exercise of that power, the due use of confirmation, and previous to that of examination ... are matters of infinite and eternal concern ... (*At the Lord's Supper. Before the Service begins.*) May it please Thee, O GOD, who hast called us to this ministry, to make us worthy to offer unto Thee this sacrifice for our own sins and for the sins of the people. Accept our service and our persons, through our LORD JESUS CHRIST, who liveth and reigneth with Thee and the HOLY GHOST, One GOD, world without end.—O reject not this people for me and for my sins. Amen.

(*Upon placing the Elements upon the Altar.*) Vouchsafe to receive these Thy creatures from the hands of us sinners, O Thou self-sufficient GOD!

(*Immediately after the Consecration.*) We offer unto Thee, our King and our GOD, this bread and this cup. We give Thee thanks for these and for all Thy mercies, beseeching Thee to send down Thy HOLY SPIRIT upon this sacrifice, that He may make this bread the Body of Thy CHRIST, and this cup the blood of Thy CHRIST; and that all we, who are partakers thereof, may thereby obtain remission of our sins and all other benefits of His passion. And together with us, remember, O GOD, for good, the whole mystical body of Thy Son; that such as are yet alive may finish their course with joy, and that we, with all such as are dead in the LORD, may rest in hope and rise in glory, for Thy Son's sake, whose death we now commemorate. Amen. May I adore Thee, O GOD, by offering to Thee the pure and unbloody sacrifice, which Thou hast ordained by JESUS CHRIST. Amen.

Whenever Church discipline meets with discountenance, impieties of all kinds are sure to get head and abound. And impieties unpunished do always draw down judgments. The same JESUS CHRIST, who appointed baptism for the receiving men into His Church and family, has appointed excommunication, to shut such out as are judged unworthy to continue in it ... If baptism be a blessing, excommunication is a real punishment; there being the same authority for excommunication as for baptism. And if men ridicule it, they do it at the peril of their souls.

BINGHAM, PRESBYTER.—Sermons on Absolution. No. 2.

In the first place, the commission of power to ministers to retain and remit other men's sins, in

whatever sense we take it, is a great engagement on them to lead holy and pure lives themselves. For it looks like an absurdity in practice, and is too often really thought so, that men should be qualified to forgive other men's sins, who are loaded with guilt and impurity themselves. There is nothing so natural and obvious to us as, Physician, heal thyself: and, therefore, if it be not a real objection against their office, yet it is an unanswerable one against their persons. If it do not destroy the tenor of their commission in the nature of the thing, yet it certainly diminishes their authority and reputation in the opinion of men when every profligate sinner can retort upon them and say, "Thou that teachest another, teachest thou not thyself? Thou that preachest a man should not steal, dost thou steal? Thou that sayest a man should not commit adultery, dost thou commit adultery? Thou that makest thy boast of the law, through breaking the law, dishonourest thou GOD?" It must needs take off very much from the veneration of the Sacrament of Baptism, to have a man pretend to wash away the sins of others, who is himself polluted and profane; and equally diminishes the reverence which is due to the tremendous mystery of the Eucharist, to have it ministered with unholy hands. It cannot relish well with men, to hear an unsanctified mouth giving blessing to others, who in effect is cursing himself; praying that the blood of CHRIST may preserve others to eternal life, while he himself is eating and drinking his own damnation, not discerning the LORD'S body. But above all, such a man cannot with any tolerable decency or freedom, discharge the office of punishing and correcting others, who is himself more justly liable to rebuke and censure. With what face can he debar others from Baptism or the Eucharist, who is himself unqualified to receive either? or exclude others from the Church, who is himself unworthy to enter into it? Nothing can be a greater engagement upon Ministers to lead holy and pure lives, than the consideration of the commission which CHRIST has given them, to retain or remit other men's sins, whether in a sacramental way, or a declaratory way, or a precatory way, or a judicial way: because without purity, they can by no means answer the end of this office, and the nature of their trust; but their mal-administration will rise up in judgment against them and condemn them.

2. A second thing which this office of retaining and remitting sins requires of Ministers, is great diligence in their studies and labours, without which they can never be able sufficiently to discharge it. The Church, indeed, has made some part of this work tolerably easy, by a prudent provision of many proper general forms of absolution: to which in her wisdom she may add proper forms of excommunication and judicial absolution. But when this is done, there still remains a great deal more belonging to the full discharge of this office, for which the Church can make no particular provision: and, therefore, that must be left to the industry and diligence of Ministers, in their particular studies and labours. And this requires both a diffused knowledge, and great application; to be able to understand the nature of all GOD'S laws, and the bounds and distinctions betwixt every virtue and vice; to be able to resolve all ordinary cases of conscience, and answer such doubts and scruples as are apt to arise in men's minds; to know the qualifications of particular men, and the nature and degrees and sincerity of their repentance, in order to give them a satisfactory answer to their demands, and grant or refuse them the several sorts of absolution, as they shall think proper, upon an impartial view of their state and condition. He that thinks all this may be done without any great labour and study, and a diligent search of the Holy Scriptures, the rule and record of GOD'S will, scorns neither to understand the nature of his office, nor the needs of men; nor what it is to stand in the place of CHRIST, and judge for him between GOD and man. The Priest's lips should preserve knowledge: and a man that considers the large extent of that knowledge, together with the great variety of cases and persons to which he may have occasion to apply it, would rather be tempted to cry out with the Apostle, "Who is sufficient for these things?"

And if this be not an argument to engage a man to industry in the office of a spiritual physician, it is hard to say what is so.

SKELTON, PRESBYTER.—Discourse 71.

The next thing the Puritans took offence at, was the Hierarchy of the Church. They looked on the Bishops as the instruments of papal tyranny, and the corrupters of true religion ... They were, it seems, so ignorant, as not to know, that the Bishops, of all men, had most reason to oppose the usurpation of the Bishop of Rome, who had made himself the only Bishop, and reduced all the rest to ciphers. Nor did they consider, whether it was in the power of man to abolish, at his discretion, an order of the Church, instituted by GOD Himself, merely because the men who filled this order had degenerated, together with all the rest of the Church, into superstition and luxury. Here again the scheme of our opposers was not to reform, but to destroy; and what was equally bold, to begin a new ministry, with hardly any other mission than such as a number of men, and sometimes one man only, wholly unauthorized, for aught that others could perceive, should assume. From men thus sending themselves, or sent by we know not whom, we are to receive the sacraments ... We must not forget, however, that these new orders lay claim to scriptural institution and primitive example. What, all of them? And without succession? Do we hear of any man in Scripture who ordained himself, or who presumed to take the ministry of GOD'S word and sacraments upon him, without being sent either immediately or successively by CHRIST? Or, can an instance of this kind be assigned during the first fourteen centuries of the Church?

So sacred a thing is the succession of ordination, that the HOLY GHOST, who had already enabled Barnabas and Saul to preach the word, ordered them to be "separated for the work whereunto He had called them, by fasting, prayer, and imposition of hands,"—that is, to be ordained: the SPIRIT of GOD hereby plainly showing, that He himself would not break the successive order of mission established in the Church.

SAMUEL JOHNSON.—[*en philosophou schemati presbeuōn ton theion logon*]. Sermon 7.

With regard to the order and government of the Primitive Church, we may doubtless follow their [the ancients'] authority with perfect security; they could not possibly be ignorant of laws executed, and customs practised by themselves; nor would they, even supposing them corrupt, serve any interest of their own, by handing down false accounts to posterity. We are, therefore, to inquire from them the different Orders established in the Ministry from the Apostolic ages; the different employments of each, and their several ranks, subordinations, and degrees of authority. From their writings, we are to vindicate the establishment of our Church, and by the same writings are those who differ from us in these particulars to defend their conduct.

Nor is this the only, though perhaps the chief use of these writers; for, in matters of faith and points of doctrine, those at least who lived in the ages nearest to the times of the Apostles undoubtedly deserve to be consulted. The oral doctrines and occasional explications of the Apostles would not be immediately forgotten, in the Churches to which they had preached, and which had attended to them with the diligence and reverence which their mission and character demanded. Their solution of difficulties, and determinations of doubtful questions, must have been treasured up in the memory of their audiences, and transmitted for some time from father to son. Every thing, at least, that was declared by the inspired teachers to be necessary to salvation, must have been carefully recorded; and, therefore, what we find no traces of in Scripture, or the early Fathers, as most of the peculiar tenets of the Romish Church, must certainly be concluded to be not necessary. Thus, by consulting first the Holy Scriptures, and next the writers of the Primitive Church, we shall make ourselves acquainted with the will of GOD; thus shall we discover the good way, and find

that rest for our souls, which will amply recompense our studies and inquiries.

HORNE, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Charge of Primary Visitation of his Diocese

The Constitution and use of the Church of CHRIST is another subject, on which our principles, for some years past, have been very unsettled, and our knowledge precarious and superficial. Ignorance is dangerous here, because there are so many whose interest it is to flatter us in it, and take advantage of it. The definition of the Church, contained in our Articles, was purposely less definitive than it might have been, to avoid giving further offence to those whom we rather wished to reconcile; but it does not appear, that the Church hath gained any thing by its moderation; it hath rather lost; because in virtue of that moderation, it hath been pleaded against us, that Ecclesiastical Unity may be dispensed with, and that all our differences in this matter are only problematical and immaterial.

But salvation is a gift of grace; that is, it is a free gift, to which we have no natural claim. It is not to be conceived within ourselves, but to be received, in consequence of our Christian calling, from GOD Himself, through the means of His Ordinances. These can no man administer to effect, but by GOD'S own appointment; at first, by His immediate appointment, and afterwards, by succession and derivation from thence to the end of the world. Without this rule we are open to imposture, and can be sure of nothing; we cannot be sure that our ministry is effective, and that our Sacraments are realities. We are very sensible the spirit of division will never admit this doctrine; yet the spirit of charity must never part with it. Writers and teachers who make it a point to give no offence, treat these things very tenderly; but he who, in certain cases, gives men no offence, will for that reason give them no instruction. *Light itself is painful to weak eyes; but delightful to them when grown stronger, and reconciled to it with use; and he who was instrumental in bringing them to a more perfect state of vision, though less acceptable at first, may yet, for his real kindness, be more cordially thanked afterwards, than if he had made the ease and safety of his own person the measure of his duty.* It is by no means evident, that the Church hath ever recommended itself the more by receding from any of its just pretensions: generosity obliges and secures a friend; but an enemy construes it into weakness, and then it never does any good. Yet the adversaries of the Church of England have always been persuading her to make the experiment, and have promised great things from it; with what views, it cannot be difficult to discover. It was an unhappy circumstance, and had very ill effects, when some pious men ¹², of more zeal than discretion, who set out on the work of reforming this nation, opened an asylum for penitents, which took in people of all persuasions, without exception of any. It came to be inferred from hence, that souls might be saved as well without as with a Church; perhaps better; and when men have once begun to neglect roles, they go on to despise them, and know not where to stop, till all things are bought into confusion . . .

The ancient Church is the standard by which all modern ones are to be examined; and unless a man knows what the Church was in centuries before the Reformation, he will see but darkly into the troubled waters of later times, in which faction and party have confounded things; and it hath become as much the interest of some, that the Church of CHRIST should be found every where, as it is the desire of others that it should be found no where . . . If we would guard against popular mistakes in the subject at large, it will be necessary to examine first, what the Church was under the Old Testament; for there we find its original establishment, its form, its authority, its ministry, its unity and uniformity, its maintenance, its independence; which things being so particularly laid down, no new establishment is to be found in the Epistles or the Gospels of the New Testament,

¹²Mr. Wesley, &c.

but the ancient constitution is referred to, to show us, in certain cases, what ought to be from what had been . . . From the Scripture we should proceed next to observe, what the Church was in the first ages of the Gospel, before worldly policy, miscalled moderation, had any influence upon the opinions of Christians. There is an epistle of St. Clement, on Church unity and Church authority, with which all students in divinity should be acquainted. It will teach them what the Christian society then was, and what it ought to be. Ignatius and Cyprian, both of them martyrs, will give further instruction. The latter is so particular and copious, that a code of discipline might nearly be formed upon his authority. With these preparations, we shall be the better able to judge, of what happened at the Reformation, when many things were right and many wrong; when the Church of England, by the singular blessing of GOD, preserved its constitution and its doctrines, while many of the reformed fell off by degrees, some into disorder, some into dissolution. What remains with us we must defend and preserve; trusting that the same GOD who hath raised this Church, when trodden down to the dust, will never forsake us till we forsake Him ...

But I must now hasten, in the last place, to a subject of more quietness or less suspicion [than the subject of civil government], in which wise men of all persuasions are more nearly of a mind; I mean, the conduct of the Christian life. Modern times and new modes of education have given too great a latitude in the articles of dress, and dissipation, and self-indulgence. Every thing is to be avoided which tends to diminish that gravity and seriousness which GOD expects to find in all those who are flying from the wrath to come. It was observed of old, that when inconsiderate people are avoiding one extreme, they commonly fall into another, while reason and discretion keep the middle way. When Protestants laid aside the austerities of superstition, they began to see less harm in the liberties taken by the world. The kind of life to which the first Christians conformed, hath been considered as a sort of heroic piety, which had more of suffering and mortification than are now required of us; as if the way to heaven could be easier, while the number of our temptations is probably increasing from the refinement of modern times, which, instead of giving us more liberty, call upon us for a greater degree of caution and reserve ...

To us JESUS CHRIST is the pattern of holiness, the great exemplar of perfection, of whom we are first to learn, what no heathen ever professed, to be "meek and lowly in heart;" and accordingly, one of the best books extant on the Spiritual life, is entitled, "The Imitation of JESUS CHRIST." Its language is barbarous, but its matter is divine and heavenly, and hath administered instruction and consolation to thousands of devout Christians. The way of true devotion must still be understood to be the same humble, secret, unaffected, un aspiring practice of piety, as it used to be of old. The Cross, which JESUS CHRIST carried for our salvation, is still the true emblem of our profession, from our baptism to our departure out of this life, and is to be borne by us in our minds, as a daily admonition to patient suffering and self-denial.

To assist us in the great duties of prayer and meditation, books of devotion have their use; but to us of the clergy, the liturgy of our Church is the best companion; and the daily use of it in our churches and families is required by the canons. It cannot be denied, that from various reasons prevailing amongst us, we are much fallen off of late years, from the practice of weekly prayers in our churches. Wherever this has been neglected, we should exhort the people to the revival of it, if circumstances will possibly permit; and alarm them against a mistake, to which they are all exposed, from a fanatical prejudice of baneful influence, namely, that they come to Church only to hear preaching; and hence they are indifferent, even on a Sunday, to the prayers of the Church, unless there is a sermon.

JONES OF NAYLAND, PRESBYTER.—Lectures on Hebrews iii.

The Church, in its nature, always was what it is now, a society comprehending the souls as well as the bodies of men; and, therefore, consisting of two parts, the one spiritual, answering to the soul, and the other outward, answering to the body. Hence, some have written much upon a visible Church and an invisible, as if they were two things; but they are more properly one, as the soul and body make a single person.

In the twelfth chapter of the Epistle to the Hebrews, the Apostle gives such a description of that society, into which Christians are admitted, as will show us the nature of it. "Ye are come," says he, "unto Mount Zion," &c. ... The terms here used give us a true prospect of the Church ... This is that Zion of the Holy One of Israel, to which the forces of the Gentiles were to flow from all parts of the world ... the city of the living GOD, distinguished from the cities of the world, as Jerusalem was from the cities of the heathens, who dedicated their cities not to the living GOD, but to the names of their dead idols ... This, being the city of the living GOD, must be an immortal society, for the living GOD does not preside over dead citizens; He is not the GOD of the dead, but the GOD of the living, and all the members of this society live unto Him ... It is, therefore, called the Heavenly Jerusalem, because it is of a heavenly nature; and it is called the Jerusalem which is above, which is free, and is the mother of us all ... Its spiritual nature is further declared, in that it is said to comprehend an innumerable company of angels ... In the communion of the Church the spirits of just men made perfect are also included. It is a society which admits only the spirits of the living, and as such cannot exclude the spirits of the dead; and this confirms what we said above, that the Church is a spiritual community, comprehending the dead as well as the living ...

But it is now to be shown, secondly, that as the Church of GOD hath always been the same in its nature, it hath likewise preserved the same form in its external economy: the wisdom of GOD having so ordained, that the Christian Church under the Gospel should not depart from the model of the Church under the Law. For as the congregation of Israel was divided into twelve tribes, under the twelve Patriarchs, so is the Church of CHRIST founded on the twelve Apostles, who raised to themselves a spiritual seed amongst all the nations of the world ... There were then three orders of priests in the Jewish Church; there was the high priest, and the sons of Aaron and the Levites. In the Church of CHRIST, there was the order of the Apostles, besides whom there were the seventy Disciples sent out after them; and, last of all, the Deacons were ordained to serve under both in the lower offices of the Church. The same form is still preserved in every regular Church of the world, which derives its succession and authority from the Church of the Apostles: after whom the Bishops succeeded by their appointment, such as Timothy and Titus, in their respective churches. This authority has been opposed to the Christian as it was in the Jewish Church: Corah and his company rose up against Moses and Aaron for usurping a lordly authority over the people; so, in the later ages of the Christian Church, a levelling principle hath prevailed, which has appeared in many different shapes ...

The Church has also been remarkably conformable to itself in its sufferings. There never was a time, so far as we can learn, when the true Church of GOD, with its doctrines and institutions, was not hated and opposed by the world: either persecuted and oppressed by powerful tyrants, or traduced and insulted by lying historians.

BISHOP[sic].—Sermon on Matt. xvi. 18, 19.

The keys of the kingdom of Heaven here promised to St. Peter ... must be something quite distinct from that with which it hath generally been confounded, the power of remission and retention of sins, conferred by our LORD, after His resurrection, upon the apostles in general, and transmitted through them to the perpetual succession of the priesthood. This is the discretionary

power lodged in the priesthood, of dispensing the sacraments, and of granting to the penitent and refusing to the obdurate the benefit and comfort of absolution. The object of this power is the individual upon whom it is exercised, according to the particular circumstances of each man's case. It was exercised by the Apostles in many striking instances. It is exercised now by every priest, when he administers or withholds the sacraments of baptism and the LORD'S Supper, or, upon just grounds, pronounces or refuses to pronounce upon an individual the sentence of absolution.

HEBER, BISHOP.—Sermons in England, No. xii.

We must return then, after all, (in ordinary cases, and where an immediate and supernatural commission from the HOLY GHOST is neither proved nor pretended,) to the appointment and ordination of those among our fellow-creatures who exercise a legitimate authority in the Church of CHRIST, and who, as being appointed by GOD, are placed in GOD'S stead, and commissioned by Him to dispense those graces which are necessary for the feeding of His flock, and to designate those labourers who are henceforth to work in His harvest.

And having arrived at this point of the discussion, even if that discussion were to proceed no further, and if the Scriptures had given us no information as to the persons by whom this authority was to be exercised, the validity of our ordinations would still be sufficiently plain, and the danger of separation from, or rebellion against, our Church would be sufficiently great and alarming, inasmuch as, where no distinct religious officer was instituted by GOD, the appointment of such officers must necessarily have devolved on the collective Christian Church, and on those supreme magistrates who, in every Christian country, are the recognized organs of the public will and wisdom . . . It happens, however, to be in our power to show (if not an explicit direction of CHRIST for the form of our Church government, and the manner of appointing our spiritual guides), yet a precedent so clear and a pattern so definite, as to leave little doubt of the intentions of our Divine Master, or of the manner in which those intentions were fulfilled by His immediate and inspired Disciples. Nor will the force of such precedent and example on the practice of succeeding Christians be regarded as trifling by those who consider that it is on such grounds as these that the obligation rests of many observances which are allowed by all parties to be essential; among which maybe classed the baptism of infants, the observance of the LORD'S Day, and our participation in the LORD'S Supper.

But, without entering into the question of the absolute necessity of this rule, and without judging those other national Churches which have departed from it, it is evident that those Churches are most wise and most fortunate, who have continued in the path which CHRIST and His Apostles have trodden before; and that religious insubordination is then most unreasonable and most dangerous, when exerted against a form of polity which the majority of our fellow-Christians, the wisdom of our civil governors, and the full stream of precedent, from the time of the Apostles themselves, combine to recommend to our reverence.

We find, accordingly, that our LORD, on His own departure from the world, committed, in most solemn terms, the government of His Church to His Apostles. We find these Apostles, in the exercise of the authority thus received, appointing Elders in every city, as dispensers of the word and the sacraments of religion; and we find them also appointing other Ecclesiastical Officers, who were to have the oversight of these Elders themselves; and who, in addition to the powers which they enjoyed in common with them, had the privilege, which the others had not, of admitting, by the imposition of hands, those whom they thought fit to the ministerial office . . .

And it is not too much to say, that we may challenge those who differ from us, to point out any single period at which the Church has been destitute of such a body of officers, laying claim to an

authority derived by the imposition of hands from the Apostles themselves; or any single instance of a Church without this form of government, till the Church of Geneva, at first from necessity, and afterwards from a mistaken exposition of Scripture, supplied the place of a single Bishop by the rule of an oligarchical presbytery.

JEBB, BISHOP.—Pastoral Instructions. Discourse i.

“And lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world;”—a promise not occasional or temporary, like that of miraculous powers; but conveying an assurance that CHRIST Himself, will, in spirit and in power, be continually present with His Catholic and Apostolick Church; with the bishops of that Church, who derive from the Apostles by uninterrupted succession, and with those inferior, but essential orders of the Church, which are constituted by the same authority, and dedicated to the same service.

VAN MILDERT, BISHOP.—Bampton Lectures. Sermon viii.

The system, of which the Apostles had laid the foundation, was to be carried on through succeeding generations; but with a gradual diminution of that extraordinary aid, which the circumstances of the case rendered no longer necessary ... Yet since the object to be attained was not temporary, but to continue from age to age, the mode, the form, and the instrument to be employed, were still to be conformable to the primitive institution. Accordingly, the Apostles ordained successors to themselves, and took measures for perpetuating in the Church a standing ministry of diverse orders and gradations. In so doing, they showed in what sense we are to interpret our LORD’S assurance, that He would “be with them always, even unto the end of the world.” ...

The evidences, from the best historical records, to the simple fact that a visible Church of this description has actually subsisted from the time of our LORD and His Apostles to this moment, are too well known to require a detail. Nor is there any defect of similar evidence, to show that, whatever errors or corruptions may have occasionally found admittance into it, the Church itself has proved a successful instrument in the hands of Providence, both of transmitting the unadulterated Word of GOD from generation to generation, and also of promulgating and maintaining all its great fundamental truths; nay, perhaps, of preserving even the very name as well as substance of Christianity, which, humanly speaking, would probably have been long since extinct, had it not been nurtured and cherished by this its appointed guardian and protector ...

Let us take, for instance, those articles of faith which have already been shown to be essential to the Christian Covenant: —the doctrines of the Trinity, of our LORD’S Divinity and Incarnation, of His Atonement and Intercession, of our sanctification by the HOLY SPIRIT, of the terms of acceptance, and the ordinances of the Christian Sacraments and Priesthood. At what period of the Church have these doctrines, or either of them, been by any public act disowned or called in question! We are speaking now, it will be recollected, of what in the language of Ecclesiastical history, is emphatically called THE CHURCH; that, which has from age to age borne rule, upon the ground of its pretensions to Apostolical succession. And to this our inquiry is necessarily restricted ...

Surely, here is something to arrest attention; something to awaken reflection; something which they who sincerely profess Christianity, and are tenacious of the inviolability of its doctrines, must contemplate with sentiments of awe and veneration. For, though a sceptic may contend that this species of evidence does not amount to a direct and demonstrative proof of the truth of the doctrines; yet if they be not true, how shall we account for their having been so uninterruptedly transmitted to these latter times? How they have withstood the assaults of continued opponents? opponents,

wanting neither talents nor inclination to effect their overthrow? If these considerations be deemed insufficient, let the adversary point out by what surer tokens we shall discover any Christian community, duly answering the Apostle's description, that it is "built upon the foundation of the Apostles and Prophets, JESUS CHRIST Himself being the chief Corner-Stone?"

MANT, BISHOP.—Parochial Sermons, xxvii.

Nor had He in this appointment a view to those times only, in which the appointment was made; but He designed that it should be extended to all future ages; for so we must understand the words which He pronounced immediately after giving His apostles their authority to baptize: "Lo, I am with you always, even unto the end of the world." A promise this which cannot be supposed to have respect to the persons of the Apostles alone, who in the common course of nature were soon to be taken from the world, to the end of which the promise itself was to extend.

In conformity with this meaning, the Apostles, who were themselves holy men and full of the HOLY GHOST, did send other persons; to whom again, they gave power and authority to send others, through whom the office of ministers of the Gospel has been handed down in regular and uninterrupted succession from the Apostles to the present time.

OXFORD,

The Feast of St. Mark

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Introduction

On the history of the Breviary ¹³

The word *Breviarium* first occurs in the work of an author of the eleventh century, and is used to denote a compendium or systematic arrangement of the devotional offices of the Church. Till that time they were contained in several independent volumes according to the nature of each. Such, for instance, were the *Psalteria*, *Homilaria*, *Hymnaria*, and the like, to be used in the service in due course. But at this memorable era, and under the auspices of the Pontiff who makes it memorable, Gregory VII., an order was drawn up, for the use of the Roman Church, containing in one all these different collections, introducing the separate members of each in its proper place, and harmonizing them together by the use of rubrics. Indeed, some have been led to conclude that in its first origin the word Breviary was appropriated to a mere collection of rubrics, not to the offices connected by them. But even taking it in its present sense, it will be obvious to any one who inspects the Breviary how well it answers to its name. Yet even thus digested, it occupies four thick volumes of duodecimo size.

Gregory VII. did but restore and harmonize these offices; which seem to have existed more or less the same in their constituent parts, though not in order and system, from Apostolic times. In their present shape they are appointed for seven distinct seasons in the twenty-four hours, and consist of prayers, praises, and thanksgivings of various forms; and, as regards both contents and hours, are the continuation of a system of worship observed by the Apostles and their converts. As to contents, the Breviary Services consist of the Psalms; of Hymns, and Canticles; of Lessons and Texts from inspired and ecclesiastical authors; of Antiphons, Verses and Responses, and Sentences; and of Collects. And analogous to this seems to have been the usage of the Corinthian Christians, whom St. Paul blames for refusing to agree in some *common* order of worship; when they came together, *every one of them* saying a Psalm, a doctrine, a tongue, a revelation, an interpretation ¹⁴. On the other hand, the Catholic seasons of devotions are certainly derived from Apostolic usage. The Jewish observance of the third, sixth, and ninth hours for prayer, was continued by the inspired founders of the Christian Church. What Daniel had practised, even when the decree was signed forbidding it, "kneeling on his knees three times a day, and praying, and giving thanks unto his GOD," St. Peter and the other Apostles were solicitous in preserving. It was when "they were all with one accord in one place," at "the *third* hour of the day," that the HOLY GHOST came down upon them at Pentecost. It was at the *sixth* hour, that St. Peter, "went up upon the house-top to pray," and saw the vision revealing to him the admission of the Gentiles into the Church. And it was at the *ninth* hour that "Peter and John went up together unto the temple." being "the hour of prayer." But though these were the more remarkable seasons of devotion, there certainly were others besides them, in that first age of the Church. After our SAVIOUR'S departure, the Apostles, we are informed, "all *continued* with one accord in prayer and supplication, with the women, and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with His brethren:" and with this accords the repeated exhortation to pray together without ceasing, which occurs in St. Paul's Epistles. It will be observed that he insists in one passage on prayer to the abridgment of sleep ¹⁵; and one recorded passage of his life exemplifies his precept. "And at midnight Paul and Silas prayed, and sang praises unto GOD, and the prisoners heard them." Surely it is more natural to suppose that this act of worship

¹³The authorities used in this account are Gavanti's *Thesaurus Rituum, cum notis Merari*; Zaccaria's *Bibliotheca Ritualis*; and Mr. Palmer's *Origines Liturgicæ*.

¹⁴Vid. Socr. Hist. 22. Vide also *Lyra Apostolica*, xv.

¹⁵Vid. Socr. Hist. 22. Vide also *Lyra Apostolica*, xv.

came in course, according to their wont, and was only not omitted because of their imprisonment, somewhat after Daniel's pattern, than that they should have gone aside to bear this sort of indirect testimony to the Gospel.

Such was the Apostolic worship as far as Scripture happens to have preserved it; that it was as systematic, and as apportioned to particular times of the day, as in the aftertimes of peace and prosperity, is not to be supposed; yet it seems to have been, under ordinary circumstances, as ample and extended, as then. If St. Paul thought a prison and a prison's inmates no impediment to vocal prayer, we may believe it was no common difficulty which ever kept him from it.

In subsequent times the Hours of prayer were gradually developed from the three, or (with midnight) the four seasons, above enumerated, to seven, viz. by the addition of Prime (the first-hour), Vespers, (the evening), and Compline (bed-time); according to the words of the Psalm, "Seven times a day do I praise Thee, because of Thy righteous judgments." Other pious and instructive reasons existed, or have since been perceived, for this number. It was a memorial of the seven days of creation; it was an honour done to the seven petitions given us by our LORD in His prayer; it was a mode of pleading for the influence of that Spirit who is revealed to us as sevenfold; on the other hand, it was a preservative against those seven evil spirits, which, are apt to return to the exorcised soul more wicked than he who has been driven out of it; and it was a fit remedy of those seven successive falls, which the Scripture says happen to "the just man" daily.

And, as the particular number of their Services admitted of various pious meanings, so did each in its turn suggest separate events in our SAVIOUR'S history. He was born, and He rose again at midnight. At Prime, (or 7 A.M. according to our reckoning,) He was brought before Pilate. At the third, (or 9 A.M.) He was devoted to crucifixion by the Jews, and scourged. At the sixth, (or noon,) He was crucified. At the ninth, (or 3 P.M.) He expired. At Vespers, He was taken down from the cross; at which hour He had the day before eat the Passover, washed His Apostles' feet, and consecrated the Eucharist. At Completorium, or Compline, He endured the agony in the garden.

These separate Hours, however, require a more distinct notice. The night Service was intended for the end of the night, when it was still dark, but drawing towards day; and, considering that the hour for rest was placed soon after sunset, it did not infringe upon the time necessary for repose. Supposing the time of sleep to extend from 8 or 9 P.M. to 3 or 4 in the morning, the worshipper might then rise without inconvenience to perform the service which was called variously by the name of Nocturns, or Matins, as we still differently describe the hours in which it took place, as night or morning. It consists, when full, of three parts or Nocturns, each made up of Psalms and Lessons; and it ended in a Service, supposed to be used shortly before sunrise, and called Lauds or Praises. This termination of the Nocturn Service is sometimes considered distinct from it, so as to make eight instead of seven Hours in the day; as if in accordance with the text, "Give a portion to seven, and also to eight." Accordingly it is sometimes called by the name of Matins, instead of the Nocturns; and sometimes both together are so called.

This subdivision of the night service has the effect of dividing the course of worship into two distinct parts, of similar structure with each other; the three Nocturns, Lauds, and Prime, corresponding respectively to the three day hours (of the 3d, 6th, and 9th) Vespers and Compline. Of these the three day hours are made up of Psalms, Hymns, and Sentences. These are the simplest of the Services, and differ very little from each other through the year. Lauds answer to Vespers, the sun being about to rise or about to set in the one or the other respectively. Each contains five Psalms, a Text, Hymn, Evangelical Canticle, Collect, and Commemoration of Saints. These hours are the most ornate of the Services, and are considered to answer to the morning and evening

sacrifices of the Jews.

Prime and Compline were introduced at the same time (the fifth century), and are placed respectively at the beginning of day and the beginning of night. In each there is a Confession, four Psalms, a Hymn, Text, and Sentences.

The ecclesiastical day is considered to begin with the evening or Vesper service; according to the Jewish reckoning, as alluded to in the text, "In the evening, and morning, and at noon-day, will I pray, and that instantly." The ancient Vespers are regarded by some to be the most solemn hour of the day. They were sometimes called the *Officium Lucernarum* ¹⁶. Prayers were in some places offered while the lamps were lighting; and this rite was called *lumen offerre* ¹⁷. The Mozarabic service supplies an instance of this, in which the Office ran as follows:

"Kyrie eleyson, Christe eleyson, Kyrie eteyson. Pater noster, &c. In nomine Domini Jesu Christi, lumen cum pace. R. Amen. Hoc est lumen oblatum. R. Deo gratias."

On Festivals, the appropriate Services, beginning on the evening of the preceding day, are continued over the evening of the day itself; so that there are in such cases two Vespers, called the First and the Second, of which the First are the more solemn.

This is the stated succession of the sacred offices through the day, but the observance of the precise hours has not been generally insisted on at any time, but has varied with local usages or individual convenience. Thus the Matin and Laud Services may be celebrated on the preceding evening, as is done (for instance) in the Sistine Chapel at Rome during Passion week, the celebrated *Miserere* being one of the Psalms in Lauds. Prime may be used just before or after sunrise; the Third soon after and soon after, the Sixth; the Ninth, near dinner; Vespers and Compline, after dinner. Or Prime, the Third, Sixth, and Ninth may come together two or three hours after sunrise. Noon, which in most ages has been the hour for the meal of the day, is made to divide the Services; there is a rule, for instance, against Compline coming before dinner.

Such is the present order and use of the Breviary Services, as derived more or less directly from Apostolic practice. Impressed with their antiquity, our Reformers did not venture to write a Prayer-Book of their own, but availed themselves of what was ready to their hands: in consequence, our Daily Service is a compound of portions of this primitive ritual, Matins being made up of the Catholic Matins, Lauds, and Prime, and Even-song of Vespers and Compline. The reason why these changes were brought about will be seen in the following sketch of the history of the Breviary from the time of Gregory VII.

The word has been already explained to mean something between a directory and an harmony of offices; but it is to be feared there was another, and not so satisfactory reason for the use of it. It implied an abridgment or curtailment of Services, and so in particular of the Scripture readings, whether Psalms, or Lessons, at least in practice. Of course there is no reason why the Church might not, in the use of her discretion, limit as well as select the portions of the inspired volume, which were to be introduced into her devotions; but there were serious reasons why she should not defraud her children of "their portion of meat in due season;" and it would seem, as if the eleventh or at least the twelfth century, a time fertile in other false steps in religion, must be charged also, as far as concerns Rome and its more intimate dependencies, with a partial removal of the light of the written Word from the Sanctuary. Whatsoever benefit attended the adjustment of the offices in

¹⁶Vid. Socr. Hist. 22. Vide also Lyra Apostolica, xv.

¹⁷This ceremony must not be confused with the *Lucernarium*, or prayers at lighting the lamps; which took place before the evening.

other respects, so far as the reading of Scripture was omitted, it as productive of evil, at least in prospect. An impulse was given, however slight in itself, which was followed up in the Centuries which succeeded, and in all those churches which either then, or in the course of time, adopted the usage of Rome.

Even now that usage is not universally received in the Latin Communion, and it was in no sense enjoined on the whole Communion till after the Council of Trent; but from the influence of the papal see and of the monastic orders, it seems to have affected other countries from a much earlier date. This influence would naturally be increased by the circumstance that the old Roman Breviary had long before Gregory's time been received in various parts of Europe: in England, since the time of Gregory the Great, who, after the pattern of Leo, and Gelasius before him, had been a Reformer of it; in Basle, since the ninth century; in France and Germany by means of Pepin and Charlemagne; while Gregory VII. himself effected its reception in Spain. Other Breviaries however still were in use, as they are at this day. The Ambrosian Breviary used in the Church of Milan, derives its name from the great St. Ambrose; and in the ninth century Charles the Bald, while sanctioning the use of the Roman, speaks also of the usage of Jerusalem, of Constantinople, of Gaul, of Italy, and Toledo.

In Gregory's Breviary there are no symptoms of a neglect of Scripture. It contains the offices for festival-days, Sundays, and week-days; Matins on festivals having nine Psalms and nine Lessons, and on Sundays eighteen Psalms and nine Lessons, as at present. The course of the Scripture Lessons was the same as it had been before his time; as it is preserved in a manuscript of the thirteenth century. It will be found to agree in great measure both with the order of the present Breviary and with our own. From Advent to Christmas were read portions of the prophet Isaiah; from the Octave of the Epiphany to Septuagesima, St. Paul's Epistle to the Romans; from Septuagesima to the third Sunday in Lent, the book of Genesis, the i., xii. and xxvii. on the Sundays to which they are allotted in our own offices; on the fourth in Lent to Wednesday in Passion week, Jeremiah; from Easter to the third Sunday after, the Apocalypse; from the third to the fifth, St. James; from the Octave of the Ascension to Pentecost, the Acts; after the Octave of Trinity to the last Sunday in July, the books of Kings; in August, Proverbs; in September, Job, Tobit, Judith, and Esther; in October, Maccabees; and in November, Ezekiel, Daniel, and other Prophets.

Well would it have been if this laudable usage, received from the first ages, and confirmed by Pope Gregory VII., had been observed, according to his design, in the Roman Church; but his own successors were the first to depart from it. The example was set in the Pope's chapel of curtailing the sacred Services, and by the end of the twelfth century it had been followed in all the churches in Rome, except that of St. John Lateran. The Fratres Minores (Minorists or Franciscans) adopted the new usage, and their Breviaries were in consequence remarkable for the title "*secundum consuetudinem Romanæ Curiaë*," contrary to the usage of such countries as conformed to the Roman Ritual, which were guided by the custom of the churches in the city. Haymo, the chief of this order, had the sanction of Gregory X., in the middle of the thirteenth century, to correct and complete a change, which, as having begun in irregularity, was little likely to have fallen of itself into an orderly system; and his arrangements, which were conducted on the pattern of the Franciscan devotions, nearly correspond with the Breviary, as it at present stands.

Haymo's edition, which was introduced into the Roman Church by Nicholas III. A.D. 1278, is memorable for another and still more serious fault. Graver and sounder matter being excluded, apocryphal legends of Saints were used to stimulate and occupy the popular mind; and a way was made for the use of those Invocations to the Virgin and other Saints, which heretofore were unknown in public worship. The addresses to the Blessed Mary in the Breviary, as it is at present

constituted, are such as the following: the Ave Mary, before commencing every office through the day and at the end of Compline; at the end of Lauds and Vespers, an Antiphon invocatory of the Virgin; the Officium B. Mariæ, on the Sabbath or Saturday, and sundry other offices, containing Hymns and Antiphons in her honour. These portions of the Breviary carry with them their own plain condemnation, in the judgment of an English Christian; no commendation of the general structure and matter of the Breviary itself will have any tendency to reconcile him to them; and it has been the strong feeling that this is really the case, that has led the writer of these pages fearlessly and securely to admit the real excellences, and to dwell upon the antiquity, of the Roman Ritual. He has felt that, since the Romanists required an unqualified assent to the *whole* of the Breviary, and that there were passages which no Anglican ever could admit, praise the true Catholic portion of it as much as he might, he did not in the slightest degree approximate to a recommendation of Romanism. But to return;—these Invocations and Services to the Blessed Virgin have been above enumerated, with a view of observing that, on the very face of them, they do not enter into the *structure* of the Breviary; they are really, as they are placed, additions, and might easily have been added at some future period, as (e.g.) was the case with our own Thanksgiving, or the Prayer for the Parliament. This remark seems to apply to all the intrinsically-exceptionable Addresses in the Breviary; for as to the Confession at Prime and Compline, in which is introduced the name of the Blessed Virgin and other Saints, this practice stands on a different ground. It is not a simple gratuitous Invocation made to them, but it is an address to ALMIGHTY GOD *in His heavenly court*, as surrounded by His Saints and Angels, answering to St. Paul's charge to Timothy, "before GOD and the LORD JESUS CHRIST and the elect Angels," and to Daniel and St. John's address to the Angels who were sent to them. The same may even be said of the Invocation "Holy Mary and all Saints,"¹⁸ &c. in the Prime Service, which Gavanti describes as being of very great antiquity. These usages certainly *now* do but sanction and encourage that direct worship of the Blessed Virgin and the Saints, which is the great practical offence of the Latin Church, and so are a serious evil; but it is worth pointing out, that, as on the one hand they have more claim to be considered an integral part of the service, so on the other, more can be said towards their justification than for those addresses which are now especially under our consideration.

This is what occurs to observe on the first sight of these Invocations; but we are not left to draw a conjectural judgment about them. Their history is actually known, and their recent introduction into the Church Services is distinctly confessed by Roman ritualists.

The Ave Mary, for instance, is made up of the Angel's salutation, "Hail, thou," &c. Elizabeth's "Blessed art thou among women," &c. and the words, "Holy Mary, Mother of GOD, pray for us sinners, now and in the hour of our death." The last clause "now and," &c. was confessedly added by the Franciscans in the beginning of the sixteenth century; and the words preceding it, "Holy Mary," &c. which Gavanti, after Baronius, wishes to attribute to the Council of Ephesus (A.D. 431), are acknowledged by the later critics, Grancolas and Merari, to have had no place in any form of prayer till the year 1508. Even the Scripture portion of the Ave Mary, which, as Merari observes, is an Antiphon rather than Prayer, and which occurs as such in the lesser office of the Blessed Virgin, and in St. Gregory's Sacramentary in the Mass Service for the fourth Sunday in Advent, is not mentioned by any devotional writer, nor by Councils, nor Fathers, up to the eleventh century, though they do enjoin the universal and daily use of the Creed and LORD'S Prayer, which are in the present Breviary used with it. It first occurs among forms of prayer prescribed for the people in

¹⁸It is observable that the words "Holy Mary" do not occur in the ancient Monastic Breviaries. The Confession at Prime and Compline does not occur in the Paris Breviary, 1735.

the statutes of Otho, Bishop of Paris, A.D. 1195, who was followed, after the interval of a hundred years, by the regulations of Councils at Oxford and elsewhere. Another space of at least fifty years intervenes before the introduction of rosaries and crowns in honour of the Virgin. As to the Roman Breviary, it did not contain any part of the Ave Mary, till the promulgation of it by Pope Pius V., after the Tridentine Council, A.D. 1550.

The four Antiphons to the Blessed Virgin, used at the termination of the offices, are known respectively by their first words: the *Alma Redemptoris*, the *Ave Regina*, the *Regina cœli*, and the *Salve Regina*. Gavanti and Merari plainly tell us that they are not to be found in ancient authors. The *Alma Redemptoris* is the composition of Hermannus Contractus, who died A.D. 1054. The author of the *Ave Regina* is unknown, as is that of the *Regina cœli*. The *Salve Regina* is to be attributed either to Hermannus, or to Peter of Compostella. Gavanti would ascribe the last words "O clemens, O pia, O dulcis," &c. to St. Bernard, but Merari corrects him, the work in which they are contained being supposititious. These Antiphons seem to have been used by the Franciscans after Compline from the thirteenth century: but are found in no Breviary before A.D. 1520.

The Saturday or Sabbath office of the Blessed Virgin was introduced, according to Baronius, by the monks of the Western church, about A.D. 1056.

The Officium Parvum B. V. M. was instituted by the celebrated Peter Damiani at the same date. It is said indeed to have been the restoration of a practice three hundred years old, and observed by John Damascene; which it may well have been: but there is nothing to show the identity of the Service itself with the ancient one, and that is the only point on which evidence would be important. Thirty years after its introduction by Damiani, it was made part of the daily worship by decree of Urban II.

The Breviary then, as it is now received, is pretty nearly what the Services became *in practice* in Rome, and among the Franciscans by the middle of the thirteenth century; the two chief points of difference between it and the ancient Catholic Devotions, being on the one hand its diminished allowance of Scripture reading, on the other its adoption of uncertain legends, and of Hymns and Prayers to the Virgin. However, the more grievous of these changes were not finally made in the Breviary itself, till the Pontificate of Pius V., after the Tridentine Council; at which time also it was imposed in its new form upon all the Churches in communion with Rome, except such as had used some other Ritual for above two hundred years. Not even at the present day, however, is this Roman novelty, as it may be called, in universal reception; the Paris Breviary, as corrected by the Archbishop of that city, A.D. 1735, differs from it considerably in detail, though still disfigured by the Invocations.

Before concluding this account of the Roman Breviary, it is necessary to notice one attempt which was made in the first part of the sixteenth century to restore it to a more primitive form. In the year 1536, Quignonius, Cardinal of Santa Crux, compiled a Breviary under the sanction of Clement VII., and published it under his successor, Paul III. This Ritual, the use of which was permitted, but not formally enjoined by the Holy See, was extensively adopted for forty years, when it was superseded by the Franciscan Breviary, as the now authorized one may be called, in consequence of a Bull of Pius V. The Cardinal's Breviary was drawn up on principles far more agreeable to those on which the Reformation was conducted, and apparently with the same mixture of right and wrong in the execution. With a desire of promoting the knowledge of Scripture, it showed somewhat of a rude dealing with received usages, and but a deficient sense of what is improperly called the *imaginative* part of religion. His object was to adapt the Devotions of the Church for private reading, rather than chanting in choir, and so to encourage something higher

than that almost theatrical style of worship, which, when reverence is away, will prevail, alternately with a slovenly and hurried performance, in the performance of Church Music. Accordingly he left out the Versicles, Responses, and Texts, which, however suitable in Church, yet in private took more time, as he says, to find out in the existing formularies than to read when found. He speaks in his preface expressly of the “perplexus ordo,” on which the offices were framed. But his great reform was as regards the reading of Scripture. He complains that, whereas it was the ancient rule that the Psalms should be read through weekly and the Bible yearly, both practices had been omitted. The Ferial or week-day service had been superseded by the service for feast-days, as being shorter: and for that reason every day, even through Lent, was turned into a festival. To obviate the temptation which led to this irregularity, he made the Ferial service about the length of that of the old feast day; and he found space in these contracted limits for the reading of the Psalms, and the whole Bible, except part of the Apocalypse, in the week and the year respectively, by omitting the popular legends of the Saints which had been substituted for them. He observes, that these compositions had been sometimes introduced without any public authority, or sanction of the Popes, merely at the will of individuals. Those which he retained, he selected from authors of weight, whether of the Greek or Latin Church. Besides, he omitted the *Officium Parvum B. M. V.*, on the ground that there were sufficient services in her honour independently of it. In all his reforms he professes to be returning to the practice of antiquity; and he made use of the assistance of men versed “in Latin and Greek, in divinity, and the *jus pontificium*.”

This Breviary was published in Rome, A.D. 1536, under the sanction, as has been said, of Paul III. However, it was not of a nature to please the divines of an age which had been brought up in the practice of the depraved Catholicism then prevalent; and its real faults, as they would appear to be, even enabled them to oppose it with justice. The Doctors of the Sorbonne proceeded to censure it as running counter in its structure to antiquity and the Fathers; and though they seem at length to have got over their objections to it, and various editions at Venice, Antwerp, Lyons, and Paris, showed that it was not displeasing to numbers in the Roman Communion, it was at length superseded by the Bull of Pius V. establishing the Franciscan Breviary, which had more or less grown into use in the course of the preceding three hundred years.

This account of Cardinal Quignonius’s Breviary, and the circumstances under which it was compiled, will remind the English reader of the introductory remarks concerning the Service of the Church, prefixed to our Ritual; which he may read more profitably than heretofore, after the above illustrations of their meaning. For this reason they shall be here cited

“There was never any thing by the wit of man so well devised, or so sure established, which in continuance of time hath not been corrupted; as, among other things, it may plainly appear by the Common Prayers, in the Church, commonly called Divine Service. The first original and ground whereof, if a man would search out by the Ancient Fathers, he shall find that the same was not ordained but of a good purpose, and for a great advancement of godliness. For they so ordered the matter, that all the whole Bible, (or the greatest part thereof,) should be read over once every year; intending thereby that the Clergy, and especially such as were Ministers in the Congregation, should (by often reading and meditating on GOD’S Word) be stirred up to godliness themselves, and be more able to exhort others by wholesome doctrine, not to confute them that were adversaries to the truth; arid further, that the people (by daily hearing of Holy Scripture read in the Church,) might continually profit more and more in the knowledge of GOD, and be the more inflamed with the love of His true religion.

“But these many years past, this godly and decent order of the ancient Fathers hath been so

altered, broken, and neglected, by planting in uncertain Stories and Legends, with multitude of Responds, Verses, vain Repetitions, Commemorations, and Synodals; that commonly when any book of the Bible was begun, after three or four chapters were read out, all the rest were unread. And in this sort the book of Isaiah was begun in Advent, and the book of Genesis in Septuagesima; but they were only begun, and never read through. After like sort were other books of Holy Scripture used. And furthermore, notwithstanding that the ancient Fathers have divided the Psalms into seven portions, whereof every one was called a Nocturn, now of late time a few of them have been daily said, and the rest utterly omitted. Moreover, the number and hardness of the rules called the Pie, and the manifold changings of the service, was the cause, that, to turn the book only was so hard and intricate a matter, that many times there was more business to find out what should be read, than to read it when it was found out.

“These inconveniences therefore considered, here is set forth such an Order, whereby the same shall be redressed. And for a readiness in this matter, here is drawn out a Calendar for that purpose, which is plain and easy to be understood; wherein (so much as may be) the reading of holy Scripture is so set forth, that all things shall be done in order, without breaking one piece from another. For this cause be cut off Anthems, Responds, Invitatories, and such like things as did break the continual course of the reading of the Scripture.”

It remains but to enumerate the selections from the Breviary which follow. First has been drawn out, an Analysis of the Weekly Service, as well for Sunday as other days. This is followed by an ordinary Sunday Service at length, as it runs when unaffected by the occurrence of special feast or season, in order to ground the reader, who chooses to pursue the subject, in the course of daily worship as a whole. With the same object a Week-day Service has also been drawn out. Two portions of extraordinary Services are then added, one from the Service for the Transfiguration, the other for the Festival of St. Lawrence, with a view of supplying specimens of a more elevated and impressive character. Next follows a design for a Service for March 21st, the day on which Bishop Ken was taken from the Church below, and another for a Service of thanksgiving and commemoration for the anniversaries of the days of death of friends or relations. These have been added, to suggest to individual Christians a means of carrying out in private the principle and spirit of those inestimable forms of devotion which are contained in our authorized Prayer-Book. The series is closed with an abstract of the Services for every day in Advent, fitting on to sections 2 and 3, which contain respectively the types of the Sunday and Week-day Service. Except by means of some such extended portion, it is impossible for the reader to understand the general structure, and appreciate the harmony of the Breviary.

Lastly, the writer of these pages feels he shall have to ask indulgence for such chance mistakes, in the detail of the following Services, as are sure to occur when an intricate system is drawn out and set in order, with no other knowledge of it than is supplied by the necessarily insufficient directions of a Rubric.

§ 1. Analysis of the Seven Daily Services of the Church Catholic, as preserved in the Breviary.

EVERY Service but Compline is commenced with privately saying the Lord's Prayer, and the Ave Mary, to which the Creed is added before Matins and Prime. In like manner, after Compline, all three are repeated. Every other Service ends with the Lord's Prayer in private, unless another Service immediately follows. Concerning the introduction of the Ave Mary, vid. supra, p. 11. This use of the Lord's prayer in private before the beginning of the Service seems to have led the

compilers of King Edward's First Book to open with the Lord's Prayer, only said aloud, not in private; but a pious custom has brought in again the private prayer, as before, though without prescribing any particular form. The compilers of King Edward's Second Book prefixed to the Lord's Prayer, the Sentences, and an Exhortation, Confession, and Absolution of their own. After these follows, "O Lord, open thou our lips," &c. which stands first in the Breviary Service.

1. MATINS, or Night Service, (after One, A.M.)

Introduction.

Verse. O Lord, open Thou my lips.

Resp. And my mouth shall shew forth Thy praise.

(Each person to sign his lips with the Cross.)

Verse. O God, make speed to save me.

Resp. O Lord, make haste to help me.

(Each person to sign himself from the forehead to the breast.)

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was, &c. Amen.

(*Ordinarily added*) Hallelujah. (*i.e.* Praise ye the Lord.)

Psalm 95.—"O come let us sing," &c. with a verse called an Invitatory, "Let us worship the Lord: our Maker," divided into two parts, the whole being used before the 1st, 3rd, and 8th verse, and at the end, and again after the *Gloria Patri*, and the latter part after the 4th and 9th, and between the *Gloria* and the whole. This Invitatory varies with the season, but its general character is always preserved; e.g. in Advent, "O Come let us worship: the Lord, the King to come;" or "the Lord is at hand, O come let us worship;" again in Lent, "It is not to you lost labour that ye haste to rise up early: for the Lord hath promised a crown to those who wait for Him." At Pentecost, "Hallelujah, the Spirit of the Lord hath filled the round world: O come let us worship, Hallelujah."

A Hymn follows according to the day, and terminates the Introduction; then follow Psalms and Lessons, in one or three Nocturns, according as the Service is for Weekday or Sunday.

On Sunday, Eighteen Psalms with Nine Lessons; viz.

Psalms 1, 2, 3, 6, 7, 8, 9, & 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15.

A passage from Scripture, in three parts—(*according to the time of the Year.*)

Psalms 16, 17, 18.

A passage from some Father of the Church, in three parts.

Psalms 19, 20, 21.

A comment on some passage of the Gospel, in three parts.

On Weekdays, Twelve Psalms with Three Lessons, viz.

On Monday.

Psalms 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38.

A passage in three parts from Scripture or the Fathers.

On Tuesday.

Psalms 39, 40, 41, 42, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50, 52.

A passage in three parts, &c. as on *Monday*.

On Wednesday.

Psalms 53, 55, 56; 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 64, 66, 68.

A passage, &c.

On Thursday.

Psalms 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80.

A passage, &c.

On Friday.

Psalms 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 94, 96, 97.

A passage, &c.

On Saturday.

Psalms 98, 99, 100, or 92. (*according to the day*) 101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109.

A passage, &c.

Then on every day of the week follows the

Te Deum Laudamus.

This noble Hymn follows in this place with especial propriety, on Sundays and other Festivals; viz. after the reading the words of Prophets and Apostles, and the writings and histories of Saints and Martyrs, all of whom are commemorated in it. On all days it impressively winds up the Service which precedes.

LAUDS;—(appended to the Matins towards the first twilight.)

Verse. "O God, make speed, &c.

Resp. O Lord, make haste,"

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

Then five Psalms, viz. on

Sunday.

Psalms 93, 100, 63 and 67.

The Song of the Three Children.

Psalms 148-150.

Monday.

Psalms 51, 5, 63. Song of Isaiah. (Is. xii.) Psalm 148.

Tuesday.

Psalms 51, 43, 63. Song of Hezekiah. (Is. xxxviii.) Psalm 148.

Wednesday.

Psalms 51, 65, 63. Song of Hannah. (1 Sam. ii. Psalm 148.)

Thursday.

Psalms 51, 90, 63. Song of Moses. (Ex. xv.) Psalm 148.

Friday.

Psalms 51, 143, 63. Song of Habakkuk. (Hab. iii.) Psalm 148.

Saturday.

Psalms 51, 92, 63. Song of Moses. (Deut. xxxii.) Psalm 148.

The Service ends on all days with a Text (Capitulum), a Hymn and a Collect (Oratio), varying with the day and season; the Song of Zacharias (Benedictus) being interposed between the Hymn and Collect, and several stated Collects, invocations, and Sentences following.

2. PRIME, on the Rising of the Sun.

Verse. "O God, make speed, &c.

Resp. O Lord, make haste, &c" and the *Gloria Patri*, &c. *as before.*

A Hymn, the same every day in the year. Then four Psalms (except Saturday when there are three,) viz.

Psalm 54;—

Sunday.—Psalm 118, or (sometimes) 93.

Monday.—Psalm 24.

Tuesday. —Psalm 25.

Wednesday.—Psalm 26.

Thursday.—Psalm 23.

Friday.—Psalm 22.

Saturday.—Psalm is omitted.

Then, throughout the week,—

Psalm 119, v. 1-32. in two parts.

Then on *Saturday* only, follows the Psalm *Quicumque*, commonly called the Athanasian Creed. It is a far truer view of this venerable composition, to consider it a Psalm or Hymn of praise, and of concurrence in GOD'S appointments, as Psalm 118 or 139, or the *Te Deum*, than as a formal Creed; and by using it weekly, its living character and spirit are incorporated into the Christian's devotions, and its influence on the heart, as far as may be, secured. The time, too, should be observed. The dawn of the first day of the week.

The Service concludes with a Text (Capitulum); with the Lord's Prayer, privately: a Confession of Priest to People, and in turn of People to Priest, and a corresponding Absolution: Sentences; Collect, the Third, for grace in our own Morning Service, a Lesson from the Book of Martyrs; an Invocation of St. Mary and All Saints; Sentences, with the Lord's Prayer, privately; Collect, the Second, at the end of our Communion Service; a Short Lesson; and Sentences.

3. The THIRD (Nine A.M.) 4. SIXTH (noon.) 5. NINTH (Three P.M.)

"O God, make speed," &c. as before.

A Hymn, the same throughout the year, at the same hours respectively: then—

At the Third.—Psalm 119, v. 33-80. in three parts.

At the Sixth.—Psalm 119, v. 81-128. in three parts.

At the Ninth.—Psalm 119, v. 129-176. in three parts.

Thus the whole of the 119th Psalm is gone through every day of the year.

Then a Text (Capitulum) and Sentences, with the Lord's Prayer, privately, varying with the time of the year. Then the Collect for the day or week.

6. VESPERS. (Evening.)

"O God, make speed," &c. as before; then Five Psalms, viz. on

Sunday.—Psalms 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, and 115.

Monday.—Psalms 116, *in two parts*, 117, 120, 121.

Tuesday.—Psalms 122, 123, 124, 125, 126.

Wednesday.—Psalms 127, 128, 129, 130, 131.

Thursday.—Psalms 132, 133, 135, 136, 137.

Friday.—Psalms 138, 139, 140, 141, 142.

Saturday.—Psalms 144, 145, 146, 147, *in two parts*.

Then on every day a Text (Capitulum), a Hymn, and the Collect, all varying with the day and season; between the Hymn and Collect always is interposed the Magnificat, sometimes with Sentences after it. The Service ends, as Lauds, with Collects and Invocations.

7. COMPLINE. (Bed-time.)

This Service is almost invariable throughout the year.

It begins with a Blessing for the ensuing night; a Short Lesson; the Confession and Absolution as at Prime; Sentences; then four Psalms, viz.

Psalms 4, 31, down to v. 6, 9, 134.

A Hymn: Text (Capitulum); Sentences; Song of Simeon (Luke ii); Sentences with the Lord's Prayer and Creed, privately; Collect for safety during the night. The Service ends with an Antiphon in praise of the Virgin, and Collect upon it.

To this Sketch of the Services must be added a few words concerning the Antiphons and Benedictions which occur throughout them, but have not been noticed in their places.

The Antiphons or Anthems are sentences preceding and succeeding the Separate Psalms and Songs, and are ordinarily verses taken from the particular compositions to which they are attached. They seem to answer the purpose of calling attention to what is coming, of interpreting it, or of pointing out the particular part of it which is intended to bear on the Service of the day; in all respects answering the place of what is called by musicians a key note. They are repeated at the end, as if to fix the impression or the lesson intended.

Antiphons are introduced in other connexions, as before Collects; such are those, for instance, in the Commemorations of the Blessed Virgin and the Apostles in Vespers and Lauds. Such, too, are the Antiphons to the Blessed Virgin placed at the end of Compline, to which especial attention was above directed (p. 11), on the ground of their objectionable nature. They shall be here given, in order to show clearly, as a simple inspection of them will suffice to do, the utter contrariety between the Roman system, as actually existing, and our own; which, however similar in certain respects, are in others so at variance, as to make any attempt to reconcile them together in their present state perfectly nugatory. Till Rome moves towards us, it is quite impossible that we should move towards Rome; however closely we may approximate to her in particular doctrines, principles, or views. In reading the following, it should be recollected, indeed, that Antiphons are not, strictly

speaking, Prayers, but Sentences applied to the particular purpose of meditation, thanksgiving, &c.; yet the following, taken together, are quite beyond the power of any defence which might thence be available for less explicit compositions.

From Advent to the Purification.

Alma Redemptoris Mater quæ pervia cœli

Porta manes, et stella maris, succurre cadenti,

Surgere qui curat, populo; to quæ genuisti,

Naturâ mirante, tuum sanctum Genitorem,

Virgo prius ac posterius, Gabrielis ab ore,

Sumens illud Ave, peccatorum miserere. Kindly Mother of the Redeemer, who art ever of heaven

The open gate, and the star of the sea, aid a fallen people,

Which is trying to rise again; thou who didst give birth,

While Nature marvelled how, to thy Holy Creator,

Virgin both before and after, from Gabriel's mouth

Accepting the All hail, be merciful towards sinners.

From the Purification to Good Friday.

Ave, Regina cœlorum!

Ave, Domina Angelorum!

Salve radix, salve porta!

Ex quâ mundo lux est orta.

Gaude, Virgo gloriosa,

Super omnes speciosa;

Vale, o valde decora,

Et pro nobis Christum exora. Hail, O Queen of the heavens

Hail, Lady of Angels

Hail, the root! hail the gate!

Whence to the world light is risen.

Rejoice, O glorious Virgin,

Beautiful above all;

Farewell, O thou most comely,

And prevail on Christ for us by thy prayer.

From Easier to the First Week complete after Pentecost.

Regina cœli, lætare,

Alleluia.

Quia quem meruisti portare,

Alleluia.

Resurrexit, sicut dixit,

Alleluia.

Ora pro nobis Deum.

Alleluia. Rejoice, O queen of heaven,

Hallelujah.

For He, whom for thy obedience' sake thou didst bear,

Hallelujah.

Is risen, as he said,

Hallelujah.

Pray thou God for us.

Hallelujah.

From Trinity tide to Advent.

Salve Regina, mater misericordiæ, vita, dulcedo et spes nostra, salve. Ad te clamamus exules, filii Hevæ. Ad te suspiramus, gementes et flentes in hac lachrymarum valle. Eja ergo advocata nostra, illos tuos misericordes oculos ad nos converte, et Jesum, benedictum fructum ventris tui, nobis post hoc exilium ostende. O clemens, O pia, O dulcis Virgo Maria. Hail, O Queen, the mother of mercy, our life, sweetness, and hope, hail. To Thee we exiles cry out, the sons of Eve. To Thee we sigh, groaning and weeping in this valley of tears. Come then, O our Patroness, turn thou on us those merciful eyes of thine, and show to us, after this exile, Jesus the blessed fruit of thy womb. O gracious, O pitiful, O sweet Virgin Mary.

These Antiphons have already been shown to be of comparatively modern origin; which, indeed, is sufficiently clear from their composition, independently of the question of doctrine. The Absolutions and Benedictions on the other hand seem, from their doctrinal character, to come from high antiquity. Wheatly remarks, that the precise *indicative* Absolution, such as it occurs in our Visitation for the Sick, though altogether justifiable and edifying, did not come into use till the twelfth century; that is, about the time of the above innovations in commemorating the Blessed Virgin. Now the Absolutions and Benedictions in the Breviary happen, on the contrary, to be of a remarkably simple character; they are uniformly in the shape of *petitions* to ALMIGHTY GOD, and they include the minister using them, being worded in the first, not the second person. Again, in the *quasi* Absolution, after the stated Confession at Prime and Compline, it is to be noticed, that the People absolve the Priest, before, and in the same words in which the Priest absolves the People, as if vindicating to the body of Christians that sacramental power, (whatever may be its degree,) which might have seemed inconsistent with the special stress laid by Romanism on Sacerdotal gifts. An Absolution occurs in each Nocturn between the Psalms and Lessons: a short Benediction is pronounced before the reading of each of the latter, being first asked for by the Reader.

§ 2. Service for Sunday, June 21, 1801.

Fourth Sunday after Pentecost

1. MATIN SERVICE

O LORD, open Thou my lips.

And my mouth shall show forth Thy praise.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. *Amen.*

Praise ye the Lord. (Hallelujah.)

(a) *Invitatory* Let us worship the Lord: our Maker.

Let us worship, &c.

Psalms 95. O come, let us sing unto the Lord: let us heartily rejoice in the strength of our salvation.

Let us come before His presence with thanksgiving: and shew ourselves glad in him with psalms.

Let us worship the Lord our Maker.

For the Lord is a great God: and a great King above
all gods.

In His hand are all the corners of the earth: and the
strength of the hills is his also.

Our Maker.

The sea is his, and he made it: and his hands prepared
the dry land.

O come, let us worship and fall down: and kneel before
the Lord our Maker.

For he is the Lord our God: and we are the people of
his pasture, and the sheep of his hand.

Let us worship the Lord our Maker.

Today if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts:
as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the
wilderness.

When your fathers tempted me: proved me, and saw
my works.

Our Maker.

Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and
said: It is a people that do err in their hearts; for they have
not known my ways.

Unto whom I aware in my wrath: that they should not
enter into my rest.

Let us worship the Lord our Maker.

Glory be, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c. *Amen.*

Our Maker.

Let us worship the Lord our Maker.

(b) *Hymn*

[Nocte surgentes.]

Let us arise, and watch by night,

And meditate always;

And chant, as in our Maker's sight,

United hymns of praise.

So, singing with the Saints in bliss,

With them we may attain

Life everlasting after this,

And heaven for earthly pain.

Grant it to us, O Father, Son,

And Spirit, God of grace,

To whom all worship shall be done

In every time and place. *Amen.*

NOCTURN 1.

(c) *Antiphon* Serve ye the Lord.

Psalm 1 (1) BLESSED is the man that hath not walked in the counsel of the ungodly, nor stood in the way of sinners: and hath not sat in the seat of the scornful;

But his delight is in the law of the Lord: and in his law will he exercise himself day and night.

And he shall be like a tree planted by the water-side: that will bring forth his fruit in due season.

His leaf also shall not wither: and look, whatever he doeth, it shall prosper.

As for the ungodly, it is not so with them: but they are like the chaff, which the wind scattereth away from the face of the earth.

Therefore the ungodly shall not be able to stand in the judgment: neither the sinners in the congregation of the righteous.

But the Lord knoweth the way of the righteous: and the way of the ungodly shall perish. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 2 (2) Why do the heathen so furiously rage together: and why do the people imagine a vain thing?

The kings of the earth stand up, and the rulers take counsel together: against the Lord, and against his Anointed.

Let us break their bonds asunder: and cast away their cords from us.

He that dwelleth in heaven shall laugh them to scorn: the Lord shall have them in derision.

Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath: and vex them in his sore displeasure.

Yet have I set my King: upon my holy hill of Sion.

I will preach the law, whereof the Lord hath said unto me: Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee.

Desire of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance: and the utmost parts of the earth for thy possession.

Thou shalt bruise them with a rod of iron: and break them in pieces like a potter's vessel.

Be wise now therefore, O ye kings: be learned, ye that are judges of the earth.

Serve the Lord in fear: and rejoice unto him with reverence.

Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and so ye perish from the right way: if his wrath be kindled, (yea, but a little) blessed are all they that put their trust in him. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 3 (3) Lord, how are they increased that trouble me: many are they that rise against me.

Many one there be that say of my soul: There is no help

for him in his God.

But thou, O Lord, art my defender: thou art my worship,
and the lifter up of my head.

I did call upon the Lord with my voice and he heard
me out of his holy hill.

I laid me down and slept, and rose up again: for the Lord
sustained me.

I will not be afraid for ten thousands of the people: that
have set themselves against me round about.

Up, Lord, and help me, O my God: for thou smitest all
mine enemies upon the check-bone; thou hast broken the
teeth of the ungodly.

Salvation belongeth unto the Lord: and thy blessing is
upon thy people. Glory be, &c. *Psalm 6 (4)* O Lord, rebuke me not in thine indignation; neither
chasten me in thy displeasure.

Have mercy upon me, O Lord, for I am weak: O Lord
heal me, for my bones are vexed.

My soul also is sore troubled: but, Lord, how long wilt
thou punish me?

Turn thee, O Lord, and deliver my soul: O save me for
thy mercies' sake.

For in death no man remembereth thee: and who will
give thee thanks in the pit?

I am weary of my groaning; every night wash I my bed:
and water my couch with my tears.

My beauty is gone for very trouble: and worn away
because of all mine enemies.

Away from me, all ye that work vanity; for the Lord hath
heard the voice of my weeping.

The Lord hath heard my petition: the Lord will receive
my prayer.

All mine enemies shall be confounded, and sore vexed:
they shall be turned back, and put to shame suddenly.

Glory be, &c.

(c) *Antiphon* Serve the Lord in fear, and rejoice unto Him with
reverence.

(d) *Antiphon* God is a righteous judge.

Psalm 7 (5) O Lord my God, in Thee have I put my trust: save me
from all them that persecute me, and deliver me.

Lest he devour my soul like a lion, and tear it in pieces:
while there is none to help.

O Lord my God, if I have done any such thing: or if there
be any wickedness in my hands;

If I have rewarded evil unto him that dealt friendly with
me: yea, I have delivered him that without any cause is mine

enemy:

Then let mine enemy persecute my soul, and take me:
yea, let him tread my life down upon the earth, and lay mine
honour in the dust.

Stand up, O Lord, in thy wrath, and lift up thyself, because
of the indignation of mine enemies: arise up for me in
the judgment that thou hast commanded.

And so shall the congregation of the people come about
thee: for their sakes therefore lift up thyself again.

The Lord shall judge the people; give sentence with me, O
Lord: according to my righteousness, and according to the
innocency that is in me.

O let the wickedness of the ungodly come to an end: but
guide thou the just.

For the righteous God trieth the very hearts and reins.

My help cometh of God: who preserveth them that are true
of heart.

God is a righteous judge, strong and patient; and God is
provoked every day.

If a man will not turn, he will whet his sword: he hath
bent his bow, and made it ready.

He hath prepared for him the instruments of death: he
ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.

Behold, he travaileth with mischief: he hath conceived
sorrow, and brought forth ungodliness.

He hath graven and digged up a pit: and is fallen him-
self into the destruction that he made for other.

For his travail shall come upon his own head: and his
wickedness shall fall on his own pate.

I will give thanks unto the Lord, according to his righte-
ousness: and I will praise the name of the Lord most High.

Glory be, &c.

Psalms 8 (6) O Lord our Governor, how excellent is thy Name in all the
world: thou that hast set thy glory above the heavens!

Out of the mouth of very babes and sucklings hast thou
ordained strength, because of thine enemies: that thou
mightest still the enemy, and the avenger.

For I will consider thy heavens, even the works of thy
fingers: the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained.

What is man, that thou art mindful of him: and the son of
man, that thou visitest him?

Thou madest him lower than the angels: to crown
with glory and worship.

Thou makest him to have dominion of the works of thy
hands: and thou hast put all things in subjection under his

feet;

All sheep and oxen: yea, and the beasts of the field;
The fowls of the air, and the fishes of the sea: and a what-
soever walketh through the paths of the seas.

O Lord our Governor: how excellent is thy Name in all
the world! Glory be, &c.

Psalms 9 & 10 (7) I will give thanks unto thee, O Lord, with my whole heart:
I will speak of all thy marvellous works.

I will be glad and rejoice in thee: yea, my songs will I
make of thy name, O thou most Highest.

While mine enemies are driven back; they shall fall and
perish in thy presence.

For thou hast maintained my right and my cause: thou art
set in the throne that judgest right.

Thou hast rebuked the heathen, and destroyed the un-
godly: thou hast put out their name for ever and ever.

O thou enemy, destructions are come to a perpetual end:
even as the cities which thou hast destroyed: their memo-
rial is perished with them.

But the Lord shall endure for ever: he hath also prepared
his seat for judgment.

For he shall judge the world in righteousness: and mi-
nister true judgment unto the people.

The Lord also will be a defence for the oppressed: even
a refuge in due time of trouble.

And they that know thy Name will put their trust in
thee: for thou, Lord, hast never failed them that seek thee.

O praise the Lord which dwelleth in Sion: shew the
people of his doings.

For when he maketh inquisition for blood, he remem-
bereth them: and forgetteth not the complaint of the poor.

Have mercy upon me, O Lord; consider the trouble
which I suffer of them that hate me: thou that liftest me
up from the gates of death.

That I may shew all thy praises within the ports of the
daughter of Sion: I will rejoice in thy salvation.

The heathen are sunk down in the pit that they made: in
the same net which they hid privily, is their foot taken.

The Lord is known to execute judgment: the ungodly is
trapped in the work of his own hands.

The wicked shall be turned into hell: and all the people
that forget God.

For the poor shall not alway be forgotten: the patient
abiding of the meek shall not perish for ever.

Up, Lord, and let not man have the upper hand: let the

heathen be judged in thy sight.
 Put them in fear, O Lord: that the heathen may know
 themselves to be but men.
 Why standest thou so far off, O Lord: and hidest thy face
 in the needful time of trouble?
 The ungodly for his own lust doth persecute the poor:
 let them be taken in the crafty wiliness that they have
 imagined.
 For the ungodly hath made boast of his own heart's desire:
 and speaketh good of the covetous, whom God abhorreth.
 The ungodly is so proud, that he careth not for God:
 neither is God in all his thoughts.
 His ways are always grievous: thy judgments are far above
 out of his sight, and therefore defieth he all his enemies.
 For he hath said in his heart, Tush, I shall never be cast
 down: there shall no harm happen unto me.
 His mouth is full of cursing, deceit, and fraud: under
 his tongue is ungodliness and vanity.
 He sitteth lurking in the thievish corners of the streets:
 and privily in his lurking dens doth he murder the innocent:
 his eyes are set against the poor.
 For he lieth waiting secretly, even as a lion lurketh he in
 his den: that he may ravish the poor.
 He doth ravish the poor: when he getteth him into his
 net.
 He falleth down, and humbleth himself: that the congre-
 gation of the poor may fall into the hands of his captains.
 He hath said in his heart, Tush, God hath forgotten: he
 hideth away his face, and he will never see it.
 Arise, O Lord God, and lift up thine hand: forget not
 the poor.
 Wherefore should the wicked blaspheme God: while he
 doth say in his heart, Tush, thou God carest not for it.
 Surely thou hast seen it: for thou beholdest ungodliness
 and wrong.
 That thou mayest take the matter into thy hand: the
 poor committeth himself unto thee; for thou art the helper
 of the friendless.
 Break thou the power of the ungodly and malicious: take
 away his ungodliness, and thou shalt find none.
 The Lord is King for ever and ever: and the heathen are
 perished out of the land.
 Lord, thou hast heard the desire of the poor: thou pre-
 parest their heart, and thine ear hearkeneth thereto.
 To help the fatherless and poor unto their right: that the

man of the earth be no more exalted against them. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 11 (8) In the Lord put I my trust: how say ye then to my soul, that she should flee as a bird unto the hill?

For, lo, the ungodly bend their bow, and make ready their arrows within the quiver: that they may privily shoot at them which are true of heart.

For the foundations will be cast down: and what hath the righteous done

The Lord is in his holy temple: the Lord's seat is in heaven.

His eyes consider the poor: and his eyelids try the children of men.

The Lord alloweth the righteous: but the ungodly, and him that delighteth in wickedness, doth his soul abhor.

Upon the ungodly he shall rain snares, fire and brimstone, storm and tempest: this shall be their portion to drink.

For the righteous Lord loveth righteousness: his countenance will behold the thing that is just. Glory be, &c. (d) *Antiphon* God is a righteous judge,

strong and patient: shall God be angry every day?

(e) *Antiphon*

Thou shalt keep them, O Lord.

Psalm 12 (9) Help me, Lord, for there is not one godly man left: for the faithful are minished from among the children of men.

They talk of vanity every one with his neighbour: they do but flatter with their lips, and dissemble in their double heart.

The Lord shall root out all deceitful lips: and the tongue that speaketh proud things.

Which have said, with our tongue will we prevail: we are they that ought to speak; who is Lord over us?

Now for this comfortless troubles' sake of the needy: and because of the deep sighing of the poor;

I will up, saith the Lord: and will help every one from him that swelleth against him, and will set him at rest.

The words of the Lord are pure words: even as the silver which from the earth is tried, and purified seven times in the fire.

Thou shalt keep them, O Lord: thou shalt preserve him from this generation for ever.

The ungodly walk on every side: when they are exalted, the children of men are put to rebuke. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 13 (10) How long wilt thou forget me, O Lord, for ever: how long wilt thou hide thy face from me?

How long shall I seek counsel in my soul, and be so vexed in my heart: how long shall mine enemies triumph over me?

Consider and hear me, O Lord my God: lighten mine eyes that I sleep not in death;

Lest mine enemy say, I have prevailed against him: for if I be cast down, they that trouble me will rejoice at it. But my trust is in thy mercy: and my heart is joyful in thy salvation.

I will sing of the Lord, because he hath dealt so lovingly with me: yea, I will praise this Name of the Lord most Highest. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 14 (11) The fool hath said in his heart: There is no God. They are corrupt, and become abominable in their doings: there is none that doeth good, no, not one.

The Lord looked down from heaven upon the children of men: to see if there were any that would understand, and seek after God.

But they are all gone out of the way, they are altogether become abominable: there is none that doeth good, no not one.

Their throat is an open sepulchre; with their tongues have they deceived: the poison of asps is under their lips. Their mouth is full of cursing and bitterness: their feet are swift to shed blood.

Destruction and unhappiness is in their ways, and the way of peace have they not known: there is no fear of God before their eyes.

Have they no knowledge, that they are all such workers of mischief: eating up my people as it were bread, and call not upon the Lord?

There were they brought in great fear, even where no fear was: for God is in the generation of the righteous.

As for you, ye have made a mock at the counsel of the poor: because he putteth his trust in the Lord.

Who shall give salvation unto Israel out of Sion? When the Lord turneth the captivity of his people: then shall Jacob rejoice, and Israel shall be glad. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 15 (12)

Lord, who shall dwell in thy tabernacle: or who shall rest upon thy holy hill?

Even he that leadeth an uncorrupt life: and doeth the thing which is right, and speaketh the truth from his heart.

He that hath used no deceit in his tongue, nor done evil to his neighbour: and hath not slandered his neighbour.

He that setteth not by himself, but is lowly in his own

eyes: and maketh much of them that fear the Lord.
He that sweareth unto his neighbour, and disappointeth
him not: though it were to his own hindrance.
He that hath not given his money upon usury: nor taken
reward against the innocent.
Whoso doeth these things shall never fall. Glory
be, &c.

(e) *Antiphon*

Thou shalt keep them, O Lord: thou shalt preserve him.

(f) *Verse and Response*

I have thought upon thy Name, O Lord, in the night
season.

And have kept thy law.

The Lord's Prayer.

(Privately till the last two petitions.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution

O Lord Jesu Christ, hear the prayers of thy servants,
and have mercy upon us, who with the Father and the Holy
Ghost, livest and reignest world without end. *Amen.* [Jube, Domine,
benedicere.]

Benediction 1.

Lesson 1.

1 Sam. xvii. 1-7.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The Father everlasting, bless us with a per-
petual blessing. *Amen.*

Now the Philistines gathered together their armies to
battle, and were gathered together at Shochoh, which *belong- eth* to Judah, and pitched between
Shochoh and Azekah,
in Ephes-dammim.

And Saul and the men of Israel were gathered together
and pitched by the valley of Elah, and set the battle in array
against the Philistines.

And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side,
and Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and *there was* a valley between them.
And there went out a champion out of the camp of the
Philistines, named Goliath, of Gath, whose height *was* six
cubits and a span.

And *he had* an helmet of brass upon his head, and *he was*
armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat *was*
five thousand shekels of brass.

And *he had* greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target

of brass between his shoulders.

And the staff of his spear *was* like a weaver's beam; and his spear's head *weighed* six hundred shekels of iron; and one bearing a shield went before him.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 1.

Prepare your hearts unto the Lord, and serve Him only; and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philis- tines.

If ye do return unto the Lord with all your hearts, then put away the strange gods from among you.

And he will deliver you out of the hands of the Philis- tines.

Benediction 2.

Reader—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The only-begotten Son of God, vouchsafe to bless and succour us. *Amen.*

Lesson 2.

1 Sam. xvii. 8-11.

And he stood and cried unto the armies of Israel, and said unto them, Why are ye come out to set *your* battle in array? *am* I not a Philistine, and ye servants to Saul? choose you a man for you, and let him come down to me.

If he be able to fight with me, and to kill me, then will we be your servants: but if I prevail against him, and kill him, then shall ye be our servants, and serve us.

And the Philistine said, I defy the armies of Israel this day: give me a man that we may fight together.

When Saul and all Israel heard those words of the Philistine, they were dismayed, and greatly afraid.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 2.

God is the avenger of all men. He hath sent His angel, and taken me from my Father's sheep; and hath anointed me with the oil of His mercy.

The Lord hath delivered me out of the mouth of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear.

And hath anointed me with the oil of His mercy.

The Benediction 3.

Reader—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The grace of the Holy Ghost illuminate our minds and hearts. *Amen.*

Lesson 3.

1 Sam. xvii. 12-16.

Now David *was* the son of that Ephrathite of Beth-lehem-

judah, whose name was Jesse; and he had eight sons: and the man went among men *for* an old man in the days of Saul.

And the three eldest sons of Jesse went, *and* followed Saul to the battle: and the names of his three sons that went to the battle *were* Eliab the first-born; and next unto him, Abinadab; and the third, Shammah.

And David was the youngest; and the three eldest followed Saul.

But David went and returned from Saul, to feed his father's sheep at Bethlehem.

And the Philistine drew near, morning and evening, and presented himself forty days.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 3.

*The Lord, who delivered me out of the mouth of the lion,
and out of the paw of the bear, He shall deliver me
from the hands of mine enemies.*

God hath sent forth His mercy and truth; my soul is among lions.

He shall deliver me from the hands of mine enemies.

Glory be, &c.

He shall deliver me from the hands of mine enemies.

NOCTURN II.

(g) *Antiphon*

My goods.

Psalm 16 (13)

Preserve me, O God: for in thee I have put my trust.

O my soul, thou hast said unto the Lord: thou art my God, my goods are nothing unto thee.

All my delight is upon the saints, that are in the earth: and upon such as excel in virtue.

But they that run after another god: shall have great trouble.

Their drink-offerings of blood will I not offer: neither make mention of their names within my lips.

The Lord himself is the portion of mine inheritance, and of my cup: thou shalt maintain my lot.

The lot is fallen unto me in a fair ground: yea, I have a goodly heritage.

I will thank the Lord for giving me warning: my reins also chasten me in the night-season.

I have set God always before me: for he is on my right hand, therefore I shall not fall.

Wherefore my heart was glad, and my glory rejoiced: my flesh also shall rest in hope.

For why? thou shalt not leave my soul in hell: neither shalt thou suffer thy Holy One to see corruption.

Thou shalt show me the paths of life: in thy presence is the fulness of joy: and at thy right hand there is pleasure for evermore. Glory be, &c.

(g) *Antiphon*

My goods are nothing unto Thee; in Thee have I put my trust, preserve me, O God.

(h) *Antiphon*

Because of the words of Thy lips.

Psalms 17 (14)

Hear the right, O Lord, consider my complaint: and hearken unto my prayer, that goeth not out of feigned lips.

Let my sentence come forth from thy presence: and let thine eyes look upon the thing that is equal.

Thou hast proved and visited mine heart in the night season; thou hast tried me, and shalt find no wickedness in me: for I am utterly purposed that my mouth shall not offend.

Because of men's works that are done against the words of my lips: I have kept me from the ways of the destroyer. O hold thou up my goings in thy paths: that my footsteps slip not.

I have called upon thee, O God, for thou shalt hear me: incline thine ear to me, and harken unto my words.

Show thy marvellous loving-kindness, thou that art the Saviour of them which put their trust in thee: from such as resist thy right hand.

Keep me as the apple of an eye: hide me under the shadow of thy wings.

From the ungodly that trouble me: mine enemies compass me round about to take away my soul.

They are inclosed in their own fat: and their mouth speaketh proud things.

They lie waiting in our way on every side: turning their eyes down to the ground;

Like as a lion that is greedy of his prey: and as it were a lion's whelp lurking in secret places.

Up, Lord, disappoint him, and cast him down: deliver my soul from the ungodly, which is a sword of thine;

From the men of thy hand, O Lord, from the men, I say, and from the evil world: which have their portion in this life, whose bellies thou fillest with thy hid trea-

sure.

They have children at their desire: and leave the rest
of their substance for their babes.

But as for me, I will behold thy presence in righteousness: and when I awake up after thy likeness, I shall be satisfied with it. Glory be, &c.

(h) *Antiphon*

Because of the words of Thy lips, I have kept me from
the ways of the destroyer.

(i) *Antiphon*

I will love Thee.

Psalm 18 (15) . . . O Lord, my strength; the Lord is my stony rock, and
my defence: my Saviour, my God, and my might, in whom
I will trust: thy buckler, the horn also of my salvation, and
my refuge.

I will call upon the Lord, which is worthy to be praised:
so shall I be safe from mine enemies.

The sorrows of death compassed me: and the overflow-
ings of ungodliness made me afraid.

The pains of hell came about me: the snares of death
overtook me.

In my trouble I will call upon the Lord: and complain
unto my God.

So shall he hear my voice out of his holy temple: and my
complaint shall come before him, it shall enter even into his
ears.

The earth trembled and quaked: the very foundations also
of the hills shook, and were removed, because he was wroth.

There went a smoke out in his presence: and a consuming
fire out of his mouth, so that coals were kindled at it.

He bowed the heavens also, and came down: and it was
dark under his feet.

He rode upon the cherubims, and did fly: he came flying
upon the wings of the wind.

He made darkness his secret place: his pavilion round
about him with dark water, and thick clouds to cover him.

At the brightness of his presence his clouds removed:
hailstones, and coals of fire.

The Lord also thundered out of heaven, and the Highest
gave his thunder: hail-stones, and coals of fire.

He sent out his arrows, and scattered them: he cast forth
lightnings and destroyed them.

The springs of waters were seen, and the foundations of
the round world were discovered, at thy chiding, O Lord:
at the blasting of the breath of thy displeasure.

He shall send down from on high to fetch me: and shall
 take me out of many waters.
 He shall deliver me from my strongest enemy, and from
 them which hate me: for they are too mighty for me.
 They prevented me in the day of my trouble: but the
 Lord was my upholder.
 He brought me forth also into a place of liberty: he
 brought me forth, even because he had a favour unto me.
 The Lord shall reward me after my righteous dealing: ac-
 cording to the cleanness of my hands shall he recompense me.
 Because I have kept the ways of the Lord: and have not
 forsaken my God, as the wicked doeth.
 For I have an eye unto all his laws: and will not cast out
 his commandments from me.
 I was also uncorrupt before him: and eschewed mine own
 wickedness.
 Therefore shall the Lord reward me after my righteous
 dealing: and according unto the cleanness of my hands in
 his eye-sight.
 With the holy thou shalt be holy: and with a perfect man
 thou shalt be perfect.
 With the clean thou shalt be clean: and with the forward
 thou shalt learn frowardness.
 For thou shalt save the people that are in adversity: and
 shalt bring down the high looks of the proud.
 Thou also shalt light my candle: the Lord my God shall
 make my darkness to be light.
 For in thee I shall discomfit an host of men: and with
 the help of my God I shall leap over the wall.
 The way of God is an undefiled way: the word of the
 Lord also is tried in the fire; he is the defender of all them
 that put their trust in him.
 For who is God, but the Lord: or who hath any strength,
 except our God?
 It is God that girdeth me with strength of war; and
 maketh my way perfect.
 He maketh my feet like harts' feet: and setteth me up on
 high.
 He teacheth mine hands to fight: and mine arms shall
 break even a bow of steel.
 Thou hast given me the defence of thy salvation: thy
 right hand also shall hold me up, and thy loving correction
 shall make me great.
 Thou shalt make room enough under me for to go: that
 my footsteps shall not slide.

I will follow upon mine enemies, and overtake them:
 neither will I turn again till I have destroyed them.
 I will smite them, that they shall not be able to stand:
 but fall under my feet.
 Thou hast girded me with strength unto the battle: thou
 shalt throw down mine enemies under me.
 Thou hast made mine enemies also to turn their backs
 upon me: and I shall destroy them that hate me.
 They shall cry, but there shall be none to help them:
 yea, even unto the Lord shall they cry, but he shall not
 hear them.
 I will beat them as small as the dust before the wind: I
 will cast them out as the clay in the streets.
 Thou shalt deliver me from the strivings of the people:
 and thou shalt make me the head of the heathen.
 A people whom I have not known: shall serve me.
 As soon as they hear of me, they shall obey me: but the
 strange children shall dissemble with me.
 The strange children shall fail: and be afraid out of their
 prisons.
 The Lord liveth, and blessed be my strong helper: and
 praised be the God of my salvation.
 Even the God that seeth that I be avenged: and subdueth
 the people unto me.
 It is he that delivereth me from my cruel enemies, and
 setteth me up above mine adversaries: thou shalt rid me
 from the wicked man.
 For this cause will I give thanks unto thee, O Lord,
 among the Gentiles: and sing praises unto thy Name.
 Great prosperity giveth he unto his king: and sheweth
 loving-kindness unto David his Anointed, and unto his seed
 for evermore. Glory be, &c.

(i) *Antiphon*

I will love Thee, O Lord, my strength.

(j) *Verse and Response*

Thou also, O Lord, shalt light my candle.

The Lord my God shall make my darkness to be light.

The Lord's Prayer

(Privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 2.

His pity and mercy succour us, who with the Father and
 the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 4.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—God the Father Almighty, be favourable and gracious to us. *Amen.*

Lesson 4.

(Sermon of St. Augustin, Bishop.)

The children of Israel presented themselves against their adversaries forty days. Which signifieth the present world having four seasons and four parts of the earth, and in which the Christian people ceaseth not to war against Goliath and his host, that is, with the devil and his angels. Yet they could not conquer, except that Christ, the true David, had descended with his staff, even the mystery of His Cross. For before the coming of Christ, dearly beloved brethren, the devil was at liberty; but when Christ came, He did towards him what the Gospel speaketh of, "No man can enter into a strong man's house and spoil his goods, unless first he bind the strong man." Christ therefore came, and bound the devil.

Thou then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 4.

Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands; for the hand of the Lord was with him, and he slew the Philistines, and took away the reproach from Israel.

Is not this he of whom they sang in the dance, saying,

Saul hath slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands.

For the hand of the Lord was with him, and he slew the Philistines, and took away the reproach from Israel.

Benediction 5.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—Christ grant to us the joys of endless life. *Amen. Lesson 5.*

(Sermon continued.)

But some one will say, If the devil be bound, how hath he still such dominion? It is true, dearly beloved, that he hath much dominion, but it is over the lukewarm and careless, and those who fear not the Lord in truth. For he is bound, as a dog that is chained, able to bite none but such as are led by a fatal recklessness to close with him. Ye know, my brethren, the foolishness of him whom a chained dog biteth. Only beware thou of closing with him in the likings and lusts of this world, and he will not dare to come to thee. He can bark, he can vex; he can in no wise bite except those that be willing. Not his violence, but his blandishments hurt us; he doth not extort, he winneth our consent.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 5.

Ye mountains of Gilboa, let there be no dew, neither let there be rain upon you; for there the mighty men of Israel are fallen.

All ye mountains which are in his border, the Lord shall visit you, and ye shall pass from Gilboa.

For there the mighty men of Israel are fallen.

Benediction 6.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—God kindle the fire of his love in our hearts.

Amen.

Lesson 6.

(Sermon continued.)

Therefore David came, and found the Jewish people fighting against the devil; and when there was no one to undertake the single combat, he, bearing the figure of Christ, proceeded to the battle, with a staff in his hand, and went out against Goliath. And then was shadowed out in him, what was fulfilled in the Lord Jesus Christ. For Christ, the true David, came, who, being to fight against the spiritual Goliath, that is, the, devil, bare his own Cross. Ye see, my brethren, where David struck the Philistine, in the forehead, which had not been signed by the sign of the Cross. For as the staff was the type of the Cross, so also the stone wherewith he was struck, was a type of the Lord Christ.

Thou therefore, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 6.

I took thee from the sheepcote, saith the Lord, to be Shepherd over my people, and I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of thy sight.

And I have made thee a great name, like unto the name of the great men that are in the earth, and have caused thee to rest from all thine enemies.

And I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of Thy sight.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

And I was with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and have cut off all thine enemies out of Thy sight.

NOCTURN III.

(k) Antiphon

There is no speech.

Psalms 19 (16)

The heavens declare the glory of God: and the firmament sheweth his handy work.

One day telleth another: and one night certifieth another.

There is neither speech nor language: but their voices are heard among them.

Their sound is gone out into all lands: and their words into the ends of the world.

In them hath he set a tabernacle for the sun: which cometh forth as a bridegroom out of his chamber, and rejoiceth as a giant to run his course.

It goeth from the uttermost part of the heaven, and runneth about unto the end of it again: and there is nothing hid from the heat thereof.

The law of the Lord is an undefiled law, converting the soul: the testimony of the Lord is sure, and giveth wisdom unto the simple.

The statutes of the Lord are right, and rejoice the heart, the commandment of the Lord is pure, and giveth light unto the eyes.

The fear of the Lord is clean, and endureth for ever; the judgments of the Lord are true, and righteous altogether.

More to be desired are they than gold, yea, than much fine gold: sweeter also than honey, and the honeycomb. Moreover by them is thy servant taught: and in keeping of them there is great reward.

Who can tell how oft he offendeth: O cleanse thou me from my secret faults!

Keep thy servant also from presumptuous sins, lest they get the dominion over me: so shall I be undefiled, and innocent from the great offence.

Let the words of my mouth, and the meditation of my heart: be always acceptable in thy sight.

O Lord: my strength, and my redeemer. Glory be, &c. (k) *Antiphon*

There is neither speech nor language, but their voices are heard among them.

(l) *Antiphon*

The Lord hear thee.

Psalm 20 (17) ... in the day of trouble: the name of the God of Jacob defend thee.

Send thee help from the sanctuary: and strengthen thee out of Sion.

Remember all thy offerings: and accept thy burnt sacrifice.

Grant thee thy heart's desire: and fulfil all thy mind.

We will rejoice in thy salvation, and triumph in the Name of the Lord our God: the Lord perform all thy petitions.

Now know I that the Lord helpeth his Anointed, and will hear him from his holy heaven: even with the wholesome

strength of his right hand.

Some put their trust in chariots, and some in horses: but we will remember the name of the Lord our God.

They are brought down, and fallen: but we are risen, and stand upright.

Save, Lord, and hear us, O king of heaven: when we call upon thee. Glory be, &c.

(l) *Antiphon*

The Lord hear thee in the day of trouble.

(m) *Antiphon*

The king.

Psalm 21 (18) ... shall rejoice in thy strength, O Lord: exceeding glad shall he be of thy salvation.

Thou hast given him his heart's desire: and hast not denied him the request of his lips.

For thou shalt prevent him with the blessings of goodness: and shalt set a crown of pure gold upon his head.

He asked life of thee, and thou gavest him a long life; even for ever and ever.

His honour is great in thy salvation: glory and great worship shalt thou lay upon him.

For thou shalt give him everlasting felicity: and make him glad with the joy of thy countenance.

And why? because the king putteth his trust in the Lord: and in the mercy of the Most Highest he shall not miscarry.

All thine enemies shall feel thy hand; thy right hand shall find out them that hate thee.

Thou shalt make them like a fiery oven in time of thy wrath: the Lord shall destroy them in his displeasure, and the fire shall consume them.

Their fruit shalt thou root out of the earth: and their seed from among the children of men.

For they intended mischief against thee: and imagined such a device as they are not able to perform.

Therefore shalt thou put them to flight: and the strings of thy bow shalt thou make ready against the face of them.

Be thou exalted, Lord, in thine own strength: so will we sing, and praise thy power. Glory be, &c.

(m) *Antiphon*

The King shall rejoice in Thy strength, O Lord.

(n) *Verse and Response*

Be Thou exalted, Lord, in thine own strength.

So will we sing and praise Thy power.

The Lord's Prayer

(Privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,
But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 3.

The Almighty and merciful Lord absolve us from the
bonds of our sins. *Amen.*

Benediction 7.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The reading of the Gospel be to us salvation
and a defence. *Amen.*

Lesson 7.

(Luke v.)

At that time, as the people pressed upon Jesus to hear the
word of God, he stood by the lake of Gennesareth.
And saw two ships standing by the lake; but the fisher-
-men were gone out of them, and were washing their nets.
And he entered into one of the ships, which was Simon's,
and prayed him that he would thrust out a little from the
land. And he sat down and taught the people out of the ship.
Now when he had left speaking, he said unto Simon,
Launch out into the deep, and let down your nets for a
draught.

And Simon answering, said unto him, Master, we have
toiled all the night, and have taken nothing: nevertheless,
at thy word I will let down the net.

And when they had this done, they enclosed a great mul-
titude of fishes: and their net brake.

And they beckoned unto *their* partners which were in the
other ship, that they should come and help them. And they
came, and filled both the ships, so that they began to sink.

When Simon Peter saw *it*, he fell down at Jesus' knees,
saying, Depart from me; for I am a sinful man, O Lord, &c.

Homily of St. Ambrose, Bishop

When the Lord wrought His various kinds of healing
among many, the multitude could not be restrained, either
by time or place, from their eagerness to be healed. The
evening fell on them; they followed. The water met them:
they pressed on. Therefore he entered into the ship of
Peter. This is that ship, which according to St. Matthew
ever tosseth, according to St. Luke is filled with fishes, as an
emblem of the Church labouring in its beginning, overflow-
ing in its latter time; for by fishes are meant those who es-
cape the surge of this life. Christ still sleeps in the one amid
His disciples, and still directs them in the other; for He
sleeps to the fearful, but he watches over the perfect.

Thou then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 7.

My transgressions are more in number than the sands of the sea, and my sins have multiplied; and I am not worthy to look up to the height of heaven for the multitude of mine iniquities, for I have provoked Thine anger; and done evil in Thy sight.

For I acknowledge my faults and my sin is ever before thee, for against Thee only have I sinned.

And done evil in Thy sight.

Benediction 8.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The help of God abide with us for ever. *Amen.*

Lesson 8.

(Homily continued.)

No distress befalls this ship, in which wisdom is pilot, misbelief is unknown, faith fills the sails. For how can she be in distress, being governed by him who is the very stay of the Church? Therefore distress is only there where there is scanty faith; where love is perfect, there is security.

Though others were told to let down their nets, to Peter alone He said, Launch out into the deep, that is, the depth of contemplation. For what is so deep as to see the depth of His riches, to know the Son of God, to confess His Divine Generation? Which, though man's understanding cannot compass fully by searching out, the full assurance of faith embraceth.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 8.

(used on the Sundays after Trinity.)

The two Seraphims cried one to the other, Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of hosts: all the earth is full of His glory.

There are three that bear record in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Ghost, and these Three are One.

Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Hosts, all the earth is full of His glory.

Glory be, &c.

All the earth is full of His glory.

Benediction 9.

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The King of Angels lead us on to the society of the inhabitants of heaven. *Amen. Lesson 9.*

(Homily continued.)

For though I may not know how He was born, yet I may not be ignorant that He was born. The mode of His generation I know not, the Author of it I confess. We were not witnesses of it, but we are witnesses of its revelation. If we believe not God, whom shall we believe? For all belief comes from sight or hearing. Sight is often deceived, hearing is of faith.

Te Deum.

We praise thee, O God: we acknowledge thee to be the Lord.

All the earth doth worship thee: the Father everlasting.
To thee all Angels cry aloud: the Heavens, and all the Powers therein.

To thee Cherubim and Seraphim continually do cry,
Holy, Holy, Holy Lord God of Sabaoth;
Heaven and earth are full of the Majesty: of thy Glory.
The glorious company of the Apostles: praise thee.
The goodly fellowship of the Prophets: praise thee.
The noble army of Martyrs: praise thee.
The holy Church throughout all the world: doth acknowledge thee;

The Father: of an infinite Majesty;
Thine honourable, true: and only Son;
Also the Holy Ghost: The Comforter.
Thou art the King of Glory: O Christ.
Thou art the everlasting Son: of the Father.
When thou tookest upon thee to deliver man: thou didst not abhor the Virgin's womb.
When thou hadst overcome the sharpness of death: thou didst open the Kingdom of Heaven to all believers.
Thou sittest at the right hand of God: in the Glory of the Father.

We believe that thou shalt come: to be our Judge.
We therefore pray thee, help thy servants: whom thou hast redeemed with thy precious blood.
Make them to be numbered with thy Saints: in glory everlasting.

O Lord, save thy people: and bless thine heritage.
Govern them: and lift them up for ever.
Day by day: we magnify thee;
And we worship thy Name: ever world without end.
Vouchsafe, O Lord: to keep us this day without sin.
O Lord, have mercy upon us: have mercy upon us.
O Lord, let thy mercy lighten upon us: as our trust is in thee.

O Lord, in thee have I trusted: let me never be confounded.

LAUDS SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. Amen.

Hallelujah.

(o) *Antiphon*

Praise ye the Lord.

Psalm 93 (1)

The Lord is King, and hath put on glorious apparel:
the Lord hath put on his apparel, and girded himself
with strength

He hath made the round world so sure: that it cannot be
moved.

Ever since the world began, hath thy seat been prepared:
thou art from everlasting.

The floods are risen, O Lord, the floods have lift up their
voice: the floods lift up their waves.

The waves of the sea are mighty, and rage horribly: but
yet the Lord, who dwelleth on high, is mightier.

Thy testimonies, O Lord, are very sure: holiness be-
cometh thine house for ever. Glory be, &c.

(o) *Ant.*

(p) *Ant.*

Psalm 100 (2)

O be joyful in the Lord, all ye lands: serve the Lord with
gladness, and come before his presence with a song.

Be ye sure that the Lord he is God: it is he that hath
made us, and not we ourselves; we are his people, and the
sheep of his pasture.

O go your way into his gates with thanksgiving, and into
his courts with praise: be thankful unto him, and speak
good of his name.

For the Lord is gracious, his mercy is everlasting: and his
truth endureth from generation to generation. Glory be, &c.

(p) *Ant.*

(q) *Ant.*

Psalm 63

and 67 (3)

O God, thou art my God: early will I seek thee.

My soul thirsteth for thee: my flesh also longeth after
thee: in a barren and dry land, where no water is.

Thus have I looked for thee in holiness: that I might

behold thy power and glory.
 For thy loving-kindness is better than the life itself: my
 lips shall praise thee.
 As long as I live, will I magnify thee on this manner:
 and lift up my hands in thy name.
 My soul shall be satisfied, even as it were with marrow
 and fatness: when my mouth praiseth thee with joyful lips.
 Have I not remembered thee in my bed, and thought upon
 thee when I was waking?
 Because thou hast been my helper: therefore under the
 shadow of thy wings will I rejoice.
 My soul hangeth upon thee: thy right hand hath up-
 holden me.
 These also that seek the hurt of my soul: they shall go
 under the earth.
 Let them fall upon the edge of the sword: that they may
 be a portion for foxes.
 But the King shall rejoice in God; all they also that
 swear by him, shall be commended: for the mouth of them
 that speak lies shall be stopped.
 God be merciful unto us, and bless us: and shew us the
 light of his countenance, and be merciful unto us;
 That thy way may be known upon earth: thy saving health
 among all nations.
 Let the people praise thee, O God: yea, let all the people
 praise thee.
 O let the nations rejoice and be glad: for thou shalt judge
 the folk righteously, and govern the nations upon earth.
 Let the people praise thee, O God; let all the people praise
 thee.
 Then shall the earth bring forth her increase; and God,
 even our own God, shall give us his blessing.
 God shall bless us: and all the ends of the world shall fear
 him. Glory be, &c.
 (q) *Antiphon*
 Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the Lord.
 (r) *Antiphon*
 The three children.
Song of the Three Children(4)
 O all ye works of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise
 him and magnify him for ever.
 O ye angels of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him,
 and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Heavens, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and mag-
 nify him for ever.

O ye Waters that be above the firmament, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O all ye Powers of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Sun and Moon, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Stars of Heaven, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Showers and Dew, bless ye the Lord: praise ye him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Winds of God, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Fire and Heat, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Winter and Summer, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Dews and Frosts, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Frost and Cold, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Ice and Snow, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Nights and Days, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Light and Darkness, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Lightnings and Clouds, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O let the Earth bless the Lord: yea, let it praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Mountains and Hills, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O all ye Green Things upon the Earth, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Wells, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Seas and Floods, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Whales, and all that move in the waters, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O all ye Fowls of the air, bless ye the Lord : praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O all ye Beasts and Cattle, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye children of Men, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and

magnify him for ever.

O let Israel bless the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

O ye Priests of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

O ye Servants of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

O ye Spirits and Souls of the Righteous, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

O ye holy and humble Men of heart, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

O Ananias, Azarias, and Misael, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and magnify him for ever.

(r) *Antiphon*

The three children, by command of the King, were thrown into the furnace, not fearing the flame of the fire, but saying, Blessed be God.

(s) *Antiphon*

Praise ye the Lord.

Psalm 148, 149,

and 150 (5)

O praise the Lord of heaven: praise him in the height.

Praise him, all ye angels of his: praise him, all his host.

Praise him, sun and moon; praise him, all ye stars and light.

Praise him, all ye heavens: and ye waters that are above the heavens.

Let them praise the Name of the Lord: for he spake the word, and they were made; he commanded, and they were created.

He hath made them fast for ever and ever: he hath given them a law, which shall not be broken.

Praise the Lord upon earth: ye dragons, and all deeps: Fire and hail, snow and vapours: wind and storm fulfilling his word.

Mountains and all hills: fruitful trees and all cedars;

Beasts and all cattle: worms and feathered fowl;

Kings of the earth and all people: princes and all judges of the world;

Young men and maidens, old men and children, praise the Name of the Lord: for his Name only is excellent, and his praise above heaven and earth.

He shall exalt the horn of his people; all his saints shall praise him: even the children of Israel, even the people that serveth him.

O sing unto the Lord a new song: let the congregation of saints praise him.

Let Israel rejoice in him that made him: and let the children of Sion be joyful in their King.

Let them praise his Name in the dance: let them sing praises unto him with tabret and harp.

For the Lord hath pleasure in his people: and helpeth the meek-hearted.

Let the saints be joyful with glory: let them rejoice in their beds.

Let the praises of God be in their mouth: and a two-edged sword in their hands;

To be avenged of the heathen: and to rebuke the people;

To bind their kings in chains: and their nobles with links of iron.

That they may be avenged of them, as it is written: Such honour have all his saints.

O Praise God in his holiness: praise him in the firmament of his power.

Praise him in his noble acts: praise him according to his excellent greatness.

Praise him in the sound of the trumpet: praise him upon the lute and harp.

Praise him in the cymbals and dances: praise him upon the strings and pipe.

Praise him upon the well-tuned cymbals: praise him upon the loud cymbals.

Let every thing that hath breath: praise the Lord.

(s) *Antiphon*

Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the Lord.

(t) *Text*

(*Capitulum.*)

Rev. vii. 12.

Minister.—Blessing, and glory, and wisdom, and thanksgiving, and honour, and power, and might, be unto our God for ever and ever. *Amen.*

(u) *Hymn*

[*Ecce jam noctis.*]

Thanks be to God.

Paler have grown the shades of night,

And nearer draws the day,

Checkering the sky with streaks of light,

Since we began to pray.

To pray for mercy when we sin,

For cleansing and release,

For ghostly safety, and within
For everlasting peace.
Grant this to us, O Father, Son,
And Spirit, God of grace,
To whom all worship shall be done
In every time and place. *Amen.*

(v) *Verse and Response*

The Lord is king, and hath put on glorious apparel.
*The Lord hath put on his apparel, and girded himself
with strength.*

(w) *Ant.*

Jesus entered into the ship.
Benedictus.

Blessed be the Lord God of Israel: for he hath visited,
and redeemed his people:
And hath raised up a mighty salvation for us: in the
house of his servant David.
As he spake by the mouth of his holy prophets: which
have been since the world began;
That we should be saved from our enemies: and from the
hand of all that hate us;
To perform the mercy promised to our forefathers: and to
remember his holy covenant.
To perform the oath which he sware to our forefather
Abraham: that he would give us;
That we being delivered out of the hand of our enemies:
might serve him without fear,
In holiness and righteousness before him: all the days of
our life.

And thou, Child, shalt be called the prophet of the High-
est: for thou shalt go before the face of the Lord to prepare
his ways;

To give knowledge of salvation unto his people: for the
remission of their sins,
Through the tender mercy of our God: whereby the Day-
spring from on high hath visited us;
To give light to them that sit in darkness, and in the
shadow of death: and to guide our feet into the way of
peace.

(w) *Antiphon*

Jesus entered into the ship, and when he was set down
he taught the multitudes.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

(x) *Collect*

(for the day and week.)

Let us pray.

Grant to us, Lord, we beseech Thee, that the course of this world may be so peaceably ordered by Thy governance, that Thy church may joyfully serve Thee in all godly quietness through the Lord. *Amen.*

Antiphon

(the following Commemorations are read at Vespers also.)

Holy Mary, succour the wretched, help the weak-hearted, comfort the mourners, pray for the people, interpose for the Clergy, intercede for the devoted females; let all feel thy assistance who observe thy holy commemoration.

Pray for us, Holy Mother of God,

That we may be made worthy of the promise of Christ.

Collect

Let us pray.

Grant, O Lord God, we beseech Thee, that we Thy servants may ever prosper in perpetual health of body and mind, and by the glorious intercession of the Blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, may be delivered from present sadness, and enjoy eternal bliss.

Antiphon

Glorious rulers of the earth, as they loved each other in this life, so in death they were not divided.

Their sound is gone out into all lands.

And their words unto the ends of the world.

Let us pray.

Collect

O God, who when thy Apostle Peter walked on the waves savedst him from drowning with Thy right hand, and delivered his fellow Apostle Paul the third day from shipwreck on the open sea, favourably hear us, and grant that, by the deserts of both of them, we may obtain everlasting glory.

Antiphon

Give peace in our time, O Lord, because there is none other that fighteth for us but only Thou, O God.

Peace be within thy walls.

And plenteousness within Thy palaces.

Let us pray.

Collect

O God, from whom all holy desires, all good counsels, and all just works do proceed, give unto Thy servants that peace which the world cannot give; that both our hearts may be set to obey Thy commandments, and also that by Thee we being defended from the fear of our enemies, may pass our

time in rest and quietness, through Jesus Christ our Lord,
who liveth and reigneth with Thee in the unity of the Holy
Ghost, one God, world without end. *Amen.*

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

(y)

Thanks be to God.

(z)

May the souls of the faithful, through God's mercy, rest in
peace. *Amen.*

Continue

§ 2. Service for Sunday, June 21, 1801 (continued).

File 1

2. PRIME SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. *Amen.* Hallelujah.

(aa) *Hymn*

[Jam lucis orto.]

The star of morn to night succeeds,

We therefore meekly pray,

May God in all our words and deeds

Keep us from harm this day.

May he in love restrain us still

From tones of strife and words of ill,

And wrap around and close our eyes

To earth's absorbing vanities.

May wrath and thoughts that gender shame

Ne'er in our breasts abide,

And painful abstinences tame

Of wanton flesh the pride:

So when the weary day is o'er

And night and stillness come once more,

Blameless and clean from spot of earth

We may repeat, with reverent mirth,

Praise to the Father, as is meet,

Praise to the only Son,

Praise to the Holy Paraclete,

While endless ages run. *Amen.*

(bb) *Antiphon* Praise ye the Lord.

Psalm 53. (1) Save me, O God, for thy Name's sake: and avenge me in
thy strength.

Hear my prayer, O God: and hearken unto the words of
 my mouth.
 For strangers are risen up against me: and tyrants, which
 have not God before their eyes, seek after my soul.
 Behold, God is my helper: the Lord is with them that
 uphold my soul.
 He shall reward evil unto mine enemies: destroy thou
 them in thy truth.
 An offering of a free heart will I give thee, and praise thy
 Name, O Lord: because it is so comfortable.
 For he hath delivered me out of all my trouble: and mine
 eye hath seen his desire upon mine enemies. Glory be, &c.
Psalms 118. (2) O give thanks unto the Lord, for he is gracious: because
 his mercy endureth for ever.
 Let Israel now confess, that he is gracious: and that his
 mercy endureth for ever.
 Let the house of Aaron now confess: that his mercy en-
 dureth for ever.
 Yea, let them now that fear the Lord confess: that his
 mercy endureth for ever.
 I called upon the Lord in trouble: and the Lord heard
 me at large.
 The Lord is on my side: I will not fear what man doeth
 unto me.
 The Lord taketh my part with them that help me: there-
 fore shall I see my desire upon mine enemies.
 It is better to trust in the Lord: than to put any confi-
 dence in man.
 It is better to trust in the Lord: than to put any confi-
 dence in princes.
 All nations compassed me round about: but in the Name
 of the Lord will I destroy them.
 They kept me in on every side, they kept me in, I say,
 on every side: but in the Name of the Lord will I destroy
 them.
 They came about me like bees, and are extinct even as
 the fire among the thorns: for in the name of the Lord I
 will destroy them.
 Thou hast thrust sore at me, that I might fall: but the
 Lord was my help.
 The Lord is my strength, and my song: and is become
 my salvation.
 The voice of joy and health is in the dwellings of the
 righteous: the right hand of the Lord bringeth mighty
 things to pass.

The right hand of the Lord hath the pre-eminence: the right hand of the Lord bringeth mighty things to pass. I shall not die, but live: and declare the words of the Lord.

The Lord hath chastened and corrected me: but he hath not given me over unto death.

Open me the gates of righteousness: that I may go into them, and give thanks unto the Lord.

This is the gate of the Lord: the righteous shall enter into it.

I will thank thee, for thou hast heard me: and art become my salvation.

The same stone which the builders refused: is become the head-stone in the corner.

This is the Lord's doing: and it is marvellous in our eyes.

This is the day which the Lord hath made: we will rejoice and be glad in it.

Help me now, O Lord: O Lord, send us now prosperity.

Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord: we have wished you good luck, ye that are of the house of the Lord.

God is the Lord who hath showed us light: bind the sacrifice with cords; yea, even unto the horns of the altar.

Thou art my God, and I will thank thee: thou art my God, and I will praise thee.

O give thanks unto the Lord, for he is gracious: and his mercy endureth for ever. Glory be, &c.

Psalms 119 (3)

1-16. Blessed are those that are undefiled in the way: and walk in the law of the Lord.

Blessed are they that keep his testimonies: and seek him with their whole heart.

For they who do no wickedness: walk in his ways.

Thou hast charged: that we shall diligently keep thy commandments.

O that my ways were made so direct: that I might keep thy statutes!

So shall I not be confounded: while I have respect unto all thy commandments.

I will thank thee with an unfeigned heart: when I shall have learned the judgments of thy righteousness.

I will keep thy ceremonies: O forsake me not utterly.

Wherewithal shall a young man cleanse his way: even by ruling himself after thy word.

With my whole heart have I sought thee: O let me not go

wrong out of thy commandments.
 Thy words have I hid within my heart: that I should not
 sin against thee.
 Blessed art thou, O Lord: O teach me thy statutes.
 With my lips have I been telling: of all the judgments of
 thy mouth.
 I have had as great delight in the way of thy testimonies:
 as in all manner of riches.
 I will talk of thy commandments: and have respect unto
 thy ways.
 My delight shall be in thy statutes: and I will not forget
 thy word. Glory be, &c. *Psalm 119.* (4)
 17-32.
 O do well unto thy servant: that I may live and keep thy
 word.
 Open thou mine eyes: that I may see the wondrous things
 of thy law.
 I am a stranger upon earth: O hide not thy command-
 ments from me.
 My soul breaketh out for the very fervent desire: that it
 hath alway unto thy judgment.
 Thou hast rebuked the proud: and cursed are they that
 do err from thy commandments.
 O turn from me shame and rebuke: for I have kept thy
 testimonies.
 Princes also did sit and speak against me: but thy servant
 is occupied in thy statutes.
 For thy testimonies are my delight: and my counsellors.
 My soul cleaveth to the dust: O quicken thou me, accord-
 ing to thy word.
 I have acknowledged my ways, and thou heardest me: O
 teach me thy statutes.
 Make me to understand the way of thy commandments:
 and so shall I talk of thy wondrous works.
 My soul melteth away for very heaviness: comfort thou
 me according unto thy word.
 Take from me the way of lying: and cause thou me to
 make much of thy law.
 I have chosen the way of truth: and thy judgments have I
 laid before me.
 I have stuck unto thy testimonies: O Lord, confound me
 not.
 I will run the way of thy commandments: when thou hast
 set my heart at liberty. Glory be, &c.
The Creed of St. Athanasius

Whosoever will be saved: before all things it is necessary that he hold the Catholic Faith.

Which Faith except every one do keep whole and undefiled: without doubt he shall perish everlastingly.

And the Catholic Faith is this: That we worship one God in Trinity, and Trinity in Unity.

Neither confounding the Persons: nor dividing the substance.

For there is one Person of the Father, another of the Son: and another of the Holy Ghost.

But the Godhead of the Father, of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, is all one: the Glory equal, the Majesty co-eternal.

Such as the Father is, such is the Son: and such as the Holy Ghost.

The Father uncreate, the Son uncreate: and the Holy Ghost uncreate.

The Father incomprehensible, the Son incomprehensible: and the Holy Ghost incomprehensible.

The Father eternal, the Son eternal: and the Holy Ghost eternal.

And yet they are not three eternals: but one eternal.

And also there are not three incomprehensibles, nor three uncreated: but one uncreated, and one incomprehensible.

So likewise the Father is Almighty, the Son Almighty: and the Holy Ghost Almighty.

And yet they are not three Almighty: but one Almighty.

So the Father is God, the Son is God: and the Holy Ghost is God.

And yet they are not three Gods: but one God.

So likewise the Father is Lord, the Son Lord: and the Holy Ghost Lord.

And yet not three Lords: but one Lord.

For like as we are compelled by the Christian verity: to acknowledge every person by himself to be God and Lord;

So we are forbidden by the Catholic Religion: to say, There be three Gods, or three Lords.

The Father is made of none: neither created, nor begotten.

The Son is of the Father alone: not made, nor created, but begotten.

The Holy Ghost is of the Father and of the Son: neither made, nor created, nor begotten, but proceeding.

So there is one Father, not three Fathers; one Son, not three Sons; one Holy Ghost, not three Holy Ghosts.

And in this Trinity none is afore, or after other: none is greater, or less than another.

But the whole three Persons are co-eternal together: and co-equal.

So that in all things, as is aforesaid: the Unity in Trinity, and the Trinity in Unity, is to be worshipped.

He therefore that will be saved: must thus think of the Trinity.

Furthermore, it is necessary to everlasting salvation: that he also believe rightly the Incarnation of our Lord Jesus Christ.

For the right Faith is, that we believe and confess: that our Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, is God and Man; God, of the Substance of the Father, begotten before the worlds: and Man, of the Substance of his Mother, born in the world.

Perfect God, and perfect Man: of a reasonable soul, and human flesh subsisting:

Equal to the Father, as touching his Godhead: and inferior to the Father, as touching his Manhood.

Who although he be God and man: yet he is not two, but one Christ.

One; not by conversion of the Godhead into flesh: but by taking of the Manhood into God;

One altogether; not by confusion of substance: but by unity of Person.

For as the reasonable soul and flesh is one man: so God and Man is one Christ.

Who suffered for our salvation: descended into hell, rose again the third day from the dead.

He ascended into heaven; he sitteth on the right hand of the Father, God Almighty: from whence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

At whose coming all men shall rise again with their bodies: and shall give account of their own works.

And they that have done good shall go into life everlasting: and they that have done evil, into everlasting fire.

This is the Catholic Faith: which except a man believe faithfully, he cannot be saved. Glory be, &c.

(bb) *Antiphon*

Praise ye the Lord, Hallelujah, Praise ye the Lord.

(cc) *Text.*

Capitulum.

1 *Tim.* i. 17.

Minister.—To the King, eternal, immortal, invisible, the

only wise God, be honour and glory for ever and ever. *Amen.*

Thanks be to God.

(dd) *Short Response*

O Christ, the Son of the living God, have mercy upon us.

O Christ, &c.

(ee) *Thou who sittest at the right hand of the Father,
Have mercy upon us.*

Glory be to the Father, &c.

O Christ, the Son of the living God have mercy upon us.

O Christ, arise, help us.

And deliver us for thy Name's sake.

(ff)

Lord have mercy.

Christ have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.) *Our Father, &c.*

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

The Creed

(privately.)

I believe, &c.

The resurrection of the body.

And the life everlasting. Amen. (In days of the double office, such as Christmas Day the Apostles' days, &c. &c. from ff to hh is omitted.) I have cried unto Three, O Lord.

And early shall my prayer come before Thee.

O let my mouth be filled with Thy praise.

That I may sing of Thy glory and honour all the day long.

Lord, turn Thy face from my sins.

And blot out all my iniquities.

Make me a clean heart, O God.

And renew a right spirit within me.

Cast me not away from Thy presence.

And take not thy Holy Spirit from me.

O give me the comfort of Thy help again.

And stablish me with Thy free Spirit.

(gg)

(Here is some- times an insertion, vide § 3.) *Our help is in the Name of the Lord.*

Who hath made heaven and earth.

Confession,

(This confession is not found in the Paris Breviary, 1735. Observations are made upon it above, pp. 11 and 21. It is repeated at Com- plin; that is at the end of the day, as Prime is the begin- ning.)

*Minister.—I confess before God Almighty, before the
Blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel,
the blessed John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul,*

before all Saints, and you, my Brethren, that I have sinned too much in thought, word, and deed. It is my fault, my fault, my grievous fault. Therefore, I beseech the blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel, the blessed John Baptist, the holy Apostles Peter and Paul, all Saints, and you, my Brethren, to pray the Lord our God for me.

People.—God Almighty have mercy upon thee, absolve thee from thy sins, and bring thee safe to life everlasting *Amen.*

People.—I confess before God Almighty, before the Blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel, the blessed John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul, before all Saints, and thee, my Father, that I have sinned too much in thought, word, and deed. It is my fault, my fault, my grievous fault. Therefore, I beseech the blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel, the blessed John Baptist, the holy Apostles Peter and Paul, all Saints, and thee, my Father, to pray the Lord our God for me.

Minister.—God Almighty have mercy upon you, absolve you from your sins, and bring you safe to everlasting life. *Amen.*

The Almighty and Merciful Lord grant to us pardon, absolution, and remission of all our sins. *Amen.*

Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep us.

This day without sin.

O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Have mercy upon us.

O Lord, let Thy mercy be showed upon us.

As we do put our trust in Thee.

Lord, hear our prayer.

And let our cry come unto Thee.

(hh)

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Collect

Let us pray.

O Lord God Almighty, who hast brought us to the beginning of this day, defend us in the same with Thy mighty power, that we fall into no sin today, but all our words, thoughts, and works may be ordered according to Thy righteousness, through our Lord Jesus Christ, Thy Son, who liveth and reigneth with Thee in the unity of the

Holy Ghost, world without end. *Amen.*

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

Here the Martyr- ology is read.

* * * * *

Right dear in the sight of the Lord.

Is the death of his saints.

Collect

(The words "Holy Mary" are not in the Monastic Bre- viaries.)

Repeated thrice.

Holy Mary and all the saints intercede for us to the
Lord, that we may be worthy of His help and salvation, who
liveth and reigneth world without end. *Amen.*

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c.

Lord, have mercy.

Christ, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

O Lord, show thy Servants Thy work, and their children

Thy glory.

And the Glorious Majesty of the Lord our God be upon

us: prosper Thou the' work of our hands upon us,

O prosper Thou our handy work.

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit. Collect

Let us pray.

O Lord God, King of heaven and earth, vouchsafe this
day to direct and sanctify, to rule and govern our hearts
and bodies, our thoughts, words, and deeds in thy law, and
in the works of Thy commandments, that through Thy
most mighty protection, both here and ever, we may ob-
tain safety and freedom, O Saviour of the world, who livest
and reignest for ever. *Amen.*

Benediction

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Minister.—The Lord Almighty order our lives and doings in His peace. *Amen.*

(ii) *Short Lesson*

2 *Thess.* iii. 5.

Reader.—The Lord direct our hearts and bodies in the love of God, and the patient waiting for Christ.

Thou, then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Benediction

Our help is in the name of the Lord.

Who hath made heaven and earth.

Bless ye.

Reader.—May God.

Minister.—The Lord bless us and defend us from all evil, and bring us to everlasting life; and may the souls of the faithful, through God's mercy, rest in peace. *Amen.*

3. THIRD HOUR SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to save me.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(jj) *Hymn*

[Nunc Sancte
obis.]

Come, Holy Ghost, who ever One

Art with the Father and the Son;

Come, Holy Ghost, our souls possess,

With Thy full flood of Holiness.

Let mouth, and heart, and flesh combine

To herald forth our Creed divine,

And love so wrap our mortal frame,

Others may catch the living flame.

This grace on Thy redeem'd confer,

Father, Co-equal Son,

And Holy Ghost, the Comforter,

Eternal Three in One. *Amen.*

(kk) *Antiphon*

Psalms 119 (1)

33-48.

Praise ye the Lord.

Teach me, O Lord, the way of thy statutes: and I shall keep it unto the end.

Give me understanding, and I shall keep thy law: yea, I shall keep it with my whole heart.

Make me to go in the path of thy commandments: for
 therein is my desire.
 Incline my heart unto thy testimonies: and not to
 covetousness.
 O turn away mine eyes lest they behold vanity: and
 quicken thou me in thy way.
 O stablish thy word in thy servant: that I may fear thee.
 Take away the rebuke that I am afraid of: for thy judgments are good.
 Behold, my delight is in thy commandments: O quicken
 me in thy righteousness.
 Let thy loving mercy come also unto me, O Lord: even
 thy salvation, according unto thy word.
 So shall I make answer unto my blasphemers: for my
 trust is in thy word.
 O take not the word of thy truth utterly out of my month:
 for my hope is in thy judgments.
 So shall I alway keep thy law: yea, for ever and ever.
 And I will walk at liberty: for I seek thy commandments.
 I will speak of thy testimonies also, even before kings:
 and will not be ashamed.
 And my delight shall be in thy commandments: which I
 have loved.
 My hands also will I lift up unto thy commandments,
 which I have loved: and my study shall be in thy statutes.
 Glory, &c.
Psalm 119. (2)
 49-64.
 O think upon thy servant, as concerning thy word: where-
 in thou hast caused me to put my trust.
 The same is my comfort in my trouble: for thy word hath
 quickened me.
 The proud have had me exceedingly in derision: yet have
 I not shrinked from thy law.
 For I remembered thine everlasting judgments, O Lord:
 and received comfort.
 I am horribly afraid: for the ungodly that forsake thy
 law.
 Thy statutes have been my songs: in the house of my
 pilgrimage.
 I have thought upon thy Name, O Lord, in the night-
 season: and have kept thy law.
 This I had: because I kept thy commandments.
 Thou art my portion, O Lord: I have promised to keep
 thy law.

I made my humble petition in thy presence with my whole heart: O be merciful unto me, according to thy word.

I called mine own ways to remembrance: and turned my feet unto thy testimonies.

I made haste, and prolonged not the time: to keep thy commandments.

The congregations of the ungodly have robbed me: but I have not forgotten thy law.

At midnight I will rise to give thanks unto thee: because of thy righteous judgments.

I am a companion of all them that fear thee: and keep thy commandments.

The earth, O Lord, is full of thy mercy: O teach me thy statutes. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 119. (3)

65-80.

O Lord, thou hast dealt graciously with thy servant: according unto thy word.

O learn me true understanding and knowledge: for I have believed thy commandments.

Before I was troubled, I went wrong: but now have I kept thy word.

Thou art good and gracious: O teach me thy statutes.

The proud have imagined a lie against me: but I will keep thy commandments with my whole heart.

Their heart is as fat as brawn: but my delight hath been in thy law.

It is good for me that I have been in trouble: that I may learn thy statutes.

The law of thy mouth is dearer unto me: than thousands of gold and silver.

Thy hands have made me and fashioned me: O give me understanding, that I may learn thy commandments.

They that fear thee will be glad when they see me: because I have put my trust in thy word.

I know, O Lord, that thy judgments are right: and that thou of very faithfulness hast caused me to be troubled.

O let thy merciful kindness be my comfort: according to thy word unto thy servant.

O let thy loving mercies come unto me, that I may live: for thy law is my delight.

Let the proud be confounded, for they go wickedly about to destroy me: but I will be occupied in thy commandments.

Let such as fear thee, and have known thy testimonies: be turned unto me.

O let my heart be sound in thy statutes: that I be not
ashamed. Glory be, &c.

(kk) *Antiphon*

Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the Lord. Praise ye the Lord.

(ll) *Text*

(*Capitulum.*)

1 John iv. 16.

Minister.—God is love, and he that dwelleth in love,
dwelleth in God, and God in him.

Thanks be to God.

(mm) *Short Response.*

Incline my heart, O God: to thy Testimonies.

Incline, &c.

Turn away mine eyes, lest they behold vanity, and quicken
Thou me in Thy way.

To Thy testimonies.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Incline my heart, O God: to Thy testimonies.

I said, Lord, have mercy upon me.

Heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee.

Lord have mercy.

Christ have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

The Lord's Prayer

(*privately.*)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Turn us again, Lord God of hosts.

*Show us the light of Thy countenance and we shall be
whole.*

O Christ, arise, help us.

And deliver us for thy name's sake.

Lord, hear my prayer.

And let my cry come unto Thee.

(nn) *Collect*

(*for the day and week.*)

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

Grant to us, Lord, we beseech Thee, that the course of
this world may be so peaceably ordered by Thy providence,
that Thy Church may joyfully serve Thee in all godly
quietness, through the Lord.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the souls of the faithful through God's mercy rest in peace. *Amen.*

4. SIXTH HOUR SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(oo) *Hymn*

[Rector potens,

verax Deus.]

O God, the Lord of place and time,

Who orderest all things prudently,

Brightening with beams the opening prime,

And burning in the mid-day sky.

Quench Thou the fires of hate and strife,

The wasting fever of the heart;

From perils guard our feeble life,

And to our souls Thy peace impart.

This grace on Thy redeemed confer,

Father, Co-equal Son,

And Holy Ghost, the Comforter,

Eternal Three in One.—*Amen.*

(pp) *Antiphon*

Psalm 119. (1)

81-96.

Praise ye the Lord.

My soul hath longed for thy salvation: and I have a good hope, because of thy word.

Mine eyes long sore for thy word: saying, O when wilt thou comfort me?

For I am become like a bottle in the smoke: yet do I not forget thy statutes.

How many are the days of thy servant: when wilt thou be avenged of them that persecute me

The proud have digged pits for me: which are not after thy law.

All thy commandments are true: they persecute me falsely; O be thou my help.

They had almost made an end of me upon earth: but I forsook not thy commandments.

O quicken me after thy loving-kindness: and so shall I keep the testimonies of thy mouth.

O Lord, thy word: endureth for ever in heaven.
 Thy truth also remaineth from one generation to another:
 thou hast laid the foundation of the earth, and it abideth.
 They continue this day according to thine ordinance: for
 all things serve thee.
 If my delight had not been in thy law: I should have
 perished in my trouble.
 I will never forget thy commandments: for with them thou
 hast quickened me.
 I am thine, O save me: for I have sought thy command-
 ments.
 The ungodly laid wait for me, to destroy me: but I will
 consider thy testimonies.
 I see that all things come to an end: but thy command-
 ment is exceeding broad. Glory be, &c.
Psalms 119. (2)
 97-112. Lord, what love have I unto thy law: all the day long is
 my study in it!
 Thou, through thy commandments, hast made me wiser
 than mine enemies: for they are ever with me.
 I have more understanding than my teachers: for thy
 testimonies are my study.
 I am wiser than the aged: because I keep thy command-
 ments.
 I have refrained my feet from every evil way: that I may
 keep thy word.
 I have not shrunk from thy judgments: for thou teachest
 me.
 O how sweet are thy words unto my throat: yea, sweeter
 than honey unto my mouth!
 Through thy commandments I get understanding: there-
 fore I hate all evil ways.
 Thy word is a lantern unto my feet: and a light unto my
 paths.
 I have sworn, and am stedfastly purposed: to keep thy
 righteous judgments.
 I am troubled above measure: quicken me, O Lord, ac-
 cording to thy word.
 Let the free-will offerings of my mouth please thee, O
 Lord: and teach me thy judgments.
 My soul is always in my hand: yet do I not forget thy law.
 The ungodly have laid a snare for me: but yet I swerved
 not from thy commandments.
 Thy testimonies have I claimed as mine heritage for ever:
 and why? they are the very joy of my heart.

I have applied my heart to fulfil thy statutes always: even unto the end. Glory be, &c.

Psalms 119 (3)

113-128. I hate them that imagine evil things: but thy law do I love. Thou art my defence and shield: and my trust is in thy word.

Away from me, ye wicked: I will keep the commandments of my God.

O establish me according to thy word, that I may live: and let me not be disappointed of my hope.

Hold thou me up, and I shall be safe: yea, my delight shall be ever in thy statutes.

Thou hast trodden down all them that depart from thy statutes: for they imagine but deceit.

Thou puttest away all the ungodly of the earth like dross: therefore I love thy testimonies.

My flesh trembleth for fear of thee: and I am afraid of thy judgments.

I deal with the thing that is lawful and right: O give me not over unto mine oppressors.

Make thou thy servant to delight in that which is good: that the proud do me no wrong.

Mine eyes are wasted away with looking for thy health: and for the word of thy righteousness.

O deal with thy servant according unto thy loving-mercy: and teach me thy statutes.

I am thy servant; O grant me understanding; that I may know thy testimonies.

It is time for thee, Lord, to lay to thine hand: for they have destroyed thy law.

For I love thy commandments: above gold and precious stone.

Therefore hold I straight all thy commandments: and all false ways I utterly abhor. Glory be, &c.

(pp) *Antiphon* Praise ye the Lord. Hallelujah. Praise ye the Lord.

(qq) *Text.*

(*Capitulum.*)

Gal. vi. 2. *Minister.*—Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.

Thanks be to God.

(rr) *Short Response* O Lord, Thy word endureth: for ever in heaven. O Lord, &c.

Thy truth also remaineth from one generation to another.

For ever in heaven.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

O Lord, thy word endureth: for ever in heaven.

The Lord is my shepherd, therefore can I lack nothing.
He shall feed me in a green pasture.
 Lord have mercy.
Christ have mercy.
 Lord have mercy.
The Lord's Prayer
(privately.)
 Our Father, &c.
 And lead us not into temptation.
But deliver us from evil.
 Turn us again, O Lord God of hosts.
Show the light of Thy countenance, and we shall be whole.
 O Christ arise, help us.
And deliver us for Thy name-sake.
 O Lord, hear my prayer.
And let my crying come unto Thee.
 (ss) *Collect*
(for the day, &c.)
 The Lord be with you.
And with thy spirit.
 Let us pray.
 Grant to us, we beseech Thee, that the course of this
 world may be so peaceably ordered by thy governance, that
 Thy Church may joyfully serve Thee in all godly quietness,
 through the Lord.
 The Lord be with you.
And with thy spirit.
 Let us bless the Lord.
Thanks be to God.
 May the souls of the faithful, through God's mercy, rest
 in peace. *Amen.*

5. NINTH HOUR SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.
O Lord, make haste to help me.
 Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.
 (tt) *Hymn*
 [Rerum Deus
 tenax vigor.]
 O God, unchangeable and true,
 Of all the life and power,
 Dispensing light and silence through
 Every successive hour.
 Lord, brighten our declining day,
 That it may never wane,

Till death, when all things round decay,
Brings back the morn again.
This grace on thy redeemed confer,
Father, Co-equal Son,
And holy Ghost, the Comforter,
Eternal Three in One. *Amen.*

(uu) *Antiphon*

Psalm 119. (1)

119-144. Praise ye the Lord.

Thy testimonies are wonderful: therefore doth my soul
keep them.

When thy word goeth forth: it giveth light and under-
standing unto the simple.

I opened my mouth, and drew in my breath: for my de-
light was in thy commandments.

O look thou upon me, and be merciful unto me; as thou
usest to do unto those that love thy Name.

Order my steps in thy word: and so shall no wickedness
have dominion over me.

O deliver me from the wrongful dealings of men; and so
shall I keep thy commandments.

Shew the light of thy countenance upon thy servant: and
teach me thy statutes.

Mine eyes gush out with water: because men keep not
thy law.

Righteous art thou, O Lord: and true is thy judgment!

The testimonies that thou hast commanded: are exceed-
ing righteous and true.

My zeal hath even consumed me, because mine enemies
have forgotten thy words.

Thy word is tried to the uttermost: and thy servant
loveth it.

I am small and of no reputation: yet do I not forget thy
commandments.

Thy righteousness is an everlasting righteousness: and thy
law is the truth.

Trouble and heaviness have taken hold upon me: yet is
my delight in thy commandments.

The righteousness of thy testimonies is everlasting: O
grant me understanding, and I shall live. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 119. (2)

145-160. I call with my whole heart: hear me, O Lord, I will keep
thy statutes.

Yea, even unto thee do I call: help me, and I shall keep
thy testimonies.

Early in the morning do I cry unto thee: for in thy word is my trust.

Mine eyes prevent the night-watches: that I might be occupied in thy words.

Hear my voice, O Lord, according unto thy loving-kindness: quicken me according as thou art wont.

They draw nigh that of malice persecute me: and are far from thy law.

Be thou nigh at hand, O Lord, for all thy commandments are true.

As concerning thy testimonies I have known long since: that thou hast grounded them for ever.

O consider mine adversity, and deliver me: for I do not forget thy law.

Avenge thou my cause, and deliver me: quicken me according to thy word.

Health is far from the ungodly: for they regard not thy statutes.

Great is thy mercy, O Lord: quicken me, as thou art wont.

Many there are that trouble me, and persecute me: yet do I not swerve from thy testimonies.

It grieveth me when I see the transgressors: because they keep not thy law.

Consider, O Lord, how I love thy commandments: O quicken me according to thy loving-kindness.

Thy word is true from everlasting: all the judgments of thy righteousness endure for evermore. Glory be, &c.

Psalms 119. (3)

161-176. Princes have persecuted me without a cause: but my heart standeth in awe of thy word.

I am as glad of thy word: as one that findeth great spoils.

As for lies, I hate and abhor them: but thy law do I love.

Seven times a day do I praise thee: because of thy righteous judgments.

Great is the peace that they have who love thy law: and they are not offended at it.

Lord, I have looked for thy saving health: and done after thy commandments.

My soul hath kept thy testimonies: and loved them exceedingly.

I have kept thy commandments and testimonies: for all my ways are before thee.

Let my complaint come before thee, O Lord: give me understanding according to thy word.

Let my supplication come before thee: deliver me according to thy word.

My lips shall speak of thy praise: when thou hast taught me thy statutes.

Yea, my tongue shall sing of thy word: for all thy commandments are righteous.

Let thine hand help me: for I have chosen thy commandments.

I have longed for thy saving health, O Lord: and in thy law is my delight.

O let my soul live, and it shall praise thee: and thy judgments shall help me.

I have gone astray like a sheep that is lost: O seek thy servant; for I do not forget thy commandments. Glory be, &c.

(uu) *Antiphon* Praise ye the Lord. Hallelujah. Praise ye the Lord.

(vv) *Test*

(*Capitulum.*)

1 Cor. iv. 20.

Minister.—For ye are bought with a price. Therefore glorify God in your body.

Thanks be to God.

(ww) *Short Response* I call with my whole heart: hear me, O Lord. I call, &c.

I will keep Thy statutes.

Hear me, O Lord.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

I call with my whole heart: hear me, O Lord.

Cleanse Thou me, O Lord, from my secret faults.

Keep back Thy servant also from presumptuous sins.

Lord have mercy.

Christ have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

The Lord's Prayer

(*privately.*) Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil.

Turn us again, Lord God of hosts.

Show us the light of Thy countenance and we shall be whole.

O Christ, arise, help us.

And deliver us for thy name's sake.

Lord, hear my prayer.

And let my cry come unto thee.

(xx) *Collect*

(*for the day, &c.*)

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

Grant to us, Lord, we beseech Thee, that the course of this world may be so peaceably ordered by Thy providence, that Thy Church may joyfully serve Thee in all godly quietness, through the Lord.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the souls of the faithful, through God's mercy, rest in peace. *Amen.*

6. VESPER SERVICE

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(yy) *Antiphon* (1)

Psalm 110. (1)

The Lord said

... unto my Lord: Sit thou on my right hand, until I make thine enemies thy footstool.

The Lord shall send the rod of thy power out of Sion: be thou ruler, even in the midst among thine enemies.

In the day of thy power shall the people offer thee free-will offerings with an holy worship: the dew of thy birth is of the womb of the morning.

The Lord aware, and will not repent: Thou art a Priest for ever after the order of Melchisedech.

The Lord upon thy right hand: shall wound even kings in the day of his wrath.

He shall judge among the heathen; he shall fill the places with the dead bodies: and smite in sunder the heads over divers countries.

He shall drink of the brook in the way: therefore shall he lift up his head. Glory be, &c.

(yy) *Antiphon* (1) The Lord said unto my Lord: Sit Thou on my right hand.

(zz) *Antiphon*. (2)

Psalm 111. (2)

All His commandments.

I will give thanks unto the Lord with my whole heart: secretly among the faithful, and in the congregation.

The works of the Lord are great: sought out of all them that have pleasure therein.

His work is worthy to be praised, and had in honour: and his righteousness endureth for ever.

The merciful and gracious Lord hath so done his marvelous works: that they ought to be had in remembrance.

He hath given meat unto them that fear him: he shall ever be mindful of his covenant.

He hath showed his people the power of his works; that he may give them the heritage of the heathen.

The works of his hands are verity and judgment: all his commandments are true.

They stand fast for ever and ever: amid are done in truth and equity.

He sent redemption unto his people: he hath commanded his covenant for ever; holy and reverend is his Name.

The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom: a good understanding have all they that do thereafter; the praise of it endureth for ever. Glory be, &c.

(zz) *Antiphon* (2) All his commandments are true: they stand fast for ever and ever.

(aaa) *Antiphon* (3)

Psalm 112. (3)

He hath great delight.

Blessed is the man that feareth the Lord; he hath great delight in his commandments.

His seed shall be mighty upon earth: the generation of the faithful shall be blessed.

Riches and plenteousness shall be in his house: and his righteousness endureth for ever.

Unto the godly there ariseth up light in the darkness: he is merciful, loving, and righteous.

A good man is merciful, and lendeth: and will guide his words with discretion.

For he shall never be moved: and the righteous shall be had in everlasting remembrance.

He will not be afraid of any evil tidings: for his heart standeth fast, and believeth in the Lord.

His heart is established, and will not shrink: until he see his desire upon his enemies.

He hath dispersed abroad, and given to the poor: and his righteousness remaineth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.

The ungodly shall see it, and it shall grieve him: he shall gnash with his teeth, and consume away; the desire of the ungodly shall perish. Glory be, &c.

(aaa) *Antiphon* (3) He hath great delight in his commandments.

(bbb) *Antiphon* (4)

Psalm 113. (4) The name of the Lord.

Praise the Lord, ye servants: O praise the name of the Lord.

Blessed be the Name of the Lord: from this time forth for evermore.

The Lord's name is praised: from the rising up of the sun, unto the going down of the same.

The Lord is high above all heathen: and his glory above the heavens.

Who is like unto the Lord our God, that hath his dwelling so high: and yet humbleth himself to behold the things that are in heaven and earth?

He taketh up the simple out of the dust: and lifteth the poor out of the mire.

That he may set him with the princes: even with the princes of his people.

He maketh the barren woman to keep house: and to be a joyful mother of children. Glory be, &c.

(bbb) *Antiphon* (4) Blessed be the name of the Lord for evermore.

(ccc) *Antiphon* (5)

Psalm 114 and

115. (5)

We who live.

When Israel came out of Egypt: and the house of Jacob from among the strange people,

Judah was his sanctuary: and Israel his dominion.

The sea saw that, and fled: Jordan was driven back.

The mountains skipped like rams: and the little hills like young sheep.

What aileth thee, O thou sea, that thou fleddest: and thou Jordan, that thou wast driven back?

Ye mountains, that ye skipped like rams: and ye little hills like young sheep?

Tremble, thou earth, at the presence of the Lord: at the presence of the God of Jacob;

Who turned the hard rock into a standing water: and the flint-stone into a springing well.

Not unto us, O Lord, not unto us, but unto thy Name give the praise: for thy loving mercy, and for thy truth's sake.

Wherefore shall the heathen say: Where is now their God?

As for our God, he is in heaven: he hath done whatsoever pleased him.

Their idols are silver and gold: even the work of men's

hands.

They have mouths and speak not: eyes have they, and see not.

They have ears and hear not: noses have they and smell not.

They have hands, and handle not; feet have they, and walk not: neither speak they through their throat.

They that make them are like unto them: and so are all such as put their trust in them.

But thou, house of Israel, trust thou in the Lord: he is their succour and defence.

Ye house of Aaron, put your trust in the Lord: he is their helper and defender.

Ye that fear the Lord, put your trust in the Lord: he is their helper and defender.

The Lord hath been mindful of us, and he shall bless us: even he shall bless the house of Israel, he shall bless the the house of Aaron.

He shall bless them that fear the Lord: both small and great.

The Lord shall increase you more and more: you and your children.

Ye are the blessed of the Lord: who made heaven and earth.

All the whole heavens are the Lord's: the earth hath he given to the children of men.

The dead praise not thee, O Lord: neither all they that go down into silence.

But we will praise the Lord: from this time forth for evermore. Praise the Lord. Glory be, &c.

(ccc) *Antiphon* (5) We who live will praise the Lord.

(ddd) *Text*

(*Capitulum.*)

2 *Cor.* i. 3, 4.

Minister.—Blessed be God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies, and the God of all comfort, who comforteth us in all our tribulation.

Thanks be to God.

(eee) *Hymn*

[*Lucis creator
optime.*]

Father of Lights, by whom each day,

Is kindled out of night;

Who, when the heavens were made, didst lay

Their rudiments in light:

Thou, who didst bind and blend in one,
The glistening morn and evening pale,
Hear Thou our plaint, when light is gone
And lawlessness and strife prevail.
Hear, lest the whelming weight of crime
Wreck us with life in view
Lest thoughts and schemes of sense and time
Earn us a sinner's due.
So may we knock at heaven's door,
And strive the prize of life to win
Continually and evermore
Guarded without and pure within.
This grace on Thy redeemed confer,
Father, Co-equal Son,
And Holy Ghost the Comforter,
Eternal Three in One. *Amen.*

(fff) Verse and Response

Let my prayer be set forth

In thy sight as the incense.

(ggg)

Ant. Magnificat Master, we have toiled all the night.
My soul doth magnify the Lord: and my spirit hath
rejoiced in God my Saviour.
For he hath regarded: the lowliness of his handmaiden.
For, behold, from henceforth: all generations shall call
me blessed.
For he that is mighty hath magnified me: and holy is
his Name.

And his mercy is on them that fear him: throughout all
generations.
He hath shewed strength with his arm: he hath scattered
the proud in the imagination of their hearts.
He hath put down the mighty from their seat: and hath
exalted the humble and meek.
He hath filled the hungry with good things: and the rich
he hath sent empty away.
He remembering his mercy, hath holpen his servant
Israel: as he promised to our forefathers, Abraham and
his seed for ever. Glory be, &c.

(ggg) Antiphon Master, we have toiled all the night and have taken
nothing; nevertheless, at Thy word I will let down the net.

(hhh) Collect

(for the day, &c.)

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

Grant to us, Lord, we beseech Thee, that the course of this world may be so peaceably ordered by Thy providence, that Thy Church may joyfully serve Thee in all godly quietness through the Lord. *Amen.*

The following Com- memorations are read at Lauds also.

Antiphon

Holy Mary, succour the wretched, help the weak-hearted, comfort the mourners, pray for the people, interpose for the clergy, intercede for the devoted women: let all feel thy help, whoso celebrate thy holy commemoration.

Pray for us, Holy Mother of God.

That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.

Let us pray.

Collect Grant, O Lord God, we beseech Thee, that we thy servants may enjoy perpetual health of mind and body, and, by the glorious intercession of the Ever-Virgin Mary, may be delivered from present sorrow, and so have the fruition of everlasting joy.

Antiphon

Peter the Apostle, and Paul the teacher of the Gentiles, they have taught us Thy law, O Lord.

Thou shalt make them princes in all lands.

They shall remember Thy name from one generation to another.

Let us pray.

O God, who when thy Apostle Peter walked on the waves, savedst him from drowning with Thy right hand, and thrice delivered his fellow Apostle Paul from shipwreck on the open sea, favourably hear us, and grant, that by the deserts of both of them we may obtain everlasting glory.

Antiphon

Give peace, in our time, O Lord, because there is none other that fighteth for us, but only Thou, O God.

Peace be within Thy walls.

And plenteousness within Thy palaces.

Let us pray.

Collect O God, from whom all holy desires, all good counsels, and all just works do proceed, give unto Thy servants that peace which the world cannot give; that both our hearts may be set to obey Thy commandments, and also that by Thee we being defended from the fear of our enemies, may pass our time in rest and quietness, through Jesus Christ our Lord, who liveth and reigneth with Thee in the unity of the Holy Ghost, one God, world without end. *Amen.*

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the souls of the faithful, through God's mercy, rest
in peace. *Amen.*

7. COMPLINE SERVICE

Reader.—Sir, pray for a blessing.

Benediction Minister.—The Lord Almighty grant us a quiet night and
an end of toils. *Amen.*

Short Lesson

1 *Pet.* v. 8. Brethren, be sober, be vigilant; for your adversary the
devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may
devour; whom resist stedfast in the faith.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Our help is in the name of the Lord,

Who hath made heaven and earth.

The Lord's Prayer

(*privately.*) Our Father, &c.

(*vide supra, Prime Service.*) *Minister.*—I confess before God Almighty, before the
blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the Blessed Michael Archangel,
the blessed John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul,
before all Saints, and you, my brethren, that I have sinned
too much in thought, word, and deed. It is my fault,
my fault, my grievous fault. Therefore I beseech the
blessed Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel,
the blessed John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul,
all Saints, and you, my brethren, to pray the Lord our God
for me.

People.—*Almighty God, pity thee, absolve thee from thy sins, and bring thee safe to life everlasting.*
Amen.

People.—I confess before God Almighty, before the blessed
Mary, Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel, the
blessed John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul,
before all Saints, and thee, my father, that I have sinned too
much in thought, word, and deed. It is my fault, my fault,
my grievous fault. Therefore I beseech the blessed Mary,
Ever-Virgin, the blessed Michael Archangel, the blessed
John Baptist, the Holy Apostles Peter and Paul, all Saints,
and thee, my father, to pray the Lord our God for me.

Minister.—Almighty God pity you, absolve you from your
sins, and bring you safe to everlasting life. *Amen.*

The Almighty and merciful Lord grant to us pardon, ab-

solution, and remission of all our sins. *Amen.* Turn thou us, O Lord our Saviour.

And let thine anger cease from us.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c.

Antiphon

Psalm 4. Have mercy upon me.

Hear me, when I call, O God of my righteousness: thou hast set me at liberty when I was in trouble: have mercy upon me, and hearken unto my prayer.

O ye sons of men, how long will ye blaspheme mine honour: and have such pleasure in vanity, and seek after leasing?

Know this also, that the Lord hath chosen to himself the man that is godly: when I call upon the Lord, he will hear me.

Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart, and in your chamber, and be still.

Offer the sacrifice of righteousness: and put your trust in the Lord.

There be many that say: who will show us any good?

Lord, lift thou up: the light of thy countenance upon us.

Thou hast put gladness in my heart: since the time that their corn, and wine, and oil increased.

I will lay me down in peace, and take my rest: for it is thou, Lord, only, that makest me dwell in safety. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 31. In thee, O Lord, have I put my trust: let me never be put to confusion: deliver me in thy righteousness.

Bow down thine ear to me: make haste to deliver me.

And be thou my strong rock, and house of defence: that thou mayest save me.

For thou art my strong rock and my castle: be thou also my guide, and lead me for thy Name's sake.

Draw me out of the net that they have laid privily for me: for thou art my strength.

Into thy hands I commend my spirit: for thou hast redeemed me, O Lord, thou God of truth. Glory be, &c.

Psalm 91. Whoso dwelleth under the defence of the Most High: shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty.

I will say unto the Lord, Thou art my hope, and my strong hold: my God, in him will I trust.

For he shall deliver thee from the snare of the hunter: and from the noisome pestilence.

He shall defend thee under his wings, and thou shalt be safe under his feathers: his faithfulness and truth shall be thy

shield and buckler.

Thou shalt not be afraid for any terror by night: nor for the arrow that flieth by day.

For the pestilence that walketh in darkness: nor for the sickness that destroyeth in the noon-day.

A thousand shall fall beside thee, and ten thousand at thy right hand: but it shall not come nigh thee.

Yea, with thine eyes shalt thou behold: and see the reward of the ungodly.

For thou, Lord, art my hope: thou hast set thine house of defence very high.

There shall no evil happen unto thee: neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling.

For he shalt give his angels charge over thee: to keep thee in all thy ways.

They shall bear thee in their hands: that thou hurt not thy foot against a stone.

Thou shalt go upon the lion and adder: the young lion and the dragon shalt thou tread under thy feet.

Because he hath set his love upon me, therefore will I deliver him: I will set him up, because he hath known my Name.

He shalt call upon me, and I will hear him: yea, I am with him in trouble: I will deliver him, and bring him to honour.

With long life will I satisfy him: and show him my salvation. Glory be, &c.

Psalms 134. Behold now, praise the Lord: all ye servants of the Lord;

Ye that by night stand in the house of the Lord: even in the courts of the house of our God,

Lift up your hands in the sanctuary: and praise the Lord.

The Lord, that made heaven and earth: give thee blessing out of Sion. Glory be, &c.

Antiphon Have mercy upon me, O Lord, and hearken unto my prayer.

Hymn

[Te lucia ante

terminum.]

Now that the day-light dies away

Ere we lie down and sleep,

Thee, Maker of the world, we pray

To own us and to keep.

Let dreams depart and visions fly,

The offspring of the night;

Keep us, like shrines, beneath Thine eye,

Pure in our foe's despite.
This grace on Thy redeemed confer,
Father, Co-equal Son,
And Holy Ghost the Comforter,
Eternal Three in One. *Amen.*

Text Jer. xiv, 9.

Minister.—Thou, O Lord, art in the midst of us, and we
are called by thy name; leave us not, O Lord, our God.

Thanks be to God.

Short Response Into thy hands, O Lord, I commend my spirit.

Into thy hands, &c.

For thou hast redeemed me, O Lord God of Truth.

I commend my spirit.

Glory be, &c.

Into thine hands, &c.

Keep us, O Lord, as the apple of an eye.

Hide us under the shadow of Thy wings.

Antiphon Save us, O Lord.

Nunc Dimittis Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace: ac-
cording to thy word.

For mine eyes have seen: thy salvation.

Which thou hast prepared: before the face of all people;

To be a light to lighten the Gentiles: and to be the glory
of thy people Israel. Glory be, &c.

Antiphon Save us, O Lord, when we are awake, guard us when we
are asleep, that we may be with Christ when awake, and
may rest in peace.

Lord, have mercy.

Christ, have mercy.

Lord, have mercy.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.) Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil.

The Creed

(privately.) I believe, &c.

The resurrection of the body,

And the life everlasting. Amen.

Blessed art Thou, O Lord God of our fathers.

Greatly to be praised, and glorious for ever.

Let us bless the Father and the Son, with the Holy Ghost.

Let us praise and exalt Him for ever.

Blessed art Thou, O Lord, in the firmament of heaven.

*And greatly to be praised, and glorious, and highly exalted
for ever.*

The Almighty and merciful Lord bless and protect us.

Amen.

Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep us,

This night without sin.

Have mercy upon us, O Lord,

Have mercy upon us.

O Lord, let Thy mercy be showed upon us.

As we do put our trust in Thee.

Lord, hear my prayer.

And let my cry come unto Thee.

The Lord be with you,

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

Collect Look down, we beseech Thee, O Lord, upon this dwelling, and drive far from it all snares of the enemy! let Thy holy angels dwell in it, and preserve us in peace, and let Thy blessing ever be upon us, through the Lord. *Amen.*

The Lord be with you,

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be given to God.

Benediction The Almighty and merciful Lord, the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Ghost, bless and preserve us. *Amen.*

(This is one of the four Anti- phons animad- verted on, pp.

11 and 23.) Hail, Queen! mother of mercy, our life, sweetness, and hope, hail! We exiles cry to thee, the children of Eve.

To thee we sigh with groans and weeping in this valley of tears. Come then, O our advocate, turn on us thy merciful eyes, and shew to us, after this banishment, Jesus, the blessed fruit of thy womb. O kind, O pitiful, O sweet Virgin Mary.

Pray for us, holy mother of God,

That we may be made worthy of the promises of Christ.

Collect Almighty everlasting God, who hast prepared the body and soul of Mary the glorious Virgin Mother, to be a fit dwelling for Thy Son, by the co-operation of the Holy Ghost, grant that we, who are gladdened by this commemoration of her, may by her pitiful intercession be delivered from present ills, and eternal death, through the same Jesus Christ our Lord. *Amen.*

The help of God remain with us always. *Amen.*

§ 3. Week-day Service.

For First Monday in Advent

O Lord, open Thou, &c.

And my mouth, &c.

God, make speed, &c.

O Lord, make haste, &c.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(a) *Invitatory*

O come let us worship the Lord, the King approaching.

O come let us sing, &c.

Glory, &c.

(b) *Hymn* Verbum supernum prodiens, &c.

Antiphon Psalm 27. (1)

Psalm 28. (2)

Antiphon

The Lord is the strength.

The Lord is my light, &c. Glory, &c.

Unto Thee will I cry, &c. Glory, &c.

The Lord is the strength of my life.

Antiphon Psalm 29. (3)

Psalm 30. (4)

Antiphon

Worship the Lord.

Bring unto the Lord, &c. Glory, &c.

I will magnify Thee, &c. Glory, &c.

Worship the Lord with holy worship.

Antiphon Psalm 31. (5)

Psalm 32. (6)

Antiphon

Deliver me.

In the, O God, have I put, &c. Glory, &c.

Blessed is he, &c. Glory, &c.

Deliver me in Thy righteousness.

Antiphon Psalm 33. (7)

Psalm 34. (8)

Antiphon

It becometh well the just.

Rejoice in the Lord, &c. Glory, &c.

I will alway give thanks, &c. Glory, &c.

It becometh well the just to be thankful.

Antiphon Psalm 35. (9)

Psalm 36. (10)

Antiphon

Fight thou against them.

Plead thou my cause, &c. Glory, &c.

My heart showeth me, &c. Glory, &c.
Fight Thou against them, that fight against me.

Antiphon

Psalm 37. (11)

Psalm 38. (12)

Antiphon

Commit thy way.

Fret not thyself, &c. Glory, &c.

Put me not to rebuke, &c. Glory, &c.

Commit thy way unto the Lord.

(f.) V.

Out of Sion hath God appeared.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not. &c.

But deliver us, &c.

Absolution 1.

O Lord Jesu Christ, hear the prayers of Thy servants,
and have mercy upon us, who with the Father, &c.

Benediction 1.

Lesson 1.

Isai. i. 16-18.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

The Father everlasting, &c.

Wash you, wake you clean; put away the evil of your
doings from before Mine eyes; cease to do evil;

Learn to do well; seek judgment, relieve the oppressed;
judge the fatherless; plead for the widow:

Come now and let us reason together, saith the Lord;
though your sins be as scarlet, they shall be as white as
snow; though they be red like crimson, they shall be as
wool.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 1.

*Cherish the word, O Virgin Mary, which is conveyed to thee from the Lord through the Angel; thou shalt
conceive in thy womb, and bring forth both God and man: that thou mayest be blessed among all women.*

Thou shalt bring forth a son, and yet abide a virgin:
thou shalt be with child, and be a mother, yet know not a
man.

That thou mayest be blessed among women.

Benediction 2.

Lesson 2.

Isai. i. 19-23.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

The only begotten Son of God, &c.

If ye be willing and obedient, ye shall eat the good of the land: but if ye refuse and rebel, ye shall be devoured with the sword, for the mouth of the Lord hath spoken it.

How is the faithful city become an harlot? It was full of judgment; righteousness lodged in it, but now murderers.

Thy silver is become dross, thy wine mixed with water; thy princes are rebellious and companions of thieves: every one loveth gifts, and followeth after rewards: they judge not the fatherless, neither doth the cause of the widow come unto them.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 2.

Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad, let the hills be joyful together, for our Lord shall come, and He shall have pity upon the poor.

In His time shall the righteous flourish; yes, and abundance of peace.

And he shall have pity upon the poor.

Benediction 3.

Lesson 3.

Isai. i. 24-28.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

The grace of the Holy Ghost, &c.

Therefore saith the Lord, the Lord of hosts, the mighty One of Israel, Ah, I will ease Me of Mine adversaries, and avenge me of Mine enemies.

And I will turn My hand upon thee, and purely purge away thy dross, and take away all thy tin;

And I will restore thy judges as at the first, and thy counsellors as at the beginning: afterward thou shalt be called the city of righteousness, the faithful city.

Zion shall be redeemed with judgment, and her courts with righteousness.

And the destruction of the transgressors and of the sinners shall be together, and they that forsake the Lord shall be consumed.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 3.

Strangers shall not pass through Jerusalem any more; for in that day the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, saith the Lord.

God shall come from Libanus, and the holy one from the

mount of cedars.

For in that day, the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, saith the Lord.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

For in that day the mountains, &c.

LAUDS

O God, make speed, &c.

O Lord, make haste, &c.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

Antiphon

Psalm 51. (1)

Antiphon Have mercy upon me.

... O God, after Thy great goodness, &c. Glory, &c.

Have mercy upon me, O God.

Antiphon

Psalm 5. (2)

Antiphon

Consider, O Lord.

Ponder my word, &c. Glory, &c.

Consider, O Lord, my meditation.

Antiphon

Psalms 63 & 67. (3)

Antiphon

O God, Thou art my God.

... Early will I seek Thee, &c. Glory, &c.

O God, Thou art my God, early will I seek thee.

Antiphon

Canticle. Isa. xii. (4)

Antiphon

Thine anger is turned away.

O Lord, I will praise Thee, &c. Glory, &c.

Thine anger is turned away, and thou comfortedst me.

Antiphon

Ps. 148-151. (5)

Antiphon

O praise the Lord.

... of heaven, praise him in the height, &c. Glory, &c.

O praise the Lord of heaven.

Text

(Capitulum.)

(t) Isai. ii. 3.

Come ye and let us go up to the mountain of the Lord, to the house of the God of Jacob; and He will teach us of His ways, and we will walk in His paths; for out of Zion

shall go forth the Law, and the Word of the Lord from Jerusalem.

Thanks be to God.

(u) *Hymn* En clara vox redarguit, &c.

(v) *Verse and Response*

The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord.

Make His paths straight.

(w) *Antiphon The Benedictus*

The Angel of the Lord made annunciation to Mary.

Blessed be the Lord God, &c.

Antiphon

The Angel of the Lord made annunciation to Mary, and she conceived of the Holy Ghost. Hallelujah.

(This portion of the Service down to the Collect, is pro- per to the Week- days of Advent, the Four Seasons, and Vigils, which are Fasts, except Christ- mas Eve; it is re- peated at Vespers after the Magnifi- cat with Psalm 51 for Psalm 130. The Lord's Prayer is all aloud.)

Lord have mercy.

Christ have mercy.

Lord have mercy.

Our Father which art in heaven, hallowed be Thy name,
Thy kingdom come, Thy will be done in earth, as it is in
heaven, Give us this day our daily bread, And forgive us our
trespasses, as we forgive them that trespass against us.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

I said, Lord, be merciful unto me.

Heal my soul, for I have sinned against thee.

Turn Thee again, O Lord, at the last.

And be gracious unto Thy servants.

Let Thy merciful kindness, O Lord, be upon us.

Like as we do put our trust in Thee.

Let Thy priests be clothed with righteousness.

And let Thy saints sing with joyfulness.

O Lord, save the king.

And hear us what time we call upon Thee.

O save Thy people, and give Thy blessing unto Thine inheritance.

Feed them and set them up for ever.

O think upon Thy congregation.

Whom Thou hast purchased and redeemed of old.

Peace be within Thy walls.

And plenteousness within Thy palaces.

Let us pray for the faithful who are departed.

Grant them, O Lord, eternal repose, and may perpetual light shine upon them.

May they rest in peace.

Amen.

For our brethren who are away.

My God, save Thy servants that put their trust in Thee.

For the afflicted and for captives.

Deliver Israel, O Lord, out of all his troubles.

Send thou help from the sanctuary.

And strengthen them out of Sion.

Lord, hear my prayer.

And let my cry come unto Thee.

Psalm 130.

Out of the deep, &c. Glory, &c.

Turn us again, Lord God of hosts.

Show the light of Thy countenance and we shall be whole.

Arise, O Christ, help us.

And deliver us for Thy name's sake.

Lord, hear my prayer.

And let my cry come unto Thee.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

(x) *Collect*

(*Oratio.*)

(*for the day and week.*)

Raise up, we pray Thee, O Lord, Thy power, and come,
that we, being meet, may be snatched from the perils of our
sins by thy succour, and be saved by Thy deliverance, who
livest, &c.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the souls of the faithful rest in peace.

Amen.

PRIME

(Here are marked merely the differences from the 4th Sunday in Pentecost. Some of them, as in Matins and Lauds, are but peculiar to the season.)

Antiphon

Psalm 54. (1)

Psalm 24. (2)

Psalm 119. (3)

1-32.

16-32. (4) In that day the mountains shall drop down new wine.

Save me, O God, &c. Glory, &c. (*as on Sunday.*)

The earth is the Lord's, &c. Glory, &c.

Blessed are those, &c. (*as on Sunday.*)

O do well, &c. (*as on Sunday.*)

Antiphon

In that day the mountains shall drop down new wine, and
the hills shall flow with milk. Hallelujah.

(cc) *Text*

(*Capitulum.*)

Zech. viii. 19, 20.

Minister.—Love the Truth and Peace, saith the Lord of
hosts.

Thanks be to God.

(dd) *Short Response*

(*the same except instead of Thou that sittest, &c.*) (ee)

O Christ, &c.

Thou that shall come into the world—

Lord have mercy, &c.

The Lord's Prayer

The Creed

Sentences

Our Father, &c.

I believe, &c.

I have cried, &c. (*down to*)

And stablish me, &c.

(*These additional Sentences are insert- ed, whenever there are the additional Sentences & Psalms as above
set down in Lauds and Ves- pers.*) Deliver me, O Lord, from the evil man.

And preserve me from the wicked man.

Deliver me from mine enemies, O God.

Defend me from them that rise up against me.

O deliver me from the wicked doers.

And save me from the blood-thirsty men.

So will I always sing praise unto Thy name.

That I may daily perform my vows.

Hear us, O God of our salvation.

Thou that art the hope of all the ends of the earth, and of them that remain in the broad sea.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Holy God, holy and strong, holy and eternal.

Have mercy upon us.

Bless the Lord, O my soul.

And all that is within me, bless His holy Name.

Bless the Lord, O my soul.

And forget not all His benefits.

Who forgiveth all thy sin.
And healeth all thine infirmities.
 Who saveth thy life from destruction.
And crowneth thee with mercy and loving-kindness.
 Who satisfieth thy mouth with good things.
Making thee young and lusty as an eagle.
 Our help is, &c.
The Confessions, Answers, and Prayer of Absolution.
 I confess, &c. God Almighty, &c. I confess, &c. God
 Almighty, &c. The Almighty, &c. vouchsafe, &c.
Collect
 O Lord, God Almighty, &c.
(And so on to the end, as on the 4th Sunday in Pentecost, with the substitution of the following.)
 (ii) *Short Lesson*
Isai. xxxiii. 2.
 O Lord, be gracious unto us. We have waited for Thee.
 Be Thou our arm every morning; our salvation also in the
 time of trouble.

THIRD HOUR

The following are the only variations.
 (kk) *Antiphon (before and after the Psalms.)*
 Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion: shout, O daughter of
 Jerusalem. Hallelujah.
 (ll) *Text*
(Capitulum.)
Jer. xxxiii. 5.
 Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, that I will raise
 unto David a righteous Branch, and a King shall reign and
 prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth.
 (mm) *Short Response*
Come thou and save us: O Lord God of hosts.
Come Thou, &c.
 Show the light of thy countenance and we shall be whole.
O Lord God of Hosts.
 Glory be to the Father, &c.
Come Thou and save us, O Lord God of hosts.
 The heathen shall fear Thy name, O Lord.
And all the kings of the earth Thy majesty.
 nn) *Collect*
(for the week.) (as in Lauds.)

SIXTH HOUR

(The variations are)

(pp) Antiphon (be- fore and after the Psalms.)

Behold, the Lord shall come, and all His Saints with Him,
and the light of that day shall be great. Hallelujah.

(qq) Text

(Capitulum.)

Jer. xxiii. 6.

In His days Judah shall be saved, and Israel shall dwell
safely; and this is the name whereby He shall be called,
The Lord our righteousness.

(rr) Short Response

Show us Thy mercy: O Lord.

Show us, &c.

And grant us Thy Salvation.

O Lord.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Show us Thy mercy: O Lord.

Remember me, O Lord, according to the favour that Thou
bearest unto Thy people.

O visit me with Thy Salvation.

(ss) Collect for the week (as before.)

NINTH HOUR

(The variations are)

(uu) Antiphon (be- fore and after the Psalms.)

Behold, the great Prophet shall come, and He shall re-
build Jerusalem. Hallelujah.

(vv) Text

(Capitulum.)

Isai. xiv. 1.

His time is near to come, and his days shall not be pro-
longed: for the Lord will have mercy on Jacob, and will yet
choose Israel.

(ww) Short Response

The Lord shall arise upon thee: O Jerusalem.

The Lord, &c.

And His glory shall be seen upon thee.

O Jerusalem.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

The Lord shall arise upon thee: O Jerusalem.

Turn us again, O Lord God of Hosts.

Show the light of thy countenance, and we shall be whole.

(xx) Collect for the week. (as before.)

VESPERS

Antiphon

Psalm 116 (part 1) (l)

Antiphon

O God, make speed, &c.

O Lord, make haste, &c.

He hath inclined.

I am well pleased, &c. Glory, &c.

He hath inclined His ear unto me.

Antiphon

Psalm 116 (part 2)

(2)

Antiphon

I believed

... and therefore will I speak, &c. Glory, &c.

I believed, and therefore will I speak.

Antiphon

Psalm 117. (3)

Antiphon

O Praise the Lord.

... all ye heathen, &c. Glory, &c.

O Praise the Lord, all ye heathen.

Antiphon

Psalm 120. (4)

Antiphon

I called upon the Lord.

When I was in trouble, &c. Glory, &c.

I called upon the Lord, and He heard me.

Antiphon

Psalm 121. (5)

Antiphon

From whence cometh.

I will lift up, &c. Glory, &c.

From whence cometh my help.

(ddd) *Text Capitulum*

Gen. xlix. 10.

The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver
from between his feet, until Shiloh come: and unto Him shall
the gathering of the people be.

Hymn

Creator alme siderum, &c.

(fff) *Verse and Response*

Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour

down Righteousness.

Let the earth open, and let them bring forth Salvation.

(ggg) *Antiphon*

Lift up thine eyes, O Jerusalem.

The Magnificat

My soul doth magnify, &c.

Antiphon

Lift up thine eyes, O Jerusalem, and behold the greatness of thy king. Behold, the Saviour comes to loose thee from thy chain.

(Then follow the same Sentences with Psalm 51, instead of Psalm 130, which are inserted in Lauds.)

(hhh) *The Collect for the week (as before.)*

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us bless the Lord.

Thanks be to God.

May the souls of the faithful rest in peace.

Amen.

COMPLINE

This office is invariable throughout the year, except in the Anthems to the Virgin at the end.

Instead of the Salve Regina as after Pentecost, in Advent is used the Alma Redemptoris.

§ 4. Part of the Service for August 6th.

The Feast of the Transfiguration

MATINS

O Lord, open thou my lips.

And my mouth shall show forth thy praise.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(a) *Invitatory* Let us worship Christ Most High, the King of Glory.

Let us worship, &c.

Psalm 95. O come, let us sing unto the Lord: let us heartily rejoice in the strength of our salvation.

Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving: and show ourselves glad in him with psalms.

Let us worship Christ, &c.

For the Lord is a great God: and a great King above all

gods.

In his hand are all the corners of the earth: and the strength of the hills is his also.

The King of Glory.

The sea is his, and he made it: and his hands prepared the dry land.

O come, let us worship and fall down: and kneel before the Lord our Maker;

For he is the Lord our God: and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand.

Let us worship Christ, &c.

Today if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts: as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the wilderness.

When your fathers tempted me: proved me, and saw my works.

The King of Glory.

Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and said: It is a people that do err in their hearts: for they have not known my ways.

Unto whom I swear in my wrath: that they should not enter into my rest.

Let us worship Christ, &c.

Glory be, &c.

The King of Glory.

Let us worship Christ Most High, the King of Glory.

(b) *Hymn*

[Quicunque

Christum quæ-
ritis.]

O ye who seek the Lord,

Lift up your eyes on high,

For there He doth the sign accord

Of His bright majesty.

We see a wondrous sight

That shall outlive all time,

Older than depth and starry height,

Limitless and sublime.

'Tis He for Israel's fold

And heathen tribes decreed,

The King to Abraham pledged of old

And his eternal seed.

Prophets foretold His birth,

And witness'd when He came;

The Father speaks to all the earth,

To hear, and fear His name.
To Jesus, who displays
To babes His beaming face,
Be, with the Father, endless praise,
And with the Spirit of grace. *Amen.*

NOCTURN I.

(c) *Antiphon* Thou madest Him a little lower than the Angels, to crown Him with glory and worship. Thou makest Him to have dominion of the works of Thy hands.

Psalms 8. (1) O Lord our Governor, how excellent is thy Name in all the world thou hast set thy glory above the heavens!
Out of the mouth of very babes and sucklings hast thou ordained strength, because of thine enemies: that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

For I will consider thy heavens, even the works of thy fingers: the moon and the stars which thou hast ordained.
What is man, that thou art mindful of him: and the son of man, that thou visitest him?

Thou madest him lower than the angels: to crown him with glory and worship.

Thou makest him to have dominion of the works of thy hands: and thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet;

All sheep and oxen: yea, and the beasts of the field;
The fowls of the air, and the fishes of the sea: and whatsoever walketh through the paths of the seas.

O Lord our Governor: how excellent is thy Name in all the world! Glory be, &c.

(c) *Antiphon* Thou madest Him a little lower than the angels, to crown Him with glory and worship. Thou makest Him to have dominion of the works of Thy hands.

(d) *Antiphon*

The Lord discovereth the thick bushes: in His temple doth every man speak of His honour.

Psalms 29. (2) Bring unto the Lord, O ye mighty, bring your rams unto the Lord: ascribe unto the Lord worship and strength.

Give the Lord the honour due unto his Name: worship the Lord with holy worship.

It is the Lord that commandeth the waters: it is the glorious God that maketh the thunder.

It is the Lord that ruleth the seas; the voice of the Lord is mighty in operation: the voice of the Lord is a glorious voice.

The voice of the Lord breaketh the cedar trees: yea, the

Lord breaketh the cedars of Libanus.

He maketh them also to skip like a calf: Libanus also, and Sirion, like a young unicorn.

The voice of the Lord divideth the flames of fire; the voice of the Lord shaketh the wilderness: yea, the Lord shaketh the wilderness of Cades.

The voice of the Lord maketh the hinds to bring forth young, and discovereth the thick bushes: in his temple doth every man speak of his honour.

The Lord sitteth above the water-flood: and the Lord remaineth a King for ever.

The Lord shall give strength unto his people: the Lord shall give his people the blessing of peace. Glory be, &c. (d) *Antiphon*

The Lord discovereth the thick bushes: in His temple doth every man speak of His honour.

(e) *Antiphon*

Thou art fairer than the children of men: full of grace are Thy lips.

Psalms 45. (3)

My heart is inditing of a good matter: I speak of the things which I have made unto the King.

My tongue is the pen: of a ready writer.

Thou art fairer than the children of men: full of grace are thy lips, because God hath blessed thee for ever.

Gird thee with thy sword upon thy thigh, O thou most Mighty: according to thy worship and renown.

Good luck have thou with thine honour: ride on, because of the word of truth, of meekness, and righteousness: and thy right hand shall teach thee terrible things.

Thy arrows are very sharp, and the people shall be subdued unto thee: even in the midst among the King's enemies.

Thy seat, O God, endureth for ever: the sceptre of thy kingdom is a right sceptre.

Thou hast loved righteousness, and hated iniquity: wherefore God, even thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows.

All thy garments smell of myrrh, aloes, and cassia: out of the ivory palaces, whereby they have made thee glad.

Kings' daughters were among thy honourable women: upon thy right hand did stand the queen in a vesture of gold, wrought about with divers colours.

Hearken, O daughter, and consider, incline thine ear: forget also thine own people, and thy father's house.

So shall the King have pleasure in thy beauty: for he is

thy Lord God, and worship thou him.

And the daughter of Tyre shall be there with a gift: like as the rich also among the people shall make their supplication before thee.

The King's daughter is all glorious within: her clothing is of wrought gold.

She shall be brought unto the King in raiment of needlework: the virgins that be her fellows shall bear her company, and shall be brought unto thee.

With joy and gladness shall they be brought: and shall enter into the King's palace.

Instead of thy fathers, thou shalt have children: whom thou mayest make princes in all lands.

I remember thy name from one generation to another, therefore shall the people give thanks unto thee, world without end. Glory be, &c.

(e) *Antiphon*

Thou art fairer than the children of men: full of grace are Thy lips.

(1) *Verse and Response*

Thou hast appeared glorious in the sight of the Lord.

Therefore the Lord hath clothed thee in comely apparel.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 1.

O Lord Jesus Christ, hear the prayers of thy servants, and have mercy upon us, who with the Father and the Holy Spirit livest and reignest, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 1.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Father everlasting, bless us with an eternal blessing. *Amen.*

Lesson 1.

2 *Pet.* i. 10-14.

The rather, brethren, give diligence to make your calling and election sure; for if ye do these things, ye shall never fall.

For so an entrance shall be ministered unto you abundantly, into the everlasting kingdom of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

Wherefore I will not be negligent to put you always in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and

be established in the present truth.

Yea, I think it meet, as long as I am in this tabernacle,
to stir you up, by putting you in remembrance.

Knowing that shortly I must put off this my tabernacle,
even as our Lord Jesus Christ hath showed me.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 1.

Arise, shine, for thy light is come, and the glory of the Lord is risen upon thee.

And Gentiles shall come to thy light, and kings to the
brightness of thy rising.

And the glory of the Lord is risen upon them.

Benediction 2.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The only-begotten Son of God, vouchsafe to
bless and help us. *Amen. Lesson 2.*

2 Pet. i. 15-17.

Moreover, I wilt endeavour, that ye may be able, after my
decease, to have these things always in remembrance.

For we have not followed cunningly devised fables, when
we made known unto you the power and coming of our
Lord Jesus Christ, but were eye-witnesses of his majesty.

For he received from God the Father honour and glory,
when there came such a voice to him from the excellent
glory, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 2.

*In the bright cloud the Holy Ghost was seen, the Father's
voice was heard: This is My beloved Son, in whom I am
well pleased; hear ye Him.*

A cloud overshadowed them, and the Father's voice was
heard in thunder.

This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye Him.

Benediction 3.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The grace of the Holy Ghost enlighten our
thoughts and hearts. *Amen.*

Lesson 3.

2 Pet. i. 18-20.

And this voice which came from heaven we heard, when
we were with him in the holy mount.

We have also a more sure word of prophecy whereunto
ye do well that ye take heed, as unto a light that shineth
in a dark place, until the day dawn, and the day-star arise

in your hearts:

Knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is
of any private interpretation.

For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man:
but holy men of God spake *as they were* moved by the Holy
Ghost.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 3.

*Behold what manner of love the Father hath bestowed upon
us; that we should be called the sons of God.*

We know that when He shall appear, we shall be like
Him, for we shall see Him as He is.

That we should be called the sons of God.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

That we should be called the sons of God.

NOCTURN II.

(g) *Antiphon*

Thou art of more honour and might than the hills of the
robbers: the proud are robbed.

[*Illuminans tu mi-
rabiliter à monti-
bus æternis, &c.*]

Psalm 76. (4)

In Jewry is God known: his name is great in Israel.

At Salem is his tabernacle: and his dwelling in Sion.

There brake he the arrows of the bow: the shield, the
sword, and the battle.

Thou art of more honour and might: than the hills of the
robbers.

The proud are robbed, they have slept their sleep: and
all the men, whose hands were mighty, have found nothing.

At thy rebuke, O God of Jacob: both the chariot and horse
are fallen.

Thou, even thou art to be feared: and who may stand in
thy sight when thou art angry?

Thou didst cause thy judgment to be heard from heaven:
the earth trembled, and was still.

When God arose to judgment: and to help all the meek
upon earth.

The fierceness of man shall turn to thy praise: and the
fierceness of them shalt thou refrain.

Promise unto the Lord your God, and keep it, all ye that
are around about him: bring presents unto him that ought
to be feared.

He shall refrain the spirit of princes: and is wonderful among the kings of the earth. Glory be, &c.

(g) *Antiphon*

Thou art of more honour and might than the hills of the robbers: the proud are robbed.

(h) *Antiphon*

Psalm 84. (5)

One day in thy courts is better than a thousand.

O how amiable are thy dwellings: thou Lord of hosts!

My soul hath a desire and longing to enter into the courts of the Lord: my heart and my flesh rejoice in the living God.

Yea, the sparrow hath found her an house, and the swallow a nest, where she may lay her young, even thy altars, O Lord of hosts, my King and my God.

Blessed are they that dwell in thy house: they will be always praising thee.

Blessed is the man whose strength is in thee: in whose heart are thy ways.

Who going through the vale of misery use it for a well: and the pools are filled with water.

They will go from strength to strength: and unto the God of gods appeareth every one of them in Sion.

O Lord God of hosts, hear my prayer: hearken, O God of Jacob.

Behold, O God our defender: and look upon the face of thine Anointed.

For one day in thy courts: is better than a thousand.

I had rather be a door-keeper in the house of my God: than to dwell in the tents of ungodliness. Glory be, &c.

(h) *Antiphon*

One day in thy courts is better than a thousand.

(i) *Antiphon*

Very excellent things are spoken of thee, thou city of God.

Psalm 87. (6)

Her foundations are upon the holy hills: the Lord loveth the gates of Sion more than all the dwellings of Jacob.

Very excellent things are spoken of thee, thou city of God.

I will think upon Rahab and Babylon: with them that know me.

Behold ye the Philistines also: and they of Tyre, with the Morians: lo, there was he born.

And of Sion it shall be reported, that he was born in her:

and the Most High shall stablish her.

The Lord shall rehearse it: when he writeth up the people,
that he was born there.

The singers also and trumpeters shall he rehearse: all
my fresh springs shall be in thee. Glory be, &c.

(i) *Antiphon*

Very excellent things are spoken of thee, thou city of God.

(j) *Verse and Response*

Thou crownest Him with glory and worship.

And makest him to have dominion of the works of thy hands.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 2.

His pity and mercy succour us, who with the Father and
the Holy Ghost, liveth and reigneth, world without end.

Amen.

Benediction 4.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—God, the Father Almighty, be favourable and
gracious unto us. *Amen. Lesson 4.*

(*Sermon of St. Leo, Pope.*)

The Lord revealed His glory before certain chosen witnesses, and brightens that bodily form which He had in common with others with such splendour, that His face was like to the sun's blaze, and His raiment all one with the snow's whiteness. In which Transfiguration this was the chief design, to remove from the hearts of the disciples the scandal of the cross, that their faith might be proof against the lowliness of His voluntary passion, by the revelation of the excellence of His hidden dignity. And it was no less a providence, that hereby the hope of the Holy Church has a sure stay, by knowing how high a change is in store for the whole body of Christ, so that the honour first shown in the Head, might be shared in anticipation by the members.

Thou then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 4.

*They shall be satisfied with the plenteousness of Thy house:
and Thou shalt give them drink of Thy pleasures, as out of
the river.*

For with Thee is the well of life, and in Thy light shall

we see light.

And Thou shalt give them drink of Thy pleasures, as out of the river.

Benediction 5.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—Christ grant to us the joys of endless life. *Amen.*

Lesson 5.

(Sermon continued.)

To confirm the Apostles and instruct them in all knowledge, that miracle contained a further lesson. For Moses and Elias, that is, the Law and the Prophets, appeared conversing with the Lord: that by the presence of five men might be most fully accomplished what is written, "By two or three witnesses, every word shall be established." What can be more stable, more firmly fixed, than that word, which was heralded by the trumpet, both of the Old and the New Testament, by the instruments of the ancient message in unison with the Evangelical teaching? For the pages of each covenant witness either to other, and the brightness of the present glory does but disclose Him manifest and clear, whom foregoing wonders had promised under the veil of Mysteries.

But thou then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 5.

Master, it is good to be here; and let us make here three tabernacles, one for Thee, one for Moses, and one for Elias.

For he knew not what he said.

And let us make here three tabernacles, one for Thee, one for Moses, and one for Elias.

Benediction 6.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—God kindle the fire of His love in our hearts.

Lesson 6.

(Sermon continued.)

Therefore stirred by these disclosures in outward tokens, the Apostle Peter, in scorn of things of the world, and in disgust of what was earthly, was carried away by a sort of transport into the longing after things eternal; and filled with joy at all that vision, he desired to dwell with Jesus there, where he was enjoying the manifestation of His glory. Wherefore he said, "Lord, it is good to be here; and, if Thou wilt, let us build here three tabernacles, one for Thee, one for Moses, and one for Elias." The Lord, however, answered not to this proposal, intimating, not that it was

presumptuous, but that it was unbecoming to make it; seeing the world could not be saved but by Christ's death, and that in the Lord's pattern faith should find its calling, not to doubt of the promises of future blessedness, but withal to understand that amid the trials of this life we must ask for patience rather than for glory.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 6.

If the ministration of death, written and engraven in stones, was glorious, so that the children of Israel could not stedfastly behold the face of Moses for the glory of his countenance, which glory was to be done away; much more shall the ministration of the Spirit, which abideth, be glorious.

For Christ was counted worthy of more glory than Moses, inasmuch as he who hath builded the house hath more honour than the house.

Much more shall the ministration of the Spirit, which abideth, be glorious.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Much more shall the ministration of the Spirit, which abideth, be glorious.

NOCTURN III.

(k) *Antiphon*

Tabor and Hermon shall rejoice in Thy Name: Thou hast a mighty arm.

Psalms 89. (7)

My song shall be alway of the loving-kindness of the Lord: with my mouth will I ever be showing thy truth from one generation to another.

For I have said, Mercy shall be set up for ever: thy truth shalt thou establish in the heavens.

I have made a covenant with my chosen: I have sworn unto David my servant;

Thy seed will I stablish for ever: and set up thy throne from one generation to another.

O Lord, the very heavens shall praise thy wondrous works: and thy truth, in the congregation of the saints.

For who is he among the clouds: that shall be compared unto the Lord?

And what is he among the gods: that shall be like unto the Lord?

God is very greatly to be feared in the council of the saints: and to be had in reverence of all them that are round about him.

O Lord God of hosts, who is like unto thee: thy truth,

most mighty Lord, is on every side.
Thou rulest the raging of the sea: thou stillest the waves
thereof when they arise.
Thou hast subdued Egypt, and destroyed it: thou hast
scattered thine enemies abroad with thy mighty arm.
The heavens are thine, the earth also is thine: thou hast
laid the foundation of the round world, and all that
therein is.
Thou hast made the north and the south: Tabor and
Hermon shall rejoice in thy Name.
Thou hast a mighty arm: strong is thy hand, and high is
thy right hand.
Righteousness and equity are the habitation of thy seat:
mercy and truth shall go before thy face.
Blessed is the people, O Lord, that can rejoice in thee:
they shall walk in the light of thy countenance.
Their delight shall be daily in thy Name: and in thy
righteousness shall they make their boast.
For thou art the glory of their strength: and in thy
loving kindness thou shalt lift up our horns.
For the Lord is our defence: the Holy One of Israel is
our King.
Thou spakest sometime in visions unto thy saints, and
saidst: I have laid help upon one that is mighty; I have
exalted one chosen out of the people.
I have found David my servant: with my holy oil have
I anointed him.
My hand shall hold him fast: and my arm shall
strengthen him.
The enemy shall not be able to do him violence: the son
of wickedness shall not hurt him.
I will smite down his foes before his face: and plague
them that hate him.
My truth also and my mercy shall be with him: and in
my Name shall his horn be exalted.
I will set his dominion also in the sea: and his right hand
in the floods.
He shall call me, Thou art my Father: my God, and my
strong salvation.
And I will make him my first-born: higher than the kings
of the earth.
My mercy will I keep for him for evermore: and my
covenant shall stand fast with him.
His seed also will I make to endure for ever: and his
throne as the days of heaven.

But if his children forsake my law: and walk not in my judgments;

If they break my statutes, and keep not my commandments: I will visit their offences with the rod, and their sin with scourges.

Nevertheless my loving-kindness will I not utterly take from him: nor suffer my truth to fail.

My covenant will I not break, nor alter the thing that is gone out of my lips: I have sworn once by my holiness, that I will not fail David.

His seed shall endure for ever: and his seat is like as the sun before me.

He shall stand fast for evermore as the moon: and as the faithful witness in heaven.

But thou hast abhorred and forsaken thine Anointed: and art displeased at him.

Thou hast broken the covenant of thy servant: and cast his crown to the ground.

Thou hast overthrown all his hedges: and broken down his strong holds.

All they that go by spoil him: and he is become a reproach to his neighbours.

Thou hast set up the right hand of his enemies: and made all his adversaries to rejoice.

Thou hast taken away the edge of his sword: and givest him not victory in the battle.

Thou hast put out his glory: and cast his throne down to the ground.

The days of his youth hast thou shortened: and covered him with dishonour.

Lord, how long wilt thou hide thyself, for ever: and shall thy wrath burn like fire

O remember how short my time is: wherefore hast thou made all men for nought?

What man is he that liveth, and shall not see death: and shall he deliver his soul from the hand of hell?

Lord, where are thy old loving-kindnesses: which thou swarest unto David in thy truth?

Remember, Lord, the rebuke that thy servants have: and how I do bear in my bosom the rebukes of many people?

Wherewith thine enemies have blasphemed thee, and slandered the footsteps of thine anointed: Praised be the Lord for evermore. Amen, and Amen.

(k) *Antiphon*

Tabor and Hermon shall rejoice in Thy Name; Thou hast

a mighty arm.

(l) *Antiphon*

There is sprung up a light for the righteous, and joyful gladness for such as are true-hearted.

Psalm 97. (8)

The Lord is King, the earth may be glad thereof: yea, the multitudes of the isles may be glad thereof.

Clouds and darkness are round about him: righteousness and judgment are the habitation of his seat.

There shall go a fire before him: and burn up his enemies on every side.

His lightnings gave shine unto the world: the earth saw it, and was afraid.

The hills melted like wax at the presence of the Lord: at the presence of the Lord of the whole earth.

The heavens have declared his righteousness: and all the people have seen his glory.

Confounded be all they that worship carved images, and that delight in vain gods: worship him, all ye gods.

Sion heard of it, and rejoiced: and the daughters of Judah were glad, because of thy judgments, O Lord.

For thou, Lord, art higher than all that are in the earth: thou art exalted far above all gods.

O ye that love the Lord, see that ye hate the thing which is evil: the Lord preserveth the souls of his saints; he shall deliver them from the hand of the ungodly.

There is sprung up a light for the righteous: and joyful gladness for such as are true-hearted.

Rejoice in the Lord, ye righteous: and give thanks for a remembrance of his holiness.

(l) *Antiphon*

There is sprung up a light for the righteous: and joyful gladness for such as are true-hearted.

(m) *Antiphon*

Psalm 104. (9)

Praise the Lord, O my soul, O my God.

... thou art become exceeding glorious: thou art clothed with majesty and honour.

Thou deckest thyself with light as it were with a garment: and spreadest out the heavens like a curtain.

Who layeth the beams of his chambers in the waters: and maketh the clouds his chariot, and walketh upon the wings of the wind.

He maketh his angels spirits: and his ministers a flaming fire.

He laid the foundations of the earth: that it never should
 move at any time.
 Thou coveredst it with the deep like as with a garment: the
 waters stand in the hills.
 At thy rebuke they flee: at the voice of thy thunder they
 are afraid.
 They go up as high as the hills, and down to the valleys
 beneath: even unto the place which thou hast appointed
 for them.
 Thou hast set them their bounds, which they shall not
 pass: neither turn again to cover the earth.
 He sendeth the springs into the rivers: which run among
 the hills.
 All beasts of the field drink thereof: and the wild asses
 quench their thirst.
 Beside them shall the fowls of the air have their habitation:
 and sing among the branches.
 He watereth the hills from above: the earth is filled with
 the fruit of thy works.
 He bringeth forth grass for the cattle: and green herb for
 the service of men;
 That he may bring food out of the earth, and wine that
 maketh glad the heart of man: and oil to make him a cheer-
 ful countenance, and bread to strengthen man's heart.
 The trees of the Lord also are full of sap: even the cedars
 of Libanus which he hath planted:
 Wherein the birds make their nests: and the fir-trees are
 a dwelling for the stork.
 The high hills are a refuge for the wild goats: and so are
 the stony rocks for the conies.
 He appointed the moon for certain seasons: and the sun
 knoweth his going down.
 Thou makest darkness that it may be night: wherein all
 the beasts of the forest do move.
 The lions roaring after their prey: do seek their meat
 from God.
 The sun ariseth, and they get them away together: and
 lay them down in their dens.
 Man goeth forth to his work, and to his labour: until the
 evening.
 O Lord, how manifold are thy works; in wisdom hast
 thou made them all; the earth is full of thy riches.
 So is the great and wide sea also: wherein are things
 creeping innumerable, both small and great beasts.
 There go the ships, and there is that Leviathan: whom

thou hast made to take his pastime therein.

These wait all upon thee: that thou mayest give them meat in due season.

When thou givest it them they gather it: and when thou openest thy hand they are filled with good.

When thou hidest thy face they are troubled: when thou takest away their breath they die, and are turned again to their dust.

When thou lettest thy breath go forth they shall be made: and thou shalt renew the face of the earth.

The glorious Majesty of the Lord shall endure for ever: the Lord shall rejoice in his works.

The earth shall tremble at the look of him: if he do but touch the hills, they shall smoke.

I will sing unto the Lord as long as I live: I will praise my God while I have my being.

And so shall my words please him: my joy shall be in the Lord.

As for sinners, they shall be consumed out of the earth: and the ungodly shall come to an end: praise thou the Lord, O my soul, praise the Lord.

Antiphon

Praise the Lord, O my soul: O Lord my God.

(n) *Verse and Response*

His honour is great in thy salvation.

Glory and great worship shalt Thou lay upon him. The Lord's Prayer (privately)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 3.

The Almighty and merciful Lord absolve us from the bonds of our sins. *Amen.*

Benediction 7.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The reading of the Gospel be to us salvation and defence. *Amen.*

Lesson 7.

Matt. xvii. 1-5.

At that time Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart,

And was transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light.

And behold, there appeared unto them Moses and Elias talking with him.

Then answered Peter, and said unto Jesus, Lord, it is good for us to be here: if thou wilt, let us make here three tabernacles; one for thee, one for Moses, and one for Elias. While he yet spake, behold a bright cloud overshadowed them: and behold a voice out of the cloud, which said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased: hear ye him.

Homily of St. John Chrysostom

Whereas the Lord spoke much concerning dangers, His own death, and the death and slaughter of His disciples, and enjoined on them many severe and difficult things, and all this, too, in the present life, and soon to come, while the gain was but in hope and expectation, (for instance, that they should save their life, if they lost it, that He will come in the glory of his Father and dispense rewards,) therefore, in order to certify them even by sight, and to show them what that glory was, with which he was to come, He shows it them as far as they could understand it in this present life, and unveils it, lest they should grieve at the thought of their own or their Lord's death, and chiefly Peter.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy on us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 7.

God hath called us with a holy calling, according to His grace, which is now made manifest by the glorious appearing of our Saviour Jesus Christ.

Who hath abolished death, and hath brought life and immortality to light.

By the glorious appearing of our Savior Jesus Christ.

Benediction 8.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The help of God abide with us for ever. *Amen.*

Lesson 8.

(Homily continued.)

And see what He does, after discoursing of his kingdom and of hell. For in that He said, "He who finds his life, shall lose it, and whoever will lose it for my sake, the same shall find it;" and in that He said, "He shall render to every one according to his works," He has pointed out both His kingdom and hell. When then He had discoursed concerning both, of His kingdom He granted the sight to human eyes, but not of hell; since, needful as that might have been for the uninstructed and unready, yet upright and clearsighted men, as the Apostles, needed but to be confirmed by the better part. This part indeed it was far more fitting He should mention, yet He did not altogether pass over the other,

placing at times the terribleness of hell as if before the eyes, as in his description of Lazarus, and of him who demanded back the hundred pence.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response.

God, who commanded the light to shine out of darkness, hath shined in our hearts: to give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ.

Unto the godly there ariseth up light in the darkness; he is merciful, loving, and righteous.

To give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

To give the light of the knowledge of the glory of God in the face of Jesus Christ.

Benediction 9.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The King of Angels bring us through to the society of the inhabitants of heaven. *Amen.*

Lesson 9.

(Homily continued.)

Think upon the greatness of mind in St. Matthew, who has not concealed the names of those who were preferred over the rest: which St. John also shows often, when he notes down the special praises of Peter so accurately and carefully. In this fellow ship of Apostles there was no place for envy or for vain-glory. Therefore He took apart with Him the chief ones of the Apostles. Why took He those only? For this reason, because they were superior to the rest. But why did He not do so at once, but after six days? lest His other disciples, or others generally should be troubled; for which reason neither did He name those whom He was alone to take with Him.

Thou, then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Te Deum Vide p. 47.

We praise thee, O God: we acknowledge thee to be the Lord.

All the earth doth worship thee: the Father everlasting.

To thee all Angels cry aloud: the Heavens, and all the Powers therein, &c.

LAUDS

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c. As it was, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(o) *Antiphon*

Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart, and was transfigured before them.

Psalm 93. (1)

Vide p. 38.

The Lord is King, and hath put on glorious apparel: the Lord hath put on his apparel, and girded himself with strength.

He hath made the round world so sure: that it cannot be moved.

Ever since the world began, hath thy seat been prepared: thou art from everlasting, &c.

Glory be, &c.

(o) *Antiphon*

Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart, and was transfigured before them.

(p) *Antiphon*

His face did shine as the sun, and His raiment was white as snow. Hallelujah.

Psalm 100, (2)

Vide p. 48.

O be joyful, &c.

Glory be, &c.

(p) *Antiphon*

His face did shine as the sun, and His raiment was white as snow. Hallelujah.

(q) *Antiphon*

And behold there appeared unto them Moses and Elias, speaking with Jesus.

Psalm 63 and 67

Vide p 48. (3)

O God, thou art my God, &c.

God be merciful unto us, &c.

Glory be, &c.

(q) *Antiphon*

And behold there appeared unto them Moses and Elias, speaking with Jesus.

(r) *Antiphon*

And Peter answered and said to Jesus, Lord, it is good

to be here.

Song of the Three

Children, vide

p. 50. (4)

O all ye works of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him,
and magnify him for ever.

O ye Angels of the Lord, bless ye the Lord: praise him,
and magnify him for ever.

O ye Heavens, bless ye the Lord: praise him, and mag-
nify him for ever, &c.

(r) *Antiphon*

And Peter answered and said to Jesus, Lord, it is good
to be here.

(s) *Antiphon*

While he yet spake, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed
them.

Psalm 148, 149

and 150. Vide

p. 52. (5)

O praise ye the Lord of heaven, &c.

O sing unto the Lord, &c.

O praise God, &c.

(s) *Antiphon*

While he yet spake, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed
them.

(t) *Text Phil. iii. 20, 21.*

Minister.—We look for the Saviour, our Lord Jesus Christ,
who shall change our vile body, that it may be like unto
His glorious body.

Thanks be to God.

(u) *Hymn*

[Lux alma Jesu.]

Light of the anxious heart,

Jesu, Thy suppliants cheer;

Bid thou the gloom of guilt depart,

And shed Thy sweetness here.

Happy the man, whose breast

Thou mak'st Thy residence;

From God's right hand a radiant guest,

Unseen by fleshly sense.

Brightness of God above!

Unfathomable grace!

Vouchsafe a present fount of love,

To cleanse Thy chosen place.

To Thee, whom children see,

The Father ever blest,
The Holy Spirit, One and Three,
Be endless praise address. *Amen.*

(v) *Verse and Response*

A crown of pure gold is on His forehead.

With the sign of holiness, glory, and honour.

(w) *Ant.*

And lo, a voice from the cloud, saying, This is My beloved
Son, in whom I am well pleased. Hear ye Him. Hallelujah. *Benedictus*
Blessed be the Lord God of Israel, &c.

Glory be, &c.

(w) *Antiphon*

And lo, a voice from the clouds, saying, This is My Be-
loved Son, in whom I am well pleased, Hear ye Him—
Hallelujah.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

(x) *Collect*

Let us pray.

O God, who in the glorious transfiguration of Thine Only
begotten hast sealed the treasure of the faith by the witness
of the ancient fathers, and by the voice coming down in a
cloud of light hast wonderfully shadowed forth the perfect
adoption of Thy sons, mercifully grant, that we may be
made fellow heirs and partners in the glory of our King,
through the same our Lord. *Amen.*

&c. &c. &c.

(So on to the end of Lauds, in the Service for Sunday.)

§ 5. Part of the Service for August 10th.

The Feast of St. Laurence, Deacon and Martyr

[In order to understand parts of the following Service, it may be necessary for the reader to have some knowledge of St. Laurence's history; which may fitly be conveyed in the following translation from St. Ambrose's Offices, as found in the British Magazine, for January, 1834.

"We must not omit mention of the blessed Laurence, who, on the sight of Sextus, his Bishop, going to martyrdom, began to weep, not so much at his passion, as his own orphanhood. So he called out to him, 'Whither goest thou, O my father, without thy son? Whither can a Priest be hurrying without his Deacon? Never as yet didst thou offer sacrifice without an attendant. How have I displeased thee? Hast thou found me a degenerate son? Peter let Stephen suffer before him. Thou, too, O my Father, show thine own graces in my person, offer up to God him whom thou hast begotten, nor seize the crown of martyrdom without a noble company to answer your good thoughts concerning them.'

"The Prelate answered, 'Nay, son, I leave thee not, neither forsake thee; a fiercer combat is in store for thee. We, as the old, are allotted the lighter skirmish, but youth must bear off a more glorious triumph over tyranny. Thou wilt soon be called upon; cease thy tears; in three days thou

shalt follow me. Ill would it seem for me who hold the third rank in the sacred ministry, to press into the first. I leave to thee the legacy of my own constancy.”

In consequence, three days after, Laurence was arrested, and, after other tortures, broiled to death on a gridiron. St. Ambrose adds, “when he was stretched upon the scorching gridiron, he did but say, The meat is done; turn it over, and eat it.” This happened A.D. 258. Other particulars of his Martyrdom will be found in the Service itself. It may be added, by way of explaining an allusion in the above account, that “Priest,” in the language of antiquity, means one who has the power of consecrating the Eucharist, *i.e.* Bishop and Presbyter, [*Leitourgos*], or as our Service seems sometimes to express it, *Minister*; and that this Deacon was the usual attendant on the Minister in the celebration.]

FIRST VESPERS

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c. Amen. Hallelujah

(yy) *Antiphon* Laurence entered on his Martyrdom, and confessed the name of the Lord Jesus Christ.

Ps. 110. p. 76. (1) The Lord said, &c.

(yy) *Antiphon* Laurence entered on his Martyrdom, and confessed the name of the Lord Jesus Christ.

(zz) *Antiphon*

Laurence hath wrought a good work, who by the sign of the Cross gave sight to the blind.

Ps. 111. p. 76. (2) I will give thanks, &c.

(zz) *Antiphon* Laurence hath wrought a good work, who by the sign of the Cross gave sight to the blind.

(aaa) *Antiphon*

My soul hangeth upon Thee, because my flesh is burned in the fire for Thee, O my God.

Ps. 112. p. 77. (3) Blessed is the man, &c.

(aaa) *Antiphon* My soul hangeth upon Thee, because my flesh is burned in the fire for Thee, O my God.

(bbb) *Antiphon*

The Lord hath sent His Angel, and hath delivered me from the midst of the fire, and I am not tormented.

Ps. 113. p. 77. (4) Praise the Lord, ye servants, &c.

(bbb) *Antiphon* The Lord hath sent his Angel, and hath delivered me from the midst of the fire, and I am not tormented.

(ccc) *Antiphon*

Blessed Laurence prayed, saying, I give Thee thanks, O Lord, because I have been found worthy to enter Thy gates.

Psalms 117. (5) O praise the Lord, all ye heathen: praise him, all ye nations.

For his merciful kindness is ever more and more towards

us: and the truth of the Lord endureth for ever. Praise
the Lord.

(ccc) *Antiphon* Blessed Laurence prayed, saying, I give Thee thanks, O
Lord, because I have been found worthy to enter Thy gates.

(ddd) *Text*

2 Cor. ix. 6.

Minister.—Brethren, he which soweth sparingly shall
reap sparingly; and he which soweth bountifully shall reap
bountifully.

Thanks be to God.

(eee) *Hymn*

[Invicte martyr

unicum. *It is remarkable that this Hymn, which is the only one of those here translated which savours of Romanism, is the only one, except one other, which is not known to be ancient. The rest are either Ambrosian or Gregorian, except one, which is by Prudentius.*

(Quicunque Chri-

stum.) *Of the Hymn Lux Alma*

Jesu, the Translator cannot discover the Author.]

Martyr of Christ, thy fight is won!

Following the Father's only Son,

O'er thy fall'n foes thou triumphest,

In heavenly courts a risen guest.

Use thou for us thy gift of prayer

To cleanse thy brethren's sin,

To sweeten earth's infectious air,

And gain us peace within.

For ever broken is the chain

That bound thy body's hallowed fane;

As God hath given thee, break the tie

Which links our hearts to vanity.

To God the Father, God the Son,

And God the Paraclete,

Be praise, while circling ages run

Beneath the Eternal's feet. *Amen.*

(fff) *Verse and Response*

Thou hast crowned him with glory and worship.

And makest Him to have dominion of the works of Thy hands.

(ggg) *Antiphon*

On the hot bars I denied Thee not, my God: and, when
brought to the fire, I confessed Thee, O Christ. Thou hast
proved my heart, and visited me in the night: thou hast
tried me by fire, and hast found no wickedness in me.

Magnificat My soul doth magnify the Lord, &c.

Antiphon On the hot bars I denied thee not, &c.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

Collect Almighty God, who gavest to blessed Laurence to overcome the fire of his torture, grant to us, we beseech Thee, to extinguish the flames of our vices, through the Lord.

Amen.

(The Service ends as above in Vespers, p. 80.)

MATIN SERVICE

O Lord, open Thou my lips:

And my mouth shall show forth Thy praise.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(a) *Invitatory* Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, is crowned, and triumphs in heaven: come, let us worship.

Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, &c.

Psalms 95 O come, let us sing unto the Lord: let us heartily rejoice in the strength of our salvation.

Let us come before his presence with thanksgiving: and show ourselves glad in him with psalms.

Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, is crowned, and triumphs in heaven: come, let us worship.

For the Lord is a great God: and a great King above all gods.

In his hand are all the corners of the earth: and the strength of the hills is his also.

Come, let us worship.

The sea is his, and he made it: and his hands prepared the dry land.

O come, let us worship and fall down: and kneel before the Lord our Maker.

For he is the Lord our God: and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand.

Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, is crowned, and triumphs in heaven: come, let us worship.

Today if ye will hear his voice, harden not your hearts: as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the wilderness;

When your fathers tempted me: proved me, and saw my works.

Come, let us worship.

Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and said: It is a people that do err in their hearts, for they have

not known my ways;
Unto whom I swear in my wrath: that they should not
enter into my rest.

Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, is crowned,
and triumphs in heaven: come, let us worship.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c. *Amen*.

Come, let us worship.

Blessed Laurence, the Martyr of Christ, is crowned, and
triumphs in heaven: come, let us worship.

(b) *Hymn*

[Deus tuorum
militum.]

O God, of Thy soldiers
The Portion and Crown,
Spare sinners, who hymn
The praise of the Blest;
Earth's bitter joys,
Its lures and its frown,
He weighed them and scorned,
And so is at rest.

Thy Martyr he ran
All valiantly o'er
A highway of blood
For the prize Thou hast given.
We kneel at Thy feet,
And meekly implore,
Our pardon may wait
On his triumph in heaven.
Honour and praise
To the Father and Son
And the Spirit be done
Now and always. *Amen*.

NOCTURN I.

(c) *Antiphon* Whither speedest thou without thy son, O my father?
Whither, holy Priest, hurriest thou without attendant?

Psalm 1. (1) Blessed is the man, that hath not walked in the counsel of
the ungodly, nor stood in the way of sinners: and hath not
sat in the seat of the scornful.

But his delight is in the law of the Lord: and in his law
will he exercise himself day and night.

And he shall be like a tree planted by the water-side:
that will bring forth his fruit in due season.

His leaf also shall not wither: and look, whatsoever he
doeth, it shall prosper.

As for the ungodly, it is not so with them: but they are like the chaff, which the wind scattereth away from the face of the earth.

Therefore the ungodly shall not be able to stand in the judgment: neither the sinners in the congregation of the righteous.

But the Lord knoweth the way of the righteous: and the way of the ungodly shall perish. Glory be, &c.

(c) *Antiphon* Whither speedest thou, without thy son, O my father? Whither, holy Priest, hurriest thou without attendant?

(d) *Antiphon*

Forsake me not, O holy father, for I have just laid out those treasures which thou gavest me in trust.

Psalm 2. (2) Why do the heathen so furiously rage together: and why do the people imagine a vain thing?

The kings of the earth stand up, and the rulers take counsel together: against the Lord, and against his Anointed.

Let us break their bonds asunder: and cast away their cords from us.

He that dwelleth in heaven shall laugh them to scorn: the Lord shall have them in derision.

Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath: and vex them in his sore displeasure.

Yet have I set my King: upon my holy hill of Sion.

I will preach the law, whereof the Lord hath said unto me: Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee.

Desire of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance: and the utmost parts of the earth for thy possession.

Thou shalt bruise them with a rod of iron: and break them in pieces like a potter's vessel.

Be wise now therefore, O ye kings; be learned, ye that are judges of the earth.

Serve the Lord in fear: and rejoice unto him with reverence.

Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and so ye perish from the right way: if his wrath be kindled, (yea, but a little) blessed are all they that put their trust in him. Glory be, &c.

(d) *Antiphon* Forsake me not, O holy father, for I have now laid out those treasures which thou gavest me in trust.

(e) *Antiphon*

I desert thee not, O my son, neither do I forsake thee; but a higher conflict for the faith of Christ is in store for

thee.

Psalm 3. (3) Lord, how are they increased that trouble me: many are they that rise against me.

Many one there be that say of my soul: There is no help for him in his God.

But thou, O Lord, art my defender: thou art my worship, and the lifter up of my head.

I did call upon the Lord with my voice; and he heard me out of his holy hill.

I laid me down and slept, and rose up again: for the Lord sustained me.

I will not be afraid for ten thousands of the people: that have set themselves against me round about.

Up, Lord, and help me, O my God: for thou smitest all mine enemies upon the cheek-bone; thou hast broken the teeth of the ungodly.

Salvation belongeth unto the Lord: and thy blessing is upon thy people. Glory be, &c.

(e) *Antiphon* I desert thee not, O my son, neither do I forsake thee; but a higher conflict for the faith of Christ is in store for thee.

(f) *Verse and Response*

Thou hast crowned him with glory and worship.

And makest him to have dominion of the works of Thy hands.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not in to temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 1. O Lord Jesus Christ, hearken unto the prayers of thy servants, and have mercy upon us, who livest and reignest with the Father and Holy Ghost, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 1.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Father everlasting bless us with a perpetual blessing. *Amen.*

Lesson 1.

Ecclus. li. 1-5. I will thank thee, O Lord and King, and praise thee, O God my Saviour, I do give praise unto Thy name;

For thou art my defender and helper, and hast preserved my body from destruction, and from the snare of the slanderous tongue, and from lips that forge lies, and hast been mine helper against mine adversaries;

And hast delivered me, according to the multitude of Thy mercies and greatness of Thy name, from the teeth of them

that were ready to devour me, and out of the hands of such
as sought after my life, and from the manifold afflictions
which I had;

From the choking of fire on every side, and from the
midst of the fire which I kindled not.

From the depth of the belly of hell, from an unclean
tongue, and from lying words, from an unjust king, and
from an unrighteous tongue.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 1.

*Laurence, the Deacon, wrought a good work, who en-
lightened the blind by the sign of the Cross: and gave
the treasures of the Church to the poor.*

He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor, and his
righteousness remaineth for ever.

And he gave the treasures of the Church to the poor.

Benediction 2.

Reader—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The only begotten Son of God vouchsafe to
bless us and help us. *Amen.*

Lesson 2.

Ecclus. li. 6-9. My soul shall praise the Lord even unto death, my life
was near to the hell beneath.

They compassed me on every side, and there was no man
to help me: I looked for the succour of men, but there was
none.

Then thought I upon thy mercy, O Lord, and upon Thy
acts of old, how Thou deliverest such as wait for Thee,
and savest them out of the hands of the enemies.

Then I lifted up my supplication from the earth, and
prayed for deliverance from death.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Response 2.

Thanks be to God.

*My child, be not afraid, for I am with thee, saith the
Lord. When thou passest through the fire, thou shalt
not be burned, neither shall the smell of fire pass upon
thee.*

I will deliver thee from the bond of the wicked, and
rescue thee from the hand of the mighty.

*When thou passest through the fire, thou shalt not be burned, neither shall the smell of fire pass upon
thee.*

Benediction 3.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The grace of the Holy Spirit enlighten our thoughts and hearts. *Amen.*

Lesson 3.

Ecclus. li. 10-12. I called upon the Lord, the Father of my Lord, that He would not leave me in the days of my trouble, and in the time of the proud, when there was no help.

I will praise Thy name continually, and will sing praise with thanksgiving; and so my prayer was heard.

For thou savedst me from destruction, and deliveredst me from the evil time: therefore will I give thanks, and praise Thee, and bless Thy name, O Lord.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Response 3.

Thanks be to God.

They bound down his limbs upon the bars; but while they ministered live coals, the deacon of Christ laughed them to scorn. Blessed Laurence, Martyr of Christ, intercede for us.

My night has no darkness, but all things grow clear in the light.

Blessed Laurence, Martyr of Christ, intercede for us.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c.

Blessed Laurence, Martyr of Christ, intercede for us.

NOCTURN II.

(g) *Antiphon* Blessed Laurence prayed saying, Lord Jesus Christ, God from God, have mercy on Thy servant.

Psalms 4. (4) Hear me when I call, O God of my righteousness: thou hast set me at liberty when I was in trouble: have mercy upon me, and hearken unto my prayer.

O ye sons of men, how long will ye blaspheme mine honour: and have such pleasure in vanity, and seek after leasing?

Know this also, that the Lord hath chosen to himself the man that is godly: when I call upon the Lord, he will hear me.

Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart and in your chamber, and be still.

Offer the sacrifice of righteousness: and put your trust in the Lord.

There be many that say: Who will show us any good? Lord, lift thou up: the light of thy countenance upon us. Thou hast put gladness in my heart: since the time that their corn, and wine, and oil increased.

I will lay me down in peace, and take my rest: for it is thou, Lord, only, that makest me dwell in safety. Glory be, &c.

(g) *Antiphon* Blessed Laurence prayed saying, Lord Jesus Christ, God from God, have mercy on thy servant.

(h) *Antiphon*

Romanus said to blessed Laurence, I see before thee a young man of fair countenance, hasten to baptize me.

Psalm 5. (5) Ponder my words, O Lord: consider my meditation.

O hearken thou unto the voice of my calling, my King and my God: for unto thee will I make my prayer.

My voice shalt thou hear betimes, O Lord: early in the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee, and will look up.

For thou art the God that hast no pleasure in wickedness: neither shall any evil dwell with thee.

Such as be foolish shall not stand in thy sight: for thou hatest all them that work vanity.

Thou shalt destroy them that speak leasing: the Lord will abhor both the blood-thirsty and deceitful man.

But as for me, I will come into thine house, even upon the multitude of thy mercy: and in thy fear will I worship toward thy holy temple.

Lead me, O Lord, in thy righteousness, because of mine enemies: make thy way plain before my face.

For there is no faithfulness in his mouth: their inward parts are very wickedness.

Their throat is an open sepulchre: they flatter with their tongue.

Destroy thou them, O God: let them perish through their own imaginations: cast them out in the multitude of their ungodliness: for they have rebelled against thee.

And let all them that put their trust in thee rejoice: they shall ever be giving of thanks, because thou defendest them: they that love thy Name shall be joyful in thee.

For thou, Lord, wilt give thy blessing unto the righteous: and with thy favourable kindness wilt thou defend him as with a shield. Glory be, &c.

(h) *Antiphon* Romanus said to blessed Laurence, I see before thee a young man of fair countenance, hasten to baptize me.

(i) *Antiphon*

Blessed Laurence answered, My night has no darkness, but all things grow clear in the light.

Psalm 8. (6) O Lord, our Governor, how excellent is thy name in all the world: thou that hast set thy glory above the heavens!

Out of the mouth of very babes and sucklings hast thou ordained strength, because of thine enemies: that thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

For I will consider thy heavens, even the works of thy fingers: the moon and the stars which thou hast ordained. What is man, that thou art mindful of him: and the Son of man that thou visitest him?

Thou madest him lower than the angels: to crown him with, glory and worship.

Thou makest him to have dominion of the works of thy hands: and thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet;

All sheep and oxen: yea, and the beasts of the field; The fowls of the air, and the fishes of the sea: and whatsoever walketh through the paths of the seas.

O Lord, our Governor: how excellent is thy name in all the world! Glory be, &c.

(i) *Antiphon* Blessed Laurence answered, My night has no darkness, but all things grow clear in the light.

(j) *Verse and Response*

Lord, thou hast set upon his head.

A crown of precious stones. The Lord's Prayer,

(privately.) Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 2. His pity and mercy help us, who with the Father and the Holy Spirit liveth and reigneth, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 4.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—God the Father Almighty be favourable and gracious unto us. *Amen.*

Lesson 4.

(*Sermon of St. Leo, Pope.*) While the fury of the heathen powers raged against the most chosen members of Christ, those chiefly who were in the order of the Ministry, Laurence the Deacon, having not only the dispensation of the Sacraments, but also of the Church's store, incited the impious persecutor, who promised himself a double price in one man, the gain of the sacred treasure and the ruin of him who surrendered it. Instigated therefore by this twofold flame, avarice and hatred of the truth, to rob him of his treasure and of Christ, he demands of the spotless Sacristan, those stores of the Church of which he was greedy. To whom he, most holy Deacon, by way of showing where they really were laid up, presented vast multitudes of Christian poor, on whose food and clothing he had expended wealth which could not be taken away, but was irrevocably his from the sanctity of his using.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 4.

Whither speedest thou without thy son, O my father? Whither hurriest thou, holy priest, without thy Deacon? Thou never yet hast offered sacrifice without attendant.

What hath in me displeased thy fatherly love? in what have I come short? make trial of his fitness to whom thou hast entrusted the dispensation of the Lord's blood.

Thou never yet hast offered sacrifice without attendant.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Benediction 5. Minister.—Christ grant us the joys of eternal life. *Amen.*

Lesson 5.

(Sermon, continued.) Therefore the disappointed robber roars aloud, and kindling into hatred of that religion, which had introduced such an application of worldly goods, he attempts the plunder of another treasure-house, not of gold or silver, to rob it of that store which was of a more holy costliness. He bids Laurence renounce Christ, and prepares against the stubborn courage of that Deacon's heart, dreadful tortures; and when the first prove fruitless, he proceeds to fiercer. He tears and shreds his limbs with continued scourging, next he gives orders to broil them over the fire, so that, being stretched upon the red hot bars, first on one side, then on the other, the torment might be the greater, and the punishment more protracted.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 5.

Forsake me not, O holy father, for I have already laid out my stores. I desert thee not, my son, neither do I forsake thee; but a fiercer conflict for the faith of Christ is in store for thee.

We, as aged men, receive the onset of the skirmish, thou being young, will have to bear off a more glorious triumph over the persecutor; the Deacon shall follow his Bishop on the third day.

I desert thee not, my son, neither do I forsake thee: but a fiercer conflict for the faith of Christ is in store for thee.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Benediction 6.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—God kindle the fire of His love in our hearts.

Amen.

Lesson 6. Thou gainest nothing, thou availest nothing, O savage

cruelty! The mortal frame is gradually released from thy tortures. Laurence departs heavenward, and thy flames fail thee. The love of Christ surpassed the flame, and the fire which burned around him was duller than that which was kindled within him. O Persecutor, thou hast spent thy rage upon the Martyr; thou hast spent it, and added to his palm, while adding to his pain. For what part of thy device has not redounded to the conqueror's glory, when even the instruments of his suffering are converted into decorations of his triumph? Let us then rejoice, dearly beloved, with a spiritual joy, and glory in the Lord concerning the most blessed end of this famous man. God is wonderful in His Saints, in whom He hath ordained for us a sanction and an example, and hath so shown forth His glory through the whole world, that from the rising to the setting sun, among the refulgent lights of the Diaconate, Rome became as honoured in her Laurence, as Jerusalem in Stephen. But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God. Response 6. Blessed Laurence cried out and said, My God I worship, Him alone I serve, and therefore I fear not your tortures.

My night hath no darkness, but all things grow clear in the light.

And therefore I fear not your tortures.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

And therefore I fear not your tortures.

NOCTURN III.

(k) *Antiphon* They bound down his limbs upon the bars: but while they laid underneath live coals, the Deacon of Christ laughs them to scorn.

Psalms 15 (7) Lord, who shall dwell in thy tabernacle: or who shall rest upon thy holy hill?

Even he that leadeth an uncorrupt life: and doeth the thing which is right, and speaketh the truth from his heart.

He that hath used no deceit in his tongue, nor done evil to his neighbour: and hath not slandered his neighbour.

He that setteth not by himself, but is lowly in his own eyes: and maketh much of them that fear the Lord.

He that sweareth unto his neighbour, and disappointeth him not: though it were to his own hindrance.

He that hath not given his money upon usury: nor taken reward against the innocent.

Whoso doeth these things shall never fall. Glory be, &c.

(k) *Antiphon* They bound his limbs upon the bars; but while they laid underneath live coals, the Deacon of Christ laughs them to scorn.

(l) *Antiphon*

Thou hast tried me with fire, and hast found no wickedness in me.

Psalms 17. (8) Hear the right, O Lord, consider my complaint: and hearken unto my prayer, that goeth not out of feigned lips.

Let my sentence come forth from thy presence: and let thine eyes look upon the thing that is equal.

Thou hast proved and visited mine heart in the night-season; thou hast tried me, and shalt find no wickedness in me: for I am utterly purposed that my mouth shall not offend.

Because of men's works, that are done against the words of thy lips: I have kept me from the ways of the destroyer. O hold thou up my goings in thy paths: that my footsteps slip not.

I have called upon thee, O God, for thou shalt hear me: incline thine ear to me, and hearken unto my words.

Show thy marvellous loving-kindness, thou that art the Saviour of them which put their trust in thee: from such as resist thy right hand.

Keep me as the apple of an eye: hide me under the shadow of thy wings.

From the ungodly that trouble me: mine enemies compass me round about to take away my soul.

They are inclosed in their own fat: and their mouth speaketh proud things.

They lie waiting in our way on every side: turning their eyes down to the ground;

Like as a lion that is greedy of his prey: and as it were a lion's whelp lurking in secret places.

Up, Lord, disappoint him, and cast him down: deliver my soul from the ungodly, which is a sword of thine;

From the men of thy hand, O Lord, from the men, I say, and from the evil world: which have their portion in this life, whose bellies thou fillest with thy hid treasure.

They have children at their desire: and leave the rest of their substance for their babes.

But as for me, I will behold thy presence in righteousness; and when I awake up after thy likeness, I shall be satisfied with it. Glory be, &c.

(l) *Antiphon* Thou hast tried me with fire, and hast found no wickedness in me.

(m) *Antiphon*

When I was questioned, I confessed the Lord: when I am burned, I give thanks.

Psalm 21. (9) The King shall rejoice in thy strength, O Lord: exceeding glad shall he be of thy salvation.

Thou hast given him his heart's desire: and hast not denied him the request of his lips.

For thou shalt prevent him with the blessings of goodness: and shalt set a crown of pure gold upon his head.

He asked life of thee, and thou gavest him a long life: even for ever and ever.

His honour is great in thy salvation: glory and great worship shalt thou lay upon him.

For thou shalt give him everlasting felicity: and make him glad with the joy of thy countenance.

And why? because the king putteth his trust in the Lord: and in the mercy of the Most Highest he shall not miscarry.

All thine enemies shall feel thy hand: thy right hand shall find out them that hate thee.

Thou shalt make them like a fiery oven in time of thy wrath: the Lord shall destroy them in his displeasure, and the fire shall consume them.

Their fruit shalt thou root out of the earth: and their seed from among the children or men.

For they intended mischief against thee; and imagined such a device as they are not able to perform.

Therefore shalt thou put them to flight: and the strings of thy bow shalt thou make ready against the face of them.

Be thou exalted, Lord, in thine own strength: so will we sing, and praise thy power. Glory be, &c.

(m) *Antiphon*

When I was questioned, I confessed the Lord: when I am burned, I give thanks.

(n) *Verse and Response*

His honour is great in thy salvation.

Glory and great worship shalt thou lay upon him.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 3.

The Almighty and merciful Lord absolve us from the chain of our sins. *Amen.*

Benediction 7.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—May the reading of the Gospel be to us salvation and a defence. *Amen.*

Lesson 7.

John xii. 24, 25.

At that time Jesus said to His disciples, Verily, verily, I say unto you, except a corn of wheat fall into the ground and die, it abideth alone; but if it die, it bringeth forth much fruit. He that loveth his life, shall lose it, and he that hateth his life in this world, shall keep it unto life eternal.

Homily of St. Augustine

The Lord Jesus Himself was the corn of wheat to be put to death, and to be multiplied; to be put to death by the unbelief of the Jews, to be multiplied by the belief of the Gentiles. Therefore, exhorting us to trace the footsteps of His passion, He says, "He that loveth his life shall lose it." Which may be understood in two ways. He that loveth, shall lose; that is, if thou lovest, thou shalt lose. If thou wouldest possess life in Christ, fear not that death for Christ which is necessary. Or otherwise; He that loveth his life, shall lose it. Love it not lest thou really lose it; love it not here, lest thou lose it eternally.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response

On the hot bars I denied Thee not, my God; and when brought to the fire, I confessed the Lord Jesus Christ.

Thou hast proved, O Lord, and visited mine heart in the night-season.

And when brought to the fire, I confessed the Lord Jesus Christ.

Benediction 8.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—May he whose festival we keep, intercede for us to the Lord. *Amen.*

Lesson 8.

(homily, continued.)

The latter of these two seems rather to be the sense of the Gospel. For it goes on, "And he that hateth his life in this world, shall keep it unto life eternal." Therefore, as is said before, "He that loveth," that is, "in this world," he surely shall lose it; but "he who hateth," namely, "in this world," shall keep it unto life eternal. A great and marvellous saying, how it should be that a man should love his life to its destruction, and hate it to its preservation. If thou hast loved it perversely, then thou really hatest it; if thou hast hated rightly, then thou hast loved it. Blessed are they who so hate it while really saving it, as not to lose it while loving it.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 8.

*O Hippolytus, if thou hast faith in the Lord Jesus Christ,
I will both show thee treasures, and promise thee life ever-
lasting.*

The blessed Laurence said to Hippolyus, If thou hast
faith in the Lord Jesus Christ.

I will both show thee treasures, and promise thee life ever- lasting.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was, &c.

I will both show thee treasures, and promise thee life ever- lasting.

Benediction 9.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The King of Angels lead us on to the fellow-
ship of the inhabitants of heaven. *Amen. Lesson 9.*

(Homily continued.)

But beware of the desire of self-murder stealing on thee,
as if from the precept of hating thy life in this world. For
hence certain evil-tempered and perverse men, and to them-
selves more cruel and wicked murderers, give themselves
to the flames, drown themselves in the water, break their
bones down precipices, and so perish. This is not from
Christ's teaching, who even answered to the devil, suggest-
ing to Him such a fall, "Get thee behind me, Satan; it is
written, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God." But to
Peter he said, signifying by what death he should glorify
God, "When thou wast young, thou girdedst thyself and
walkedst whither thou wouldest; but when thou art old,
another shall gird thee, and shall carry thee whither thou
wouldest not." Where he sufficiently intimated that he who
follows Christ's footsteps must be put to death, not by
himself but by another.

Te Deum

We praise thee, O God; we acknowledge thee to be the
Lord.

All the earth doth worship thee: the Father everlasting.
To thee all Angels cry aloud: the heavens and all the
Powers therein, &c.

§ 6. Matin Service for March 21.

Bishop Ken's day

[For Social or Private Devotion.]

O Lord, open Thou my lips.

And my mouth shall show forth Thy praise.

O God, make speed to save me.

O Lord make haste to help me.

Glory be, &c.

As it was, &c. *Amen.*

Praise to Thee, O Lord, King of eternal glory.

(a) *Invitatory with Psalm 95.*

Vide pp. 17 & 21.

O come, let us worship the Lord, the King of Confessors.

O come, let us sing unto the Lord: let us heartily rejoice, &c.

(b) *Hymn*

In witness of his Lord,

In humble following of his Saviour dear,

This is the man to wield the unearthly sword,

Warring unharmed with sin and fear.

Who, Lord, uncalled by Thee,

Dare touch Thy Spouse, Thy very self below?

Or who dare count him summoned worthily,

Except Thine hand and seal he show?

Where can Thy seal be found,

But on the chosen seed from age to age,

By Thine anointed heralds duly crowned,

As kings and priests, Thy war to wage?

Or this.

Lord, and what shall this man do?

Ask'st thou, Christian, for thy friend?

If his love for Christ be true,

Christ hath told thee of his end:

This is he whom God approves,

This is he whom Jesus loves.

Ask not of Him more than this,

Leave it to his Saviour's breast,

Whether early called to bliss,

He in youth shall find his rest,

Or armed at his station wait,

Till his Lord be at the gate.

Gales from heaven, if so He will,

Sweeter melodies can wake,

On the lonely mountain rill,

Than the meeting waters make,

Who hath the Father and the Son,
May be left, but not alone.

NOCTURN I.

(c) *Antiphon* Blessed is the man whose delight is in the law of the Lord.

Psalm 1. (1) Blessed is the man that, &c.

(c) *Antiphon* Blessed is the man whose delight is in the law of the Lord, who hath not walked in the counsel of the ungodly, nor stood in the way of sinners, and hath not sat in the seat of the scornful.

(d) *Antiphon*

Desire of me, and I will give thee the heathen for thine inheritance.

Psalm 2. (2) Why do the heathen, &c.

(d) *Antiphon* Desire of me, and I will give thee the heathen for thine inheritance, and the utmost parts of the earth for thy possession. Thou shalt bruise them with a rod of iron.

(e) *Antiphon*

Thou, O Lord, art my worship.

Psalm 3. (3) Lord, how are they, &c.

(e) *Antiphon* Thou, O Lord, art my worship, and the lifter up of my head. I did call upon the Lord with my voice, and He heard me out of His holy hill.

(1) *Verse and Response*

The Lord loved him and adorned him.

And clothed him in a robe of glory.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil. Absolution 1. O Lord Jesus Christ, mercifully hear the supplications of Thy people, and grant us Thy peace all the days of our life, who livest and reignest with the Father and the Holy Ghost, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 1.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Lord bless us and keep us. *Amen.*

Lesson 1.

1 *Tim.* iii. 1-6. This is a true saying, If a man desire the office of a Bishop, he desireth a good work.

A Bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre;

but patient, not a brawler, not covetous:

One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all gravity;

(For if a man know not how to rule his own house, how shall he take care of the Church of God?)

Not a novice, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 1.

Well done, thou good and faithful servant, thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy Lord.

Lord, Thou deliveredst unto me five talents, behold, I have gained beside them five talents more.

Enter thou into the joy of thy Lord.

Benediction 2.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Lord make His face to shine upon us, and be gracious unto us. *Amen.*

Lesson 2.

Tit. i. 7-11. For a Bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not self-willed, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;

Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

For there are many unruly and vain talkers and deceivers, specially they of the circumcision.

Whose mouth must be stopped, who subvert whole houses, teaching things which they ought not, for filthy lucre's sake.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 2.

Let Thy Thummim and Thy Urim be with Thy holy one, whom Thou didst prove at Massah, and with whom Thou didst strive at the waters of Meribah; they shall put incense before Thee, and whole burnt sacrifice upon Thine altar.

Bless, Lord, his substance, and accept the work of his hands; smite through the loins of them that rise against him, and of them that hate him, that they rise not again:

They shall put incense before Thee, and whole burnt sacrifice upon Thine altar.

Benediction 3.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Lord lift up His countenance upon us, and give us peace. *Amen.*

Lesson 3.

Tit. ii. 1-8. But speak thou the things which become sound doctrine.

That the aged men be sober, grave, temperate, sound in faith, in charity, in patience.

The aged women likewise, that *they be* in behaviour as becometh holiness, not false accusers, not given to much wine, teachers of good things;

That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children.

To be discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.

Young men likewise exhort to be sober-minded.

In all things showing thyself pattern of good works; in

doctrine *showing* uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity,

Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 3.

Let the saints be joyful with glory, let them rejoice in their beds, let the praises of God be in their mouths, and a two-edged sword in their hands: to bind their kings in chains, and their nobles with links of iron.

That they may be avenged of them, as it is written, Such honour have all His saints.

To bind their kings in chains, and their nobles with links of iron.

Glory be, &c.

To bind their kings in chains, and their nobles with links of iron.

NOCTURN II.

(g) *Antiphon* Thou hast put gladness in my heart.

Psalm 4. (4) Hear me when I call, &c.

(g) *Antiphon* Thou hast put gladness in my heart, since the time that their corn, and wine, and oil increased.

(h) *Antiphon*

Lead me, O Lord, in Thy righteousness.

Psalm 5. (5) Ponder my words, &c.

(h) *Antiphon* Lead me, O Lord, in Thy righteousness, because of mine

enemies; make Thy way plain before my face.

(i) *Antiphon*

Out of the mouth of very babes and sucklings hast Thou ordained strength.

Psalm 8. (6) O Lord, our Governor, &c.

(i) *Antiphon* Out of the mouth of very babes and sucklings hast Thou ordained strength, because of Thine enemies, that Thou mightest still the enemy and the avenger.

(j) *Verse and Response*

The Lord hath chosen Him as a priest unto Himself.

To sacrifice to Him the offering of praise.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Absolution 2.

Grant, O Lord, we beseech Thee, that we, who for our evil deeds do worthily deserve to be punished, by the comfort of Thy grace may mercifully be relieved, who livest and reignest with the Father and the Holy Ghost, ever one God, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 4.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister. —The love of God be upon us now and for ever.

Lesson 4. Thomas Ken, the son of an ancient family, was born at Berkhamstead, in Hertfordshire, in the year of grace, 1637, and educated at Winton and Oxford, on the foundation of William of Wykeham, of famous memory, some time Bishop of Winton. Admitted into holy orders, he commenced a course of preaching at St. John's church, near Winton, where there was no preacher, with so blessed an effect, that many Anabaptists came over to the Church, and received baptism at his hands. That he might have time for these active duties, for study also, and for prayer, he restricted himself to but one sleep, rising at one or two of the clock in the morning, and sometimes sooner; which practice grew into a habit, and continued with him almost till his last illness. After a while he was made chaplain to the king's niece, the Princess of Orange, and passed over to Holland; where, after gaining her entire esteem for his most prudent behaviour and strict piety, he fell under the displeasure of the Prince, for interfering with one of his courtiers, who had seduced a young English gentlewoman, and was eventually obliged to leave the royal service.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 4.

Princes have persecuted me without a cause; but my heart standeth in awe of Thy word.

I will speak of Thy testimonies also, even before kings,
and will not be ashamed.

But my heart standeth in awe of Thy word.

Benediction 5.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be upon us,
now and for ever. *Amen.*

Lesson 5. Afterwards, when he was at Winton, in his Prebendal house, the king came thither with his court and mistress, whom his harbingers ordered to be lodged where Ken dwelt; but fearing God more than the face of the king, he refused her admittance, and obliged her to seek another lodging. And herein was seen how winning is holy severity, even with those who suffer for it; for a vacancy soon occurring in the see of Bath and Wells, the king himself, as his own especial act, named Ken to fill it; and he was consecrated thereunto out St. Paul's day, in the year 1684. Moreover, during the king's last illness, he was admitted to his chamber, and gave close attendance at his bedside for at least three whole days and nights, without any intermission, watching at proper intervals to suggest pious thoughts and prayers; in which time one of the King's mistresses coming in, the Bishop prevailed with him to have her removed, and induced him further to send for the Queen, and ask her forgiveness for his long infidelity. And though he was not able to do all he had wished for his dying Sovereign, he did all that was allowed him.

But Thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 5.

Many shall be purified, and made white, and tried: and many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake.

And they that be wise shall shine as the brightness of the firmament, and they that turn many to righteousness as the stars for ever and ever.

And many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake.

Benediction 6.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The fellowship of the Holy Ghost be with us

now and for ever. *Amen.*

Lesson 6. When the King's brother succeeded to the throne, Ken showed his loyalty to him indeed, but in word was free spoken. At length, when the King advanced in daring, the Bishop refusing to submit the conduct of the Church to his pleasure, and mindful of the rights of Christ's heritage, was in consequence committed, together with six of his brethren, to the Tower, on a charge of treason. Afterwards, when the King and his family were dethroned for arbitrary doings, he showed his true loyalty to him by refusing to acknowledge the new dynasty, and lost his station in the state rather than violate his allegiance. Being driven from his see by the civil power, he died in obscurity in the year 1710. Thus he gave to Cæsar the things that be Cæsar's, and to God the things that be God's. He was as meek, gentle, and affectionate in his bearing, as he was bold in the cause of the Gospel; and he took his troubles cheerfully and lightly. He possessed, in an especial way, that most excellent gift of charity. Once, when four thousand pounds fell to his see, he gave great part of it to the French Protestants then under persecution; and, when he was deprived, all his means, after the sale of goods at his palace and elsewhere, was not more than seven hundred pounds. When state interests interfered with the prosperity of the Church in Scotland, he said, he conceived great hopes that God would have compassion on the English branch of it, if she did but compassionate and support her sister: and he gave testimony concerning his belief shortly before his death, saying that he died in the Holy Catholic and Apostolic Faith, professed by the whole Church before the disunion of east and west. Such was Ken, a burning and shining light, bringing back primitive times.

But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 6.

*I said I have laboured in vain, I have spent my strength
for nought and in vain; yet surely my judgment is
with the Lord, and my work with my God.*

He hath made my mouth like a sharp sword: in the
shadow of His hand hath He hid me.

*Surely my judgment is with the Lord, and my work with
my God.*

Glory be, &c.

*Surely my judgment is with the Lord, and my work with
my God.*

NOCTURN III.

(k) *Antiphon* Lord, he shall dwell in Thy tabernacle.

Psalm 15. (7) Lord, who shall dwell, &c.

(k) *Antiphon* Lord, he shall dwell in Thy tabernacle: he hath led an uncorrupt life, he hath done the thing that is right.

(l) *Antiphon*

He asked life of Thee, and Thou gavest him a long life.

Psalm 21. (8) The king shall rejoice, &c.

(l) *Antiphon* He asked life of Thee, and Thou gavest him a long life: glory and great worship shalt Thou lay upon him: Thou shalt set a crown of pure gold upon his head.

(m) *Antiphon*

He shall receive the blessing from the Lord.

Psalm 24. (9) The earth is the Lord's, &c.

(m) *Antiphon* He shall receive the blessing from the Lord, and righteousness from the God of his salvation; for this is the generation of them that seek him.

(n) *Verse and Response*

The key of David will I lay upon his shoulder.

He shall open and none shall shut, and He shall shut and none shall open.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation.

But deliver us from evil. Absolution 3. Grant to us, merciful Lord, that, whereas we are sore let and hindered in running the race that is set before us, Thy bountiful grace and mercy may speedily help and deliver us, who livest and reignest with the Father and the Holy Ghost, ever one God, world without end. *Amen.*

Benediction 7.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The reading of the Gospel be to us salvation and a defence. *Amen.*

Lesson 7.

Luke xxii. 25-30. And he said unto them, The Kings of the Gentiles exercise lordship over them: and they that exercise authority upon them are called benefactors.

But ye shall not be so: but he that is greatest among you, let him be as the younger: and he that is chief, as he that doth serve.

For whether is greater, he that sitteth at meat, or he that serveth? *is not he that sitteth at meat? but I am among you as he that serveth.*

Ye are they which have continued with me in my temptations.

And I appoint unto you a kingdom, as my Father hath appointed unto me;

That ye may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and sit on thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

(From the works of Jeremy Taylor, Bishop.) The nature of honour is to be a reward of virtue; and by how much greater the reward is, by so much the greater is the honour which is conferred. What honour shall it then be, when God shall give unto those who served Him, not only to tread upon the stars, to inhabit the palaces of honour, to be lords of the world, but, transcending all that is created, and finding nothing among his riches sufficient to reward them, shall give then His own Infinite Essence, to enjoy, as a recompence of their holiness, not for a day, but to all eternity. O happy labour of the victorious, and glorious combat of the just, against the vices and temptations of the world, when victory deserves so inestimable a crown! How great shall be that glory, when a just soul shall, in the presence of an infinite number of angels, sit in the same throne with Christ: and shall, by the just sentence of God, be praised for a conqueror over the world, and the invisible powers of hell! What can it desire more, than to be partaker of all those Divine goods, and even to accompany Christ in the same throne? How cheerfully do they bear all afflictions for Christ, who with a lively faith and certain hope apprehend so sublime honours.

Thou, then, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 7.

Whosoever shall confess Me before men, him shall the Son of man also confess before the Angels of God.

To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with Me in My throne.

Him shall the Son of man also confess before the Angels of God.

Benediction 8.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—Grace be with all them that love our Lord Jesus Christ in sincerity. *Amen.*

Lesson 8. If the applause of men, and the good opinion which they have from others, be esteemed an honour, what shall be the applause of heaven, and the good opinion not only of Saints and Angels, but of God himself, whose judgment cannot err? David took it for a great honour, that the daughter of his king was judged a reward of his valour; God surpasses this, and honours so much the service of his elect, that He pays their merits with no less a reward than Himself. Be-

sides this, he who is most known, and is praised and celebrated for good and virtuous by the greatest multitude, is esteemed the most glorious and honourable person: but all this world is a solitude in respect of the citizens of heaven, where innumerable angels approve and praise the virtuous actions of the just; and they likewise are nothing: and all creatures, men, and angels, are but a solitary wilderness, in respect of the Creator. What man so glorious upon earth, whose worth and valour hath been known to all? Those who were born before him could not know him; but the just in heaven shall be known by all, past and to come, and by all the angels, and by the King of men and angels. But thou, O Lord, have mercy upon us.

Thanks be to God.

Response 8.

In the sight of the unwise they seemed to die, and their departure is taken for misery, but they are in peace.

Though they be punished in the sight of men, yet is their hope full of immortality.

But they are in peace.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

But they are in peace.

Benediction 9.

Reader.—Sir, be pleased to bless us.

Minister.—The Lord of peace Himself give you peace always by all means. *Amen.*

Lesson 9. The honour of the just in heaven depends not, like that of the earth, upon accidents and reports, nor is exposed to dangers, or measured by the discourse of others; but in itself contains its own glory and dignity. The Romans erected statues unto those whom they intended to honour; because, being mortal, there should something remain after death, to make their persons and services, which they had done to the common weal, known to posterity; but in heaven there is no need of this artifice, because those, which are there honoured, are immortal, and shall have in themselves some character engraved, as an evident and clear token of their noble victories and achievements; what greater honour than to be friends of God, sons, heirs, and kings in the realm of heaven?

Te Deum We praise Thee, O God; we acknowledge Thee to be the Lord.

All the earth doth worship Thee: the Father everlasting.

To Thee all angels cry aloud; the heavens, and all the Powers therein, &c.

§ 7. Service in Commemoration of the Dead in Christ.

[It is perhaps scarcely necessary to observe, that the complaints and supplications contained in the Psalms and Lessons selected, are introduced in memory of those temporal miseries, especially in sickness and dying, from which death opens an escape. On the subject of the state of the Dead, *vide* No. 5 of Mr. Dodsworth's recent Sermons.]

FIRST VESPERS

Antiphon Behold, O Lord, how that I am Thy servant.

Psalm 116. (1)

(Instead of Glory be, &c.) I am well pleased, &c.

With thee is the well of life.

And in Thy light they shall see light.

Antiphon Behold, O Lord, how that I am Thy servant; Thou hast broken my bonds in sunder.

Antiphon

My soul hath long dwelt among.

Psalm 120. (2) When I was in trouble, &c.

With Thee, &c.

And in Thy, &c.

Antiphon My soul hath long dwelt among them that are enemies unto peace.

Antiphon

The Lord shall preserve Thee from all evil.

Psalm 121. (3) I will lift up mine eyes, &c.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon The Lord shall preserve Thee from all evil; yea, it is even He that shall keep Thy soul.

Antiphon

I look for the Lord.

Psalm 130. (4) Out of the deep, &c.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon I look for the Lord, my soul doth wait for Him.

Antiphon

Though I walk in the midst of trouble.

Psalm 138. (5) I will give thanks unto Thee, &c.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon Though I walk in the midst of trouble, yet shalt Thou refresh me.

(fff) Verse and Response

I heard a voice from heaven, saying unto me,

Blessed are the dead that die in the Lord.

(ggg) Ant. All that the Father giveth Me.

Magnificat My soul doth magnify, &c. Glory be, &c.

Ant. All that the Father giveth Me, shall come to Me; and him that cometh to Me, I will in no wise cast out.

The Lord's Prayer
(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

And lead us not into temptation,

But deliver us from evil.

Psalm 146. Praise the Lord, O my soul, &c.

With Thee is the well of life.

And in Thy light shall they see light.

In the valley of the shadow of death.

They shall fear no evil.

Into Thy hands we commend their spirit.

For Thou hast redeemed them, O Lord, Thou God of truth.

Lord hear our prayer.

And let our cry come unto Thee.

The Lord be with you.

And with thy spirit.

Let us pray.

O God, the Maker and Redeemer of all believers, grant to all Thy servants a merciful judgment at the last day, that they, in the face of all creatures, may then be acknowledged as Thy true children, through our Lord Jesus Christ. *Amen.*

O Almighty God, who hast knit together thine elect in one communion and fellowship in the mystical body of Thy Son Christ our Lord, grant us grace to follow Thy blessed Saints in all virtuous and godly living, that we may come to those unspeakable joys which Thou hast prepared for them that unfeignedly love Thee, through Jesus Christ our Lord. *Amen.*

Almighty God, with whom do live the spirits of them that depart hence in the Lord, and with whom the souls of the faithful, after they are delivered from the burden of the flesh, are in joy and felicity, we give Thee hearty thanks for that it pleased Thee, as on this day, to deliver our dear brother out of the miseries of this sinful world; beseeching Thee that it may please Thee of Thy gracious goodness, shortly to accomplish the number of Thine elect, and to hasten Thy kingdom, that we, with all those that are departed in the true faith of Thy holy name, may have our perfect consummation and bliss, both in body and soul, in Thy eternal and everlasting glory, through Jesus Christ our Lord. *Amen.*

O God, merciful and faithful, the aid of all that trust in Thee, keep safely under the shadow of thy wings ourselves, our relations, and friends, and all believers, even Thy whole Church, that we may enjoy Thy presence alway, and increase in Thy Holy Spirit more and more, till we come to Thine everlasting kingdom, through our Lord and

Saviour Jesus Christ. *Amen.*
With Thee is the well of life.
And in Thy light shall they see light.
May their souls rest in peace. *Amen.*

MATINS

O Lord, open Thou my lips.
And my mouth shall show forth Thy praise.
O God, make speed to save me.
O Lord, make haste to help me.
Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.
(a) *Invitatory* Let us worship the Lord of spirits: for all live unto Him.
Psalm 95. O come, let us sing, &c.
With Thee is the well of life.
And in Thy light shall they see light.

NOCTURN I.

Antiphon In Thy fear will I worship.
Psalm 5. Ponder my words, &c.
Antiphon With Thee, &c.
In Thy fear will I worship towards Thy Holy Temple.
Antiphon
The Lord hath heard my petition.
Psalm 6. O Lord, rebuke me not, &c.
With Thee, &c.
Antiphon The Lord hath heard my petition, the Lord will receive
my prayer.
Antiphon
We will rejoice.
Psalm 20. The Lord hear thee in the day of trouble, &c.
With Thee, &c.
Antiphon We will rejoice in Thy salvation, and triumph in the
name of the Lord our God.
(f) *Verse and Response*
In the valley of the shadow of death.
They shall fear no evil.
The Lord's Prayer
(privately.)
Our Father, &c.
Lesson 1.
Job ix. 11-20. Lo, he goeth by me, and I see *him* not: he passeth on
also, but I perceive him not.
Behold, he taketh away, who can hinder him? who will
say unto him, What doest thou?

If God will not withdraw his anger, the proud helpers do stoop under him.

How much less shall I answer him, *and* choose out my words *to reason* with him?

Whom, though I were righteous, *yet* would I not answer, *but* I would make supplication to my judge.

If I had called, and he had answered me; *yet* would I not believe that he had hearkened unto my voice.

For he breaketh me with a tempest, and multiplieth my wounds without cause.

He will not suffer me to take my breath, but filleth me with bitterness.

If I *speak* of strength, lo, *he is* strong: and if of judgment, who shall set me a time *to plead*?

If I justify myself, mine own mouth shall condemn me: *if I say I am* perfect, it shall also prove me perverse.

Response 1.

I know that my Redeemer liveth, and that he shall stand on the latter day upon the earth; and in my flesh shall I see God.

Whom I shall see for myself, and my eyes shall behold, and not another.

And in my flesh shall I see God.

Lesson 2.

Job x. 1-7.

My soul is weary of my life; I will leave my complaint upon myself; I will speak in the bitterness of my soul.

I will say unto God, Do not condemn me; show me wherefore thou contendest with me.

Is it good unto thee that thou shouldest oppress, that thou shouldest despise the work of thine hands, and shine upon the counsel of the wicked?

Hast thou eyes of flesh? or seest thou as man seeth?

Are thy days as the days of man? *are* thy years as man's days?

That thou enquirest after mine iniquity, and searchest after my sin?

Thou knowest that I am not wicked: and *there is* none that can deliver out of thine hand.

Response 2.

I should utterly have fainted, but that I believe verily to see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living.

O tarry thou the Lord's leisure: be strong and He shall comfort thine heart, and put thou thy trust in the Lord.

I believe verily to see the goodness of the Lord in the land of the living.

Lesson 3.

Job x. 14-22.

If I sin, then thou markest me, and thou wilt not acquit me from mine iniquity.

If I be wicked, woe unto me; and *if* I be righteous, *yet* will I not lift up my head. I *am* full of confusion; therefore see thou mine affliction;

For it increaseth. Thou huntest me as a fierce lion; and again thou showest thyself marvellous upon me.

Thou renewest thy witnesses against me, and increasest thine indignation upon me; changes and war *are* against me!

Wherefore then hast thou brought me forth out of the womb? Oh that I had given up the ghost, and no eye had seen me!

I should have been as though I had not been; I should have been carried from the womb to the grave.

Are not my days few? cease *then*, and let me alone, that I may take comfort a little.

Before I go *whence* I shall not return, *even* to the land of darkness and the shadow of death;

A land of darkness, as darkness *itself*; and of the shadow of death, without any order, and *where* the light is as darkness.

Response 3.

The people that walked in darkness have seen a great light; they that dwelt in the land of the shadow of death, upon them hath the light shined.

Awake thou that sleepest, and arise from the dead, and Christ shall give thee light.

They that dwell in the land of the shadow of death, upon them hath the light shined.

With thee is the well of life,

And in thy light shall we see light.

They that dwell in the land of the shadow of death, upon them hath the light shined.

NOCTURN II.

Antiphon He shall feed me.

Psalm 23. (4) The Lord is my shepherd, &c.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon He shall feed me in a green pasture.

Antiphon

Mine eyes are ever looking.

Psalm 25. (5) Unto Thee, O Lord, will I lift up my soul.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon Mine eyes are ever looking unto the Lord, for he shall pluck my feet out of the net.

Antiphon

In the time of trouble.

Psalm 27. (6) The Lord is my light, &c.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon In the time of trouble He shall hide me in His tabernacle.

(j) *Verse and Response*

Let the Saints be joyful with glory.

Let them rejoice in their beds.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

Lesson 4.

Job xiii. 20-28. Only do not two *things* unto me: then will I not hide myself from thee.

Withdraw thine hand far from me: and let not thy dread make me afraid.

Then call thou, and I will answer: or let me speak, and answer thou me.

How many *are* mine iniquities and sins? make me to know my transgression and my sin.

Wherefore hidest thou thy face, and holdest me for thine enemy?

Wilt thou break a leaf driven to and fro? and wilt thou pursue the dry stubble?

For thou writest bitter things against me, and makest me to possess the iniquities of my youth.

Thou puttest my feet also in the stocks, and lookest narrowly unto all my paths; thou settest a print upon the heels of my feet.

And he, as a rotten thing, consumeth, as a garment that is moth-eaten.

Response 4.

Comfort us again now after the time that thou hast plagued us, and for the years wherein we have suffered adversity.

Show Thy servants Thy work, and their children Thy glory.

For the years wherein we have suffered adversity.

Lesson 5.

Job xvi. 7-22.

But now he hath made me weary: thou hast made desolate all my company.

And thou hast filled me with wrinkles, *which* is a witness *against me*: and my leanness rising up in me, beareth witness to my face.

He teareth *me* in his wrath, who hateth me: he gnasheth upon me with his teeth; mine enemy sharpeneth his eyes upon me.

They have gaped upon me with their mouth, they have smitten me upon the cheek reproachfully, they have gathered themselves together against me.

God hath delivered me to the ungodly, and turned me over into the hands of the wicked.

I was at ease, but he hath broken me asunder: he hath also taken *me* by my neck, and shaken me to pieces, and set me up for his mark.

His archers compass me round about, he cleaveth my reins asunder, and doth not spare; he poureth out my gall upon the ground.

He breaketh me with breach upon breach, he runneth upon me like a giant.

I have sewed sackcloth upon my skin, and defiled my horn in the dust.

My face is foul with weeping, and on my eye-lids *is* the shadow of death;

Not for *any* injustice in mine hands: also my prayer *is* pure.

O earth, cover thou not my blood, and let my cry have no place.

Also, now, behold, my witness *is* in heaven, and my record *is* on high.

My friends scorn me: but *mine* eye poureth out *tears* unto God.

Oh that one might plead for a man with God, as a man *pleadeth* for his neighbour!

When a few years are come, then I shall go the way *whence* I shall not return.

Response 5.

My God hath sent his Angel, and hath shut the lions' mouths that they have not hurt me.

Forasmuch as before Him innocency was found in me; *He hath shut the lions' mouths that they have not hurt me.*

Lesson 6.

Job xiv. 1-10.

Man *that is* born of a woman *is* of few days, and full of trouble.

He cometh forth like a flower, and is cut down; he fleeth also as a shadow, and continueth not.

And dost thou open thine eyes upon such an one, and bringest me into judgment with thee.

Who can bring a clean thing out of an unclean? Not one.

Seeing his days *are* determined, the number of his months *are* with thee, thou hast appointed his bounds that he cannot pass.

Turn from him that he may rest, till he shall accomplish, as an hireling, his day.

For there is hope of a tree, if it be cut down, that it will sprout again, and that the tender branch thereof will not cease.

Though the root thereof wax old in the earth, and the stock thereof die in the ground;

Yet through the scent of water it will bud, and bring forth boughs like a plant.

But man dieth, and wasteth away: yea, man giveth up the ghost, and where *is* he?

Response

Thy sun shall no more go down, neither shall thy moon withdraw itself, for the Lord shall be thine everlasting light.

And the days of thy mourning shall be ended.

For the Lord shall be thine everlasting light.

With thee is the well of life, &c.

For the Lord shall be thine everlasting light.

NOCTURN III.

Antiphon

He brought me out.

Psalm 40. (7)

I waited patiently, &c.—With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

He brought me out of the horrible pit, out of the mire and clay.

Antiphon

Heal my soul.

Psalm 41. (8)

Blessed is he, &c.—With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

Heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee.

Antiphon

My soul is athirst.

Psalm 42. (9)

Like as the hart, &c.—With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

My soul is athirst for God, yea, even for the living God;

when shall I come to appear before the presence of God?

(n) *Verse and Response*

O deliver not the soul of Thy turtledove unto the multitude of the enemies.

And forget not the congregation of the poor for ever.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.) Our Father, &c.

Lesson 7.

Job xvii. 11-16.

My days are passed, my purposes are broken off, *even* the thoughts of my heart.

They change the night into day: the light *is* short because of darkness.

If I wait, the grave *is* mine house: I have made my bed in the darkness.

I have said to corruption, Thou *art* my father: to the worm, *Thou art* my mother and my sister.

And where is now my hope? as for my hope, who shall see it?

They shall go down to the bars of the pit, when *our* rest together *is* in the dust.

Response 7.

Thy dead men shall live, together with my dead body shall they arise.

Awake and sing, ye that dwell in dust, for thy dew is as the dew of herbs, and the earth shall cast out the dead.

Together with my dead body shall they come.

Lesson 8.

Job xix. 20-27.

My bone cleaveth to my skin and to my flesh, and I am escaped with the skin of my teeth.

Have pity upon me, have pity upon me, O ye my friends; for God hath touched me.

Why do ye persecute me as God, and are not satisfied with my flesh?

Oh that my words were now written, oh that they were printed in a book!

That they were graven with an iron pen and lead, in the rock for ever!

For I know *that* my Redeemer liveth, and *that* he shall stand at the latter *day* upon the earth:

And *though* after my skin *worms* destroy this *body*, yet in my flesh shall I see God:

Whom I shall see for myself, and mine eyes shall behold, and not another; *though* my reins be consumed within me.

Response 8.

If Thou, Lord, wilt be extreme to mark what is done amiss, O Lord, who may abide it? but there is mercy with Thee,

Wash me throughly from my wickedness, and cleanse me from my sin.

But there is mercy with Thee.

Lesson 9.

Jonah ii. 2-10.

I cried by reason of mine affliction unto the Lord, and he heard me; out of the belly of hell cried I, *and* thou hearest my voice.

For thou hadst cast me into the deep, in the midst of the seas; and the floods compassed me about: all thy billows and thy waves passed over me.

Then I said, I am cast out of thy sight; yet I will look again toward thy holy temple.

The waters compassed me about, *even* to the soul; the depth closed me round about, the weeds were wrapt about my head.

I went down to the bottoms of the mountains: the earth with her bars *was* about me for ever: yet hast thou brought up my life from corruption, O Lord my God.

When my soul fainted within me, I remembered the Lord, and my prayer came in unto thee, into thine holy temple.

They that observe lying vanities, forsake their own mercy.

But I will sacrifice unto thee with the voice of thanksgiving; I will pay *that* that I have vowed: salvation *is* of the Lord.

And the Lord spake unto the fish, and it vomited out Jonah upon the dry land.

Response 9.

I am the Resurrection and the Life, he that believeth in me, though he were dead, yet shall he live.

And whosoever liveth and believeth in Me shall never die.

Though he were dead, yet shall he live.

With Thee is the well of life, &c.

Though he were dead, yet shall he live.

LAUDS

Antiphon

Cast me not away.

Psalms 51. (1)

Have mercy upon me, &c. With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

Cast me not away from thy presence, and take not Thy Holy Spirit from me.

Antiphon

Have I not remembered Thee?

Psalm 63. (2)

O God, Thou art my God, &c. With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

Have I not remembered Thee in say bed, and thought
upon Thee when I was waking?

Antiphon

I am like a green olive tree.

Psalm 52. (3)

O God, thou art my God, &c. With Thee, &c.

I am like a green olive tree in the house of God; my
trust is in the tender mercy of God for ever and ever.

Antiphon

The living, the living, he shall praise Thee.

Song of Ezekias (4)

Is. xxxviii. 10-20.

I said, in the cutting off of my days I shall go to the gates
of the grave: I am deprived of the residue of my years, &c.

I said, I shall not see the Lord, even the Lord in the
land of the living: I shall behold man no more with the
inhabitants of the world.

Mine age is departed, and is removed from me as a shep-
herd's tent: I have cut off like a weaver my life: he will
cut me off with pining sickness: from day *even* to night wilt
thou make an end of me.

I reckoned till morning, *that* as a lion so will he break
all my bones: from day even to night wilt thou make an
end of me.

Like a crane *or* a swallow, so did I chatter: I did mourn
as a dove; mine eyes fail *with looking* upward: O Lord, I
am oppressed; undertake for me.

What shall I say? he hath both spoken unto me, and
himself hath done *it*: I shall go softly all my years in the
bitterness of my soul.

O Lord, by these *things men* live, and in all these *things is* the life of my spirit: so wilt thou
recover me, and make
me to live.

Behold, for peace I had great bitterness: but thou hast
in love to my soul *delivered it* from the pit of corruption:
for thou hast cast all my sins behind thy back.

For the grave cannot praise thee, death can *not* celebrate
thee: they that go down into the pit cannot hope for thy
truth.

The living, the living, he shall praise thee, as I do this

day: the father to the children shall make known thy truth.

The Lord *was ready* to save me: therefore we will sing my songs to the stringed instruments all the days of our life, in the house of the Lord. With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

The living, the living, he shall praise Thee, as I do this day.

Antiphon

Let every thing that hath breath.

Ps. 148, 149, &

150. (5)

O praise the Lord of heaven.

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

Let every thing that hath breath praise the Lord.

(v) Verse and Response

I heard a voice from heaven, saying unto me,

Blessed are they that die in the Lord.

(w) Antiphon

I am the Resurrection and the life.

Benedictus

Blessed be the Lord God of Israel, &c

With Thee, &c.

Antiphon

I am the Resurrection and the life; he that believeth in

Me, though he were dead, yet shall he live, and whosoever

liveth and believeth in Me, shall never die.

The Lord's Prayer

(privately.)

Our Father, &c.

Psalm 126.

When the Lord turned again, &c.

The Service terminates with the Collects and Sentences used at Vespers, p. 147, 148.

With Thee is the well, &c.

May their souls rest in peace. *Amen.*

§ 8. Service for the Sundays in Advent.

[Sections 2 and 3 form the respective bases to this and the following section, the letters and numbers marking the substitutions: the Hymns at Matins, Lauds, and Vespers are the only portion of the Services not given. Christmas Day is here supposed to fall on a Sunday. The Service for St. Thomas's necessarily affects the Lauds and dependent Hours on the 21st: with this exception no notice is taken of Festivals, which materially alter the Advent Services as actually performed in the Latin Church. It is instructive to compare the Sunday Services as they here stand, with ours, which are formed from them.]

MATINS

O Lord, open, &c.

And our mouth, &c.

O God, make speed, &c.

O Lord, make haste, &c.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

(a) *Invitatory Sundays 1 & 2.* O come, let us worship: the Lord our King is coming.

Sundays 3 & 4. O come, let us worship: the Lord is now at hand.

(b) *Hymn*

Verbum supernum prodiens, &c.

NOCTURN I.

(c) *Antiphon* Behold, the mighty King: shall come with great power to save the nations. Hallelujah.

(d) *Antiphon* Strengthen ye: the weak hands, and confirm the feeble knees; say to them of fearful heart, Behold your God will come and save you. Hallelujah.

(e) *Antiphon* Be strong: fear not, behold your God will come with vengeance, even God with a recompense: He will come and save you. (f) *Verse and Response* Out of Sion hath God appeared in perfect beauty.

SUNDAY 1.

Lesson 1.

Isa. i. 1-3. The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz, which he saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem in the days of Uzziah, Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.

Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth: for the Lord hath spoken, I have nourished and brought up children, and they have rebelled against me.

The ox knoweth his owner, and the ass his master's crib: but Israel doth not know, my people doth not consider.

Response 1. I look afar off, and behold, I see the power of God coming, and a cloud covering the whole earth: Go ye forth to meet him, and say: Tell us, whether Thou be He: who shall rule over the people Israel.

All ye children of the earth and sons of men, the rich and the poor together.

Go ye forth to meet him, and say: Tell us, whether Thou be He: who shall rule over the people Israel.

Hear, O Thou Shepherd of Israel, Thou that leadest Joseph like a sheep.

Tell us, whether Thou be He: who shall rule over the people Israel.

Lift up your heads, O ye gates, and be ye lift up, ye everlasting doors, and the King of glory shall come in.

Who shall rule over the people Israel.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

I look afar off, and behold, I see the power of God, &c.

Lesson 2.

Isa. i. 4-6. Ah sinful nation, a people laden with iniquity, a seed of evil doers, children that are corrupters: they have forsaken the Lord, they have provoked the Holy One of Israel unto anger, they are gone away backward.

Why should ye be stricken any more? ye will revolt more and more: the whole head is sick, and the whole heart faint.

From the sole of the foot even unto the head *there is* no soundness in it; *but* wounds, and bruises, and putrifying sores: they have not been closed, neither bound up, neither

mollified with ointment. *Response 2. I saw in the night visions, and behold, One like unto the Son of man come with the clouds of heaven, and there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom: that all people, nations, and languages should serve Him.*

His dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and His kingdom that which shall not be destroyed.

That all people, nations, &c.

Lesson 3.

Isa. i. 7-9. Your country *is* desolate, your cities are burned with fire: your land, strangers devour it in your presence, and *it is* desolate, as overthrown by strangers.

And the daughter of Zion is left as a cottage in a vineyard, as a lodge in a garden of cucumbers, as a besieged city.

Except the Lord of hosts had left unto us a very small remnant, we should have been as Sodom, *and* we should have been like unto Gomorrah.

Response 3. The angel Gabriel was sent to Mary, a virgin espoused to Joseph, announcing to her the Word, and the virgin was troubled at the light: Fear not, Mary, thou hast found favour with the Lord, and behold thou shall conceive and bring forth a son, and He shall be called the Son of the Highest.

The Lord God shall give unto Him the Throne of His father David, and He shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever.

Behold, thou shalt conceive, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Behold, thou shalt conceive, &c.

SUNDAY 2.

Lesson 1.

Isa. xi. 1-4. And there shall come forth a rod out of the stem of Jesse, and a Branch shall grow out of his roots:

And the Spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him, the spirit of wisdom and understanding, the spirit of counsel and might, the spirit of knowledge and of the fear of the Lord; And shall make him of quick understanding in the fear of the Lord: and he shall not judge after the sight of his eyes, neither reprove after the hearing of his ears:

But with righteousness shall he judge the poor, and reprove with equity for the meek of the earth: and he shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the

breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked. *Response. O Jerusalem, thy salvation shall come quickly:*

wherefore

art thou consumed with grief? is there any counselor in thee? because sorrow hath changed thee:

I will save thee and deliver thee: fear not.

For I am the Lord thy God; the Holy One of Israel, thy Redeemer.

I will save thee and deliver thee: fear not.

Lesson 2.

Is. xi. 4-7. And he shall smite the earth with the rod of his mouth, and with the breath of his lips shall he slay the wicked.

And righteousness shall be the girdle of his loins, and faithfulness the girdle of his reins.

The wolf also shall dwell with the lamb, and the leopard shall lie down with the kid; and the calf and the young lion and the fatling together; and a little child shall lead them.

And the cow and the bear shalt feed; their young ones shall lie down together: and the lion shall eat straw like the ox.

Response 2. The Lord, my God, shall come, and all the saints with

Thee, and in that day there shall be great light: and

it shall be in that day that living waters shall go out

from Jerusalem, and the Lord shall be king for ever:

over all the earth.

Behold, the Lord shall come with power, and His kingdom shall be in His hand, and dominion and sovereignty,
Over all the earth.

Lesson 3.

Is. xi. 8-10. And the sucking child shall play on the hole of the asp, and the weaned child shall put his hand on the cockatrice' den.

They shall not hurt nor destroy in all my holy mountain: for the earth shall be full of the knowledge of the Lord, as the waters cover the sea.

And in that day there shall be a root of Jesse, which shall stand for an ensign of the people; to it shall the Gentiles seek: and his rest shall be glorious.

Response 3. City of Jerusalem, weep thou not, for the Lord hath sorrowed for thee: and He shall take from thee all tribulation.

Behold, the Lord shall come in strength, and his arm shall rule.

And He shall take, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

And He shall take, &c. (go on to (g))

SUNDAY 3.

Lesson 1.

Is. xxvi. 1-6. In that day shall this song be sung in the land of Judah; We have a strong city; salvation will *God* appoint *for* walls and bulwarks.

Open ye the gates, that the righteous nation which keepeth the truth may enter in.

Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, *whose* mind *is* stayed *on thee*: because he trusteth in thee.

Trust ye in the Lord for ever: for in the Lord Jehovah *is* everlasting strength.

For he bringeth down them that dwell on high: the lofty city, he layeth it low; he layeth it low, even to the ground: he bringeth it *even* to the dust.

The foot shall tread it down, *even* the feet of the poor, *and* the steps of the needy.

Response 1. Behold, the Lord shall appear on a white cloud: and with him the thousands of His saints; and he shall have written on his garment and on his thigh, King of kings, and Lord of lords.

He shall appear in the end and shall not lie: if He tarry, wait for Him; for He shall surely come:

And with Him the thousands, &c.

Lesson 2.

Is. xxvi. 7-10.

The way of the just *is* uprightness; thou, most upright, dost weigh the path of the just.

Yes, in the way of thy judgments, O Lord, have we waited for thee: the desire of *our* soul *is* to thy name, and to the remembrance of thee.

With my soul have I desired thee in the night; yea, with my spirit within me will I seek thee early: for when thy judgments *are* in the earth, the inhabitants of the world will learn righteousness.

Let favour be showed to the wicked, *yet* will he not learn righteousness: in the land of uprightness will he deal unjustly, and will not behold the majesty of the Lord.

Response 2. O Bethlehem, city of the Most High God, out of thee shall go forth the Ruler of Israel, whose goings forth have been from everlasting, and He shall be great in the midst of the whole earth: and there shall be peace in our land, when He shall come.

He shall speak peace to the Gentiles, and His dominion shall be from sea to sea.

And there shall be peace, &c.

Lesson 3.

Is. xxvi. 11-14. Lord, when thy hand is lifted up, they will not see: but they shall see, and be ashamed for their envy at the people; yea, the fire of thine enemies shall devour them.

Lord, thou wilt ordain peace for us: for thou also hast wrought all our works in us.

O Lord our God, *other* lords beside thee have had dominion over us: *but* by thee only will we make mention of thy name.

They are dead, they shall not live; they are deceased, they shall not rise: therefore hast thou visited and destroyed them, and made all their memory to perish.

Response 3. He that shall come will come, and will not tarry; and fear shall no more be in our borders; for He is our Saviour.

He will subdue our iniquities; and Thou wilt cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.

For He is our Saviour.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

For He is our Saviour. (go on (g))

SUNDAY 4.

Lesson 1.

Is. xxxv. 1-7. The wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose.

It shall blossom abundantly, and rejoice even with joy and singing: the glory of Lebanon shall be given unto it, the excellency of Carmel and Sharon, they shall see the glory of the Lord, *and* the excellency of our God.

Strengthen ye the weak hands, and confirm the feeble knees.

Say to them *that are* of a fearful heart, Be strong, fear not: behold, your God will come *with* vengeance, *even* God *with* a recompence; He will come and save you.

Then the eyes of the blind shall be opened, and the ears

of the deaf shall be unstopped.

Then shall the lame *man* leap as an hart, and the tongue of the dumb sing: for in the wilderness shall waters break out, and streams in the desert.

And the parched ground shall become a pool, and the thirsty land springs of water.

Response 1. Blow the trumpet in Sion, summon the nations, proclaim to all people and say: Behold God our Saviour shall come.

Proclaim and make it heard; speak and cry aloud.

Behold, God our Saviour shall come.

Lesson 2.

Is. xxxv. 7-10. In the habitation of dragons, where each lay, *shall be* grass with reeds and rushes.

And an highway shall be there, and a way, and it shall be called The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it; but it *shall be* for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein.

No lion shall be there, nor *any* ravenous beast shall go up thereon; it shall not be found there: but the redeemed shall walk *there*.

And the ransomed of the Lord shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads: they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

Response 2. The sceptre shall not depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver from between his feet, until Shiloh come: and unto Him shall the gathering of the people be.

His eyes are redder than wine, and His teeth whiter than milk.

And unto Him shall, &c.

Lesson 3.

Is. xli. 1-4. Keep silence before me, O islands; and let the people renew *their* strength: let them come near; then let them speak: let us come near together to judgment.

Who raised up the righteous man from the east, called him to his foot, gave the nations before him, and made *him* rule over kings? he gave *them* as the dust to his sword, *and* as driven stubble to his bow.

He pursued them, *and* passed safely; *even* by the way *that* he had not gone with his feet.

Who hath wrought and done *it*, calling the generations from the beginning? I the Lord, the first, and with the last; I *am* he.

Response 3. I must decrease, but He must increase; he that cometh after me, was in being before me: whose shoes' latchet I am not worthy to unloose.

I baptized you with water: but He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost.

Whose shoes' latchet, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Whose shoes' latchet, &c. (go on (g))

NOCTURN II.

(g) *Antiphon* Rejoice greatly: O daughter of Jerusalem; behold thy king cometh unto thee; O Sion, be not afraid, for thy salvation cometh quickly.

(h) *Antiphon* Our king: shall come, even Christ, whom John proclaimed as the Lamb which was to come.

(i) *Antiphon* Behold, I come: quickly, and My reward is with Me, to give to every man according as his work shall be.

(j) *Verse and Response* Send ye the Lamb to the Ruler of the land.

From Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the daughter of Sion.

SUNDAY 1.

Lesson 4.

(*From St. Leo.*) Our Saviour, in His account of the coming of the kingdom of God, and of the end of the world, addressed to His Apostles, and in them to the whole Church, bids them beware, lest, at any time, their hearts should be weighed down with surfeiting and drunkenness, and cares of this life: which warning, beloved brethren, we know to belong to us specially, to whom the threatened day, though hidden, is certainly near.

Response 4. Hail thou that art highly favoured; the Lord is with thee: the Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shalt overshadow thee; therefore that Holy Thing which shall be born of Thee shall be called the Son of God.

How shall this be, seeing I know not a man? and the angel answered and said to her,

The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, &c.

Lesson 5. For whose coming it is fitting that all mankind should make ready, lest it should surprise any by gluttony or worldly cares. For daily experience proves, my beloved, that the keenness of the mind is blunted by fulness of drink, and the vigour of the heart clouded by excess of meat; so that love of eating even does injury to our bodily health, unless a rule of temperance counteracts the seduction and

refuses to indulgence what afterwards would be a burden.

Response 5. We look for the Saviour, the Lord Jesus Christ; who shall change this vile body that it may be fashioned like unto His glorious body.

Let us live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present world, looking for the blessed hope and the glorious appearance of the great God.

Who shall change, &c.

Lesson 6. For though the flesh hath no desires apart from the soul, and derives its senses from whence it gains animation, yet it is the part of the soul to deny some things to that body which is made subject to her, and by an inward discretion to hold back what is outward from mischief; that, being often at leisure from bodily desires, she may devote herself to divine wisdom in the palace of the mind, and while the noise of earthly cares is altogether hushed, may rejoice in holy meditations and everlasting pleasures.

Response 6. O my Lord, send, I pray Thee, by the hand of him whom Thou wilt send: behold the affliction of Thy people: as Thou hast spoken, come: and deliver us.

Hear, O Thou Shepherd of Israel, Thou that leadeth Joseph like a sheep, Thou that sittest between the cherubim.
As Thou hast spoken, come: and deliver us.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

And deliver us. (go on (k))

SUNDAY 2.

(From St. Jerome.) And there shall go forth a rod out of the root of Jesse. As far as the beginning of the vision, or burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz saw, all this prophecy relates to Christ. Which I would explain by portions, lest if it be all set forth, and treated at once, it confuse the memory of the reader. The Jews understand our Lord by the rod and flower from the rod of Jesse, the rod signifying his power, the flower his comeliness.

Response 4. Behold, the Lord shall come, our defender, the Holy One of Israel: with the crown of His kingdom upon Him.

And he shall reign from sea to sea, and from the river unto the ends of the earth.

With the crown, &c.

Lesson 5. But we, by the rod from the root of Jesse, understand the holy Virgin Mary, who had no shrub belonging to her: of whom we read before, Behold, a Virgin shall conceive, and shall bear a son. And by the flower is meant the Lord and Saviour, who says in the Song of songs, I am the rose of Sharon, and the lily of the valleys.

Response 5. As a mother comforteth her sons, so will I comfort you, saith the Lord: and from Jerusalem, the city I have chosen, shall succour come to you; and you shall see, and your heart shall rejoice.

I will give to Sion salvation, and to Jerusalem My glory.

And you shall see, &c.

Lesson 6. Therefore upon this flower, which shall suddenly spring up from the stem and root of Jesse by the Virgin Mary, the Spirit of the Lord shall rest; for in Him it hath seemed good that all the fulness of the Godhead should dwell bodily; not by portions, as in the case of other saints, but, according to the Hebrew gospel of the Nazarenes, all the fountain of the Holy Spirit shall descend upon Him. But the Lord is that Spirit; and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.

Response 6. O Jerusalem, thou shall plant thy vine upon thy mountains. Leap for joy, for the day of the Lord shall come. Arise, O Sion, be turned unto the Lord thy God; rejoice and be glad, O Jacob: for thy Saviour shall come in the midst of the nations.

Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Sion: shout, O daughter of Jerusalem.

For thy Saviour shall come in the midst of the nations.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

For thy Saviour shall come, &c. (go on (k))

SUNDAY 3.

Lesson 4.

(From St. Leo.) The time of the year, and our own religious custom, leads me to proclaim to you, dearly beloved, with the anxiety of a pastor, the fast of the 10th month, in which for the completion of the gathering of all fruits, is poured out most suitably to the Lord their giver, the tribute of abstaining from them; for what can be more available than fasting? by observing which we draw near to God, and resisting the devil, overcome our pleasant vices.

Response 4. Weep not, O Egypt, for thy Ruler shall come to thee, before whose coming the depths shall be moved: to deliver His people from the hand of power.

Behold the Lord of hosts shall come, thy God with great power.

To deliver, &c.

Lesson 5. For fasting has ever been the food of virtue. In a word, from abstinence proceed chaste thoughts, moderate wishes, sober purposes: and by voluntary inflictions, the desires of the flesh are mortified, the graces of the spirit strengthened. But since, not by fasting only, the health of our souls is

gained, let us make almsgiving the supplement of fasting. Let us give to active virtue, what we diminish from indulgence: Let the abstinence of the faster be the refreshment of the poor.

Response 5. Her time is well nigh come, and her days shall not be prolonged: the Lord shall have pity upon Jacob, and Israel shall be saved.

Return, O virgin of Israel, return into thy cities.

The Lord shall have pity, &c.

Lesson 6. Let us give attention to the defence of widows, the welfare of orphans, the consolation of mourners, the reconciliation of enemies. Befriend the foreigner, assist the oppressed, clothe the naked, nurse the sick; that whoso of us by righteous labours shall offer to God, the author of all good, such pious sacrifice, may receive in turn for the same the reward of His heavenly kingdom. Let us keep fast on Wednesdays and Fridays; let us keep Vigil on the Sabbath with the blessed Apostle Peter, whose deeds of grace working together with our prayers, we may obtain what we seek through our Lord Jesus Christ, who with the Father and the Holy Ghost, liveth and reigneth, world without end. *Amen.*

Response 6. The Lord shall descend as the rain into a fleece of wool: righteousness shall spring forth in His days, yea, and abundance of peace.

And all kings shall worship Him, all the heathen shall serve Him.

Righteousness shall spring forth, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Righteousness shall spring forth, &c. (go on (k))

SUNDAY 4.

Lesson 4.

(*From St. Leo.*) If we understand truly and wisely, dearly beloved, the history of our creation, we shall find that man was therefore formed after the likeness of God, that he might imitate the Creator; and that the natural dignity of our race consists in the image of divine kindness shining within us as in a mirror. Towards which we are daily renewed by the grace of the Saviour, so that what fell in the first Adam, is raised again in the second.

Response 4. Unto us a child is born, and He shall be called the mighty God: He shall sit upon the throne of David His Father and shall reign: and the dominion shall be upon His shoulder.

And in Him shall all tribes of the earth be blessed, and all nations shall serve Him.

He shall sit, &c.

Lesson 5. The sole cause of our recovery is the pitifulness of God,

whom we should not love, unless He first loved us, and scattered the darkness of our ignorance with the light of His truth; which the Lord declaring by holy Isaiah saith, I will bring the blind by a way that they know not, and paths of which they were ignorant will I make them tread; I will make their darkness light, and their crooked straight. This will I do to them, and not forsake them. And again, I am found of them who sought me not, and I am manifested to them that asked not for me.

Response 5. Behold the fulness of time is now come, in which God sent forth His Son upon the earth, born of a virgin, made under the Law: to redeem those that are under the Law.

For His great love wherewith He loved us, God sent forth His Son in the likeness of sinful flesh.

To redeem those, &c.

Lesson 6. How this was fulfilled the Apostle John teaches, saying, We know that the Son of God is come, and has given us an understanding that we may know him that is true, and we are in His true Son. And again, We love God, because He first loved us. Therefore God, by loving us, restores in us His own image, and that He may find in us the likeness of His own goodness, He giveth whence we also may work what He worketh, by lighting the lamps of our minds, and kindling in us the flame of His own love, that we may love not Him only, but all that He loves.

Response 6. O Virgin of Israel, return to thy cities; how long wilt thou be put aside and be in sorrow? thou shalt conceive the Lord and Saviour, a new oblation in the earth: men shall go forward to salvation.

I have loved thee with an everlasting love; therefore with loving kindness have I drawn thee.

How long wilt thou be put aside and be in sorrow? Thou shalt conceive thy Lord and Saviour, a new oblation in the earth: men shall go forward to salvation.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Men shall go forward to salvation, &c.

NOCTURN III.

(k) *Antiphon* The Angel Gabriel: spake unto Mary, saying, Hail thou that art highly favoured, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women.

(l) *Antiphon* Mary said: What meaneth this salutation ? for my soul is troubled, and I shall bear my King, and yet remain a virgin.

(m) *Antiphon* Before the coming: of the great King, let the hearts of

men be cleansed, to walk worthily to meet Him, for behold
He will come, and will not tarry.

(n) *Verse and Response* The Lord will come forth of his holy place.
He will come to save His people.

SUNDAY 1.

Lesson 7.

Luke xxi. 25-33. At that time Jesus said to his disciples.

There shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in
the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations, with per-
plexity; the sea and the waves roaring;
Men's hearts failing them for fear, and for looking after
those things which are coming on the earth: for the powers
of heaven shall be shaken.

And then shall they see the Son of man coming in a cloud
with power and great glory.

And when these things begin to come to pass, then look
up, and lift up your heads; for your redemption draweth
nigh.

And he spake to them a parable: Behold the fig-tree, and
all the trees;

When they now shoot forth, ye see and know of your own
selves that summer is now nigh at hand.

So likewise ye, when ye see these things come to pass,
know ye that the kingdom of God is nigh at hand.

Verily I say unto you, This generation shall not pass
away, till all be fulfilled.

Heaven and earth shall pass away: but my words shall
not pass away.

(*Homily of Pope Gregory.*) Our Lord and Redeemer, desirous of finding us ready,
foretels what evils shall attend the ageing world, in order to
sober us from the love of it. He makes known how great
strokes shall precede its approaching end; that, if we will
not fear God in prosperity, at least when afflicted by His
strokes, we may dread His near judgment. *Response 7.*

*Behold a virgin shall conceive and bear a Son, saith
the Lord, and His name shall be called Wonderful, the
mighty God.*

Upon the throne of David and over his kingdom shall
He reign for ever.

And his name shall, &c.

Lesson 8. Shortly before the passage of the holy Gospel, which my
brethren have been hearing, the Lord had said, Nation
shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom:
and great earthquakes shall be in divers places, and pesti-
lences and famines. Then after some additions, He says

what you have heard: There shall be signs in the sun, and in the moon, and in the stars; and upon the earth distress of nations with perplexity; the sea and the waves roaring. Of all these signs certainly some we see fulfilled already, others we fear as soon coming.

Response 8. Hear the word of the Lord, O ye nations, and declare it in the ends of the earth; and say to the isles afar off, Our Saviour shall come.

Declare it, and make it heard; speak, and cry out.

And say to the isles, &c.

Lesson 9. For nation is rising against nation, and distress from them presses upon the countries, more in the events we see than in the books we read. You know too how often we hear from other parts of the world, of earthquakes overwhelming cities; pestilences we suffer without respite. We do not yet openly behold signs in the sun, moon, and stars: but the alteration of the atmosphere betokens that they are not far off.

Response 9. Behold the days come, saith the Lord, that I will raise up unto David a righteous Branch, and a King shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth: and this is His name whereby He shall be called: The Lord our Righteousness.

In his days Judah shall be saved and Israel shall dwell safely.

And this is His name whereby He shall be called: The Lord our Righteousness.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

The Lord is our Righteousness.

(End of Matins. The Te Deum is not sung in Advent.)

SUNDAY 2.

Lesson 7.

Matt. xi. 2-9.

Now when John had heard in the prison the works of Christ, he sent two of his disciples.

And said unto Him, Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?

Jesus answered and said unto them, Go and show John again those things which ye do hear and see:

The blind receive their sight, and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.

And blessed is *he*, whosoever shall not be offended in me.

And as they departed, Jesus began to say unto the multitudes concerning John, What went ye out into the wil-

derness to see? A reed shaken with the wind?
But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft
raiment? behold, they that wear soft *clothing* are in king's
houses.

But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? yea, I say
unto you, and more than a prophet.

(Homily of Pope Gregory.)

So many signs and so many miracles, were to earls be-
holder not an offence but a wonder. Yet the mind of un-
believers took this serious offence at Him, that after all
His miracles He should be seen to die. Whence also Paul
saith, We preach Christ crucified, to the Jews a stumbling-
block, and to the Gentiles foolishness. For it seemed to
man to be foolish, that for man the Source of life should
die; and thus man took offence at Him for the very thing,
whence he ought to have felt himself the more His debtor.
For God is so much the more worthy of honour from men,
by how much He has for men undergone dishonour.

Response 7.

*The Lord shall come from Samaria to the Eastern Gate,
and shall come to Bethlehem, walking upon the waters
of the redemption of Judah: then shall every man be
saved, for behold He cometh.*

And his throne shall be prepared in mercy, and He shall
sit on it in truth.

Then shall every man, &c.

Lesson 8.

What means His saying, that He is blessed whosoever is
not offended in Him, but to mark, in plain words, the abject
and degrading nature of His death? as if He openly said,
I do what is marvellous, yet I submit to suffer what is abject.
Since then I shortly follow thee in dying, men must specially
beware, lest, though venerating My signs, they despise My
death. *Response 8.*

*Make haste and tarry not, O Lord: and deliver thy
people.*

Come, O Lord, and do not tarry; absolve Thy people
from their iniquities.

And deliver Thy people.

Lesson 9.

But let us hear what he said to the crowd concerning
this same John, when He had dismissed John's disciples:
What went ye out into the wilderness for to see? a reed
shaken with the wind? which he means to be answered in
negative. For as the wind takes it, a reed moves this way

or that. And what is the reed, but the carnal mind? which, according as it falls in with popularity or reproach, at once inclines to the one side or the other.

Response 9.

Behold the Lord shall come down with glory and His power with him: to visit His people in peace, and to establish upon them everlasting life.

Behold our Lord shall come with power.

To visit His people, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

To visit His people, &c. (End of Matins.)

SUNDAY 3.

Lesson 7.

John i. 19-28.

And this is the record of John, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem to ask him, Who art thou
And He confessed, and denied not but confessed, I am not the Christ.

And they asked him, What then? art thou Elias? And he saith, I am not. Art thou that prophet? And he answered, No.

Then said they unto him, Who art thou? that we may give an answer to them that sent us. What sayest thou of thyself?

He said, I am the voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, as said the prophet Esaias.

And they which were sent were of the Pharisees.

And they asked him, and said unto him, Why baptizest thou then, if thou be not that Christ, nor Elias, neither that prophet?

John answered them, saying, I baptize with water: but there standeth one among you, whom ye know not; He it is, who coming after me is preferred before me, whose shoes latchet I am not worthy to unloose.

These things were done in Bethabara beyond Jordan, where John was baptizing.

(Homily of Pope Gregory.)

From the words of this lesson, dearest brethren, we have proof of John's humility: who, whereas he had such grace that he was taken for the Christ, yet preferred to remain unmoveably in what he was, lest he should be carried away by human opinion into fancies above what he was. For he confessed and denied not, but confessed I am not the Christ. But in saying, I am not, he denied what he was

not, not what he was: that by speaking truth he might become a member of Him, whose name he did not fraudulently appropriate. While then he is not ambitious of the name, he becomes a member of Christ; because in aiming at humbly confessing his own weakness, he was found worthy of truly possessing His majesty.

Response 7.

Come, O Lord, and do not tarry; absolve Thy people from their iniquities: and bring back the scattered ones into their own land.

Stir up, O Lord, Thy power, and come, and save us.

And bring back, &c.

Lesson 8.

But when we recollect our Saviour's saying in another passage, the words of this passage raise a perplexing question. For elsewhere, when the Lord was asked by His disciples concerning the coming of Elias, He answered, Elias is already come, and they have done unto him whatsoever they listed, and, if ye will know, John himself is Elias. Yet John, when he was asked, said, I am not Elias. What means it, dearly beloved brethren, that what the truth affirms, the prophet of the truth denies? The two statements are very different; It is he, and, I am not he. How then is he the prophet of the truth, if he agrees not with the sayings of that truth itself?

Response 8.

Behold, the root of Jesse shall come for the salvation of the people; unto Him shall the Gentiles seek: and His name shall be glorious.

And the Lord God shall give unto him the throne of His father David, and He shall reign over the house of Jacob for ever.

And his name, &c.

Lesson 9.

But if we inspect the matter minutely, what seems inconsistent, will be found consistent. For the angel said to Zacharias concerning John, He shall go before Him in the spirit and power of Elias. He then is said to be coming in the spirit and power of Elias, inasmuch as he went before the first coming of the Lord, as Elias will go before His second coming. As he will be the forerunner of the Judge, so John was the forerunner of the Redeemer. John then was in the spirit of Elias, not in his person. What then the Lord declares of the spirit, John denies of the person.

Response 9.

*The Lord shall teach us His ways, and we will walk in
His paths: for out of Sion shall go forth the law,
and the word of the Lord from Jerusalem.*

Come ye, and let us go up into the mountain of the Lord,
and to the house of the God of Jacob.

For out of Sion, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

For out of Sion, &c. (End of Matins.)

SUNDAY 4.

Lesson 7.

Luke iii. 1-9.

Now in the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Cæsar,
Pontius Pilate being governor of Judea, and Herod being
tetrarch of Galilee, and his brother Philip tetrarch of Iturea
and of the regions of Trachonitis, and Lysanias the tetrarch
of Abilene,

Annas and Caiaphas being the high priests, the word of
God came unto John the son of Zacharias in the wilderness.

And he came into all the country about Jordan, preaching
the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins;

As it is written in the book of the words of Esaias the
prophet, saving, The voice of one crying in the wilderness,
Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make His paths straight.

Every valley shall be filled, and every mountain and hill
shall be brought low; and the crooked shall be made

straight, and the rough ways *shall* be made smooth;

And all flesh shall see the salvation of God.

Then said he to the multitude that came forth to be
baptized of him, O generation of vipers, who hath warned
you to flee from the wrath to come?

Bring forth therefore fruits worthy of repentance, and
begin not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to
our father: for I say unto you, That God is able of these
stones to raise up children unto Abraham.

And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees;
every tree therefore which bringeth not forth good fruit is
hewn shown, and cast into the fire. (*Homily of Pope Gregory.*)

John said to the multitudes which went out to be bap-
tized by him, O generation of vipers, who hath warned
you to flee from the wrath to come? For the wrath to
come is the punishment of uttermost vengeance; which
the sinner is not able then to flee, who has not now
recourse to the laments of penitence. And it is observa-
ble, that evil offspring, imitating the conduct of evil pa-

rents, are called generation of vipers: for in envying and persecuting the good, repaying evil, injuring their neighbours, in all these ways following the doings of their carnal fathers, they are as though poisonous children of poisonous parents.

Response 7.

I have sworn, saith the Lord, that I will no longer be wroth upon the earth; for the mountains and the hills shall receive My righteousness: and My covenant of peace shall be with Jerusalem.

My salvation is near to come, and My righteousness to be revealed.

And My covenant, &c.

Lesson 8.

But since we have already sinned, since we are involved in the usage of bad habits, let him say what we must do, in order to flee from the wrath to come. It follows; Bring forth therefore fruits, worthy of repentance. In these words it is observable that the friend of the bridegroom enjoins not only fruits, but worthy fruits of repentance. It is one thing to bring forth the fruit, another worthy fruits of repentance. By way of explaining what is meant by worthy, it must be borne in mind, that whoso has committed nothing unlawful, he may lawfully use what is lawful; and do his works of charity without necessarily relinquishing the world.

Response 8.

We will not depart from Thee, O Lord, Thou wilt quicken us, and we will call upon Thy name: show us Thy countenance, and we shall be whole.

Remember me, O Lord, according to the favour that Thou bearest unto Thy people: O visit me with Thy salvation.

Show us Thy countenance, &c.

Lesson 9.

But if any one has incurred the guilt of fornication, or perchance, what is still more heinous, adultery, be so much more should he deprive himself of things lawful, as he remembers he has committed what is unlawful. Nor should the fruit of a good work be the same, where a man has sinned less, or sinned more, been betrayed into none, or into some crimes, or into many. In saying then “worthy fruits of penance,” the conscience of every one is suitably addressed, that he may obtain by so much the more advantage of good works by penance, as he has incurred heavier

loss by sinning.

Response 9.

Behold ye, how great is He, who comes to save the nations. He is the king of righteousness; of whose generation there is no end.

The Forerunner is for us entered, made for ever an high priest after the order of Melchizadek.

Of whose generation, &c.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

Of whose generation, &c.

LAUDS

(o) *Antiphon*

(also at prime on the respective Sundays and the rest of each week till Dec. 17.)

SUNDAY 1.

In that day the mountain shall drop down new wine,
and the hills shall flow with milk. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

Behold, the Lord shall come in the clouds of heaven with
great power. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

The Lord will come and will not tarry, and will bring to
light the hidden things of darkness, and manifest himself
to all nations. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 4.

Blow the trumpet in Sion, for the day of the Lord is at
hand; behold, he shall come and save us. Hallelujah.
Hallelujah.

(p) *Antiphon*

(also at Third till Dec. 17.)

SUNDAY 1.

Rejoice greatly, daughter of Sion: shout, O daughter of
Jerusalem. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

We have a strong city; salvation will God appoint for
walls and bulwarks. Open ye the gates, for God is with
us. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

Rejoice, O Jerusalem, with great joy, for the Saviour
shall come unto thee. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 4.

Behold, the Desire of all nations shall come, and the house
of the Lord shall be filled with glory. Hallelujah.

(q) *Antiphon*

(also at sixth, till Dec. 17.)

SUNDAY 1.

Behold, the Lord shall come and all his saints with Him, and the light in that day shall be great. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

Behold, the Lord shall appear, and will not lie; though He tarry, wait for Him, because He will surely come, He will not tarry. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

I will give salvation to Sion, and my glory to Jerusalem. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 4.

The crooked shall be made straight, and the rough places plain; come, Lord, and do not tarry. Hallelujah.

(r) *Antiphon*

SUNDAY 1.

Ho, every one that thirsteth, come ye to the waters; seek ye the Lord while he may be found. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

The mountains and the hills shall break forth before him into singing; and all the trees of the field shall clap their hands: for the Lord the king shall come to his everlasting kingdom. Hallelujah. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

Every mountain and hill shall be made low, and the crooked shall be made straight, and the rough places plain: Come, O Lord, and do not tarry. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 4.

The Lord shall come: meet ye Him, and say, Great is His beginning, and of His kingdom shall be no end. The mighty God our king, the Prince of peace. Hallelujah. Hallelujah.

(s) *Antiphon*

(also at Ninth, till Dec. 17.)

SUNDAY 1.

Behold the great Prophet shall come, and He shall rebuild Jerusalem. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

Behold, our Lord shall come with power, and shall enlighten the eyes of His servants. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

Let us live righteously and godly, waiting for the blessed hope and coming of the Lord.

SUNDAY 4.

Thy Almighty word leaped down from heaven out of
Thy royal throne. Hallelujah.

(t) *Text*

(also at Third, and Vespers on the respective Sundays.)

SUNDAY 1.

Brethren, it is high time to wake out of sleep, for now is
our salvation nearer than when we believed.

SUNDAY 2.

Brethren, whatsoever things were written aforetime, were
written for our learning, that we through patience and
comfort of the Scriptures might have hope.

SUNDAY 3.

Brethren, rejoice in the Lord always; and again I say,
Rejoice. Let your moderation be known unto all men. The
Lord is at hand.

SUNDAY 4.

Brethren, let a man so account of us, as ministers of
Christ, and stewards of the mysteries of God. Moreover, it
is required of stewards, that a man be found faithful.

(u) *Hymn*

En clara vox redarguit, &c.

(v) *Verse and Response*

The voice of one crying in the wilderness; Prepare ye
the way of the Lord.

Make his paths straight.

(w) *(Antiphon of the Benedictus.)*

SUNDAY 1.

The holy Ghost shall come upon thee, O Mary; fear
not, thou shalt conceive in thy womb the Son of God.
Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

When John had heard in the prison the works of Christ,
he sent two of his disciples, and said unto Him, Art Thou
He that should come, or do we look for another?

SUNDAY 3.

Upon the throne of David and upon his kingdom, He
shall sit for ever. Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 4.

Hail thou that art highly favoured; the Lord is with
thee; blessed art thou among women. Hallelujah.

(x) *Collect*

(also at Third, Sixth, Ninth, and Vespers on the respective Sundays.)

SUNDAY 1.

Raise up, we beseech Thee, O Lord, Thy power, and
come, that we being found meet may be snatched from

the perils of our sins by Thy succour, and may be saved by Thy deliverance, who livest and reignest with God the Father, &c.

SUNDAY 2.

Stir up, O Lord, our heart, to prepare the ways of Thy only begotten Son, that by His coming we may be made meet to serve Thee with purified minds, who liveth with Thee, &c.

SUNDAY 3.

Give ear, we beseech Thee, O Lord, to our prayers, and lighten the darkness of our mind by the grace of Thy visitation, who livest and reignest, &c.

SUNDAY 4.

Raise up, we pray Thee, Thy power, and come among us, and with great might succour us, that by the aid of Thy grace, what our sins do hinder, the bounty of Thy propitiation may forward, who livest, &c.

PRIME

(bb) *Antiphon*

Same as (o).

(ee) *Verse in Short Response*

(ii) *Short Lesson,*

Isa. xxxiii. 2.

Thou that art now coming into the world.

O Lord, be gracious unto us; we have waited for Thee;

be Thou our arm every morning, our salvation also in the time of trouble.

THIRD HOUR

(kk) *Antiphon*

The same as (p).

(ll) *Text*

The same as (t).

(mm) *Short Response*

Come Thou and save us: O Lord God of hosts.

Come Thou, &c. (Repeated.)

Show the light of Thy countenance, and we shall be whole.

O Lord God of hosts.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost, &c.

Come Thou and save us, O Lord God of hosts.

The heathen shall fear Thy name, O Lord.

And all the kings of the earth Thy majesty.

(nn) *Collect*
The same as (x).

SIXTH HOUR

(pp) *Antiphon* The same as (q).

(qq) *Text*

SUNDAY 1.

The night is far spent, the day is at hand, let us therefore cast away the works of darkness, and put upon us the armour of light.

SUNDAY 2.

Now the God of patience and consolation grant you to be like minded one toward another, according to Jesus Christ, that ye may with one mind and one mouth glorify God, even the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.

SUNDAY 3.

Be careful for nothing; but in every thing by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known unto God.

SUNDAY 4.

But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged of you, or of man's judgment; yea I judge not myself.

(rr) *Short Response*

Show us Thy mercy, O Lord.

Show us, &c.

And grant us Thy salvation,

O Lord.

Glory be, &c.

Show us Thy mercy, O Lord.

Remember me, O Lord, according to the favour that thou bearest unto Thy people.

O visit me with Thy salvation.

(ss) *Collect* The same as (x.)

NINTH HOUR

(uu) *Antiphon* The same as (s).

(vv) *Text*

SUNDAY 1.

Let us walk honestly as in the day, not in rioting and drunkenness, not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying; but put ye on the Lord Jesus Christ.

SUNDAY 2.

Now the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in

believing, that ye may abound in hope, through the power of the Holy Ghost.

SUNDAY 3.

And the peace of God which passeth all understanding, shall keep your hearts and minds in Christ Jesus our Lord.

SUNDAY 4.

Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord come, who both will bring to light the hidden things of darkness and will make manifest the counsels of the heart, and then shall every man have praise of God.

(ww) *Short Response The Lord shall arise upon thee: O Jerusalem.*

The Lord, &c.

And His glory shall be seen upon thee.

O Jerusalem.

Glory be to, &c.

The Lord shall arise upon thee: O Jerusalem.

Turn us again, Lord God of hosts.

Show the light of Thy countenance, and we shall be whole.

(xx) *Collect* The same as (x).

VESPERS

(yy)

(zz)

(aaa) *Antiphon the*

(bbb) *same as*

(ccc) (0)

(p)

(q) *respectively.*

(r)

(s)

(ddd) *Text* The same as (t).

(eec) *Hymn* Creator alme siderum, &c.

(fff) *Verse and Response* Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness.

Let the earth open, and let them bring forth salvation.

(ggg) *Antiphon of the Magnif.*

SUNDAY 1.

Fear not, Mary, for thou hast found favour with God: and behold, thou shalt conceive, and shalt bear a son.

Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 2.

Art Thou He that should come? or look we for another?

Tell John the things which ye see. The blind receive their sight, the dead are raised, to the poor the Gospel is preached.

Hallelujah.

SUNDAY 3.

Blessed art thou, O Mary, which believedst in the Lord:
there shall be a performance in thee of those things which
were said to thee of the Lord.

SUNDAY 4.

(*being Dec. 18.*)

O Lord, and Ruler of the House of Israel, who appear-
edst unto Moses in the flame of a burning bush, and
gavest to him the Law in Sinai, come to redeem us with a
stretched out arm.

(hhh) *Collect* The same as (x).

§ 9. Service for Week Days in Advent.

MATINS

(a) *Invitatory*

(*the same as the respective Sundays.*)

O Lord, open, &c. Glory be, &c.

1st and 2d week. O come, let us worship: the Lord our
king approaching.

3d and 4th week. O come, let us worship: the Lord is
close at hand.

(b) *Hymn*

(*all four weeks.*)

Verbum supernum prodiens, &c.

Monday Tuesday Wednesday Thursday Friday Saturday

Antiphon The Lord is

the That I

offend not O that the

Lord would Haste Thee:

O Lord God Sing we

merrily: For the

Lord hath

done:

(1) *Psalm* 27 39 53 69 81 98

(2) *Psalm* 28 40 55 70 82 99

Antiphon strength: of

my life. in my

tongue. deliver: His

people out

of captivity.

to deliver

me. unto God

our strength. marvellous

things.
Antiphon
 Worship the
 Lord:
 Heal: my
 soul, for
 For my soul
 Be thou:
 Thou only,
 art the most
 O be joyful:
 (3) *Psalm* 29 41 56 71 83 100
 (4) *Psalm* 30 42 57 72 84 101
Antiphon with holy
 worship. I have sin-
 ned against
 Thee.
 trusteth
 in Thee. my strong
 hold. highest over
 all the earth. the Lord all
 ye lands.
Antiphon
 Deliver me:
 in
 My heart is
 inditing
 Do ye judge
 the thing
 Think upon
 the tribe:
 Lord, Thou
 art become
 Let my
 crying:
 (5) *Psalm* 31 44 58 73 85 102
 (6) *Psalm* 32 45 59 74 86 103
Antiphon Thy righte-
 ousness. of a good
 matter. is right: O
 ye sons of
 men.
 of Thine in-
 heritance. gracious:
 unto Thy

land. come unto

Thee.

Antiphon

It becometh

well:

A very pre-

sent help:

O be Thou:

our

Unto Thee:

do we

Her founda-

tions: are

Praise the

Lord.

(7) *Psalm* 33 46 60 75 87 104

(8) *Psalm* 34 47 61 76 88 105

Antiphon the just to

be thankful.

in trouble. help in

trouble. give thanks. upon the

holy hills. O my soul.

Antiphon

Fight

against them

Great is the

Lord:

My soul

truly

Thou art the

God:

Praised be

the Lord

O visit me:

with

(9) *Psalm* 35 48 62 77 89 106

(10) *Psalm* 36 49 64 78 94 107

Antiphon that fight

against me. and highly

to be

praised.

waiteth still

upon God. that doest

wonders. for ever-

more. Thy salva-

tion.

Antiphon

Commit thy

way:

The Lord,

even the

most

O praise:

our God

Be merciful:

Sing unto

the Lord:

I will give

great

thanks:

(11) *Psalm* 37 50 66 79 96 108

(12) *Psalm* 38 52 68 80 97 109

Antiphon unto the

Lord. mighty God:

hath spoken. ye people. unto our

sins, O

Lord. and praise

His name. unto the

Lord with

my mouth.

(f) *Verse and Response*

(as on Sundays.) Out of Sion hath God appeared

In perfect beauty.

The Lord's Prayer Our Father, &c.

Absolution

(These numbers answer to the numbers affixed to the Absolutions and Benedictions in § 2.) M. T. W. Th.

F. S.

1.—2.—3. 1.—2.—3.

1st Monday Benediction 1.—1¹⁹.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* i. 16-18²⁰.

Response 1. Cherish the Word, O Mary the Virgin, which
is conveyed to thee from the Lord by the angel; thou shalt

¹⁹The Benedictions run as follows:

M. T. W. Th. F. S.

Benediction 1st.—1. 4. 7. 1. 4. 7.

2d.—2. 5. 8. 2. 5. 8.

3d.—3. 6. 9. 3. 6. 9.

²⁰These lessons will illustrate the complaint in the preface of our Prayer Book, that "when any book of the Bible was begun," in the Breviary, "after 3 or 4 chapters were read out, all the rest were unread." No chapter is finished.

conceive in thy womb and bring forth God and man; that thou mayest be called blessed among all women.

Yea, thou shalt bring forth a son, yet abide a virgin; thou shalt be with child and be a mother, yet know not a man. That thou mayest be blessed among all women.

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. Isaiah i. 19-23.

Response 2. Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth be glad, let the hills be joyful together before the Lord, for He shall come, and shall have pity on the poor.

In His time shall the righteous flourish, yea and abundance of peace.

And He shall have pity on the poor.

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah i. 24-28.

Response 3. Strangers shall not pass through Jerusalem any more, for in that day the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, saith the Lord.

God shall come from Lebanon, and the Holy One from the woody mountain.

For in that day the mountains, &c. (End of Matins.)

1st Tuesday

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. Isaiah ii. 1-3.

Response 1. Ye mountains of Israel, spread forth your branches, and bud into flower, and bear fruit; it is full time that the day of the Lord come.

Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness; let the earth open and bring forth salvation.

It is full time that the day of the Lord come.

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. Isaiah ii. 4-6.

Response 2. Let the mountains break forth with joy, and the hills with righteousness, for the Lord, the light of the world, is come with power.

Out of Zion shall go forth the law, and the word of the Lord from Jerusalem.

For the Lord, the light, &c.

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. Isaiah ii. 7-9.

Response 3. Behold, I come, the Lord your God from Timon: to visit you in peace.

I will look upon you, and make you to increase ; ye shall

be multiplied, and I will establish My covenant with you.
To visit you in peace. (End of Matins.)

1st Wednesday

Benediction 1.—7 + ²¹.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* iii. 1-4.

Response 1. *Christ our King shall come, whom John
announced as the Lamb that was to come.*

Kings shall keep peace before him, and the Gentiles shall
supplicate Him.

Whom John announced as the Lamb that was to come.

Benediction 2—8.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* iii. 5-7.

Response 2. *Ezekiel prophesied long before, I saw a gate
that was shut; behold, the everlasting God went forth
from it for the salvation of the world: and again it was
shut, figuring the Virgin, who after the birth remained a
virgin.*

The gate which thou sawest, the Lord alone shall pass
through it.

And again it was, &c.

(As Response 9 of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* iii. 8-11.

Response. 3. *Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, that I
will raise up unto David a righteous branch, and a king
shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and
justice in the earth; and this is His name whereby He shall
be called, The Lord our Righteousness.*

In His days Judah shall be saved, and Israel shall dwell
safely.

And this is His name, &c. (End of Matins.)

1st Thursday

(as on Monday.)

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* iv. 1-3.

Response 1. *Cherish the Word, &c.*

(As Response 2 of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* v. 1-4.

Response 2. *I saw in the night visions, and behold, one like
unto the Son of man came with the clouds of heaven; and*

²¹Where the number of this Benediction is marked with a †, it runs thus:
“May He bless us who liveth and reigneth world without end. Amen.”

*there was given Him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom:
that all people, nations, and languages should serve Him.*

His dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not
pass away, and His kingdom that which shall not be
destroyed.

That all people, &c.

*(As Response 3
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah v. 5-7.

*Response 3. The angel Gabriel was sent to Mary, a virgin
espoused to Joseph, announcing to her the Word, and the
virgin was troubled at the light: Fear not, Mary, thou
hast found favour with the Lord: behold, thou shalt con-
ceive and bring forth a Son, and He shall be called the Son
of the Highest.*

The Lord God shall give unto Him the throne of His
father David, and He shall reign over the house of Jacob for
ever.

Behold, thou shalt conceive, &c. (End of Matins.)

1st Friday

*(As Response 4
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. Isaiah vi. 1-3.

*Response 1. Hail thou that art highly favoured, the Lord
is with thee; the Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and
the power of the highest shall overshadow thee, therefore
that holy thing which shall be born of thee shall be called
the Son of God.*

How shall this be, seeing I know not a man? And the
Angel answered and said to her.

The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, &c.

*(As Response 5
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. Isaiah vi. 4-7.

*Response 2. We wait for the Saviour, the Lord Jesus
Christ, who shall change our vile body, that it may be
fashioned like unto his glorious body.*

Let us live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present
world, looking for that blessed hope, and the glorious appear-
ing of the great God.

Who shall change, &c.

(As Response 6
of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* vi. 8-10.

Response 3. *O my Lord, send, I pray Thee, by the hand of him whom thou wilt send; behold the affliction of thy people: as Thou hast spoken, come, and deliver us.*

Hear, O Thou Shepherd of Israel, Thou that leadest Joseph like a sheep, Thou that sittest between the cherubim.

As Thou hast spoken, &c. (End of Matins.)

1st Saturday

(As Response 7
of Sunday.)

Benediction 1.—7 †.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* vii. 1-3.

Response 1. *Behold, a virgin shall conceive, and shall bring forth a Son, saith the Lord, and his name shall be called Wonderful, the Mighty God.*

Upon the throne of David, and upon his kingdom He shall sit for ever.

And His name shall be called Wonderful, the Mighty God.

(As Response 8
of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* vii. 4-6.

Response 2. *Hear the Word of the Lord, O ye nations, and declare it in the ends of the earth; and say to the isles afar off, our Saviour shall come.*

Declare it and make it heard; speak and cry out.

And say to the isles, &c.

(As Response 9 of Sunday and Response 3 of Wednesday.)

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* vii. 10-15.

Response 3. *Behold the day is come, &c. (End of Matins.)*

2d Monday

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* xiii. 1-4.

Response 1. *Cherish the Word, &c.*

(The Response as
on 1st Monday.)

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* xiii. 4-8.

Response 2. *Let the heavens rejoice, &c.*

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xiii. 9-11.

Response 3. Strangers shall not pass, &c. (End.)

2nd Tuesday

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xiv. 1-4.

Response 1. Ye mountains of Israel, &c.

(Responses as on

1st Tuesday.)

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xiv. 3-6.

Response 2. Let the mountains, &c.

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xiv. 12-15.

Response 3. Behold, I come, &c. (End.)

2d Wednesday

Benediction 1.—7 †.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xvi. 1-4.

Response 1. Christ our king, &c.

(As on 1st

Wednesday.)

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xvi. 4-6.

Response 2. Ezekiel prophesied, &c.

(As Response 9

of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xvi. 7, 8.

*Response 3. Behold, the Lord shall come, descending in
glory, and His power with Him: to visit His people in
peace, and establish upon them everlasting life.*

Behold our Lord shall come with power.

To visit His people, &c. (End.)

2d Thursday

(As Response 1

of Sunday.)

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xix. 1, 2

*Response 1. O Jerusalem, thy salvation shall come quickly;
wherefore art thou consumed with grief? is there any
counsellor in thee? because sorrow hath changed thee. I
will save thee and deliver thee, fear not.*

*For I am the Lord thy God, the Holy one of Israel, thy
Redeemer.*

I will save thee and deliver thee, fear not.

(As Response 2
of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* xix. 3-6.

Response 2. The Lord my God shall come and all the Saints with Thee, and in that day there shall be great light; and it shall be in that day that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem, and the Lord shall be king for ever over all the earth.

Behold, the Lord shall come with power, and His kingdom shall be in His hand, and dominion and sovereignty.
Over all the earth.

(As Response 3
of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* xix. 11-13.

Response 3. City of Jerusalem, weep thou not, for the Lord has sorrowed for thee; and He shall take from thee all tribulation.

Behold, the Lord shall come in strength, and His arm shall rule.

And He shall take, &c. (End.)

2d Friday

(As Response 4
of Sunday.)

Benediction 1—4.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* xxiv. 1-3.

Response 1. Behold, the Lord shall come, our defender, the Holy one of Israel, having the crown of His kingdom upon Him.

And He shall reign from sea to sea, and from the river even unto the ends of the earth.

Having the crown of his kingdom upon him.

(As Response 5
of Sunday.)

Benediction 2—5.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* xxiv. 4-6.

Response 2. As a mother comforteth her sons, so will I comfort you, saith the Lord; and from Jerusalem, the city I have chosen, shall succour come to you; and you shall see and your heart shall rejoice.

I will give to Zion salvation, and to Jerusalem, My glory,
And you shall see, &c.

(As Response 6

of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xxiv. 7-15.

Response 3. O Jerusalem, thou shalt plant thy vine upon thy mountains; leap for joy, for the day of the Lord shall come; arise, O Zion, be turned unto the Lord thy God; rejoice and be glad, O Jacob: for thy Saviour shall come in the midst of the nations.

Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion, shout, O daughter of Jerusalem.

For thy Saviour, &c. (End.)

2d Saturday

(As Response 7

of Sunday.)

Benediction 1.—7 †.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xxv. 1-4.

Response 1. The Lord shall come from Samaria to the eastern gate, and shall come to Bethlehem, walking upon the waters of the redemption of Judah; then shall every man be saved, for, behold, He cometh.

And His throne shall be prepared in mercy, and He shall sit on it in truth.

Then shall every man be saved, for, behold, He cometh.

(As Response 8

of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xxiv. 4-7.

Response 2. Make haste, and tarry not, O Lord: and deliver Thy people.

Come, O Lord, and do not tarry: absolve thy people from their iniquities.

And deliver Thy people.

(As Response 9

of Sunday and 3

of Wednesday.)

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xxv. 8-12.

Response 3. Behold, the Lord shall come, &c. (End.)

3d Monday

(As Response 1

of Sunday.)

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xxviii. 1-3.

Response 1. Behold the Lord shall appear, &c.

(As Response 2
of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* xxviii. 4-7.

Response 2. *O Bethlehem, city, &c.*

(As Response 3
of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* xxviii. 16-18.

Response 3. *He that shall come, will come, &c. (End.)*

3d Tuesday

(As Response 4
of Sunday.)

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. *Isaiah* xxx. 18-20.

Response 1. *Weep not, O Egypt, &c.*

(As Response 5
of Sunday.)

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. *Isaiah* xxx. 22-25.

Response 2. *Her time is well nigh, &c.*

(As Response 6
of Sunday.)

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. *Isaiah* xxx. 26-28.

Response 3. *The Lord shall descend as the rain, &c. (End.)*

3d Wednesday

Benediction 1.—7.

Lesson 1. *Luke* i. 26-38.

Homily of St. Ambrose

(*Lib. 2 in Lucam.*)

(*for Ember day.*)

Divine mysteries lie hid, nor is it easy, as the prophet says, for any one among men to know the purpose of God. Yet, from the other deeds and precepts of the Lord and Saviour, we are able to understand that it was a matter of solicitous purpose that she should be chosen above others to bear the Lord, who was already betrothed to a husband. For why did she not conceive before she was betrothed? probably, lest it should be said that she had conceived in adultery.

Response 1. *O Jerusalem, that bringest good tidings, lift up thy voice, be not afraid; say unto the cities of Judah, Behold your God! Behold the Lord God will come whom we did wait for.*

O Sion, which bringest good tidings; get thee up into the high mountains, lift up thy voice with strength.

Say unto the cities of Judah, Behold your God! Behold, the Lord God will come whom we did wait for.

(Homily continued.)

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2.

And the angel came in unto her. Recognize the virgin in her behaviour, in her modesty, in the annunciation, in the mystery. To be frightened belongs to virgins; and to dread the approach, to feel abashed at the address of man. Let woman learn to imitate the settled resolve of modesty herein displayed. Alone was she in the inner chamber, seen by no man, found by the angel alone. Alone without companion, alone without witness, lest she should be insulted by any unworthy voice, she is saluted by the angel.

Response 2. There shall come a star out of Jacob, and a sceptre shall arise out of Israel, and shall smite through the princes of Moab: and all the earth shall be His possession.

All kings shall fall down before Him, all nations shall do Him service.

And all the earth, &c.

(Homily continued.)

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. For the mystery of so high a message was to be divulged by the mouth, not of man, but of an Angel. Today is it first heard; The Holy Ghost shall come upon thee. It is heard, it is believed. Lastly she says, Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word. Observe her humility, observe her devotion. She calls herself the handmaid, who is chosen to be the mother of the Lord; nor is she elated by the sudden promise.

Response 3. The Lord Almighty shall soon come; and His name shall be called Emmanuel.

Righteousness shall arise in His days, and abundance of peace.

And his name, &c. (End.)

3d Thursday

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xxxiii. 1, 2.

Response 1. The Lord shall go forth and fight against the nations; and His feet shall stand in that day upon the mount of Olives, towards the east.

And He shall be exalted above the hills, and all nations

shall flow unto Him.

And His feet, &c.

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xxxiii. 3-6.

*Response 2. The forerunner is for us entered, a Lamb
without spot; made an high priest for ever and ever,
after the order of Melchizedek.*

He is the king of righteousness, and of His generation
there is no end.

Made an high priest, &c.

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xxxiii. 14-17.

*Response 3. The Gentiles shall see Thy righteousness,
and all kings Thy glory: and Thou shalt be called by
a new name, which the mouth of the Lord shall name.*

Thou shalt also be a crown of glory in the hand of the
Lord, and a royal diadem in the hand of thy God.

And Thou shalt be called, &c. (End.)

3d Friday

Homily of St. Ambrose, Lib.

2 in Luc.

(For Ember day.)

Benediction 1.—7.

Lesson 1. Luke i. 39-45.

Those who exact faith, are used to give grounds for it.

Accordingly the angel when announcing what was hidden
to give grounds for faith, by the precedent of the elder and
barren woman, announced the conception of the Virgin, by
way of declaring that with God all is possible whatsoever
He will. Mary, on hearing this, not as incredulous at the
heavenly voice, nor as uncertain as to the message, nor as
doubtful of the precedent, but as joyful from her resolve,
religious by her calling, speedy for joy, proceeded into the
mountainous country. Whither indeed should she hasten,
who was filled with God, but to what is upward?

*Response 1. Send ye the Lamb to the Ruler of the land,
from Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the
Daughter of Sion.*

O Lord, show Thy mercy upon us, and grant us Thy sal-
vation.

*From Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the
daughter of Sion.*

(Homily con- tinued.)

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. Learn hence also, ye holy women, what at-

tention ye should pay to your relations who are with child. Mary, who before lived in solitude in the inner chambers, was not deterred from going abroad by her virgin modesty, nor from her eagerness by the mountainous journey, nor from her dutifulness by its length. A virgin leaves her home and goes into the mountains with haste, a virgin mindful of her duty, unmindful of the hardships, called not by her sex, but by affection. Learn hence, O virgins, not to go about from house to house, not to loiter in public places, not to talk freely in society. Mary, loitering at home, in haste when abroad, abode for three months with her kinswoman.

Response 2. Drop down ye heavens from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness; let the earth open and bring forth salvation.

Send ye the Lamb to the Ruler of the land, from Sela to the wilderness, unto the mount of the daughter of Sion.

Let the earth, &c.

Homily continued.

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. Ye have been taught, O virgins, the modesty of Mary, observe the humility. She came as kinswoman to her next of kin, as junior to her elder; nor came alone, but first saluted her. For it beseems a virgin, the purer she is, to be the more humble also. Let her be used to defer to her seniors. Let her be a pattern of humility, who has taken the profession of chastity. Here too is a rule of doctrine, as well as a pattern of piety. For let it be considered that the superior comes to the inferior that this inferior may be aided: Mary to Elizabeth, Christ to the Baptist.

Response 3. The fields of the desert have brought forth the plant of the odour of Israel, for behold, our God shall come with strength: and His brightness with Him.

Out of Sion the perfection of beauty our God shall manifest Himself.

And His brightness with Him. (End.)

3d Saturday

Homily of Pope Gregory in Evang. 20.

(For Ember day.)

Benediction 1.—7.

Lesson 1. Luke iii. 1-3.

The time when the forerunner of our Redeemer received the office of preaching, is marked by mention of the Roman Emperor, and the Kings of Judea. For, whereas he came to proclaim Him, who was to redeem some from Judea and many from the heathen, therefore, the date of his

preaching is marked by the ruler of the Gentiles and the governor of the Jews. And whereas heathenism was to be brought in, and Judea scattered for the guilt of its misbelief, the very description of the earthly sovereign signifies this; the prince of the Roman state being described as one, of Judea as fourfold.

Response 1. There shall come forth a rod out of the stem of Jesse, and a branch shall grow out of His roots; and righteousness shall be the girdle of His loins, and faithfulness the girdle of His reins.

And the Spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him; the spirit of wisdom and understanding, the spirit of counsel and might.

And righteousness shall be, &c.

Homily con- tinued.

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. And indeed, the voice our Redeemer has declared, Every kingdom divided against itself shall be brought to desolation. It is plain, therefore, that Judea had come to the end of its kingdom, being parted among so many kings. Also, it is suitably noted what priests, as well as what kings, were in power at the time: and, whereas John the Baptist was proclaiming Him who was at once king and priest, Luke the Evangelist marked the date of that proclamation by mention of the kingdom and the priesthood.

Response 2. There shall be a root of Jesse, which shall rise to judge the Gentiles: on Him shall the Gentiles trust: and His name shall be blessed for evermore.

The kings shall shut their mouths at Him: the Gentiles shall implore Him,

And His name, &c.

Homily con- tinued.

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. And he came into all the regions of Jordan, proclaiming the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins. It is plain to every reader, that John not only proclaimed the baptism of repentance, but also administered it to some, yet he could not administer it for the remission of sins. For the remission of sins is imparted to us only in

Christ's baptism. The words then are observable; *pro- claiming* the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins.

He proclaimed that cleansing Baptism which he could not administer: that, as he forerun the Incarnate Word of the Father by the word of proclamation, so he might forerun

also the baptism of repentance, in which sins are forgiven,
with his own baptism, by which sins could not be forgiven.

*Response 3. Come, O Lord, and do not tarry; absolve Thy
people from their sins; and recover the scattered ones into
their own land.*

O Lord raise up Thy power, and come to save us.
And recover, &c. (End.)

4th Monday

*(As Response 1
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xli. 8-10.

Response 1. Blow the trumpet, &c.

*(As Response 2
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xli. 11-13.

Response 2. The sceptre shall not depart, &c.

*(As Response 3
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xli. 14-16.

Response 3. I must decrease, &c. (End.)

4th Tuesday

*(As Response 4
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. Isaiah xlii. 1-4.

Response 1. Unto us as a child, &c.

*(As Response 5
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. Isaiah xlii. 5-7.

Response 2. Behold the fulness of time, &c.

*(As Response 6
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. Isaiah xlii. 10-13.

Response 3. O virgin of Israel, &c. (End.)

4th Wednesday

*(As Response 7
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 1.—7 †.

Lesson 1. Isaiah li. 1-3.

Response 1. I have sworn, &c.

*(As Response 8
of Sunday.)*

Benediction 2.—8.

Lesson 2. Isaiah li. 4-6.

Response 2. And so will not we, &c.

*(As Response 9
on Sunday.)*

Benediction 3.—9.

Lesson 3. Isaiah li. 7, 8.

Response 3. Consider how great, &c. (End.)

4th Thursday

(As Response 1

of Sunday and Response 1 of Monday.)

Benediction 1.—1.

Lesson 1. Isaiah lxiv. 1-4.

Response 1. Blow the trumpet, &c.

(As Response 2

of Sunday and Response 2 of Monday.)

Benediction 2.—2.

Lesson 2. Isaiah lxiv. 5-7.

Response 2. The sceptre shall not depart, &c.

(As Response 3

of Sunday and Response 3 of Monday.)

Benediction 3.—3.

Lesson 3. Isaiah lxiv. 8-11.

Response 3. I must decrease, &c. (End.)

4th Friday

(As Response 4

of Sunday and Response 1 of Tuesday.)

Benediction 1.—4.

Lesson 1. Isaiah lxvi. 5-8.

Response 1. Unto us as a child, &c.

(As Response 5

of Sunday and Response 2 of Tuesday.)

Benediction 2.—5.

Lesson 2. Isaiah lxvi. 9-12.

Response 2. Behold the fulness of time, &c.

(As Response 6

of Sunday and Response 3 of Tuesday.)

Christmas Eve, &c. &c.

Christmas Day, &c. &c.

Benediction 3.—6.

Lesson 3. Isaiah lxvi. 13-16.

Response 3. O virgin of Israel, &c. (End.)

LAUDS

O God, make speed, &c.

O Lord, make haste, &c.

Glory be, &c. Amen. Hallelujah.

Antiphons and Psalms

1st, 2d, & 3d

Monday. 4th Monday (the 19th.)

(o) Have mercy.

(o) Behold, the Lord will come, the King of the whole earth.

(1) *Psalm 51.*

(o) Have mercy

on me, O God. (o) Behold, the Lord will come, the King of the whole earth; blessed are they that are ready to meet Him.

(p) Consider.

(p) When the Son of man cometh.

(2) *Psalm 5.*

(p) Consider my

meditation. (p) When the Son of man cometh, will He find faith on the earth?

(q) O God, Thou

art my God.

(q) Behold, the fulness of time is now come.

(3) *Psalm 63 & 67.*

(q) O God, Thou

art my God,

early will I seek

Thee. (q) Behold, the fulness of time is now come, in the which God sent forth his Son to the earth.

(r) Thine anger.

(r) With joy shall ye draw water.

(4) *Song of Isaiah. (Isaiah xii.)*

(r) Thine anger

is turned away,

and Thou com-

fortedst me. (r) With joy shall ye draw water out of the wells of salvation.

(s) O praise the

Lord.

(s) The Lord shall go forth of His holy place.

(5) *Psalm 148-150.*

(s) O praise the

Lord of heaven. (s) The Lord shall go forth of His holy place, He shall come to save his people. (*go on (t)*)

1st, 2d & 3d

Tuesday

4th Tuesday, (the 20th.)

(o) Cleanse me.

(o) Drop down, ye heavens.

(1) *Psalm* 51.

(o) Cleanse me. (o) Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies pour down righteousness; let the earth open and bring forth salvation.

(p) The help.

(p) Send ye the Lamb.

(2) *Psalm* 43.

(p) The help of

my countenance

and my God. (p) Send ye the Lamb to the Ruler of the land, from Sela in the wilderness, unto the mount of the daughter of Zion.

(q) Early.

(q) That Thy way may be known.

(3) *Psalm* 63 & 67.

(q) Early will I

seek Thee, my

God. (q) That Thy way may be known upon earth, Thy saving health among all nations.

(r) Save us O

Lord.

(r) Reward, O Lord.

(4) Song of Hezekiah. (*Isaiah xxxviii.*)

(r) Save us, O

Lord, all the

days of our life. (r) Reward, O Lord, them that wait for Thee, that Thy prophets be found faithful.

(s) Praise him.

(s) The Law was given by Moses.

(5) *Psalm* 148-150.

(s) Praise Him,

all ye angels of

His. (s) The Law was given by Moses, but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ. (*go on (t)*)

1st, 2d & 3d

Wednesday.

4th Wednesday, (the 21st, St. Thomas's.)

(o) Wash me

thoroughly.

(o) This is My commandment, that ye love one another
as I have loved you.

(1) *Psalm* 51. (1) *Psalm* 94.

(o) Wash me

thoroughly from

my wickedness. (o) This is My commandment, that ye love one another
as I have loved you.

(p) Thou, O

Lord.

(p) Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay
down his life for his friends.

(2) *Psalm* 65.

(2) *Psalm* 100.

(p) Thou, O

Lord, art prais-

ed in Sion.

(p) Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay
down his life for his friends.

(q) My lips

shall praise

Thee.

(q) Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command
you, saith the Lord.

(3) *Ps.* 63 & 67.

(3) *Ps.* 63 & 67.

(q) My lips

shall praise

Thee as long as

I live, my God.

(q) Ye are my friends, if ye do whatsoever I command
you, saith the Lord.

(r) The Lord

shall judge.

(r) Blessed are the peace-makers, blessed are the pure in
heart, for they shall see God.

(4) *Song of Hannah* (1 *Sam.*

ii.)

(4) *Song of the Three Children.* (*Benedicite Omnia Opera.*)

(r) The Lord

shall judge the

ends of the

earth.

(r) Blessed are the peace-makers, blessed are the pure in
heart, for they shall see God.

(s) Praise Him.
 (s) In your patience possess ye your souls.
 (5) *Ps.* 148-150.
 (5) *Psalm* 148-150.
 (s) Praise Him,
 all ye heavens.
 (s) In your patience possess ye your souls.
 1st, 2d & 3d
Thursday.
 4th *Thursday* (the 22d.)
 (o) Against
 Thee only have
 I sinned.
 (o) The Lord Almighty shall come.
 (1) *Psalm* 51.
 (o) Against
 Thee only have
 I sinned, have
 mercy upon me,
 O Lord.
 (o) The Lord Almighty shall come to save His people.
 (p) Lord.
 (p) Turn Thee, Lord.
 (2) *Psalm* 90.
 (p) Lord, Thou
 hast been our
 refuge.
 (p) Turn Thee, Lord, a little while, and delay not to come
 to Thy servants.
 (q) Have I not
 thought.
 (q) The Lord who is to reign.
 (3) *Psalm* 63 & 67.
 (q) Have I not
 thought upon
 Thee when I
 was waking.
 (q) The Lord who is to reign shall come from Sion;
 Emmanuel is His mighty name.
 (r) I will sing.
 (r) He is my God.
 (4) *Song of Moses* (*Exod.* xv.)
 (r) I will sing
 unto the Lord,
 for he hath tri-

umphed gloriously.

(r) He is my God, and I will prepare him an habitation; my father's God, and I will exalt Him.

(s) O praise God.

(s) The Lord is our lawgiver.

(5) *Psalm* 148-150.

(s) O praise God

in His holiness.

(s) The Lord is our lawgiver, the Lord is our king: He will come and save us.

1st, 2nd, & 3rd

Friday.

4th Friday (the 23d.)

(o) Stablish me.

(o) Stand still.

(1) *Psalm* 51.

(o) Stablish me

with Thy free

Spirit.

(o) Stand still, and ye shall see the salvation of the Lord.

(p) Hearken unto me.

(p) To Thee, O Lord, have I lift up my soul.

(2) *Psalm* 143.

(p) Hearken unto

me for Thy truth

and righteousness' sake.

(p) To Thee, O Lord, have I lift up my soul; come, O Lord, and deliver me, for I flee unto thee.

(q) Shew us the light.

(q) Come, O Lord, and do not tarry.

(3) *Psalm* 63 and 67.

(q) Shew us the

light of Thy

countenance.

(q) Come, O Lord, and do not tarry: absolve Thy people Israel from their iniquities.

(r) O Lord.

(r) God shall come from Lebanon.

(4) *Song of Habakhuk* (*Hab.* iii.)

(r) O Lord, I

have heard Thy

speech, and
 was afraid.
 (r) God shall come from Lebanon, and His brightness
 shall be as a stream.
 (s) Praise Him.
 (s) But I will look towards the Lord.
 (5) *Psalm* 148-150.
 (s) Praise Him
 in the cymbals
 and dances.
 (s) But I will look towards the Lord, and will wait for
 God my Saviour.
 1st and 2nd *Saturday*.
 3rd *Saturday* (the 17th.)
 (o) O be favour-
 able.
 (o) The prophets announced.
 (1) *Psalm* 51.
 (o) O be favour-
 able and gracious.
 (o) The prophets announced that the Saviour should be
 born of the Virgin Mary.
 (p) It is a good
 thing.
 (p) The Spirit of the Lord.
 (2) *Psalm* 92.
 (p) It is a good
 thing to give
 thanks unto the
 Lord.
 (p) The Spirit of the Lord is upon me; He hath sent
 me to preach good tidings to the poor.
 (q) All the ends
 of the world.
 (q) for Sion's sake will I not hold my peace.
 (3) *Psalm* 63 and 67.
 (q) All the ends
 of the world
 shall fear Him.
 (q) For Sion's sake will I not hold my peace, until the
 righteousness thereof goeth forth as brightness.
 (r) Ascribe ye
 greatness.
 (r) My speech shall drop as the rain.
 (3) *Song of Moses* (Deut. xxxii.)

(r) Ascribe ye
greatness unto
our God.

(r) My speech shall drop as the rain, and our God shall
come down upon us as the dew.

(s) Praise him.

(s) Tell the people, and say.

(5) *Psalm* 148-150.

(s) Praise Him
upon the well-
tuned cymbals.

(s) Tell the people, and say, Behold God our Saviour
shall come.

(t) *Text*

Isa. ii. 3.

(for every day.)

Come ye, and let us go up to the mountain of the Lord,
to the house of the God of Jacob; and He will teach us of His
ways, and we will walk in His paths; for out of Zion shall
go forth the law, and the Word of the Lord from Jerusalem.

(u) *Hymn*

En clara vox redarguit.

(v) *Verse and Response*

(for every day.)

The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye
the way of the Lord.

Make his paths straight.

(w) *Antiphon of the Benedictus*

1st *Monday*

The angel of the Lord made announcement to Mary, and
she conceived of the Holy Ghost. Hallelujah.

1st *Tuesday*

Before they came together, Mary was found with child of
the Holy Ghost. Hallelujah.

1st *Wednesday*

Out of Sion shall go forth the law, and the Word of the
Lord from Jerusalem.

1st *Thursday*

Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit
of thy womb.

1st *Friday*

Behold God and man of the house of David shall come to
sit on the throne. Hallelujah.

1st *Saturday*

O Sion, be not afraid: behold thy God shall come.

Hallelujah.

2nd Monday

The Almighty Lord shall come from heaven, and in His hand is honour and dominion.

2nd Tuesday

The Lord shall arise upon thee, O Jerusalem; and his glory shall be seen in thee.

2nd Wednesday

Behold I send My messenger, who shall prepare My way before Thee. *2nd Thursday*

Thou art He that should come, O Lord, whom we look for, to save Thy people.

2nd Friday

Say ye, strengthen the weak-hearted; behold our Lord God shall come.

2nd Saturday

The Lord shall lift up an ensign among the nations, and shall gather together the dispersed of Israel.

3rd Monday

A rod shall go forth out of the root of Jesse, and all the earth shall be filled with the glory of the Lord; and all flesh shall see the salvation of God.

3rd Tuesday

Thou, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah, art not the least among the princes of Judah; for out of thee shall come forth a governor, that shall rule my people Israel.

3rd Wednesday

The Angel Gabriel was sent to a Virgin, Mary, who was espoused to Joseph.

3rd Thursday

Watch ye in heart, for the Lord our God is at hand.

3rd Friday

As soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in mine ears, the babe leaped in my womb for joy. Hallelujah.

3rd Saturday

How shall this be, Angel of God, seeing I know not a man? Hear thou, Mary the Virgin, the Holy Ghost shall come upon thee, and the power of the Highest shall overshadow thee.

4th Monday

The Lord saith, Repent ye, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

4th Tuesday

Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the Lord.

4th Wednesday

(the 21st.)

Be afraid, for on the fifth day our Lord shall come to you.

4th Thursday

I will place salvation in Sion, and in Jerusalem my glory.

4th Friday

Behold all things are accomplished, which were said by the Angel concerning Mary the Virgin.

Christmas Eve, &c.

(x) *Collect*

(the same as in the four Sundays respectively.)

(Except on the three Ember days, when it is as follows:)

1st Week. Raise up we beseech Thee, &c.

2nd Week. Stir up, O Lord, &c.

3rd Week. Give ear, we beseech Thee, &c.

4th Week. Raise up, we beseech Thee, &c.

(x) *Collect for Ember Wednesday*

Grant to us, we beseech Thee, Almighty God, that when the festival of our redemption cometh, it may both furnish us with aids for this present life, and impart to us the rewards of everlasting bliss, through the Lord, &c.

Friday

Raise up, we beseech Thee, O Lord, Thy power, and come, that they who rely upon Thy mercy may be speedily delivered from all adversity, who livest and reignest, &c.

Saturday

O God, who seest that we are afflicted by our own corruption, mercifully grant that we may be consoled by Thy visitation, who livest, &c.

PRIME, THIRD, SIXTH, NINTH

((o) (p) (q) (s)) *The Service is the same as on the respective Sundays, except that from the 17th inclusive, the Antiphons in the four Services are taken successively from the 1st, 2d, 3d, and 5th Antiphons at Lauds, on the same day;*

That in Prime, there is a Psalm according to the day of the week, instead of the Benedicite, (vid. § 1. supra.) the Athanasian Creed is omitted, and the Text (c) is Love the truth and peace, saith the Lord of Hosts, instead of To the King, &c.

And in the Third, Sixth, and Ninth, the collect(nn, ss, xx)

is the same as at the Lauds (x) of each day; and that the Text for every day is as follows:

At the Third

(ll)

Behold the days come, saith the Lord, that I will raise unto David a righteous branch, and a king shall reign and prosper, and shall execute judgment and justice in the earth.

At the Sixth

(qq) In his days Judah shall be saved and Israel shall dwell

safely; and this is His name whereby He shall be called,
the Lord our righteousness.

At the Ninth

(vv)

(*and on the 21st at Prime also, instead of the Lectio Brevis.*) Her time is near to come, and her days
shall not be pro-
longed; for the Lord will have mercy on Jacob, and will
yet choose Israel.

VESPERS

Monday Tuesday Wednesday Thursday Friday Saturday

(yy) *Ant.* He hath

inclined We will

go into They shall

not be

ashamed

when they

speak And all Even

before the

gods will Blessed is

the

Psalm (1) 116 (*part*) 122 127 132 138 144

(yy) *Ant.* His ear

unto me. the house

of the Lord. with their

enemies in

the gate.

his trouble. I sing

praise unto

Thee. Lord my

strength.

(zz) *Ant.* I believed:

and there-

fore O thou

that

dweldest Blessed are

all they Behold

how good

and joyful

a thing

it is, O Lord,

thou hast Every day

will I

Psalm (2) 116 (*part*) 123 128 133 139 145

(zz) *Ant.* will I speak. in the

heavens
have mercy
upon us.
that fear
the Lord. brethren,
to dwell
together
in unity. searched
me out and
known me. give thanks
unto Thee.

(aaa) *Ant.* Praise the
Lord Our help
is in the Many a
time have Whatsoever
the Lord Preserve
me from While I
live will

Psalm (3) 117 124 129 135 140 146

(aaa) *Ant.* all ye
heathen. name of
the Lord. they fought
against me
from my
youth up.
pleased,
that did
He. the wicked
man. I praise
the Lord.

(bbb) *Ant.* I called
upon the
Lord, Do good,
O Lord,
unto Out of the
deep have I For His
mercy Lord, I
call upon
Thee: A joyful
and
pleasant
thing

Psalm (4) 120 125 130 136 141 147 (*part*)

(bbb) *Ant.* and He
heard me. those who

are good,
and turn our
hearts.
called unto
Thee, O
Lord. endureth
for ever. haste Thou
unto me. it is to be
thankful.
(ccc) *Ant.* From
whence
cometh Then
were we
like O Israel,
trust Sing us
one of Thou art
my portion Praise the
Lord

Psalms (5) 121 126 131 137 142 147 (*part*)

(ccc) *Ant.* my help. unto them
that dream. in the
Lord. the songs of
Sion. in the land
of the
living. O
Jerusalem.

(ddd) *Text*

(*On Saturdays the Text is that of Lauds and Vespers of the following Sundays.*) The Sceptre shall not
depart from Judah, nor a lawgiver
from between his feet, until Shiloh come, and unto Him shall
the gathering of the people, &c.

(eee) *Hymn*

Creator alme siderum, &c.

(fff) *Verse and Response* Drop down, ye heavens, from above, and let the skies
pour down righteousness. *Let the earth open and bring forth salvation.*

(ggg)

1st Monday Antiphon of the Magnificat.

Lift up thine eyes, O Jerusalem, and behold the greatness
of thy King. Behold thy Saviour cometh to loose thee from
thy chains.

1st Tuesday Seek ye the Lord while He may be found; call upon
Him while He is near. Hallelujah.

1st Wednesday One that is mightier than I shall come after Me, whose
shoes' hatchet I am not worthy to unloose.

1st Thursday I will wait for the Lord my Saviour, and will attend upon

Him while He is near. Hallelujah.

1st Friday Out of Egypt have I called My Son. He shall come to save His people.

1st Saturday Come, O Lord, to visit us in peace, that we may rejoice before Thee with a perfect heart.

2nd Monday Behold the king, the Lord of the earth shall come; and He shall take away the yoke of our captivity.

2nd Tuesday The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make the paths of our God straight.

2nd Wednesday O Sion, thou shalt be renewed, and thou shalt see thy Holy One, who is to come unto thee.

2nd Thursday He who shall come after me, was in being before me: whose sandals I am not worthy to unloose.

2nd Friday O sing unto the Lord a new song, His praise is from the ends of the earth.

2nd Saturday There was no God made before Me, neither shall there be after Me; for every knee shall bow to Me, and every tongue confess to God.

3rd Monday All generations shall call me blessed; because God hath regarded the low estate of His handmaiden.

3rd Tuesday Awake, awake, stand up, O Jerusalem, loose the chains off thy neck, O captive daughter of Sion.

3rd Wednesday Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word.

3rd Thursday Rejoice ye with Jerusalem, and leap for joy in her all ye that love her for ever.

3rd Friday This was the witness of John; He that cometh after me, was in being before me.

3rd Saturday
(the 17th.)

[*O Sapientia.*]

(This is the first of a series of Majores Antiphonæ, beginning on this day. They are said whole before and after the Magnificat.)

O eternal Wisdom, which proceedest from the mouth of the Most High, reaching from one end of creation unto the other, mightily and harmoniously disposing all things, come Thou teach us the way of understanding. *4th Monday* (19) O Root of Jesse, who art placed for a sign of the people, before whom kings shall shut their mouths, whom the Gentiles shall supplicate; come Thou to deliver us, do not tarry.

(Vide 4th Sunday for the intervening Antiphon.)

4th Tuesday (20) O Key of David and Sceptre of the house of Israel, who openest and none shutteth, who shuttest and none openeth, come Thou, and bring forth the captive from the house of

bondage, who sitteth in darkness and in the shadow of death.

4th Wed. (21) O rising Brightness of the Everlasting Light and Sun of Righteousness, come Thou and enlighten those who sit in darkness and in the shadow of death.

4th Thurs. (22) O King and the Desire of all nations, and chief Cornerstone, who makest two to be one, come Thou and save man whom Thou formedst from the clay.

4th Friday (23) O Emmanuel, our King and Lawgiver, the gatherer of the people and their Saviour, come Thou to save us, O Lord our God.

Christmas Eve, &c.

(hhh) Collect

(The same as on the respective Sundays: each Saturday belonging to the Sunday following.)

1st week. Raise up, we beseech Thee, &c.

2d week. Stir up, O Lord, &c.

3d week. Give ear, we beseech Thee, &c.

4th week. Raise up, we beseech Thee, &c.

OXFORD,

The Feast of St. John the Baptist.

ERRATUM.

In pages 35, 36, 41, 42, 45, 46, 63, 82, the words "Jube, Domine, benedicere" are translated by mistake, "Sir, pray for a blessing," instead of, "Sir, be pleased to bless us." [FOURTH EDITION.]

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1840.

Catena Patrum No. II. Testimony of Writers in the later English Church to the Doctrine of Baptismal Regeneration

Tract No. 76 (Ad Populum)

CONSIDERING the confidence and zeal with which modern and unscriptural views on the subject of Christian Baptism are put forth at the present time, it will not be unseasonable to present the reader with some testimonies from the writings of Anglican Divines in behalf of the doctrine of Baptismal Regeneration. By this doctrine is meant, first, that the Sacrament of Baptism is not a mere *sign* or *promise*, but actually a *means* of grace, an *instrument*, by which, when rightly received, the soul is admitted to the benefits of CHRIST'S Atonement, such as the forgiveness of sin, original and actual, reconciliation to GOD, a new nature, adoption, citizenship in CHRIST'S kingdom, and the inheritance of heaven,—in a word, Regeneration. And next, Baptism is considered to be rightly received, when there is no positive obstacle or hindrance to the reception in the recipient, such as impenitence or unbelief would be in the case of an adult; so that infants are necessarily right recipients of it, as not being yet capable of actual sin. So much as these two positions is certainly held by every one of the authors of the following passages, though it is impossible to bring out their full meaning in such brief extracts, however carefully selected.

There is a variety of questions connected with the subject beyond the two positions above set down, on which the writers under review differ more or less from each other, but not so as in the slightest degree to interfere with their clear and deliberate maintenance of these. Such, for instance, as the following:—Whether grace be given in and through the water, or only contemporaneously with it. Again, whether Baptism, strictly speaking, *conveys* the blessings annexed to it, or simply *admits* into a state gifted with those blessings, as being the initiatory rite of the covenant of mercy. Or, again, whether or not Baptism, besides washing away past sin, admits into a state in which, for sins henceforth committed, Repentance stands in place of a Sacrament, so as to ensure forgiveness without specific ordinance; or whether the Holy Eucharist is that ordinance; or whether the full and explicit absolution of sin after Baptism is altogether put off till the day of judgment. Or, again, there may be difference of opinion as to the state of infants dying unbaptized. Or, again, whether Regeneration is an instantaneous work completed in Baptism, or admits of degrees and growth. Or, again, whether or not the HOLY SPIRIT can utterly desert a soul once inhabited by Him, except to quit it for ever. Or, whether the change in the soul made by Baptism is indelible, for good or for evil; or may be undone, as if it had never been. Or, how far the enjoyment of the grace attached to it is suspended on the condition of our doing our part in the covenant. All these are questions, far from unimportant, but which do not at present come into consideration; the one point, maintained in the following extracts, being, that infants are by and at baptism unconditionally translated from a state of wrath into a state of grace and acceptance for CHRIST'S sake.

List of Authors cited.

1. Jewell 22. Scott
2. Hooker 23. Jenkin
3. Andrews 24. Sherlock
4. Donne 25. Wall
5. Field 26. Potter
6. Jackson 27. Nelson
7. Laud 28. Waterland
8. Bramhall 29. Kettlewell

9. Hammond 30. Hickes
10. Taylor 31. Johnson
11. Heylin 32. Leslie
12. Allestrie 33. Wilson
13. Barrow 34. Bingham
14. Thorndike 35. Skelton
15. Pearson 36. Horne
16. Bull 37. Jones
17. Comber 38. Heber
18. Ken 39. Jebb
19. Patrick 40. Van Mildert
20. Beveridge 41. Mant
21. Sharp

N. B. It would be easy to extend this list, were it necessary: vid. Cosin's Devotions, Stanhope's Boyle Lectures, &c.

JEWELL, BISHOP.—Treatise on Sacraments

"They (the sacraments) are not bare signs; it were blasphemy so to say. The grace of GOD doth always work with His sacraments; but we are taught not to seek that grace in the sign, but to assure ourselves by receiving the sign, that it is given us by the thing signified. We are not washed from our sins by the water, we are not fed to eternal life by the bread and wine, but by the precious blood of our SAVIOUR CHRIST, that lieth hid in these sacraments." p. 263.

For this cause are infants baptized, because they are born in sin, and cannot become spiritual but by this new birth of the water and the Spirit. They are the heirs of the promise; the covenant of GOD'S favour is made unto them. GOD said to Abraham, "I will establish my covenant between me and thee, and thy seed after thee." "Therefore," saith the Apostle, "If the root be holy, so are the branches." And again, "The unbelieving husband is sanctified by the wife, and the unbelieving wife is sanctified by the husband; else were your children unclean; but now are they holy." When the disciples rebuked those that brought little children to CHRIST, that He might touch them, he said, "Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not, for of such is the kingdom of GOD." And again, "Their angels always behold the face of my Father which is in heaven," p. 265.

"The water wherein we are baptized doth not cleanse the soul;" but, "the blood of JESUS CHRIST His SON doth cleanse us from all sin." Not the water, but the blood of CHRIST reconcileth us unto GOD, strengtheneth our conscience, and worketh our redemption. We must seek salvation in CHRIST alone, and not in any outward thing. Hereof saith Cyprian, "Remissio peccatorum, sive per baptismum, sive per alia sacramenta donetur, proprie Spiritus Sancti est. Verborum solemnitas," &c. "The remission of sins, whether it be given by baptism, or by any other sacraments, does properly appertain to the HOLY GHOST. The solemnity of the words, and the invocation of GOD'S holy Name, and the outward signs appointed to the ministry of the priest by the institution of the Apostles, work the visible outward sacrament. But touching the substance thereof, it is the HOLY GHOST that worketh it." St. Ambrose also saith, "Vidisti fontem, vidisti sacerdotem," &c. "Thou hast seen the water, thou hast seen the priest, thou hast seen those things which thou mightest see with the eyes of thy body, and with such sight as man hath: but those things which work and do the deed of salvation, which no eye can see, thou hast not seen.

"Such a change is made in the sacrament of baptism. Through the power of GOD'S working the water is turned into blood. They that be washed in it receive the remission of sins; their robes

are made clean in the blood of the Lamb. The water itself is nothing; but by the working of GOD'S SPIRIT, the death and merits of our LORD and SAVIOUR CHRIST are thereby assured unto us.

"A figure hereof was given at the Red Sea. The children of Israel passed through in safety; but Pharaoh and his whole army were drowned. Another figure hereof was given in the ark. The whole world was drowned, but Noah and his family were saved alive. Even so in the fountain of baptism, our spiritual Pharaoh, the devil, is choked: his army, that is, our sins are drowned, and we are saved. The wicked of the world are swallowed in concupiscence and vanities, and we abide safe in the ark: GOD hath chosen us to be a peculiar people to Himself; we walk not after the flesh, but after the SPIRIT, therefore we are in CHRIST JESUS, and there is now no condemnation unto us.

"Now touching the minister of this sacrament, whether he be a good man or an evil man, godly or godless, an heretic or a Catholic, an idolater or a true worshipper of GOD: the effect is

all one, the value or worthiness of the sacrament dependeth not of man, but of GOD. Man pronounceth the word, but GOD setteth our hearts with grace: man toucheth or washeth us with water, but GOD maketh us clean by the cross of CHRIST. It is not the minister, but CHRIST Himself which is the Lamb of GOD that taketh away the sins of the world." p. 266.

Ibid.—Reply to M. Harding's Censure, p. 249.

And forasmuch as these two sacraments, being both of force like, these men [the Romanists] to advance their fantasies in the one, by comparison so much abase the other: and specially for the better opening of Chrysostom's mind, I think it good, briefly and by the way, somewhat to touch what the old Catholic Fathers have written of GOD'S invisible working in the Sacrament of Baptism. Dionysius generally of all mysteries writeth thus: "Angeli Deum," &c. "The angels being creatures spiritual, so far forth as it is lawful for them, behold GOD, and his godly power. But we are led as we may, by sensible outward tokens," (which he calleth images) "unto the contemplation of heavenly things." The Fathers, in the Council of Nice, say thus: "Baptism must be considered, not with our bodily eyes, but with the eyes of our mind. Thou seest the water; think thou of the power of GOD, that in the water is hidden. Think thou that the water is full of heavenly fire, and of the sanctification of the HOLY GHOST." Chrysostom, speaking likewise of baptism, saith thus: "Ego non aspectu judico ea, quæ videntur, sed mentis oculis," &c. "The things that I see, I judge not by sight, but by the eyes of my mind. The heathen, when he heareth the water of baptism, taketh it only for plain water: but I see not simply, or barely, that I see; I see the cleansing of the soul by the SPIRIT of GOD." So likewise saith Nazianzenus: "Mysterium (baptismi) majus est, quam ea quæ videntur;" "The mystery of baptism is greater than it appeareth to the eye." So St. Ambrose: "Aliud est, quod visibiliter agitur: aliud quod invisibiliter celebratur:" "In baptism there is one thing done visibly to the eye; another thing is wrought invisibly to the mind."

Again he saith, "Believe not only the bodily eyes (in this sacrament of baptism): the thing that is not seen, is better seen: the thing that thou seest is corruptible; the thing that thou seest not is for ever." To be short, in consideration of these invisible effects, Tertullian saith, "The HOLY GHOST cometh down and halloweth the water." St. Basil saith, "The kingdom of heaven is there set open." Chrysostom saith, "GOD Himself in baptism, by his invisible power, holdeth thy head." St. Ambrose saith, "The water hath the grace of CHRIST; in it is the presence of the Trinity." St. Bernard saith, "Let us be washed in his blood."

By the authorities of thus many ancient Fathers, it is plain, that in the sacrament of baptism, by the sensible sign of water, the invisible grace of GOD is given unto us."

HOOKE, PRESBYTER AND DOCTOR.—On Ecclesiastical Polity,
Book v. 60.

Unless as the SPIRIT is a necessary inward cause, so water were a necessary outward mean, to our regeneration, what construction should we give unto those words wherein we are said to be new born, and that [*ex hndatos*], even of water? Why are we taught, that with water GOD doth purify and cleanse His Church? Wherefore do the Apostles of CHRIST term baptism a bath of regeneration? What purpose had they in giving men advice to receive outward baptism, and in persuading them it did avail to remission of sins? If outward baptism were a cause in itself possessed of that power, either natural or supernatural, without the present operation whereof no such effect could possibly grow, it must then follow, that seeing effects do never prevent the necessary causes out of which they spring, no man could ever receive grace before baptism: which being apparently both known, and also confessed to be otherwise, in many particulars, although in the rest we make not baptism a cause of grace; yet tile grace which is given them with their baptism, doth so far forth depend on the very outward sacrament, that GOD will have it embraced, not only as a sign or token what we receive, but also as an instrument or means whereby we receive grace, because baptism is a sacrament which GOD hath instituted in His Church, to the end that they which receive the same might thereby be incorporated into CHRIST; and so through His most precious merit obtain, as well that saving grace of imputation which taketh away all former guiltiness, as also that infused divine virtue of the HOLY GHOST which giveth to the powers of the soul their first disposition towards future newness of life. There are that elevate too much the ordinary and immediate means of life, relying wholly upon the bare conceit of that eternal election, which notwithstanding includeth a subordination of means, without which we are not actually brought to enjoy what GOD secretly did intend; and therefore, to build upon GOD'S election, if we keep not ourselves to the ways which He hath appointed for men to walk in, is but a self-deceiving vanity. When the Apostle saw men called to the participation of JESUS CHRIST, after the Gospel of GOD embraced, and the sacrament of life received, he feareth not then to put them in the number of elect saints; he then accounteth them delivered from death, and clean purged from all sin. Till then, notwithstanding their preordination unto life, which none could know of, saving GOD, what were they, in the Apostle's own account, but children of wrath, as well as others, plain aliens, altogether without hope, strangers, utterly without GOD in this present world? So that by sacraments, and other sensible tokens of grace, we may boldly gather, that He whose mercy vouchsafeth now to bestow the means, hath also sithence intended us that whereunto they lead. But let us never think it safe to presume of our own last, and by bare conjectural collections of his first intent and purpose, the means failing that should come between. Predestination bringeth not to life without the grace of eternal vocation, wherein our baptism is implied. For as we are not naturally men without birth, so neither are we Christian men in the eye of the Church of GOD but by new birth; nor according to the manifest ordinary course of divine dispensation new born, but by that baptism which both declareth and maketh us Christians. In which respect, we justly hold it to be the door of our actual entrance into GOD'S house, the first apparent beginning of life, a seal perhaps to the grace of election before received: but to our sanctification here, a step that hath not any before it.

Ibid. 64.

Were St. Augustine now living, there are which would tell him for his better instruction, that to say of a child, it is elect, and to say, it doth believe, are all one; for which cause, sith no man is able precisely to affirm the one of any infant in particular, it followeth that precisely and absolutely we ought not to say the other. Which precise and absolute terms are needless in this case. We speak of infants as the rule of piety alloweth both to speak and think. They that can take to themselves in ordinary talk, a charitable kind of liberty to name men of their own sort GOD'S

dear children, (notwithstanding the large reign of hypocrisy,) should not, methinks, be so strict and rigorous against the Church, for presuming as it doth of a Christian innocent. For when we know how CHRIST in general hath said, Of such is the kingdom of heaven, which kingdom is the inheritance of GOD'S elect; and do withal behold how His providence hath called them unto the first beginnings of eternal life, and presented them at the well-spring of new birth, wherein original sin is purged, besides which sin there is no hindrance of their salvation known to us, as themselves will grant; hard it were that having so many fair inducements whereupon to ground, we should not be thought to utter, at the least, a truth as probable and allowable in terming any such particular infant an elect babe, as in presuming the like of others whose safety, nevertheless, we are not absolutely able to warrant.

ANDREWS, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—On the Holy Ghost,

Serm. vii.

Now CHRIST is baptized. And no sooner is He so, but He falls to His prayers, *Indigentia mater orationis*, (we say) want begets prayer: therefore, yet there wants somewhat—a part and that a chief part of baptism is still behind.

There goes more to baptism, if it be as it should be, than *baptismus fluminis*, yea (I may boldly say,) there goes more to it, if it be as it should, than *baptismus sanguinis*. CHRIST “came in water and blood, not in water only, but in water and blood:” that is not enough, except the “SPIRIT also bear witness.” So *baptismus fluminis* is to come too. There is to be a Trinity beneath,—1. water, 2. blood, and 3. the SPIRIT, to answer to that above: but (the SPIRIT'S baptism coming too) in the mouth of all three, all is made sure, all established thoroughly. This is it, He prays for, as man.

For the baptism of blood that was due to every one of us, (and each of us to have been baptized in his own blood, to have had three such immersions?) that hath CHRIST quit us of when he was asked by the prophet, “How his robes came so red?” He says, “He had been in the wine-press;” but there He had been, and that “He bad trod alone, and not one of the people with Him;” none but He there; in that, spare us in that.

But the other two parts He sets down precisely to Nicodemus (and in him, to us all,)—1. water, 2. and the HOLY GHOST . . .

St. Paul tells us (Col. ii.) that besides the circumcision, that was the manufacture, there was another made without hands. There is so in baptism, besides the hand seen, that casts on the water, the virtue of the HOLY GHOST is there, working, without hands, what here was wrought.

And for this CHRIST prays; that then it might, might then, and might ever, be joined to that of the water. Not in his baptism only, but in the people's; and (as he afterwards enlarges His prayer) in all others that “should ever after believe in His name:” that what in His (here) was, in all theirs might be: what in this first, in all following; what in CHRIST'S, in all Christians; heaven might open, the HOLY GHOST come down, the FATHER be pleased to say over the same word, *toties quoties*, so oft as any Christian man's child is brought to his baptism. CHRIST hath prayed, now,

See the force of His prayer. Before it heaven was mured up, no dove to be seen, no voice to be heard, *Altum silentium*. But straight upon it (as if they had but waited the last word of His prayer) all of them follow immediately.

Heaven opens, first. For, if when the lower heaven was shut three years, Elias was able with his prayer to open it, (it is our SAVIOUR in the next chapter following,) and bring down rain; the prayer of CHRIST (who is more of might than many such as Elias) shall it not be much more of force, to enter the Heaven of heavens, the highest of them all, and to bring down thence the waters “above the heavens,” even the heavenly graces of the HOLY SPIRIT?

For, so when our SAVIOUR cried, (John vii.) “If any thirst,” &c. This (saith St. John) He spake of the SPIRIT.” For the SPIRIT and His graces are the very supercelestial water; one drop whereof, infused into the waters of Jordan, will give them an admirable power to pierce even into the innermost parts of the soul: and to baptize it, (that is) not only to take out the stains of it, and make it clean; but further, give it a tincture, lustre, or gloss; for so is baptism properly of [*baptō*], taken from the dyer’s fat, and is a dyeing or giving a fresh colour, and not a bare washing only.

Always, the opening of heaven, opens unto us, that no baptism without heaven open: and so, that baptism is *de cælo, non ab hominibus*, from heaven, not of men. So it was here; so is it to be holden for ever. 2. And from heaven; not *clanculum* (as Prometheus is said to get his fire), but [*aneōichthēnai*], orderly, by a fair door set open, in the view of much people; for all that were present saw the impression in the sky. Which door was not mured up again; for we find it still open, (Apoc. iii.) and we find that keys were made, and given of it, after this. 3. And all this, that there might not only be a passage for these down, but for us up. For heaven gate, *ab hoc exemplo*, doth ever open at baptism in sign, he that new cometh from the fount hath then right of entrance in thither. Then (I say) when by baptism he is cleansed; for, before, *Nihil inquinatum*, nothing defiled can enter there.

DONNE, PRESBYTER.—Serm. xxxi.

p. 309.

The water of Baptism, is the water that runs through all the Fathers; all the Fathers that had occasion to dive or dip in these waters (to say anything of them) make these first waters, in the creation, the figure of baptism. Therefore Tertullian makes the water, *Primam sedem Spiritus Sancti*, the progress, and the settled house, the voyage, and the harbour, the circumference, and the centre of the HOLY GHOST. And therefore St. Hierome calls these waters, *Matrem mundi*, the Mother of the world: and this in the figure of baptism. The waters brought forth the whole world, were delivered of the whole world, as a mother is delivered of a child; and this, *in figura baptismi*, to foreshew that the waters also should bring forth the Church; that the Church of GOD should be born of the Sacrament of Baptism. So says Damascen, and he establishes it with better authority than his own. The divine Basil saith (saith he) “The SPIRIT of GOD wrought upon the waters in the creation, because he meant to do so after, in the regeneration of man. And therefore, *Pristinam sedem recognoscens conquiescit*, till the HOLY GHOST have moved upon our children in baptism, let us not think all done that belongs to those children; and when the HOLY GHOST hath moved upon those waters, so in baptism, let us not doubt of His power and effect upon all those children that die so. We know no means how those waters could have produced a minnow, a shrimp, without the SPIRIT of GOD had moved upon them; and by this motion of the SPIRIT of GOD, we know they produce whales, and leviathans. We know no ordinary means of any saving grace for a child but baptism; neither are we to doubt of the fulness of salvation, in them that have received it. And for ourselves, *mergimur et emergimus*, in baptism we are sunk under water, and then raised above the water again; which was the manner of baptizing in the Christian Church, by immersion and not by aspersion, till of late times: *Affectus et amores*, (says he,) our corrupt affections, and our inordinate love of this world is that, that is to be drowned in us; *Amor securitatis*, a love of peace, and holy assurance, and acquiescence in GOD’S ordinance, is that that lifts us above water.

Therefore that Father puts all upon the due consideration of our baptism: and as St. Jerome says, Certainly he that thinks upon the last Judgment advisedly, cannot sin thus; so he that says with St. Augustine, Let me make every day to GOD, this confession; *Domine*, &c. O LORD my GOD, O holy, holy, holy LORD my GOD; I consider that I was baptized in thy name, and what thou promised me, and what I promised thee then, and can I sin this sin? can this sin stand with

those conditions, those stipulations which passed between us then? The SPIRIT of GOD is motion, the SPIRIT of GOD is rest too; and in due consideration of baptism, a true Christian is moved, and settled too; moved to a sense of the breach of his conditions, settled in the sense of the mercy of his GOD, in the merits of his CHRIST, upon his godly sorrow. So these waters are the waters of baptism.

FIELD, PRESBYTER.—Of the Church,
book i. chap. xii.

This was the fault of sundry in the Primitive Church; and which was yet more to be condemned, many did therefore defer and put off their baptism, that so whatsoever evil things they did in the mean time, might in that laver of new birth be washed away, thereby taking greater liberty to offend, for that they had so present means of full remission, and perfect reconciliation; so making that which was ordained against sin, and for the weakening and overthrow of it, to be an encouragement thereunto, and to give life and strength unto it.

JACKSON, PRESBYTER AND DOCTOR.—On CHRIST'S exercise of his everlasting Priesthood,

ch. i. (vol. iii. p. 271.)

It is no part of our Church's doctrine or meaning, that the washing, or sprinkling infants' bodies with consecrated water, should take away sins by its own immediate virtue. To affirm thus much implies, as I conceive, a contradiction to that apostolical doctrine. "The like figure whereunto even Baptism doth also now save us (not the putting away the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a good conscience towards GOD) by the resurrection of JESUS CHRIST, who is gone into heaven," &c. 1 Pet. iii. 21. The meaning of our Church intends no further than thus: That if this sacrament of Baptism be duly administered, the blood, or bloody sacrifice of CHRIST, or (which is all one) the influence of His SPIRIT doth always accompany, or is concurrent to this solemn act. But whether this influence of His Spirit or virtual presence of His body and blood be either immediately or only terminated to the soul and spirit of the party baptized, or have some virtual influence upon the water of Baptism as a mean to convey the Grace of Regeneration unto the soul of the party baptized, whilst the water is poured upon him, is too nice and curious a question, in this age, for sober Christians to debate or contend about. It may suffice to believe that this sacramental pledge hath a virtual presence of CHRIST'S Blood, or some real influence from His Body, concomitant, though not consubstantiated to it, which is prefigured or signified by the washing or sprinkling the body with water.

But it will be, or rather is objected, but only by private or some saucy spirits, That if the doctrine of our Church were true and sound, then all that be rightly baptized should be undoubtedly saved, being once washed or cleansed from their sins. The objection were of some force, if the Church of England did hold or maintain such doctrine or tenets as they do which make or favour it; to wit, That the sins of the elect only are remitted by Baptism, or by Sacrament of CHRIST'S Body and Blood; or, that sins once remitted cannot be remitted afresh; or, that the party which is once pardoned for his sins, before committed, cannot afterwards be condemned. The orthodoxal truth is, That albeit the original sin of children truly baptized in the name of CHRIST, or the actual sins of young or elder men so baptized, and the sins of their forefathers (so far as it concerns men of riper years to repent of them both) be so truly remitted in Baptism, that neither young men nor old may be baptized again; yet the stipulation of a good conscience, wherein the internal Baptism (as St. Peter tells) doth consist, may and ought, by the law of GOD and of CHRIST'S Church, to be reiterated.

And this stipulation of every Christian, male or female, though baptized after they have passed their nonage for civil contracts, ought to be resumed or reacknowledged as often as they intend to receive the sacramental pledges of CHRIST'S Body and Blood, either privately or in the public congregation. But for all such as have been baptized in their infancy, the personal resumption or ratification of that vow, which their fathers and mothers in GOD did make for them at the sacred laver, is to be exacted of them *ore tenus*, in some public congregation, before they can be lawfully admitted to be public communicants of CHRIST'S Body and Blood.

Ibid.—Ch. lv. (p. 298.)

If either the actual sins of all men, or the sins of the elect in special, had been so remitted by CHRIST'S death, as some conceive they were, that is, absolutely pardoned before they were committed, there had been no end or use of CHRIST'S Resurrection in respect of us; no need of Baptism: yet was Baptism, from the hour of His resurrection, necessary unto all that did believe in His death and resurrection. The urgent and indispensable necessity of Baptism, especially in respect of actual believers, is not anywhere more emphatically intimated than in St. Peter's answer to the Jews, whose hearts were pierced with sorrow that they had been the causes of CHRIST'S death. They in this stound or sting of conscience demand, "Men and brethren, what shall we do? And Peter answered them, Repent, and be baptized every one of you, in the name of Jesus CHRIST, for the remission of sins. And they that gladly received the word were baptized the same day." Acts ii. 37, 38, 41. These men had been deeply tainted with sin, not original only, but with sins actual of the worst kind; guilty they were, in a high degree, of the death of the SON of GOD, yet had they as well their actual as their original sins remitted by Baptism. It is then unsound and imperfect doctrine, that sin original only is taken away or remitted by Baptism; for whatsoever sins are remitted or taken away by CHRIST'S death, the same sins are in the same manner remitted and taken away by Baptism into His death; actual sins are remitted, in such as are guilty of actual sins when they are baptized, though only sin original be actually remitted in those which are not guilty of actual sins, as in infants. No man's sins are actually remitted before he be actually guilty of them.

The question is, how either sin original is remitted, or how any work of Satan is dissolved by Baptism; and this question, in the general, is rightly resolved, by saying, "They are remitted by faith." But this general resolution sufficeth not, unless we know the object of our faith in this particular. Now the particular object of our faith, of that faith by which sins (whether by Baptism or otherwise) are remitted, is not our general belief in CHRIST; even our belief in CHRIST dying for us in particular, will not suffice, unless it include our belief of the everlasting virtue of His bloody sacrifice, and of His everlasting priesthood for purifying and cleansing our souls. No sins be truly remitted unless they be remitted by the office or exercise of His priesthood and whilst so remitted they are not remitted by any other sacrifice than by the sole virtue of His body and blood, which He "once offered for all," for the sins of all. It is not the virtue or efficacy of the consecrated water in which we were washed, but the virtue of his blood which was once shed for us, and which, by Baptism, is sprinkled upon us, or communicated unto us, which immediately cleansed us from all our sins. From this everlasting virtue of this His bloody sacrifice, faith, by the ministry of Baptism, is immediately gotten in such as had it not before. And in such as have faith before they be baptized, the guilt of actual sins is remitted by the exercise or act of faith, as it apprehends the everlasting efficacy of this sacrifice, and by the prayer of faith, and supplication unto our High Priest. Faith, then, is as the mouth or appetite by which we receive this food of life, and is a good sign of health; but it is the food itself received, which must continue health and strengthen spiritual life in us; and the food of life is no other than CHRIST'S body and blood; and it is our High Priest

Himself which must give us this food.

Baptism, saith St. Peter, (1 Pet. iii. 20.) doth save us. What Baptism doth save us? not the putting away the filth of the flesh, (yet this is the immediate effect of the water in Baptism,) but the answer (or stipulation) of a good conscience towards GOD! But how doth this kind of Baptism, or this concomitant of Baptism save us? The Apostle, in the same place, tells us, “by the resurrection of JESUS CHRIST.” “The answer or stipulation of a good conscience,” includes an illumination of our Spirits by the SPIRIT of GOD; a qualification by which we are made sons of light, being before the sons of darkness. But, that by this qualification we become the sons of light; that this qualification is, by Baptism, wrought in us; that by this qualification, however wrought in us, we are saved from our sins; all this is immediately from the “virtue of CHRIST’S Resurrection.” That is, as you have heard before, He was consecrated by the sufferings of death to be an everlasting Priest, and by His resurrection from death, His body and blood became an everlasting propitiation for sins, an inexhaustible fountain of grace, by which we are purified from the dead works of sin.

Ibid.—Of Christ’s session at the right hand of God. ch. xvii. p. 170.

[St. Paul] saith, “that all that are baptized are dead to sin;” that is, first, they are “dead unto it by solemn vow or profession.” Secondly, they are said to be “dead unto sin, or sin to be dead in them,” inasmuch as they in Baptism receive an antidote from GOD by which the rage and poison of it might easily be assuaged or expelled, so they would not either receive that grace or means which GOD in Baptism exhibits unto them in vain, or use it amiss. So we may say that any popular disease is quelled or taken away, after a sovereign remedy be found against it, which never fails; so men will seek for it, reasonably apply for it, and observe that diet which the physician, upon the taking of it, prescribes unto them. Some in our times there be (and more, I think, than have been in all the former) which deny all baptismal grace. Others there be which grant some grace to be conferred by Baptism, even unto infants; but yet these restrain it only to infants elect. And this they take to be the meaning of our Church’s Catechism, wherein children are taught to believe [That as CHRIST, the second person in the Trinity, did redeem them and all mankind; so the HOLY GHOST (the third person) doth sanctify them, and all the elect people of GOD.]

But can any man be persuaded that it was any part of our Church’s meaning, to teach children when they first make profession of their faith, to believe, that they are of the number of the elect; that is, of “such as cannot finally perish?” This were to teach them their faith backwards, and to seek the kingdom of heaven not *ascendendo*, by ascending, but *descendendo*, by descending from it. For higher than thus St. Paul himself, in his greatest perfection, could not possibly reach; no, nor the blessed angels, which have kept their first station almost these 6000 years. Yet certain it is, that our Church would have every one, at the very first profession of his faith, to believe that he is one of the elect people of GOD.

LAUD, ARCHBISHOP AND MARTYR.—Conference with Fisher, § 15.

First, that Baptism is necessary to the salvation of infants (in the ordinary way of the Church, without binding GOD to the use and means of that sacrament, to which He hath bound us) is expressed in St. John iii. “Except a man be born of water,” &c. So, no baptism, no entrance. Nor can infants creep in any other ordinary way. And this is the received opinion of all the ancient Church of CHRIST.

And, secondly, that infants ought to be baptised, is first, plain by evident and direct consequence out of Scripture. For if there be no salvation for infants in the ordinary way of the Church but by Baptism, and this appear in Scripture, as it doth, then out of all doubt, the consequence is most evident out of that Scripture, that infants are to be baptized, that their salvation may be certain.

For they which cannot help themselves, must not be left only to extraordinary helps, of which we have no assurance, and for which we have no warrant at all in Scripture, while we, in the mean time, neglect the ordinary way and means commanded by CHRIST. Secondly, it is very near an expression in Scripture itself. For when St. Peter had ended that great Sermon of his, Acts ii., he applies two comforts unto them, verse 38, "Amend your life," &c. And then, v. 39, He infers, "For the promise is made," &c. The promise; what promise? What? why the promise of sanctification by the HOLY GHOST. By what means; Why, by Baptism. For it is expressly, "Be baptized, and ye shall receive." And as expressly, "This promise is made to you and to your children."

BRAMHALL, ARCHBISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Of persons dying without Baptism,
p. 979.

The discourse which happened the other day, about your little daughter, I had quite forgotten till you were pleased to mention it again last night. If any thing did fall from me, which gave offence to any there present, I am right sorrowful, but I hope there did not; as, on the other side, if any occasion of offence had been given to me, I should readily have sacrificed it to that reverend respect, which is due to the place—your table,—anciently accounted a sacred thing, and to the lord of it, yourself. This morning, lying musing in my bed, it produced some trouble to me, to consider how passionately we are all wedded to our own parties, and how apt we are all to censure the opinions of others before we understand them, while, our want of charity is a greater

error in ourselves, and more displeasing to ALMIGHTY GOD, than any of those supposed assertions which we condemn in others, especially when they come to be rightly understood. And to show thus particular breach is not so wide, nor the more moderate of either party so disagreeing, as is imagined, I digested these sudden meditations, drawn wholly, in a manner from the grounds of the Roman schools; and so soon as I was risen, I committed them to writing.

First, there is a great difference to be made between the sole want of Baptism upon invincible necessity, and the contempt or wilful neglect of Baptism when it may be had. The latter we acknowledge to be a damnable sin, and, without repentance and GOD'S extraordinary mercy, to exclude a man from all hope of salvation. But yet if such a person, before his death, shall repent and deplore his neglect of the means of grace, from his heart, and desire, with all his soul, to be baptized, but is debarred from it invincibly, we do not, we dare not pass sentence of condemnation upon him; nor yet the Roman Catholics themselves. The question then is, whether the want of Baptism, upon invincible necessity, do evermore infallibly exclude from heaven?

Secondly, we distinguish between the visible sign, and the invisible grace; between the exterior sacramental ablution, and the grace of the sacrament, that is, interior regeneration. We believe that whosoever hath the former, hath the latter also, so that he do not put a bar against the efficacy of the sacrament by his infidelity or hypocrisy, of which a child is not capable. And therefore our very Liturgy doth teach, that a child baptized, dying before the commission of actual sin, is undoubtedly saved.

Thirdly, we believe that without baptismal grace, that is, regeneration, no man can enter into the kingdom of GOD. But whether GOD hath so tied and bound himself to His ordinances and sacraments, that He doth not or cannot confer the grace of the sacraments, extraordinarily, where it seemeth good to His eyes, without the outward element: this is the question between us.

HAMMOND, PRESBYTER, CONFESSOR, AND DOCTOR.—Sermon XV.—A New Creature.

It is observable, that our state of nature and sin is, in Scripture, expressed ordinarily by old age, the natural sinful man; that is, all our natural affections that are born and grow up with us, are

called the old man; as if, since Adam's fall, we were decrepit and feeble, and aged as soon as born, as a child begotten by a man in a consumption never comes to the strength of a man, is always weak, and crazy, and puling, hath all the imperfections and corporal infirmities of age before he is out of his infancy. And, according to this ground, the whole analogy of Scripture runs; all that is opposite to the old decrepit state, to the dotage of nature, is new. The new covenant, Mark i. 27. The language of believers, new tongues, Mark xvi. 17. A new commandment, John xiii. 34. A new man, Eph. ii. 15. In sum, the state of grace is expressed by [*panta kaina*], all is become new, 2 Cor. v. 17. So that old and new, as it divides the Bible, the whole state of things, the world; so it doth that to which all these serve, man; every natural man, which hath nothing but nature in him, is an old man, be he never so young, is full of years, even before he is able to tell them. Adam was a perfect man when he was but a minute old, and all his children are old even in the cradle, nay, even dead with old age, Eph. ii. 5. And, then, consequently, every spiritual man, which hath somewhat else in him than he receiveth from Adam, he that is born from above, John iii. 3, [*gennēthēi anōthen*], (for it may be so rendered from the original, as well as born again, as our English read it), he that is by GOD'S SPIRIT quickened from the old death, Eph. ii. 5, he is, contrary to the former, a new man, a new creature; the old eagle hath cast his beak and is grown young; the man, when old, hath entered the second time into his mother's womb, and is born again; all the grey hairs and wrinkles fall off from him, as the scales from blind Tobit's eyes, and he comes forth a refined, glorious, beauteous new creature: you would wonder to see the change. So that you find, in general, that the Scripture presumes it, that there is a renovation, a casting away the old coat, a youth and spring again in many men, from the old age and weak bedrid state of nature. Now that you may conceive wherein it consists, how this new man is brought forth in us, by whom it is conceived, and in what womb it is carried, I will require no more of you, than to observe and understand with me, what is meant by the ordinary phrase in our divines, a new principle, or inward principle of life, and that you shall do briefly thus. A man's body is naturally a sluggish, inactive, motionless, heavy thing, not able to stir or move the least animal motion, without a soul to enliven it; without that, it is but a carcase, as you see at death, when the soul is separated from it, it returns to be but a stock or lump of flesh; the soul bestows all life and motion on it, and enables it to perform any work of nature. Again, the body and soul together, considered in relation to somewhat above their power and activity, are as impotent and as motionless as before the body without the soul. Set a man to remove a mountain, and he will heave, perhaps, to obey your command, but in event will do no more towards the displacing of it, than a stone in the street could do: but now, let an omnipotent power be annexed to this man, let a supernatural spirit be joined to this soul, and then will it be able to overcome the proudest, stoutest difficulty in nature. You have heard, in the Primitive Church, of a grain of faith removing mountains; and believe me, all miracles are not yet outdated. The work of regeneration, the bestowing of a spiritual life on one dead in trespasses and sins, the making of a carcase walk, the natural old man to spring again, and move spiritually, is as great a miracle as that . . .

For the third question, when this new principle enters: first you are to know, that it comes into the heart in a threefold condition; first, as an harbinger; secondly, as a private secret guest; thirdly, as an inhabitant or housekeeper. As it is an harbinger, so it comes to fit and prepare us for itself; trims up, and sweeps, and sweetens the soul, that it may be readier to entertain him when he comes to reside; and that he doth (as the ancient gladiators had their *arma prælusoria*,) by skirmishing with our corruptions, before he comes to give them a pitched battle; he brandishes a flaming sword about our ears, and as by a flash of lightning, gives us a sense of a dismal, hideous state; and so somewhat restrains us from excess and fury; first, by a momentary remorse, then by a more lasting,

yet not purifying flame, the spirit of bondage. In sum, every check of conscience, every sigh for sin, every fear of judgment, every desire of grace, every motion or inclination toward spiritual good, be it ever so short-winded, is *prælude spiritus*, a kind of John Baptist to CHRIST, something that GOD sent before “to prepare the ways of the LORD.” And thus the SPIRIT comes very often; in every affliction, every disease, (which is part of GOD’S discipline, to keep us in order,) in brief, at every sermon that works upon us at the hearing: then, I say, the lightning flashes in our eyes; we have a glimpse of His SPIRIT, but cannot come to a full sight of it: and thus He appears to many, whom He will never dwell with. Unhappy men, that cannot lay hold on Him, when He comes so near them! and yet somewhat more happy than they that never came within ken of Him; stop their ears when He spake to them even at this distance. Every man in the Christian Church hath frequently, in his life, a power to partake of GOD’S ordinary preparing graces: and it is some degree of obedience, though no work of regeneration, to make good use of them; and if he without the inhabitation of the SPIRIT, cannot make such use as he should, yet to make the best he can: and thus, I say, [i.e. in a *parallel* way] the SPIRIT appears to the unregenerate, almost every day of our lives. 2ndly, when this SPIRIT comes a guest to lodge with us, then He is said to enter; but till by actions and frequent obliging works, he makes himself known to his neighbours, as long as he keeps his chamber, till he declare himself to be there, as long he remains a private secret guest, and that is called the introduction of the form, that makes a man to be truly regenerate; when the seed is sown in his heart, when the habit is infused, and that is done sometimes discernibly, sometimes not discernibly, but seldom, as when Saul was called in the midst of his madness, Acts ix., he was certainly able to tell a man the very minute of his change, of his being made a new creature. Thus they which have long lived in an enormous Antichristian course, do many times find themselves stricken on a sudden, and are able to date their regeneration, and tell you punctually how old they are in the SPIRIT. Yet because there be many preparations to this SPIRIT, which are not this SPIRIT, many presumptions in our hearts false grounded, many tremblings and jealousies in those that have it, great affinity between faith natural and spiritual: seeing it is a SPIRIT that thus enters, and not as it did light on the Disciples, in a bodily shape, it is not an easy matter for any one to define the time of his conversion. Some may guess somewhat nearer than others, as remembering a sensible change in themselves; but, in a word, the surest discerning of it is in its working, not at its entering. I may know that now I have the SPIRIT, better than at what time I came to it. Undiscernibly GOD’S supernatural agency interposes sometimes in the mother’s womb, as in John Baptist springing in Elizabeth at Mary’s salutation, (Luke i. 41.) and perhaps in Jeremy, (Jer. i. 5.) “Before thou camest out of the womb, I sanctified thee;” and (in Isa. xlix. 5.) “The LORD that formed me from the womb to be his servant.” But this divine address attends most ordinarily till the time of our Baptism, when the SPIRIT, accompanying the outward sign, infuses itself into their hearts, and there seats and plants itself, and grows up with the reasonable soul, keeping even their most luxuriant years within bounds; and as they come to an use of their reason, to a more and more multiplying this habit of grace into holy spiritual acts of faith and obedience; from which it is ordinarily said, that infants baptized have habitual faith, as they may be also said to have habitual repentance, and habits of all other graces, because they have the root and seed of those beauteous, healthful flowers, which will actually flourish there when they come to years. And this, I say, is so frequent to be performed at Baptism, that ordinarily it is not wrought without that means, and in those means we may expect it, as our Church doth in our Liturgy, where she presumes, at every Baptism, that it hath pleased GOD to regenerate the infant by his HOLY SPIRIT. And this may prove a solemn piece of comfort to some, who suspect their state more than they need, and think it

impossible that they should be in a regenerate condition, because they have not as yet found any such notable change in themselves, as they see and observe in others. These men may as well be jealous they are not men, because they cannot remember when their soul came to them: if they can find the effects of spiritual life in themselves, let them call it what they will, a religious education, or a custom of well-doing, or an unacquaintedness with sin; let them comfort themselves in their estate, and be thankful to GOD who visited them thus betimes; let it never trouble them that they were not once as bad as other men, but rather acknowledge GOD'S mercy, who had prevented such a change, and by uniting them to Him in the cradle, hath educated and nursed them up in familiarity with the SPIRIT.

TAYLOR, BISHOP, CONFESSOR, AND DOCTOR.—Life of Christ,
sect. 9.—On Baptism, part ii. 16.

Thirdly, in baptism we are born again; and this infants need in the present circumstances, and for the same great reason that men of age and reason do. For our natural birth, is either of itself insufficient, or is made so by the fall of Adam, and the consequent evils, that nature alone, or our first birth, cannot bring us to heaven, which is a supernatural end, that is, an end above all the power of our nature as now it is. So that if nature cannot bring us to heaven, grace must, or we can never get thither; if the first birth cannot, a second must: but the second birth spoken of in Scripture is baptism; "a man must be born of water and the Spirit." And therefore baptism is [*loutron palingenesias*], "the laver of a new birth." Either then infants cannot go to heaven any way that we know of, or they must be baptized. To say they are left to GOD, is an excuse, and no answer; for when GOD hath opened the door, and calls that the "entrance into heaven," we do not leave them to GOD, when we will not carry them to him in the way which He hath described, and at the door which Himself hath opened: we leave them indeed, but it is but helpless and destitute: and though GOD is better than man, yet that is no warrant to us; what it will be to the children, that we cannot warrant or conjecture. And if it be objected, that to the new birth are required dispositions of our own, which are to be wrought by and in them that have the use of reason; besides that, this is wholly against the analogy of a new birth, in which the person to be born is wholly a passive, and hath put into him the principle that in time will produce its proper actions; it is certain that they that can receive the new birth, are capable of it. The effect of it is a possibility of being saved, and arriving to a supernatural felicity. If infants can receive this effect, then also the new birth, without which they cannot receive the effect. And if they can receive salvation, the effect of the new birth, what hinders them but they may receive that, that is in order to that effect, and ordained only for it, and which is nothing of itself, but in its institution and relation, and which may be received by the same capacity, in which one may be created, that is, a passivity, or a capacity obediencial?

Fourthly; concerning pardon of sins, which is one great effect of baptism, it is certain that infants have not that benefit, which men of sin and age may receive. He that hath a sickly stomach, drinks wine, and it not only refreshes his spirits, but cures his stomach: he that drinks wine, and hath not that disease, receives good by his wine, though it does not minister to so many needs; it refreshes, though it does not cure him: and when oil is poured upon a man's head, it does not always heal a wound, but sometimes makes him a cheerful countenance, sometimes it consigns him to be a king, or a priest. So it is in baptism: it does not heal the wounds of actual sins, because they have not committed them; but it takes off the evil of original sin: whatsoever is imputed to us by Adam's prevarication, is washed off by the death of the second Adam, into which we are baptized.

HEYLIN, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—On the Apostles' Creed,
Art. x. Chap. vi.

In which, (Article the 27th) lest any should object, as Dr. Harding did against Bishop Jewell, that we make baptism to be nothing but a sign of regeneration, and that we dare not say, as the Catholic Church teacheth, according to the Holy Scriptures, "That in and by baptism, sins are fully and truly remitted, and, put away," we will reply with the said most reverent and learned prelate, (a man who well understood the Church's meaning), That we confess, and have ever taught, that in the Sacrament of Baptism, by the death and blood of CHRIST, is given remission of all manner of sins; and that not in half, or in part, or by way of imagination and fancy, but full, whole, and perfect of all together; and that if any man affirm, that "Baptism giveth not full remission of sins," it is no part nor portion of our doctrine. To the same effect also saith judicious Hooker, "Baptism is a Sacrament," &c. [quoted above] . . . But because these were private men, neither of which, for aught appears, had any hand in the first setting out of the Book of Articles, (which was in the reign of King Edward the Sixth,) though Bishop Jewell had in the second edition, when they were reviewed and published in Queen Elizabeth's time; let us consult the Book of Homilies, made and set out by those who composed the Articles; and there we find, that by GOD'S mercy and the virtue of that sacrifice which our High Priest and SAVIOUR CHRIST JESUS, the SON of GOD, once offered for us upon the cross, we do obtain GOD'S grace, and remission, as well of our original sin in baptism, as of all actual sin committed by us after baptism, if we truly repent and turn unfeignedly unto Him again. Which doctrine of the Church of England, as it is consonant to the Word of GOD in Holy Scripture, so is it also most agreeable to the common and received judgment of pure antiquity. For in the Scripture it is said expressly by St. Peter, &c. &c. This also was the judgment of the ancient writers, and that too long before the starting of the Pelagian heresies, to which much is ascribed by some as to the advancing of the efficacy and fruit of baptism, by succeeding Fathers. For thus Tertullian; "Now (saith he) do the waters daily preserve the people of GOD, death being destroyed and overthrown by the washing away of sins; for where the guilt is taken away, there is the punishment remitted also." St. Cyprian thus; "That the remission of sins, whether given in baptism, or by any other of the sacraments, is properly to be ascribed to the HOLY GHOST." The African Fathers in full Council do affirm the same, and so doth Origen also for the Alexandrian, of both which we shall speak anon in the point of Pædobaptism. Thus Nyssen for the Eastern churches: "Baptism (saith he) is the expiation of our sins, the remission of our offences, the cause of our new birth and regeneration." Thus do the Fathers in the Constantinopolitan Council profess their faith in one baptism (or being only once baptized) "for the remission of sins." And finally, that this was the doctrine of the Church in general, before Augustine's time, who is conceived to be the first that did advance the power and efficacy of baptism to so great a height, in opposition to the Pelagian heresies, appears by a byword grown before his time into frequent use; the people being used to say, when they observed a man to be too much addicted to his lusts and pleasures, Let him alone to take his pleasure, "for as yet the man is not baptized." More of this we shall see anon in that which follows. Nor is this only *Primitive*, but good *Protestant* doctrine, as is most clear and evident by that of Zanchius, whom only I shall instance in, of the later writers. "When the minister baptizeth, I believe that CHRIST with His own hand reacheth as it were from heaven, besprinkleth the infant with His blood to the remission of sins, by the hand of that man whom I see besprinkling him with the waters of baptism." So that I cannot choose but marvel how it comes to pass, that it must now be reckoned for a point of Popery, that the "Sacraments are instrumental causes of our justification," or of the "remission of our sins," or that it is a point of learning, of which neither the Scriptures, nor the reformed religion, have taught us anything. So easy a thing it is to blast that with Popery, which any way doth contradict our own private fancies.

ALLESTRIE, PRESBYTER.—Serm. ii. p. 23.

In our Israel by our covenant there is as much of this required, for we were all initiated into our profession by washing, “regenerated in a laver,” and “born again of water,” becoming so *Tertullian’s sanctitatis designati*, set aside for holiness, consecrated to cleanness, and made the votaries of purity: how clean a thing then must a Christian be who must be washed into the name? nor is he thus washed only in the font, there was a more inestimable “fountain opened for sin and uncleanness.” (Apoc. xi. 5.) “JESUS CHRIST hath washed us in his own blood;” and Heb. ix. 14. “The blood of CHRIST did purge our consciences from dead works to serve the living GOD.” How great is our necessity of being clean, when to provide a means to make us so, GOD opens his SON’S side, and our laver is drawn out of the heart of CHRIST. Yet we have more effusions to contribute to it. (1 Cor. vi. 11.) “But ye are washed,” &c. and we must “be baptized with the HOLY GHOST and with fire.” A laver of flame also to wash away our scurfe as well as sallages, and beyond all these, some of us have been purged too with the fiery trial, and molten in the furnace of affliction, to separate our dross and purify us from alloy, that we may be clean and refined too, may become Christians of the highest *correct*.

BARROW, PRESBYTER AND DOCTOR.—Of the Holy Ghost.

Serm. xlv. vol. iii. p. 370.

The memorial therefore of that most gracious and glorious dispensation, [of the HOLY GHOST at Pentecost, &c.] the Christian Church wisely and piously hath continually preserved, obliging us at this time peculiarly to bless GOD for that incomparable and inestimable gift conferred then most visibly upon the Church, and still really bestowed upon every particular member duly incorporated thereinto.

I say bestowed upon every particular member of the Church, for the evangelical covenant doth extend to every Christian; and a principal ingredient thereof is the collation of this SPIRIT, which is the finger of GOD, whereby (according to the Prophet Jeremy’s description of that covenant) “GOD’S law is put into their inward parts, and written in their hearts!” inscribed (as St. Paul allusively speaketh) not with ink, but by the SPIRIT, &c. not only as the Jewish law, represented from without to the senses, but impressed within upon the mind and affections; whence GOD’S SPIRIT is called the SPIRIT of promise, the donation thereof being the peculiar promise of the Gospel; and the end of our SAVIOUR’S undertaking is by St. Paul declared, “that we might receive the promise of the SPIRIT by faith;” that is, by embracing Christianity, might partake thereof, according to GOD’S promise; and the apostolical ministry or exhibition of the Gospel is styled “the ministration of the Spirit,” and tasting “of the heavenly gift, and participation of the HOLY GHOST,” is part of a Christian’s character; and the inception of Christianity is described by St. Paul, “But we are bound to give thanks,” &c. (2 Thess. ii. 13); and our SAVIOUR instructed Nicodemus, that no man can enter into the kingdom of GOD (that is, become a Christian, or subject of GOD’S spiritual kingdom,) without being regenerated by water, and by the Spirit, that is, without baptism, and the spiritual grace attending it, according as St. Peter doth in the words adjoining to our text imply, that the reception of the HOLY SPIRIT is annexed to holy baptism: “Repent (saith he) and be baptized every one,” &c. ... “for the promise (that great promise of the HOLY GHOST) is unto you,” &c. ... that is, the HOLY SPIRIT is promised to all, how far soever distant in place and time, whoever shall be invited unto, and shall embrace the Christian profession. St. John also maketh it to be a distinctive mark of those, in whom CHRIST abideth, and who dwell in CHRIST, that is, of all true Christians, to have this SPIRIT; “Hereby [saith he] we know that he abideth in us by the SPIRIT,” &c. ... and St. Paul denieth him to be a good Christian who is destitute thereof. “Now

(saith he) if any man have not the SPIRIT," &c. ... "and know ye not, (saith he to the Corinthians) that ye are the temple," &c. ... that is, Do ye not understand this to be a common privilege of all Christians, such as ye profess yourselves to be? And the conversion of men to Christianity he thus expresseth, "After the kindness and love of GOD our SAVIOUR," &c. (Tit. iii. 4.) ... And all pious dispositions qualifying us for entrance into heaven and happiness (faith, charity, devotion, every grace, every virtue) are represented to be the fruits of the HOLY SPIRIT. And the union of all Christians into one body; the Catholic society of all truly faithful people, doth according to St. Paul, result from this one SPIRIT, as a common soul animating and actuating them: "For (saith he) by one SPIRIT are they all baptized," &c. ...

In fine, whatever some few persons, or some petty sects (as the Pelagians of old, the Socinians now) may have deemed, it hath been the doctrine constantly, and with very general consent delivered in the Catholic Church, that to all persons by the holy mystery of baptism duly initiated to Christianity, or admitted into the communion of CHRIST'S body, the grace of GOD'S HOLY SPIRIT, certainly is bestowed, enabling them to perform the conditions of piety and virtue then undertaken by them; enlightening their minds, rectifying their wills, purifying their affections, directing and assisting them in their practice; the which holy gift (if not abused, ill treated, driven away, or quenched by their ill behaviour) will perpetually be continued, improved, and increased to them; it is therefore by Tertullian (in his prescriptions against heretics,) reckoned as part of that fundamental rule which was grounded upon the general tradition and consent of the Christian Church, that "CHRIST hath sent the virtue of the HOLY GHOST, in his room, which doth act believers;" to which that article doth answer of the Apostolical Creed, in which we profess to believe the HOLY GHOST, meaning, I suppose, thereby, not only the bare existence of the HOLY GHOST, but also its gracious communication and energy.

THORNDIKE, PRESBYTER.—Book iii. chap. viii.

It is demanded in the second place, what is that regeneration by the HOLY GHOST, and wherein it consists, whereof infants that are baptized can be thought capable. For the wild conceits of those that imagine them to have faith in CHRIST (which without actual motion of the mind, is not), require miracles to be wrought of course, by baptizing, that the effect thereof may come to pass. And if the state of grace (which the habitual grace of GOD'S SPIRIT either supposed or inferreth) is not to be attained but by the resolution of embracing the covenant of grace, (as, by all the premises, it is not otherwise attended), it will be every whit as hard to say what is that habitual grace, that is said to be poured into the souls of infants that are baptized, being nothing else but a facility in doing what the Covenant of Grace requireth. But, if we conceive the regeneration of Infants that are baptized to consist in the habitual assistance of GOD'S SPIRIT, the effects whereof are to appear, in making them able to perform that which their Christianity requires at their hands, so soon as they shall understand themselves to be obliged by it; we give reason enough of the effect of their baptism, whether they die or live, and yet become not liable to any inconvenience. For supposing the assistance of GOD'S SPIRIT assigned them by the promise of baptism, to take effect when their bodily instruments enable the soul to act as Christianity requireth; if the soul, by death, come to be discharged of them, can any thing be said why original concupiscence, which is the law of the members, should remain any more, to impeach the subjection of all faculties to the law of GOD'S SPIRIT? Or will it be any thing strange, that when they come to be taught Christianity, the same SPIRIT of GOD should be taught to sway them, to embrace it of their own choice, and not only in compliance with the will of their parents? Yet is this no more, than the regeneration of infants by water and the HOLY GHOST importeth; that the SPIRIT of GOD should be habitually

present, to make those reasons which GOD hath given to convince the world, that they ought to be Christians, both discernible to the understanding, and weighing down the choice; whereas, those that are converted from being enemies to GOD, (that is to say, at those years, when no man can be converted to GOD, that is not His enemy before), though the SPIRIT of GOD knock at their hearts without, striving to cast out the strong man that is within doors, and to make a dwelling for itself in the heart, are possessed by a contrary principle, till they yield GOD'S SPIRIT that entertainment which GOD requireth.

PEARSON, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Exposition of the Creed.

Article ix.

Being therefore we are that the preaching remission of sins belongeth not only certainly, but in some sense peculiarly, to the Church of CHRIST, it will be next considerable how this remission is conferred upon any person in the Church.

It is certain that forgiveness of sins was promised to all who were baptized in the name of CHRIST; and it cannot be doubted but all persons who did perform all things necessary to the receiving the ordinance of baptism, did also receive the benefit of the ordinance, which is *remission of sins*. "John did baptize in the wilderness, and preach the baptism of repentance for the remission of sins." (Mark i. 4.) And St. Peter made this exhortation of his first sermon, "Repent, and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of JESUS CHRIST, for the remission of sins." (Acts ii. 38.) In vain doth doubting and fluctuating Socinus endeavour to evacuate the evidence of this Scripture; attributing the remission either to repentance without consideration of baptism, or else to the public profession of faith made in baptism; or if any thing must be attributed to baptism itself, it must be nothing but a declaration of such remission. For how will these shifts agree with that which Ananias said unto Paul, without any mention either of repentance or confession, "Arise and be baptized, and wash away thy sins:" (Acts xxii. 16.) and that which St. Paul, who was so baptized, hath taught us concerning the Church, that CHRIST doth "sanctify and cleanse it with the washing of water." (Eph. v. 26.) It is therefore sufficiently certain that baptism, as it was instituted by CHRIST after the pre-administration of St. John, wheresoever it was received with all qualifications necessary in the person accepting, and conferred with all things necessary to be performed by the person administering, was most infallibly efficacious, as to this particular, that is, to the remission of all sins committed before the administration of this sacrament.

BULL, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Sermon vii.

"And besides this," &c. (2 Pet. i. 5.) As if he had said, You have now, GOD be thanked, escaped the pollutions of the world, and are truly, I hope, converted to Christianity, and in baptism have been regenerated by the HOLY GHOST (that he means by their being *made partakers of the divine nature*). This indeed is a very great achievement, and an invaluable mercy of GOD, vouchsafed to you; yet I beseech you, rest not here: but *besides this, giving all diligence, add to your faith, virtue, &c.*

COMBER, PRESBYTER.—Part iii. sect. iii.

p. 201.

We must not presently turn our backs upon GOD so soon as the holy rite [baptism] is finished, but complete the solemnity by thanksgiving and prayer; and that we may do both, not only with the spirit, but with understanding, the minister doth here teach us what must be the subjects of our praises and petitions.

I. Our praises must look back upon the grace already showed, and the benefits which are already given to this infant, which are principally two 1. Internally it is regenerated; 2. Externally it is grafted into CHRIST'S Church, for which we must give hearty thanks to ALMIGHTY GOD.

To which we must add, II. Our prayers, which must look forward upon the grace which will be needful to enable it to live answerable to this estate into which it is admitted; and this we must beg of ALMIGHTY GOD also, or else the former blessings will be altogether in vain. Now all this is plain, that no more would need to be added, but only that some with Nicodemus are apt to say, "How can these things be?" (John iii. 9.) Judging it impossible that so great a matter as regeneration can be effected so soon, and by so mean an instrument as they account it; whereas the effect is to be ascribed to the divine power of the Author, not to the intrinsic efficacy of the outward means: yet in regard we can never bless GOD heartily for a mercy unless we believe He hath bestowed it, we must labour to remove these scruples by a fuller account of this baptismal regeneration, that we may not withhold the divine praises, by our doubting and unbelief. The word regeneration is but twice (that I know of) used in Scripture; first, Matt. xix. 28, "Ye that have followed me in the regeneration;" where though (by altering the point—"followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of Man," &c.) it may signify the resurrection yet as we read, it signifies the renewing of men by the Gospel and baptism. Secondly, (Tit. iii. 5.) "He saved us by the laver of regeneration, and renewing of the HOLY GHOST," which is a paraphrase upon that of our SAVIOUR, (John iii.) "Except a man be born of water," &c. And, because persons, come to age before their conversion, are first taught and persuaded by the Word of GOD, the language of Holy Writ enlarges the metaphor, and saith, Such as are begotten by the Word of GOD, (1 Cor. iv. 15.) and then born again or regenerated in baptism. In like manner speak the Fathers, who do constantly and unanimously affirm, that we are regenerated in, or by baptism. So that we must next inquire wherein this regeneration doth consist. And first, whereas both children and those of riper years are by nature dead in sin, so that they lie under the guilt and power thereof: our gracious FATHER doth here in baptism seal a covenant with us, wherein He promiseth to pardon us; and when this deadly load is removed, the soul receives as it were a new life, and takes new hopes and courage, being restored to the divine favour, and being set free from the sad expectations of unavoidable condemnation for former sin, original in infants, and both it and actual in those of riper years. Before this covenant we were dead in law, and by the pardon of our sins we are begotten again to a lively hope; and herein stands the first particular of our regeneration, viz. in the remission of sins, wherefore both Scripture and antiquity teach us, that baptism is the means for remission of sin, and hence they join pardon and regeneration commonly together, because this forgiveness puts us into a new estate, and an excellent condition in comparison of that which our natural birth had left us in.

Secondly; But further, by baptism we gain new relations, and old things being done away all things become new, &c. ... Thirdly; Our corrupt nature is changed in baptism, and there is a renovation effected thereby, both as to the mortification of the old affections, and the quickening of the new, by the HOLY SPIRIT, which is hereby given to all that put no bar or impediment unto it. This was the Ancients' doctrine, who affirmed a real change to be wrought, and believed the SPIRIT to be therein bestowed as GOD had promised, (Ezek. xxxvi. 25, 26.) "That he would sprinkle clean water," &c. ... And it is manifest that in the first ages of the Church there were abundant of gifts and graces miraculously bestowed upon Christians in their baptism, and no doubt if the catechumens of our days who are at age, would prepare themselves as strictly by repentance, fasting, and prayer, as they of old did, they should find incomparable effects of this sacred laver, if not in as miraculous measures, yet to as real purposes; that is, they should be truly regenerated, and their hearts changed by the influence of the Divine SPIRIT. But some may doubt whether infants be regenerate in this sense, because they are not capable of giving any evidences of their receiving the SPIRIT, nor doth

there any immediate effects of their regeneration appear; hence the Palagians denied it, but they are therefore condemned by the Milevitan Council, Can. ii. and confuted by St. Aug. ad Bon. lib. iii. It is confessed they can show no visible signs of spiritual life in the operations thereof, no more can they of their having a rational soul, for some time, and yet we know they have the power of reason within them; and since all infants are alike, either all do here receive a principle of new life, or none receive it; wherefore I see no reason why we may not believe as the ancients did, that GOD'S grace (which is dispensed according to the capacity of the suscipient) is here given to infants to heal their nature, and that He bestowed on them such measures of His SPIRIT as they can receive; for the malignant effects of the first Adam's sin are not larger than the free gift obtained by the second Adam's righteousness. (Rom. v. 15, 18.) And if it be asked how it comes to pass, then, that so many children do afterwards fall off to all impurity? I answer, so do too many grown persons also, and neither infants nor men are so regenerated in this life, as absolutely to extinguish the concupiscence: for the flesh still will lust against the Spirit: but thus GOD gives the SPIRIT also to lust against the flesh. (Gal. v.)

KEN, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Exposition of Church Catechism,

p. 136.

Glory be to thee, O most indulgent Love, who in our baptism dost give us the HOLY SPIRIT of Love, to be the principle of new life and of love in us, to infuse into our souls a supernatural, habitual grace, and ability to obey and love thee, for which all love, all glory be to thee.

Glory be to thee, O compassionate Love, who, when we were conceived and "born in sin," of sinful parents, when we sprang from a root wholly corrupt, and were all "children of wrath," hast in our baptism "made us children" of thy own heavenly FATHER by adoption and grace; when we were heirs of hell, hast made us heirs of heaven, even joint heirs with thy own self, of thy own glory; for which, with all the powers of my soul, I adore and love thee.

PATRICK, BISHOP.—On Baptism,

p. 441.

The sum of all is, that hereby we are regenerated and born again. It is the sacrament of the new birth, by which we are put into a new state, and change all our relations: so that whereas before we were only the children of Adam, we are now taken to be the children of GOD; such of whom He will have a fatherly care, and be indulgent and merciful unto. We have now a relation likewise to CHRIST as our Head, and to the HOLY GHOST as the giver of life and grace. Yea, herein He grants remission of sin, and we are sanctified, and set apart to His uses. We being hereby given to Him, and He accepting of us, do become His possession and proper goods, and cannot without being guilty of the foulest robbery, sin against GOD. We are made hereby the temples of the HOLY GHOST, the place where He, and nothing else is to inhabit; and being by this consecrated to Him, He likewise then enters upon His possession, and we are said thereby to receive the HOLY GHOST; so that if we run into sin, we defile His house, and commit the greatest profaneness and impiety, and may be said very truly to do despite to the SPIRIT of GOD whereby we were sanctified.

BEVERIDGE, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—On admission into the Church by Baptism.

Vol. i. Sermon. xxxv. p. 304.

But what he means by being "born of water and the SPIRIT," is now made a question: I say now, for it was never made so till of late years. For many ages together none doubted of it, but the whole Christian world took it for granted, that our SAVIOUR, by these words, meant only that except a man be baptized according to His institution, he cannot enter into the kingdom of GOD; this being the most plain and obvious sense of the words, forasmuch as there is no other way of

being born again of water, as well as of the SPIRIT but only in the Sacrament of Baptism.

To understand what He means by being born again, we must call to mind what He saith in another place, "My kingdom is not of this world;" (John xviii. 36.) though it is in this world, it is not of it; it is not a secular or earthly kingdom, but a kingdom purely spiritual and heavenly: "It is not meat and drink, but righteousness, and peace, and joy in the HOLY GHOST (Rom. xiv. 17.) And therefore when a man is born into this world, he is not thereby qualified for the kingdom of GOD, nor hath any right or title to it, no more than as if he had not been born at all; but before he enter into that, he must be born again, he must undergo another kind of birth than he had before: he was before born of the flesh, he must now be born of the SPIRIT; otherwise he cannot be capable of entering into such a kingdom as is altogether spiritual. Thus our LORD Himself explains his own meaning in my text, by adding immediately in the next words, "That which is born of the flesh, is flesh," &c. . . . As if He had said, He that is born, as all men are at first, only of the flesh, such a one is altogether carnal and sensual; and so can be affected with nothing but the sensible objects of this world. But he that is born of the SPIRIT of GOD, thereby becomes a spiritual creature, and so is capable of those spiritual things of which the kingdom of GOD consisteth, "even of righteousness, and peace, and joy in the HOLY GHOST." And he whose mind is changed, and turned from darkness to light, and from the power of Satan unto GOD, is truly said to be born again; because he is quickened with another kind of life than he had before; and to be born of the SPIRIT of GOD, because it is by it that this new and spiritual life is wrought in him. So that he is now born into another world, even into the kingdom of GOD, where he hath GOD himself, of whom he is born, for his Father, and the kingdom of GOD for his portion and inheritance. And therefore it is, that except a man be thus born of the SPIRIT, it is impossible he should enter into the kingdom of GOD, seeing he can enter into it no other way, than by being born of the SPIRIT.

But that we may thus be born of the SPIRIT, we must be born also of water, which our SAVIOUR here puts in the first place. Not as if there was any such virtue in water, whereby it could regenerate us, but because this is the rite or ordinance appointed by CHRIST, wherein to regenerate us by His HOLY SPIRIT; our regeneration is wholly the act of the SPIRIT of CHRIST. But there must be something done on our parts in order to it, and something that is instituted and ordained by CHRIST Himself, which in the Old Testament was circumcision; in the New, baptism, or washing with water; the easiest that could be invented, and the most proper to signify His cleansing and regenerating us by His HOLY SPIRIT. And seeing this is instituted by CHRIST Himself, as we cannot be born of water without the SPIRIT, neither can we, in an ordinary way, be born of the SPIRIT without water, used or applied in obedience and conformity to His institution. CHRIST hath joined them together, and it is not in our power to part them: he that would be born of the SPIRIT, must be born of water too . . .

As baptizing necessarily implies the use of water, so our being made thereby disciples of CHRIST, as necessarily implies our partaking of His SPIRIT: for all that are baptized, and so made the disciples of CHRIST, are thereby made the members of His body; and are therefore said to be baptized into CHRIST, (Rom. vi. 5. Gal. iii. 27.) But they who are in CHRIST, members of His body, must needs partake of the SPIRIT that is in Him their Head. Neither doth the SPIRIT of CHRIST only follow upon, but certainly accompanies the Sacrament of Baptism, when duly administered according to His institution. For as St. Paul saith, "By one SPIRIT we are all baptized into one body." (1 Cor. xii. 13.) So that in the very act of baptism, the SPIRIT unites us unto CHRIST, and makes us members of His body; and if of His body, then of His Church and kingdom, that being all His body. And therefore all who are rightly baptized with water, being at the same time baptized also

with the HOLY GHOST, and so born of water and the SPIRIT, they are, *ipso facto*, admitted into the kingdom of GOD, established upon earth, and if it be not their own fault, will as certainly attain to that which is in heaven.

Ibid. p. 306 —This I would desire all here present to take special notice of, that you may not be deceived by a sort of people risen up among us, who being led, as they pretend, by the light within them, are fallen into such horrid darkness, and damnable heresies, that they have quite laid aside the Sacrament of Baptism, and affirm, in flat contradiction to our SAVIOUR'S words, that they may be saved without it. I pray GOD to open their eyes, that they may not go blindfold into eternal damnation. And I advise you all, as you desire not to apostatize from the Christian religion, and as you tender your eternal salvation, take heed that you be never seduced by them, under any pretence whatsoever; but rather, if you be acquainted with any of them, do what you can to turn them from darkness to light, from the power of Satan unto GOD again; that they may obtain forgiveness of their sins, and inheritance among them who are sanctified by faith in Him, who saith, "Except a man be born of water," &c.

Not only a man, in contradiction to a child, or a woman, but as it is in the original, [*ean mē tis*], except any one, any human creature whatsoever, man, woman, or child, "except he be born of water," &c. ... So that our LORD is so far from excluding children from baptism, that He plainly includes them, speaking in such general terms, on purpose that we may know that no sort of people, old or young, can ever be saved without it. And so He doth too, where He commands, as was observed before, that "All nations should be made disciples by being baptized in the name of," &c. ... For, under all nations, children must needs be comprehended, which make a great, if not the greatest part of all nations. And although these general expressions be sufficient to demonstrate the necessity of Infant Baptism, yet foreseeing that ignorant and unlearned people would be apt to wrest the Scriptures to their own destruction, He elsewhere commands children particularly to be brought unto Him, saying, "Suffer the little children," &c. (Mark x. 14.) But if the kingdom of GOD consist of children, as well as other people, they must of necessity be baptized, or born of water and the SPIRIT; for otherwise, He Himself saith, "They cannot enter into the kingdom."

Hence it is, that we find the Apostles baptizing whole families, children, if any, as well as others: and the whole Catholic Church, in all places and ages ever since, hath constantly admitted the children of the believing parents into the Church, by baptizing them according to the institution and command of our SAVIOUR; none ever making any question of it, but all Christians, all the world over, taking it for granted that it ought to be done, till of late years.

SHARP, ARCHBISHOP.—Vol. v. Sermon v.

p. 71.

There is the same relation between CHRIST and Christians, that there is between the vine and the branches; the same necessity of communication of vital influences from the root to the branch in the one as in the other: which communication of influences is made by the HOLY SPIRIT of GOD, derived from CHRIST, and diffusing Himself into every particular member of the whole body of Christians. Hence it is Christians are so frequently called the Temples of the HOLY GHOST. "Know ye not," saith St. Paul, "that ye are," &c.; and, again, "Know ye not, that your bodies are the members," &c. which he explains presently after thus: "Know ye not that your bodies are the Temples," &c. And the same St. Paul, in the eighth to the Romans, lays the foundation of our relation to CHRIST, and our hopes of eternal life, in the very thing, viz. the SPIRIT of GOD his dwelling in us; as may be there seen more at large.

This, then, being the privilege of all Christians, that by their being consecrated to CHRIST, they

have a right to the continual presence of the HOLY GHOST in their souls; or, if you will, GOD hath so great a right and property in them, that He sends down His HOLY SPIRIT to take possession of them, in order to the securing and sealing them for His own in the other world; we may easily, from hence, gather what it is *to grieve the Holy Spirit*, (which is the thing we are now inquiring into,) viz. We then grieve Him, when being already Christians in profession, we either will not vouchsafe Him a lodging in our hearts, which He doth desire; and, in order to the obtaining it, makes frequent applications to our souls by His holy motions; or, when we have already given Him entertainment, we carry ourselves so unbecomingly towards Him, as to tempt Him to forsake us. We then grieve the HOLY SPIRIT, when, having taken upon ourselves the covenant of Baptism, and thereby consecrated and consigned ourselves to GOD, we either refuse to admit the SPIRIT to take possession of us, or having admitted Him, do not show that respect, nor observe that decency, nor express that kindness, that is due to so worthy a guest: but by our rude, and unmannerly, and ill-natured behaviour towards Him, put such affronts upon Him as highly provoke Him to quit his habitation.

SCOTT, PRESBYTER.—*Christian Life*, chap. ii. sect i.

p. 354.

Second sort of the HOLY GHOST'S operations, viz. that which He ordinarily doth, and always hath done, and will always continue to do; for upon the cessation of these His miraculous operations, the HOLY GHOST did not wholly withdraw Himself from mankind, but He still continues mediating with us under CHRIST, in order to the reconciling our wills and affections to GOD, and subduing that inveterate malice and enmity against Him, which our degenerate nature hath contracted. For it is by this blessed SPIRIT that CHRIST hath promised to be with us to the end of the world. (Matt. xxviii. 20.) And CHRIST Himself hath assured us, that upon His ascension into heaven He would "pray His Father, and He should give us another Comforter," meaning this HOLY GHOST, "that he might abide with us for ever;" (John xiv. 16.) and, accordingly, the HOLY GHOST is vitally united to the Church of CHRIST, even as souls are united to their bodies. For as there is one Body, the Church, so here is one SPIRIT, *i.e.* the HOLY GHOST, which animates that Body, (Eph. iv. 4.) and hence the unity of the Church is in the foregoing verse called the unity of the SPIRIT: because as the soul, by diffusing itself through all the parts of the body, unites them together, and keeps them from flying abroad, and dispersing into atoms; so the HOLY SPIRIT, by diffusing Himself throughout this mystical Body, joins and unites all its parts together, and makes it one separate and individual corporation. So that, when by Baptism we are once incorporated into this body, we are entitled to, and do at least, *de jure*, participate of the vital influences of the HOLY GHOST, who is the soul of it; and accordingly, as Baptism joins us to that body, of which this Divine SPIRIT is the soul; so it also conveys that Divine SPIRIT to us. So that, as in natural bodies, those ligaments which unite and tie the parts to one another, do also convey life and spirit to them all; so also in this mystical body, those federal rites of Baptism and the LORD'S Supper, which are, as it were, its nerves and arteries, that join and confederate its members to one another, are also the conveyance of that spiritual life from the HOLY GHOST, which moves and actuates them all. And hence the "washing of regeneration," and "the renewing of the HOLY GHOST," the "being born of water and of the HOLY GHOST," are put together as concurrent things; and in Acts ii. 38. Baptism is affirmed to be necessary to our receiving the HOLY GHOST; and if by Baptism we receive the HOLY GHOST, that is a right and title to His grace and influence, then must the HOLY GHOST be still supposed vitally united to the Church, whereof we are made members by our Baptism, and, like an omnipresent soul, to be diffused all through it, and to move and actuate every part of it by

His heavenly grace and influence.

JENKIN, PRESBYTER.—On Christian Religion, vol. ii.

p. 427.

Baptism is very agreeable to the nature of the Christian Religion, being a plain and easy rite, and having a natural significancy of that purity of heart, which it is the design of the Gospel to promote and establish in the world; and it is fitted to represent to us the cleansing of our souls by the Blood of CHRIST, and the grace of purity and holiness, which is conveyed in this sacrament, and the spirit of regeneration which is conferred by it. Tit. iii. 5.

SHERLOCK, BISHOP.—Vol. ii. Disc. vii.

You see the power of Baptism, and the blessings that are annexed to it, to which all are entitled who partake in the Baptism of CHRIST: for Himself He was neither born nor baptized but for our sakes; that the blessings of both might descend on us, who, through faith, are heirs together with Him of the promises of GOD.

By Baptism the gates of heaven are set open to us, and the way paved for our return to our native country. By Baptism we are declared to be such sons of GOD in whom He will delight, and whom He will appoint to be heirs of His kingdom. By Baptism we receive the promise of the SPIRIT, by which we cry, Abba, Father.

Are not these great privileges? And is not here room for mighty expectations? And yet how unsuitable to these claims do the circumstances of a Christian's life often appear? He is upon the road to heaven, you say, and the gates stand open to receive him; but how does he stumble and fall like other men, and sometimes lose his way, and wander long, bewildered in night and darkness? Or, if he keeps the road, how lazily does he travel, as if he were unwilling to come to his journey's end, and afraid to see the country which he is going to possess? The Christian only, of all men, pretends to supernatural power and strength, and an intimate acquaintance with the SPIRIT of GOD; and yet how hardly does he escape the pollutions of the world, and how often look back, with languishing eyes, upon the pleasures, riches, and honours of this life? And though he boasts of more than human strength, yet how does he sometimes sink below the character and dignity even of a man? Ye sons of GOD, for such ye are, how do ye die like the children of men, and how like is your end to theirs?

And what must we say of these things? Is the promise of GOD become of none effect? Is Baptism sunk into mere outward ceremony, and can no longer reach to the purifying the heart and mind? The fact must not be disputed; it is too evident, at least in these our days, that the lives of Christians do not answer to the manifold gifts and graces bestowed on them.

WALL, PRESBYTER.—On infant Baptism, part ii. chap. vi.

I believe Calvin was the first that ever denied this place (John iii. 5.) to mean Baptism. He gives another interpretation, which he confesses to be new. This man did, indeed, write many things in defence of Infant Baptism. But he has done ten times more prejudice to that cause, by withdrawing (as far as in him lay) the strength of this text of Scripture (which the ancient Christians used as a chief ground of it) by that forced interpretation of his, than he has done good to it by all his new hypotheses and arguments. What place of Scripture is more fit to produce, for the satisfaction of some plain and ordinary man, (who, perhaps, is not capable of apprehending the force of the consequences by which it is proved from other places,) that he ought to have his child baptized, than this, (especially if it were translated in *English*, as it should be,) where our SAVIOUR says, that no *person* shall come to heaven without it? meaning, at least in GOD'S *ordinary* way.

POTTER, ARCHBISHOP.—of Church Government, chap. i.

p. 14.

Whoever wilfully neglects to be made a member of the Christian Church, does, by necessary consequence, deprive himself of all the privileges which belong to it; just as in any civil corporation they who are not members of it can plead no right to any of its privileges. This has already been shown to be the sense of CHRIST, and the same is constantly affirmed by the Christian writers of all ages. "They who do not come into the Church [saith Irenæus] do not partake of the SPIRIT, but deprive themselves of life." For where the Church is, there is the SPIRIT of GOD. And in St. Cyprian's opinion, he cannot have GOD for his Father who has not the Church for his Mother.

Hence the privileges of the Christian Church, such as Remission of Sins, the Grace of the HOLY SPIRIT, and Eternal Life, are commonly said to be annexed to Baptism, this being the constant rite of initiation into the Church. Thus, in Ananias's exhortation to St. Paul, "Arise, and be baptized," &c. . . . St. Barnabas expressly affirms, that "Baptism procures remission of sins;" and proves, from the Scriptures, that they who are baptized, are received into GOD'S favour, whereas all the rest of mankind lie under His displeasure. Peter thus exhorts his new converts "Repent, and be baptized every one of you," &c. . . . Our blessed SAVIOUR joins Faith and Baptism together, as necessary conditions of salvation: "Except a man be born of water and of the SPIRIT," &c. . . . And in another place, "He that believes, and is baptized, shall be saved." From these, and like passages of Scripture, the Primitive Church constantly inferred, that where the Gospel had been sufficiently propounded, no man could be saved, without Baptism actually obtained, or earnestly desired. Whence Tertullian calls it the "happy sacrament of water, whereby we are washed from the sins of our former blindness, and delivered into eternal life." And Cyprian gives this reason, why the Baptism of infants should not be delayed so long as the eighth day after their birth, that (since it is said in the Gospel, that "the Son of Man came not to destroy men's souls, but to save them") it is our duty, as far as in us lies, to take care that no soul shall be destroyed.

NELSON, CONFESSOR.—Festivals and Fasts,

p. 115.

By this means [by Baptism] the children of believers are entered into covenant with GOD under the Gospel, as they were under the Law by circumcision; and that infants are capable of this federal relation, is plainly declared by Moses; (Deut. xxix. 11.) and since they are the offspring of Adam, and consequently obnoxious to death by his fall, how can they be made partakers of that redemption which CHRIST hath purchased for the children of GOD, if they do not enjoy the advantage of that method which is alone appointed by CHRIST for them to become members of GOD'S kingdom? For JESUS himself has assured us, "Except one be born of water," &c. . . . And therefore it was the constant custom of the Primitive Church to administer Baptism to infants for the remission of sins. And this practice was esteemed, by the best tradition, to be derived from the Apostles themselves.

WATERLAND, PRESBYTER.—On Regeneration. 2.

The second is the case of infants. Their innocence and incapacity are to them instead of repentance, which they do not need, and of actual faith, which they cannot have. They are capable of being savingly born of water and the SPIRIT, and of being adopted into sonship with what depends thereupon; because, though they bring no virtues with them, no positive righteousness, yet they bring no obstacle, no impediment. They stipulate, they enter into contract, by their sureties, upon a presumptive and interpretative consent: they become consecrated in solemn form to FATHER, SON, and HOLY GHOST; pardon, mercy, and other covenant privileges are made over to them; and the HOLY SPIRIT translates them out of their state of nature (to which a curse

belongs) to a state of grace, favour, and blessing; this is their regeneration.

KETTLEWELL, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—On the Creed— Article, Forgiveness of Sins,

p. 685.

Ques.—For whose sake doth ALMIGHTY GOD allow us all this benefit of forgiveness?

Ans.—For JESUS CHRIST, who, as you have seen, died for our sins, and gave His blood a ransom, to purchase for us this pardon of them. “He is set forth a propitiation,” &c, (Rom. iii. 25.) And thus we shall receive all this mercy for His sake, when, with the disposition before expressed, we devoutly pray to GOD for it in His name.

Ques.—By the promises of the Gospel, I see that this forgiveness is assured to all Christians upon the terms which you have described. But is it in any signs and tokens outwardly dispensed to them?

Ans.—Yes; both in the Holy Sacraments and in the sacerdotal Absolution. Which ways of ministering this forgiveness, as well as the forgiveness itself, are noted in some ancient Creeds: this article being thus professed in St. Cyprian’s Form at Baptism: “I believe the Remission of Sins by the Church.”

Ques.—Is this forgiveness dispensed to us in the Sacrament of Baptism?

Ans.—Yes; and that most amply, the water of Baptism washing off the stain of all former sins. “Be baptized, and wash away thy sins,” said Ananias to Saul; “Repent, and be baptized for the Remission of Sins,” said St. Peter to the Jews; and “He hath saved us by the Laver of Regeneration;” *i.e.* the Water of Baptism, and the renewing of the HOLY GHOST. (Tit. iii. 5.) So that whatever pollutions men had upon them, if they come to Baptism with true faith and repentance, they are thereby made clean again.

HICKES, BISHOP AND CONFESSOR.—Christian Priesthood.

It belonged to the Apostles and Presbyters, by virtue of their sacerdotal office and ministry, to be advocates and intercessors with GOD ... I need not insist upon their power of baptizing for the remission of sins with fasting and prayer, which was a most solemn act of expiation for washing away all the past sins of the baptized.

JOHNSON, PRESBYTER.—Unbloody Sacrifice.—Vol. i. ch. ii.

sect. 1. p. 165.

I think the only immediate effect of the SPIRIT in Baptism, is the remission of all sin, and removing our natural disability to the worship and service of GOD, and the sentence of condemnation under which we were all born: (Rom. v. 16.) and that other graces are wrought in us by that HOLY SPIRIT, which by Baptism receives us under its protection, gradually, and according to the capacity of the recipient: and this doctrine I learned from those words of St. Barnabas, in his Epistle, cap. vi.: “After, therefore, that CHRIST had renewed us by the remission of our sins, he made us [in] another shape, so as to have an infant-like soul, even as he himself reformed us:” where he plainly makes renovation to consist in forgiving sins; and makes the new moulding, or reformation of our minds, to be not performed at the same time with the other, or all at once, but to be consequent upon the former renovation: and CHRIST is always thus reforming us, from our Baptism to our death. And I look on these words of St. Barnabas to be a better explication of the renovation, or regeneration of Christians by Baptism, than whole volumes of modern writers upon the same subject. And I may here very reasonably observe, that as the HOLY SPIRIT is present in our Baptism, to seal the remission of sins, and to infuse the beginnings of Christian Life; for He is present in confirmation, to shed further influences on them that receive it, for the further suscitation of the gift of GOD

bestowed in Baptism and in the Eucharist, as will hereafter appear at large for our further progress and increase in grace.

LESLIE, PRESBYTER AND CONFESSOR.—On Water Baptism, § 5.

The end of CHRIST'S Baptism was, to instate us into all the inconceivable glories, and high eternal prerogatives which belong to the members of His body, of His flesh, and of His bones, (Eph. v. 30.) that we might receive the adoption of sons. (Gal. iv. 5.) Henceforth no more servants, but sons of GOD, and heirs of heaven! These are ends so far transcendent above the ends of all former Baptisms, that, in comparison, other Baptisms are not only less, but none at all; like the glory of the stars in presence of the sun, they not only are a lesser light, but when he appears they become altogether invisible.

And as a pledge or foretaste of these future and boundless joys, the gift of the HOLY GHOST is given upon earth, and is promised as an effect of the Baptism of CHRIST: as Peter preached (Acts ii. 38), "Repent, and be baptized," &c. And (Gal. iii. 27.) "As many of you as have been baptized into CHRIST, have put on CHRIST."

This of the gift of the HOLY GHOST was not added to any Baptism before CHRIST'S, and does remarkably distinguish it from all others.

WILSON, BISHOP, CONFESSOR, AND DOCTOR.—Maxims of Piety, Vol. i.

p. 310.

The HOLY SPIRIT at Baptism takes possession of us, and keeps possession, till men grieve Him; then He forsakes us, and an evil spirit succeeds.

By Baptism we contract and oblige ourselves, all our life long, to complete and perfect the image of JESUS CHRIST in ourselves. The blessings and excellencies of Baptism:—It separates us from Adam, and engrafts us into CHRIST.—It is a resurrection from sin to grace.—It discharges us from the debt owing to the justice of GOD, by our sins, now fully satisfied by faith in the suffering and death of CHRIST.—It cancels the law of death and malediction which was against us.—In Baptism our sins did indeed die, and were buried; but the seed and root remain in us. These we are to mortify all our lives long.

BINGHAM, PRESBYTER.—On Lay Baptism, part ii. ch. vi.

... What it [indelible character] was taken to signify in Baptism? For an indelible character was always supposed to be imprinted as much in Baptism as in ordination; though I do not remember that any ancient Council expressly used that term about either, but only say something that may be reckoned equivalent to it; and that is this, as it relates to baptism: that a man, who is once truly baptized, can never do any thing that can so far erase or cancel his Baptism, as that he shall need, upon any occasion, to be re-baptized with a second Baptism. Thus far the ancients believed an indelible character in Baptism. Though a man turns his back on Christianity, and totally apostatize and fall away from the profession of it; though he turn heretic or schismatic; though he excommunicate himself, or be excommunicated by the Church; though he embrace Paganism or Judaism, or any other opposite Religion; though he curse and blaspheme CHRIST in a synagogue or in a temple, as many of the old apostates did; though he become a *Julian* or an *Ecebolius*, and "trample under foot the SON of GOD, and count the Blood of the Covenant an unholy thing, and do despite to the Spirit of Grace;" yet, after all, if this man turn again to Christianity, he was not to be received by a second Baptism. His repentance, and the Church's absolution, was sufficient in that case to re-instate him in his ancient profession, and he was not to be re-baptized to be made again a Christian. The Church had but one Baptism for the remission of sins, and the virtue of that was so far indelible, that it would always qualify the man that had received it,

to be admitted to communion again after the greatest apostasy, only by a true repentance and reconciliatory imposition of hands, without re-baptizing. This was what the ancients understood by what we now call the indelible character of Baptism. But they were far from thinking, that a man who was such an apostate had any right or authority, whilst he was an apostate, to challenge any of the common privileges of a Christian. They did not think, whilst he was a Pagan or a Jew, that he was properly a member of the Christian Church still, because of his Baptism; or that he had any right to be called Christian, or to be admitted to the prayers of the Church, and much less to the communion with other faithful laymen: and yet, after all, there was so much of a Christian in him, by virtue of his Baptism, that he needed not to be baptized again as a mere *Jew* or *Pagan*. His Baptism was such as nothing could obliterate; it would remain with him when he was an apostate, and either go to hell with him to his condemnation, or bring him back to heaven and the Church by way of repentance, not re-baptization. Now, if any one should ask whether such an apostate, while he continued an apostate, was a Christian? the answer must be in the negative; but yet there is something of a Christian in this apostate, that is, his Baptism; in respect of which he is not so perfectly a no-Christian, as one that never was baptized.

SKELTON, PRESBYTER.—Vol. ii. Disc. xxi.

Our blessed SAVIOUR and MEDIATOR, who hath procured the benefit of this covenant for us by the “sacrifice of His Blood,” hath appointed the Sacrament of Baptism as the means whereby the contracting parties, GOD and the new Christian, solemnly plight their promises to each other; and hath likewise made the other Sacrament, that of His Last Supper, the seal which renews and confirms the covenant with every penitent transgressor. In both He communicates the assistance of the HOLY SPIRIT, which “helps our infirmities,” and enables us, if we are not shamefully wanting to ourselves, to observe and perform the conditions promised on our part.

We have already seen, in general, what we are to expect as the fruits of peace with GOD; namely, eternal life, eternal happiness and glory. Our present assurance of this is represented in various lights by the Scriptures. We are made one with CHRIST, as He is one with the FATHER. We are united into one Church, or Spiritual Body, whereof “He is the head.” All together “we are the body of CHRIST, and members in particular.” Thus joined to Him, who is by nature the SON of GOD, we also become, by a “new birth in Baptism,” the adopted sons or children of GOD. “We I have received the Spirit of adoption, whereby we cry, Abba, Father:” and being taken into the family of GOD, are made His children by “faith in JESUS CHRIST.” The provision made for us is suitable to the grandeur of our new relation; no less than an eternal kingdom, “which it is the FATHER’S good pleasure to give us,” as His beloved children, and consequently, “heirs of GOD, and joint heirs with CHRIST: insomuch much that being one with Him, “where He is, there shall we be also,” partakers both of His nature, and of His inheritance in happiness and glory. We need not say, since these are the promises of GOD, that they cannot possibly fail of performance, provided we do our utmost to fulfil the promises made on our part.

HORNE, BISHOP AND DOCTOR.—Vol. ii. Disc. xviii.

The first portion of sanctifying grace is given at Baptism, which is the seal of justification, and the beginning of sanctification; inasmuch as the sinner being thus sacramentally buried with CHRIST into His death, arises with Him in the power of His resurrection, justified from the guilt of sin through repentance and faith in His blood, and renewed unto holiness by the operation of His SPIRIT. This total renewal, at first conferred by the baptismal laver, is styled *regeneration*, and answers in things natural to the birth of an infant. But then, as an infant, though born complete in all its parts, yet comes to its full stature and strength by slow and imperceptible degrees; by being

supplied with proper kinds of food for its nourishment when in health, and proper medicines for its recovery when otherwise; so is it with the regenerate spirit of a Christian: while it is (as St. Peter calls it) a babe in CHRIST, it must be fed with the milk of the word; when it is more grown in grace, with the strong meat of its salutary doctrines; when it is infirm, it must be strengthened by the comforts of its promises; and when sick, or wounded by sin, it must be recovered and restored by godly counsel and wholesome discipline, by penance and absolution, by the medicines of the word and sacraments as duly and properly administered in the Church, by the lawfully and regularly appointed delegates and representatives of the Physician of souls. This gradual and complex work of our sanctification is carried on, through our lives, by the SPIRIT of GOD, given, in due degree and proportion, to every individual for that purpose. And it is marvellous to behold, as the excellent Bishop Andrews observes, how, from the laver of regeneration, to the administration of the *viaticum*, this good SPIRIT helpeth us, and poureth His benefits upon us, having a grace for every season. When we are troubled with erroneous opinions, He is the SPIRIT of truth; when assaulted with temptations, He is the SPIRIT of holiness; when dissipated with worldly vanity, He is the SPIRIT of compunction; when broken with worldly sorrow, He is the HOLY GHOST the Comforter. It is He who, after having regenerated us in our baptism, confirms us by the imposition of hands; renews us to repentance, when we fall away; teaches us, all our life long, what we know not; puts us in mind of what we forget; stirs us up when we are dull; helps us in our prayers; relieves us in our infirmities; consoles us in our heaviness; gives us songs of joy in the darkest night of sorrow; seals us to the day of our redemption; and raises us up again in the last day; when that which was sown in grace shall be reaped in glory, and the work of sanctification, in spirit, soul, and body, shall be completed.

JONES, PRESBYTER.—On the figurative language of the Holy Scriptures. Lect. vi.

p. 156.

As the Ark was prepared by Noah, so hath CHRIST prepared His Church, to conduct us in safety through the waves of trouble and the perils of the world, in which so many are lost. And as the waters of the flood carried Noah and his family into a new world after the old was drowned; so do the waters of baptism carry us into a new state with JESUS CHRIST, who passed over the waves of death, and is risen from the dead. And this practical inference is to be made in favour of the ordinance of the Church, that as the ark could not be saved but by water, so must all the Church of CHRIST be baptized.

Ibid. p. 167.—We know that Satan has not that sovereignty over baptized Christians as he hath over men in the state of nature. After baptism a Christian is no longer the subject of that tyrant, but the child of GOD, who undertakes thenceforth to conduct him through all the trials and dangers of this life to the inheritance promised to the fathers.

HEBER, BISHOP.—Sermons in England, xviii.

It (justification) is the same with that regeneration of which baptism is the outward symbol, and which marks out, wherever it occurs, (that it ordinarily occurs in baptism, I am for my own part firmly persuaded,) our admission into the number of the children of GOD, and the heirs of everlasting happiness. It is the commencement of that state of salvation, in which, if a man continues, death has no power over him, in as much as the grave, which our nature so greatly fears, is to him no extinction of life, but a passage to a life more blessed and more glorious.

JEBB, BISHOP.—Pastoral Instructions. Disc. vi.

p. 112.

But how, may it be asked, are the benefits and blessings of spiritual regeneration conferred

upon infants in their tender years? To this inquiry we need not be careful to reply: we need only state, that in this, as in various other instances, it hath pleased ALMIGHTY GOD to set limits to the presumptuousness of human curiosity; and thus, at once to try our humility and our faith. It is enough for us, rest assured, that GOD is now, and ever, the same all-good and gracious Parent; that, as in times past, it was “out of the mouths of babes and sucklings he perfected praise:” and as “He revealed unto babes those things which were hidden from the wise and prudent,” so He is, at all times, abundantly able to pour forth the dew of His blessing upon infants who are faithfully brought to the baptism of his SON. It is enough for us to believe and cherish the prevalent sentiment of the universal Church, as it has been maintained from the age of the Apostles, that at the time of baptism, a new nature is divinely communicated, and gracious privileges are especially vouchsafed, in such measure and degree that, whosoever are clothed with this white garment, may, through GOD’S help, “keep their baptism pure and undefiled, for the remainder of their lives, never wilfully committing any deadly sin.”

VAN MILDERT, BISHOP.—Bampton Lectures, vi.

Regeneration is represented, by a certain class of interpreters, as an instantaneous, perceptible, and irresistible operation of the HOLY SPIRIT upon the heart and mind; which, whether the person have been baptized or not, affords the only certain evidence of his conversion to a saving and justifying faith. By others, it is regarded as a continued and progressive work of the SPIRIT, or as a state commencing in baptism, but not completed until, by perseverance to the end, the individual has “finished his course, and is about to enter upon his final reward.” Others again, separating what the Scriptures state to be joined together in the work of the new birth, maintain a distinction between baptismal and spiritual regeneration; the former taking place in the Sacrament of Baptism; the latter subsequent to it, and, whether progressive or instantaneous in its operation, equally necessary with baptism to a state of salvation.

But here the analogy of faith seems to be violated throughout. For how can any of these views of regeneration consist with the plain and simple notion of it as an entrance upon a new state, or a sacramental initiation into the Christian covenant? Nay, how can they consist with the terms and conditions of the covenant itself? If the Gospel be a covenant, admission into which, on the terms of faith and repentance, gives an immediate title to its present privileges, with an assurance of the spiritual helps necessary for the attainment of salvation; and if baptism be the divinely-appointed means of admission into that covenant, and of a participation in those privileges, is not the person so admitted actually brought into a new state? Has he not obtained that thing which by nature he cannot have? “And being thus regenerated and born anew of water and of the HOLY GHOST,” to what subsequent part of his Christian life can a term so peculiarly expressive of his first entrance upon it be with propriety applied?

MANT, BISHOP.—Bampton Lectures, vi.

Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the SPIRIT, &c. . . . It should appear, I say, that he was here alluding by anticipation to the Sacrament of Baptism, which he intended to ordain: and to that supernatural grace which was thereby to be conferred through the instrumentality of water, and by the HOLY GHOST; adopting, not only the ceremony itself, which he meant to exalt to more noble and spiritual purposes; but also the very term, by which the Jews had described the change wrought in the baptized, although he undoubtedly employed it, in a similar sense indeed, but in an infinitely more dignified sense. To the proselyte from heathenism to the Jewish faith, baptism had been a death to his natural incapacities, and a new birth to the civil privileges of a Jew: to him, who should be admitted to a profession of the Christian faith, and who

should be “born not of blood, nor of the will of the flesh,” &c. . . . it was to be a death unto sin, and a new birth unto those spiritual privileges, which should accompany his deliverance “from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of GOD.” The Jewish proselyte had been baptized with water: the Christian was to be baptized, not with water only, but with the HOLY GHOST.

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On Purgatory (Against Romanism.—No. 3.)

Tract No. 79

THE extract from Archbishop Ussher's Answer to a Jesuit, contained in Tract 72, on the subject of the ancient Commemorations for the Dead in CHRIST, may fitly be succeeded by an inquiry as to what degree and sort of proof remains for the Roman tenet of Purgatory, after deducting from the evidence those usages or statements of the early Church, which are commonly supposed, but, as Ussher shows, improperly, to countenance it. Ussher's explanations have had the effect, it is presumed, of cutting away the *primâ facie* evidence, on which the doctrine is usually rested; and it now remains to see what is left when it is withdrawn. With this view it is proposed in the following pages to draw out in detail the evidence alleged by the Romanists in behalf of their belief, with such remarks as may be necessary, in order to form a fair estimate of it. A plain statement of the doctrine itself, and of its rise, shall be also attempted, as not unseasonable at a time when the strength of Romanism rests in no small degree in its opponents mistaking the points in debate, and making or refuting propositions which but indirectly or partially bear upon the errors which they desire to combat.

Before commencing, it is necessary to warn the reader against estimating the magnitude or quality of any of those errors by its apparent dimensions in the theory. What seems to be a small deviation from correctness in the abstract system, becomes considerable and serious when it assumes a substantive form. This is especially the case with all doctrinal discussions, in which the undeveloped germs of many diversities of practice and moral character lie thick together and in small compass, and as if promiscuously and without essential differences. The highest truths differ from the most miserable delusions by what appears to be a few words or letters. The discriminating mark of orthodoxy, the Homœo~~u~~sion, has before now been ridiculed, however irrationally, as being identical, all but the letter *i*, with the heretical symbol of the Homoio~~u~~sion. What is acknowledged in the Arian controversy, must be endured without surprise in the Roman, in whatever degree it occurs. We may be taunted as differing from the Romanists only in phrases and modes of expression; and we may be taunted, or despised, according to the fate of our Divines for three centuries past, as taking a middle, timid, unsatisfactory ground, neither quite agreeing nor quite disagreeing with our opponents. We may be charged with dwelling on trifles and niceties, in a way inconsistent with plain, manly good sense; but in truth it is not we who are the speculatists, and unpractical controversialists, but they who forget that *hæc nugæ seria ducunt in mala*.

But again there is another reason, peculiar to the Roman controversy, which occasions a want of correspondence between the appearance presented by the Roman theology in theory, and its appearance in practice. The separate doctrines of Romanism are very different, in position, importance, and mutual relation, in the abstract, and when developed, applied, and practised. Anatomists tell us that the skeletons of the most various animals are formed on the same type; yet the animals are dissimilar and distinct, in consequence of the respective differences of their developed proportions. No one would confuse between a lion and a bear; yet many of us at first sight would be unable to discriminate between their respective skeletons. Romanism in the theory may differ little from our own creed; nay, in the abstract type, it might even be identical, and yet in the actual framework, and still further in the living and breathing form, it might differ essentially. For instance, the doctrine of Indulgences is in the theory entirely connected with the doctrine of Penance; that is, it has relation solely to *this world*, so much so that Roman apologists sometimes speak of it without even an allusion to its bearings elsewhere: but we know that in practice it is mainly, if not altogether, concerned with the next world,—with the alleviation of sufferings in

Purgatory.

And further still, as regards the doctrine of Purgatorial suffering, there have been for many ages in the Roman Church gross corruptions of its own doctrine, untenable as that doctrine is even by itself. The decree of the Council of Trent, which will presently be introduced, acknowledges the fact. Now we believe that those corruptions still continue; that Rome has never really set herself in earnest to eradicate them. The pictures of Purgatory so commonly seen in countries in communion with Rome, the existence of Purgatorian societies, the means of subsistence accruing to the clergy from belief in it, afford a strange contrast to the simple wording and apparent innocence of the decree by which it is made an article of faith. It is the contrast between a drug in its lifeless seed, and the same developed, thriving, and rankly luxuriant in the actual plant.

And lastly, since we are in no danger of becoming Romanists, and may bear to be dispassionate, and (I may say) philosophical in our treatment of their errors, some passages in the following account of Purgatory are more calmly written than would satisfy those who were engaged with a victorious enemy at their doors. Yet, whoever be our opponent, Papist or Latitudinarian, it does not seem to be wrong to be as candid and conceding as justice and charity allow us. Nor is it unprofitable to weigh accurately how much the Romanists have committed themselves in their formal determinations of doctrine, and how far, by GOD'S merciful providence, they had been restrained and overruled; and again how far they must retract, in order to make amends to Catholic truth and unity.

§ 1. Statement of the Roman Doctrine concerning Purgatory

§ 2. Proof of the Roman Doctrine concerning Purgatory

§ 3. History of the Rise of the Doctrine of Purgatory, and Opinions in the Early Church concerning it

§ 4. The Council of Florence

§ 1. Statement of the Roman Doctrine concerning Purgatory

THE Roman doctrine is thus expressed in the Creed of Pope Pius IV.

Constanter teneo Purgatorium esse, animasque ibi detentas fidelium suffragiis juvari.

"I hold without wavering that there is a Purgatory, and that souls there detained are aided by the suffrages of the faithful."

The words of this article are taken from the decree of the Council of Trent on the subject, (Sess. 25,) which runs as follows:

"Whereas the Church Catholic, fully instructed by the HOLY GHOST, hath from the sacred Scriptures and ancient tradition of the Fathers, in sacred Councils, and last of all in this present Ecumenical Synod, taught that there is Purgatory, and that souls there detained are aided by the suffrages of the living, and above all by the acceptable sacrifice of the altar, this holy Synod enjoins on Bishops, to make diligent efforts that the sound doctrine concerning Purgatory, handed down from the holy Fathers and sacred Councils, be believed, maintained, taught, and everywhere proclaimed by the disciples of CHRIST. At the same time, as regards the uneducated multitude, let the more difficult and subtle questions, such as tend not to edification nor commonly increase piety, be excluded from popular discourses. Moreover, let them disallow the publication and discussion of whatever is uncertain or suspicious; and prohibit whatever is of a curious or superstitious nature, or savours of filthy lucre, as the scandals and stumbling-blocks of believers. And let them provide, that the suffrages of believers living, that is, the sacrifices of masses, prayers, alms, and other

works of piety, which believers living are wont to perform for other believers dead, be performed according to the rules of the Church, piously and religiously; and whatever are due for them from the endowments of testators, or in other way, be fulfilled, not in a perfunctory way, but diligently and accurately by the Priests and Ministers of the Church, and others who are bound to do this service."

Such is the Roman doctrine; and taken in the mere letter there is little in it against which we shall be able to sustain formal objections. Purgatory is not spoken of at all as a place of pain; it need only mean, what its name implies, a place of purification. There is indeed much presumption in asserting definitively that there is such a place; and assuredly there is not only presumption, but very great daring and uncharitableness in including belief in it, as Pope Pius' Creed goes on to do, among the conditions of salvation; but if we could consider it as confined to the mere opinion that that good which is begun on earth is perfected in the next world, the tenet would be tolerable. The word "*detentas*" indeed expresses a somewhat stronger idea; yet after all hardly more than that the souls in Purgatory would be happier out of it than in it, and that they cannot of their own will leave it; which is not much to grant. Further, that the prayers of the living benefit the dead in CHRIST, is, to say the least, not inconsistent, as Ussher shows us, with the primitive belief. So much as to the *letter* of the decree; but it is not safe to go by the letter: on the contrary, we are bound to take the universal and uniform doctrine taught and received *in* the Roman Communion, as the real and true interpreter of words which are in themselves comparatively innocent. What that doctrine is, may be gathered from the words of the Catechism of Trent, in which the spirit of Romanism, not being bound by the rules which shackle it in the Council, speaks out. The account of Purgatory which that formulary supplies, shall here be taken as our text, and Cardinal Bellarmine's Defence shall be used as a comment upon it.

The Catechism then speaks as follows:

"Est Purgatorius ignis, quo piorum animæ ad definitum tempus cruciatæ expiantur, ut eis in æternam patriam ingressus patere possit, in quam nihil coinquinatum ingreditur."—Part i. De Symb. 5.

"There is a Purgatorial fire, in which the souls of the pious are tormented for a certain time, and cleansed, in order that an entrance may lie open to them into their eternal home, into which nothing defiled enters."

In like manner Bellarmine says,

"Purgatory is a certain place in which, as if in a prison, souls are purged after this life, which have not been fully purged in it, in order, (that is,) that thus purged they may be enabled to enter heaven, which nothing defiled shall enter."

A painful light is at once cast by these comments on the Synodal Decree. "There is a Purgatory" in the Decree, is interpreted by Bellarmine "there is a sort of *prison*;" and by the Catechism, "there is a Purgatorial *fire*." And whereas the Decree merely declares that souls are "detained there," the Catechism says they are "tormented and cleansed." Moreover, both the Catechism and Bellarmine imply that this is the ordinary mode of attaining heaven, inasmuch as no one scarcely can be considered, and no one can be surely known, to leave this world "fully purged;" whereas the Decree speaks vaguely of "the souls there." So much at first sight; now to consider the persons with which Purgatory is concerned, the sins, condition of souls, place, time, punishment, and remedies; Bellarmine likening it to a *carcer*, the Catechism saying that the "*animæ piorum ad definitum tempus cruciatæ expiantur purgatorio igne*."

1. The Persons who are reserved in Purgatory

THE Roman Church holds that Christians or believers only are tenants of Purgatory, as for Christians only are offered their prayers, alms, and masses. The question follows, whether all Christians? not all Christians, but such as die in GOD'S favour, yet with certain sins unforgiven. Some Christians die simply in GOD'S favour with all their sins forgiven; others die out of His favour, as the impenitent, whether Christians or not; but others, and that the great majority, die, according to the Romanists, in GOD'S favour, yet more or less under the bond of their sins. And so far we may unhesitatingly allow to them, or rather we ourselves hold the same, if we hold that after Baptism there is no plenary pardon of sins in this life to the sinner, however penitent, *such* as in Baptism was once vouchsafed to him. If for sins committed after Baptism we have not yet received a simple and unconditional absolution, surely penitents from this time up to the day of judgment may be considered in that double state of which the Romanists speak, their persons accepted, but certain sins uncanceled. Such a state is plainly revealed to us in Scripture as a real one, in various passages, to which we appeal as well as the Romanists. Let the case of David suffice. On his repentance Nathan said to him, "The LORD also *hath put away thy sin; thou shalt not die; howbeit*, because by this deed thou hast given great occasion to the enemies of the LORD to blaspheme, the child also that is born unto thee shall surely die." 2 Sam. xii. 13, 14. Here is a perspicuous instance of a penitent restored to GOD'S favour at once, yet his sins afterwards visited; and it needs very little experience in life to be aware that such punishments occur continually, though no one takes them to be an evidence that the sufferer himself is under GOD'S displeasure, but rather accounts them punishments even when we have abundant proofs of his faith, love, holiness, and fruitfulness in good works. So far then we cannot be said materially to oppose the Romanists. They on the other hand agree with us in maintaining that CHRIST'S death *might*, if GOD so willed, be applied for the removal even of these specific punishments of sins, which they call *temporal* punishments, as fully as it really is for the acceptance of the *soul* of the person punished, or the removal of eternal punishment. Further, both parties agree, that in matter of fact it is not so applied; the experience of life shows it; else every judgment might be taken as evidence of the person suffering it being under GOD'S wrath. The death of the disobedient prophet from Judah would, in that case, prove that he perished eternally, which surely would be utterly presumptuous and uncharitable. As far as this then we have no violent difference of *principle* with the Romanists; but at this point we separate from them: *they* say these temporal punishments on sin are inflicted on the faults incurring them, in a certain fixed proportion; that every sin of a certain kind has a definite penalty or price; in consequence, that if it is not fully discharged in this life, it must be hereafter; and that Purgatory is the place of discharging it.

2. The sins for which persons are confined in Purgatory

The next question is, what are the sins which are thus punished? not all sins of Christians, for some incur an eternal punishment. There are sins, it is maintained, which in themselves merit eternal damnation, are directly opposed to love or charity, quench grace, and throw the doer of them out of GOD'S favour. These in consequence are called mortal; such as murder, adultery, or blasphemy. Such sins do not lead to Purgatory; hell is their portion if unrepented of. But all but these, all but *unrepented mortal* sins are in the case of Christians punished in Purgatory. Of these it follows there are two kinds, sins though *repented* of, and sins though not *mortal*; concerning which a few words shall be said.

1. Mortal sins, though repented of, and though the offender cease to be under GOD'S displeasure, yet have visibly their own punishment in many cases, as in the instance of David. But the Romanists consider that these sins have their penalty assigned to them as if by weight and measure;

moreover, that we can ourselves take part in discharging it, and by our own act anticipate and supersede GOD'S judgment, according to the text: "If we would judge ourselves, we should not be judged." This voluntary act on our part is called Penance, and is said to expiate the sin, that is, to wash away its temporal effects. Should we die before the full temporal punishment, or satisfaction, has been paid for all our mortal sins, we must pay the rest hereafter, *i.e.* in Purgatory.

2. Sins which are not mortal, are called *venial*, and are such as do not quench grace, or run counter to love. Bellarmine thus contrasts them:

"Mortal sins are they which absolutely turn us from GOD, and merit eternal punishment; Venial, those which somewhat impede our course to Him, but do not turn it, and are with little pains blotted out. The former are crimes, the latter sins ... Mortal sin is like a deadly wound, which suddenly kills: Venial is a slight stroke, which does not endanger life, and is easily healed. The former fights with love, which is the soul's life; the latter is rather beside than against love."—*De Amiss. Grat.* i. 2.

Venial sin differs from Mortal in two ways, in *kind* and *degree*. An idle word, excessive laughter, and the like, are sins in kind distinct from perjury or adultery. Again, anger is a venial sin when slight and undesigned, but when indulged interferes with love and is mortal; a theft of a large sum may be mortal, of a small venial.

Venial sins, being such, are considered by Romanists not to deserve so much as eternal punishment,—to be pardonable not merely by an express and immediate act of GOD'S mercy, or again through the virtue of our state of regeneration, but to be intrinsically venial, to offend GOD, but not so as to alienate Him. They rest this doctrine upon such passages as the following: "Sin, when it is *finished*, bringeth forth *death*," James i. 15; therefore, before it is finished or perfected, it has no such fearful power. Still they say it requires *some* punishment; which it receives in the next world, should it not receive it in this, that is, in Purgatory.

Such then are the sins of GOD'S true servants, penitent believers, for which, according to the Romanists, they suffer in Purgatory; mortal sins repented of, and those sins of infirmity which befall them so continually and so secretly, that they cannot repent of them specifically if they would, and which do not deserve eternal punishment, though they do not. They consider the Purgatorial punishment of *venial* sins to be meant by the Apostle, when he speaks of those who, building on the true foundation "wood, hay, and stubble," are "saved so *as by fire*;" and the punishment for *mortal* sins, in our SAVIOUR'S declaration, that certain prisoners shall not go out till they have "paid the very last mite." Luke xii. 59. It may be added, that Martyrdom is supposed to be a full expiation of whatever guilt of sin still rests on the Christian undergoing it; and therefore to stand instead of Purgatory. Martyrs then are at once admitted to the Beatific vision, which is the privilege in which Purgatory terminates.

From this account of the inmates of Purgatory, and the causes why they are there detained, we gather what has already been hinted, that the one main or rather sole reason of the appointment, is a satisfaction of GOD'S justice. The persons concerned are believers destined for bliss eternal; but before they pass on from earth to heaven, the course of their existence is, as it were, suspended, and they are turned aside to discharge a debt; how they effect it, or in what length of time, or with what effect on themselves, being questions as beside the mark, as if they were used with reference to the payment of a charge in worldly matters. It is an appointment altogether without bearing upon their moral character or eternal prospects; and after it is over, is wiped out as though it had never been.

3. The moral condition of souls in Purgatory

Bellarmino well illustrates the supposed mental state of believers while in Purgatory, by com-

paring them to travellers who come up to a fortified town after nightfall, and have to wait at the gates till the morning. Such persons have come to the end of their journey; they are not on the way, they have attained; they are sure of admittance, which is a matter of time only.

Accordingly the Romanists hold that souls in Purgatory become neither better nor worse, neither sin nor add to their good works; they are one and all perfect in love, and ready for heaven, were it not for this debt, which hangs about them as so much rust or dross, and cannot be purged away except for certain appointed external remedies. They support this view of the stationary condition of the soul in Purgatory by such texts as the following: "The night cometh when no man can work." "Where the tree falls, there it shall lie." "We must all appear before the judgment-seat of CHRIST, that every one may receive the things *done in his body*." John ix. 4. Eccles. xi. 3. 2 Cor. v. 10.

Next, with the exception of some few theologians, they consider that souls in Purgatory are comforted with the assurance that their eternal happiness is secured to them. Their state in consequence is thus described by Bellarmine (ii. 4).

"You will object that they may be in doubt whether they are in hell or in purgatory. Not so; for in hell GOD is blasphemed, in Purgatory He is praised; in hell there is neither habit of faith, nor hope, nor love of GOD, in Purgatory all of these. A soul then which shall understand that it hopes in GOD, praises and loves GOD, will clearly know it is not in hell. But perhaps it will fear it is to be sent to hell, though not there yet; neither can this be, for the same faith remains in it, which it had here. Here it believed according to the plain word of Scripture, that after death none can become of good bad, or of bad good, and none but the bad are to be sent into hell. When then it perceives that it loves GOD, and is therefore good, it will not fear damnation."

4. The place and time of Purgatory

On this subject the Church has not formally determined any thing: but the common opinion of the Schoolmen is, that it is one of four prisons or receptacles, which are situated in the heart of the earth, Hell for the damned, the *Limbus Puerorum* for children dying without baptism, the *Limbo Patrum* for the just who died before the passion of CHRIST, and who since that time have all been transferred from it to heaven, and Purgatory for believers under punishment. In other words, whereas all punishment is either for a time or eternal, either positive (*pœna sensûs*) or negative (*pœna damni*), that of good men before CHRIST'S coming was the *pœna damni*, or absence of GOD'S light and joy for a time, that of unbaptized infants is the *pœna damni* for ever, that of Purgatory the *pœna sensûs* for a time, that of Hell the *pœna sensûs* for ever. To these some Romanists have added a fifth, that is, of faithful souls, who without being yet admitted into heaven, are yet secured against all pain; but these, according to Bellarmine, as at least enduring the *pœna damni*, are to be considered in Purgatory, though in the most tolerable place in it, as being but in the condition of the old Fathers before CHRIST came.

The time of Purgatory depends of course upon the state of the debt which is to be liquidated in each case, and varies consequently with the individual. Martyrs, as has been above stated, are supposed to satisfy it in the very act of martyrdom; others will not be released till the day of judgment. Again, the period of suffering depends upon the exertions of survivors, by prayers, alms, and masses, which have power not only to relieve but to shorten the pain.

5. The nature of the Punishment

Here the Roman Church has defined nothing; its catechism, as we have seen, and its theologians in accordance, consider it to be material fire, but in the Council of Florence, the Greeks would not do more than subscribe to the existence of Purgatory; they denied that the punishment was fire; the

question accordingly remains open, that is, it is not determined either way *de fide*. The difficulty, how elementary fire, or any thing of a similar nature, can affect the disembodied soul, is paralleled by St. Austin by the mystery of the union of soul and body.

The pains of Purgatory are considered to be horrible, and far exceeding any in this life; "*Pœnas Purgatorii esse atrocissimas; et cum illis nullas pœnas hujus vitæ comparandas, docent constanter Patres,*" says Bellarmine (ii. 14), and proceeds to refer to Austin, Pope Gregory, Bede, Anselm, and Bernard. Yet on this point theologians differ. Some consider the chief misery to consist in the *pœna damni*, or absence of GOD'S presence, which to holy souls, understanding and desiring it, would be as intolerable as extreme thirst or hunger to the body; and in this way seem to put all purgatorial pain on a level, or rather assign the greater pain to the more spiritually-minded. Others consider the *pœna damni* to be alleviated by the certainty of heaven and of the continually lessening term of their punishment. With them then the *pœna sensûs*, or the fire, is the chief source of torment, which admits of degrees according to the will of GOD.

6. The efficacy of the suffrages of the Church

By suffrages are meant co-operations of the living with the dead; prayers, masses, and works, such as alms, pilgrimages, fastings, &c. These aids, which individuals can supply, alms, prayers, &c., only avail when offered by good persons; for he who is not accepted himself, cannot do acceptable service for another. Moreover these aids may be directed either to the benefit of all souls in Purgatory indiscriminately, or specially to the benefit of a certain soul in particular.

There is one other means of escaping the penalties due to sin in Purgatory, which may briefly be mentioned, viz. by the grant of indulgences; these are dispensed on the following theory. Granting that a certain fixed temporal penalty attached to every act of sin, in such case, it would be conceivable that, as the multitude of Christians did not discharge their total debt in this life, so some extraordinary holy men might more than discharge it. Such are the Prophets, Apostles, Martyrs, Ascetics, and the like, who have committed few sins, and have undergone extreme labours and sufferings, voluntary or involuntary. This being supposed, the question rises, what becomes of the overplus; and then there seems a fitness that what is not needed for themselves, should avail for their brethren who are still debtors. It is accordingly stored, together with CHRIST'S merits, in a kind of treasure-house, to be dispensed according to the occasion, and that at the discretion of the Church. The application of this treasure is called an Indulgence, which stands instead of a certain time of penance in this life, or for the period, whatever it be, to which that time is commuted in Purgatory. In this way, the supererogatory works of the Saints are supposed to go in payment of the debts of ordinary Christians.

§ 2. Proof of the Roman Doctrine concerning Purgatory

1. Proofs from supernatural appearances

THE argumentative ground, on which the belief in Purgatory was actually introduced, would seem to lie in the popular stories of apparitions witnessing to it. Not that it rose in consequence of them historically, or that morally it was founded in them; only that when persons came to ask themselves why they received it, this was the ultimate ground of evidence on which the mind fell back; viz. the evidence of miracles, not of Scripture, or of the Fathers.

Bellarmino enumerates it as one of the confirmatory arguments. With this view he refers in particular to some relations of Gregory of Tours, A.D. 573; of Pope Gregory, A.D. 600; of Bede, A.D. 700; of Peter Damiani, A.D. 1057; of St. Bernard, A.D. 1100; and of St. Anselm, A.D. 1100. The dates are worth noticing, if it be true, as is here assumed, that such supernatural accounts as then were

put forth, are really the argument on which the doctrine was and is received; for it would thence appear, first, that the doctrine was not taught as divine before the end of the sixth century; next, that when it was put forth, it was grounded on the authority of an (alleged) *new revelation*. This indeed is confessed in the Dialogues of Pope Gregory, in which after he has related to his friend Peter the Deacon, an instance of a soul which was seen in the Purgatorial fire, Peter remarks, "How is this, that *in these last times* so many things come to light about souls, which before were hidden?" lib. iv. 40. But the passage will hereafter come before us in another connection. The following miraculous narratives are found in a Protestant Selection from Roman writers, published in 1688, and entitled "Purgatory proved by Miracles."

"St. Gregory the Great writes, that the soul of Paschasius appeared to St. Germanus, and testified to him, that he was freed from the pains of Purgatory for his prayers.

"When the same St. Gregory was abbot of his Monastery, a monk of his, called Justus, now dead, appeared to another monk, called Copiosus, and advertized him, that he had been freed from the torments of Purgatory, by thirty Masses, which Pretiosus, Prefect of the Monastery, by the order of St. Gregory, had said for his soul, as is recounted in his life.

"St. Gregory of Tours writes of a holy damsel, called Vitaliana, that she appeared to St. Martin, and told him she had been in Purgatory for a venial sin which she had committed, and that she had been delivered by the prayers of the Saint.

"Peter Damiani writes, that St. Severin appeared to a clergyman, and told him that he had been in Purgatory, for not having said the Divine Service at due hours, and that afterwards GOD had delivered him, and carried him to the company of the blessed.

"St. Bernard writes, that St. Malachy freed his sister from the pains of Purgatory by his prayers; and that the same sister had appeared unto him, begging of him that relief and favour.

"And St. Bernard himself by his intercession freed another, who had suffered a whole year the pains of Purgatory: as William Abbot writes in his life."—*Flowers of the Lives of the Saints*, p. 830.

These instances among others are adduced by Bellarmine; and he adds, "*plura similia legi possunt apud, &c. . . . sed quæ attulimus, sunt magis authentica.*"—1. 11.

2. Proofs from the Old and New Testaments

Bellarmino adduces the following texts from the Old and New Testaments; in doing which he must not be supposed to mean that each of them contains in itself the evidence of its relevancy and availableness, or could be understood without some authoritative interpretation; only, if it is asked, "is Purgatory the doctrine of Holy Scripture, and where?" he would answer, that in matter of fact it is taught in the following passages, according to the explanations of them found in various writers of consideration.

1. 2 Mac. xii. 42-45. "Besides that noble Judas exhorted the people to keep themselves from sin, forso much as they saw before their eyes the things that come to pass for the sins of those that were slain. And when he had made a gathering throughout the company to the sum of two thousand drachms of silver, he sent it to Jerusalem, *to offer a sin offering*, doing therein very well and honestly, in that he was mindful of the Resurrection; for if he had not hoped that they that were slain should have risen again, it had been superfluous and vain to pray for the dead. And also, in that he perceived that there was great favour laid up for those that died godly, *it was an holy and good thought*. Whereupon he made a reconciliation for the dead, that they might be delivered from sin."

2. Tob. iv. 17. "*Pour out thy bread on the burial of the just*, but give nothing to the wicked;" that is, at the burial of the just, give alms; which were given to gain for them the prayers of the poor.

3. 1 Sam. xxxi. 13. "And they took their bones," [of Saul and his Sons,] "and *buried* them under

a tree at Jabesh, and *fasted seven days*." Vid. also 2 Sam. i. 12; iii. 35. This fasting was an offering for their souls.

4. Ps. xxxviii. 1. "O LORD, rebuke me not in Thy *wrath*; neither chasten me in Thy *hot displeasure*." By *wrath* is meant Hell; by *hot displeasure* Purgatory.

5. Ps. lxvi. 12. "We went through *fire* and through *water*, but Thou broughtest us out into a wealthy place" (*refrigerium*). Water is Baptism; fire is Purgatory.

6. Is. iv. 4. "When the LORD shall have washed away the filth of the daughters of Zion, and shall have *purged* the blood of Jerusalem from the midst thereof, by the spirit of judgment and by the spirit of *burning*."

7. Is. ix. 18. "Wickedness burneth as the fire; it shall devour the briers and thorns."

8. Mic. vii. 8, 9. "Rejoice not against me, O mine enemy; when I fall, I shall arise; when I *sit in darkness*, the LORD shall be a light unto me. I will bear the *indignation* of the LORD, because I have sinned against Him, *until he plead my cause*, and execute judgment for me: *He will bring me forth to the light*, and I shall behold His righteousness."

9. Zech. ix. 11. "As for Thee also, by the blood of Thy covenant, I have *sent forth Thy prisoners out of the pit*, wherein is no water." This text is otherwise taken to refer to the *Limbus Patrum*.

10. Mal. iii. 3. "He shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver; and He shall *purify* the sons of Levi, and *purge* them as gold and silver," &c.

From the New Testament he adduces the following texts;

1. Matt. xii. 32. "Whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, *neither in the world to come*;" that means, "neither in Purgatory," for in hell the very supposition of forgiveness is excluded.

2. 1 Cor. iii. 15. "He himself shall be saved; *yet so as by fire*."

3. 1 Cor. xv. 29. "Else what shall they do, which are *baptized*" i.e. who undergo the baptism of tears and humiliation, who pray, fast, give alms, &c. "for the dead, if the dead rise not at all?"

4. Matt. v. 25, 26.—Luke xii. 58, 59. "Agree with thine adversary quickly, whilst thou art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison. Verily, I say unto thee, *thou shalt by no means come out thence*, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing." By the *way*, is meant this present life; by the *adversary*, the Law; by the *Judge*, our SAVIOUR; by the *officer*, or executioner, the Angels; by the prison, Purgatory.

5. Matt. v. 22. "Whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause, shall be in danger of the *judgment*; and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the *Council*: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire." Here are three kinds of punishments spoken of. Hell belongs to the next world; therefore also do the other two. Hence there are in the next world, besides eternal punishment, punishments short of eternal.

6. Luke xvi. 9. "Make to yourselves friends of the mammon of unrighteousness, that, when ye fail, they may receive you into everlasting habitations." To *fail*, is to die: the *friends* are the Saints in glory, and they *receive* us, i.e. from Purgatory, in consequence of their prayers.

7. Luke xxiii. 42. "Lord, *remember me, when Thou comest into Thy kingdom*." That is, there is a remembrance and a remission of sin, not only in this life, but after it, in Christ's future kingdom.

8. Acts ii. 24. "Whom God hath raised up, having loosed the pains of death (*infern*); because it was not possible that He should be holden of it." CHRIST Himself was released from no *pains* on being raised, nor were the ancient Fathers in the *Limbus*: nor were lost souls released at all. Therefore the pains which GOD loosed, were those of souls in Purgatory.

9. Phil. ii. 10. "That at the name of JESUS every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, *and things under the earth.*" Vid. also Rev. v. 3. "And no *man* in heaven, nor in earth, *neither under the earth*, was able to open the book, neither to look thereon."

Now as to many of these texts, we who have not been educated in the belief of Purgatory, may well wonder how they come to be enlisted in support of Purgatory at all. This may be explained in some such way as the following,—which may be of use in helping us to understand the state of mind under which the Romanists view them. It is obvious, as indeed has been already remarked, that they do not of themselves *prove* the doctrine, nor are they chosen by Bellarmine himself, but given on the authority of writers of various times. Could indeed competent evidence be brought from other quarters, that the doctrine really was true and Apostolical, we should not unreasonably have believed that some of them did allude to it; especially if writers of name, who might speak from tradition, so considered. We could not have taken upon ourselves to say at first sight that it certainly was not contained in them, only we should have waited for evidence that it was. Some of the texts in question are obscure, and seem to desiderate a meaning; and so far it is a sort of gain when they have any meaning assigned them, as though they were unappropriated territory which the first comer might seize. Again, the coincidence of several of them in one and the same mode of expression, implies that they have a common drift, whatever that drift is,—that there is something about them which seems to have reference to secrets untold to man. Amid these dim and broken lights, the text in the Apocrypha first quoted, comes as if to combine and steady them. All this is said *by way of analysing how* it is that such a class of texts, though of so little cogency critically, has that influence with individuals, which it certainly sometimes has. The reason seems to be that the doctrine of Purgatory professes to interpret texts which GOD'S word has left in obscurity. Yet whatever be the joint force of such arguments from Scripture, in favour of the doctrine, it vanishes surely, at once and altogether, before one single clear text, such as the following: "Blessed are the dead *which die in the Lord*, from henceforth; yea, saith the Spirit, *that they may rest from their labours.*" Or again, if any one is destined to endure Purgatory for the temporal punishment of sins, one should think it would be persons circumstanced as the thief on the cross,—a dying penitent; yet to him it is expressly said, "Verily I say unto thee, *to day* shalt thou be with me in Paradise."

3. Proofs from Antiquity

After Scripture, Bellarmine brings the testimony of early Churches in Council, as follows:

1. The African Church: "Let the Altar Sacrament be celebrated fasting; if, however, there be any Commendation of the Dead made in the afternoon, let prayers only be used."—Conc. Carth. IV. c. 79.

2. The Spanish enjoins that suicides should not be prayed for, &c.—Conc. Bracar. I. c. 39.

3. The Gallic: "It has seemed fit, that in all celebrations of the Eucharist, the Lord shall be interceded with in a suitable place in Church, for the spirits of the dead."—Conc. Cabilon.

4. The German defines, (Conc. Wormat. c. 10.) that prayers and offerings should be made even for those who are executed.

5. The Italic declares (Conc. VI. under Symmachus), that it is sacrilege to defraud the souls of the dead of prayer, &c.

6. The Greek in like manner.

Moreover, the Liturgies of St. James, St. Basil, &c. all contain prayers for the dead.

Now these professed instances are here enumerated in order to show how plainly and entirely they fall short of the point to be proved. Not one of them implies the doctrine of Purgatory; or goes beyond the doctrine which Archbishop Ussher (vide Tract 72.) has shown to have existed in the

early Church, that the Saints departed were not at once in their full happiness, and that prayers benefited them. One of these instances indeed is somewhat remarkable, the allowing prayers for malefactors executed; but all were the subject of prayer who were not excluded from hope, and malefactors are, even by us, admitted to Holy Communion, and are allowed the Burial Service. To pray for them was merely the expression of hope.

Next, Bellarmine appeals to the Fathers, of whom I shall only cite those within the first five hundred years; viz. Tertullian, Cyprian, Eusebius, Cyril of Jerusalem, Gregory Nazianzen, Ambrose, Jerome, Chrysostom, Paulinus, Augustine, Theodoret, and one or two others. Now in order to keep the point in controversy clearly in view, let it be recollected that we are not disputing the existence in the Ritual of the Church, of the custom of praying for the dead in CHRIST; but *why* prayer was offered was a question in dispute, a point unsettled by any Catholic tradition, but variously treated by various Doctors at various times. There is nothing contrary to the genius of religion, natural and revealed, that duties should be prescribed, yet the reasons for them not told us, as Bishop Butler has abundantly showed; and the circumstance that the ancients do agree in the usage, but differ as to the reasons, shows that the reasons were built upon the usage, not the usage on the reasons. And while this variety of opinions in the early Church, as to the meaning of the usage, forfeits for any one of these any claim to be considered apostolical, of course it deprives the doctrine of Purgatory of authority inclusively, even supposing for argument's sake it was received by some early writers as true. Purgatory is but a violent hypothesis to give meaning to a usage, for which other hypotheses short of it and very different from it, and equally conjectural with it, may be assigned, nay, and were assigned before it, and far more extensively. Let it be remembered then, when the following lists of passages, professedly in behalf of Purgatory, is read, that what we have to look for is, not evidence of a certain usage, which we grant did exist, but of an opinion, of a particular opinion explaining it; not of Prayer for the dead simply, nor of the opinion that Prayer for the dead profits, but that such Prayer is intended and tends to rescue them from a state of suffering. Further, what we look for is not the testimony of one or two writers to the truth of this opinion, even if one or two could be brought, but an agreement of all in its favour. If however it be said that the usage of Prayer in itself tends to the doctrine of Purgatory, I answer, that so far from it, in its primitive form it included prayers for the Virgin Mary and Apostles, which while retained were an indirect but forcible standing witness against the doctrine.

Tertullian, in his *de Coronâ*, § 3. speaks of “*oblaciones pro defunctis*,” offerings for the dead.

Again, “Let her” [the widow] “pray for the soul of” [her deceased husband] “and ask for him a place of refreshment in the interval before the judgment, and a fellowship in the first resurrection, and let her offer on the anniversary of his falling to sleep.”—*De Monogam.* § 10. Vid, also *de Pudicit.*

Cyprian. “The Bishops our predecessors ... decreed that no one dying should nominate clerics as guardians or executors, and if any one had done this, no offering should be made for him, or sacrifice celebrated for his sleeping well.”—*Epist.* i. 9. *et infra.*

Eusebius (vid. Constant. iv.) says that Constantine had wished to be buried in a frequented Church, in order to have the benefit of many prayers. On his death they offered the Holy Eucharist over his remains²².

Cyril of Jerusalem. “We pray for all our community who are dead, believing that this is the greatest benefit to those souls for whom the offering is made.”—*Mystagog.* 5.

Gregory Nazianzen. “Let us commend to GOD our own souls, and the souls of those who, as

²²Vid. also passage in Records of the Church, No xii. “The Adversary contrived that his [Polycarp's] poor body might not be obtained by us, though many much desired to secure it, and to communicate over his holy remains.”

men more advanced on the same road, have arrived before us at their resting place."—*Orat. in Cæsar. fin.*

Ambrose. "Therefore she is, I think, not so much to be lamented as to be followed with your prayers; she is not to be mourned over with your tears, but rather her soul is to be commended to GOD by your oblations."—*Ep. ii. 8. ad Faustinum.* Vid. also *de ob. Theod., &c. &c.*

Jerome. "Other husbands scatter on their wives' graves violets, roses, lilies, and purple flowers; but our Pammachius waters her holy ashes and reverend relics with the balsams of almsgiving; with such embellishments and perfumes he honours the sleeping remains, knowing what is written, 'As water quenches fire, so doth alms sin.'"—*Ad Pammach.*

Chrysostom. "The dead is aided not by tears, but by prayers, by supplications, by alms . . . Let us not weary in giving aid to the dead, offering prayers for them."—*Hom. 41. in 1. ad Cor.*

Again. "Not without purpose has it been ordained by the Apostles, that in the awful Mysteries a commemoration should be made of the dead; for they know that thence much gain accrues to them, much advantage."—*Hom. 69. ad pop.* Vid. also *Hom. 32. in Matt. In Joan. Hom. 84. In Philipp. 3. in Act. Apost. 21.*

Paulinus, writing to Delphinus, Bishop of Bordeaux: "Do thy diligence that he may be granted to thee, and that from the least of thy sacred fingers the dews of refreshment may sprinkle his soul."

Augustine. "We read in the book of Maccabees that sacrifice was offered for the dead; but though it were not even found in the Old Scriptures, the authority of the universal Church is not slight, which is explicit as to this custom, viz. that in the Priests' prayers which are offered to the LORD GOD at His altar, the commendation of the dead is included."—*De Cur, pro mortuis, c. ii. et alibi.*

Theodoret (*Hist. v. 26.*) mentions that Theodosius the younger fell down at the tomb of St. John Chrysostom, and prayed for the souls of his parents, then dead, Arcadius and Eudoxia.

Isidore. "Unless the Church Catholic believed that sins are remitted to the dead in Christ, she would not do alms, or offer sacrifice to GOD for their spirits."—*De off. div. i. 18.*

Gregory the Great. "Much profiteth souls even after death the sacred oblation of the lifegiving Sacrifice, so that the souls of the dead themselves sometimes seem to ask for it."—*Dial. iv. 55.*

Again: "They who are not weighed down by grievous sins, are profited after death by burial in the Church, because that their relatives, whenever they come to the same sacred places, remember their own kin whose tombs they behold, and pray to the LORD for them."

It is evident that the above passages go no way to prove the point in debate, being nothing more in fact than Ussher allows to be found in the early Fathers. They contain the musings of serious minds feeling a mystery, and attempting to solve it, at least by conjecture. They state that prayers benefit the dead in CHRIST, but *how*, is either not mentioned, or vaguely, or hesitatingly, or discordantly. Accordingly, Bellarmine begins anew, and draws out a series of authorities for the doctrine of *Purgatory* expressly; and this certainly demands our attention more than the former. It contains such as the following:—

For instance, Origen says that "he who is saved, is saved by fire, that if he has any alloy of lead, the fire may melt and separate it, that all may become pure gold."—*Hom. 6. in Exod.*

Tertullian speaks of our being "committed into the prison beneath, which will detain us till every small offence is expiated, during the delay of the resurrection."—*De Anim. 17.*

Cyprian contrasts the being purged by torment in fire, and by martyrdom.—*Epist. iv. 2.*

Gregory Nazianzen speaks of the last Baptism being "one of fire, not only more bitter, but longer than the first Baptism."—*In Sancta lum. circ. fin.*

Ambrose speaks of our being “saved through faith, as if through fire,” which will be a trial under which grievous sinners will fall, while others will pass safe through it.—In *Pa.* xxxvi.

Basil speaks of the “Purgatorial fire,” in cap. ix. *Isa.*

Gregory Nyssen, of “our recovering our lost happiness by prayer and religiousness in this life, or after death by the *purgatorial fire*.”—*Orat. pro Mort.* Elsewhere too he speaks of the Purgatorial fire.

Eusebius Emissenus uses such determined words, as to require quoting. “This punishment under the earth will await those, who, having lost instead of preserving their Baptism, will perish for ever; whereas those who have done deeds calling for temporal punishments, shall pass over the fiery river and that fearful water the drops of which are fire.”

Hilary declares that we have to undergo “that ever-living fire, which is a punishment of the soul in cleansing of sin.”—In *Ps.* cxviii. Lactantius speaks to the same effect.—*Div. Inst.* vii. 21.

Jerome contrasts the eternal torments of the devil, and of atheists and infidels, with “the judgment tempered with mercy, of sinners and ungodly men, yet Christian, whose works are to be tried, purified in the fire.”—In *fin. Comment. in Is.* In another place in a like contrast he speaks of Christians, if overtaken in a fault, being saved after punishment.—*Lib. i. in Pelag.*

Augustine has various passages in point, such as *Civ. Dei*, xxi. 24, where, speaking of believers who die with lighter sins, he says, “It is certain that these being purified before the day of judgment by means of temporal punishment, which their souls suffer, are not to be given over to eternal fire.” Pope Gregory the first expresses the same doctrine, as do some others.

These instances are at first sight to the point, and demand serious consideration. Yet there is nothing in them really to alarm the inquirer whither he is being carried. I say this, that no one may be surprised at the deliberateness and over-patience with which I may seem to loiter over the explanation of them. First, then, let it be observed, were they ever so strong in favour of something more than we believe, it does not therefore follow that they take that very view which the Romanists take, nay, it does not necessarily follow that they take any one view at all, or agree with each other. Now it so happens neither the one nor the other of these suppositions is true, as regards those passages, though they ought both to hold, if the Roman doctrine is to be satisfactorily maintained. These Fathers, whatever they teach, do not teach Purgatory, they do not teach any one view at all on the subject. Romanists consider Purgatory to be an article of faith, necessary to be believed in order to salvation; or, in Bellarmine’s words, “Purgatory is an article of faith, so that he who disbelieves its existence, will never have experience of it, but will be tormented in hell with everlasting fire.” Now it can only be an article of faith, supposing it is held by Antiquity, and that unanimously. For such things only are we allowed to maintain, as come to us from the Apostles; and that only (ordinarily speaking) has evidence of so originating, which is witnessed by a number of independent witnesses in the early Church. We must have the unanimous “consent of Doctors,” as an assurance that the Apostles have spoken; and much less can we tolerate their actual disagreement, in a case where unanimity was promised us. Now as regards Purgatory, not only are early writers silent as to the modern view of Rome, but they do not agree with each other; which proves they knew little more about the matter than ourselves, whatever they might conjecture; that they possessed no Apostolic Tradition, only at most entertained floating opinions on the subject. Nay, it is obvious, if we wished to believe them, we could not; for *what* is it we are to believe? if, as I shall show, various writers speak various things, which of their statements is to be taken? If this or that, it is but the language of an individual: if all of them at once, a doctrine results discordant in its details, and in general outline, if it have any, vague and imperfect at the best.

Now as to the passages quoted by Bellarmine, it will be observed that in the number are extracts from the works of Origen, St. Ambrose, St. Hilary, St. Jerome, and Lactantius. He introduces the list with these words, "*Sunt apertissima loca in Patribus, ubi asserunt Purgatorium, quorum pauca quædam afferam,*" i. 10. "There are most perspicuous passages in the Fathers, in which they assert Purgatory, of which I will adduce some few." Will it be believed that in his second book these Fathers, nay, for the most part in the very extracts, which he has before adduced in proof of the doctrine, are enumerated as at variance with it, and mistaken in their notion of it? He quotes a passage of Origen, (not the same) the very same two passages from St. Ambrose, the very same passage from St. Hilary, the very same from Lactantius, and a passage (not the same) from St. Jerome. Then he says, "*Hæc sententia, accepta ut sonat, manifestum errorem continet; for*" (he proceeds) "it is defined in the Council of Florence, &c" ii. 1. Next he observes, "*Adde, quod Patres adducti, Origene excepto . . . videntur sano modo intelligi posse.*" At length, after he has given the two most favourable explanations assignable to their words, he adds of one of the two, "*Sane hanc sententiam [quæ docet omnes transituros per ignem, licet non omnes lædendi sint ab igne] nec auderem pro vera asserere, nec ut errorem improbare.*" "The only alleviation of this strange inconsistency," says a work which has recently appeared, "is that he quotes not the very same sentences both for and against his Church, but adjoining ones." The work referred to, thus comments on Bellarmine's conduct, as throwing light upon the state of feeling under which Romanists engage in controversy. "A Romanist," the writer says, "cannot really argue in defence of the Roman doctrines. He has too firm a confidence in their truth, if he is sincere in his profession, to enable him critically to adjust the due weight to be given to this or that evidence. He assumes his Church's conclusion as true; and the facts or witnesses he adduces, are rather brought to receive an interpretation than to furnish a proof. His highest aim is to show the mere consistency of his theory, its possible adjustment, with the records of antiquity. I am not here inquiring how much of high but misdirected moral feeling is implied in this state of mind; certainly as we advance in perception of the truth, we all of us become less fitted to be controversialists. If this, however, be the true explanation of Bellarmine's strange error, the more it tends to exculpate him, the more deeply it criminales his system. He ceases to be chargeable with unfairness, only in proportion as the notion of the infallibility of Rome is admitted to be the sovereign and engrossing tenet of his communion, the foundation stone, or (as it may be called) the fulcrum of its theology. I consider then, that when he first adduces the aforementioned Fathers in proof of Purgatory, he was really but interpreting them; he was teaching what they ought to mean, what in charity they must be supposed to mean, what they might mean as far as the very words went, *probably* meant considering the Church so meant, and might be taken to mean, even if their authors did not so mean, from the notion that they spoke vaguely, and, as children, really meant something besides what they formally said, and that after all they were but the spokesmen of the then existing Church, which, though in silence, held, as being the Church, the same doctrine which Rome has since defined and published. This is to treat Bellarmine with the same charity with which he has on this supposition treated the Fathers, and it is to be hoped, with a nearer approach to the matter of fact. So much as to his first use of them: but afterwards, in noticing what he considers erroneous opinions on this subject, he treats them, not as organs of the Church infallible, but as individuals, and interprets their language by its literal sense or by the context, and in consequence condemns it ... How hopeless then is it to contend with Romanists, as if they practically agreed to the foundation of faith, however much they pretend to it! Ours is antiquity: theirs the existing Church. Its infallibility is their first principle; belief in it is a deep prejudice, quite beyond the reach of any thing external. It is quite clear that the combined testimonies of all the Fathers, supposing

such a case, would not have a feather's weight against a decision of the Pope in Council, nor would matter at all, except for the Fathers' sakes who had by anticipation opposed it. They consider that the fathers ought to mean what Rome has since decreed, and that Rome knows their meaning better than they themselves did. That venturesome Church has usurped their place, and thinks it merciful, only not to banish outright the rivals she has dethroned. By an act, as it were, of grace she has determined, that when they contradict her, though not available as witnesses against her, yet, as living in times of ignorance, they are only heterodox, and not heretical; and she keeps them around her, to ask their advice when it happens to agree with her own.

"Let us then understand the position of the Romanists towards us; they do not really argue from the Fathers, though they seem to do so. They may affect to do so on our behalf, happy if by an innocent stratagem they are able to convert us; but all the while in their own feelings, they are taking a far higher position. They are teaching, not disputing or proving. They are interpreting what is obscure in antiquity, purifying what is alloyed, correcting what is amiss, perfecting what is incomplete, harmonizing what is various. They claim and use all its documents as ministers and organs of that one infallible Church, which once forsooth kept silence, but since has spoken, which by a divine gift must ever be consistent with itself, and which bears with her her own evidence of divinity."

Leaving Bellarmine then, let us proceed to inquire what the opinion of the Fathers in the foregoing passages really is.

§ 3. History of the Rise of the Doctrine of Purgatory and Opinions in the Early Church concerning it

THE argumentative ground of the doctrine of Purgatory as far as the Infallibility of the Church has not superseded any, has ever been, I conceive, the report of miracles and visions attesting it; but the historical origin is to be sought elsewhere, viz. in the anxious conjectures of the human mind about its future destinies, and the apparent coincidences of these with certain obscure texts of Scripture.

These may be supposed to have operated as follows; as described in the work already cited. "How ALMIGHTY GOD will deal with the mass of Christians, who are neither very good nor very bad, is a problem with which we are not concerned, and which it is our wisdom, and may be our duty, to put from our thoughts. But, when it has once forced itself upon the mind, we are led in self-defence, with a view of keeping ourselves from dwelling unhealthily on particular cases, which come under our experience and perplex us, to imagine modes, not by which GOD does, (for that would be presumptuous to conjecture,) but by which He may solve the difficulty. Most men, to our apprehensions, are too unformed in religious habits either for heaven or for hell, yet there is no middle state when CHRIST comes in judgment. In consequence it is obvious to have recourse to the interval before His coming, as a time during which this incompleteness might be remedied; a season, not of changing the spiritual bent and character of the soul departed, whatever that be, for probation ends with mortal life, but of developing it into a more determinate form, whether of good or of evil. Again, when the mind once allows itself to speculate, it will discern in such a provision, a means whereby those, who not without true faith at bottom yet have committed great crimes, or those who have been carried off in youth while still undecided, or who die after a barren, though not an immoral or scandalous life, may receive such chastisement as may prepare them for heaven, and render it consistent with GOD'S justice to admit them thither. Again, the inequality of the sufferings of Christians in this life, compared one with another, would lead the

unguarded mind to the same speculations, the intense suffering, *e.g.* which some men undergo on their death-bed, seeming as if but an anticipation in their case of what comes after death upon others, who without greater claims on GOD'S forbearance, have lived without chastisement and die easily. I say, the mind will inevitably dwell upon such thoughts, unless it has been taught to subdue them by education or by the experience of their dangerousness.

"Various suppositions have, accordingly, been made, as pure suppositions, as mere specimens of the capabilities, (if one may so speak,) of the Divine Dispensation, as efforts of the mind reaching forward and venturing beyond its depth into the abyss of the divine counsels. If one supposition could be produced to solve the problem, ten thousand others were conceivable, unless indeed the resources of GOD'S Providence are exactly commensurate with man's discernment of them. Religious men, amid these searchings of heart, have naturally gone to Scripture for relief, to see if the inspired word anywhere gave them any clue for their inquiries. And from what was there found, and from the speculations of reason upon it, various notions have been hazarded at different times; for instance, that there is a certain momentary ordeal to be undergone by all men after this life, more or less severe according to their spiritual state; or that certain gross sins in good men will be thus visited, or their lighter failings and habitual imperfections; or that the very sight of divine perfection in the invisible world will be in itself a pain, while it constitutes the purification of the imperfect but believing soul; or that, happiness admitting of various degrees of intensity, penitents late in life may sink for ever into a state, blissful as far as it goes, but more or less approaching to unconsciousness; infants dying after baptism may be as gems paving the courts of heaven, or as the living wheels in the Prophet's vision; while matured Saints may excel in capacity of bliss, as well as in dignity, the highest Archangels. Such speculations are dangerous when indulged; the event proves it; from some of these in fact seems to have resulted the doctrine of Purgatory.

"Now the texts to which the minds of the early Christians seem to have been principally drawn, and from which they ventured to argue in behalf of these vague notions, were these two: 'The fire shall try every man's work,' &c.; and 'He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire.' These texts, with which many more were found to accord, directed their thoughts one way, as making mention of '*fire*,' whatever was meant by the word, as the instrument of trial and purification; and that, at some time between the present time and the judgment, or at the judgment. And accordingly, without perhaps having any definite or consistent meaning in what they said, or being able to say whether they spoke literally or figuratively, and with an indefinite reference to this life, as well as to the intermediate state, they sometimes named fire as the instrument of recovering those who had sinned after their baptism. That this is the origin of the notion of a Purgatorial fire, I gather from these circumstances, first, that they do frequently insist on the texts in question, next, that they do not agree in the particular sense they put upon them. That they quote them shows they rest upon them; that they vary in explaining them, that they had no Catholic sense to guide them. Nothing can be clearer, if these facts be so, than that the doctrine of the Purgatorial fire in all its senses, as far as it was more than a surmise, and was rested on argument, was the result of private judgment exerted in defect of Tradition, upon the text of Scripture . . .

"As this doctrine, thus suggested by certain striking texts, grew in popularity and definiteness, and verged towards its present Roman form, it seemed a key to many others. Great portions of the books of Psalms, Job, and the Lamentations, which express the feelings of religious men under suffering, would powerfully recommend it by the forcible and most affecting and awful meaning which they received from it. When this was once suggested, all other meanings would seem tame and inadequate.

"To these must be added various passages from the Prophets, as that in the beginning of the 3rd chapter of Malachi, which speaks of fire as the instrument of judgment and purification when CHRIST comes to visit His Church.

"Moreover there were other texts of obscure and indeterminate bearing, which seemed on this hypothesis to receive a profitable meaning; such as our LORD'S words in the Sermon on the Mount, 'Verily, I say unto thee, thou shalt by no means come out thence till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing;' and St. John's expression in the Apocalypse, that 'no man in heaven, nor in earth, *neither under the earth*, was able to open the book.'

"Further, the very circumstance that no second instrument of a plenary and entire cleansing from sin was given after Baptism, such as Baptism, led Christians to expect that the unknown means, when accorded, would be of a more painful nature than that which they had received so freely and instantaneously in infancy, and confirmed, not only the text already cited, 'He shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost and with fire,' but also St. Paul's announcement of the 'judgment and fiery indignation' which awaits those who sin after having been once 'enlightened,' and by CHRIST'S warning to the impotent man to sin no more lest a worse thing come unto him.

"Lastly, the universal and apparently apostolical custom of praying for the dead in CHRIST, called for some explanation, the reason for it not having come down to posterity with it. Various reasons may be supposed quite clear of this distressing doctrine, but it supplied an adequate and a most constraining motive for its observance to those who were not content to practise it in ignorance."

Should any one for a moment be startled by any thing that is here said, as if investing the doctrine with some approach to plausibility, I would have him give GOD thanks for the safeguard of Catholic Tradition, which keeps us from immoderate speculation upon Scripture or a vain indulgence of the imagination, by authoritatively declaring the contents and the limits of the Creed necessary to salvation and profitable to ourselves.

There seem, on the whole, to be two chief opinions on the subject embraced in the early Church. One of these is Origen's, which I shall first exhibit in the language of St. Ambrose, being the very passage referred to by Bellarmine. The notion is this, that the fire at the day of judgment will burn or scorch every one in proportion to his remaining imperfections. St. Ambrose then thus comments on Psalm xxxvii. (38) 14.

"'Thou hast proved us by fire,' says David; therefore we shall all be proved by fire, and Ezekiel (Malachi) says, 'Behold the LORD ALMIGHTY cometh, and who may abide the day of his coming? &c. . . . for he is like a refiner's fire, and like fullers' soap; and He shall sit as a refiner and purifier of silver; and He shall purify the sons of Levi, and purge them as gold and silver, &c.' Therefore the sons of Levi will be purged by fire; *by fire Ezekiel, by fire Daniel*. But these, though proved by fire, yet shall say, 'We *passed* through fire and water,' (Ps. lxvi. 12.) Others shall remain in the fire: and the fire shall be as dew to them, (Song of Three Children, 27.) as to the Hebrew Children who were exposed to the fire of the burning furnace. But the Ministers of impiety shall be consumed in the avenging flame. Woe is me should my work be burned, and I suffer this worsting of my labour! Although the LORD will save His servants, we shall be saved by faith, but so saved as by fire. Although we shall not be consumed, yet we shall be burned. But how some remain in the fire, others escape through it, learn from another Scripture. The Egyptians were drowned in the Red Sea, the Israelites passed over; Moses escaped to land, Pharaoh sank, for his heavy sins drowned him. In like manner the irreligious will sink in the lake of burning fire."

It is plain that St. Ambrose, so far from imagining a Roman Purgatory, definite in period,

place, and subjects, speaks of an ordeal by fire which *all* Christians must undergo at the last day, and grounds it on the solemn text already referred to, 1 Cor. iii. 12-15. which whether rightly so interpreted or not, a point we cannot determine, since it is an [*apax legomenon*] in Scripture, yet at least may be so understood without violence to the wording. "If any man build upon this foundation, gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, stubble, every man's work shall be made manifest; for the Day shall declare it, because it (the Day) shall be revealed in fire; and the fire shall try every man's work, of what sort it is. If any man's work abide which he hath built thereupon, he shall receive a reward. If any man's work shall be burned, he shall suffer loss; but he himself shall be saved, yet so as by fire." Now it would seem plain that in this passage the searching process of final Judgment, essaying our works of righteousness, is described by the word *fire*. Not that we may presume to *limit* the word fire to that meaning, or on the other hand to say it is a merely *figurative* expression denoting judgment; which seems a stretching somewhat beyond our measure. Doubtless there is a mystery in the word *fire*, as there is a mystery in the word *day of judgment*. Yet it any how has reference to the *instrument* or *process* of judgment. And in this way the Fathers seem to have understood the passage; referring it to the last Judgment, as Scripture does, but at the same time religiously retaining the use of the word *fire*, as not affecting to interpret and dispense with what seems some mysterious economy, lest they should be wiser than what is written.

Next let us turn to the same Father's 20th Sermon on Ps. cxix. which is also referred to by Bellarmine.

"As long as the Israelites were in Egypt, they were in the iron furnace, that is, in the furnace of temptation, in the furnace of affliction, where they were afflicted by cruel tyranny. Whence also it is written, 'I brought them forth out of the land of Egypt, from the iron furnace.' The furnace was iron, because, while the people was yet in Egypt, no one's works were illuminated by holiness. no one's gold had been there assayed, no one's lead of iniquity burned away. It was a cruel furnace, a furnace of perpetual death, which none could escape, which consumed every one, in which pain and sorrow dwell only. But the furnace, in which Ananias, Azarias, and Misael sang their hymn to the Lord was a golden furnace, not an iron; by means of which wisdom hath shown forth in the faith of true obedience all over the world. It was indeed in Babylon, where spiritual gold was not, unless perchance in captivity, for 'the LORD led captivity captive.' This is the gold in GOD'S saints who were captives among the Babylonians in body, but in spirit were freemen with GOD, delivered from the chains of human captivity, and bearing the yoke of spiritual grace. And perchance the same furnace would be iron to the unstable, and gold to those who persevere.

"*All must be proved through fire*, as many as desire to return to Paradise; for it is not said for nothing, that when Adam and Eve were expelled from Paradise, GOD placed at the outlet a fiery sword which turned every way. *All must pass through the flames*, whether he be John the Evangelist, whom the LORD so loved as to say to Peter of him, 'If I wish him to tarry, what is that to thee? Follow thou me.' Some have doubted of his death: of his passage through the fire we cannot doubt, for he is in Paradise, not separated from CHRIST. Or whether he be Peter; he who received the keys of the kingdom of Heaven, who walked upon the sea, must still say, 'We passed through fire and water, and Thou broughtest us out into a place of refreshment.' But the fiery sword will soon be turned by St. John, for iniquity is not found in him, whom righteousness itself loved. Whatever human defect was in him, Divine Love melted it away; for her wings are as the wings of fire, (Cant. viii. 6.)

"He who possesses this fire of love, will have no cause to fear there the fiery sword. To Peter, who so often exposed his life for CHRIST, He will say, 'Go and sit down to meat.' But he shall say,

Thou hast tried us with fire, as silver is tried; for, when many waters do not drown love, how can fire consume then?' But he shall be tried as silver, I as lead; *I shall burn till the lead melts away*. If no silver be found in me, ah me! I shall be plunged down into the lowest pit, or consume entire as the stubble. Should ought of gold or silver be found in me, not for my works, but through the mercy and grace of CHRIST, by the ministry of the priesthood, I shall peradventure say, 'They that hope in Thee, shall not be ashamed.'

"The fiery sword then shall consume iniquity, which is placed on the leaden scale. One only could not feel that fire, CHRIST the Righteousness of GOD, who did no sin; for the fire found nought in Him which it might consume."

It is now sufficiently clear what St. Ambrose's belief was. The only point of approximation between it and the doctrine of Purgatory is this; that he conceived that for all but the highest saints, in whom love dissolved all remaining dross whatever, some transient suffering, more or less in duration, was in store in the day of judgment. And hence the force of the ordinary prayers of the early Church, as based on Scripture, (and described at length by Archbishop Ussher, in Tract, No. 72,) that departed believers might have "a merciful trial at the last day."

St. Hilary is another witness, whom Bellarmine, in his former book quotes, in his latter surrenders. He, too, will be found to hold this same view of the purgatorial nature of the fire of the last judgment.

"The prophet [the Psalmist] observes, that it is difficult and most perilous to human nature, to desire GOD'S judgments: For, since no one is clean in His sight, how can His judgment be desirable? Considering we shall have to give account for every idle word, shall we long for the day of judgment, in which we must undergo that ever-living fire, and those heavy penalties for cleansing the soul from its sins? Then will a sword pierce through the soul of Mary that the thoughts of many hearts may be revealed. If that Virgin which could compass GOD is to come into the severity of the judgment, who shall dare desire to be judged of GOD? Job, when he had finished his warfare with all calamities of man and had triumphed, who, when tempted, said, 'The LORD gave,' and confessed himself but [dust and] ashes when he heard GOD'S voice from the cloud, and determined that he ought not to speak another word. And who shall venture to desire GOD'S judgments, whose voice from heaven neither so great a Prophet endured, nor the Apostles again, when they were with the Lord in the Mount?"—Tract, in Ps. cxviii. (cxix.) lit. 3. § 12. vid. also § 5.

Again,

"He [John the Baptist] marks the season of our salvation and judgment in the LORD, saying, 'He shall baptize you with the HOLY GHOST and with fire;' for to those who are baptized in the HOLY GHOST it remains to be perfected in the fire of judgment."—Comm. in Matt. ii. § 4.

Let us now proceed to Origen, who is historically the first who has put forward the theory under review. Even Origen, be it remembered, is at first alleged by Bellarmine, though afterwards absolutely relinquished. His words, as quoted by that author himself, are as follows:

"I consider that even after the resurrection from the dead, we need a sacrament to wash us thoroughly and cleanse us; for no one will rise without dross upon him, nor can the soul be found which at once is free from all defects."—Hom. 14. in Luc.

Again,

"We must all come to that fire, be we Paul or Peter," in Ps. xxxvii.

Lactantius expresses the same, or almost the same doctrine in the following passage, as referred to by Bellarmine.

"Moreover, when He shall have judged the just, He will also try them in the fire. Then they

whose sins prevail in weight or number, will be tortured in the fire and partially burned; but they, who are mature in righteousness and ripeness of virtue, shall not feel that flame; for they have somewhat of GOD within them, to repel and throw off the force of the flame. Such is the force of innocence, that from it that fire recoils without mischief, as having received this property from GOD to burn the irreligious, to recede from the righteous.”—Div. Inst. vii. 21.

Two more writers may be mentioned, as holding the same view, both of whom are quoted by Bellarmine in his favour. St. Jerome, as referred to by him, speaks as follows:

“The fire,” he says, commenting on Amos vii. 4, “being called for judgment, devours first the deep; that is, all kinds of sins, wood, hay, stubble, and afterwards consumes also a part, that is, reaches to his saints, who are accounted the LORD’S portion.”

St. Paulinus of Nola is the other, who thus writes to Severus:

“If we attain by these works to be citizens with the saints, our works shall not be burned; and that sagacious fire will, on our passing its ordeal, surround us with no severe heat of punishment; but as if we were commended to its care it will play around us with a kind caress, so that we may say, ‘We have passed through fire and water,’ &c.”—Ep. 28. (9.)

To these passages, others similar might be added from St. Basil and St. Gregory Nazianzen.

So much on this speculation or foreboding concerning the fire of the last judgment. Before proceeding to consider the second notion of a Purgatory, which existed in the early Church, I stop to make a remark. What has been said will illustrate what is meant by Catholic Tradition, and how it may be received without binding us to accept every thing which the Fathers say. It must be *Catholic* to be of authority; that is, all the writers who mention the subject, must agree together in their view of it, or the exceptions, if there be any, must be such as *probare regulam*. And again, they must profess it *is* Traditionary teaching. For instance, supposing all the Fathers agreed together in their interpretation of a certain text, I consider that agreement would invest that interpretation with such a degree of authority, as to make it at first sight most rash (to say the very least) to differ from them; yet it is conceivable that on some points, as the interpretation of unfulfilled prophecy, they might be mistaken. It is abstractedly conceivable, that a modern commentator *might* on certain occasions plausibly justify his dissent from them:—this is conceivable, I say, *unless* they were explaining a doctrine of the Creed, which is otherwise known to come from the Apostles,—or professed, (which would be equivalent) that such an interpretation had ever been received in their respective Churches as coming from the Apostles. Catholic Tradition is something more than Catholic teaching. Great as is the authority of the latter, (and we cannot well put it too high,) Tradition is something beyond it. This remark is in point here, for it might be objected that so many Fathers agree together in the notion of a last-day Purgatory, that, were it not for the accident of others speaking differently, we should certainly have received it as Catholic Tradition. I answer, no; whatever the worth of so many witnesses would have been, and it certainly for safety’s sake ought to have been taken for very much,—still, Origen, Hilary, Ambrose, and the rest, do not approximate in their remarks to the authoritative language in which they would speak of the Trinity or the benefits of Baptism. They do not profess to be delivering an article of the Faith once delivered to the saints.—Now, to consider the second theory in the early Church on the subject of Purgatory.

While the Greek Churches, and thence the Italian held the doctrine of a judgment Purgatory, a doctrine far more like the Roman is found from an early age in the African Church; at the same time, it was so far from being considered as a necessary article of faith, that even St. Austin, who brings it out most fully, expresses his doubt about its truth. It was in fact only an opinion or conjecture.

Tertullian speaks thus, when discussing the question, whether souls suffer in the intermediate

state, or wait till the resurrection of the body:

"In short, considering we understand that prison, which the Gospel discloses, to be the places under the earth (inferos), and, explain the very last farthing to mean, that every slightest fault is then to be washed away in the interval before the resurrection, no one will doubt that the soul pays something in those nether places without intrenching on the fulness of the resurrection also through the flesh."—De Anim. fin.

Next comes St. Cyprian. Cyprian is arguing in favour of readmitting the lapsed, when penitent, and his argument seems to be, that it does not follow we absolve them simply, by restoring them to the Church; we do but admit them to present privileges, the judgment being reserved in GOD'S hands. He thus writes to Antonianus.

"Neither suppose, dearest brother, that the virtue of the brethren will be impaired, or martyrdoms fail, though penitence be indulged to the lapsed, and hope of reconciliation set before the penitent. Strength unmoveable abides with those who have true faith; and to those who fear and love GOD with their whole heart, integrity endures in firmness and in courage. Even to adulterers a period of penitence is granted by us, and reconciliation allowed; yet not on that account does virginity decline in the Church, or the glorious resolve of continence languish through the sins of others. The Church is still embellished by the crown of so many virgins, and chastity and purity are as glorious as before; nor, though the adulterer is indulged with penitence and pardon, is the vigour of continence relaxed. It is one thing to stand for pardon, another to arrive safe at glory; one to be sent to prison, there to remain till the last farthing be paid; another to receive at once the reward of faith and virtue; one thing to be tormented for sin in long pain, and so to be cleansed, and to be purged a long while in the fire, another to have washed away all sin in martyrdom; one thing in short, to wait for the LORD'S sentence in the day of judgment, another at once to be crowned by Him."—Ep. 55. ad Antonian.

Rigaltius, Fell, and some others, understand this passage to refer to the penitential discipline of the Church which was imposed on the penitent; and, as far as the context goes, certainly no sense could be more apposite. Yet, if, I may venture on an opinion apart from such high authorities, the words in themselves seem to go beyond any mere ecclesiastical, though virtually divine censure, especially "*missum in carcerem*," and "*purgari diu igne*."

Further, the passage in Tertullian, weak in itself, for it was perhaps written after he was a Montanist, fixes a sense, though it rests for authority on Cyprian's language. Tertullian explains Cyprian; Cyprian sanctions Tertullian. It should be recollected, moreover, that Cyprian used to call Tertullian his Master; and the inference deducible from all this is greatly strengthened; when we come to consider the views of St. Austin, another African. At the same time it is worth noticing, the *occasion* and *manner* of St. Cyprian's statement, whatever it means. He will be found to speak conjecturally, and as if in disputation. He is *accounting* for a difficulty; as if he said,—"*You suppose that, should the lapsed be received, this makes it all one as if they had never fallen. Far from it; they do not receive an absolute pardon; they are reserved to the judgment of the great day. Had they endured and suffered martyrdom, they would have had their pardon sealed at once; as it is, it is uncertain, and who knows but in GOD'S judgments such a recompense is in store for them as will allow the Church to be merciful to them without GOD'S ceasing to be just?*"

St. Austin is lastly to be mentioned; who speaks neither in one uniform way, nor with one and the same degree of certainty. Sometimes he seems to hold the Greek opinion of the final purgatorial conflagration. In the following passage, after alluding to Abraham's sacrifice, (Gen. xv.) in which the beasts were divided, but not the birds, and "when the sun went down," "a smoking furnace and

a burning lamp passed between those pieces," and interpreting the birds of the spiritual members of the Church, and the beasts of carnal men, some of whom are within, some outside the Church, he says,

"The smoking furnace will come; for Abraham sat there till the evening, and then comes the great terror of the day of judgment. For the evening is the end of the world, and the furnace is the coming day of judgment. It went between those things which were already divided, separating them to the right and left. Thus there are certain carnal men who are yet in the Church's bosom, living according to their own way, who are in danger of seduction from heretics. While they remain carnal, they are divisible; He did not divide the birds, but the carnal are divided. 'I could not speak unto you as unto spiritual, but as unto carnal.' . . . Whoso shall remain such, and in a way of life suitable to the carnal, and yet has not receded from the bosom of the Church, not been seduced by heretics, so as to be divided off the other way, the furnace will come, nor will he be able to stand on the right without undergoing it. If then he would escape that furnace, let him be changed now into the turtle-dove and pigeon. Let him receive it, who can. But if not, but he shall have built on the foundation, wood, hay, stubble; that is, if he has heaped over the foundation of his faith worldly likings,—yet if CHRIST be there, so as to have the first place in his heart, above all other objects, such are endured, are suffered. The furnace shall come, and shall burn the wood, hay, and stubble; and 'he shall be saved, yet so as by fire.' This will the furnace do; separating off some to the left,—others it will in a manner strain off onto the right: but it did not divide the birds."—In Ps. civ. Sermon. iii. and de Civ. Dei, xvi. 24. vid. also, in Ps. vi. de Civ. Dei, xx. 25; xxi. 16, and in Gen. contr. Man. ii. 20 fin.

This is one notion St. Austin had of Purgatory; another was, that it would be of a certain duration, in proportion to the sins of each individual. Without asserting that this view is plainly inconsistent with the former, it fairly may be called a distinct one. The following passage will be found to contain it:

"Some suppose that those who do not renounce the name of CHRIST, and are baptized in his font in the Church, nor are cut off therefrom by any schism or heresy, whatever be their crimes, though neither washed away by penitence nor ransomed by alms, but persevered in obstinately to the last day of life, will yet be saved by fire, punished indeed according to the greatest of their excesses and wickednesses, but not with eternal fire . . . But since those clear and positive apostolical testimonies to the contrary (James ii. 14. 17. 1 Cor. vi. 9, &c.) cannot be false, the former obscure text concerning those who build on this foundation, which is CHRIST, not gold, silver, precious stones, but wood, hay, stubble, . . . must be so explained as not to contradict passages which are clear. Wood, then, hay, stubble, may naturally mean such desires of lawful things of this world as cannot be foregone without some pain of mind. But when that pain burns, if CHRIST abides in the heart as a foundation, so that nothing is preferred to him, and the man who feels the fire of that pain, had rather lose the things which he so loves than CHRIST, he is saved through fire . . . The trial of tribulation is a certain fire, of which Scripture speaks plainly in another place. 'Earthen vessels are proved by the furnace, and righteous men by the trial of tribulation.' That fire fulfils the Apostle's words in this life; for instance, should it befall two Christians, one caring for the things of GOD, how he may please GOD; that is, building upon the foundation of CHRIST, gold, silver, precious stones; the other caring for the things of the world, how he may please his wife, that is, building on the same foundation wood, hay, stubble; the work of the former is not burned away, for he has not loved things the loss of which would distress him; but the other's work is burned away, since those things are not lost without suffering which are possessed with

enjoyment. But since, when an alternative comes, he had rather lose them than CHRIST, nor from apprehension of losing such things renounces CHRIST, though he may feel a pain during the loss, yet he is 'saved so as by fire;' for though the loss of what he loved is a burning pain, yet it does not subvert or consume one who is secured by the firmness and indestructibility of his foundation. *Such a suffering too, it is not impossible may happen after this life;* and it is a fair question, whether it can be settled or not; viz. that some Christians, according to their love of the perishing goods of this world, attain salvation more slowly or speedily through a certain purgatorial fire; not such, however, of whom it is said, 'that they shall not inherit the kingdom of GOD,' unless they repent suitably, and gain remission of their crimes."—Enchirid. 68. 89. vid. also ad Dulcitium, § 6-13. de Fide et Operib. § 16.

In his *de Civitate Dei*, after speaking (as above noticed) of the fire at the judgment, he goes on to change its position in the course of the Divine Economy, and places it between death and the resurrection; yet still he observes his hesitating and conjectural tone.

"After the death of the body, until the arrival of that last day of condemnation and reward after the resurrection [of the body], should it be said that in this interval the spirits of the dead suffer a fire, such as they do not feel who had not habits and likings in the life of this body, which requires their wood, hay, and stubble to be burned up, but they feel who have not carried with them the like worldly tabernacles, whether these only, or how and then, or not then because here, though they experience the fire of transitory tribulation rescuing venial offences from damnation by consuming them, *I do not oppose, for perchance it is true.*"

He then proceeds to speak as before, of the other senses of the word *fire*, as used in the text, which affords matter for his inquiry.

And now the reader has before him the whole extent of Augustine's much-talked-of admissions in behalf of Purgatory; and he may see how hesitating and incomplete they are. It is remarkable that the passages on which Bellarmine chiefly relies, are rejected by the Benedictines as not Augustine's; so that Romanists, if they would use this celebrated Father in the controversy, must betake themselves to such as the two extracts last quoted, in which Augustine speaks but doubtfully, and which (it is remarkable) Bellarmine introduces, not in his own favour, but on an opponent's challenge, to explain, as if from their conjectural tone rather making against him. It really would appear, as if in the African Church, there had been no advance in definiteness of doctrine in this matter since the days of Cyprian; but that what was a speculation then, remained as little insisted on or settled when St. Austin wrote.

If it were necessary to add any other evidence, how little the Fathers knew on this mysterious subject, I might mention, that in one place St. Austin implies that the impenitent are in Purgatory; and that St. Jerome seems to say, all baptized persons, however they suffer in Purgatory, are eventually saved ²³.

I have now finished my account of what the early Fathers said about Purgatory; but very imperfect justice is done to the subject, till the reader is put into possession of those decisive testimonies of the Fathers the other way, (that is, in favour of the peace and rest of the intermediate state to true believers,) which will reduce the opinions already described to a mere conjecture, pious indeed and solemnly made, yet received one moment, and abandoned the next. Without determining whether the strict wording of the following passages be such as necessarily to exclude the doctrine of Purgatory, which is a poor way of seeking after what the fact really was, simply

²³Faber's Difficulties of Romanism, i. 12. This reference to Trevern is made on the authority of Mr. Faber.

consider whether persons who *practically held* that doctrine, who kept it simply before them as the whole truth and acted upon it, could possibly have written them.

Cyprian, on occasion of the famous plague of A.D. 252,

“Let him fear death, who has never been born anew of water and the Spirit, and is sold over to the flames of hell; him, who has not been given an interest in the cross and passion of CHRIST; who is to pass from temporal to the second death; whose departure from the world will be followed by the torments of eternal flame of punishment; who by a longer delay gains but a longer respite from pangs and groans. Many of our people are dying in this pestilence, that is, are delivered from the world; and what is truly a plague to Jews, heathen, and enemies of CHRIST, is to GOD’S servants an end bringing salvation. That you witness righteous and wicked dying together without any distinction of man from man, is no reason for your supposing that destruction is common to good and evil; *the righteous are called to a place of refreshment, the wicked are hurried to punishment*, shelter is promptly afforded to the believing, punishment to infidels. We are undiscerning and ungrateful, well-beloved brethren, in return for GOD’S benefits, nor do we recognise the mercy vouchsafed to us. Lo! the virgins depart in peace safe, and with their glory secured, without the dread of the threats, the seductions, and the impurities of approaching Anti-Christ; youths escape the perils of their anxious age, and happily receive the prize of continence and chastity; the delicate matron no more fears the tortures, the fury of persecution, the violent hands and the cruelties of the executioner, receiving the gain of a speedy death. By fear of the pestilence the lukewarm are kindled, the languid are braced, the slothful are roused, deserters are driven back, the heathen are constrained to believe; *the multitude of those who are already believers is called to peace*; recruits are collected in abundance and with increased strength, prepared to fight without fear of death, when the action comes on, as having joined in a season when death was busy.”—De Mortal. 9.

“Our brethren should not cause us sorrow, whom the LORD’S call has delivered from the world, knowing as we do that they are not lost to us but sent before us, they do not recede, but precede: we should behave as towards men going a journey or a voyage, regret but not deplore them, nor go into mourning *for those who have already put on white raiment*,” &c.—Ibid. 14.

“It is not an exit, but a passage, a travelling to things eternal, when time has been journeyed through. *Who would not hasten to what is better?*”—Ibid. 15.

That in this last passage St. Cyprian is speaking of heavenly felicity after the resurrection, is certain from the context; but it is as plain that he looks upon the intermediate state as the beginning of it, or the out-post, which he could not do, unless he thought that at least, on the whole, and to the generality, it was a state of rest and peace.

St. Ambrose:

“Death is in every way a good; because it puts away those principles in us which war against each other, and because it is *a sort of harbour for those* who after tossing on the wide sea of this life, *seek for an anchorage of secure peace*; and because it puts an end to the chance of deterioration, but, as it finds a man in that condition it consigns him to the future judgment, and comforts him with the rest itself, and withdraws him from such present goods as raise envy, and quiets him with the expectation of the future.”—De Bono Mortis, 4.

“Unwise persons fear death as the greatest of ills; but the wise desire, *as if a rest after toil, and the end of ills*.”—Ibid. 8.

“Relying on these considerations, let us betake ourselves courageously to our Redeemer JESUS; courageously to the council of Patriarchs, to our father Abraham, when our day shall arrive; courageously to that holy assembly and congregation of the just. We shall go to our fathers, to our

preceptors in the faith, so that, though our works fail us, our faith may succour us, our birthright plead for us. We shall go where holy Abraham opens his arms to receive the poor, as he received Lazarus; where they rest who in this life have endured heavy and sharp inflictions . . . We shall go to those, who sit down in the kingdom of GOD with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, because when asked to supper they did not excuse themselves. We shall go thither, where there is a paradise of delight, where Adam, who fell among thieves, has forgotten to lament his wounds, where too the thief himself rejoices in the fellowship of the kingdom of heaven; *where are no clouds*, where no thunder, no lightning, no storm of wind, no darkness, no evening, no summer, no winter will vary the seasons. There will be no cold, hail, rain, nor the presence of this sun, moon, or stars; but the brightness of Light will alone shine forth.”—Ibid. 12.

St. Hilary:

“The vengeance of hell overtakes us at once: and immediately we depart from the body, if we have so lived, we ‘perish from the right way.’ The rich and poor man in the Gospel show us this: the one placed by angels in the abode of the blessed and in Abraham’s bosom, the other at once received into the place of punishment. So quickly did punishment come upon the dead, that even his brothers were still alive. There is no deferring or delaying there. For, as the day of judgment is the eternal award either of bliss or punishment, so the time of death orders the interval for every man by its own laws, committing every one to Abraham or to punishment till the judgment.”—In Psalm ii. § 48.

Nazianzen thus speaks on the death of his father:—

“There is but one life, to look forward towards life; and one death, even sin, which is the destruction of the soul. Whatever else men exult in, is but a vision in sleep in mockery of realities, and a phantom seducing the soul. If these be our feelings, O my Mother, we shall neither exult in life, nor be much distressed at death. What heavy misfortune has befallen us, if we have passed hence to the true life, released from meat and drink, from dizzinesses, from surfeiting, from base money-getting, and placed amid stable not transitory possessions, as lesser lights, circling in festive dance round the Great Luminary?”—Orat. 19. fin.

Macarius, in answer to the question what shall become of those who have two principles, of sin and grace, within them, answers that they will go to that place on which their heart is stayed: for

“The LORD, beholding thy mind, that thou lightest and lovest Him with thy whole soul, separateth death from thy soul in one hour, (for it is not for him to do so,) and receiveth thee unto His bosom and to light. For He snatcheth thee in an hour’s turn from the mouth of darkness, and forthwith translates thee into His kingdom. For to GOD all things are easy to do in an hour’s turn, so that thou hast the love of Him.”—Hom. 26.

The hour’s space spoken of seems to imply that the hour of death would supply the necessary purification of the soul from sin²⁴; but, whatever it means, the passage is quite irreconcilable with the Roman tenet, for the *state* of the dead is made one of bliss, and that “forthwith” upon death. The following passage is to the same effect; after saying that the guilty soul is upon death carried away by the devil, he proceeds,

“When they” (the righteous) “depart from the body, the choirs of angels receive their souls to their own place, to the pure world, and so bring them to the LORD.”—Hom. 22.

St. Jerome:

“Let the dead be bewailed, but it must be he whom hell receives, whom the pit swallows up,

²⁴Faber’s Difficulties of Romanism, i. 12. This reference to Trevern is made on the authority of Mr. Faber.

for whose punishment the everlasting fire is in motion. We, whose departure a crowd of angels accompanies, whom CHRIST goes out to meet, let us rather feel distress, if we have longer to dwell in this tabernacle of death, for as long as we delay here, we are pilgrims from the LORD.”—Ep. 25.

So much on the theology of the first five hundred years. But it may be shown that not even Pope Gregory at the end of that period, held the doctrine of Purgatory in the modern Roman form of it. He seems to have gone little further than maintain the Greek notion of the fire of judgment, as above explained, but, from the circumstance of his considering the end of the world close at hand, he so expressed himself as to give it a different character. Nothing has been more common in every age than to think the day of judgment approaching; and perhaps it was intended that the Church should ever so suppose. Perhaps so to suppose is even a mark of a Christian mind; which at least will ever be on its watch-tower, to see whether it be coming or no, from desire of its SAVIOUR’S return. But any how, as at other times, so in St. Gregory’s case, this expectation prevailed; and, as thinking that the end was all but arrived, he seems to have fancied that “fire upon earth” was almost “kindled,” that last judicial and purgatorial trial, which the Greeks and some of the Latins had made attendant upon it. If then he speaks of Purgatory in language since adopted by Romanism, it was not as intending thereby to sanction the idea to which it is appropriated in that theology, viz. that of a regular and ordinary *system* of fiery cleansing in the intermediate state; but, because he imagined the world was on the eve and under the incipient symptoms of an extraordinary crisis, when the sun was to be darkened, and the earth dissolved, and the graves opened, and all souls to be judged which were in earth and under the earth. He says,

“As, when night is ending and day beginning, before the sun rises there is a sort of twilight, while the remains of the departing darkness are changing perfectly into the radiance of the day which succeeds, so the end of this world is already mingling with the commencement of the next, and the very gloom of what remains has begun to be illuminated with the incoming of things spiritual.”—Dial. iv. 41.

To the same effect, he puts into the mouth of Peter the Deacon, the following words: —

“Why is it, I ask, that in these last times so many things *begin to be clear* about souls which before were hidden; so that by open revelations and disclosures the age to come seems forcing itself on us and to be dawning?”—Ibid. 40.

Conformably with this view, he considered the pains of Purgatory to be diverse and various in their modes and circumstances, in this earth as well as under the earth, and consisting in other torments as well as those of fire, being but the pangs and shudderings of intellectual natures, when their Judge was approaching, and disclosing themselves in a supernatural agony parallel to that trembling of the earth or the failing of the sun, which will precede the dissolution of the physical world. Occasion has already been taken to speak of the belief in visions and miracles, as occurring in attestation of the doctrine, and of the predispositions of the popular mind to receive it. The state of the evidence, of the popular feeling, and of the doctrine itself, is strikingly set before the reader in the following passage of Bishop Jeremy Taylor, though perhaps with somewhat less of considerateness in the wording of it, than such a subject might bear.

“The people of the Roman Communion have been principally led into belief of Purgatory by their fear, and by their credulity; they have been softened and enticed into this belief, by perpetual tales and legends, by which they loved to be abused. To this purpose, their priests and friars have made great use of the apparition of St. Jerome, after death, to Eusebius, commanding him to lay his sack upon the corpse of three dead men, that they, arising from death, might confess Purgatory, which formerly they, had denied. The story is written in an epistle imputed to St. Cyril; but the ill

luck of it was, that St. Jerome outlived St. Cyril, and wrote his life, and so confuted that story; but all is one for that, they believe it nevertheless; but these are enough to help it out and if they be not firmly true, yet if they be firmly believed, all is well enough. In the *Speculum Exemplorum* it is said, that a certain priest, in an ecstasy, saw the soul of Constantinus Turritanus in the eaves of his house, tormented with frosts and cold rains, and afterwards climbing up to heaven upon a shining pillar. And a certain monk saw some souls roasted upon spits, like pigs, and some devils basting them with scalding lard; but a while after, they were carried to a cool place, and so proved Purgatory. But Bishop Theobald standing upon a piece of ice to cool his feet, was nearer Purgatory than he was aware, and was convinced of it, when he heard a poor soul telling him, that under that ice he was tormented; and that he should be delivered if for thirty days continual he would say for him thirty masses. And some such thing was seen by Conrade and Udelric in a pool of water: for the place of Purgatory was not yet resolved on, till St. Patrick had the key of it delivered to him; which, when one Nicholas borrowed of him, he saw as strange and true things there, as ever Virgil dreamed of in his Purgatory, or Cicero in his dream of Scipio, or Plato in his Gorgias, or Phædo, who indeed are the surest authors to prove Purgatory. But, because to preach false stories was forbidden by the Council of Trent, there are yet remaining more certain arguments, even revelations made by angels, and the testimony of St. Odilio himself, who heard the devil complain ... that the souls of dead men were daily snatched out of his hands, by the alms and prayers of the living; and the sister of St. Damianus being too much pleased with hearing of a piper, told her brother, that she was to be tormented for fifteen days in Purgatory.

“We do not think that the wise men in the Church of Rome believe these narratives; for if they did, they were not wise; but this we know, that by such stories the people were brought into a belief of it, and having served their turn of them, the master builders used them as false arches and centres, taking them away when the parts of the building were made firm and stable by authority. But even the better sort of them do believe them; or else they do worse, for they urge and cite the Dialogues of St. Gregory, &c.”—*Dissuasive from Popery*, part. i. ch. i. § 4.

Yet not even after Pope Gregory's times was the doctrine unhesitatingly received. Ussher (Answer ch. vi.) quotes the words of the Council of Aix la Chapelle in Charlemagne's time, near 250 years after Gregory, to the effect that there are “three ways in which sins are punished; two in this life, and the third in the life to come; that of the former one is the punishment with which the sinner, GOD inspiring, by penitence, takes vengeance on himself, the other the punishment which ALMIGHTY GOD inflicts; and that tile third is that of everlasting fire. He also quotes the author of the tracts *de Vanitate Sæculi*, and *de Rectitudine Catholicæ Conversationis*, wrongly ascribed to St. Austin; the former of which says, “Know that when the soul is separated from the body, presently it is either placed in paradise for its good works, or plunged into the bottom of hell for its sins:” and the latter, “The departing soul, which is invisible to eyes of flesh, is received by the angels, and placed either in Abraham's bosom, if it be faithful, or, if a sinner, in the keeping of the prison beneath, till the appointed day arrive for it to receive its own body again and give account of its works before the judgment seat of CHRIST, the true Judge.” Even in the days of Otto Frisingensis, A.D. 1146, the doctrine of Purgatory was considered but a private opinion, not an article of faith universally received; for he writes, “*Some affirm* there is in the unseen state a place of Purgatory, in which those who are to be saved are either troubled with darkness only, or are refined by the fire of expiation.”

However, without entering further into the history of the gradual reception of the doctrine, which, if the circumstances of its rise be clear, is unnecessary, even could it be given, I conclude this

head of the subject with one or two avowals on the part of Romanists confirmatory of what has been said.

As to the text of Scripture, we have the candid admission of the celebrated M. Trevern, present Bishop of Strasburgh, that it is silent as regards this doctrine, at least so Mr. Faber understands him.

"Instead of vainly labouring to establish the doctrine on some one or two misinterpreted texts of the New Testament, he fairly and honestly confesses, that we have received no revelation concerning it from JESUS CHRIST. Hence he judiciously wastes not his time in adducing passages of Holy Writ, which are altogether irrelevant. 'Had it been necessary for us,' says he, 'to be instructed in such questions, JESUS would doubtless have revealed the knowledge of them. He has not done so. We can, therefore only form conjectures on the subject more or less probable.'" ²⁵

It seems then the doctrine is not taught in *Scripture*. The silence of *Antiquity* concerning it is avowed by Fisher, Bishop of Rochester, Alphonsus a de Castro, and Polydore Virgil.

Of these the celebrated Cardinal Fisher speaks as follows:

"It weighs perhaps with many, that we lay such stress upon indulgences, which are apparently of but recent usage in the Church, not being found among Christians till a very late date. I answer, that it is not clear from whom the tradition of them originated. They are said not to be without precedent among the Romans from the most ancient times; as may be understood from the numerous stations in that city. Moreover Gregory the First is said to have granted some in his own time. We all indeed are aware, that by means of the acumen of later times many things both from the Gospels and the other Scriptures are now more clearly developed and more exactly understood than they once were; whether it was that the ice was not yet broken by the ancients, and their times were unequal to the task of accurately sounding the open sea of Scripture, or that it will ever be possible in so extensive a field, let the reapers be ever so skilful, to glean somewhat after them. For there are even now a great number of obscure passages in the Gospel, which I doubt not posterity will understand much better. Why should we despair of it when the Gospel is given for this very purpose, to be understood thoroughly and exactly? Seeing then that the love of CHRIST towards His Church continues not less strong now than before, nor His power less, and that the HOLY GHOST is her perpetual guardian and restorer, whose gifts flow into her as unceasingly and abundantly as from the beginning, who can question that the minds of posterity will be enlightened unto the clear knowledge of those things which remain still unknown in the Gospel?"

After a sentence or two, he adds:

"Whoever reads the commentaries of the ancient Greeks, will find no mention, as far as I see, or the slightest possible concerning Purgatory. Nay, even the Latins did not all at once, but only gradually, enter into the truth of this matter . . . For a while it was unknown, at a late date it was known, to the Church Universal. Then it was believed by some, by little and little, partly from Scripture, partly from revelations."—Assert. Luther. Confutat. 18.

It will be observed how accurately Bishop Fisher's words bear out, as far as they go, our foregoing account. First, he candidly gives up the Greek Church, and almost gives up the Latin. He says it was gradually introduced, that at length it became universal. What can we desire more in disproof of the Roman doctrine? He implies too, that the doctrine, though not suggested by the plain text of Scripture, was recommended by it, when once suggested in whatever way; as if what it did, was just what has been above supposed, viz. bring out in a touching way a certain possible

²⁵Faber's *Difficulties of Romanism*, i. 12. This reference to Trevern is made on the authority of Mr. Faber.

deep sense which the sacred text could not be said to teach but might contain; else why should it be understood only after a long delay? Further, he illustrates and confirms what has above been observed, that the Church of Rome, relying on its supposed gift of enunciating the truth, cares not to *prove* its doctrines ancient, and rather interprets the Fathers by its present teaching than thinks it necessary to depend upon them. And lastly, he is a witness that, as far as Rome has cared to argue in this matter, she has rested the doctrine on *revelations*;—a true and honest account of the matter of fact, but decidedly opposed to the more accurate, though inapplicable, theory established after his death at Trent, which is this, that the revelation was concluded once for all in the Apostles, that all that the Church does is to discriminate and define their doctrine, and that he is Anathema, though an angel from heaven, who adds to it. “That alone is matter of faith,” says Bellarmine, “which is revealed by GOD either mediately or immediately; but divine revelations are *partly written partly unwritten*. The decrees of Councils, and Popes, and the consent of Doctors, . . . *then only* make a doctrine an article of faith, when they *explain the Word of God or deduce* any thing from it.” ²⁶

Polydore Virgil appeals to Fisher’s statement as above given, and adds, “Moreover by the Greeks, even to this day, the doctrine is not believed.” Alphonsus de Castro says, “Concerning Purgatory there is scarcely any mention, especially among the Greek writers; for which reason, even to this day, it is not believed by the Greeks.” ²⁷

Lastly, the following is the avowal of the Benedictine Editor of St. Ambrose’s Works in his preface to the *de Bono Mortis*, on certain passages concerning the state of the dead, some of which have been above extracted in the course of these remarks.

“If we interpret the words of our author strictly and literally, we must plainly confess that in his judgment souls are kept shut up in certain dwellings till the general resurrection, and there wait the award due to their deeds, which will not however be paid them before the last day; meanwhile that they are visited with some good or punishment, according as each of them has deserved. Lastly, the joy of the righteous is dispensed according to certain ranks.

“It is not surprising that Ambrose should have written in this way concerning the state of souls; but what might seem almost incredible, is, the uncertainty and inconsistency of the Holy Fathers on the subject from the very times of the Apostles down to the Pontificate of Gregory XI. and the Council of Florence, that is, for nearly the whole of fourteen centuries. For, not only do they differ one from the other, as commonly happens in such questions not yet defined by the Church, but they are not even consistent with themselves, sometimes appearing to grant that those souls enjoy the clear sight of the divine nature, of which at other times they deprive them.”

§ 4. The Council of Florence

It remains to give a brief notice of the Council of Florence, by which the doctrine of Purgatory was first made an article of faith. With it I shall bring this paper to an end.

The Council of Constance, which had been summoned principally with a view to the reformation of the clergy, terminated in April 1418, without having taken any effectual measures for their object. Five years afterwards the remonstrance which the existing state of things occasioned, obliged the then Pope Martin V. to summon another, which, in consequence of his sudden death, eventually opened at Basle, 23d of July, 1431, in the pontificate of Eugenius, under the presidency of Cardinal Julian Cæsarini. Basle, as being across the Alps, was removed from the influence of the Roman see: and the Fathers assembled at once applied themselves to determine a question, which had already

²⁶Bellarm. de Purg. i. 15.

²⁷These three passages are from Taylor’s Dissuasive, part 2. ii. 2.

been agitated at Constance, the superiority, viz. of a General Council to the Pope. They passed a decree that the jurisdiction of the representatives of the Church Catholic in Council Assembled was supreme and universal, and that they could not be dissolved, prorogued, or transferred without their own consent. They proceeded to summon, threaten, and censure Eugenius; and at length when he resisted their proceedings, they suspended him from all his powers unless he submitted to them within 60 days. In these acts they were supported by the Emperor and other chief powers of Europe, as well as by the clergy; and the Pope was forced to submit.

They next attempted to reconcile the Greeks to the Latin Church. At this time Constantinople was much pressed by the Turkish arms; and the Emperor John Palæologus, the second of that name, after the example of his father, hoped by holding out the prospect of a union of the Churches to gain succours from the West. The Fathers of Basle invited him to attend their meeting with the Patriarch and other chief ecclesiastics of his division of Christendom; but, on his objecting to a journey across the Alps, an opening was afforded to Eugenius, who was not slow to avail himself of it, to propose to the Greeks to transfer the seat of the Council from the Rhine to Italy. In spite of the opposition of the Fathers at Basle, Eugenius was successful in his overtures. The Greek Emperor and ecclesiastics accepted the place of meeting which he proposed, which was Ferrara, and proceeded thither, that is, besides Palæologus himself, the Patriarch, and twenty chief bishops, among whom were the metropolitans of Heraclea, Cyzicus, Nice, Nicomedia, Ephesus, and Trebizond; representatives also attended from Alexandria, Antioch, and Jerusalem; and the Primate of Russia. Such were the members of the Greek Church present at this Council, who, however, high in station as they were, evidently were too few to express the voice of the East. It is well known that on the ancient principle of Councils, decisions were made not by authority, but by the independent and concordant testimony of all the Bishops of Christendom, or what was virtually all, to the doctrines declared. On the side of the Latins there were but five archbishops, eighteen bishops, and ten abbots, the greater part of whom were subjects or countrymen of the Pope. This scanty representation however of the Latin Church received, as it happened, a considerable reinforcement from Basle; for a reaction taking place there in the Pope's favour, some chief members of the rival Council coming over to him, the whole number of subscribers which he at last obtained to the synodical decree, amounted to eight cardinals, two patriarchs, eight archbishops, fifty-two bishops, and forty-five abbots. After all, however, these are at first sight scarcely to be considered representatives of the whole of Christendom; yet such was the composition of the assembly, known in history as the Council of Florence, (whither a plague had driven it from Ferrara) which established the doctrine of Purgatory.

This is a sketch of its external history: but the point to be considered is the part taken by the Greeks in its proceedings. At the first glance here is this circumstance, almost in itself decisive against its authority, that the Greeks were actuated by motives of interest, and at least by the influence and the presence of a Sovereign. Were they in number fifty times as many, they would not have appeared in Italy at all, had not the Ottomans been at the gates of Constantinople. Next they were unprotected in a strange country, depending even for their daily food on the bounty of those who were bent upon the reconciliation of the Churches; and they were detained by delays which, whether necessary or not, were sufficient to alarm them, and to make them impatient to bring their dispute to a termination. After the first session of the Council at Ferrara, the public proceedings were adjourned about six months. The Greek ecclesiastics were allowed each three or four gold florins a month; at one time there was an arrear of four months in the payment, at another of three, and at the time of their agreeing to unite with the Latins, of five and a half. Besides, even had they the means, their withdrawal from the Council was absolutely forbidden: passports were

required at the gates of Ferrara, the Venetian Government had engaged to intercept all fugitives, and civil punishment awaited them at Constantinople. Their condition is vividly described by Syropulus or Sguropulus, the ecclesiarch or preacher, who was present at the Council as one of the Patriarch's five attendants, and whose history of its proceedings is extant. Some extracts shall be introduced from his work; which, besides proving what I have said about the position of the Greeks, will introduce us in particular to the course taken in their discussions on the subject of Purgatory. There were four points of difference between the Churches: the use of leaven in the Eucharistic bread, the supremacy of the Pope, the nature of Purgatory, and the double procession of the Holy Ghost. Concerning the subject which alone here concerns us, Syropulus says,

"At our fourth meeting the bishop of Ephesus said, 'In our last meeting, venerable Fathers, you laid before us four heads for discussion, out of which we might take our choice . . . Julian (the legate of Eugenius at Basle) said . . . it seems to us best, to treat first of the purgatorial fire, that our own minds may be cleared by the discussion. Let us then now dispute upon this subject. The Bishop of Ephesus answered, Be it so as you have decided; but tell us first, whence has your Church her traditions about it, and when did she receive and profess it, and what is her exact doctrine on the subject. These inquiries will help us forward. This was agreed to, and we separated.

"Meanwhile our allowance of provisions was demanded, but not given us. Though we made frequent demands on account of our need, it was not given until we came into the proposed conditions. When we had come round, we received the second monthly allowance on the 12th of May.

"While we were so circumstanced, serious news kept coming that Amurath was preparing an attack upon Constantinople. The Venetians sent the despatches to our Emperor and the Patriarch; afterwards came letters from the city itself, intimating the same, and begging them to do their utmost to gain succours. On hearing this, we were sadly afflicted, were sick of life, prayed to GOD for help, took it to heart, and with groans and tears begged for some escape from so great a calamity . . . The Emperor had much talk with the Cardinals on this subject, and made representations through them to the Pope. We, indignant at their unbecoming conduct, betook ourselves to such private friends as we might have among them. When some of us had intreated in this way brother Ambrose, he said to them, 'Be not out of heart, *but do your utmost to bring about an union*, and then we shall make great preparations, and will send a formidable force to Constantinople.'

"Meanwhile some of our company said, that if a subscription for raising forces was proposed to our Archbishops, they would be ready according to their power. The Emperor catching at this, immediately went to the Patriarch, and called us all together, and made us a speech concerning contribution, saying that he himself had set the pattern by borrowing money to fit out a vessel of his own, that he felt confident the Pope would send some also, and that it was a duty in the case of those who had the means to be liberal in the service of their country. To this the principal Archbishops made answer, that were they in Constantinople, they would contribute even more than they could well afford; but, being at present in a foreign land, and not knowing what was coming upon them, they felt it necessary to keep what they had, even supposing some among them had any thing left; . . . however, under the necessity, they would each give something. Accordingly four of them promised 50 aspers apiece.

"The Bishop of Nicea (the celebrated Bessarion) said, 'I have no ducats, but I have three urns, of which I will contribute two.' The Bishop also who came next said, 'I have no ducats, but I have two woollen cloaks, and I give one of them.' The Emperor on hearing as far as this, gave up the attempt as vain, for he had reckoned that the Archbishops together might have almost fitted out one vessel

...

"In the fifth meeting, Julian began to discuss the subject of Purgatory, and said that the Roman Church, even from the very first, had received and held this doctrine, from the time of the Holy Apostles, receiving it from St. Peter and St. Paul, . . . and then from the Doctors of the Church who succeeded them."

To complete the imbecility of the Greek party, they were at variance with each other, Bessarion of Nicea inclining to the Latins, Gregory the Penitentiary taking either side as it happened, and both opposing Mark of Ephesus, the resolute defender of the Greek doctrines. The Latins having put their argument on paper, the Greeks had to do the same, and the Emperor commanded Mark to draw it up, who declined the office, unless it was understood that what he should present would be accepted. The following childish scene ensued, which is here introduced merely to show that the Greek cause was not fairly represented in that Council, since it was in the hands, as will be seen, of two rival Bishops and an Emperor as umpire, and not as if to imply that a Council must be composed of none but superior men in order to come to a right conclusion.

"It appeared proper that some among ourselves should stay with the Bishop of Ephesus, and that the paper should be drawn in our presence and hearing, and with our assistance, if it happened to be needed. Accordingly the Bishop of Nicea, the great Ecclesiarch" (the writer), "Gregory the Penitentiary, the Secretary of the Holy Consistory, met him. The Bishop of Nicea began to converse carelessly, and to digress into a variety of subjects. The Penitentiary followed, and rivalled him in the irrelevancy of his discourse. They took up each other, and emulated each other in wasting time on trifles and impertinences. I at intervals begged them to spare words and attend to the writing, but they persisted; when good part of the day was thus wasted, the Bishop of Ephesus said, 'At this rate I shall not be able to write a word: leave me with the Secretary of the Consistory, and I will draw up something. Afterwards you shall look over it, and correct any thing that is amiss?' On this we left the room. Then the Bishop of Ephesus began to write; but the Bishop of Nicea did the same, at the suggestion of the Penitentiary, who praised what he drew up to the Emperor, and wished him to send it to the Latins, as more striking in style, and more eloquent. At his command both compositions were brought to him, and read in the presence of select judges. Then the Emperor said to the Bishop of Ephesus, 'Your composition is good: it has many strong points. But it has some things too which will give advantage to the Latins, such as the story of St. Macarius asking the skull (of an idolater) and receiving an answer; for you can bring no unexceptionable testimony to this, and they will at once put it aside, and some other arguments also. Better let alone what can be easily met, and urge a little and strong than a parade of arguments, some of which may be easily upset, for your opponent will fix on your weak points, and if he masters you on one or two, he will appear to the many, or rather he will be heralded forth, as having defeated you altogether. Therefore put out these passages.' ... Then turning to the Bishop of Nicea, he remarked, 'You too have your own faults, you begin by saying, 'O men of Latium;' this is unsuitable. It is more becoming to say, 'Venerable Fathers,' or something of the same respectful and acceptable nature; you have other mistakes too.' He ended by saying that the proem and previous statements of the Bishop of Nicea were the better, but the course of the argument, the proofs, and collateral remarks, stronger in the paper of the Bishop of Ephesus; and that it seemed advisable to take the commencement of the former, and any other serviceable passages, and the body of the latter." ...

The reply thus compounded by two men of discordant sentiments was submitted to the Latins, and an answer drawn up to it in due form. A reply followed, and the discussion became animated.

"Meanwhile in private conversations the Latins begged the Bishop of Ephesus to propound plainly the doctrine which our Church holds concerning souls departed hence. *But he did not state*

it, being hindered by the Emperor. And in proportion as they perceived him resisting, and not wishing to set forth our Church doctrine on the matter, so much the more did they press him, and entreat him, and remonstrate with him, and asked what he meant by his reserve, saying, that every regular member of any Church was bound, when asked what was the Church's view on any question, at once to give it, without hesitation or ambiguity. But the Bishop had his mouth stopped by the royal command."

John, a Spanish Bishop, then entered into a discussion with the Bishop of Ephesus with great dialectic skill, and Bessarion deserted to the Latins; at length, however, the Emperor consented to Mark's speaking out, and he put the Latins into full possession of the Greek notions on the subject of Purgatory. The next sentences run as follows:—

"Our allowance was expended, and nothing more was given us in spite of our frequent demands: but, when we yielded to their demand, and told them our Church's opinion on the question in discussion, then they gave us three months' allowance on the 30th of June, 689 florins." 5. § 18.

This was all that passed on the subject of Purgatory, before the final decree, which, as in other points, so in this, was over-ruled by the determination of the Latins and the need of the Emperor. But here let me instance another hardship inflicted on the Greeks, for which I have already prepared the reader.

"We sat down in sorrow, not only because of existing and expected perils, but for the loss of liberty, for we were shut up as slaves. And when three months and more were passed, and all were indignant at our dependence upon strangers, the straits we were in, and our want of provision, ... three clerics, under the spur of necessity, found an escape ... But the Patriarch learning it, and being indignant at it, wrote at once to the Doge of Venice, who found out the men, and sent them to him."

After many months' discomfort from the causes that have been enumerated, the Greeks came to an understanding with the Latins: indeed, from the first, they had very little trust or attachment to their view. Their doctrine is said to have been, that the souls of imperfect Christians went to a place of darkness and sadness, where they were for some time in affliction and deprived of the light of GOD'S countenance, in which state they were benefited by Eucharistic offerings and by alms; to this the Latins wished to add, that souls without stain enter at once into heavenly glory, while those who have repented of sin, but have not had time to complete the necessary penance, are consigned for a longer or shorter time to purgatorial fire. This was the difference between the Churches, and they compromised the matter thus: the Latins did not press the doctrine of *fire*, and the Greeks gave up—not a word, but a truth,—they allowed, contrary to the belief with which they had come to the Council, that those who are not in Purgatory are immediately beatified, and enjoy the sight of GOD.

It may be objected, and readily admitted, that the narrative of which the above are extracts, is drawn up by a writer unfriendly and unfair to the Latins. But it would seem to prove as much as this, viz. what was the popular view in Greece on the subject of these discussions and their termination, immediately upon it.

A high ecclesiastic, as Syropulus was, would hardly have ventured to have set himself against a recent and solemn act of his own Church, sanctioned by the Court, unless he had had a strong feeling with him. The very fact of his opposition proves that the conduct of the Greeks at Florence was but the act of a party at most in the Church; while the line of the history, their sufferings and compelled decision, is too clearly guaranteed to us as true by the known circumstances of the case. But we need not thus painfully deduce the real dissatisfaction of the Greek Church with the articles

imposed upon its delegates at Florence. On their return home, they had to encounter so general an indignation and

resentment at their conduct, that they were obliged at once to recant and confess their weakness, and throw themselves on the mercy of their brethren. Mark of Ephesus had not signed the decree, and became a rallying point for all who held by the popular religion; while the successor of the Patriarch was deserted even by his cross-bearers, and presided in an empty Cathedral.

The feeling spread north and south; the patriarchs of Alexandria, Antioch, and Jerusalem assembled a numerous Council, and disowned the acts of their representatives in Italy; and Isidore, the Primate of Russia, on returning to his country, was synodically condemned and imprisoned in a monastery.

Again, it may be objected that the great article of difference between Greeks and Latins was the question of the Procession, not that of Purgatory, and after all, that the real point of repulsion between them lay in national jealousies; whereas they agreed together, as the Council shows, or at least with the slightest difference, on the question in which we are concerned, while the subsequent resentment of the Greeks at home had little or no reference to it; and that their agreement under such circumstances was only the more remarkable. It may be replied, that the object of the foregoing account has been to show that the Greeks at Florence were not trustworthy, that they had neither the ease of circumstances, the learning, or the composure of mind to be witnesses of the traditionary and universal doctrine of their Churches. If this is proved by after circumstances, by the popular indignation as regards one doctrine, it takes all credit from their testimony as regards another. Moreover as regards the doctrine of Purgatory, they did not agree with the Latins in an important point, yet that point they gave up to them; most unfaithfully, considering them as stewards of Gospel truth; and, had they discerned the bearings of the Latin doctrine, which doubtless they did not, most treacherously. They admitted, against the national belief, the beatification of souls under specific circumstances, before the judgment, and in so doing they admitted practically almost as much, as if they had subscribed to the doctrine of purgatorial fire. For, as the mention of fire on the one hand is definite, and ascertains Purgatory to be strictly a place of punishment, which the general expressions of the Greeks did not strictly imply, so in like manner to separate off from it all the perfected saints, and transfer them to a better and heavenly state, does in effect sink it, by the contrast, to a place of privation and suffering. The presence of the souls of all saints, (to speak in general terms, that is, not to include the Martyrs whom the early Church has excepted) in Hades, Paradise, or Abraham's bosom, or by whatever other name we designate the Intermediate State, is our guarantee for the substantial blessedness of that State. We cannot spare the higher Saints from Paradise, in that they are our pledges for its heavenly character in the case of all believers. Thus as regards their own doctrine, the Greeks made most important admissions to the Latins, for making which they had no warrant, and therefore cannot be considered of authority in witnessing a Purgatory at all, any more than in the account they gave of it.

And with these remarks shall terminate a discussion, which has extended far beyond the limits which were originally proposed by the writer.

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Daily Prayers

Preparation

1. Times of Prayer

Always. *Luke* xviii. 1.

Without ceasing. *1 Thes.* v. 17.

At all times. *Eph.* vi. 18.

Samuel among such as call upon His name ²⁸. *Ps.* xcix. 6.

GOD forbid that I should sin against the Lord in ceasing to pray for you and showing you the good and the right way. *1 Sam.* xii. 23.

We will give ourselves continually to prayer and to the ministry of the word. *Acts* vi. 4.

He kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed and gave thanks before his GOD, as he did aforetime. *Dan.* vi. 10.

In the evening, and morning, and at noon day will I pray, and that instantly, and He shall hear my voice. *Ps.* lv. 18.

Seven times a day do I praise Thee. *Ps.* cxix. 164.

1. In the morning, a great while before day. *Mark* i. 35.

2. In the morning watch. *Ps.* lxiii. 6. [vid. also *Ps.* cxxx. 6.]

3. The third hour of the day. *Acts* ii. 15.

4. About the sixth hour. *Acts* x. 9.

5. The hour of prayer, the ninth. *Acts* iii. 1.

6. The eventide. *Gen.* xxiv. 63. 7. By night. *Ps.* cxxxiv. 2.

At midnight. *Ps.* cxix. 62.

2. Places of Prayer

In all places where I record My Name, I will come to thee, and I will bless thee. *Exod.* xx. 24.

Let ²⁹ Thine eyes be open towards this house night and day, even toward the place of which Thou hast said, My Name shall be there; that Thou mayest hearken unto the prayer which Thy servant shall make towards this place. *1 Kings* viii. 29.

Thou that hearest the prayer
unto Thee shall all flesh come.

The fierceness of man shall turn to Thy praise,
and the fierceness of them shalt Thou refrain.

As for me, I will come into Thy house
even upon the multitude of Thy mercy,
and in Thy fear will I worship
toward Thy Holy Temple.

Hear the voice of my humble petitions,
when I cry unto Thee;

²⁸Transferred from p. 4 of Edition of 1675.

²⁹Transferred from pp. 5, 6, and 9, of Edition 1675.

when I hold up my hands
towards the mercy-seat of Thy Holy Temple.
We wait for Thy loving-kindness, O GOD,
in the midst of Thy Temple.

1. Among the faithful and in the congregation. *Ps. cxi. 1.*
2. Enter into thy closet and, when thou hast shut thy door,
pray to thy Father which is in secret. *Matt. vi. 6.*
3. They went up into an upper room. *Acts i. 13.*
4. He went up upon the housetop to pray. *Acts x. 9.*
5. They went up together into the Temple. *Acts iii. 1.*
6. We kneeled down on the shore, and prayed. *Acts xxi. 5.*
7. He went forth over the brook Cedron, where was a garden.
John xviii. 1.
8. Let them rejoice in their beds. *Ps. cxlix. 5.*
9. He departed into a desert place and there prayed. *Mark i. 35.*
10. In every place lifting up holy hands without wrath and doubting.
1 Tim. ii. 8.

3. Circumstances of Prayer

1. Kneeling, *humiliation.*

He kneeled down and prayed. *Luke xxii. 41.*

He went a little further, and fell on His face, and prayed.

Matt. xxvi. 39.

My soul is brought low, even unto the dust,
my belly cleaveth unto the ground.

2. Sinking the head, *shame.*

Drooping the face. [*Ezr. ix. 6.*]

3. Smiting the breast, [*Luke xviii. 13.*] *indignation.* *

4. Shuddering, [*Acts xvi. 29.*] *fear.* *

5. Groaning, [*Isai. lix. 11.*] *sorrow.* *

Clasping of hands.

6. Raising of eyes and hands, [*Ps. xxv. 15. cxliii. 6.*] *vehement desire.* *

7. Blows, [*Ps. lxxiii. 14.*] *revenge.* *

* *2 Cor. vii. 11.*

Order of Matin Prayer

Litany.

Glory be to Thee, O LORD, glory to Thee.

Glory to Thee who givest me sleep

to recruit my weakness,

and to remit the toils

of this fretful flesh.

To this day and all days,

a perfect, holy, peaceful, healthy, sinless course,

Vouchsafe O LORD.

The Angel of peace, a faithful guide,

guardian of souls and bodies,

to encamp around me,

and ever to prompt what is salutary,

Vouchsafe O LORD.

Pardon and remission

of all sins and of all offences

Vouchsafe O LORD.

To our souls what is good and convenient,

and peace to the world

Vouchsafe O LORD.

Repentance and strictness

for the residue of our life,

and health and peace to the end,

Vouchsafe O LORD.

Whatever is true, whatever is honest,

whatever just, whatever pure,

whatever lovely, whatever of good report,

if there be any virtue, if any praise,

such thoughts, such deeds,

Vouchsafe O LORD.

A Christian close,

without sin, without shame,

and, should it please Thee, without pain,

and a good answer

at the dreadful and fearful judgment-seat

of JESUS CHRIST our LORD,

Vouchsafe O LORD.

Confession.

Essence beyond essence, Nature increate,

Framer of the world,

I set Thee, LORD, before my face,

and I lift up my soul unto Thee.

I worship Thee on my knees,

and humble myself under Thy mighty hand.
 I stretch forth my hands unto Thee,
 my soul gaspeth unto Thee as a thirsty land.
 I smite on my breast
 and say with the Publican,
 GOD be merciful to me a sinner,
 the chief of sinners;
 to the sinner above the Publican,
 be merciful as to the Publican.
 Father of mercies,
 I beseech Thy fatherly affection,
 despise me not
 an unclean worm, a dead dog, a putrid corpse,
 despise not Thou the work of Thine own hands,
 despise not Thine own image
 though branded by sin.
 LORD, if Thou wilt, Thou canst make me clean,
 LORD, only say the word, and I shall be cleansed.
 And Thou, my SAVIOUR CHRIST,
 CHRIST my SAVIOUR,
 SAVIOUR of sinners, of whom I am chief,
 despise me not, despise me not, O LORD,
 despise not the cost of Thy blood,
 who am called by Thy Name;
 but look on me with those eyes
 with which Thou didst look upon
 Magdalen at the feast,
 Peter in the hall,
 the thief on the wood;—
 that with the thief I may call on Thee humbly,
 Remember me, LORD, in Thy kingdom;
 that with Peter I may bitterly weep and say,
 O that mine eyes were a fountain of tears
 that I might weep day and night;
 that with Magdalen I may hear Thee say,
 Thy sins be forgiven thee,
 and with her to love much,
 for many sins yea manifold
 have been forgiven me.
 And Thou, All-holy, Good, and Life-giving Spirit,
 despise me not, Thy breath,
 despise not Thine own holy things;
 but turn Thee again, O LORD, at the last,
 and be gracious unto Thy servant.
Commendation.

Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
Our GOD,
the GOD of our Fathers;
who turnest the shadow of death into the morning;
and lightenest the face of the earth;
who separateth darkness from the face of the light
and banishest night and bringest back the day;
who lightenest mine eyes,
that I sleep not in death;
who deliverest me from the terror by night,
from the pestilence that walketh in darkness;
who drivest sleep from mine eyes,
and slumber from mine eyelids;
who makest the outgoings of the morning and evening
to praise Thee;
because I laid me down and slept and rose up again,
for the LORD sustained me;
because I waked and beheld,
and my sleep was sweet unto me.
Blot out as a thick cloud my transgressions,
and as a cloud my sins;
grant me to be a child of light, a child of the day,
to walk soberly, holily, honestly, as in the day,
vouchsafe to keep me this day without sin.
Thou who upholdest the falling and liftest the fallen,
let me not harden my heart in provocation,
or temptation or deceitfulness of any sin.
Moreover, deliver me today
from the snare of the hunter
and from the noisome pestilence;
from the arrow that flieth by day,
from the sickness that destroyeth in the noon day.
Defend this day against my evil,
against the evil of this day defend Thou me.
Let not my days be spent in vanity,
nor my years in sorrow.
One day telleth another,
and one night certifieth another.
O let me hear Thy loving-kindness betimes in the morning,
for in Thee is my trust;
show Thou me the way that I should walk in,
for I lift up my soul unto Thee.
Deliver me O LORD, from mine enemies,
for I flee unto Thee.
Teach me to do the thing that pleaseth Thee,

for Thou art my GOD;
let Thy loving SPIRIT lead me forth
into the land of righteousness.
Quicken me, O LORD, for Thy Name's sake,
and for Thy righteousness' sake
bring my soul out of trouble;
remove from me foolish imaginations,
inspire those which are good
and pleasing in Thy sight.
Turn away mine eyes
lest they behold vanity;
let mine eyes look right on,
and let mine eyelids look straight before me.
Hedge up mine ears with thorns
lest they incline to undisciplined words.
Give me early the ear to hear,
and open mine ears to the instruction of Thy oracles.
Set a watch, O LORD, before my mouth,
and keep the door of my lips.
Let my word be seasoned with salt,
that it may minister grace to the hearers.
Let no deed be grief unto me
nor offence of heart.
Let me do some work
for which Thou wilt remember me, LORD, for good,
and spare me according to the greatness of Thy mercy.
Into Thine hands I commend
my spirit, soul, and body,
which Thou hast created, redeemed, regenerated,
O LORD, Thou GOD of truth;
and together with me
all mine and all that belongs to me.
Thou hast vouchsafed them to me,
LORD, in Thy goodness.
Guard us from all evil,
guard our souls,
I beseech Thee, O LORD.
Guard us without falling,
and place us immaculate
in the presence of Thy glory
in that day.
Guard my going out and my coming in
henceforth and for ever.
Prosper, I pray Thee, Thy servant this day,
and grant him mercy

in the sight of those who meet him.
O GOD, make speed to save me,
O LORD, make haste to help me.
O turn Thee then unto me,
and have mercy upon me;
give Thy strength unto Thy servant,
and help the son of Thine handmaid.
Show some token upon me for good,
that they who hate me may see it and be ashamed,
because Thou, LORD, hast holpen me
and comforted me.

Order of Evening Prayer

30

Meditation.

The day is gone,
and I give Thee thanks, O LORD.

Evening is at hand,
furnish it with brightness.

As day has its evening
so also has life;
the even of life is age,
age has overtaken me,
furnish it with brightness.

Cast me not away in the time of age;
forsake me not when my strength faileth me.

Even to my old age be Thou HE,
and even to hoar hairs carry me;
do Thou make, do Thou bear,
do Thou carry and deliver me.

Abide with me, LORD,
for it is toward evening,
and the day is far spent
of this fretful life.

Let Thy strength be made perfect
in my weakness.

Day is fled and gone,
life too is going,
this lifeless life.

Night cometh,
and cometh death,
the deathless death.

Near as is the end of day,
so too the end of life.

We then, also remembering it,
beseech of Thee
for the close of our life,
that Thou wouldest direct it in peace,
Christian, acceptable,
sinless, shameless,
and, if it please Thee, painless,
LORD, O LORD,
gathering us together
under the feet of Thine Elect,
when Thou wilt, and as Thou wilt

³⁰Page 196, edit. 1675.

only without shame and sins.
 Remember we the days of darkness,
 for they shall be many,
 lest we be cast into outer darkness.
 Remember we to outstrip the night
 doing some good thing.
 Near is judgment;—
 a good and acceptable answer
 at the dreadful and fearful judgment-seat
 of JESUS CHRIST
 vouchsafe to us, O LORD.
 By night I lift up my hands in the sanctuary,
 and praise the LORD.
 The LORD hath granted His loving-kindness
 in the day time;
 and in the night season did I sing of Him,
 and made my prayer unto the GOD of my life.
 As long as I live will I magnify Thee on this manner,
 and lift up my hands in Thy Name.
 Let my prayer be set forth in Thy sight
 as the incense,
 and let the lifting up of my hands
 be an evening sacrifice.
 Blessed art Thou, O LORD, our GOD,
 the GOD of our fathers,
 who hast created the changes of days and nights,
 who givest songs in the night,
 who hast delivered us from the evil of this day,
 who hast not cut off like a weaver my life,
 nor from day even to night made an end of me.
Confession.
 LORD,
 as we add day to day,
 so sin to sin.
 The just falleth seven times a day;
 and I, an exceeding sinner,
 seventy times seven,
 a wonderful, a horrible thing, O LORD.
 But I turn with groans
 from my evil ways,
 and I return into my heart,
 and with all my heart I turn to Thee,
 O GOD of penitents and Saviour of sinners;
 and evening by evening I will return
 in the innermost marrow of my soul;

and my soul out of the deep
 crieth unto Thee.
 I have sinned, O LORD, against Thee,
 heavily against Thee;
 alas, alas, woe is me! for my misery.
 I repent, O me! I repent, spare me, O LORD,
 I repent, O me, I repent,
 help Thou my impenitence.
 Be appeased, spare me, O LORD;
 be appeased, have mercy on me:
 I said, LORD, have mercy upon me,
 heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee.
 Have mercy upon me, O LORD, after Thy great goodness,
 according to the multitude of Thy mercies
 do away mine offences.
 Remit the guilt,
 heal the wound,
 blot out the stains,
 clear away the shame,
 rescue from the tyranny,
 and make me not a public example.
 O bring Thou me out of my trouble,
 cleanse Thou me from secret faults,
 keep back Thy servant also from presumptuous sins.
 My wanderings of mind
 and idle talking
 lay not to my charge.
 Remove the dark and muddy flood
 of foul and wicked thoughts.
 O LORD,
 I have destroyed myself;
 whatever I have done amiss, pardon mercifully.
 Deal not with us after our sins,
 neither reward us after our iniquities.
 Look mercifully upon our infirmities;
 and for the glory of Thy All-holy Name,
 turn from us all those ills and miseries,
 which by our sins, and by us through them,
 are most righteously and worthily deserved.
Commendation.
 To my weariness, O LORD,
 vouchsafe Thou rest,
 to my exhaustion
 renew Thou strength.
 Lighten mine eyes that I sleep not in death.

Deliver me from the terror by night,
the pestilence that walketh in darkness.
Supply me with healthy sleep,
and to pass through this life without fear.
O keeper of Israel,
who neither slumberest nor sleepest,
guard me this night from all evil,
guard my soul, O LORD.
Visit me with the visitation of Thine own,
reveal to me wisdom in the visions of the night.
If not, for I am not worthy, not worthy,
at least, O loving LORD,
let sleep be to me a breathing time
as from toil, so from sin.
Yea, O LORD,
nor let me in my dreams imagine
what may anger Thee,
what may defile me.
Let not my loins be filled with illusions,
yea, let my reins chasten me in the night season,
yet without grievous terror.
Preserve me from the black sleep of sin;
all earthly and evil thoughts
put to sleep within me.
Grant to me light sleep,
rid of all imaginations
fleshly and satanical.
LORD, Thou knowest
how sleepless are mine unseen foes,
and how feeble my wretched flesh,
who madest me;
shelter me with the wing of Thy pity;
awaken me at the fitting time,
the time of prayer;
and give me to seek Thee early,
for Thy glory, and for Thy service.
Into Thy hands, O LORD, I commend myself,
my spirit, soul, and body:
Thou didst make, and didst redeem them;
and together with me, all my friends
and all that belongs to me.
Thou hast vouchsafed them to me, LORD,
in Thy goodness.
Guard my lying down and my rising up,
from henceforth and for ever.

Let me remember Thee on my bed,
and search out my spirit;
let me wake up and be present with Thee;
let me lay me down in peace, and take my rest:
for it is Thou, LORD, only
that makest me dwell in safety.

Course of Prayers for the Week

The First Day

Introduction.

Through the tender mercies of our GOD
the day-spring from on high hath visited us.
Glory be to Thee, O LORD glory to Thee.
Creator of the light,
and Enlightener of the world,—
of the visible light,
the Sun's ray, a flame of fire,
day and night,
evening and morning,—
of the light invisible,
the revelation of GOD,
writings of the Law,
oracles of Prophets,
music of Psalms,
instruction of Proverbs,
experience of Histories,—
light which never sets.
GOD is the LORD who hath showed us light;
bind the sacrifice with cords,
yea even unto the horns of the altar.
O by Thy resurrection raise us up
unto newness of life,
supplying to us frames of repentance.
The GOD of peace,
who did bring again from the dead
the great Shepherd of the sheep,
through the blood of the everlasting covenant,
our LORD JESUS CHRIST,
perfect us in every good work,
to do His will,
working in us what is acceptable before Him,
through JESUS CHRIST,
to whom be glory for ever.
Thou who didst send down on Thy disciples
on this day
Thy Thrice-Holy SPIRIT,
withdraw not Thou the gift, O LORD, from us,
but renew it in us, day by day,
who ask Thee for it.
(1) *Confession.*

Merciful and pitiful LORD,
Long-suffering and full of pity,
I have sinned, LORD, I have sinned against Thee;
O me, wretched that I am,
I have sinned, Lord, against Thee,
much and grievously,
in attending on vanities and lies.
I conceal nothing:
I make no excuses.
I give Thee glory, O LORD, this day,
I denounce against myself my sins;
Truly I have sinned before the LORD,
and thus and thus have I done.
I have sinned and perverted
that which was right,
and it profited me not.
And what shall I now say?
or with what shall I open my mouth?
What shall I answer, seeing I have done it?
Without plea, without defence, self-condemned, am I.
I have destroyed myself.
Unto Thee, O LORD, belongeth righteousness,
but unto me confusion of face,
because Thou art just in all that is come upon me;
for Thou hast done right,
but I have done wickedly.
And now, LORD, what is my hope?
Truly my hope is even in Thee,
if hope of salvation remain to me,
if Thy loving-kindness cover
the multitude of my iniquities.
O remember, what my substance is,
the work of Thine hands,
the likeness of Thy countenance,
the cost of Thy blood,
a name from Thy Name,
a sheep of Thy pasture,
a son of the covenant,
Despise not Thou the work of Thine own hands.
Hast Thou made for nought
Thine own image and likeness?
for nought, if Thou destroy it.
And what profit is there in my blood?
Mine enemies will rejoice;
May they never rejoice, O LORD!

Grant not to them my destruction.
 Look upon the face of Thine Anointed,
 and in the Blood of Thy covenant,
 the propitiation for the sins of the whole world,
 LORD, be propitious unto me, a sinner;
 even unto me, O LORD, of sinners
 chief, chiefest and greatest,
 For Thy Name's sake be merciful unto my sin,
 for it is great: it exceeds.
 For Thy Name's sake, that Name,
 beside which, none other under heaven
 is given among men,
 whereby we must be saved,
 the SPIRIT Himself helping our infirmities,
 and making intercession for us,
 with plaints unutterable,
 for the tender yearnings of the FATHER,
 the bloody wounds of the SON,
 the unutterable plaints of the SPIRIT,
 give ear, O LORD, have mercy, O LORD,
 O LORD, hearken and do;
 defer not, for Thine own sake,
 O my GOD.
 For me, I forget not my sins,
 they are ever before me;
 I remember them in the bitterness of my soul;
 I am anxious about them;
 I turn away and groan,
 I have indignation and revenge
 and wrath against myself.
 I despise and bruise my own self,
 that my penitence, LORD, O LORD,
 is not deeper, is not fuller;
 help Thou mine impenitence.
 And more, and still more,
 pierce Thou, rend, crush my heart;
 and remit, forgive, pardon
 what things are grief to me,
 and offence of heart.
 Cleanse Thou me from secret faults,
 and keep Thy servant also from presumptuous sins.
 Magnify Thy mercies towards the wretched sinner;
 and in season, LORD, say to me,
 Be of good cheer; thy sins are forgiven thee;
 My grace is sufficient for thee.

Say unto my soul, I am thy salvation.
 Why art thou so heavy, O my soul?
 and why art thou so disquieted within thee?
 Return unto thy rest, O my soul,
 for the LORD hath rewarded thee.
 O LORD, rebuke me not in Thine indignation,
 neither chasten me in Thy displeasure.
 I said, I will confess my sins unto the LORD,
 and so Thou forgavest the wickedness of my sin.
 LORD, Thou knowest all my desire,
 and my groaning is not hid from Thee.
 Have mercy upon me, O GOD,
 after Thy great goodness,
 according to the multitude of Thy mercies
 do away mine offences.
 Thou shalt arise, and have mercy on me, O LORD,
 for it is time that Thou have mercy upon me,
 yea, the time is come.
 If Thou, O LORD, shouldest mark iniquities,
 O LORD, who shall stand?
 Enter not into judgment with Thy servant, O LORD,
 for in Thy sight shall no man living be justified.
 (2) *Prayer for grace.*
 My hands will I lift up
 unto Thy commandments which I have loved.
 Open Thou mine eyes that I may see,
 incline my heart that I may desire,
 order my steps that I may follow,
 the way of Thy commandments.
 O LORD GOD, be Thou to me a GOD,
 and beside Thee none else,
 none else, nought else with Thee.
 Vouchsafe to me, to worship Thee and serve Thee
 in truth of spirit,
 in reverence of body,
 in blessing of lips
 in private and in public;
 to pay honour to them that have the rule over me,
 by obedience and submission
 to show affection to my own,
 by carefulness and providence;
 to overcome evil with good;
 to possess my vessel in sanctification and honour;
 to have my converse without covetousness,
 content with what I have;

to speak the truth in love;
to be desirous not to lust,
not to lust passionately,
not to go after lusts.

(The Hedge of the Law.

i.e. precautions.)

1. To bruise the serpent's head. *Gen.* iii. 15.
2. To remember my latter end. *Deut.* xxvii. 29.
3. To cut off opportunities. *2 Cor.* xi. 12.
4. To be sober. *1 Pet.* v. 8.
5. Not to sit idle. *Matt.* xx. 6.
6. To shun the wicked. *Ps.* xxvi. 5.
7. To cleave to the good. *Rom.* xii. 9.
8. To make a covenant with the eyes. *Job* xxxi. 1.
9. To bring my body into subjection. *1 Cor.* ix. 27.
10. To give myself unto prayer. *1 Cor.* vii. 5.
11. To betake myself to penitence. *2 Pet.* iii. 9.

Hedge up my way with thorns,

that I find not the path

for following vanity.

Hold Thou me in with bit and bridle,

lest I fall from Thee.

O LORD compel me to come in to Thee.

(3) Profession.

I believe, O LORD,

in Thee, Father, Word, Spirit, One GOD;

that by Thy fatherly love and power

all things were created;—

that by Thy goodness and love to man

all things have been begun anew

in Thy Word,—

Who for us men and for our salvation,

was made flesh,

was conceived and born,

suffered and was crucified,

died and was buried,

descended and rose again,

ascended and sat down,

will return and will repay;—

that by the shining-forth and working

of Thy Holy Spirit,

hath been called out of the whole world

a peculiar people into a polity,

in belief of the truth

and sanctity of living:—

that in it we are partakers
 of the communion of saints
 and forgiveness of sins
 in this world,—
 that in it we are waiting
 for resurrection of the flesh
 and life everlasting
 in the world to come.—
 This most holy faith
 which was once delivered to the saints
 I believe, O LORD;
 help Thou mine unbelief,
 and vouchsafe to me
 to love the FATHER for His fatherly love,
 to reverence the ALMIGHTY for His power,
 as a faithful CREATOR, to commit my soul to Him
 in well doing;
 vouchsafe to me to partake
 from JESUS of salvation,
 from CHRIST of anointing,
 from the ONLY-BEGOTTEN of adoption;
 to worship the LORD
 for His conception in faith,
 for His birth in humility,
 for His sufferings in patience and hatred of sin;
 for His cross to crucify beginnings,
 for His death to mortify the flesh,
 for His burial to bury evil thoughts in good works,
 for His descent to meditate upon hell,
 for His resurrection upon newness of life,
 for His ascension, to mind things above,
 for His sitting on high, to mind the good things on His right,
 for His return, to fear His second appearance,
 for judgment, to judge myself ere I be judged.
 From the SPIRIT
 vouchsafe me the breath of salutary grace.
 In the Holy Catholic Church
 to have my own calling, and holiness, and portion.
 and a fellowship ³¹
 of her sacred rites, and prayers,
 fastings and groans,

³¹This passage serves to illustrate St. Leo's language as it occurs in Tract 75. *Beatum Apostolum Petrum, cujus suffragantibus meritis, quæ noscimus, impetrare possimus per Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum.*

vigils, tears, and sufferings,
for assurance of remission of sins,
for hope of resurrection and translation
to eternal life.

(4) *Intercession.*

O Hope of all the ends of the earth,
and of them that remain in the broad sea;
O Thou on whom our fathers hoped,
and Thou didst deliver them;
on whom they waited,
and were not confounded;
O my Hope from my youth,
from my mother's breasts;
on whom I have been cast from the womb,
be Thou my hope
now and evermore,
and my portion in the land of the living:
In Thy nature,
in Thy names, in Thy types,
in word and in deed,
My Hope,
let me not be disappointed of my hope.
O the Hope of all the ends of the earth,
remember Thy whole creation for good,
visit the world in Thy compassion;
O guardian of men,
O loving LORD,
remember all our race.
Thou who hast shut up all in unbelief,
on all have pity, O LORD.
O Thou who didst die and rise again,
to be LORD both of the dead and living,
live we or die we,
Thou art our LORD;
LORD, have pity on living and dead.
O helper of the helpless,
seasonable aid in affliction,
remember all who are in necessity,
and need Thy succour.
O GOD of grace and truth,
establish all who stand in truth and grace,
restore all who are sick with heresies and sins.
O wholesome Defence of Thine anointed,
remember Thy Congregation
which Thou hast purchased and redeemed of old.

O grant to all believers
 one heart and one soul.
 Thou that walkest amid the golden candlesticks,
 remove not our candlestick
 out of its place.
 Amend what are wanting,
 establish what remain,
 which Thou art ready to cast away,
 which are ready to die.
 O LORD of the harvest
 send forth labourers, made sufficient by Thee,
 into Thy harvest.
 O portion of those
 who wait in Thy temple,
 grant to our clergy.
 rightly to divide the word of truth,
 rightly to walk in it;
 grant to Thy Christian people
 to obey and submit to them.
 O King of nations, unto the ends of the earth;
 strengthen all the states
 of the inhabited world,
 as being Thy ordinance,
 though a creation of man.
 Scatter the nations that delight in war,
 make wars to cease in all the earth.
 O expectation of the isles and their hope,
 LORD, save this island,
 and all the country in which we sojourn,
 from all affliction, peril, and need.
 LORD of lords, Ruler of rulers,
 remember all rulers
 to whom Thou hast given rule in the earth,
 and O remember specially
 our divinely-guarded king,
 and work with him more and more,
 and prosper his way in all things.
 Speak good things unto his heart,
 for Thy Church, and all Thy people,
 grant to him profound and perpetual peace,
 that in his tranquility
 we may lead a quiet and peaceable life
 in all godliness and honesty.
 O Thou by whom are ordained the powers that be,
 grant to those who are chief in court,

to be chief in virtue and Thy fear;
 grant to the Parliament Thy holy wisdom;
 to our great men, to do nothing against
 but for the truth;
 to the courts of law, Thy judgments,
 to judge in all things concerning all
 without preference, without partiality.
 O GOD of armies,
 give a prosperous course and strength
 to all the Christian army,
 against the enemies of our most holy faith.
 Grant to our population
 to be subject unto the higher powers,
 not only for wrath, but also for conscience-sake.
 Grant to farmers and graziers good seasons;
 to the fleet and fishers fair weather;
 to tradesmen, not to overreach one another;
 to mechanics, to pursue their business lawfully,
 down to the meanest workman,
 down to the poor.
 O GOD, not of us only but of our seed,
 bless our children among us,
 to advance in wisdom as in stature,
 and in favour with Thee and with men.
 Thou who wouldest have us provide for our own,
 and hatest the unnatural,
 remember, LORD, my relations according to the flesh;
 grant me to speak peace concerning them,
 and to seek their good.
 Thou who willest us to make return
 to our benefactors,
 remember, LORD, for good,
 all from whom I have received good;
 keep them alive that they may be blessed upon earth,
 and deliver them not
 into the will of their enemies.
 Thou who hast noted
 the man who neglects his own, as worse than an infidel,
 remember in Thy good pleasure
 all those in my household.
 Peace be to my house,
 the SON of peace upon all in it.
 Thou who wouldest that our righteousness exceed
 the righteousness of sinners,
 grant me, LORD, to love those who love me,

my own friend, and my father's friend, and my friend's children,
never to forsake.

Thou who wouldst that we overcome
evil with good,
and pray for those who persecute us,
have pity on mine enemies, LORD,
as on myself;
and lead them together with me to Thy heavenly kingdom.

Thou who grantest the prayers of Thy servants
one for another,
remember, LORD, for good,
and pity all those
who remember me in their prayers,
or whom I have promised to remember in mine.
Thou who acceptest diligence in every good work,
remember, LORD, as if they prayed to Thee,
those who for any good reason
give not time to prayer.

Arise, and have mercy
on those who are in the last necessity,
for it is time that Thou hast mercy upon them,
yea the time is come.

Have mercy on them, O LORD,
as on me also, when in extremities.

Remember, LORD,
infants, children, the grown, the young, the middle aged, the old,
hungry, thirsty, naked, sick,
prisoners, foreigners, friendless, unburied,
all in extreme age and weakness,
possessed with devils, and tempted to suicide,
troubled by unclean spirits,
the hopeless, the sick in soul or body, the weak-hearted,
all in prison and chains, all under sentence of death;
orphans, widows, foreigners, travellers, voyagers,
women with child, women who give suck,
all in bitter servitude, or mines, or galleys, or in loneliness.

Thou, LORD, shalt save both man and beast,
how excellent is thy mercy, O GOD!

And the children of men shall put their trust
under the shadow of Thy wings.

The LORD bless us, and keep us,
and show the light of His countenance upon us,

And be merciful unto us,

The LORD lift up His countenance upon us,
And give us peace!

I commend to Thee, O LORD,
 my soul, and my body,
 my mind, and my thoughts,
 my prayers, and my vows,
 my senses, and my limbs,
 my words, and my works ³²,
 my life, and my death;
 my brothers, and my sisters,
 and their children;
 my friends, my benefactors, my well wishers,
 those who have a claim on me;
 my kindred, and my neighbours,
 my country, and all Christendom.
 I commend to Thee, LORD,
 my impulses, and my startings,
 my intentions, and my attempts,
 my going out, and my coming in,
 my sitting down, and my rising up.
 (5) *Praise.*
 Up with our hearts;
 we lift them to the LORD.
 O how very meet, and right, and fitting, and due,
 in all, and for all,
 at all times, places, manners,
 in every season, every spot,
 everywhere, always, altogether,
 to remember Thee, to worship Thee,
 to confess to Thee, to praise Thee,
 to bless Thee, to hymn Thee,
 to give thanks to Thee,
 Maker, nourisher, guardian, governor,
 preserver, worker, perfecter of all,
 LORD and Father,
 King and God,
 fountain of life and immortality,
 treasure of everlasting goods.
 Whom the heavens hymn,
 and the heaven of heavens,
 the Angels and all the heavenly powers,
 one to other crying continually,—
 and we the while, weak and unworthy,
 under their feet,
 HOLY, HOLY, HOLY

³²Page 172, edit. 1675.

LORD the GOD of Hosts;
full is the whole heaven,
and the whole earth,
of the majesty of Thy glory.
Blessed be the glory of the LORD
out of His place,
for His Godhead, His mysteriousness,
His height, His sovereignty, His almightiness,
His eternity. His providence.
The LORD is my strength, my stony rock, and my defence,
my deliverer, my succour, my buckler,
the horn also of my salvation and my refuge.

The Second Day

Introduction.

My voice shalt Thou hear betimes, O LORD,
early in the morning will I direct my prayer unto Thee,
and will look up.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who didst create the firmament of heaven,
the heavens and the heaven of heavens,
the heavenly powers,
Angels, Archangels,
Cherubim, Seraphim,
waters above the heavens,
mists and exhalations,
for showers, dew, hail, snow as wool,
hoar frost as ashes, ice as morsels,
clouds from the ends of the earth,
lightnings, thunders, winds out of Thy treasures, storms;
waters beneath the heavens,
for drinking and for bathing.

Confession.

I will confess my sins,
and the sins of my fathers,
for I have transgressed and neglected Thee, O LORD,
and walked perversely before Thee.
Set not, O LORD, set not my misdeeds before Thee,
nor my life in the light of Thy countenance,
But pardon the iniquity of Thy servant,
according to Thy great mercy;
as Thou hast been merciful to him from a child,
even so now.
I have sinned, what shall I do unto Thee,
O Thou preserver of men?
Why hast Thou set me as a mark against Thee,
so that I am a burden to myself?
O pardon my transgression,
and take away mine iniquity.
Deliver me from going down to the pit,
for Thou hast found a ransom.
Have mercy on me, SON of DAVID,
LORD, help me.
Yea, LORD, even the dogs eat of the crumbs
which fall from their masters' table.
Have patience with me, LORD,
yet I have not wherewith to pay,

I confess to Thee;
 forgive me the whole debt, I beseech Thee.
 How long wilt Thou forget me, O LORD? for ever?
 How long wilt Thou hide Thy face from me?
 How long shall I seek counsel in my soul,
 and he vexed in my heart day and night?
 How long shall mine enemies triumph over me?
 Consider and hear me, O LORD my GOD,
 lighten mine eyes that I sleep not in death,
 lest mine enemy say I have prevailed against him,
 for if I be cast down, they that trouble me will rejoice at it;
 but my trust is in thy mercy.

(2) *Prayer for grace.*

Remove from me

(*The Ten Com- mandments*) 1. all iniquity and profaneness, superstition,
 and hypocrisy.

2. worship of idols, of individuals.

3. rash oath and curse.

4. neglect or indecency of worship.

5. haughtiness and recklessness.

6. strife and wrath.

7. passion and corruption.

8. indolence and fraud.

9. lying and injuriousness.

10. every evil notion, every impure thought,
 every base desire, every unseemly
 thought.

Grant to me,

1. to be religious and pious.

2. to worship and serve.

3. to bless and swear truly.

4. to confess meetly in the congregation.

5. affection and obedience.

6. patience and good temper.

7. purity and soberness.

8. contentedness and goodness.

9. truth and incorruptness.

10. good thoughts, perseverance to the end.

(3) *Profession.*

I believe in GOD,

1. the FATHER, Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth.

2. And in JESUS CHRIST, His Only-begotten Son, our LORD.

(1.) conceived of the HOLY GHOST,

(2.) born of Mary, ever-virgin,

(3.) suffered under Pontius Pilate,

(4.) crucified,
(5.) dead,
(6.) buried.—
(1.) descended into hell,
(2.) risen from the dead,
(3.) ascended into heaven,
(4.) set down on the right hand.
(5.) to return thence,
(6.) to judge both quick and dead.

3. And in the HOLY GHOST,

(1.) The Holy Church,
(2.) Catholic,
(3.) communion of saints,
(4.) remission of sins,
(5.) resurrection of flesh,
(6.) life everlasting.

And now, LORD, what is my hope?
Truly my hope is even in Thee;
in Thee, O LORD, have I trusted,
let me never be confounded.

(4) *Intercession.*

Let us pray GOD,
for the whole creation;
for the supply of seasons,
healthy, fruitful, peaceful;
for the whole race of mankind;
for those who are not Christians;
for the conversion of Atheists, the ungodly;
Gentiles, Turks, and Jews;
for all Christians;
for restoration of all
who languish in faults and sins;
for confirmation of all
who have been granted truth and grace;
for succour and comfort of all
who are dispirited, infirm, distressed, unsettled,
men and women;
for thankfulness and sobriety in all
who are hearty, healthy, prosperous, quiet,
men and women;
For the Catholic Church,
its establishment and increase;
for the Eastern,
its deliverance and union;
for the Western,

its adjustment and peace;
 for the British,
 the supply of what is wanting in it,
 the strengthening of what remains in it ³³;
 for the episcopate, presbytery, christian people;
 for the states of the inhabited world;
 for christian states,
 far off, near at hand;
 for our own;
 for all in rule;
 for our divinely-guarded king,
 the queen and the prince;
 for those who have place in the court;
 for parliament and judicature,
 army and police,
 commons and their leaders,
 farmers, graziers, fishers, merchants,
 traders, and mechanics,
 down to mean workmen, and the poor;
 for the rising generation;
 for the good nurture of all the royal family,
 of the young ones of the nobility;
 for all in universities, in law colleges,
 in schools in town or country,
 in apprenticeships;
 for those who have a claim on me from relationship,
 for brothers and sisters,
 that GOD'S blessing may be on them,
 and on their children;
 or from benefits conferred,
 that Thy recompence may be on all
 who have benefitted me,
 who have ministered to me in carnal things;
 or from trust placed in me,
 for all whom I have educated,
 all whom I have ordained:
 for my college, my parish,
 Southwell, St. Paul's, Westminster,
 Dioceses of Chichester, Ely, and my present,
 clergy, people, helps, governments,
 the deanery in the chapel royal,
 the almonry,
 the colleges committed to me ³⁴;

³³An allusion apparently to the Church in Sardis.—Rev. iii. 2.

³⁴As Visitor.

or from natural kindness,
 for all who love me,
 though I know them not;
 or from Christian love;
 for those who hate me without cause,
 some too, even on account of truth and righteousness;
 or from neighbourhood,
 for all who dwell near me
 peaceably and harmlessly;
 or from promise,
 for all whom I have promised to remember
 in my prayers;
 or from mutual offices,
 for all who remember me in their prayers,
 and ask of me the same;
 or from stress of engagements,
 for all who on sufficient reasons fail to call upon Thee;
 for all who have no intercessor
 in their own behalf;
 for all who at present are in agony
 of extreme necessity or deep affliction;
 for all who are attempting any good work
 which will bring glory to the Name of GOD
 or some great good to the Church;
 for all who act nobly
 either towards things sacred or towards the poor;
 for all who have ever been offended by me
 either in word or in deed.
 GOD have mercy on me and bless me;
 GOD show the light of His countenance upon me
 and pity me.
 GOD bless me, even our GOD,
 GOD bless me and receive my prayer;
 O direct my life towards Thy commandments,
 hallow my soul,
 purify my body,
 correct my thoughts,
 cleanse my desires,
 soul and body, mind and spirit,
 heart and reins.
 Renew me thoroughly, O GOD,
 for, if Thou wilt, Thou canst.
 (5) *Praise.*
 The LORD, the LORD GOD,
 merciful and pitiful,

long-suffering and full of pity, and true,
keeping pity for thousands,
taking away iniquities and unrighteousnesses and sins;
not clearing the guilty one,
bringing sins of fathers upon children.
I will bless the LORD at all times,
His praise shall ever be in my mouth.
Glory to GOD in the highest,
and on earth peace,
goodwill towards men.
The Angels,
Archangels,
Powers,
Thrones,
Dominions,
Principalities,
Authorities,
Cherubim,
Seraphim,
guardianship;
glory;
marvels:
judgment;
beneficence;
government;
against devils;
knowledge;
love.

The Third Day

Introduction.

O GOD, Thou art my GOD,
early will I seek Thee.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who gatheredst the water into the sea,
and broughtest to sight the earth,
and madest to sprout
herb and fruit tree.
There are the depths and the sea as on an heap,
lakes, rivers, springs;
earth, continent, and isles,
mountains, hills, and valleys;
glebe, meadows, glades,
green pasture, corn, and hay;
herbs and flowers
for food, enjoyment, medicine;
fruit trees bearing
wine, oil and spices,
and trees for wood;
and things beneath the earth,
stones, metals, minerals, coal,
blood and fire, and vapour of smoke.

(1) Confession.

Who can understand his errors?
Cleanse Thou me from secret faults.
Keep back Thy servant also from presumptuous sins,
lest they have the dominion over me.
For Thy Name's sake,
be merciful unto my sin,
for it is great.
My iniquities have taken such hold upon
me that I am not able to look up,
yea, they are more in number than the hairs of my head,
and my heart hath failed me.
Be pleased, O LORD, to deliver me,
Make haste, O LORD, to help me.
Magnify Thy mercies upon me,
O Thou who savest them that trust in Thee.
I said, LORD, have mercy upon me,
heal my soul, for I have sinned against Thee;
I have sinned but I am confounded,
and I turn from my evil ways,
and I turn unto mine own heart,

and with my whole heart I turn unto Thee;
 and I seek Thy face,
 and I beseech Thee, saying,
 I have sinned, I have committed iniquity,
 I have done unjustly.
 I know, O LORD, the plague of my heart,
 and lo, I turn to Thee with all my heart,
 and with all my strength.
 And Thou, O LORD, now from Thy dwelling-place,
 and from the glorious throne of Thy kingdom in heaven
 O hear the prayer
 and the supplication of Thy servant;
 and be propitious towards Thy servant
 and heal his soul.
 O GOD, be merciful to me a sinner,
 be merciful to me the chief of sinners.
 Father, I have sinned against heaven, and against Thee,
 and am no more worthy to be called Thy son,
 make me one of Thy hired servants;
 Make me one, or even the last,
 or the least among all.
 What profit is there in my blood,
 when I go down to the pit?
 shall the dust give thanks unto Thee?
 or shall it declare Thy truth?
 Hear, O LORD, and have mercy upon me;
 LORD, be Thou my helper;
 Turn my heaviness into joy,
 my dreamings into earnestness,
 my falls into clearings of myself,
 my guilt, my offence into indignation,
 my sin into fear,
 my transgression into vehement desire,
 my unrighteousness into strictness,
 my pollution into revenge.
 (2) *Prayer for grace.*
 Hosanna in the highest ³⁵.
 Remember, me, O LORD,
 with the favour that Thou bearest unto Thy people,
 O visit me with Thy salvation;
 that I may see the felicity of Thy chosen,
 and rejoice in the gladness of Thy people,
 and give thanks with Thine inheritance.

³⁵Vide p. 186, edit. 1675.

There is glory which shall be revealed;
 for when the Judge cometh
 some shall see Thy face cheerful,
 and shall be placed on the right,
 and shall hear those most welcome words,
 "Come, ye blessed."
 They shall be caught up in clouds
 to meet the LORD;
 they shall enter into gladness,
 they shall enjoy the sight of Him.
 they shall be ever with Him.
 These alone, only these are blessed
 among the sons of men.
 O to me the meanest grant the meanest place
 there under their feet;
 under the feet of Thine elect,
 the meanest among them.
 And that this may be,
 let me find grace in Thy sight
 to have grace,
 so as to serve Thee acceptably
 with reverence and godly fear. (*Heb.* xii. 28.)
 Let me find that second grace,
 not to receive in vain (*2 Cor.* vi. 1.)
 the first grace,
 not to come short of it; (*Heb.* xii. 15.)
 yea, not to neglect it, (*1 Tim.* iv. 14.)
 so as to fall from it, (*Gal.* v. 4.)
 but to stir it up, (*2 Tim.* i. 6.)
 so as to increase in it, (*2 Pet.* iii. 18.)
 yea, to abide in it
 till the end of my life.
 And O, perfect for me what is lacking
 of Thy gifts,
 of faith,
 of hope,
 of love, help Thou mine unbelief,
 establish my trembling hope,
 kindle its smoking flax.
 Shed abroad Thy love in my heart,
 so that I may love Thee,
 my friend in Thee, my enemy for Thee.
 O Thou who givest grace to the humble-minded,
 also give me grace to be humble-minded.
 O Thou who never failest those who fear Thee,

my Fear and my Hope,
let me fear one thing only,
the fearing ought more than Thee.
As I would that men should do to me
so may I do to them;
not to have thoughts beyond what I should think,
but to have thoughts unto sobriety.
Shine on those who sit in darkness,
and the shadow of death;
guide our feet into the way of peace,
that we may have the same thoughts
one with another,
rightly to divide, rightly to walk,
to edify,
with one accord, with one mouth,
to glorify GOD;
and if ought otherwise,
to walk in the same rule
as far as we have attained;
to maintain order,
decency and stedfastness.

(3) *Profession.*

Godhead, paternal love, power,
providence:
salvation, anointing, adoption,
lordship;
conception, birth, passion,
cross, death, burial,
descent, resurrection, ascent,
sitting, return, judgment;
Breath and Holiness,
calling from the Universal,
hallowing in the Universal,
communion of saints, and of saintly things ³⁶,
resurrection,
life eternal.

(4) *Intercession.*

Hosanna on the earth ³⁷.
Remember, O LORD,
to crown the year with Thy goodness;
for the eyes of all look towards Thee,
and Thou givest their food in due season.
Thou openest Thine hand,

³⁶Vide p. 172, edit. 1675.

³⁷Vide p. 172, edit. 1675.

and fillest all things living with plenteousness,
And on us, O LORD, vouchsafe
the blessings of heaven and the dew above,
blessings of fountains and the deep beneath,
courses of sun, conjunctions of moons,
summits of eastern mountains, of the everlasting hills,
fulness of the earth and of produce thereof,
good seasons, wholesome weather,
full crops, plenteous fruits,
health of body, peaceful times,
mild government, kind laws,
wise councils, equal judgments,
loyal obedience, vigorous justice,
fertility in resources, fruitfulness in begetting,
ease in bearing, happiness in offspring,
careful nurture, sound training,
That our sons may grow up as the young plants,
our daughters as the polished corners of the temple,
that our garners may be full and plenteous
with all manner of store,
that our sheep may bring forth thousands
and ten thousands in our streets:
that there be no decay,
no leading into captivity
and no complaining in our streets.

(5) *Praise.*

³⁸ Thou, O LORD, art praised in Sion,
and unto Thee shall the vow be performed in Jerusalem.
Thou art worthy, O LORD our God,
the HOLY ONE
to receive glory, and honour, and power.
Thou that hearest the prayer,
unto Thee shall all flesh come,
my flesh shall come.
My misdeeds prevail against me,
O be Thou merciful unto our sins;
that I may come and give thanks
with all Thy works,
and bless Thee with Thy holy ones.
O LORD, open Thou my lips,
and my mouth shall show forth Thy praise.
My soul doth praise the LORD,
for the goodness He hath done

³⁸Vide p. 172, edit. 1675.

to the whole creation,
 and to the whole race of man;
 for Thy mercies towards myself,
 soul, body, and estate,
 gifts of grace, nature, and fortune;
 for all benefits received,
 for all successes, now or heretofore,
 for any good thing done;
 for health, credit, competency,
 safety, gentle estate, quiet.
 Thou hast not cut off as a weaver my life,
 nor from day even to night made an end of me.
 He hath vouchsafed me life and breath
 until this hour,
 from childhood, youth, and hitherto
 even unto age.
 He holdeth our soul in life
 and suffereth not our feet to slip;
 rescuing me from perils, sicknesses,
 poverty, bondage,
 public shame, evil chances;
 keeping me from perishing in my sins,
 fully waiting my conversion,
 leaving in me return into my heart,
 remembrance of my latter end,
 shame, horror, grief,
 for my past sins;
 fuller and larger, larger and fuller,
 more and still more, O my LORD,
 storing me with good hope
 of their remission,
 through repentance and its works,
 in the power of the thrice-holy Keys,
 and the mysteries in Thy Church.
 Wherefore day by day
 for these Thy benefits towards me,
 which I remember,—
 wherefore also for others very many
 which I have let slip
 from their number, from my forgetfulness—
 for those which I wished, knew and asked,
 and those I asked not, knew not, wished not,—
 I confess and give thanks to Thee,
 I bless and praise Thee, as is fit, and every day
 I pray with my whole soul,

and with my whole mind I pray.
Glory be to Thee, O LORD, glory to Thee;
glory to Thee, and glory to Thine All-holy Name,
for all Thy Divine perfections in them;
for Thine incomprehensible and unimaginable goodness,
and thy pity towards sinners
and unworthy men,
and towards me of all sinners
far the most unworthy.
Yea, O LORD,
through this, and through the rest,
glory to Thee, and praise, and blessing, and thanksgiving,
with the voices and concert of voices
of Angels and of men,
of all Thy saints in heaven,
and all Thy creatures in heaven or earth,
and of me, beneath their feet,
unworthy and wretched sinner,
Thy abject creature,
now, in this day and hour,
and every day till my last breath,
and till the end of the world,
and for ages upon ages.

The Fourth Day

Introduction.

I have thought upon Thee, O LORD,
when I was waking,
for Thou hast been my helper.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who madest the two Lights, Sun and Moon,
greater and lesser,
and the stars
for light, for signs, for seasons,
spring, summer, autumn, winter,
days, weeks, months, years,
to rule over day night.

(1) Confession.

Behold, Thou art angry, for we have sinned.
We are all as an unclean thing
and all our righteousnesses
as filthy rags.
We all do fade as a leaf,
and our iniquities, like the wind,
have taken us away.
But now, O LORD, Thou art our Father,
we are clay, Thy handiwork all.
Be not wroth very sore,
nor remember iniquity for ever,
behold, see, we beseech Thee,
we are all Thy people.
O LORD, though our iniquities testify against us,
do Thou it for Thy Name's sake;
for our backslidings are many,
we have sinned against Thee.
Yet thou, O LORD, art in the midst of us,
and we are called by Thy Name,
leave us not.
O Hope of Israel,
The SAVIOUR thereof in time of trouble,
why shouldest Thou be as a stranger in the land,
and as a wayfaring man that turneth aside
to tarry for a night?
why shouldest Thou be as a man astonished,
as a mighty man that cannot save?
Be merciful to our unrighteousnesses,
and our iniquities remember no more.
LORD, I am carnal,

sold under sin;
 there dwelleth in me, that is, in my flesh,
 no good thing;
 for the good that I would, I do not,
 but the evil which I would not, that I do.
 I consent unto the law that it is good,
 I delight in it after the inner man;
 But I see another law in my members,
 warring against the law of my mind,
 and enslaving me to the law of sin.
 Wretched man that I am,
 who shall deliver me from the body of this death?
 I thank GOD through JESUS CHRIST,
 that where sin abounded,
 grace hath much more abounded.
 O LORD, Thy goodness leadeth me to repentance:
 O give me sometime repentance
 to recover me from the snare of the devil,
 who am taken captive by him
 at his will.
 Sufficient for me the past time of my life
 to have done the will of lusts,
 walking in lasciviousness, revelling, drunkenness,
 and in other excess of profligacy.
 O LAMB without blemish and without spot,
 who hast redeemed me with Thy precious Blood,
 in that very Blood pity me and save me;
 in that Blood,
 and in that very Name,
 besides which is none other under heaven
 given among men,
 by which we must be saved.
 O GOD, Thou knowest my foolishness,
 and my sins are not hid from Thee.
 LORD, Thou knowest all my desire,
 and my groaning is not hid from Thee.
 Let not them that trust in Thee,
 O LORD GOD of hosts,
 be ashamed for my cause;
 let not those that seek Thee be confounded through me,
 O LORD GOD of Israel.
 Take me out of the mire that I sink not;
 O let me be delivered from them that hate me
 and out of the deep waters;
 Let not the water flood drown me,

neither let the deep swallow me up,
and let not the pit shut her mouth upon me.

(2) *Prayer for grace:*

(*against deadly sins.*)

(*covetousness.*)

(*sloth.*)

[Defend me from]

Pride

envy

wrath

gluttony

lechery

the cares of life

lukewarm indifference

Amorite.

Hittite.

Perizzite.

Girgashite.

Hivite.

Canaanite.

Jebusite.

[Give me]

Humility, pitifulness, patience,

sobriety, purity, contentment, ready zeal.

One thing have I desired of the LORD, which I will require ³⁹,

that I may dwell in the house of the LORD

all the days of my life,

to behold the fair beauty of the LORD,

and to visit His temple.

Two things have I required of Thee, O LORD,

deny Thou me not before I die;

remove far from me vanity and lies;

give me neither poverty nor riches,

feed me with food convenient for me;

lest I be full and deny Thee

and say, who is the LORD?

or lest I be poor and steal,

and take the Name of my GOD in vain.

Let me learn to abound,

let me learn to suffer need,

in whatsoever state I am,

therewith to be content.

For nothing earthly, temporal, mortal,

³⁹Vide p. 194, edit. 1675.

to long nor to wait.
Grant me a happy life
in piety, gravity, purity,
in all things good and fair,
in cheerfulness, in health, in credit,
in competency, in safety, in gentle estate, in quiet;
a happy death,
a deathless happiness.

(3) *Profession.*

I believe
in the FATHER, benevolent affection;
in the Almighty, saving power;
in the Creator, providence
for guarding, ruling, perfecting the universe.
In JESUS, salvation,
in CHRIST, anointing;
in the Only-begotten SON, sonship,
in the LORD, a master's treatment,
in His conception and birth
the cleansing of our unclean conception and birth;
in His sufferings, which we owed, that we might not pay;
in His cross the curse of the law removed;
in His death the sting of death;
in His burial eternal destruction in the tomb;
in His descent, whither we ought, that we might not go;
in His resurrection, as the first fruits of them that sleep;
in His ascent, to prepare a place for us;
in His sitting, to appear and intercede;
in His return, to take unto Him His own;
in His judgment, to render to each according to his works.
In the HOLY GHOST, power from on high,
transforming unto sanctity
from without and invisibly,
yet inwardly and evidently.
In the Church, a body mystical
of the called out of the whole world,
unto intercourse in faith and holiness.
In the communion of Saints, members of this body,
a mutual participation in holy things ⁴⁰,
for confidence of remission of sins,
for hope of resurrection, of translation,
to life everlasting.

(4) *Intercession.*

⁴⁰Vide above, p. 24, 42.

And I have hoped in Thy mercy
from everlasting to everlasting.
How excellent is Thy mercy, O LORD;
If I have hope, it is in Thy mercy,
O let me not be disappointed of my hope.
Moreover we beseech Thee,
remember all, LORD, for good;
have pity upon all, O Sovereign LORD,
be reconciled with us all.
Give peace to the multitudes of Thy people;
scatter offences;
abolish wars;
stop the uprisings of heresies.
Thy peace and love
vouchsafe to us, O GOD our SAVIOUR,
the Hope of all the ends of the earth.
Remember to crown the year
with Thy goodness;
for the eyes of all wait upon Thee,
and thou givest them their meat in due season.
Thou openest Thy hand,
and fillest all things living with plenteousness.
Remember Thy Holy Church,
from one end of the earth to the other;
and give her peace,
whom Thou hast redeemed with Thy precious blood;
and establish her
unto the end of the world.
Remember those who bear fruit, and act nobly,
in Thy holy Churches,
and who remember the poor and needy;
recompense to them
Thy rich and heavenly gifts;
vouchsafe to them,
for things earthly, heavenly,
for corruptible, incorruptible,
for temporal, eternal.
Remember those who are in virginity,
and purity and ascetic life;
also those who live in honourable marriage,
in Thy reverence and fear.
Remember every Christian soul
in affliction, distress, and trial,
and in need of Thy pity and succour;
also our brethren in captivity, prison, chains,

and bitter bondage;
supplying return to the wandering,
health to the sick,
deliverance to the captives.
Remember religious and faithful kings,
whom Thou hast given to rule upon the earth;
and especially remember, LORD,
our divinely-guarded king;
strengthen his kingdom,
subdue to him all adversaries,
speak good thing to his heart,
for Thy Church, and all Thy people.
Vouchsafe to him deep and undisturbed peace,
that in his serenity
we may lead a quiet and peaceable life
with all godliness and honesty.
Remember, LORD, all power
and authority,
our brethren in the court,
those who are chief in council and judgment,
and all by land and sea
waging Thy wars for us.
Moreover, LORD, remember graciously
our holy Fathers,
the honourable Presbytery, and all the clergy,
rightly dividing the Word of Truth,
and rightly walking in it.
Remember, LORD, our brethren around us,
and praying with us in this holy hour,
for their zeal and earnestness-sake.
Remember also those who on fair reasons are away,
and pity them and us
in the multitude of Thy pity.
Fill our garners with all manner of store,
preserve our marriages in peace and concord,
nourish our infants,
lead forward our youth,
sustain our aged,
comfort the weak-hearted,
gather together the scattered,
restore the wanderers,
and knit them to Thy Holy Catholic Apostolic Church.
Set free the troubled
with unclean spirits,
voyage with the voyagers,

travel with the travellers,
stand forth for the widow,
shield the orphan,
rescue the captive,
heal the sick.

Those who are on trial, in mines, in exile, in galleys,
in whatever affliction, necessity, and emergence,
remember, O GOD;
and all who need Thy great mercy;
and those who love us,
and those who hate;
and those who have desired us unworthy
to make mention of them in our prayers;
and all Thy people remember, O LORD, our GOD,
and upon all pour out Thy rich pity,
to all performing their requests for salvation;
and those of whom we have not made mention,
through ignorance, forgetfulness, or number of names,
do Thou Thyself remember, O GOD,
who knowest the stature and appellation of each,
who knowest every one from his mother's womb.
For thou art, O LORD, the Succour of the succourless,
the Hope of the hopeless,
the Saviour of the tempest-tost,
the Harbour of the voyager,
the Physician of the sick,
do Thou Thyself become all things to all men.
O Thou who knowest each man and his petition,
each house, and its need,
deliver, O LORD, this city,
and all the country in which we sojourn,
from plague, famine, earthquake, flood,
fire, sword, hostile invasion,
and civil war.
End the schisms of the Churches,
quench the haughty cries of the nations,
and receive us all into Thy kingdom,
acknowledging us as sons of light;
and Thy peace and love
vouchsafe to us, O LORD, our GOD.
Remember O LORD, our GOD,
all spirits and all flesh
which we have remembered, and which we have not.
And the close of our life,
LORD, LORD, direct in peace,

Christianly, acceptably, and, should it please Thee,
painlessly,
gathering us together under the feet of Thine elect,
when Thou wilt and how Thou wilt,
only without shame and sins.

The brightness of the LORD our GOD be upon us,
prosper Thou the work of our hands upon us,
O prosper Thou our handy work.

Be, LORD,
within me to strengthen me,
without me to guard me,
over sue to shelter me,
beneath me to stablsh me,
before me to guide me,
after me to forward me,
round about me to secure me.

(5) *Praise.*

Blessed art Thou, LORD, GOD of Israel,
our FATHER,
from everlasting to everlasting.

Thine, O LORD,
is the greatness and the power,
the triumph and the victory,
the praise and the strength,
for Thou rulest over all
in heaven and on earth.

At Thy face every king is troubled,
and every nation.

Thine, O LORD, is the kingdom
and the supremacy over all,
and over all rule.

With Thee is wealth, and glory is from Thy countenance;
Thou rulest over all, O LORD,
the Ruler of all rule;
and in Thine hand is strength and power,
and in Thine hand to give to all things
greatness and strength.

And now, LORD, we confess to Thee,
and we praise Thy glorious Name.

The Fifth Day

Introduction.

We are satisfied with Thy mercy, O LORD,
in the morning.

Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who broughtest forth from the water
creeping things of life,
and whales,
and winged fowl.

Be Thou exalted, O GOD, above the heavens,
and Thy glory above all the earth.

By Thy Ascension, O LORD,
draw us too after Thee,
that we savour of what is above,
not of things on the earth.

By the marvellous mystery
of the Holy Body and precious Blood,
on the evening of this day,
LORD, have mercy.

(1) Confession.

Thou who hast said,
"As I live, saith the LORD,
I will not the death of a sinner,
but that the ungodly return from his way
and live;

turn ye, turn ye from your wicked way,
for why will ye die, O house of Israel?"
turn us, O LORD, to Thee,
and so shall we be turned.

Turn us from all our ungodlinesses,
and let them not be to us for punishments.

I have sinned, I have committed iniquity, I have done wickedly,
from Thy precepts, and Thy judgments.

To Thee, O LORD, righteousness,
and to me confusion of face,
as at this day,

in our despicableness, wherewith Thou hast despised us.

LORD, to us confusion of face,
and to our rulers

who have sinned against Thee.

LORD, in all things is Thy righteousness,
unto all Thy righteousness;

let then Thine anger and Thy fury be turned away,
and cause Thy face to shine

upon Thy servant.
 O my God, incline Thine ear and hear,
 open Thine eyes and see my desolation.
 O LORD hear, O LORD forgive, O LORD hearken and do;
 defer not for Thine own sake, O my GOD,
 for Thy servant is called by Thy Name.
 In many things we offend all;
 LORD, let Thy mercy rejoice against Thy judgment
 in my sins.
 If I say I have no sin, I deceive myself,
 and the truth is not in me;
 but I confess my sins many and grievous,
 and Thou, O LORD, art faithful and just,
 to forgive me my sins when I confess them.
 Yea, for this too
 I have an Advocate with Thee to Thee,
 Thy Only-begotten SON, the Righteous.
 May He be the propitiation for my sins,
 who is also for the whole world.
 Will the LORD cast off for ever?
 and will He be no more intreated?
 Is His mercy clean gone for ever?
 and is His promise come utterly to an end for evermore?
 Hath GOD forgotten to be gracious?
 and will He shut up His loving kindness in displeasure?
 And I said, It is mine own infirmity;
 but I will remember the years of the right hand
 of the most Highest.

(2) *Prayer for grace.*

[Give me grace]
 to put aside every weight,
 and the sin that doth so easily beset us;
 all filthiness
 and superfluity of naughtiness,
 lust of the flesh, of the eyes,
 pride of life,
 every motion of flesh and spirit
 alienated from the will of Thy sanctity:
 to be poor in spirit,
 that I have a portion in the kingdom of heaven;
 to mourn, that I be comforted;
 to be meek, that I inherit the earth;
 to hunger and thirst for righteousness, that I be filled;
 to be pitiful, that I be pitied;
 to be pure in heart, that I see GOD;

to be a peace-maker that I be called the son of GOD;
to be prepared for persecutions and revilings
for righteousness' sake,
that my reward be in heaven,—
all this, grant to me, O LORD.

(3) Profession.

I, coming to GOD,
believe that He is,
and that He is a rewarder of them
that diligently seek Him.
I know that my Redeemer liveth,
that He is CHRIST, the SON of the Living GOD,
that He is truly the SAVIOUR of the world,
that He came into the world to save sinners,
of whom I am chief.

Through the grace of JESUS CHRIST
we believe that we shall be saved
like as our fathers.

I know that my skin shall rise up upon the earth,
which undergoes these things.

I believe to see the goodness of the LORD
in the land of the living.

Our heart shall rejoice in Him,
because we have hoped in His holy Name,
in the Name of the Father,
of the Saviour, Mediator, Intercessor, Redeemer,
of the two-fold Comforter,
under the figures of the Lamb and the Dove.
Let Thy merciful kindness, O LORD, be upon us,
like as we do put our trust in Thee.

(4) Intercession.

Let us beseech the LORD in peace,
for the heavenly peace,
and the salvation of our souls;—
for the peace of the whole world;
for the stability of GOD'S holy Churches,
and the union of them all;—
for this holy house,
and those who enter it with faith and reverence;
for our holy Fathers,
the honourable Presbytery, the Diaconate in CHRIST,
and all, both clergy and people;—
for this holy retreat, and all the city and country,
and all the faithful who dwell therein;—
for salubrious weather, fruitfulness of earth,

and peaceful times;—
 for voyagers, travellers,
 those who are in sickness, toil, and captivity,
 and for their salvation.
 Aid, save, pity, and preserve them,
 O GOD, in Thy grace.
 Making mention
 of the all-holy, undefiled, and more than blessed
 Mary, Mother of GOD and Ever-Virgin,
 with all saints,
 let us commend ourselves, and each other, and all our life,
 to CHRIST our GOD.
 To Thee, O LORD, for it is fitting,
 be glory, honour, and worship.
 The grace of our LORD, JESUS CHRIST,
 and the love of GOD,
 and the communion of the HOLY GHOST,
 be with me, and with all of us. Amen.
 I commend me and mine, and all that belongs to me,
 to Him who is able to keep me without falling,
 and to place me immaculate
 before the presence of His glory,
 to the only wise GOD and our SAVIOUR;
 to whom be glory and greatness,
 strength and authority,
 both now and for all ages. Amen.
 (5) *Praise.*
 O LORD, my LORD,
 for my being, life, reason,
 for nurture, protection, guidance,
 for education, civil rights, religion,
 for Thy gifts of grace, nature, fortune,
 for redemption, regeneration, catechising,
 for my call, recall, yea, many calls besides;
 for Thy forbearance, long-suffering, long long-suffering
 to me-ward,
 many seasons, many years, up to this time;
 for all good things received, successes granted me, good things done;
 for the use of things present,
 for Thy promise, and my hope
 of the enjoyment of good things to come;
 for my parents honest and good,
 teachers kind,
 benefactors never to be forgotten,
 religious intimates congenial,

hearers thoughtful,
friends sincere,
domestics faithful,
for all who have advantaged me
by writings, homilies, converse,
prayers, patterns, rebukes, injuries;
for all these, and all others
which I know, which I know not,
open, hidden,
remembered, forgotten,
done when I wished, when I wished not,
I confess to Thee and will confess, I bless Thee and will bless,
I give thanks to Thee and will give thanks,
all the days of my life.
Who am I, or what is my father's house,
that Thou shouldst look upon a dead dog,
the like of me?
What reward shall I give unto the LORD
for all the benefits which he hath done unto me?
What thanks can I recompense unto GOD,
for all He has spared and borne with me until now?
Holy, Holy, Holy,
worthy art Thou,
O LORD and our GOD, the Holy One,
to receive the glory, and the honour, and the power,
for Thou hast made all things,
and for thy pleasure they are,
and were created.

The Sixth Day

Introduction.

Early shall my prayer come before Thee.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who broughtest forth of the earth, wild beasts, cattle,
and all the reptiles,
for food, clothing, help;
and madest man after Thine image, to rule the earth,
and blessedst him.
The fore-counsel, fashioning hand,
breath of life, image of GOD,
appointment over the works,
charge to the Angels concerning him,
paradise.—
Heart, reins, eyes, ears, tongue, hands, feet,
life, sense, reason, spirit, free will, memory, conscience,
the revelation of GOD, writing of the law,
oracles of prophets, music of psalms,
instruction of proverbs, experience of histories,
worship of sacrifices.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
for Thy great and precious promise
on this day
concerning the Life-giving Seed,
and for its fulfilment in fulness of the times
at this day.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
for the holy passion
of this day.
O by thy salutary sufferings
on this day,
save us, O LORD.

(1) Confession.

I have withstood Thee, LORD,
but I return to Thee; (*Hosea.*)
for I have fallen by mine iniquity.
But I take with me words,
and I return unto Thee and say,
take away all iniquity and receive us graciously,
so will we render the calves of our lips.
Spare us, LORD, spare, (*Joel.*)
and give not Thine heritage to reproach,
to Thine enemies.
LORD, LORD, be propitious,

cease, I beseech Thee, (*Amos.*)
 by whom shall Jacob arise?
 for he is small.
 Repent, O LORD, for this,
 and this shall not be.
 While observing lying vanities (*Jonah.*)
 I forsook my own mercy,
 and am cast out of Thy sight.
 When my soul fainted within me,
 I remembered the LORD;
 yet will I look again toward Thy Holy Temple;
 Thou hast brought up my life from corruption.
 Who is a GOD like unto Thee, (*Micah.*)
 that pardoneth iniquity
 to the remnant of His heritage?
 He retaineth not His anger for ever,
 because He delighteth in mercy.
 Turn again and have compassion upon us, O LORD,
 subdue our iniquities,
 and cast all our sins into the depths of the sea,
 according to Thy truth, and according to Thy mercy.
 O LORD, I have heard thy speech and was afraid, (*Habakkuk.*)
 in wrath remember mercy.
 Behold me, LORD, clothed in filthy garments; (*Zechariah.*)
 behold Satan standing at my right hand;
 yet, O LORD, by the blood of Thy covenant,
 by the fountain opened for sin and for uncleanness,
 take away my iniquity,
 and cleanse me from my sin.
 Save me as a brand
 plucked out of the fire.
 Father, forgive me, for I knew not,
 truly I knew not, what I did
 in sinning against Thee.
 LORD, remember me
 when Thou comest in Thy kingdom.
 LORD, lay not mine enemies' sins to their charge,
 LORD, lay not my own to mine.
 By Thy sweat bloody and heavy,
 Thy soul in agony,
 Thy head crowned with thorns, bruised with staves,
 Thine eyes swimming with tears,
 Thine ears full of insults,
 Thy mouth moistened with vinegar and gall,
 Thy face dishonourably stained with spitting,

Thy neck weighed down with the burden of the cross,
Thy back ploughed with the wheals and gashes of the scourge,
Thy hands and feet stabbed through,
Thy strong cry, Eli, Eli,
Thy heart pierced with the spear,
the water and blood thence flowing,
Thy body broken,
Thy blood poured out,
LORD, forgive the offence of Thy servant,
and cover all his sins.
Turn away all Thy displeasure,
and turn Thyself from Thy wrathful indignation.
Turn me then, O GOD our SAVIOUR,
and let Thine anger cease from us.
Wilt Thou be displeased at us for ever,
and stretch out Thy wrath from one generation to another?
Wilt Thou not turn again and quicken us,
that Thy people may rejoice in Thee?
Show us Thy mercy, O LORD,
and grant us Thy salvation.

(2) *Prayer for grace.*

....
the works of the flesh,
adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lasciviousness,
idolatry, witchcraft,
enmities, strifes,
emulations, heats,
quarrels, parties,
heresies, envyings, murders,
drunkennesses, revellings, and such like.

....
the fruits of the SPIRIT,
love, joy, peace,
long-suffering, gentleness, goodness,
faith, meekness, temperance;
the spirit of wisdom, of understanding.
of counsel, of might,
of knowledge, of godliness,
of fear of the LORD:—
and the gifts of the SPIRIT,
the word of wisdom, of knowledge,
faith, gifts of healing, working of miracles,
prophecy, discerning of spirits,
kinds of tongues, interpretation of tongues.

May Thy strong hand, O LORD ⁴¹,
become my defence;
Thy mercy in CHRIST
my salvation;
Thy all-veritable word,
my instructor;
the grace of Thy life-bringing Spirit,
my consolation,
all along, and at last.
The Soul of CHRIST hallow me,
and the Body strengthen me,
and the Blood ransom me,
and the Water wash me,
and the Bruises heal me,
and the Sweat refresh me,
and the Wound hide me.
The peace of GOD
which passeth all understanding,
keep my heart and thoughts
in the knowledge and the love of GOD.

(3) *Profession.*

I believe
that Thou hast created me;
despise not the work of Thine own hands;—
that Thou madest me after Thine image and likeness,
suffer not Thy likeness to be blotted out;—
that Thou hast redeemed me in Thy blood,
suffer not the cost of that redemption to perish;
that Thou hast called me Christian after Thy name,
disdain not Thine own title;
that Thou hast hallowed me in regeneration,
destroy not Thy holy work;—
that Thou hast grafted me into the good olive tree,
the member of a mystical body;
the member of Thy mystical body
cut not off.

O think upon Thy servant as concerning Thy word,
wherein Thou hast caused me to put my trust.

My soul hath longed for Thy salvation,
and I have good hope because of Thy word.

(4) *Intercession.*

[I pray]
for the prosperous advance and good condition

⁴¹Vide p. 146, edit. 1675.

of all the Christian army,
against the enemies of our most holy faith;
for our holy fathers,
and all our brotherhood in CHRIST;
for those who hate and those who love us,
for those who pity and those who minister to us;
for those whom we have promised
to remember in prayer;
for the liberation of captives;
for our fathers and brethren absent;
for those who voyage by sea;
for those who lie in sickness.
Let us pray also for fruitfulness of the earth;
and for every soul of orthodox Christians.
Let us bless pious kings,
orthodox high-priests,
the founders of this holy retreat,
our parents,
and all our forefathers
and our brethren departed.

(5) *Praise.*

Thou who, on man's transgressing Thy command,
and falling,
didst not pass him by, nor leave him, GOD of goodness;
but didst visit in ways manifold,
as a tender Father,
supplying him with Thy great and precious promise,
concerning the Life-giving Seed,
opening to him the door of faith,
and of repentance unto life,
and in fulness of the times,
sending Thy CHRIST Himself
to take on Him the seed of Abraham;
and, in the oblation of His life,
to fulfil the Law's obedience;
and, in the sacrifice of His death,
to take off the Law's curse;
and, in His death,
to redeem the world;
and, in His resurrection,
to quicken it:—
O Thou, who doest all things,
whereby to bring again our race to Thee,
that it may be partaker
of Thy divine nature and eternal glory;

who hast borne witness
to the truth of Thy gospel
by many and various wonders,
in the ever-memorable converse of Thy saints,
in their supernatural endurance of torments,
in the overwhelming conversion of all lands
to the obedience of faith,
without might, or persuasion, or compulsion:—
Blessed be Thy Name,
and praised and celebrated,
and magnified, and high exalted,
and glorified, and hallowed;
its record, and its memory,
and every memorial of it,
both now and for evermore.
Worthy art Thou to take the book,
and to open the seals thereof,
for Thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to GOD
by Thy blood,
out of every kindred and tongue,
and people, and nation.
Worthy is the Lamb that was slain
to receive the power, and riches, and wisdom,
and strength, and honour, and glory, and blessing.
To Him that sitteth upon the Throne,
and to the Lamb,
be the blessing, and the honour, and the glory, and the might,
for ever and ever. Amen.
Salvation to our GOD, which sitteth upon the throne,
and to the Lamb.
Amen : the blessing and the glory and the wisdom,
and the thanksgiving and the honour,
and the power and the strength,
be unto our GOD,
for ever and ever,
Amen.

The Seventh Day

Introduction.

O LORD, be gracious unto us,
we have waited for Thee;
be Thou our arm every morning,
our salvation also in the time of trouble.
Blessed art Thou, O LORD,
who restedst on the seventh day
from all Thy works,
and blessedst and sanctifiedst it:
[concerning the Sabbath,
concerning the Christian rest instead of it,
concerning the funeral rites of CHRIST,
and the resting from sin,
concerning those who are already gone to rest.]

(1) Confession.

I am ashamed, and blush, O my GOD,
to lift up my face to Thee,
for mine iniquities are increased
over my head,
and my trespass is grown up unto the heavens;
since the days of youth
have I been in a great trespass
unto this day;
I cannot stand before Thee because of this.
My sins are more in number than the sand of the sea,
my iniquities are multiplied,
and I not worthy to look up
and see the height of heaven,
from the number of my unrighteousnesses;
and I have no relief,
because I have provoked Thine anger,
and done evil in Thy sight;
not doing Thy will,
not keeping Thy commandments.
And now my heart kneels to Thee,
beseeching Thy goodness.
I have sinned, O LORD, I have sinned,
and I know mine iniquities;
and I ask and beseech,
remit to me, O LORD, remit to me,
and destroy me not in mine iniquities;
nor be Thou angry for ever,
nor reserve evil for me;

nor condemn me
 in the lowest parts of the earth.
 Because Thou art GOD, the GOD of penitents,
 and Thou shalt show in me all Thy loving-kindness;
 for Thou shalt save me unworthy,
 according to Thy much pity,
 and I will praise Thee alway.
 LORD, if Thou wilt, Thou canst cleanse me;
 LORD, only say the word, and I shall be healed.
 LORD, save me;
 Carest Thou not that we perish?
 Say to me, Be of good cheer, thy sins are remitted to thee.
 JESU, Master, have mercy on me;
 Thou Son of David, JESU, have mercy on me;
 JESU, Son of David, Son of David.
 LORD, say to me, Ephphatha.
 LORD, I have no man ⁴²;
 LORD, say to me, be loosed from thine infirmity.
 Say unto my soul, I am thy salvation.
 Say unto me, My grace is sufficient for thee.
 LORD, how long wilt Thou be angry?
 shall Thy jealousy burn like fire for ever?
 O, remember not our old sins;
 but have mercy on us and that soon,
 for we are come to great misery;
 Help us, O GOD of our salvation;
 for the glory of Thy Name.
 O deliver us and be merciful unto our sins,
 for Thy Name's sake.
 (2) *Prayer for grace.*
 [O LORD, remit]
 all my failings, shortcomings, falls,
 offences, trespasses, scandals,
 transgressions, debts, sins,
 faults, ignorances, iniquities,
 impieties, unrighteousnesses, pollutions.
 The guilt of them,
 be gracious unto,
 remit,
 be propitious unto,
 impute not, pardon;
 forgive;
 spare;

⁴²John v. 7.

charge not, remember not.
 The stain,
 pass by,
 disregard,
 hide,
 blot out, pass over;
 overlook;
 wash away;
 cleanse.
 The hurt,
 remit,
 take off,
 abolish, heal,
 remove,
 annul, remedy;
 away with;
 disperse, annihilate;
 that they be not found, that they exist not.
 Supply
 to faith,
 to virtue,
 to knowledge,
 to continence,
 to patience,
 to godliness,
 to brotherly love, virtue;
 knowledge;
 continence;
 patience;
 godliness;
 brotherly love;
 charity.
 That I forget not my cleansing from my former sins,
 but give diligence to make my calling and election sure
 through good works.
 (3) *Profession.*
 I believe in Thee the FATHER;
 Behold then, if Thou a Father and we sons,
 as a father pitieth sons,
 be Thou of tender mercy towards us, O LORD.
 I believe in Thee, the LORD;
 behold Then, if Thou art LORD and we servants,
 our eyes are upon Thee our LORD,
 until Thou have mercy upon us.
 I believe, that though we be neither sons nor servants,

but dogs only,
 yet we have leave to eat of the crumbs
 that fall from Thy Table.
 I believe that CHRIST is the Lamb of GOD;
 O Lamb of GOD that takest away the sins of the world,
 take Thou away mine.
 I believe that JESUS CHRIST came into the world
 to save sinners;
 Thou who earnest to save sinners
 save Thou me, of sinners
 chief and greatest.
 I believe that CHRIST came to save what was lost;
 Thou who earnest to save the lost,
 never suffer, O LORD, that to be lost which Thou hast saved.
 I believe that the SPIRIT is the Lord and Giver of life;
 Thou who gavest me a living soul,
 give me that I receive not my soul in vain.
 I believe that the SPIRIT gives grace
 in His sacred things;
 give me that I receive not His grace in vain,
 nor hope of His sacred things.
 I believe that the SPIRIT intercedes for us
 with plaints unutterable;
 grant me of His intercession and those plaints
 to partake, O LORD.
 Our fathers hoped in Thee,
 they trusted in Thee, and Thou didst deliver them.
 They called upon Thee and were holpen,
 they put their trust in Thee, and were not confounded.
 As Thou didst our fathers
 in the generations of old,
 so also deliver us, O LORD,
 who trust in Thee.
 (4) *Intercession.*
 O Heavenly KING,
 confirm our faithful kings,
 stablish the faith,
 soften the nations,
 pacify the world,
 guard well this holy retreat,
 and receive us in orthodox faith and repentance,
 as a kind and loving Lord.
 The power of the FATHER guide me,
 the wisdom of the SON enlighten me,
 the working of the SPIRIT quicken me.

Guard Thou my soul,
stablish my body,
elevate my senses,
direct my converse,
form my habits,
bless my actions,
fulfil my prayers,
inspire holy thoughts,
pardon the past,
correct the present,
prevent the future.

(5) *Praise.*

Now unto Him that is able to do
exceeding abundantly
above all that we ask or think,
according to the power that worketh in us.
to Him be glory
in the Church in CHRIST
unto all generations
world without end. Amen.

Blessed, and praised, and celebrated,
and magnified, and exalted, and glorified, and hallowed,
be Thy Name, O LORD,
its record, and its memory,
and every memorial of it;
for the all-honourable senate of the Patriarchs,
the ever-venerable band of the Prophets,
the all-glorious college of the Apostles,
the Evangelists,
the all-illustrious army of the Martyrs,
the Confessors,
the assembly of Doctors,
the Ascetics,
the beauty of Virgins,
for Infants the delight of the world,—
for their faith,
their labours,
their blood,
their diligence,
their purity,
their hope,
their truth,
their zeal,
their tears,
their beauty.

Glory to Thee, O LORD, glory to Thee,
glory to Thee who didst glorify them,
among whom we too glorify Thee.
Great and marvellous are Thy works,
LORD, the GOD ALMIGHTY;
just and true are Thy ways,
O King of Saints.
Who shall not fear Thee, O LORD,
and glorify Thy Name?
for Thou only art holy.
for all the nations shall come and worship before Thee,
for Thy judgments are made manifest.
Praise our GOD, all ye His servants,
and ye that fear Him,
both small and great.
Alleluia,
for the LORD GOD Omnipotent reigneth;
let us be glad and rejoice, and give honour to Him.
Behold the tabernacle of GOD is with men,
and He will dwell with them;
and they shall be His people,
and GOD Himself shall be with them,
and shall wipe away all tears from their eyes.
And there shall be no more death;
neither crying, neither pain any more,
for the former things are passed away.

Deprecations

1.

O LORD ⁴³, Thou knowest, and canst, and willest
the good of my soul.
Miserable man am I;
I neither know, nor can, nor, as I ought,
will it.
Thou, O LORD, I beseech Thee,
in Thine ineffable affection,
so order concerning me,
and so dispose,
as Thou knowest to be most pleasing to Thee,
and most good for me.
[Thine is]
goodness, grace;
love, kindness;
benignity, gentleness, consideration;
forbearance, long suffering;
much pity, great pity;
mercies, multitude of mercies, yearnings of mercies;
kind yearnings, deep yearnings;
in passing over,
in overlooking, in disregarding;
many seasons, many years;
[punishing] unwillingly, not willingly;
not to the full,
not correspondently,
in wrath remembering mercy,
repenting of the evil,
compensating doubly,
ready to pardon,
to be reconciled,
to be appeased.

2. Litany

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FATHER, the Creator,
SON, the Redeemer,
SPIRIT, the Regenerator,
destroy me not,

⁴³Vide p. 92, edit. 1675.

⁴⁴Page 180, edit. 1675.

whom Thou hast created, redeemed, regenerated.
 Remember not, LORD, my sins,
 nor the sins of my forefathers;
 neither take vengeance for our sins, theirs, nor mine.
 Spare us, LORD, them and me ⁴⁵,
 spare Thy people,
 and, among Thy people, Thy servant,
 who is redeemed with Thy precious blood;
 and be not angry with us for ever.
 Be merciful, be merciful; spare us, LORD,
 and be not angry with us for ever.
 Be merciful, be merciful; have pity on us, LORD,
 and be not angry with us to the full.
 Deal not, O LORD,
 deal not with me after mine iniquities,
 neither recompense me according to my sins;
 but after Thy great pity,
 deal with me,
 and according to the multitude of Thy mercies,
 recompense me;
 after that so great pity,
 and that multitude of mercies,
 as Thou didst to our fathers
 in the times of old:—
 by all that is dear unto Thee.
 From all evil and adversity,
 in all time of need;
 from this evil and this adversity,
 in this time;
 raise me, rescue me, save me, O LORD.
 Deliver me, O LORD,
 and destroy me not.
 On the bed of sickness;
 in the hour of death;
 in the day of judgment,
 in that dreadful and fearful day,

⁴⁵Thus in St. Gregory's Sacramentary.—"Præsta, quæsumus, omnipotens Deus, ut animam famuli, &c. . . . in congregatione iustorum æternæ beatitudinis jubeas esse consortem. Per Dominum, &c." "Præsta, &c. ut animam, &c. ab angelis lucis susceptam in præparata habitacula deduci facias beatorum. Per Dominum, &c." "Suscipe, Domine, preces nostras, pro anima famuli tui ... ut si quæ ei maculæ de terrenis contagiis adhæserunt, remissionis tuæ remedio deleantur." For similar language in the second century vide Ussher as quoted in Tract 72.

rescue me, LORD, and save me;—
 from seeing the Judge's face overcast,
 from being placed on the left,
 from hearing the dreadful word, Depart from Me,
 from being bound in chains of darkness,
 from being cast into the outer darkness,
 from being tormented in the pit of fire and brimstone,
 where the smoke of the torments
 ascendeth for ever.
 Be merciful, be merciful,
 spare us, pity us,
 O LORD:
 and destroy us not for ever,
 deliver and save us.
 Let it not be, O LORD; and that it be not,
 take away from me, O LORD,
 hardness of heart,
 desperateness after sinning,
 blindness of heart,
 contempt of Thy threats,
 a cauterized conscience,
 a reprobate mind,
 the sin against the HOLY GHOST,
 the sin unto death,
 the four crying sins ⁴⁶;
 the six which forerun ⁴⁷
 the sin against the HOLY GHOST.
 Deliver me
 from all ills and abominations of this world,
 from plague, famine, and war;
 earthquake, flood, and fire,
 the stroke of immoderate rain and drought,
 blast and blight;
 thunder, lightning and tempest;
 epidemic sickness, acute and malignant,
 unexpected death;
 from ills and difficulties in the Church,
 from private interpretation,
 from innovation in things sacred,
 from heterodox teaching;

⁴⁶Wilful murder, the sin of Sodom, oppressing the poor, defrauding workmen of their wages.

⁴⁷Despair of salvation, presumption of God's mercy, impugning known truth, envy at another's grace, obstinacy in sin, and impenitence.

from unhealthy inquiries and interminable disputes,
 from heresies, schisms, scandals,
 public and private,
 from making gods ⁴⁸ of kings,
 from flattering of the people,
 from the indifference of Saul,
 from the scorn of Michal,
 from the greediness of Hophni,
 from the plunder of Athaliah,
 from the priesthood of Micah,
 from the brotherhood of Simon and Judas,
 from the doctrine of men unlearned and unestablished,
 from the pride of novices,
 from the people resisting the priest:—
 from ills and difficulties in the state,
 from anarchy, many rulers, tyranny,
 from Asher, Jeroboam, Rehoboam, Gallio, Haman,
 the profligacy of Ahithophel,
 the foolishness of Zoan ⁴⁹,
 the statutes of Omri,
 the justice of Jezebel,
 the overflowings of Belial ⁵⁰,
 the courage of Peor,
 the valley of Achor,
 pollution of blood or seed,
 incursion of enemies,
 civil war,
 bereavement of good governors,
 accession of evil and unprincipled governors;
 from an intolerable life,

⁴⁸[*Tēs apothēōseōs*], vid. Acts xii. 22. Mr. Waller “going to see the king at dinner, overheard a very extraordinary conversation between his Majesty [King James] and two prelates, the Bishop of Winchester [Andrews] and Dr. Neale, Bishop of Durham, who were standing behind the king’s chair. His majesty asked the bishops, ‘My lords, cannot I take my subjects’ money when I want it, without all this formality in parliament?’ The Bishop of Durham readily answered, ‘God forbid, Sir, but you should; you are the breath of our nostrils.’ Whereupon the king turned and said to the Bishop of Winchester, ‘Well, my lord, what say you?’ ‘Sir,’ replied the bishop, ‘I have no skill to judge of Parliamentary cases.’ The king answered, ‘No put-off’s, my lord, answer me presently.’ ‘Then, Sir,’ said he, ‘I think it lawful for you to take my brother Neale’s money, for he offers it.’”—Waller’s Life, quoted in Biograph. Brit.

⁴⁹Isai. xix.

⁵⁰Ps. xviii. 4.

in despondence, sickness, ill-fame,
distress, peril, slavery, restlessness:
from death
in sin, shame, tortures,
desperateness, defilement, violence, treachery;
from death unexpected,
from death eternal.

Forms of Intercession

1.

51

For all creatures,
men,
persons compassed
with infirmity,
Churches
Catholic,
Eastern,
Western,
British.
The Episcopate,
Presbytery,
clergy,
Christian people.
States
of the whole earth,
Christian,
neighbouring,
our own,
Rulers,
kings,
religious kings,
our own,
councillors,
judges,
nobles,
soldiers,
sailors,
the people,
the rising generation,
schools,
those at court,
in cities,
the country.
Those who serve the soul;
those who serve the body,
in food,
clothing,
health,
necessaries.

⁵¹Vide p. 90, edit. 1675.

[Those who have a claim on
my prayers,]
in nature,
by benefits,
from trust,
formerly or now,
in friendship,
in love,
in neighbourhood;
from promise,
from mutual offices,
from want of leisure,
from destitution,
from extremity.

2.

52

Thy whole creation,
our whole race,
the states of the world,
the Catholic Church,
the separate Churches,
the separate states,
our Church,
our state,
the orders in each,
the persons in the orders,
the world,
the inhabited earth,
the Christian religion,
our country,
the priesthood,
the person of the King, of the Prince,
the City,
the parish in which I was baptized, All Hallows, Barking.
My two schools,
my University,
my College,
the parish committed to me, St. Giles's,
the three Churches
of Southwell,
St. Paul's,
Westminster;

⁵²Page 170, edit. 1675.

the three Dioceses of Chichester,
Eli,
Winton,
my home,
my kindred
those who show me pity,
those who minister to me;
my neighbours,
my friends,
those who have a claim on me.

3.

53

The creation,
the race of man,
all in affliction and in prosperity,
in error,
in sin, and in truth,
and in grace;
the Church Ecumenical,
Eastern, Western, our own,
Rulers, Clergy, people.
States of the earth,
Christian, neighbouring, our own,
the King, the Queen, the Prince,
the nobles.
Parliament, Law Courts, army, police.
The Commons,
farmers, merchants, artisans,
down to mean workmen,
and poor.
Those who have a claim on me,
from kindred,
benefaction,
ministration of things temporal,
charge formerly or now,
natural kindness,
Christian love,
neighbourhood,
promise on my part,
their own desire,
their lack of leisure,
sympathy for their extreme misery;

⁵³Page 206, edit. 1675.

any good work,
any noble action,
any scandal from me,
having none to pray for them.

4.

54

World,
Church
throne,
Council-chamber,
schools,
Infants,
the grown,
men,
aged,
The possessed,
sick,
orphans,
foreigners,
travellers,
with child
in bitter bondage,
overladen.
earth inhabited.
kingdom,
altar.
law courts,
work-places.
boys,
youths,
elderly,
decrepit.
weak-hearted,
prisoners,
widows,
voyagers,
who give suck,
in desolateness,

⁵⁴Page 210, edit. 1675.

Meditations

1. On Christian Duty

What shall I do that I may inherit eternal life?
Keep the commandments. *Mark* x. 17.
What shall we do?
Repent and be baptized every one of you. *Acts* ii. 37, 38.
What must I do to be saved?
Believe on the LORD JESUS CHRIST. *Acts* xvi. 31.
What shall we do then?
(*To the multitude.*) He who hath two coats, let him impart to him that hath none.
He that hath meat, let him do likewise.
(*To the publicans.*) Exact no more than is appointed you.
(*To soldiers.*) Do violence to no man; neither accuse any falsely;
be content with your wages. *Luke* iii. 10-14.
The knowledge and faith
of [GOD'S] justice [GOD'S] mercy
[leads] unto
fear,
abasement,
repentance,
fasting,
prayers,
patience,
a sacrifice ⁵⁵, hope,
consolation,
thanksgiving,
almsgiving,
hymns,
obedience,
an oblation.

2. On the Day of Judgment

FATHER Unoriginate, Only-begotten SON,
Life-giving SPIRIT,
merciful, pitiful, long-suffering,
full of pity, full of kind yearnings,
who lovest the just and pitiest the sinful,
who passest by sins and grantest petitions,

⁵⁵E.g. Concede nobis, Domine Deus noster, ut hæc hostia salutaris, et nostrorum fiat purgatio delictorum, et tuæ propitiatio Majestatis, per, &c.—St. Gregory's Lib. Sacrament. p. 57.

GOD of penitents,
SAVIOUR of sinners,
I have sinned before Thee, O LORD,
and thus and thus have I done.
Alas, alas! woe, woe.
How was I enticed by my own lust!
How I hated instruction!
Nor felt I fear nor shame
at Thy incomprehensible glory,
Thy awful presence,
Thy fearful power,
Thy exact justice,
Thy winning goodness.
I will call if there be any that will answer me;
to which of the Saints shall I turn?
O wretched man that I am,
who shall deliver me from the body of this death?
how fearful is Thy judgment, O LORD?
when the thrones are set
and Angels stand around,
and men are brought in,
the books opened,
the works inquired into,
the thoughts examined
and the hidden things of darkness.
What judgment shall be upon me?
who shall quench my flame?
who shall lighten my darkness,
if Thou pity me not?
LORD, as Thou art loving,
give me tears,
give me floods, give me today.
For then will be the incorruptible Judge,
the horrible judgment-seat,
the answer without excuses,
the inevitable charges,
the shameful punishment,
the endless Gehenna,
the pitiless Angels,
the yawning hell,
the roaring stream of fire,
the unquenchable flame,
the dark prison,
the rayless darkness,
the bed of live coals,

the unwearied worm,
the indissoluble chains,
the bottomless chaos,
the impassable wall,
the inconsolable cry,
none to stand by me,
none to plead for me,
none to snatch me out.
But I repent, LORD, O LORD, I repent,
help Thou mine impenitence,
and more, and still more,
pierce, rend, crush my heart.
Behold, O LORD, that I am
indignant with myself,
for my senseless, profitless,
hurtful, perilous passions;
that I loathe myself,
for these inordinate, unseemly,
deformed, insincere,
shameful, disgraceful
passions,
that my confusion is daily before me,
and the shame of my face hath covered me.
Alas! woe, woe—
O me, how long?
Behold, LORD, that I sentence myself
to punishment everlasting,
yea, and all miseries of this world.
Behold me, LORD, self-condemned;
Behold, LORD, and enter not into judgment with Thy servant.
And now, LORD,
I humble myself under Thy mighty hand,
I bend to Thee, O LORD, my knees,
I fall on my face to the earth.
Let this cup pass from me!
I stretch forth my hands unto Thee;
I smite my breast, I smite on my thigh.
Out of the deep my soul crieth unto Thee,
as a thirsty land;
and all my bones,
and all that is within me.
LORD, hear my voice.

3. On Human Frailness

Have mercy on me, LORD, for I am weak;
remember, LORD, how short my time is;
remember that I am but flesh,
a wind that passeth away, and cometh not again.
My days are as grass, as a flower of the field;
for the wind goeth over me, and I am gone,
and my place shall know me no more.
I am dust and ashes,
earth and grass,
flesh and breath,
corruption and the worm,
a stranger upon the earth,
dwelling in a house of clay,
few and evil my days,
today, and not tomorrow,
in the morning, yet not until night,
in a body of sin,
in a world of corruption,
of few days, and full of trouble,
coming up, and cut down like a flower,
and as a shadow, having no stay.
Remember this, O LORD, and suffer, remit;
what profit is there in my blood,
when I go down to the pit?
By the multitude of Thy mercies,
by the richness and excessive redundance
of Thy pity;
by all that is dear to Thee,
all that we should plead,
and before and beyond all things, by Thyself,
by Thyself, O LORD, and by Thy CHRIST.
LORD, have mercy upon me, the chief of sinners.
O my LORD, let Thy mercy rejoice
against Thy judgment in my sin.
O LORD, hear, O LORD, forgive,
O LORD, hearken,
O LORD, hearken and do,
do and defer not for Thine own sake,
defer not, O LORD my GOD.